

The Legendarium of Rodos

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The Legendarium of Rodos

*being the Five Books of the island, the Annals of its years,
the Appendices, and a Gazetteer of its towns*

as they are kept in the Library at Muileann chaol
and told at the hearths of the island

Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann.

We did not come; we were here.

cut on the column at Cnoc ghorm

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THE FIRST BOOK

AN AOIS ÀRSÀIDH

the Ancient Age

12,999 – 3,001 BDE

Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann. We did not come; we were here.
— cut on the column at Cnoc ghorm

I

Of the Crack in the Stone

Before the kings and before the keepers, before any mouth had spoken the name of the island, there was the stone; and in the stone there was the vein; and the vein was dark, and no one knew of it.

So the old tellings begin, and the scribes of Muileann chaol begin their first book with them, for they have nothing older to set in their place. In this age there are no letters and no treaties. There are hearths under turf and shell-heaps on the headlands, stones cut with signs that no one can read, and the tellings of a people who would not be written down for thousands of years. The Ancient Age kept no calendar that anyone has found.

The library writes the first day as 20 am Faoilleach 12,923 BDE. In the hill country it is only "once", and the tale is told at the hearth in the dark of the year by whoever is oldest in the house. It goes like this.

A mason was sinking a well. He had been at it since first light, with a wedge of hard stone and a maul of oak, splitting the rock a hand's depth at a time and lift-

ing the pieces out. It was the dead of the year. The rain hung over the heather and would not fall, and his hands were raw from the wet stone.

He set the wedge in a seam and struck. The rock broke, and it broke along a line he had not seen.

Out of every stone he had ever split there had come grey dust and grit, the same dust his father had shaken from his hair. Here the break showed black, a vein as glossy as a raven's wing, and out of it welled colour. It seeped into the wet of the cut the way blood comes into a scratch, slowly and then more, red at the edge and deeper than red at the heart.

The tellers do not give the mason a name. What he said, if he said anything, they do not give either. They say only that he stopped.

Of all the tales on Rodos this is the nearest to a tale of the making of the world. Other peoples begin with a sea, or a void, or a god who speaks. The Ròdaich begin with a man at work, and a thing that answered him as stone should never answer. The gods of the Old Faith have tellings of their own, and many of them; none of the gods comes into this one.

Three wells claim the crack. Tobar dhìreach, Tobar dhubh and Tobar òg each keep a telling that the mason's well was theirs. Tobar dhìreach can show a capped shaft with a dark stain on its lip; the other two can show only the telling. The library holds all three claims and chooses none.

On what the mason's people did next, every telling agrees. They dug no further. They laid a flat stone over the broken vein, and would draw no water beside it, and cut their well again a stone's throw away. Of all the deeds of the Ancient Age this is the one told most often, to children and to kings, and it is told the same way every time: the people found a wonder in the ground, and they covered it.

II

Of the Waters and the Woods

In those years Rodos was another shape. The snowfields on the central mountains were shrinking, and their meltwater cut the bed that Abhainn uaine follows still; its gravel terraces hold hearth-stones at three heights, each left as the water came up to it. In the bog beneath Doire ghlas the birch and pine of the colder years gave way to oak and hazel.

At Achadh dhìreach lie the first hearths of the high valleys: pine and heather charcoal, scrapers of grey flint, the split bones of red deer. Nothing in them is black glass. Whoever sat at them either had none of the ore or would not burn it.

And the sea rose. It drowned the low neck that joined Eilean dhubh to the main island, and the island's deer, cut off, grew smaller in the lifetimes after. Out on Eilean mhin seal-hunters pitched their camps a season at a time, reached by boat, and that is the first sure sign that anyone on Rodos crossed open water on purpose. Abhainn ìseal, the longest river of the island, settled into its broad bed, and weirs of hazel were staked across its side channels, and the stakes were renewed in the same holes for generations.

These are small things. A people who leave no words leave their fires, their weirs and their bones, and whoever would know them must learn to read those.

III

Of the Seann-Dhaoine

At Seann Dunn there is a mound taller than a man, made of limpet shell and seal bone and burnt weed, laid down over many lifetimes. It is the first sure trace of the **Seann-Dhaoine**, the Old Ones; and no tool in it is shaped as any later Ròdach shaped a tool.

What they called themselves is lost. The name they bear was given afterward, by others, and means only that they were before. Yet they held the shores of Rodos longer than the Ròdaich have held their kingdom.

Of them it is told that at Seann Chwen they sank their nets with beach stones, and every stone was notched with the same three strokes, the earliest mark on Rodos made again and again on purpose. At Seann Skell they laid a mole of unmortared boulders out into the river, and every quay wall built there since stands upon it. At Seann Bhral they cut two hundred and twelve steps up the cliff from the shingle to the grazing, and the treads are worn hollow in the middle; no one has counted how many feet that took. At Seann Toll they cut a channel into a river pool with a slot for a gate of wattle, and the slot is still sharp. At Seann Warr they laid a road of crushed shell across the reed marsh, a forearm above the reeds, and it is the first made road on the island that can still be walked. At Seann Mhorn they built seven fish-kilns to dry the catch over peat smoke, the first buildings on Rodos raised for a trade. At Seann Bhrenn they laid long ramps of stone

into the water, wide enough for hulls bigger than any hide boat. The hulls are gone, and so is any tale of where they went.

At Seann Tarr they cut rows of signs into the cliff. It is the script that turns up later on the standing stones. It is no Ròdais, and it has never been read, and not one sign of it has an agreed meaning.

The Seann-Dhaoine of Seann Vell rowed their dead out to Eilean dhearg and laid them in stone boxes that face the mainland. Forty have been counted. No grave of theirs on the mainland from that time has been found. So the dead of the Old Ones were set to look back across the water at the living.

Their works went up on every coast. Platforms on oak piles stood out in the shallows of Loch chrom, though whether the Old Ones raised them or some other people the timbers do not tell. Below the southern Seann Dunn the ribs of a stranded whale were raised as the frames of round houses. At the eastern Seann Vell there are fourteen house-rings of dry stone. At the north-western Seann Skell stands a hollow-walled tower with a stair in the thickness of its wall, looking over the water where the Sea-Watcher would later be seen. There was a second Seann Mhorn, a headland of oyster and whelk whose lowest oysters are larger than any taken there since, and a second Seann Bhrenn far to the north-east with the same ramps; whether one people built both or the name was carried, none can say. At the eastern Seann Tarr a long house was built into a cleft of the cliff, and the rock behind its hearth is black with soot to the height of a man.

At their height, in 9054 BDE, they held every coast: the ten places whose names begin with *Seann*, and the islands off them, and their greatest landing was Seann Skell on the Abhainn naomh, where the mole already stood. At the warm springs of Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh they set stone basins, and the bones buried nearby show old breaks that knitted clean. That is the first place on Rodos where the sick were brought to be made well. Let it be remembered of them also.

IV

Of the Three Ruins and the Deep Shafts

The three centuries that began in 10,400 BDE saw as many works and wonders as any stretch of the age. The tellings hold them together as one time, when great works went up inland and great fears came in from the sea.

On a spur above the ground where Cathair mhòr now stands a walled outpost was raised, which later tongues called Làrach an Dùin-fhaire. Its stones are dressed on the outer face only, and its one gate faces inland, away from the sea. A greater work went up on the height near Ceann mhin: three rings of wall, a cistern cut in the bedrock, and room for four hundred people with their beasts. That is Làrach an Dùin, and whether the outpost's builders raised it too has never been settled. Near Àth fhionn run stretches of a kerbed track, a cart's width and paved with flat slabs, heading toward both; it is the only road the Seann-Dhaoine are known to have built away from the shore.

In the eastern hills a stepped platform was built with an altar block on its top step, and the altar was set square to the central mountains. That is Làrach an Teampaill. Every later temple on Rodos faces some other way. Seers have said since that it faces the vein under the mountains; each who hears it may join the two or leave them apart.

At the eastern Toll-dubh a shaft was sunk straight down through the rock, its walls tooled smooth as far as a lamp can show, and no spoil heap lies beside it. Whatever was taken out of it was carried away, or nothing was. Across the island, at the western Toll-dubh, a second shaft of the same make was cut. Stones thrown into either are never heard to land.

None of these works lasted. The single gate of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire was blocked with rubble from the inside; whoever did it left by another way, or never left. The outpost stood empty, and was a ruin already when the first sure chronicles begin. The cistern of Làrach an Dùin was found choked with the bones of cattle thrown in whole, and no one drew from it again, and the fortress was left in the same state and the same mystery. The top stone of the altar at Làrach an Teampaill was prised off and carried away. The sockets are still sharp. The stone has never been found. Then the temple too was left.

After the high places were given up, every new work of the Seann-Dhaoine lay within sight of salt water, and the middens at the southern Seann Chwen grew as fast as those of Seann Dunn once had. It is as if a people went up into the hills, and built, and were turned back, and came down to the shore and stayed there. That is how the tellers put it, and the stones neither agree nor argue.

Long after, in the days of the Stone Kings, the people of the south-east plaited a rope of hide and brought a youth to the lip of the eastern shaft. The wind came up out of the hole, cool and smelling of wet stone, and lifted the hair from his

brow as he sat on the edge with the rope knotted under his arms. He had a lamp of fat in a hollowed stone, and he sat looking down into the dark.

They let him go hand over hand, the men braced with their heels in the turf and the hide creaking through their fists. The lamp went down and grew small, a pin of light on the smooth wall, and then the dark closed over it and there was only the rope going out. The rope ran out to its last knot, and they held it there, and it hung straight and heavy and gave no sign.

Then it jerked twice, and they hauled.

He came up alive. His lamp was out and his face was the colour of ash. They asked him, and he shook his head. He never said what was at the bottom, not then and not in all the years he lived; and after him no one went down again in that age.

V

Of the Sea-Watcher and the Hollow Man

In those same years the fears of Rodos were born, and two of them have never left it.

Among the coastal families of the Tuathaich, in a far later age, there lives a fragment of a voyaging tale, with a named steersman and a first crossing, which they call the First Canoe. It is the voyage of Naomh Breandan, the saint of their Church, who put out west with his monks and came to the Isle of the Blessed; the families who keep it hold that the isle was Rodos, and set the landing in this age. The druids of the Old Faith call it superstition, and it was put down and is half-remembered; yet it belongs here, at the beginning of boats. What is sure is smaller. Below Ceann mhòr, in the tidal mud, lie a row of mooring stakes and a scrap of stitched hide, the first sure boats of the north-west coast. Who rowed them, and from where, the mud does not say.

On 1 an t-Sultain 9952 BDE the Sea-Watcher was first sighted. Old sailors of the north-west speak of a creature vaster than any whale in the water off that coast, and add, before anyone else can, that no wreck has ever been raised to prove them wrong. On the headland where Taigh-solais Baile chrom now stands a fire was kept, and its ash lies a man's height deep. The tellings say it burned to turn boats away from the Watcher's water. The beacon-keepers' word to the boats is kept at Baile chrom:

Tionndaidh air ais. Chan ann dbutsa an t-uisce seo. Turn back. This water is not for you.

A telling of that coast counts seven boats gone from Ros ruadh in one calm season, with no storm to blame; that was the first loss laid at the Watcher's door by name. After it the seal-bone thins in the middens of the north-west, and the middens at Caol mhòr and Cuan bheag grow. The hunters were working the southern sides of the headlands now, out of sight of the open sea.

Inland the rock faces of the Doire uaine hills are cut with writing, more than anywhere else on the island, in lines that run for yards; and some of the lines are cut over and defaced by the same kind of tool that cut them. The tellings say they speak of something that walked without breathing and fell upon anyone who lit a fire in its sight. This is the Hollow Man of Doire uaine. How a thing written in an unread script came to be known at all, no one has ever explained; yet known it is, in every house of those hills.

After the writing, the hearths of those hills changed. Fires were dug into pits and roofed with slabs, and no open hearth showed on those slopes for many lifetimes. The people stayed. They hid their light. At the hill camp later built over by Muileann chiar nine people lie where they fell inside a hut, beside a hearth of fresh ash, and no wound has been found on any bone. The hut was never reopened, and no one was buried from it.

The fear did not pass. Long after, a herding family new to the hills lit an open fire at Doire uaine against the custom, and their hut was found empty with the fire still burning in it. After that the custom was kept harder.

Later again, two herders were driving beasts home past the Doire uaine hills when the light went. They had stayed too long at the far pasture. Neither had flint or tinder out, for they were hill-bred and would sooner have walked blind; and so they went on in the half-dark with the beasts crowding at their heels.

The younger saw it first and caught the other's arm. Up on the ridge, against the last grey of the sky, a figure was walking, upright and unhurried, along the crest. They watched it for as long as a man might count a score. It was cold enough that the herders' breath hung in clouds before them. Above the walker on the ridge nothing hung at all.

They did not run, for running is noise. They stood among the cattle with their hands over their mouths until the figure passed over the crest. At home they

would not let the fire be uncovered until full day. They had no fire lit on the path, the telling says, and that is why they lived.

So the covered hearth spread from the Doire uaine hills to every settlement round Muileann chiar, and the rule that no open fire is lit on those slopes after dark begins there. Mothers in that country still say:

Na las teine far am faic e thu. Light no fire where it can see you.

VI

Of the Groves and the Beasts

A forest near Muileann chiar was hallowed long before any order of the Old Faith laid claim to it: Coille Naomh Muileann chiar. The trees understood, the old telling goes, before the people did. The charcoal in the hearths around it comes from every wood but that one; the families at its edge carried their fuel a half-day's walk rather than cut a branch within it. There, at the edge of the trees, three hunters once saw a white stag, and none of them drew. The stag comes back in the tellings of every age after. The druid schools of later days hold it to be the white stag of Flidais, lady of the deer and the wild; the tellings of this age give it no god at all.

A second forest, older in its feeling than the first, was never settled, never felled, never fully walked: Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag. Paths lead toward it from three sides, and all three end at a low line of set stones short of the trees. Nothing is worn beyond the stones. Lifetimes later a child of Cnoc bheag went past the line and was never found, and the searchers stopped at the stones. The telling does not blame them. The hearths of that country say the sith took the child, the people of the hills and mounds, whose country begins where the worn paths end.

Near Doire fhionn the red deer were driven down lines of stake and brush into a gully, and the antlers of the greatest stags were stacked apart. At Cnoc fhionn dogs were buried beside people, each with a shell at its head, the first beasts given graves on Rodos; and long after, at Tobar fhiadhaich, wolves were laid in the ground on their sides like people. The grey geese of Eilean ghorm come into the tellings in these years. They come with the first storm and leave with the last, and they are never hunted there.

In 7773 BDE a thing was first marked that no one has since explained: the great cats of the island cross the mountains by fixed roads at fixed seasons. These are the panther roads. The hill-folk learned the cats' timing and kept off the passes while they crossed. A party of eleven from the southern shore went up near Cnoc àrsaidh in the crossing season and did not come back, and their bones were found years afterward along the line the cats still use. The households at Baile dhomhain came to cut a sign on their gateposts at the start of the crossing and scrape it off at the end, the first mark on Rodos made for a season. Herders from Muileann bhàn who drove cattle into the passes out of season lost thirty head in a night and came down with nothing. And once the cats came down the road near Imrich nam Pantar and turned back at the foothills. The hill-folk took it for a sign, and stored double; and the winter was hard.

VII

Of the Hill-Folk and the Three Stones

In the high valleys around the crack there lived people who were of another kind from the Seann-Dhaoine. They buried their dead in the ground, and cut no script. Whether they shared the island with the Old Ones or came after them, no telling knows. Their own answer, given later, is that they were always there. These are the hill-folk, and from them came the Ròdaich. They left the green mounds of the valleys unbroken, and built on none of them, and the hearths of every later age give the same reason: the sìth live in the hills and the mounds, and a house on a mound is a house on someone else's roof.

At Àth gharbh, in a hearth of plain peat ash, lies a sliver of black glass burnt to a bead, and the hearthstone round it is stained through with colour. It is the earliest burning of the ore anyone has found. It is also small: one sliver, one fire. In the graves at Achadh dhìreach is wool streaked with colour no plant makes, for the hill-folk rubbed broken ore into cloth for their dead, one grave in some thirty. And far off on the western coast, in a midden at Seann Bhral, lies a chip of the ore still staining the shell around it. How a piece of the vein came to a rubbish-heap of the Old Ones, by gift or trade or theft, is anyone's guess.

Then the stones were raised; and the Ròdaich hold them holier than any temple.

The first is Carragh Cnoc bheag. On its upper face runs a line of the unread script, and lower down, cut with a narrower tool by another hand, are four words of Ròdais:

Bha teine sa chloich. There was fire in the stone.

When that second hand came, the stone does not say.

The second is Colbh Cnoc chlar, and it carries two words only:

Cuimhnich an teine. Remember the fire.

No one has ever explained the command. The ground round it is trodden hard in a ring paved with fire-cracked stones, where hearth-sized fires were kept again and again, and nothing else was left.

The third is Calbh Cnoc ghorm, and it carries the doctrine itself, whole: *Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann.* If the doctrine has a birthplace, it may be there. The ground round it holds the post-holes of shelters for some hundreds, used and rebuilt many times. Whatever was said there was said to a crowd.

In those years a burial ground grew about a place that no one remembers hallowing: Tuam Cnoc dhìreach, whose oldest graves are older than its oldest names that can be read. In one of the oldest lies a child with a sliver of black glass closed in one hand. The sliver still stains the cloth it is kept in, and it is the only piece of the vein found buried with the dead in all this age. The graves came to be laid in rows, heads toward the central mountains; the earliest rows are straight, and the later ones bend round graves already there that no one would disturb.

Long lifetimes after, a single dwelling was sealed by chance under three yards of peat. Its hearth is laid with dry wood, and beside the wood lies a slip of the ore, and none of it was ever burned. Whoever laid it went away and did not come back to light it. It is the earliest witness that someone on Rodos chose to leave unburned a thing they might easily have burned, and the keepers of later ages call it the Unlit Hearth.

For in those years a custom set in across the hills, that no fire should take more of the ore than can be held in one cupped hand. It was nowhere written and everywhere kept, and the Small-Burning Law of the next age is this custom hardened. The reason is always the same tale, told to children when they first reach toward the ore-box. At Achadh dhìreach, it goes, a household once burned a whole basket of the ore at one time. The house burned down with three people

in it; and when the neighbours came in the grey of morning the hearthstone was cracked through and running with colour. Then the teller cups a hand, and says:

Làn na glaice, 's gun tuilleadh. The hollow of the hand, and no more.

And the families near the crack began to sit by the slab laid over it, a household at a time, through the dark half of the year, from Samhain, when the dark half begins, until the light came back. No one ever said what they were watching for.

VIII

Of the Counting of the Dead and the Silence of the Old Ones

In 7293 BDE the Seann-Dhaoine began to cut strokes on flat stones set at the edges of their middens, one stone to a household. The strokes are simpler than the script: a mark, and then another. They were counting their dead. Before there was a Ròdach people to take up the craft, the Old Ones kept count of their own losses, and the chroniclers of Muileann chaol own them as their first forebears in it, though they cannot name one of them.

At the eastern Seann Warr the counting stones were built into a wall, some three thousand strokes in all, and the wall grew for many lifetimes. At Seann Tarr in the north-east the strokes were cut in fives and the stones set into the floor of a house, and the house was lived in over its own dead. Then the tally stones of Seann Warr, Seann Tarr and Seann Chwen all thicken together, more strokes on each stone, more stones in each course. Whatever killed so many killed on three coasts at once. The strokes do not say what it was.

At the Seann Chwen near Cuan dhearg, on 5 an Cèitean 7091 BDE, the last tally stone was left half-cut: two strokes finished, a third begun and given up. The chisel marks stop mid-groove.

After the half-cut stone no new work of the Seann-Dhaoine can be dated. Their middens stop growing, their harbours silt, and their script is never cut again. How they ended, no one knows. Others have guessed in every age, and the library at Muileann chaol keeps their guesses in a press of their own and lends them to no one as history.

There is a lament for them on the south coast. It is young, as such things go, and it says what the stones say:

Stràc air a' chloich, is tràc eile; an treas tràc, cha deach a chrìochnachadh.

Dh'fhalbh iad, is dh'fhàg iad na b-ainmean.

A stroke on the stone, and another stroke; the third stroke, it was never finished. They went, and they left the names.

For the hill-folk went on calling the Old Ones' places by the Old Ones' names, putting only their own word for *old* in front: Seann Dunn, Seann Chwen, Seann Skell and the rest. They translated nothing, and the roots are still not understood. Hill-folk families came down the Abhainn naomh and settled the empty river harbour at Seann Skell, using the old mole and mending none of it, the first time they are known to have lived by the water. Long after, a wind-name was cut in the Ròdaich manner on a boulder at the central Seann Chwen, over an older mark of the Seann-Dhaoine, and there the marks of the two peoples lie one upon the other. When diggers at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach broke into a grave lined with slabs in the Seann-Dhaoine way, they closed it and moved their row, and no one opened it again.

At the eastern Seann Dunn, near the end of the age, a household set about cutting a floor for a new house into the side of the old midden.

The woman of the house had the spade, a blade of shoulder-bone on an ash handle, and her two sons carried the spoil away in baskets. The midden smelled of salt and long-dead fires. At a man's length in, the spade rang.

She knelt and cleared it with her hands. It was a flat stone, set on its edge, and when she brushed the grit from its face she saw the strokes: one and one and one, row on row, cut clean and close, more than she could count on her hands and her sons' hands together. Beside it was another. Behind that, another.

She knew what they were. Everyone on that coast knew, though no one had ever seen one: the Old Ones' counting of their dead.

They lifted them out one at a time, and she laid them on the turf in the order they had come, the first on the left. She looked at them a long while in the wind off the sea. Then she and her sons put them back, the last first, each in its own place and facing the way it had faced, and they filled the cut and trod it down. They built their house elsewhere, on poorer ground.

So the Ròdaich have always dealt with the Old Ones: as a people whose count must not be disturbed.

I X

Of the Stone Kings and the Red Hill

In those same centuries the kings begin; and so the last of the Old Ones and the first of the kings stand in the annals side by side, and neither list names the other.

The reciters at the ford open the oldest spoken king-list, *Rìghbrean na Cloiche*, the Stone Kings, with a name, and it is the name of **Ailean Mòr**, on 9 an Lùnastal 7600 BDE. He is said to have held the hill where Dùn ìseal now stands and thrown up its first bank: a single bank and ditch round some forty houses, the oldest defended place of the hill-folk. The list gives no lengths of reign, and it is older than the name Ròdaich. A second list was kept in the west, and it opens with **Beathag Ruadh**, who held the hill where Cathair dhearg now stands, and that is the Red Hill. For long the two lists say nothing of each other.

Gormshuil nic Ailein, second of the Stone Kings, is the first woman in any list on Rodos, and her telling gives her one deed: in a hard winter she moved the herds of Dùn ìseal down to the warm springs and lost none. **Dòmhnall Clachach**, third, set marker stones along the valley to part the grazing, and some stand yet, and are still quarrelled over. After him came the first named storm, whose name is lost and only the fact of it kept. It broke the shell causeway of Seann Warr in three places and the Seann-Dhaoine never mended it. Then came **Fearchar Bacach**, the lame king, carried to the gatherings in a chair of woven birch, the first ruler on Rodos remembered for a hurt. On the Red Hill **Uisdean Mòr** dug a ditch across the neck of the hill and set a palisade on it, which burned twice and was twice rebuilt; and **Seonag nic Uisdein**, who held the hill after her father, counted her people by pebbles in a bag, one to a household, and knew by the weight when a household had gone.

The first war in either list was a raid for salt. **Mòrag Chruaidh**, fifth of the Stone Kings, went down to the pans at Baile ghorm, shallow clay basins behind a shingle bar and the island's first salt-works, and carried off the salt. Seven died on the hill side, and the telling keeps the number. **Iain Dubh**, sixth, went down to do it again and was killed on the shingle. The list says only that he was brought home.

The land was not quiet under those kings. A sheet of sea sand full of deep-water shells, a hand thick, lies over the hearths of a village on the site of Cnoc chaol, and the village was never rebuilt on that ground. At Cill ghlas a crack a man could

fall into opened across the valley and a spring moved a hundred paces downhill; the hill-folk banked it with stones and laid a line of white stones along it, and built no house within a stone's throw. The dwellings on Loch chrom burned to the waterline, and their charred piles were left standing in the shallows.

X

Of the Ford of Salt and Wool

Raghnall Ceannfhionn, seventh of the Stone Kings, came down to the ford to meet the Red Hill, and the reciters make much of his coming.

He brought only a few with him, for more would have looked like a raid. It was early summer, the river running clear and shallow over its stones, and midges hung in clouds over the water. The Red Hill's holder, whose name the lists do not keep, waited on the far bank with as many, and the two parties looked at each other a long time across the water while the river talked between them.

The two hills had never once spoken. The old salt raids were still sung on the hill side, and a king of Dùn ìseal still lay under his cairn for the salt of Baile ghorm. He also knew his hill had sheep in plenty and too little salt, and that the west had salt in plenty and was short of wool.

So he waded in, alone, to the middle of the ford, with the water to his knees and his cloak held up out of it, and stood there. After a while the other came out to meet him.

What they said the reciters give short. The hill would bring wool; the west would bring salt; neither would bring spears. They clasped arms over the water and waded back, each to their own bank.

Both lists record it, and it is the first time either names the other. The meeting became a yearly gathering where salt, flint, wool, dried fish and pots changed hands and marriages were agreed, and its trodden ground, where the fair of Muileann òg is held now, is the oldest meeting-place on the island that has never been left. **Murchadh Gearr**, who held the Red Hill after Seonag, kept the peace of the ford, and walked the salt road himself every year to be seen on it.

The hill-folk spread in those generations: to Ros bheag on the west coast; to Cathair dhomhain, paying salt to the Red Hill; to Cnoc ghorm with the first cattle of the north-west; to Cathair gheal, where a long-house forty paces long burned and was rebuilt on its footing twice. The first pots were fired at Doire

shean. An oak dug-out long enough for six was sunk at Cidhe Beag, the oldest boat on Rodos whose whole shape is known. Seal-oil lamps burned at Caol leathan, the first light on the island that was no hearth.

Hard years came. At the site of Baile chrom in the north-west the pots are found full of boiled bark and seaweed and the grave-rows doubled: the oldest hunger on Rodos with a place to it. The springs of Achadh shean ran dry, and its fields were given up to the grass. **Sileas Bhàn**, eighth of the Stone Kings, held Dùn ìseal through years of failed grazing, and her telling gives her no deed but that. She held, and the list goes on after her. **Tormod Liath**, ninth, outlived three heirs, and in his time Dùn ìseal got its second bank.

Things were fixed in those lifetimes that have never been unfixed. Flint was dug at Cnoc àrsaidh, the only good flint on Rodos, and the road of those who carried it is sunk a yard deep near Àth leathan. A hawk was carved on a lintel at Àth mhòr, wings closed, head turned, the oldest carving of any bird on the island. The Hawk order of later ages claims it for the Hawk of Acaill, the grey hawk as old as Fionntan; the lintel keeps its own counsel. Someone began to mark the high-water line against a fixed rock, at intervals too regular for a fisherman's habit, and the practice was carried to Ros dhomhain with the interval unchanged; and there the marks crept upward from keeper to keeper, until by the age's end the lake stood a hand higher than at the first cut. The keepers kept cutting. And the eight winds were named, with names that translate awkwardly and have never been replaced. Eight stones were set in a ring on the point at Ceann leathan, one to each wind, and sailors of every age since have touched the stone of the wind they want before they go out.

XI

Of the Ròdaich Name and the Sharing before the Storms

By 5400 BDE the hill-folk had begun to call themselves **Ròdaich**, and their island **Ròdos**. The first mouth to say it is forgotten. The oldest tellings already take both names for granted, and the doctrine goes with them.

With the name came the first forbidden marriage, two lineages refused to each other for reasons none can now give: the earliest sign that the Ròdaich ordered themselves by bloodline before the vein gave them any cause to. At the ford, households began to recite their lines seven names back on each side before a mar-

riage was agreed, and those are the first genealogies on Rodos. None survives whole.

In the same years they went looking for another vein. Diggers from Dùn ìseal opened a trench near Cnoc dhubh and gave it up when two of them were crushed by a fall. A second opening elsewhere struck ordinary rock with nothing beneath it, and so it was first shown that the vein under the mountain stands alone. No one in this age tried a third. The Ròdaich took it that the vein chooses where it lies, and that the choosing is not theirs to test.

Then came the custom that later ages lean on more than they admit: that any household with food to spare must share it before a storm season. At Dùn ìseal it was shared in the open within the bank, by count of mouths. At Àth shean a household hid its grain in a pit beneath the floor and brought nothing, and when the pit was found the household was put out with what it could carry, the first known punishment under the custom. And when the storm called *A' Ghaoth Dhubh*, the Black Wind, the oldest storm whose name is kept, stripped the thatch from every house on the east coast from Cuan ruadh to Ceann chiar, the settlements of that coast fed Cuan ruadh through a whole winter out of what they had shared, and no one there is remembered as dying of hunger that season.

Between the two hills there was fosterage. **Eilidh Ghlas**, tenth of the Stone Kings, sent her younger son to the Red Hill, the first fosterage in either list, and **Lachlann Ruadh** took him in; and the Red Hill list calls Lachlann for it *Lachlann an Altraim*, Lachlann of the fostering, more often than by his own name. **Peigi Dhubh**, who held the hill after him, sent the son home grown, with gifts of salt, and the ford peace held a generation more. He brought the western salt-songs to Dùn ìseal. The list gives him no name and no reign. He is remembered only as the one who went.

XII

Of Oighrig and the Stone Cup

At the slab the heart of the age was kept, and the hearths of the hill country tell this part closest of all.

It was 26 an t-Samhain 5198 BDE, in the dark half of the year, when the families who watched the slab met beside it and agreed that they would stop taking turns by household and choose one keeper at a time by lot.

Oighrig nic Dhòmhnaill stood among them with her shawl over her head against the drizzle. The slab lay grey in the middle of the gathering with the rain beading on it, and the old stain at its lower edge that never washed out. She had sat by it through many nights with her household, and had never once seen it do anything at all.

The lots were pebbles in a bag, one marked. She put her hand in and felt the cold stones knock against her fingers, and brought one out, and opened her hand. Everyone near her saw it before she did.

No one cheered. An old man touched her shoulder once and stepped back. She looked at the pebble a while, and then at the slab, and she put the pebble in her belt, and she kept the slab for the rest of her life.

A house was built beside it at Tobar dhìreach with its door toward the stone, the first building on Rodos that exists only to be near the vein, and it has been rebuilt on that footing many times. Before two years of her keeping were out, Oighrig went to a man who worked stone, and set her own hand on the table before him, cupped as for water, and said she wanted a cup of grey stone that would hold what that hand held and not a grain more, so that the handful should be the same in every house. He ground it over many days and fitted it to her palm again and again, until it sat in the hollow of her hand like an egg in a nest.

The tellings give her a word at the grinding, though whether she said it, only she could tell:

Chan e mo làmh-sa a th' ann, ach làmh gach teallaich. It is not my hand; it is the hand of every hearth.

Copies were ground at Àth gharbh, Achadh dhìreach and Cnoc chaol. Each was carried with the first to a spring on the moor between Àth gharbh and Tobar dhìreach, and the four were set side by side on a flat stone and filled from the spring in turn. The place is called Coinneachadh nan Cupan, the meeting of the cups, and the hill settlements came back to it whenever a cup was broken and a new one had to be proved. So the hills came to measure the ore with one measure.

The lot did not make its keepers holy. A keeper named **Gilleasbuig Beag** was found with a basket of broken ore in his own house. The households sat in judgement at the slab and rowed him out to Eilean chrom and left him there with no boat to come back in, the first person anyone remembers exiled for the vein. The ore was neither burned nor kept. The keeper who followed him carried it back to

the slab, and knelt, and laid it under the stone's edge piece by piece until the basket was empty. The tellings say it in three words:

Chaidh a' mhèinn dhachaigh. The ore went home.

Eilean chrom was left empty after, and never fished. His fire was seen on it for three nights, the tellings say, and then no more.

Then the kings reached for the lot. **Calum Ciar**, eleventh of the Stone Kings, asked that it be drawn at Dùn ìseal in his sight, and the households refused him; and the list records the refusal, which is more than the list usually records of anything. The lot was still drawn at the slab. The Stone Kings ruled the grazing and the gatherings, and the keepers ruled the vein, and that line held for the rest of the age. It was written nowhere yet.

XIII

Of Anndra Breac and the Doctrine Spoken

In the spring of the year before, the watchers in the tower at Seann Skell had seen the Sea-Watcher off the point, a back as long as three boats rising and going under, and there were four of them to swear to it. That summer planks of stitched boats, broken small, washed up along the western shore, with no bodies among them and no boat missing from any settlement there. Those who tell what follows at the ford set these two things down beside it and let them lie.

On 29 an Giblean 5179 BDE the gathering at the ford was full, and **Anndra Breac**, a teller from the western coast, stood up before the gathering to give a telling.

He was a lean man with a freckled face burnt dark by the sea wind and a voice made for the open air. The crowd settled on the trodden grass with their food in their laps, and a child slept against its mother's knee.

He began, and for a while they listened, because he was good. Then they understood what the telling was. In it the people came to Rodos. They came over the sea, in boats, from somewhere else.

The first shout came from the hill households, and then it came from everywhere at once. Men stood up. A crust was thrown and fell short. Anndra Breac raised his voice over them, which was the worst thing he could have done, for they

shouted louder to drown it; and he stood with his mouth still moving and no one hearing a word, and the child woke and cried.

The gathering put him out of the ford for the rest of his life. He went west along the river path and did not look round. His telling was not kept, only the fact of it.

After Anndra Breac, the saying on the column at Cnoc ghorm was spoken aloud at the opening of every ford gathering: *Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann*. It was the first time the doctrine was said as a rule that bound, where before it had only been believed.

XIV

Of the Beacons, the Tide-Rocks and the Long Settling

In those years the coasts were lit. Fires were kept on the capes where Taigh-solais Baile ìseal, Taigh-solais Muileann bheag, Taigh-solais Àth dhearg and Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg stand now. The ash under the Muileann bheag tower goes down three yards; the steps at Àth dhearg are narrower than those of Seann Bhral, and less worn. With the old fire at Baile chrom the coasts were lit at five points. The old fire warned boats off, and the tellings say these new ones were kept to bring them home in a storm.

The tide-rock at Ros dhomhain passed to **Seònaid Mhòr**, who cut her marks in pairs, high water and low; her pairs are still readable, and the keepers after her went back to single marks. Inis thais cut its own marks at the same interval, so that three rocks ran side by side, and none says why the interval is what it is. Ros dhomhain grew to some sixty houses, fishing from boats now instead of from the shore, and the Red Hill built its first landing of laid stone on the river-mouth below the hill, where the harbour of Cathair dhearg is now.

The salt-songs of the pans are the oldest songs on Rodos whose words are said to survive, a refrain of four lines that no one can fully turn into any other speech, and this book will not pretend to. At Cnoc àrsaidh near the panther road were found pipes of bird-bone bored with four holes, the oldest instruments on the island. At Caol bheag the boats were named for the winds they fished in, and a boat that sank had its name never used again. Pilgrims sat a night at the edge of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar without entering, and came in numbers to the warm

springs of Muileann ruadh, where the oldest cure-tale on Rodos is set: a herder who came lame and walked home.

Then, over nearly two thousand years, the Ròdaich filled the island. It is enough here to show the shape of it. Baile chrom, emptied by the old hunger, was settled again from Cnoc ghorm. Caol mhòr was built on the Old Ones' middens. A salt road ran from the pans of Baile ghorm through the ford to Muileann àr-saidh, where salt sold at three times its price. Dùn thais was banked, the first Ròdaich fort away from Dùn ìseal and the Red Hill, and Dùn chrom was raised in the island's middle with a bank that faces both ways. Cuan ruadh was rebuilt in stone to the eaves against the wind, and Ceann chiar set a stone in its midst cut with one mark for each house the Black Wind took: twenty-two.

Everywhere the settlers let the old things be. Those who built below Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, where Cathair mhòr now stands, took no stone from the ruin, though it was the nearest quarry. At Ceann mhin they would not go up to Làrach an Dùin. A path was worn round Làrach an Teampail at a distance. At Cnoc bheag, near the Carragh, no house was set with its door toward the stone. At Cnoc naomh the hill was already called holy when the settlers came, and why, none could tell them; the hearths say the sìth were in it, and the settlers built below it and never on it.

On the hill of Muileann chaol there was a cattle-fold where the library stands now, and a cairn was raised above it for each head of a household at death, some forty by the age's end. The ford gathering grew till it drew every coast, its ground parted by custom: salt people downstream, hill people upstream, flint people on the far bank. Green-stone axes from Àth àrsaidh, too fine for work, went into graves across the island until the quarry was left. Stepping-stones were laid across Abhainn fhionn, the first made crossing of any river, and a spate on Abhainn chaol took twelve salt-carriers at its fords.

The land kept its old wounds. The sea came again over Cnoc chaol, less far, and the houses built higher up the slope were not lost. The crack at Cill ghlas moved and the spring went back uphill, and the white stones were found broken in two places and relaid. A dry summer lay on the eastern plain, and Dùn ìseal and Muileann bhàn drove their cattle to the warm springs; and the shared surplus held, and the tellings count no deaths.

East of the vein a double-banked fort was raised at Dùn dhearg by households who owed nothing to Dùn ìseal. The Stone Kings' list does not name its holders. It says only that Dùn dhearg did not come to the gatherings, until in the lifetime

the tellings give to Catrìona Mhòr, before ever she held Dùn ìseal, its people came to the ford with seal-skins, asking for salt, and were given ground of their own on the far bank. The last settlings of the age went up at Inis mhòr, whose two facing rows of houses are the oldest street on Rodos; at Baile gheal, round a house limed white with shells burned from the Old Ones' middens; and at Àth bheag, the easternmost place of the age, whose boats went out to the geese.

XV

Of Catrìona Mhòr and the Eve of the Binding

The last name the Stone Kings' list gives is **Catrìona Mhòr**, twelfth of the line, who knew, her telling says, every household of the hills by its line back seven names. The last in the Red Hill's spoken list is **Seumas Òg**. The list stops with him; in the next age what the reciters kept of it was written down.

Her people counted the households of the hills by knots on a cord, a knot to a hearth, and the cord from Dùn ìseal is said to have held some nine hundred knots, the largest count made on Rodos in this age. The Old Ones had counted their dead on stone; the Ròdaich counted their living on a cord.

The lot for the slab was drawn now from every part of the hills, and the keepers' house at Tobar dhireach became a place people walked to. Then the keepers were nine, one for each of nine districts, meeting at the slab when a keeper died and at no other time. Every household burned its handful in the dark of the year, measured in a copy of the stone cup, all at once by agreement, so that the colour showed on every hillside on the same night. That night was Samhain, when the year turns to the dark, and it has been the night of the handful ever since. Only the household of the Cnoc dhubh trench, the one that crushed two diggers, refused its handful for as long as anyone remembered, the first on record to choose to burn nothing at all.

The words on the column at Cnoc ghorm, worn shallow, were recut along their old grooves by a hand from the Stone Kings' hill. Some later readers say the recutting changed a letter, and no one can prove which. And the households of the south-east coast began to row their dead to Eilean ìseal in the old manner of the Seann-Dhaoine, whether they learned it from the graves on Eilean dhearg or from nothing.

In the first summer of her holding the two king-lists were recited at the ford one after the other, from first name to last, and it took from dusk to dawn. The reciter of Dùn ìseal stood first, and gave Ailean Mòr and his bank, and Gormshuil and the herds, and Iain Dubh brought home from the shingle, and Calum Ciar refused; and when he came to her own name he said it and sat down, and she felt every face at the ford turn to her in the firelight. Then the reciter of the Red Hill stood, and gave Beathag Ruadh and her hill, and Seonag with her bag of pebbles, and Lachlann of the fostering, down to Seumas Òg, who had taken the Red Hill that same season and sat across the fire from her. It was the first time anyone had heard both lists whole. By the end the sky over the river was grey and the children were asleep in heaps.

She held Dùn ìseal a long time after that night, and she was old when the nine keepers came to her.

They came up together across the trodden ground of the ford while the gathering was full, and stood before her, and the one who spoke for them was older than she was. They asked that their charge be declared before the whole gathering: that the slab and the lot and the handful were theirs to keep, so that no king after her could draw the lot at Dùn ìseal as Calum Ciar had wanted to.

Catrìona Mhòr looked at them a long while. She knew them all, and their lines, seven names back. She looked past them at the gathering, the salt people and the hill people and the flint people on the far bank, all waiting to see what she would do.

"Not this year," she said. And when the old keeper opened his mouth: "Ask me again."

She did not refuse, and she did not agree. The matter was carried forward.

So the age came to 7 an Lùnastal 3051 BDE, and to the eve. The handful was kept in every hearth of the hills; the keepers were nine; the sharing before the storms was kept on every coast; the doctrine was said at every gathering. The Old Ones were names on the shore. The three ruins stood empty and unquarried, the two shafts gave back no sound, and the slab lay over the crack as the mason's people had laid it nearly ten thousand years before.

No telling of the age names a god over any of it. The hearths kept the slab, the handful and their dead, and left the sìth their hills; Bride's flame and Crom's stone come into the story with the Binding and not before. What had been custom waited to be law, and what had been a covered wound in the rock waited to be named a flame.

Here the chroniclers of Muileann chaol close the first book, on the question Catriona Mhòr would not answer; and they open the second with its answer, for the Holy Age begins when the thing every hearth already kept was spoken aloud and bound, and that is the Binding of the First Flame.

THE SECOND BOOK

AN Aois Naomh

the Holy Age

3,000 – 40 BDE

Làn an dà bhois, agus gun tuilleadh. The fill of the two palms, and
no more.

— said of the stone cup at Dùn ìseal

I

Of the Binding of the First Flame

In the days before the Binding the hill-folk of Rodos burned the black ore by the handful and shared their grain before the storms, and at every gathering they said that they had always been on the island and had come from nowhere. Nine keepers, one drawn by lot for each district of the hills, watched the slab over the crack at Tobar dhìreach. All of it was custom, and none of it was law. So the tellers close the Ancient Age: everything in its place, and nothing yet sworn.

The Holy Age opens with an oath. On 23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE a custodianship was declared over the vein beneath the central mountains, and that swearing is called the Binding of the First Flame. The flame bound that day was Brìde's undying flame. The vein and the slab over it were given to Crom Cruaich, the bent one of the mound, whose price is measured. One order took both into its keeping, Òrd Bhrìde, the order of Brìde's flame, eldest of the orders of the Old Faith. It was a faith and a government at once, the first such thing on Rodos, and it

stood for centuries before anything like a king. Whoever came after to rule the roads and harbours ruled beside it and never over it, for as long as the age lasted.

The choosing came after, at Dùn ìseal under the mountain, on 28 an t-Ògmhios 2995 BDE.

Beathag Bhàn stood at the back of the crowd, with the mud of the path still wet on her shins. A wind came down off the high passes and tugged at every cloak on the slope. The keepers of the slab sat on stones in a half-ring, and behind them stood the households who had sworn the Binding, smelling of wet wool and peat-smoke and the ore-dust that never quite washes out of a hill-woman's hands.

Someone spoke her name. Then the crowd parted, as barley parts when a hare runs through it, and she found herself walking down the lane it made. The eldest of the keepers held out a lit rush in his cupped hands, as a man holds water he is afraid to spill.

"Hold it for Brìde," he said. "And answer to Crom for what is taken from the vein."

She took the rush. It stank of tallow, and the little flame leaned away from the wind toward the mountain. She found she had nothing to say, so she said nothing; and the Keepers after her counted that silence in her favour.

Of what she had been before that morning, nothing is kept. The Keepers' recited roll begins with her name, and no name stands before it. The Library mistrusts a roll that begins so bare, but it has found nothing to set against this one.

Nine households round the mountain's foot, one for each district of the old keepers of the slab, took the tending of the flame by turns, each sending a son or a daughter to sit with it through a season. These were the nine hearths, and more houses in later days claimed descent from them than nine hearths could ever have bred. Over the flame they raised Talla na Lasrach, the Hall of the Flame, of dry stone and turf, with one door facing the vein and none facing the sea. Bride's flame burned within; Crom's stone lay under the mountain beyond the door. Many times the Hall was rebuilt on the same footings, and the footings are all that anyone can now swear to.

Beside the Binding, and older at the root, the hearths kept a reverence of their own, and in those years it took a name: Seann Spioradan nan Ròdach, the Old Spirits. It honoured the ancestors, the sìth of the hills and mounds, the vein, and the weather that ruled the mining season. It had no priests and wanted none. Its watchers on the cairns above Cnoc ghlas read the cloud on the high passes to tell

the Hall when the galleries might open, and they were chosen with more care than the Keeper was.

The first Keepers ruled mostly by forbidding. No fire might be lit where the hills of Doire uaine could see it, in obedience to the old inscriptions there, and nobody has ever owned to breaking the ban.

Once Beathag Bhàn walked to Làrach an Teampaill, the ruined temple of the Old Ones. She went in alone, the tellers say, with the wind crying in the broken stones, and found the altar already turned toward the mountain. When she came out she said that the place was neither Bride's nor Crom's, and not the Hall's to keep. No Keeper set foot inside it for the rest of the age. Whose it was, she did not say, and it seems she did not know.

She died at Dùn ìseal, and they laid her on the slope with her face to the vein and her back to the sea, though it is over the sea, in Taigh Dhuinn, that the dead are gone. The nine hearths chose her sister's son, Muireach Liath, to keep the flame after her.

II

Of Muireach Liath and the Silver

At Muileann chiar, when a crucible is set on the coals, the old smiths tell this while they wait for the metal to run.

Muireach Liath, they say, fixed the first common measure of ore: a lidded basket of plaited heather, one to a household, filled once in the season. Yet the smiths remember him for two refusals.

The first was over a stream. Allt an Àigh gave fortune, men said, to whoever drank from it in a certain quarter of the moon, and it had become a place of pilgrimage, as it has never wholly ceased to be. Pilgrims wore a path to it from the river landing at Caol shean and walked it by night, to come to the water at the right hour. Muireach Liath ruled that the stream belonged to the ancestors and the weather, and that the Hall would not keep it, for it had nothing to do with the vein. That was the first parting anyone could see between the Keepers' rite and the older reverence, and both sides later quoted it as proof that they were right. In the same temper the Keepers let the sick be carried to the warm springs below Muileann ruadh and bathed at dawn, since the water's heat came up from the

mountain without any hand breaking the stone. The springs were held to be Dian Cècht's, the healer of the gods, and Crom had no claim on them.

The second refusal was over silver, and here the smiths lean closer to the fire.

In the far east, near the great vein yet no part of it, a seam was found at the place called Muileann chiar: the first thing out of the ground on Rodos that was surely not obsidian. Fearchar Airgeadach, a basket-carrier of the nine hearths, was the first to smelt it and hammer it into rings. He fed his furnace with wood and peat, and the smiths call that the first fire on the island that answered to nobody in the Hall. They say it with some pride.

When the Hall was asked whether the seam fell under the flame, Muireach Liath turned a ring over in his fingers and gave it back, and answered:

Chan eil fuil san airgead, agus chan ann leis a' bheinn a tha e. There is no blood in silver, and it is not the mountain's.

Silver does not bleed colour when broken, and so it was not holy to Crom. The smiths gave their first ring to Goibhniu, the smith of the gods, and the Hall said nothing against it. Muileann chiar was left free to dig as deep as it liked, and it dug. Every later quarrel over the silver began from that sentence. Carriers took the rings down to Ros fhionn and traded them for salt fish and sealskin, the first trade on the island made in anything but food, and the first whose price is remembered. One ring bought a boatload.

Muireach Liath died at Dùn ìseal, keeping the flame. The nine hearths passed over three candidates of other lines and chose his daughter, Gormshuil nic Mhuirich. Her kin came to be called Sliochd Mhuirich, the house of Muireach, the first custodian house known by a name and no longer by a hearth, and the office stayed with them for many generations. The other hearths made no complaint that anyone kept, say the smiths; but then, they add, it was Muireach's own people who did the keeping.

III

Of the Stag and the Stone Cup

In Gormshuil's years a school arose in the east that would spread wider than any order on the island: the first of the druid schools, Scoiltean nan Draoid-

hean, which the east still calls Feallsanachd an Fhèidh, the Philosophy of the Stag. It began with one stubborn woman. Sileas nic Coinnich, a cutter of Muileann chiar, had seen the ore bleed colour freely under some picks and sullenly under others, and she would not leave the thing alone. She taught in Coille Naomh Muileann chiar, and her hearers kept her question as she left it:

Carson a tha an fhèith a' freagairt do làimh seach làimh eile? Why does the vein answer one hand and not another?

Until then the Ròdaich had revered the obsidian. Sileas was the first to reason about it. Her hearers took their name from a stag said to have stood in the grove through a whole lesson, the white stag of Flidais, lady of the deer and the wild, whose wood it was. The school's later name, and the stag's name, Camaran, are found only in much younger writings.

The Hall did not welcome the question. Gormshuil forbade Sileas's hearers to cut in the galleries of Dùn ìseal, holding that a question asked of the vein is a demand made of it, and for a long while after, the stag's people kept to the east and sent no cutters to the mountain.

Then a death made the next law. In a hard year a household at Cnoc dhubh burned its ore by the basketful. The smoke lay down in the valley like a sick dog and would not lift, and three of that household died of it, and two of their neighbours. The case was argued at Dùn ìseal for the rest of the season.

The Keeper who ended it was Fionnlagh Dall, Fionnlagh the Blind.

He came into the Hall on the arm of a boy and found the threshold with his foot. The council had been shouting since morning and their voices were hoarse. He could smell the peat on their clothes and the wet dogs by the door, and under it all the thin hot scent of Bride's flame at his back. The kin of the dead sat on his left. He knew where they were by their silence.

He had brought the old keepers' stone cup, a thing of the Ancient Age, re-cut in grey stone to hold exactly what a pair of cupped hands will hold. He set it on the threshold of Talla na Lasrach, knelt, and laid his palm across its mouth.

"Give me the ore," he said.

They poured it for him, a little at a time. He did not know whose hand poured, and he did not ask. When the black grains rose to touch his palm, level with the rim, he said, "Enough," and took his hand away and let them look. No one afterward could say he had favoured anyone's hands.

On 13 an Lùnastal 2857 BDE the custom hardened into the Small-Burning Law: no household might burn more than a measured handful of ore in a season. It held for centuries.

Its first sentence fell on a household of Seann Tarr that had burned twice its measure. It lost its right for the season after, and its name went on the roll with the offence beside it. Its descendants petitioned for many centuries to have the offence struck out, and never won, and the offence is the only reason anyone remembers them.

The Keepers carried the Law to the coasts. No ore, they ruled, might feed a beacon, since a beacon burns for strangers:

Cha loisc clach na beinne do choigrich. The mountain's stone will not burn for strangers.

So the fire on the headland at Tobar dhearg was kept with driftwood and seal fat, and so was every sea-light on the island after it.

IV

Of the Roads, the Bridges and the Road-Peace

This is how the carriers tell it at the long table of the house that is now Am Buabhall Fortanach, while the juggled buffalo sits on the fire.

The Law made the Hall a giver-out of ore, they say, and what is given out must be carried. So the island's roads grew along the carriers' tracks, down stepped paths such as the one to Ceann chaol. The rivers took their toll. One night the Abhainn dhomhain rose at a ford and swallowed eleven carriers with their baskets. The Hall mourned the ore as well as the men, and the carriers will tell you, if you let them, that the Hall's roll names the ore first. Fionnlagh Dall asked the council for a crossing the river could not take, and stone bridges began to join the mining paths to the coast, the forefathers of Drochaid Cathair dhearg and Drochaid Ros fhionn.

Above Ros fhionn, Ailean Clachair and forty masons of the nine hearths threw a single span of fitted stone over the river, and Ailean cut a hearth-sign in the keystone. Every later bridge carried one, and a carrier would sooner wade than trust a bridge without it. The masons swore an oath on the stone cup: no span to

be closed in the dark, and none to be paid for in ore. They kept their lodge near the western crossing, in the country of Ros dhomhain.

Houses grew along the roads to feed the people on them, the forebears of Am Buabhall Fortanach, An Taigh-òsta Grianach and the rest of the circuit. The carriers always begin with this one. Its first keeper was Mòr nic Dhùghaill, a widow of Doire shean, who served carriers juggled buffalo from her own herd, and here the carriers bang the table, for the house serves it still. Where An Taigh-seinnse Mòr stands there was then a turf longhouse with a hearth at each end, one for carriers going up and one for carriers coming down.

Then the keepers of the houses made a law of their own: no feud might be pursued under an inn roof, nor within a spear's throw of its door. It was first kept at the house where An Sligeanach Fad' às now stands, and it is the oldest law on the island that no Keeper made. The carriers put it plainly:

Fo mbullach an taighe, chan eil nàmb ann. Under the roof of the house,
there is no enemy.

The roads carried settlers too, to coasts that had names already. Fishers of the nine hearths settled the harbour of Seann Mhorn and kept its name, which is in no tongue of theirs, saying that the name came with the stones; it was the first such name to be kept. Families walking the new road resettled Seann Warr on the western shore of Loch chrom in the same way, and built on the house-footings they found in the grass. At this point the whole table sings:

Thog sinn air na clachan, is cha do dh'fhaighnich sinn cò leis. We built upon
the stones, and did not ask whose.

Fionnlagh Dall died at Dùn iséal. At his own asking he was not laid on the slope with the Keepers before him. He was carried south to the old graves near Cnoc dhìreach, which no living people had claimed, and his bearers took eleven days over the road and laid him among graves older than any name. Why he asked it, the Keepers after him gave two answers and would not choose between them, and the carriers do not choose either. So Tuam Cnoc dhìreach, ancient already, received its first burial that anyone set down, and a graveyard that no one owned became one that somebody did. Families settled nearby to tend it, and the Hall paid them one handful of ore each a season. It was the only payment in ore the Law

ever allowed, and the carriers, who carried every other handful on the island, find that fitting.

V

Of the Four Houses and the Reverent Centuries

In time the nine hearths chose a Keeper from outside the house of Muireach: Eilidh nic Ìomhair of Dùn dhearg. Sliochd Mhuirich refused her for a season, and then accepted her on one condition, that the stone cup never leave Talla na Lasrach. It never did.

Under Eilidh the office was bound to four houses of custody: Sliochd Mhuirich of Dùn ìseal, Sliochd Ìomhair of Dùn dhearg, Sliochd Thormoid of Seann Dunn, and Sliochd Raghnaill of Seann Tarr. The other hearths kept their council seats but lost their claim to the flame. Most of the island's later nobility comes down from one of the four, or says it does, and from here onward the tale of the age is largely theirs.

Sliochd Thormoid raised a hall and a shrine at Seann Dunn, facing the mountain across the river. Its ore-lamp burned at the Law's measure, and the other houses grumbled that Seann Dunn's measure was always the fullest. Sliochd Raghnaill made its seat at Seann Tarr, the very town first sentenced under the Law, kept boats where the others kept galleries, and grew rich on fish. Its boats sailed round Eilean dhubh and came home, the first voyage ever made only to look at a coast.

Not everyone lived inside the Law. Households stripped of their right for a third offence took to boats and raided the north-western strands, and the name spùinneadairean, plunderers, clung to those waters after them. There a boat out of Baile chrom was lost in a flat calm, and the two men who swam home said something had risen under it. The village has kept a wake for it every year since, and it relit the old beacon on the point with driftwood, as the Law required. From that fire comes Taigh-solais Baile chrom.

Fishers resettled Seann Bhrenn, kept its old name, and used the stone quay they found under the silt. At Cathair naomh a cairn for the dead was begun that is growing yet. When the great cats' crossing was found to run over the southern road, Eilidh ruled that no panther might be killed there in its season, and the rule held, for it cost the carriers only time.

At Dùn dhearg, Sliochd Ìomhair built granaries of stone and filled them from the lowland fields against the storm season, as the old custom of sharing asked. The granaries gave that house something the Hall had never had: people who owed it their bread.

In those days, the reverent centuries, each generation mined the same modest measure and burned the same modest measure, and the number of the people stood still. Shepherds took the uplands at Achadh chaol; their headman sat one season on the council, was found to hold no hearth-right, and went home. Coinneach Mòr mac Tormoid, first Keeper of his house, kept the flame longer than any before him and changed nothing at all. He sent walkers out to list the ruins of the Old Ones, and they came back with Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, Làrach an Dùin, Làrach an Teampaill and the standing stones. Beside each place the list says who does not own it. It does not say who built it, for the Keepers ruled that it should not guess. At Cnoc bheag the people fenced the old obelisk with stakes against the cattle, and every generation since has renewed the fence. Over the springs at Muileann ruadh a bath-house was roofed, and the Hall named a keeper of the springs in Dian Cècht's name, the first office it made that had nothing to do with the ore.

VI

Of the First Rìgh and the Division of Keeping

In the generations after Coinneach Mòr the rolls grow fuller, and in them the island can be watched filling out, as a field fills with barley.

The silversmiths of Muileann chiar cast weights from a barley-corn to a newborn lamb, and a thing weighed there was weighed fairly. The stag's people founded a house at Cnoc bhàn, and the Keeper Seonaid Chiar let their cutters back into the galleries on oath to ask nothing of the vein aloud. The Hall called it a reconciliation; the school still calls it a truce. Cathair mhòr built the first town wall on the island and never said what it feared. Ceann leathan's harbour-master kept notched tally-sticks, and they lie now at Muileann chaol, the oldest counted things there. Inis thais burned its handful on the shore so that the drowned could see it, and the salt of Cuan shean kept the fish of half the island. The sunny house rose where An Taigh-òsta Grianach stands. A roof fell in the highest gallery and killed four cutters, and Seonaid Chiar propped every gallery with oak.

Carriers founded Cathair dhomhain above the western harbour, proud of keeping the measure strictly. A few miles off, at the bridge-foot on the Abhainn dhomhain below Loch chrom, the Red Hill's old settlement, long shrunk to a fishing town on red stone, began to grow again. In those days Cathair dhearg was a place carriers passed through on the way to somewhere else.

At Dùn dhearg the lowland households who ate from Sliochd Ìomhair's granaries began to call the head of that house their rìgh, their king. He was Goraidh mac Ìomhair, and no one before him in any record had borne the word. The granaries gave it to him.

He went up to Dùn ìseal in the spring to meet the council, on foot, as a carrier would.

It was a long climb, and by the time the grey roof of Talla na Lasrach came in sight over the shoulder of the hill his breath was short. He had left his spear with his men at the last house on the road. He had thought about that for three nights. A man who comes to the Hall armed has already said what he wants, and he hoped they would read the other thing in his empty hands.

The council sat outside on the stones before the door, for the day was fine, and the Keeper sat among them with the stone cup at her feet. Goraidh stood before them in his travelling cloak with the wind in his beard, and he said the thing he had come to say before anyone could ask it.

"I claim nothing under the mountain. Not a gallery, not a grain of ore. Let the Hall hear me say it."

The Hall heard him. Then they bargained until the light went.

On 9 an t-Sultain 2305 BDE the council at Dùn ìseal and the rìgh agreed the division of keeping. The Keeper kept the flame and the galleries. The rìgh kept the roads, the granaries and the peace of the lowlands. The rìgh might not enter the galleries, and the Keeper might not raise spears. On that division Rodos was ruled for the rest of the age, and most of the age's quarrels were over which side of it a thing lay on.

Goraidh Mòr, as they called him after, built a timber hall at Dùn dhearg with a granary at each corner, and set a toll on the roads of one fish in twenty for the guards and the bridges. The waypoint-keepers collected it and kept a share, and the rolls, to their credit, say so. His daughter was Mòrag nan Rathad, Mòrag of the Roads, who walked every carriers' road on the island with a staff in her hand and had the bad stretches remade. She raised the house where An Taigh-seinnse Òir stands, the first built by a ruler, and widened the western crossing of the

Abhainn dhomhain with Ailean Clachair's sign recut in the keystone, and the bridge-foot town began to swell.

Her son Dòmhnall Crùbach, Dòmhnall the Lamé, could not walk the roads, and ruled through the waypoint-keepers, who round Ceann mhin paid him what toll they judged fair. They judged generously to themselves. When a storm took a third of Seann Chwen, the Hall and the rìgh both sent grain, and the survivors remembered that the Hall's came first.

Settlers from Cathair dhomhain founded Baile àrsaidh among the yellow scorpions of the western heath, and swore their oaths on a scorpion's sting kept in a box. Their neighbours found the custom strange.

At Muileann chiar the stag's teachers turned the cutters' tally-notches into signs for sounds, so that a teaching could be kept without a teacher. These stag-letters, the ogham, which the druids say Ogma of the gods first cut, were the first letters of the Ròdaich, and nearly every later hand on the island comes from them. The scholars carried them to Carragh Cnoc bheag and held them up beside the marks on the obelisk. They matched nothing. So the scholars wrote that the stone's writers were not their teachers: the first thing the Ròdaich ever wrote about the Old Ones, and it tells only what they were not.

Dòmhnall's niece Sileas Dhonn made the waypoint-keepers come to her hall once a year and render account of the tolls. Several of them did.

VII

Of the War of the Roads

Caol leathan in the south-west grew fat on the western fishing and the southern end of the carriers' road, and its leading family under Lachlann Ciar began to keep the road-toll and send none to Dùn dhearg.

Iain Garbh, Iain the Rough, son of Sileas Dhonn, sent west to demand the tolls. His messenger came back with a covered basket, set it on the floor of the hall, and would not meet his eye. Iain lifted the lid himself. The smell came up first, old and rank. The basket was full of fish-bones, picked clean and packed in rows, as a careful wife packs herring.

He looked at them a long time. Then he laughed, which frightened his household more than shouting would have, and called for the road-guards.

He marched west with the road-guards and the lowland levies and burned the toll-house at Muileann òg that Lachlann Ciar's people had taken, and he watched the thatch go up with his arms folded. It was the first war between Ròdaich and Ròdaich, and it was fought over the roads the first rìgh had been made to keep.

The Hall blessed neither side. When Iain's messengers asked at Dùn ìseal for the Hall's handful to light the warband's hearths, the Keeper Uisdean mac Ruairidh sent them back empty, and made them repeat his answer before they went:

Cha bhlàthaich an lasair fir a tha a' dol a mbarbhadh. The flame will not warm men who are going to kill.

"Then we'll burn peat," said Iain. The warband wintered on peat, coughing. The division of keeping had been tried, and it held: the rìgh had the spears and the Keeper had the flame, and neither could take the other's.

At the ford of Àth fhiadhaich the men of Caol leathan stood in the water and held it for a day. Iain went in with the second rank. He remembered afterward the cold that took his legs at the first step, and the noise, and a man of Caol leathan who fought on with a split shield until a spear from behind Iain found him. By evening they had given way. Forty lay dead of the two sides, and the carriers long called it the ford of the forty, and said the Morrìgan's crows were on it before the light went.

Falling back, Lachlann Ciar's men burned Baile ghlas so the levies would find no grain. Iain rode through the warm ashes the next morning and found no one to ask where the people had gone. They had walked to Cathair dhomhain, and many never came back. Baile chlar, south of the bridge-foot, shut its gate against both armies and fed the burned-out people through the winter. Neither side forgave it, and neither side attacked it.

Iain closed Caol leathan by land at the start of winter, but he could not close the harbour. From his camp on the hill he watched the boats slip in at dusk, low in the water with fish. When his levies began going home for the next harvest, first by ones and then by villages, the siege ended without an assault.

The war ended under the carriers' law. Iain Garbh and Lachlann Ciar met under the roof of Mòr nic Dhùghaill's house, where by the road-peace neither could draw. They sat at one board, and Iain saw that his enemy was older than he had thought, and had a cough of his own. They ate the jugged buffalo, and then they talked. Caol leathan kept half its tolls and sent half to Dùn dhearg, and Lachlann

Ciar swore to the Law before the Keeper's witness. So the War of the Roads was ended in a house built to feed carriers.

It left three things. Caol leathan's fighters became its road-guards and swore their watch on a white stone carved as a wolf, kept at the town gate, and called themselves the wolf-sworn. Later ages read more into the stone than they did: Òrd na Cloiche, the order of the Stone, holds it the first of its stones, and its sworn guards, the Fianna, keep the wolf for their beast. Caol fhiadhaich, whose boats had fed the besieged town, was given a share of the western tolls and built a harbour wall with it. And when Iain Garbh died, his daughter Catrìona buried him in the floor of his hall at Dùn dhearg and not on the slope at Dùn ìseal. He had never forgiven the Hall, and the Hall did not ask for him.

Catrìona Ghlic, Catrìona the Wise, mended the breach. She sent her own son to sit with the flame for a season, the first of the royal house to do so since the division, and by the end of her reign the Hall and the hall were speaking again. She had houses built on the northern road where An Leòmhann Buidhe and An Taigh-seinnse Reòta stand, the second out on the open moor for carriers caught by snow; its keepers were paid in grain by the Hall and in cloth by the crown, and grumbled at both. Inis mhòr, on the wool trade, outgrew every northern town.

VIII

Of the Letters, the Woods and the Measuring of the Vein

The scholars of Muileann chaol count the clerk at the start of this chapter their first forebear, and they tell it with the care of heirs.

After Catrìona Ghlic the king-list gives eleven names at Dùn dhearg and nothing more, and the Keepers' roll five names and nothing more. A clerk broke that silence. Tormod mac Iain, a younger son of the house of Tormod, learned the stag-letters at Muileann chior, the first of the royal kin to read, and was called Tormod Sgrìobhaiche, Tormod the Writer. Ealasaid Chiar bade him write down every ruler the reciters could name, in order. That was the first written king-list, and from then on rulers were kept by name and no longer only by story. His roll runs from Goraidh Mòr to Ealasaid Chiar. He marked which names came from the reciters and which from living memory, and in three places where it disagreed with the Keepers' roll he wrote both readings and would not choose. For that above all the Library loves him.

The Hall, shamed (in its own words) by the rìgh's clerk, had its recited roll written down at Dùn Ìseal. It begins with Beathag Bhàn and is several centuries longer than Tormod's.

In the west a company settled at the edge of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, the uncleared wood, to watch for a black horned beast they said walked in it. They were the wood-watchers. Òrd Mhacha, the order of Macha, takes that beast for a sign of Dubh Sainglenn, the black horse, and claims them, though none of their own accounts is older than the order. They came east and cut a black-barked tree in the stag's grove, saying the beast had shown it to them. The stag's people called it theft and sent teachers to hold lessons in the dark wood, saying the first stag had come from there. In each wood the two companies met under the trees and did not speak. It was the first quarrel on Rodos between rival holy claims, and it was settled by sharing the keeping, with no winner named. Before Fearchar Òg, rìgh after Ealasaid Chiar, and the Keeper Calum Liath, the stag's people took the eastern wood and the wood-watchers the western, each free to walk the other's unarmed and without cutting. Two of the boundary stones, cut in stag-letters, stand yet.

Calum Liath then sent cutters with knotted cords and lamps into every gallery to follow the vein and mark where it thickened and thinned. The work took several ore-seasons, and the households went short to pay for it. It was the first attempt to measure how much obsidian the mountain held. The sum, cut on a slab in the Hall, found that the mountain could give every household its handful for more generations than there were grains in the granaries of Dùn dhearg. It was read to the council and heard in silence, which the Hall took for assent. The slab can still be read, and in this age, with the vein nearly spent, those who read it say nothing.

Two youths sent into the lower gallery without a Keeper's cutter broke the wrong face and were crushed. Their families asked what the Hall owed them, and the council had no answer. Out of that grief came the apprentice-binding: young Ròdaich were bound to a master custodian for seven years before they might touch the ore, and every later mining guild takes its shape from it. Oighrig Bhàn, Keeper after Calum Liath, bound the first twelve on the stone cup, and four of them lived to be Keepers, which is the custom's best argument. The stag's house at Cnoc bhàn took up the seven years and added a written account of every strike. These strike-books became the school's chief record, and in time they asked a question of their own.

Fearchar Òg reigned long and is remembered mostly for dying old. His clerks paid the road-guards in stamped silver rings, the first payment in metal by any ruler, and the rings travelled further than the guards did. The southern guards began meeting at Ceann leathan each year to fight with blunted staves for a ring, and the meeting outlived its purpose: its field is the one where Còmhrag Ceann leathan was fought long after. The first winner whose name is kept was a woman, Mòrag Dhubh of Cnoc mhòr. Burned Muileann òg was built again, and its harvest fair, held at Lùnastal, the feast of Lugh, became Fèill Muileann òg. At Cidhe Beag on the Abhainn uaine a landing was built for river-boats over the carriers' protest, and the hide boatmen of Muileann chrom swore their fellowship on a paddle.

I X

Of the Red Hall and the Census of Hands

Beathag Mhòr, great-granddaughter of Fearchar Òg, is the first ruler the list calls banrìgh, queen, and the change of word is the list's own. On 10 an Gearran 1300 BDE she moved her hall from Dùn dhearg to the town at the western bridge-foot, Cathair dhearg, where the roads, the river and the western harbours met. It has been the seat of rule on Rodos ever since. Her hall was built of the town's red stone on the rise above the harbour, and its foundations lie under the later citadel. The masons cut the hearth-sign in its lintel as if it were a bridge.

Dùn dhearg kept its granaries, the graves of the house of Ìomhar, and its pride. Cathair dhomhain, older and larger, refused the queen's toll on its boats and was granted a charter of its own, and the two towns, a few miles apart, stayed rivals for the rest of the age.

By then the council at Dùn ìseal heard more quarrels over the right to the handful than over anything else: new households, divided households, and claims of descent from the nine hearths without proof. The Keeper Dùghall mac Ragh-naill asked the queen for a count, with the clerks to write and the Keepers to judge. The counters worked from the waypoint houses, since every household lay within a day of one, and the houses, feeding them at the queen's cost, remember it as a good year.

The census of hands was completed on 22 an t-Ògmhios 1264 BDE, the first island-wide count of the households holding the right to burn the ore, and proof that the reverent custom was already being rationed. The rolls gave eleven thousand four hundred households holding the right and about two thousand refused. The refused went on a roll of their own, and it is that roll later generations searched when they wished to prove an ancestor's standing. Many of the refused were fisher-families round Seann Tarr who had never burned ore and now had no right to begin. Sliochd Raghnaill argued their case and lost. The fishers burned peat, and said it was warmer.

Beathag Mhòr was carried back at her own order to lie at Dùn dhearg among the house of Ìomhar, the longest royal journey yet made. Her son Ruairidh Liath was already grey when he took the hall, and his byname is the only joke the list makes. He demanded one silver ring in five from Muileann chiar. Sliochd Fhearchair, the silversmiths' house, quoted Muireach Liath back to him, that silver is not holy and so not the crown's either, and shut the workings. For three seasons no silver left Muileann chiar. It is called the Silver Feud, though no one died in it. At last both sides went up to Dùn iséal and asked the Keeper to judge.

Dùghall mac Raghnaill heard them in the Hall on a raw day, with the door shut against the rain. The smiths had sent an old woman of Sliochd Fhearchair to speak for them. She said Muireach Liath's sentence, and then said it again, slowly, as though the Hall might have forgotten it. The queen's man stood across the hearth and talked of roads and bridges and guards unpaid since Samhain.

Dùghall let them both run dry. Each of them was right, he said afterward, and that is the worst quarrel a judge can be handed.

"Muireach Liath's words stand," he said at last. "Silver is not the mountain's." The old woman nodded as if she had known it all along. "But the crown keeps the roads," Dùghall went on, "and the silver walks on them."

The crown took one ring in ten, the workings reopened, and both sides went home calling it a victory. The Muileann chiar weights were made the only lawful weights on the roads, cast in bronze at Muileann dhearg for every waypoint house.

Ruairidh Liath's granddaughter Seonag Chrom gave the clerks a room in the red hall, and from her reign the king-list was kept year by year. At Inis bheag a stag-teacher taught letters to fishers' children, and the Hall's roll remarked that fish do not need reading. In the red hall Peigi nic Tormoid, of Tormod Scriobhaiche's line, became the first clerk whose hand can be told from the others, and

much of what the Library knows of the middle of the age is in her hand or copied from it.

X

Of the Hawk, the Cup, the Wolf and the Two Schools

In the later centuries of the age the one practice of the Ròdaich began to come apart, in each place for its own reason.

At Seann Skell on the northern coast every fowler household kept a hawk and fed it before the family ate. They burned their handful at dawn with the hawk on the wrist, saying that the flame is a hunger and should be fed as a hunger is fed. They called the hawk Mòd, and said it was the Hawk of Acaill, the grey hawk of time, as old as Fionntan mac Bòchra, eldest of men, who lived through the long ages as a salmon, an eagle and a hawk; and that between the two of them they remember everything. The dawn-burning spread up the Abhainn ìseal to Inis ìseal and Cnoc bheag. The Keeper wrote that since it kept the measure exactly, it was no concern of the Hall's, and that was the last time the Hall said so of any rite. In the west the sting-oath went up the coast from Baile àrsaidh to Ros bheag, where the harbour court took it for every oath of trade, and a merchant who would not swear on the sting was trusted by no one. The wolf-sworn set a second white wolf-stone at the shrine of Inis thais, sledged from the mountain at more cost than the shrine, and its keepers began to pray before it as well as to the drowned.

The stag's people split as well.

At Cnoc bhàn, Donnchadh mac Iain sat up a whole winter with the strike-books, generations of them stacked along the wall higher than his head. He read by a lamp kept at the Law's measure, with a blanket round his shoulders and his breath smoking, and he began, without quite meaning to, to keep a tally on a slate. One night near midwinter he read back down the slate and sat very still. The ore bled brighter for cutters in their later years than in their first, whatever house they came from.

He took it to the elders in the morning. They heard him out in the cold room, and when he had finished the eldest folded her hands.

"The vein answers to what a cutter is born with," she said. "Practice only shows it."

"Then why does it show more every year?"

She did not answer, and he saw in their faces that the matter was closed. So he left with twenty-two hearers and copies of the strike-books wrapped in oiled hide on their backs, and settled at Muileann chaol. The elders called it theft. Donnchadh called it copying, which it was.

That was the second school of Feallsanachd an Fhèidh. It held that the vein answers to effort, and it wrote no cutter's parentage in its books at all. The two schools argued by letter for the rest of the age, and both kept the letters. The Library stands in Muileann chaol now, and its scholars know that the Long War would one day be fought over that same argument in a very different form. They tell this part quietly.

The Keeper Raonaid Dhubh heard both druid schools at Dùn ìseal and gave no ruling:

Cha do dh'iarr an fhèith oirnn breith a thoirt. The vein has not asked us to give judgment.

No refusal in the Hall's history was quoted more often.

Once more the Old Ones stepped into the tale, as a question. Scholars from Muileann chaol could not read the pillar at Cnoc ghorm, and the people of Cnoc ghorm told them it said *Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann*: we did not come; we were here. The scholars wrote that the people said so, and no one has explained the stone or the saying since. Men of Baile ghorm dug under Làrach an Dùin for its rumoured riches and found only ash. The Keeper sentenced them as lawbreakers though no law covered the case, and the sentence became the rule for every old place after. The diggers' families did their penance by keeping the road to Tuam Cnoc dhireach in repair, and it is still called the diggers' road.

X I

Of the Shared Meal and the Lean Year

At Àth dhìreach, high in the mountain country, they tell this at the turn of the year, and set out an extra bowl for the carriers.

Lachlann Bàn built granaries in every province seat that would take one. With the Keeper Raonaid Dhubh he wrote the island's oldest custom into law at Cath-

air dhearg: a household with grain beyond its winter's need was to give the surplus to its district's common granary before the storm season, and the granary would feed any household of the district that ran short. It was the first law made by rìgh and Keeper together. Cnoc mhòr built its granary first, and its reeve was sent a silver ring. Granaries went up in the mountain districts round Muileann chiar, where people lived by cutting and carrying, and the lowlands grumbled at filling them.

Lachlann's daughter Oighrig nic Lachlainn had no children, and the houses began counting their claims before her reign was half over. Early in that reign the weather tried the law. The watchers above Cnoc ghlas looked up in spring and saw snow on the high passes, and looked again a month later and saw it still, white in the sun, long after the galleries should have opened. The Hall kept them shut. When they did open, they opened late and closed early, and a third of a common season's ore came down. The mountain households of Muileann gheal, Doire uaine and Àth dhìreach, who traded their carrying for grain, had nothing to trade, and by the following autumn they were eating their seed.

On 4 an Dàmhair 526 BDE the first famine on Rodos was turned back. The shared-meal law held. The mountain granaries were opened at Muileann gheal, and when they ran low the granaries of Dùn dhearg and the southern coast sent grain up the carriers' roads without needing to be asked twice. The carriers took no fee. No one in the three settlements is known to have died of hunger that winter. Àth dhìreach gave the carriers who had brought the grain the right to rest in any house of the town for as long as they lived. The last of them died old, and the right died with him, and his is the bowl they still set out.

The reeves of Dùn dhearg, who had refused Cathair dhearg their accounts for generations, opened the old granaries of the house of Ìomhar without waiting for an order. The queen wrote that she would have given the order had they waited. The clerk wrote beneath it that they had not waited. The Keepers of later days named that winter in the same breath as the Binding.

Oighrig nic Lachlainn died without an heir of her body, and the line of Go-raidh Mòr, as the list reckons it, ended with her. The red hall was shut, and its clerks kept it. The Four Houses met at Dùn ìseal to choose a ruler, since no custom covered a hall without an heir. Sliochd Ìomhair claimed by blood, Sliochd Thormoid through the clerks, and Sliochd Raghnaill through its boats. Sliochd Mhuirich, which held the Keeper's office, made no claim at all. How long the houses sat, and whether the hall stood empty all that while, the tellers cannot say;

the rolls put the choosing some years after the meeting, and there the tale moves on.

XII

Of the House of Tormod

The houses chose Gilleasbuig Mòr mac Tormoid of Seann Dunn, a grandson of the clerks' line. The Keeper set the stone cup in his hands before the council, the first time a ruler was made at Dùn ìseal, and it looked very much, as more than one chronicler has dryly said, as if the Hall had made the king. Sliochd Ìomhair consented on condition that its graves at Dùn dhearg stay the kings' burying-place. Gilleasbuig had the king-list recopied with a line drawn under Oighrig nic Lachlainn, and the line is in every later copy. He made his house's shrine at Seann Dunn a temple, whose lamp a Keeper's cutter still checked every season, and he was buried at Dùn dhearg as agreed. His son Tormod Òg succeeded without any meeting of the houses, and nobody asked for one.

Between Tormod Òg and Anna Ruadh the list gives nine rulers of the house with their years and little else, and the rolls of those reigns hold mostly harvests, tolls and bridge repairs. The Library takes this for a sign that the island was doing well.

The bridges, at any rate, were mended. The span at Cathair dhearg was widened for carts on Mòrag nan Rathad's piers. Above Ros fhionn the masons found Ailean Clachair's sign still sharp and left it alone. New crossings rose at Dùn chrom and Ceann àrsaidh, and at Doire mhin the keystone carries, beside the hearth-sign, the first mason's mark on the island: the name of Beathag Clachair. An Sligeanach Fad' às was rebuilt in stone and got its name, for carriers said you were never nearer to it than halfway. The house on the northern road began serving a barley spirit the carriers called fire-water. The Keepers ruled that it was not a burning, and its trade doubled.

The north-west kept to the edge of things. Caol mhòr paid its tolls only when the road-guard came for them, and Inis mhin appears in the rolls once, for a complaint. The seal-oil of Ceann mhòr lit the western harbours brighter than anything else on Rodos. Two boats of Baile chrom felt something vast move under them in the north-western water, and one did not come home. The wake kept for the first loss is kept now for both.

Sliochd Raghnaill's boats made the round of the offshore islands, Eilean ruadh, Eilean dhearg and Eilean fhada among them, in a single season. No crew of the age went further than the islands, and none wished to.

Anna Ruadh of the house of Tormod walked the whole road circuit, as Mòrag nan Rathad had, and she walked it twice. At the house where the War of the Roads was ended she ate the jugged buffalo at the long table like a carrier. She gave the sunny house the only royal charter any waypoint house holds, and gave the contest at Ceann leathan a walled field and fed its losers at the crown's cost. She also kept a wood-watcher in her household to read the omens of the hall, the first sign in the capital of the rite of Macha, lady of sovereignty and of horses. The Keeper protested from Dùn ìseal and got no answer. Cathair dhomhain, proud of keeping the Law strictly, would take no wood-watcher, and said the capital had handed its omens to people who sat in trees. From then on the two towns' rivalry was a quarrel of faith as well.

Anna Ruadh was buried at Dùn dhearg. Her son Coinneach Bànn reigned long and quietly and had the rolls copied for every province seat. Several of those copies have lasted where the originals have not, and much of what the Library knows of these reigns rests on them.

XIII

Of the Parting of the Rites

Seumas Bànn of Sliochd Mhuirich was chosen Keeper, and in his first winter he sat down in the Hall with the Keepers' roll, meaning only to learn the names of those before him.

He read it by the light of Brìde's flame. The names went down and down in the old stag-letters, some cramped, some sprawling, a few so faded he had to tilt the page to the fire. Past the middle he began to notice how often he met his own house. By the end he had stopped reading and was counting. More than half the Keepers of the whole age had been of Sliochd Mhuirich.

He sat a while with that. Then he sent for a clerk and a knife and had the fact scraped from the preface. The clerk did as he was told. An unscraped copy survived all the same, and so Seumas Bànn is remembered chiefly for the one thing he wished forgotten.

That winter too he had the Hall list every rite that burned the handful or claimed the vein, so the council would know what it was keeping. The list named the Hall's own rite of the flame and the stone, the old ancestor-keeping, the dawn-hawk, the wood-watchers, the wolf-sworn, the sting-oath and both schools of the stag.

In spring he sent a cutter to check the hawk-keepers' measure at Seann Skell. The man came back wind-burned and angry, with a strip of hide in his hand. The hawk-keepers had sent him back unheard: the measure was the hawk's, they said, and the hawk was not the Keeper's, and they had written it down so he could not mistake it. It was the first rite to refuse the Hall's check outright. Seumas Bàn read the hide twice and put it in the chest with the roll.

After that the news came from every side, and none of it pleased him. The wolf-sworn built a hall round their stone at Caol leathan and swore oaths there that were no longer guards' oaths. The stone, they said, watches the whole island as the guard watches the road, and knows its rightful king. At the western Seann Skell the harbour court's sting-oath became a creed. One power stings the liar wherever he is, its keepers said, and that power is Manannan mac Lir, lord of the sea; the scorpion is only his sign. From then on they swore over a cup marked with the scorpion, Manannan's Cup of Truth, which breaks in three at three lies spoken over it and is whole again at three truths. It was the first teaching on the island to call itself the only true one. Seann Vell, below Cuan shean, took up the sting-oath of its neighbours and carved a scorpion in yellow stone, the first made for worship; every one before it had been sworn on. The wood-watchers stopped bringing their disputes to the Hall and judged them under the trees. They held that the black beast has two natures, one that keeps and one that devours, and that the vein has the same two; the order of Macha later told it of the two horses that drew one chariot, the black Dubh Sainglenn and the grey Liath Macha.

By 11 an Gearran 144 BDE the one practice of the Hall had plainly split. It had become the threads later ages would name as the orders of An Creideamh Sean, the Old Faith, with the older reverence of the hearths standing apart beside them, and the belief of the Ròdaich was no longer one thing. The council, which had sat by hearth and house, began to sit in companies by rite, each on its own benches.

Seumas Bàn looked down the Hall on the first day they sat so, at the knots of people who would not look at one another, and said to the clerk beside him,

loudly enough to be written down, that he kept the flame now for eight peoples, and each of them thought itself the only keeper.

Two customs stayed outside the companies. Pilgrims of every rite still walked to Allt an Àigh at the right quarter of the moon, the one custom the Hall's list set under no company, and in one season pilgrims of four rites repaved the path from Caol shean together. And the keeper of the springs at Muileann ruadh ruled that the sick of every rite should be bathed without being asked which. It was the last ruling of the age that every company accepted, and it came from the one office the Hall had made that had nothing to do with the ore.

XIV

Of the Last Quiet Years and the Close of the Age

The last generations of the age live in the provincial rolls, which care about what was made and what was owed. The eastern Cnoc dhìreach wove the carriers' heavy cloth, and Muileann bhàn dyed it a pale hill-blue; the Keepers wore theirs undyed, and said so. A flood at Àth chiar took six townfolk, but the granary on its rise fed the town through the winter. The south-eastern Seann Vell grew into a city on fish and silver and built the island's first stone quay. The beacon at Tobar dhearg was raised on a stone tower. At Muileann naomh a mill and a shrine shared a roof, and the Keeper's cutter found the measure kept and the flour good. Dùn thais built the stag's first temple of stone, a hall of the druid schools. Baile Mòr mhòr sent a member to the council, and the Four Houses seated him at the foot of the hall.

When drought burned the pastures of Achadh shean, grain came from Baile chaol and Cuan ruadh under the shared-meal law, and the rolls at Baile chaol record it repaid measure by measure, the first such debt repaid in full. At Baile ruadh a timber watch-tower was manned against island raiders, the only tower of war the age built. At Inis chrom the families of the drowned set an empty place for each of the lost at a yearly feast on the shore, and the custom spread north to Seann Warr. At Cnoc naomh the ancestors were still kept in the old way, with no hawk or wolf, sting or stag, and the Hall's list counted the old reverence as one company among the others.

Mòr nic Coinnich, granddaughter of Coinneach Bàn, received the stone cup from the Keeper Catriona nic Mhuirich at Dùn ìseal, as Gilleasbuig Mòr had.

Hers is the last name in the king-list of the Holy Age. At the close of the age the Keepers' roll held one hundred and forty names from Beathag Bhàn to Catriona nic Mhuirich, and the king-list more than ninety from Goraidh Mòr to Mòr nic Coinnich. The Small-Burning Law had not changed by a word since Fionnlagh Dall filled the cup, and the cup still stood on the threshold of Talla na Lasrach.

Later chroniclers look back on those years with some unease. The years about 1 an Cèitean 50 BDE belong to the last age of even population, the final stretch of Rodian history in which no family held meaningfully more years of life than any other. Keepers aged at the pace of carriers, and every ruler died in their time. No one then dreamed this could be lost, so no one wrote it down as a blessing. It is told now because the tellers know what came after.

Thus ended the Holy Age, with the cup on the threshold and the sea at the island's back, uncrossed and unwished-for. The next age began on that sea. Crews from the western harbours brought word of a land across open water, empty of anyone like the Ròdaich, and none of them claimed to have been first. The report would be heard in the red hall at Cathair dhearg, and it would put to the Ròdaich a question the Keepers had never had to answer: who would choose to go. The Holy Age had counted every hand that held the right to the flame. The next would count those willing to leave it. That is the Age of Sundering, An Aois Scaraidh, and the chroniclers of Muileann chaol tell it in the book that follows.

THE THIRD BOOK

AN AOIS SCARaidh

the Age of Sundering

Roghnaich iadsan, agus dh'fhuirich sinne. They chose, and we stayed.

— written in the margin of the custody-book at Muileann dhearg, in
a hand the keepers have never identified

I

Of the Rumour of a Shore

In those days the kings of Rodos kept their hall at Cathair dhearg, and the custodians kept the vein under the mountain, and the Small-Burning Law measured out the black ore hearth by hearth as it had done since the early centuries of the Holy Age. Into that settled house there came a rumour. On 6 am Faoilleach 39 BDE word came back to the island of a land across open water, a coast where no one lived who resembled the Ròdaich. Who first carried it, and in what boat, the tellers at the hearth do not know; they shrug and go on, for the tale has never needed a first finder.

By winter it had reached the capital. In the red hall of Queen Beathag nic Dhòmhnaill, daughter of Mòr nic Coinnich, three crews from the western harbours told it one after another, and none of them claimed to have been first. The queen's scribe took down all three and wrote at the foot of the leaf that they agreed on the coast and on nothing else. Most of what Rodos has known of the land beyond has been of that kind.

Then came the Choosing, which the later chronicles call a vote. Perhaps it was; or perhaps the word was laid afterward over something older and looser,

settled at hearths and on quays. Of one matter every telling is sure: those who went, went because they wished to. No lots were drawn, and no one was pressed. The Choosing is remembered on 8 an Dùbhlachd 39 BDE, though it was a season more than a day.

At Seann Skell, the western river port that would give the age its fleet, the harbour scribes opened a roll for those who meant to go. They entered it by household, never by single name, as though going were a thing a family did together or not at all. The roll was kept on boards in the harbour-house, and a later hand notes that entries were struck out as often as they were added.

II

Of the Queen's Word and the Queen's Sister

The harbour scribe of Seann Skell learned that year to dread the sound of his own door. All summer they came in off the quay: fishers with tar on their hands, farm wives from up the river with a child on the hip. They stood before the boards and said a household's name, and he cut it. A week later, as often as not, the same man came back grey in the face and asked to have it struck out, and he struck it.

In the autumn of 38 BDE a rider came down from the capital with the queen's word, and the scribe read it out at the harbour-house door. The crown would send no one across the water, and the crown would keep no one back. The custody-book gives her words only in substance. The harbour songs of Seann Skell, younger and less careful, give them like this:

Cha chuir mi duine thairis, agus cha chùm mi duine air ais. I will send no one over, and I will keep no one back.

Within that same season a woman came in out of the rain whom he knew before she had lowered her hood. It was Mòrag nic Dhòmhnaill, the queen's younger sister. She did not sit. She gave the name of her own household, spelled it out for him as though he might not know it, and watched his knife until the last stroke was cut. Then she thanked him and went back out into the weather.

He wrote nothing beside the entry. The record makes no comment, and the later chroniclers, who have made a great many, were none of them in the room.

Up at the vein-house above Muileann dhearg, keeper of Crom's stone and heir to the Keepers' Hall at Dùn ìseal where Bride's flame was first bound, the custodians sat down with the roll and counted what the Choosing would cost them. Nearly one in five of the households holding the customary right to burn the ore had entered it. They counted twice, the custody-book says, because nobody believed the first figure. Fishers and farmers were going, and the queen's own sister, and many whose hands the vein had answered.

III

Of the Building of the Ships

The island had no ship fit for the crossing. Her craft until then were sewn-plank coasters that never slept out of sight of land, and a fleet had to be made such as Rodian memory had never seen. The making took the better part of a generation.

In 35 BDE, on the river strand below Seann Skell, the shipwright Alasdair mac Iain, called Alasdair Saor, laid down the first deep-keeled hull ever built on Rodos. Its oaks came from the grove that had given Doire fhionn its name. They went down to the coast on ox-sleds, and the grove never grew again, so the village kept a name it no longer had a reason for. Alasdair bound the wrights of the strand into one fellowship, each apprentice sworn for seven years after the manner of the vein custodians. The custody-book calls it Comann nan Saor-luinge, the fellowship of the ship-wrights.

In 34 BDE Alasdair Saor stood on the headland above Ros àrsaidh, where the ships of Inis àrsaidh put to sea, his hands jammed under his arms for want of work. Below him the first finished hull came down out of the Abhainn naomh and met the open water. She rode higher than he had meant, but she rode well, and for the length of a long breath he let himself be glad of her.

Then a following sea came up under her quarter. He saw the stern lift and the bow go under, and the stern lift again, higher, and then she did not come back. She went over slowly, as a tired beast lies down. There were heads in the water, and then there were fewer. Eleven were drowned.

That night by a driftwood fire he drew the keel in the sand with a stick, rubbed it out, and drew it again. He changed its setting, and every later hull of the fleet was built to the changed pattern. What the change was lived in the hands of

his wrights and nowhere else, and some three centuries later no one on the island could remember it.

The rest of Rodos laboured with him. Cuan shean laid long rope-walks down its harbour front and gave its hemp fields over wholly to cordage. Every weaving household in Siorrachd Baile àrsaidh was asked for a length of close-woven sail-cloth, reckoned on tally-sticks at the shire seat; the tallies survive, though how many households paid does not. On the eastern shore the old steersmen of Cuan ruadh, the only sailors on the island who had ever held a course by night, taught the fleet's pilots to keep a heading by the stars. Some of their lore was written down, and that part is lost.

In 22 BDE the households on the roll met at Seann Skell and chose their own leaders: Mòrag nic Dhòmhnail, the queen's sister, and Fearchar mac Ruairidh, a custodian of the vein. How they chose, the custody-book does not tell. Seven years on, the vein-house ruled whether departing custodians might carry the ore. Each ship might take one sealed measure, as much as a single household might burn in a season under the Small-Burning Law. It is the only text in the custody-book addressed to people who were leaving, and it gives them no blessing. A later custodian wrote a couplet beside it, which is still said at the measured burning in some of the old houses:

Dòrlach airson an teallaich ùir, is an seann teallach fhabhast blàth. A hand-ful for the new hearth, and the old hearth still warm.

Masons came from the capital to lengthen the west quay at Seann Skell with dressed stone, so that the deep hulls could lie alongside at low water. They set down the stones on which the later rite would be held, and they did not know it.

In 2 BDE the whole venture nearly foundered on a quarrel over how much of the island's stored harvest the ships might take. It ran a season and was settled, and nobody wrote how. One piece of it survives. At Àth shean the reeve of the granaries, Tormod mac Coinnich, barred the store-houses while the quarrel was open and set a watch on the doors, and the watch stood until the thing was done. Tormod held no office after that. When the barges moved at last, a tally-keeper on Drochaid Cathair dhearg notched them one by one as they passed down Abhainn dhomhain for the fleet, and made the count forty-one.

In the spring of that year the fleet lay complete at Seann Skell. The custody-book gives it as nineteen hulls. A later hand in the margin makes it twenty-one, and there the matter has rested ever since.

IV

Of the Sunwise Turn

On the last night before the sailing every house along the Seann Skell waterfront set a lamp on its sill and kept it burning until morning. It is the first custom of the Sundering that anyone wrote down as a custom.

A boy of the harbour sat that night on the wall of the west quay with his knees drawn up to his chin and watched the lamps come out along the strand, one and then another, until the whole curve of the water was pricked with light. The April air was sharp. Below him the hulls lay against the new stones, so close that he could have dropped a pebble onto a deck. He smelt pitch and wet hemp and the sheep's fat the crews had rubbed into the blocks. Somewhere aboard, someone was singing under her breath, and someone else told her to hush.

He was to be one of the counters. The harbour scribe had given him a hazel stick and a knife, and told him: one notch for each hull as she passes, and no talking.

On 19 an Giblean 1 DE, in the grey before sunrise, the volunteers departed.

They did not go straight down to the sea. The first hull came off the quay and swung, and the next came after her, and the boy saw that they meant to go round the river pool, sunwise, *diosal*, as you walk round a well or a new-built house for luck. He cut his notches. The hulls went by so near that he knew faces on them, and he did not look at the faces long, because he was counting.

At the foot of the pool the fleet straightened and went away down the Abhainn naomh toward open water, and there the harbour scribe's account of them ends, as if his pen had been lifted from the leaf. Of the crowd, or the weather, or who wept, the chronicles of the island say nothing. The harbour songs go a little further. They say the fleet stood out west into Manannan's sea, toward the Otherworld of the tellings, Tír nan Óg and Magh Meall, and that a mist came down on the water behind the last hull and did not lift until it was gone.

Whether the boy's stick said nineteen or twenty-one, no one thought to ask him.

V

Of the Two Landfalls and the White Sorrow

The years of Rodos are counted from that turn, though not at once. In 5 DE Donnchadh mac Thormoid, scribe of the vein-house, began to number the years from the sunwise turn at Seann Skell and called them the years of the Diosal. The crown's scribes took up his count only a generation later. So an island that had reckoned its time by kings and harvests began, in one clerk's hand, to reckon it by an absence.

That same year a report of the fleet came into Seann Skell. By whom it came, or in what boat, the custody-book will not say; only that the harbour scribe copied it in a hand that shook. The copy came down to later keepers stained by water, and its end is gone.

It tells of two landfalls, two separate coasts reached, and the keepers have read in it the seed of two later peoples where one had sailed. Which hulls went to which shore, and whether storm or quarrel or purpose parted them, is dark. Sixteen centuries later Beathag nic Thòmais of Muileann chaol found three copies of the report, and they differed in the order of the coasts and in the number of hulls. She wrote all three out side by side and chose none of them, and the library has followed her ever since.

In 7 DE Queen Beathag struck her sister Mòrag, and Mòrag's children, from the order of succession, as persons no longer on Rodos. The act stands in the roll without comment, between a grain ruling and the mending of a bridge. It is the last time the crown of Rodos wrote Mòrag's name, and it wrote it in the ordinary way.

What befell across the water after that, the island learned in pieces, if it learned it at all. The chronicle calls it the thinning. Cut off from the vein, whatever strength the crossing had asked of the departed faded in their children, and by the third generation abroad nothing was left that Rodos would have known for its own.

Then came the second silence. Some twelve years after the thinning is first written, men spoke of a second and smaller crossing: fewer ships, bound for a shore nobody named. Nothing that survives either bears it out or gives it the lie, and the keepers enter it and let it stand.

In 14 DE the vein-house counted again the households that held the right to the ore, and set the loss down as one hand in five. Beside the figure Donnchadh

mac Thormoid wrote that the vein itself answered no differently for those who stayed. Donnchadh never said whether he meant it as comfort or complaint, and men have argued over it since.

The next year the queen made a rite for the departed, and she kept it first for her sister. Beathag nic Dhòmhnaill came into her own hall in a gown of undyed wool, pale and rough as a fleece off the hill, and sat at the head of the board. Beside her a place was laid with no one in it: a cup, a trencher, a knife set straight. The meal that followed was neither feast nor fast. The court did not know what to do with its face, so it ate. The queen did not look at the empty place, and she did not look away from it either.

The court called the custom an *Tùrsa Geal*, the white sorrow, and the chronicle calls it the Mourning Custom, a rite that was never quite grief and never quite gladness. By the next generation it was kept in every harbour town on the island. Long afterward it would be taken up again, uneasily, for a very different leaving, and that belongs to its own book.

The year after, the island shaped itself around what was left. With part of the ore-bonded people gone the custodian class grew smaller and closer, and every later aristocracy of Rodos was cast in that mould. In 16 DE the remaining custodian households were gathered into seven houses, each answerable to the vein-house for its share of the ore and of the measured burning: Clann Mhuirich, Clann Fhearchair, Clann Ìomhair, Clann Raghnaill, Clann Thormoid, Clann Choinnich and Clann Lachlainn. Mark those names. Until that day the right to the ore had been earned by apprenticeship; from it, the right passed by house.

Queen Beathag died at Cathair dhearg in the summer of that year, the last ruler of Rodos to have seen the fleet. Her son Raghnaill mac Uilleim was crowned in the same hall.

VI

Of the Empty Harbour

The net-menders of Seann Skell tell the years after the leaving on winter nights with the door shut, and they tell them so.

A ceremony grew up around the berth the ships had left from, the empty-harbour rite, and it is kept still, in a lesser form, on an anniversary no one can now fix to the day. By 25 DE the harbour-master was writing his berths down

at half their old use, because the fishing households that had crewed the fleet were simply gone, and the rope-walks at Cuan shean laid off hands for the first time. On the north-west coast the fishers of Ceann mhòr kept a watch from the headland for returning sails, household by household in turn. The watch lapsed within a generation. No sail came.

By 28 DE Seann Skell had found a way to go on trading. The berth of the departure was given a new name, so that common trade could keep the old one without the memory clinging to it; the chronicle calls this a forgetting done on purpose. In the harbour rolls the berth became Cidhe an Diosail, the quay of the sunwise turn, and the name Cidhe an Iar passed to the new fish-wharf at the north end of the strand, where within a few years the fishers used it without a thought.

The tongue kept what the harbour put away. From 28 DE the custody-book writes *rogbnaich*, to choose, with nothing after it, meaning to have chosen the crossing, and the scribes of the next century write it so and never gloss it. By that same year a generation had grown up that had never seen the harbour with those ships in it, and for them the leaving was already history. A saying of the western shore claims to come from about this time:

Is fhada an cuan, is goirid a' chuimbne. Long is the sea, and short is memory.

Alasdair Saor died at Seann Skell at the end of that summer. His last work was a coasting trader of the old sewn-plank kind, built for a fish merchant of Inis àr-saidh. Seventeen years later his fellowship came quietly apart, since no one wanted ocean-going hulls any more, and its craft was half forgotten before anyone thought to need it again. In a hard season after that, its patterns and keel-moulds were broken up and burned for firewood. The harbour-master wrote down the loss of the shed and said nothing of what had been in it.

In 70 DE the seven houses drew lots at the vein-house for the galleries each would keep. The lot-stones went into a bag at Muileann dhearg, and for centuries the keepers there tipped them out into the hands of visitors. Doire fhionn, its oaks gone to the fleet, began to cut its woods by coppice, and the law spread to every shire with a *doire* in its name.

Every year on the eve of the empty-harbour rite the waterfront of Seann Skell kept the night of lamps. The children were told the lamps were for ships coming

home, and the priests let them believe it. The children's verse is still known on the west coast:

Solas air an uinneig, solas gus an tig iad dhachaigh. A light on the window,
a light till they come home.

Donnchadh mac Thormoid died at Muileann dhearg in 70 DE. His last entry is a list of the ore burned that season, household by household, in the same hand as his first. Sixteen years on, in 86 DE, King Ragnall died after a long reign in which little happened, and his son Ìomhar mac Raghnaill was crowned. The custody-book gives Ragnall a single line. After the shaking of its first years the age seems to have wanted no more than that.

VII

Of the Hawk and the Firlot

The centuries that followed were quiet as a well-kept house is quiet: much afoot, and most of it small. The silver of Muileann chiar, mined since the Holy Age, was beaten into neck-rings for the heads of the seven houses, and the smiths' fellowship of the seam shut its craft up within four families. Inis mhòr built barges for its grain, to go down the Abhainn ghorm and along the coast, sewn-plank boats of the old kind that never slept out of sight of land. The road-house of Am Buabhall Fortanach burned to its footings, and its keeper, Eilidh nic Chaluim, raised it again in stone. The account of her rebuilding already speaks of the juggled buffalo it was known for.

Beathag's line ended in 141 DE with King Ìomhar, who died childless. The heads of the seven houses were summoned to the capital, and in 143 DE they chose Fearchar mac Lachlainn of Baile Mòr dhomhain, of Clann Fhearchair. He was the first king in the record crowned by the choosing of the custodian houses. His son Fearchar Donn followed him, and no one gainsaid it.

In those years the orders of the Old Faith began to take their shapes. At Cnoc bheag the dawn-hawk rite of the Holy Age was still kept, and there in 190 DE the priestess Gormshuil nic Artair taught that the hawk of the rite was Mòd, the Hawk of Acaill, as old as Fionntan mac Bòchra, the oldest of men, and remembering all things with him; and that the vein was the Hungry Hawk, who must be

fed the measured handful and no more. A hawk overfed will not hunt, she said, and a hawk starved will turn on the hand. Her followers gathered the old rite into the first house of Òrd an t-Seabhaig, the order of the Hawk of Acaill, and her pupils raised a second at Ros gheal. After her death her sayings were written down as Leabhar an t-Seabhaig, the Book of the Hawk. The copyist, Ùisdean mac Pàdraig, marked every saying he had not heard from her own mouth, and the marked sayings outnumber the rest. The first in the book is one he heard:

Beathaich an seabhag, ach na sàsaich e. Feed the hawk, but do not glut him.

In 222 DE Clann Ìomhair walled Dùn dhearg in stone, the first walls on the island that any custodian house had raised. That same year Sileas nic Fhearchair, crowned after her father, fixed one measure for grain across the whole island, the firlot of Cathair dhearg, so that barter between shires need no longer begin with a quarrel over the size of a basket. She sent firlots of oak bound with iron to every shire seat. Later she set a tally-house in each royal granary, where every trade of grain for cloth, salt or labour was cut on paired sticks. It was the first account of trade to run the length of the island, and not one coin passed through it. She reigned more than half a century, and her son Uisdean mac Dhùghaill followed her in 285 DE.

It was a good time to be a carter. Near Imrich nam Pantar the herders began clearing the panther roads on the days the great cats crossed, driving their flocks aside beforehand, and those crossing days were the first thing the southern shires ever agreed on in writing. At An Leòmhann Buidhe on the northern mining road the ore-carters were served oatcakes fried in linseed oil, and fire water, and the keeper was fined for watering the fire water. Ros fhionn laid out salt pans at the brine springs on its river flats, and its salt, carted inland over Drochaid Ros fhionn, became the common measure of worth in the north-east.

VIII

Of the Forbidden Question, the Stone and the Two Horses

In 275 DE Coinneach mac Mhàrtainn, a druid of the schools of Flidais, lady of the deer, whose teaching the old rolls call Feallsanachd an Fhèidh, founded a house of disputation at Dùn thais. There the schools' old question, *Carson*

an làmh seo?, why the vein answers some hands and not others, was argued by rule, and pupils came to hear it from as far as Caol bheag.

Ten years later Coinneach stood up in his own hall to ask the thing he had been carrying.

The benches were full, and the air was thick with wet wool and tallow smoke. Coinneach was old enough by then to know which questions were safe. He had turned this one over on the road, to the knock of his stick, and it had grown no safer for the turning.

"We ask why the vein answers this hand and not that one," he said. "Then let us ask it of the hands that went. Were they the hands it answered best? And if they were, does it answer fewer now?"

No one spoke. A bench creaked. Somewhere at the back a young man laughed, once, and then thought better of it. Coinneach waited, as the rule of disputation bade him, for someone to answer. When no one did, he sat down.

The answer came from the seven houses. They forbade the question at their own tables. The record notes that until then they had forbidden only deeds, and that this was the first question they forbade.

The skills of the fleet were slipping already. In 305 DE a merchant of Inis àr-saidh paid for a deep-keeled hull, but the wrights could no longer remember how Alasdair Saor had scarfed his keels, and she listed so badly at her launch that she was broken up for timber.

Aonghas mac Uisdein, crowned in 355 DE, was the first king who learned his letters as a child, and in his reign two more orders took their shapes. In 370 DE Dòmhnall mac Ailein, a net-maker of Inis thais, where the wolf-sworn's stone stood, gave that stone its name and its order. He called it Clach, the Stone, and said it was Lia Fàil, which cries out under the rightful king; and he called its sworn guards the Fianna, who keep the island as a wolf keeps its range. So began Òrd na Cloiche, the order of the Stone, and the tales of Fionn and his band, which every hearth on the island knew, the Fianna took for their own. When the Hawk and the Stone both laid claim to the harbour shrine at Caol leathan, the king's reeve divided its days between them as the Holy Age had divided the sacred woods, and the sharing held.

In 402 DE Aonghas himself took up the wood-watchers' rite of Macha, which keeps the two horses of one chariot, foaled on one night: Liath Macha the grey and Dubh Sainglenn the black. Two horses, one yoke, the rite says; dark and light are two powers in balance, and the vein belongs to both. The court followed its

king, and Òrd Mhacha, the order of Macha, became the order of Cathair dhearg. From Aonghas on, the kings of Rodos were made by Macha's rite.

In 445 DE Eilidh nic Iain of Doire chiar, called Eilidh Dhubh, raised again the Holy Age's rival teaching, that the vein answers effort and cares nothing for birth, and her tracts were read aloud at harvest gatherings across the north-east. The vein-house ordered every copy brought to Muileann dhearg and burned, and some hundred were given up. Eilidh herself was never punished. She died at Doire chiar, still teaching.

Aonghas died that winter and was the first king buried by the rite of Macha. His son Iain reigned a short while, and Iain's son Tormod mac Iain, called Tormod Bàn for his white hair, was sworn to without dispute. On the central mining road the ox-teams of the mountain now waited out the snow at An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, whose keeper, Iain mac Mhurchaidh, built them a second byre and kept a book of the teams that lodged.

IX

Of the War of the Three Claimants

In 495 DE both sons of King Tormod Bàn were drowned when a ferry overturned crossing Abhainn fhionn in spate. The king had no other child. Thirteen years later he died at Cathair dhearg without naming an heir, and three claims were laid before the houses at once. Catrìona nic Aonghais of Inis thais was the dead king's niece. Dùghall Garbh of Baile Mòr dhomhain was his half-brother. Ragnall Ruadh was head of Clann Raghnaill and master of the vein-house. The seven houses split among the three, and in 513 DE the War of the Three Claimants began.

So small a cause, and so long a war: the keepers have wondered at it. Perhaps, having held the ore by inheritance for five hundred years, each house had come to believe that a crown could be inherited the same way.

Seann Warr, the port nearest the capital on the west, shut its gates on all three and declared for none. It was besieged twice and taken by neither. At the ford of Àth shean, the northern town of that name and no kin to the granary town, Dùghall Garbh's host broke Ragnall Ruadh's, and the custody-book counts some three hundred dead, most of them drowned in the ford. Ragnall's men burned Doire mhin and its granary as they fell back, and the villagers wintered at

Cathair mhòr on the charity of Macha's priests. Catriona laid siege to Cathair dhomhain, which had declared for Dùghall, and took it after forty days, when the dead of the siege lines had fouled its wells; and she let the garrison go free on their oath.

Snow lay on the mountain on 24 am Faoilleach 519 DE, when Ragnall Ruadh came out into the yard of the vein-house.

The carriers were waiting there with their baskets and their sealed measures, as carriers had waited every season since before there were kings, stamping against the cold. Beyond the gate the road wound down toward the shires, white and empty.

Ragnall had a list in his hand. His clerk had drawn it up the night before: the shires that stood against him, and every hearth and temple in them that took the handful. It was a long list. He read it through once more in the thin light, and then he gave it to the master of the store.

"None of these," he said.

The master of the store looked at the list, and then at him. Since the Small-Burning Law began it had measured the ore out; no one in that yard had ever seen it used to hold the ore back. "Lord," the man said, and got no further.

"None of these," said Ragnall again, and went in out of the wind.

Down in the shires that stood against him, hearths that had been lit with the ore for generations burned low, and grey, and then went cold. The chronicle says the deed turned more against him than any battle. A verse from the cold shires survives, with no name to it:

Cha do chaill sinn blàr, ach chaill sinn an teine. We did not lose a battle, but we lost the fire.

Catriona and Dùghall joined their hosts against him, and on 14 am Faoilleach 521 DE, in the dead of another winter, they met Ragnall below Muileann chrom. He was killed on the field. The next day his own custodians opened the vein-house, and the carriers went down the white road with their baskets full. Dùghall died of his wounds at Baile Mòr dhomhain in 522 DE, and his followers went over to Catriona without another blow. She was crowned at Cathair dhearg in 523 DE, and was called ever after Catriona Bhuadhach, Catriona the Victorious. The war had lasted some ten years.

Three years later she did the deed she is remembered for. With the vein-house she fixed it in law that no claimant, house or king might withhold the measured handful from any lawful hearth. This was the ruling of the hearth, the first law in the record written to bind the custodians themselves. To Seann Warr she granted the right to keep its own gates and tolls, in memory of its standing aside, and had the grant cut over the landward gate. When she died in 565 DE the houses swore to her son Lachlann mac Iain in a single day, and the record remarks on it.

In 585 DE Seònaid nic Coinnich, a clerk of the late queen's household, wrote the history of the war from the custody-book and from the mouths of those who had fought. It is the oldest history on Rodos told as one tale from end to end, and every later history of the island descends from it, this book among them. That same year a spotted fever killed some three hundred at Inis chrom. The Fianna of the Stone nursed the sick, and many of them died of it, and after that the town was the Stone's for good.

X

Of Manannan's Mist, and the Crown Joined to the Vein

So the fishing families of the west coast tell the coming of Manannan's order, as an old woman of Ros bheag once told it to a keeper of Muileann chaol over her nets.

In 615 DE a preacher named Mànas mac Ruairidh stood up at Seann Skell, of all places, where the sting-creed of the Holy Age had first called itself the only true faith, and proclaimed its one power: Manannan mac Lir, lord of the sea, whose Cup of Truth breaks at a lie spoken over it and bears the yellow scorpion for its sign. Manannan, he said, had shut the western sea behind the fleet with his mist, and hid the island in it from every ship beyond; and what the fleet had done must never be tried again. Those who heard him on the quay were the first congregation of Òrd Mhanannain, the order of Manannan. A month later, in the autumn of 615 DE, Lachlann mac Iain died at Cathair dhearg and his daughter Anna was crowned. The record calls his reign quiet, and means it as praise.

The teaching went down the west coast with the fishing families. At Cuan shean the rope-makers, whose walks had been laid out for the fleet, were among the first to take it up. In 655 DE Manannan's priests at Ros bheag laid it down that no boat of the faithful might go beyond sight of the headlands. The west

coast kept that rule for centuries, and there the steering of boats by the stars, half lost already, was lost entirely. Of all the orders of the Old Faith the keepers have been least easy with Manannan's, the one order whose teaching stands on the Sundering; and what it teaches is that the island must never again do what the fleet did.

In 700 DE the vein-house and the crown's scribes found that their counts of years since the Setting-Out disagreed. They settled the difference by agreement, and by the same agreement fixed the day of the empty-harbour rite, which the two counts had placed differently. Later scribes gave up pretending it had been fixed by evidence. Every year in this book stands on that bargain between two offices, and the reader should know it.

Eilidh Bhàn, fifth ruler of the house of Catrìona, was crowned in 730 DE, and the record of her long reign is nearly all harvests. The north-west had no share in them. From 745 DE boats out of the small islands off that coast fell on the coasting traders and took their fish and grain. The sea-thieves were Ròdaich of the north-west shore, and the harbour rolls give some of their names. Baile chrom reported half its houses empty, and the crown remitted its grain dues. In 762 DE a force sent by Eilidh Bhàn landed on Eilean dhubh and burned the thieves' boats on the strand, and their leader, Uilleam Ruadh, was hanged at Cathair dhearg. It did not save the coast. In 780 DE a run of failed harvests brought a dearth to the north-west shore that the shared-meal custom could not carry. Families went inland and east, and the north-west stayed thinly held until the age was out.

In 790 DE the queen's scribes recopied the king-list from its oldest surviving roll and added the rulers since the Sundering. The new copy opens the present age with the Choosing, ahead of the fleet, and this book keeps that order. Twelve years after, Eilidh Bhàn died childless, and the seven houses met to choose; this time they met at the vein-house, and the capital waited on their word. They named Dòmhnall Ruadh of Clann Raghnaill, a descendant of the claimant killed at Muileann chrom, and he kept the mastery of the vein-house together with the crown. In 820 DE his reeves wrote into the custody-book that the ruler of Rodos is also master of the vein-house. From then on the heads of the seven houses sat as the king's council, and custodians and court were one body. What Raghnaill Ruadh had seized in war, his descendant now held by law. The ruling of the hearth still bound the custodians; the custodians, now, were the crown. Dòmhnall Ruadh was buried at Muileann dhearg, under the mountain, far from the capital.

The Hawk split in 850 DE over whether Mòd's measure might ever be raised. Those who held it fixed for ever kept the name of the Hungry Hawk and the house at Cnoc bheag. Those who said a larger flock might be fed a larger handful were called the Fed Hawk, and they went to Seann Skell on the north coast, the other town of that name. In 880 DE they petitioned the council to raise the handful by a quarter for the northern hearths. The council refused. It was the first recorded asking to change the Small-Burning Law, and the custody-book enters the Fed Hawk's teaching as an error, at length.

XI

Of the Stair under the Hill

In 890 DE a second tremor in the hills of Cill ghlas brought down a gallery of the vein and killed fourteen labourers. The vein-house closed the gallery and set a stone at its mouth with the fourteen names cut on it. The last shepherds left the high pastures of Doire uaine. They said it was for the grazing, and every one of them who was asked also spoke of the Marbh-bheò.

In 940 DE, north of the capital, a quarry face gave way under the hammers and opened on darkness.

Air came up out of the hole, cold as well-water, and it smelt of nothing at all, which was worse than any smell. One of the quarrymen held a lamp in at arm's length, and they saw steps: a stair cut in the living rock, each tread worn hollow at the middle, going down and down past where the light would reach. Someone said the name before anyone else could, Toll-dubh, the shaft of the old tellings, long lost. After that nobody said anything.

One of them went down. His fellows watched his lamp go, turning and dropping and dwindling, until the rock swallowed it. They waited. One who was there said afterward that they waited long enough to be ashamed of how glad they were when the light came back.

The man climbed out, sat down on the spoil heap and said nothing, and whatever he may have said later went unwritten. The custodians came down from the vein-house and had the entrance walled up.

Twenty years later Ailean mac Dhùghaill of the druid school at Dùn thais measured the ruin of Làrach an Teampaill and wrote that its altar faced the central mountains, with its back to the sea. Who had set it so, he would not guess. By 972

DE he had finished his tables of the three old ruins, Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, Làrach an Dùin and Làrach an Teampaill, with their measures and their stone and the lie of each, and he concluded that he could not say whether one people had built all three. Because of his tables no one after him could say either.

Mòrag Ruadh of Clann Raghnaill was crowned in 980 DE, the first ruler whose household accounts survive whole. On 15 an Dùbhlachd 1000 DE, in the dark of the year, the vein-house marked the thousandth year of its count with a single measured burning of the ore on Cidhe an Diosail at Seann Skell, and the queen stood by. The flame burned the colour of the vein, the record says, and the crowd went home without a word.

X I I

Of Things Forgotten, and the Brothers' War

After the thousandth year the island began, plainly, to lose what it knew. A sickness that closed the throat, the swallowing cough, broke out at Muileann dhomhain in 1040 DE and killed nearly a third of the town. When it reached Seann Bhral the townsfolk shut their own harbour and kept the shared-meal custom by leaving food at the gate. Queen Beathag Fhionn, daughter of Mòrag Ruadh, closed the coast road between the two towns and set reeves at the fords to turn travellers back, and the cough went no further west. Her son Ailean followed her, the first of four kings of that name in the house of Raghnaill.

The dyers of Baile ghorm had made a fast blue from a marsh plant and a mordant of their own, and it was the feast-day dress of the seven houses. In 1100 DE the last dyer who knew the mordant died without apprentices, having quarrelled with both of hers, and the blue that came after was the common blue of the rest of the island.

The Abhainn bheag silted behind a shifting bar below Ros fhionn, and the salt-masters moved their trade to Caol gharbh on the coast. The carts stopped crossing Drochaid Ros fhionn, and the bridge-keeper's office was done away with. Fishers of the thinned north-west saw the Sea-Watcher, Uilebheist na Mara, close enough to foul their nets, and the few boats left there drew further in.

In 1170 DE Raghnaill mac Chaluim of the druid school at Dùn thais set out a table showing that the heads of the custodian houses lived, on the average, a few years longer than the tenants of their lands, and he asked whether the vein an-

swers the hand that holds it. The record notes the finding uneasily and gives it no answer. The council forbade the table to be copied and shut the house at Dùn thais for a generation. Raghnaill's own copy went into the vein-house and was entered in its inventory.

In 1227 DE King Ailean mac Raghnaill died and left two sons by different mothers, Iain Ciar and Alasdair Bàn, each of whom had been told he was the heir. Four years after, Alasdair Bàn's men seized Cnoc naomh and Iain Ciar took it back. The houses split four to three, and the Brothers' War, Cogadh nam Bràithrean, took its name from that fight. Alasdair's ships burned the waterfront of Ceann mhin, which held for his brother; the fire took the rope stores and the granary, and the town had to beg its bread from Cathair mhòr. In 1235 DE Iain Ciar beat Alasdair below Muileann ghlas, took him alive, and let his captains go home. The field comes into the record again two ages on.

The peace was made in 1237 DE at An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, the road-house where the ox-teams waited out the snow, on neutral ground between the brothers' lands.

The keeper of the house had been given a day's warning and had spent it scrubbing. She set the long board in the common room with a bench on either side, the benches the same length to a finger's breadth, for she had heard that great men quarrel over such things, and she put the same bread and the same ale at each end. Then she stood by the fire and tried to look as though she were not listening.

Iain Ciar came in first and sat. Alasdair Bàn came after him, stiff as a man is who has lately been a prisoner, and sat down across the board. For a long while neither spoke, and the keeper could hear the oxen shifting in the byre. What passed between them she never told. Alasdair gave up his claim and took the lordship of Seann Chwen for his life. Iain Ciar was crowned. When they rose, both loaves had been broken and neither eaten.

Alasdair kept the peace he had made and died at Seann Chwen. Because he had seen Ceann mhin beg its bread, Iain Ciar ordered every shire seat to keep a year's grain against the next war. The law held while he lived and lapsed within a few years of his death, as he had foreseen in a note in his own hand. His clerk Pàdraig mac Ruairidh wrote the account of the war. It praises the king at every turn, and it is the only account that survives, which later readers have found inconvenient.

The road-houses come back into the record here. In 1280 DE the crown chartered the seven great road-houses of the mining circuit and made their keepers answerable for the roads between them, and the keepers met once a year at An Sligeanach Fad' às to settle their accounts. At An Taigh-seinnse Reòta on the bare northern road a party of reeves was snowed in for a whole season and lived on pickled spinach and fire milk. Their complaint to the charter-roll is set down in full.

In 1320 DE Seumas mac Iain of Seann Skell tried to build a deep-keeled hull again from what the strand still remembered of the Sundering fellowship's lore. She filled and sank at her launch, and Manannan's priests preached on her for a year.

Thirty years later Iseabail nic Lachlainn, a folk-collector of the royal household, came to Cuan shean for the songs of the rope-makers. She found them at the end of a walk that had lost half its length to barley, going backward in a line as they twisted the strands and singing to keep the pace. Most of it was the common stuff of work-songs. Then the leader struck up a song she had never heard, and the others fell in behind him, and she caught *druim* and *aisne*, keel and rib, and began to write fast.

Afterward she asked what the song was about. Rope, they told her. And the words further on? They looked at one another. Nobody knew. They were the words of the song.

It names the parts of a deep keel. It is the only record of the fleet's craft that survives in any shape. Its first lines can still be understood:

Druim fon aisne, aisne fon chlàr, clàr ri clàr is an cuan fodhpa. Keel under rib, rib under plank, plank to plank and the sea beneath them.

After that the song runs on in words no one can read. The rope-makers who kept it were of Manannan's order by then, and they sang it anyway.

XIII

Of the Last Lamps

The last four centuries of the age are the longest stretch in the record and have the least to tell, and the keepers will not dress them up.

The order of the Stone split over whether the dead, who are Donn's, might be prayed for at Clach, and its two houses, at Inis thais and Baile gheal, were not reconciled in this age. Catriona Bheag of Clann Raghnaill was crowned in 1390 DE, the first queen in more than three centuries. The record notes that she was small, and that no one said so twice. In 1410 DE she had the heads of the seven houses swear to the ruling of the hearth in her presence, the first renewal of that oath since Catriona Bhuadhach. Clann Choinnich swore last.

More was forgotten. The potters of Muileann gheal made a grey-green glaze no other kiln could match, and the custodian houses bought it for their tables. The secret stayed in one family, and in 1470 DE the last of them died without passing it on. The smiths of Dùn dhearg lost the last man who knew how their layered steel was folded, and afterward the blades of Dùn dhearg were ordinary. In the east, charcoal-burners found again the eastern Toll-dubh of the old tellings, with the same cut stair as the first. The custodians walled that one up as well, and the scribe cross-referenced the two entries.

At Àth shean the granary found that its firloft had worn smaller than the standard of Cathair dhearg, and had been so for generations. The reeve corrected the accounts as far back as anyone could reckon.

Sileas Òg, named for the queen of the firloft, was crowned in 1490 DE, the first ruler to visit every shire seat. She ordered a new count of the households holding the right to the ore. It came out smaller than any before it, for the right had narrowed into fewer and larger households, and she had it entered without comment. In 1520 DE Clann Choinnich asked leave to burn the ore beyond the measured handful to smelt silver at Muileann chiar, arguing that it burned hotter than charcoal. The council refused. Until then the ore had been burned only for worship, and this was the first asking to burn it for work. The keepers know where that asking leads in the next age, and here they only set it down.

Ailean the Fourth had the shortest reign in the king-list. His sister Mòrag nic Ailein, who followed him, reigned forty years, and her entries record nothing but good harvests and the rite. In 1551 DE the priests of Manannan met in synod at Seann Skell, restated the rule of sight-of-land, and added a prayer to be said at the foot of the river pool:

A Mhanannain, cùm a' mhuir dùinte. Manannan, keep the sea shut.

The library that keeps this record begins here. In 1620 DE Beathag nic Thòmais, a mill-owner's widow of Muileann chaol, began buying up old copies of the custody-book and the harbour rolls from houses that no longer read them, and stacked them in a loft over her mill. Soon a mill in the same town began making paper from rags, the first on Rodos, and the custody-book was copied onto paper for the first time. Among her papers were the three copies of the landfall report. She died in 1660 DE and left the loft to the town on condition that nothing in it be burned. The town kept that condition, and very little else of her wishes.

The crown sent a reeve to list the households of the north-west coast between Baile chrom and Ceann mhòr, and he counted fewer households than harbour berths. Tormod mac Ruairidh, crowned in 1670 DE, reigned more than fifty years. In 1675 DE Manannan's priests at Seann Skell began saying their prayer to keep the sea shut on the same day as the empty-harbour rite, so that the two were kept together on Cidhe an Diosail. Neither side was pleased.

In 1710 DE a visiting scribe found the rite at Seann Skell kept by the harbour priests and a few old families, and wrote that none of them could say on which day the fleet had truly sailed. The house of disputation at Dùn thais, shut and opened more than once since the table of years, opened again in 1720 DE on condition that the question of longer lives was not raised. The scholars agreed, and argued about the vein instead.

Tormod's daughter Gormshuil nic Thormoid, crowned in 1727 DE, rode a progress round every shire seat. Her clerks wrote down each shire's grievances, and she answered none of them in writing. On the eastern road An Taigh-òsta Grianach fed her company on pan-fried spinach and black wine, and its keeper, Peigi nic Dhonnchaidh, was let off her road dues for a year. It is the last warm entry of the age. In 1737 DE Clann Choinnich asked again to burn the ore for the silver smelt, with three of the seven houses behind it now, and Gormshuil's council refused by one voice. The record names the member who changed his vote and keeps his reason to itself. In 1752 DE the vein-house counted the households of the right for the last time in this age. They were fewer than ever, and larger, and three of the seven houses held more than half the right between them.

In 1755 DE a worked timber came ashore at Ceann mhòr on the empty north-west coast, from beyond Manannan's mist, as the fishers said. It was longer than any tree on the island and fastened with nails of a make no smith on Rodos knew. They carted it to Seann Skell and showed it to Manannan's priests, and the priests burned it.

By then fewer and fewer houses on the Seann Skell waterfront kept the night of lamps, and at last none did. An old woman set a lamp in a window of the harbour-house, and the scribe wrote that it was she who kept it, and not the town.

On 17 an t-Sultain 1764 DE the harbour scribe of Seann Skell went down to Cidhe an Diosail with his board and his pen for the empty-harbour rite. The dressed stones of the old quay were green at the foot, where the river had been working at them for eighteen centuries. He counted the people standing on them, and it did not take him long. There were eleven. When the rite and Manannan's prayer were said and the people had gone home, he looked at the sky and at the water, and wrote down the number, the weather and the state of the tide. He sat a while with the pen in his hand before he closed the board.

Clann Choinnich did not bring its silver petition to the council again, for the member who had turned the vote had died. The petition lay in the vein-house unanswered, and the record of the age ends with the Small-Burning Law still kept.

In those last winters the priests of Manannan at Seann Skell wrote that the mist on the western sea, which had hidden Rodos from every ship beyond it since the fleet sailed into it, lay thinner each year. On 27 an Dàmhair 1774 DE they set it down in so many words, and they said their prayer at every tide.

A fisher of the west coast, putting out before dawn on one of those still mornings, rested on her oars off the headland where the rule of sight-of-land told her to turn. All her life the grey had stood out there on the water like a wall of wet fleece, and the sea ran into it and did not come out. That morning she could see through it. Beyond the grey lay a line, hard and dark and level, ruled across the edge of the world: the open sea, going on. She looked at it for a long time. Then she turned for home as the rule said, and from the quay she heard the priests at their prayer. Manannan, keep the sea shut.

Eighteen centuries after a queen at Cathair dhearg said she would keep no one back, Rodos had kept the vein and kept the law, and had let go of nearly everything else the fleet had meant: the keel and the stars, the far coast, all but eleven keepers of the rite. The houses were fewer and richer. The north-west was nearly empty. For two hundred years the prayer to keep the sea shut had been said, and no one had tried the sea. Then the mist lifted, and sails came in over that water from the far side, and they were no sails of Rodos. The people under them had crossed the water the Ròdaich once crossed. Whether any of them came down from those who chose to go, no one on Rodos knew then, and no one

knows now. With their coming begins the Age of Strangers, and the next book tells it.

THE FOURTH BOOK

AN AOIS CHOIGREACH

the Age of Strangers

Thàinig na coigrich air an t-sàl, agus dh'fhàg iad an cnoc falamh.

The strangers came over the brine, and they left the hill empty.
— a line sung in the camps, as the copyists at Muileann chaol set it
down

Here is told the history of Rodos from the Crossing to the Severance: the hundred and fifty years in which men from over the western sea ruled the island, first by leave and then without it. It is drawn from four witnesses: the rolls of the custodians, most of which live now only in the copies made in a cellar of Muileann chaol; the letter-books of the humans' Administration, left lying in the Residency when its masters fled; the daybooks of the beacon-keepers, who wrote down every sail they saw; and the songs of the camps, which were forbidden, and were written down for that reason. Where the witnesses quarrel, both are heard. Where they fall silent, the telling falls silent with them.

I

Of the Three Ships and the Leave to Stay

The age begins with the Crossing, on 5 am Faoilleach 1780 DE, when the humans first made landfall on Rodos. That winter Manannan's mist lifted, which had lain on the western sea since the fleet of the Sundering sailed

into it and had hidden the island from every ship beyond. The fishers of Achadh àrsaidh saw it go, and theirs is the first telling.

Two boats were out that morning, working the lines off the north-west cape, where the old men say the Sea-Watcher rises when it pleases. The mist stood on the water as it had stood all their lives, a grey wall a few oar-lengths off. But that morning the wall had gone to gauze, and behind the gauze there was a paleness that moved.

It was sail; then three sails, heaped high on masts taller than any tree the fishers knew, and under them black hulls, wet and shining, coming on slowly out of the west with the mist tearing off their bows in rags. A voice called down from high up in a tongue that was no tongue at all.

The steersman stood and gave back the old hail of the north-west boats. The voice answered. Neither understood a word of the other. Nothing in all the customs of Rodos told a fisherman what to do when the sea opened. At last the steersman put his tiller over and turned south for Cuan shean, where there were custodians whose business it was to know. When he looked back, the three ships were following.

The place of that meeting is called Coinneachadh nan Long, the meeting of the ships (13 am Faoilleach 1780 DE), and the boats of Achadh àrsaidh slow there still.

The roll of Cuan shean, which is the fuller witness, first sets the ships down on the thirteenth day of that month: three hulls out of the west riding at anchor off the town, the first of their size seen from any shore of the island since the fleet of the Sundering went out sunwise from the harbour and did not come back. Their master came in through the surf in a small boat with eleven men and no weapon among them that anyone could see. The roll calls him Edmund Harrow. He waded the last of the way, stood on the shingle in front of the custodians of the town, and held out an empty cask and tipped his hand to his mouth.

They gave him water. More than that they would not give on their own word, for no custodian living had ever been asked such a thing, and they sent a rider inland to the capital for counsel. For forty days the strangers were fed on the beach and kept below the dunes.

On 11 am Faoilleach 1781 DE the Council of Custodians at Cathair dhearg gave the strangers leave to stay. The council had sat in the crown's place since the crown fell vacant at the close of the Age of Sundering, and its high custodian in those years was Tormod mac Ailein. The roll enters the vote as unanimous. In the

margin a later hand has written that three custodians were absent. The copyists kept the note, for it is the first of many places in the record of this age where what was written and what was so do not quite meet.

Soon the old sailors of Cuan shean began to say that the strangers had come in from the very quarter of the sea into which the Sundering fleet had sailed. The council forbade the remark in its hall. It was written down anyway, and never answered. Whether the humans were children of the departed, or of some other people of those waters, or of no one the Ròdaich ever knew, the island has never learned.

II

Of the Season of Words

The strangers had a name for their homeland in their own tongue, and no Ròdach scribe troubled to set it down. From the first season the rolls call it *an Tìr Thall*, the land beyond, and call its people simply the humans; and so they are called in this book. They had brought their god with them over the sea: Crìosd, one God and no other, with priests and a Bible and a great company of saints. The Ròdaich called that faith *an Eaglais*, the Church, after the word its clerics used, and the name has held.

Then came the season of words, when the clerics of the Church and the custodians sat down together to make a common tongue out of two. What was agreed in that season neither side has handed down whole. Two lists were kept, side by side.

The custodian Gormshuil nic Fhearchair kept the Ròdach list. Through that season she sat across a table from the cleric Samuel Wren, a thin, courteous man who coughed in the damp, and the two of them pointed at things. He held up a cup and said his word, and she wrote it; she held up bread and said *aran*, and he wrote that. Before the season was out they had some hundreds of words each.

Then one morning Gormshuil tipped a basket of broken ore out on the table where the window-light fell, a double handful from the vein, black and glassy, bright at the edges where the stone had split.

She began to name the colours. There was the green that lies under the black like deep water under weed, and the red at the break that deepens if you breathe on it, and the grey-violet of old cuttings, and the brown that means the piece

came from near the surface; and she laid a finger on each and gave its word, as any child of the hills could have done. She gave forty, and there were more, and she stopped because Wren had stopped writing.

He picked up a piece and turned it in the light with his eyes narrowed, and looked at her in a puzzled, kindly way. Then he said a single word, and wrote a single word, and tapped the whole heap with his pen to show that the word stood for all of it.

When she understood the word she sat very still. It was the word for the fuel his people burned at home.

She waited for him to ask for hers. He smiled, and set the ore aside to make room on the table, and held up a candle.

Wren's list lies still in the Administration's letter-books. Gormshuil's was lost, and only its first leaf lives on, in a copy: forty words for the colours of broken ore. Her copyist wrote beneath it a thing the chroniclers have since set at the head of the whole age. The humans had one word for the black ore of the vein, and it was their word for fuel. No Ròdais word in either list answered to it. And the humans did not ask for one.

III

Of the Years of Fair Exchange

Let it be told plainly, since what came after has thrown its shadow back across them: the first years were good. The island had been alone for eighteen centuries and lacked much that the strangers had, and the giving ran both ways. For a few years the bargain looked as if it would last, and those who trusted it were no fools.

The humans set up a trading post at Ros dhomhain, the capital's harbour on the lake. Iron tools went across its counter, and window glass, lamp-oil and paper; wool came back, and salt fish, hides and dyed cloth. Its first tally-book, kept by the trader Thomas Pike, balances to the last line across its first year. The smiths of Cathair dhearg took the humans' bar-iron gladly and learned to temper it in a single winter, and within a few seasons the old bronze hoes of the capital's fields were melted down for bells. The salt-pans of Seann Warr sold to Pike by the barrel, and theirs was the first Ròdach trade the humans came back asking for twice.

Harrow sailed west with hides and cloth in his holds and came back with four ships in place of three. He brought carpenters, and a surgeon, and a letter from a trading house in an Tìr Thall asking what else the island had. The surgeon, Jonas Tull, set the broken leg of a Cuan shean fisherman whom the whole town had given up for lame, and the custodian of Cuan shean entered it in the roll as the first debt owed to a stranger.

In 1784 DE the small port of Baile dhìreach, on the south-west coast, took Ròdaich and humans alike under one council of six, three of either people. Its founding compact was written twice, once in each tongue, and it is the only such compact of the age. The chair passed in alternate years between the fisherman Iain mac Chaluim and the human carpenter William Rook, and the harbour dues went half to the custodians and half to the humans' post.

At Baile dhìreach the net-maker Eilidh nic Ruairidh married the human cooper Samuel Hale. The council entered the marriage in both its books. The custodians at Cathair dhearg, asked for a ruling on it, sent none. No other town tried what Baile dhìreach had tried, and the tellers will come back to that marriage when they reach the years in which the humans' law found a use for it.

In 1785 DE a human supply ship struck the western reefs in fog and nine of her crew were drowned. Her master had been sailing, the letter-books complain, by a chart drawn from memory on a coast lit only by the old driftwood fires. The human navigators asked for beacons, and the Ròdach engineers agreed, and did not yet see what the asking would bring. The navigator James Fenn and the Ròdach mason Torcall Clachair walked the coast together that year to choose the ground. They marked the five headlands of the old fires. Fenn's chart survives. Torcall's cairns, for the most part, have gone back into the hills.

IV

Of the Treaty in One Tongue, and the Company

In 1787 DE the terms of the humans' presence were set down in writing for the first time, in the humans' tongue only, and no one on the Ròdach side is known to have spoken against it.

Tormod mac Ailein came to the council hall at Cathair dhearg on the day of the signing, 7 an Cèitean 1787 DE, and sat down at the long table across from Jo-

siah Pell, newly come over the sea as the humans' first Commissioner. Between them lay the treaty, covered edge to edge in the strangers' close black writing.

Tormod could not read a word of it. The letters stood on the page like a fence of thorn. Someone read it to him, and he sat with his hands folded and listened as the voice went down the sheets, and once he asked for a line to be read again. Outside the rain was coming off the lake.

When the reading was done Pell turned the last sheet round and held out a pen. Tormod took it. He looked a long moment at the place where his name should go, as a man looks at a ford before he wades it. Then he wrote, and Pell signed after him for the Administration.

Pell built a house of dressed stone on the rise above Ros dhomhain and called it the Residency, and from it the humans governed Rodos for a hundred and forty years. Harrow went back to the sea, and with Pike he founded a trading house licensed by the Administration, which the island knew only as the Company. Its charter gave it first refusal on "all fuels, ores and minerals the island may yield." Its first building of its own was a stone warehouse at Cathair dhomhain, along the lake shore, where it kept its tools out of reach of the harbour thieves. The copyists ask the reader to remember that warehouse.

The strangers' fever came ashore at Cuan shean with a crowded ship in 1788 DE and ran down the west coast. Ninety-one Ròdaich died of it, by the custodians' count, and eleven humans. The custodians shut Cuan shean to ships for a season, and Pell protested in writing.

In 1789 DE the Company sent two prospectors, Abel Stone and Hugh Mercer, into the hills east of the capital, the country of Muileann chrom. They came down again with sacks of broken ore on their backs and word that the black seam ran "further than can be walked in a day." The custodians demanded the ore back, to be laid in the rock again with the proper words. The Company gave back half. The roll enters the other half as "carried west."

In 1790 DE trade turned into arrangement. Under the first contracts of extraction Ròdach hands began to cut the vein on a scale that no reverent keeping had ever used. A crew of thirty opened the first pit at Muileann chrom, paid by the ton in iron tools and lamp-oil, where the custodians' own cuttings had never once been measured by weight. The Company built an ore quay at Ceann fhada, a fishing hamlet below the hills, and paid the fishermen for their foreshore in iron nails, by weight. Wren finished his grammar of Ròdais for the Mission, which was the Church's mission to the island. It is careful and right in most things, and it turns

the name of the vein's custodians into "keepers of the coal." The Mission raised a chapel on the quay at Ros dhomhain and hung in it the first iron bell on Rodos, and the custodians asked that it not be rung before the fishing fleet was out.

In 1793 DE one settlement would not sign.

The Company's agent climbed to Doire mhòr, in the hills above Muileann chrom, with the contract under his coat. The custodian, Beathag Dhubh, met him at her door and did not ask him in. She let him say all he had come to say, and answered him in a few words, and shut the door.

Her words live only in his report, where he set them down in his own tongue: that the hill was not hers to sell, and not his to buy.

Doire mhòr was not punished. The Company opened its next working at Cnoc fhiadhaich instead, and ran its cart-road round Doire mhòr's fields rather than through them. The annals add two words: *for now*.

The first of the new beacons was finished in 1794 DE on the southern headland at Tobar dhearg, a round tower of grey stone raised over the old fire-tower and paid for by the Company. Torcall Clachair built it and Fenn set its lens.

In 1796 DE the humans brought in their coin beside the barter of the island, for convenience, they said: the mark and its hundred pence, struck at Ros dhomhain from metal shipped in from an Tìr Thall, with a ship on one face and nothing of Rodos on either. At the capital the custodians' clerks began to keep two sets of books, and complained of it in both. Within ten years nothing that came across the sea could be had for anything but marks.

Wren spent a winter at Dùn thais among the druids of Feallsanachd an Fhèidh, the school of the deer. He asked them why the vein should be holy. They asked him why his fuel should be burned. Neither side's account names a winner. Wren wrote home that the druids told of a voyage west to an isle of the blessed very like his own Church's telling of Naomh Breandan, told from the other shore, and that he did not know what to make of it.

The Harbour Articles followed, written like the treaty in the humans' tongue alone, and they fixed the dues at Ros dhomhain in the Company's favour. This time two custodians refused to sign. The council granted the Administration upland grazing in the north-west, around Muileann àrsaidh, for human families who would not work in the pits. The grant was for grazing. The families built houses of stone.

Tormod mac Ailein died at Cathair dhearg in 1799 DE, and the council chose Coinneach Glas of Ceann àrsaidh to follow him, a man who had never met a hu-

man before the Crossing and had dealt with little else since. In 1800 DE Edmund Harrow's ship did not come home from the western crossing. The Company passed wholly into Pike's hands, and the letter-books mourned Harrow as the man who found Rodos.

V

Of the Lapse of the Law, and the First Steward

The keepers at the hearths of the hills tell the end of the Small-Burning Law as they would tell of a fire that went out for want of feeding. That Law had been kept since the Holy Age: that the vein be cut and burned sparingly, and that what the hill could give in a year be counted and never exceeded. The Age of Sundering ended with it still kept. Within a generation of the Crossing it was gone. No council repealed it. It stopped being enforced when it stopped paying to enforce it. At Dùn dhearg the custodian Fionnghal nic Artair wrote to the council the only defence of the Law that has come down. The ore, she wrote, had never been the heart of it; the Law had been about the people, who would become whatever the burning made them.

At Seann Skell the hawk-priest Murchadh Seabhag preached that Mòd, the Hungry Hawk of Acaill, starves those who eat faster than the land can feed them. The sermon was copied and carried into the camps, and it was the first Ròdach writing the Company's agents were told to seize. At Muileann chrom the Company burned ore by the cartload to drive its pumps, and when Coinneach Glas's council asked that the old tally be kept, it was sent a copy of the Company's accounts.

Pell sailed home in 1803 DE and did not return. Henry Maddox came in his place, with orders to double the yield and a letter in his pocket promising him a share of it. In 1804 DE a gallery at Cnoc fhiadhaich, driven forward faster than any Ròdach crew would have chosen and without the timbering the crews had begged for, came down and killed eleven. The custodians' roll names all eleven. The Company's report names none, and calls the gallery "unsound ground." Then a dry cough ran through the camps and killed thirty-eight, most of them boys who broke ore at the pit-mouth. The Mission's surgeon called it a winter complaint. It lasted through the summer.

The second beacon was lit at Baile ìseal on the eastern shore, with Torcall Clachair directing the work from a chair at the foot of the headland, too old now to climb. The Company founded a camp of timber huts at Àth ìseal, the first settlement on Rodos built for no purpose but the pit. It dammed the stream that watered Doire mhòr to wash its ore. No order for it was ever found. Beathag Dhubh's people carried water up by hand for two summers, and then they began to leave. In 1809 DE the hill villages lost their oats to rain that no one was home to cut ahead of, and the Company sold them meal for marks, and they had few marks.

From 1810 DE the mountain was worked by the ton. The Company was chartered anew in an Tìr Thall under a name the Ròdaich never used, and at Ros dhomhain its agents outnumbered the Administration's clerks four to one. Ore barges loaded at Cidhe Beag on Abhainn uaine, where the old canoe landing was widened with cut stone and its shrine carried uphill out of the way. Within a few seasons the green river ran black with slurry and the salmon at its mouth failed, and the fishermen kept the river's name and said it bitterly. Baile dhomhain was laid out on a grid by a Company surveyor, the first Ròdach town drawn on paper before a stone of it was set. On the ore road the old carters' house at the halfway stage was rebuilt and kept its name, An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, and its keeper Seònaid Bhàn took marks and barter both, the only keeper on the road who would. Seann Toll was made an ore landing for the barges on the Abhainn uaine, and its fishing boats were moved to the next reach.

In 1815 DE a Ròdach was set over Ròdach miners to answer to human masters, and the chroniclers count it the first crack within the Ròdaich themselves. He was Ragnall mac Dhòmhnaill of Muileann chrom, a crew-leader since the first contract. The Company gave him its staff and a house with a slate roof, and the Ròdaich gave him his byname: Ragnall Maor, Ragnall the steward. Soon there were overseers at every working in the district, and the roll stopped giving their names and gave only their number. At Cnoc mhòr the overseer Seumas Dubh was killed by his own crew after a boy was crushed on a haulage he had ordered hurried, and the Company hanged two men at Ros dhomhain. It was the first hanging the Administration did on Rodos.

Maddox barred the priests of the hawk from the camps in 1817 DE, on the ground that their preaching slowed the work. The overseers enforced it; several of them were hawk-faithful themselves, and the roll says so. A spotted pox came up the ore road from the quays of Ros dhomhain. The Mission counted four hun-

dred and six dead. The custodians counted more, and wrote the difference in the margin of the Mission's list. The Administration moved its customs house from Baile dhìreach to Ros dhomhain, and the mixed council there, left with half an income, shrank from six to four. In 1820 DE Maddox left Rodos a rich man, and Arthur Lisle, a lawyer, came to the Residency. His first act was to have every agreement since the treaty copied into a single bound book.

VI

Of the Silver Compact, and the Things the Clerks Could Not File

Reading that book closely, Lisle found in it nothing whatever about silver. When the Company's surveyors came up the valley to Muileann chiar with their chains and pegs, Ùna nic Choinnich was waiting for them at the mouth of the adit. Behind her, filling the yard and the slope above it, stood the whole membership of the guild in their leather aprons, not one of them speaking, and two of the eldest held the guild's ledgers open across their forearms.

The chief surveyor began to read out his authority. Ùna let him finish. Then she turned the first ledger toward him, and the second, and asked him, in his own tongue and quite pleasantly, to find the humans' name anywhere in either.

He looked. The yard waited, and the wind came down off the hill with the smell of the smelting-floors in it. After a while the surveyor closed his book, and the Company's men went back down the valley.

On Là Fhèill Bhrìde of 1823 DE Lisle signed a compact that left the seam to the town. It was the first writing of the age in which the Ròdach side kept the better terms, and Muileann chiar held its silver in its own hand through all the rest of the age. When a Company ore ship was taken off the eastern coast by raiders in low black boats and burned to the waterline, the Company said the guild had paid them. The guild said nothing.

The third beacon was lit at Àth dhearg in 1824 DE, and its keeper, Tormod mac Pheadair, kept a daybook of every ship he saw. From his book, and the books of the keepers after him, the sailings of the humans in this age are known; and the copyists have leaned on the daybooks more than on any other witness, for a keeper has nothing to gain from a ship that is not there.

In 1826 DE the council of Baile dhìreach broke up in a quarrel over a boundary wall and never sat again. The human families went to Ros bheag and Ros dhomhain; the Ròdaich stayed. The households that were both split, or went quiet. The next year the rain failed for a single season around Achadh shean, and it was a warning nobody heeded.

At Dùn thais in 1828 DE the Deer master Aonghas mac Coinnich put to his students a question the register calls new: why the humans could not see the colour in broken ore that every Ròdach child sees. He did not answer it, and told them it was the wrong question. Its form in the Deer books has been quoted in every age since:

Carson a chì sinne an dath, is iadsan dall air?

Why do we see the colour, and they blind to it?

On the concession the human families founded a market town at Cathair gheal under a charter that made no mention of the custodians. In 1830 DE the family of Eachann Mòr, a custodian of Ceann àrsaidh who had lost his seat, sent their son Calum west on a Company ship hoping his schooling would buy them better treatment. He never came home. The Mission opened a school at Ros dhomhain in the humans' tongue, and most of its pupils were the children of overseers. The Company rebuilt the old bridge over the river at Ros fhionn for its eastern ore road.

Two things the Administration's clerks never knew where to file. The crew of a Company brig reported a beast larger than their ship off the north-western headlands; the clerk put the report in with the complaints about pirates, and the sailors of that coast said they had wondered when the humans would see it. And two Company surveyors went up into the hills at Doire uaine against the villagers' advice and were not seen again.

In 1836 DE the Administration's share of the ore rose sharply, and what the Ròdach towns received did not rise with it. Lisle's schedule took the portion from one part in five to one part in three, and the custodians received it in the humans' tongue with a translation made by a Mission pupil. A bloody flux broke out on the Ros dhomhain quays; the Mission's nurse Anne Colby turned the chapel into a sick-house, and the record credits her with keeping the dead under two hundred. Lisle died at the Residency in 1840 DE, and Walter Crane, the Company's

chief agent at the pits, took the seal after him, the first man to hold both offices in turn.

Ragnall Maor died in 1841 DE, and the Company gave his staff to his son Dòmhnall. The custodians had hoped the office would die with the man. It became a family's inheritance instead.

The fourth beacon was lit at Muileann bheag in 1842 DE. It was the first to burn ore in place of oil, and its flame laid a colour on the water that no oil lamp ever had. The Mission cleric Edwin Lowe dug that season at Làrach an Teampaill and found cut stone, burnt bone and marks he could not read, and wrote that the ruin's builders "were not the present race." The custodians agreed with him, and added nothing. What became of the Seann-Dhaoine his spade did not turn up.

In 1846 DE the Company agent Martha Gale offered the silver guild a partnership, on terms its own ledger calls generous. Ùna nic Choinnich was very old by then. She had the offer read aloud twice in the guild hall, slowly, and then put it to a show of hands, and the hands refused it. That same year a new camp was opened at Achadh dhomhain for the deep galleries. Its houses were built of spoil.

VII

Of the Child in the Camps, and the Green Death

When the women of the camps tell of the Green Death, they begin with a child, for she was born in the same years and the same dust, and the one tale has grown into the other.

On 7 am Màrt 1848 DE a girl was born in the mining camps. Her whole life long she was steeped in more raw ore than any Ròdach in living memory, and she did not age as the people around her aged. Her name was Aisling, and she was the first of the generation that would be called immortal. Of her the rolls give three things, her birth, her name and her condition, and the tellers are content to leave her there.

The next year the Company set up a great steelyard on the quay at Ros dhomhain, and from then on the island's yield was known by the ton, and the custodians' old count, kept in seasons of labour, was no longer entered. What was happening to the child had no name in any tongue on the island, and decades passed before anyone tried to find one. At Cill ghlas the custodians of Òrd Bhrìde kept the old rites of the flame and the stone at the mouth of the oldest cutting, while

the pits deepened all around them. It was the last shrine in the district the crews still climbed to on the old feast days, at Samhain and Imbolc, Bealltainn and Lùnastal. Remember it.

In 1852 DE came A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death.

It showed first at Achadh dhomhain. A man would go pale with a greenish cast, like a candle seen through bottle-glass; then came a cough that brought up dark dust; then weakness. The camp buried forty in the first month, in a field beyond the spoil-heaps that is called the green acre to this day. It went out along the ore roads from the camps at Muileann chrom, Àth ìseal and Cnoc fhiadhaich, and it fell hardest on Ros dhireach, Ceann òg, Inis ìseal, Baile dhomhain, Achadh fhada, Cnoc bheag, Muileann uaine, Cuan àrsaidh and Inis bhàn. Twenty-six settlements set down cases. The roll lists them, and leaves a blank line after the last, as though waiting for another. At Àth ghlas the custodians burned every hut in which anyone had died, bedding and all, over the Company's protest at the loss of its property, and there the sickness stopped sooner than anywhere else.

The dust was blamed, and no study was ever finished. The Administration's physician Nathaniel Bright began one at Muileann chrom, weighing the dust in the lungs of the dead. He fell ill in its second season, and his notebooks break off in the middle of a table. Commissioner Crane, who had walked the camps through the worst of it, died of it at the Residency in 1854 DE, and Martha Gale held his seal until George Tolley came over the sea, with orders that the yield must not fall. Tolley never visited the camps. His letter-book blames the dust, the Rò-dach habit of sleeping near the fire, and the custodians' shrines, in that order.

The hawk-priests were still barred, so the crews carried the sermons in their own mouths, and the overseers' reports of those years list hawk-feathers nailed above hut doors as a matter for discipline. The saying of the feathered doors outlived every report:

Ithidh Mòd an neach a dh'itheas an cnoc.

Mòd will eat whoever eats the hill.

Anne Colby opened sick-houses at Àth ìseal and Achadh dhomhain and nursed in them until the sickness ebbed. Of all the humans on the island she is the only one the camp people name in their own tellings of the plague, and they name her kindly.

VIII

Of the Eleven Days of Baile thais

Catrìona nic Eachainn called the halt on a grey morning in 1856 DE, standing on an upturned ore-tub at the pithead of Baile thais with the whole shift below her.

She had asked the Company to close the galleries where the Green Death had been worst, and had been told that the yield must not fall. So she told the crews what she had told the agent, and then she stepped down off the tub and sat on it, and folded her arms, and did not go below.

Nobody went below. By noon the word had gone round every hut in the town, and the winding-gear stood still, and the ore-carts stood in a line on the rails with nothing in them. The agent came up and shouted in two tongues, and the crews sat on the spoil-heaps in the thin rain and listened to him politely.

For eleven days no ore left Baile thais. Each evening Catrìona walked the town and counted the loaves in the windows, and knew what the agent knew: that there was one store in Baile thais, and it was the Company's. Each day the shelves were barer. On the twelfth morning she went down to it herself and looked through the shutters at the empty shelves, and then she walked back up to the pit-head and told the crews to go below.

After it the Company built its own granary at Muileann chrom and forbade the camps to keep more grain than a week's ration, and the order was signed by Dòmhnall mac Raghnaill Maor. Catrìona was turned out of Baile thais and refused work at every Company pit. She went east over the hills to Muileann chior, and the silver guild took her on as a refiner. The Company asked for her back. The guild's answer was filed, and has not been kept.

The Administration built a new bath-house at the hot springs near Muileann ruadh for officials recovering from fevers. The Ròdaich, who had bathed there for centuries, were let in on certain days for a penny. The silver town grew, for the humans wanted both metals, and in 1861 DE the guild founded a daughter town to the west for its refiners and carters, under the same name; the record calls them the old town and the new, and does not always say which it means. The guild sold bar silver to the Company at a price the guild fixed, and it was the only thing on Rodos in all the age priced by Ròdach hands.

At Tolley's asking the priests of Òrd Mhacha at Cathair dhearg, the capital's own order and the crown's, blessed the Residency's new coin. Macha's priesthood

teaches that the two horses of her rite, Dubh Sainglenn the black and Liath Macha the grey, each have their due, the dark and the light; the dissenting priests said the coin was only one of them. In 1865 DE barter was cheapened against the mark a second time, on terms set wholly by the Administration. In 1866 DE the dissenting priests left the capital's temple for the sacred forest at Cnoc bheag, where custodians who had lost their seats found a welcome. And Dòmhnall Maor died, and his son Iain took the staff: the first overseer schooled at the Mission, who kept his reports in the humans' tongue and his household in Ròdais.

IX

Of the Levy, the Ring of Beacons, and the Great Hunger

The hunger of Baile chrom is told in the north-west by the beacon-keepers' families, and they begin it with a piece of paper. On 4 am Faoilleach 1867 DE Tolley issued the ordinance the Ròdaich called simply the Levy. Every farming village in the west and north was to send one in five of its able men and women to the pits for two years, and be paid for them in marks, at the new rate. It fell hardest on the villages round Baile chrom and on the northern concession, which had never sent crews to the pits. The Ròdaich of the concession were taken. Its human farmers were exempt.

Tolley closed the hall of Feallsanachd an Fhèidh at Dùn thais in 1868 DE, over a lecture on whether the humans' blindness to the colour of the ore might be a kind of sickness. The masters went on teaching in their own houses, to smaller rooms each year, and some went out under the trees of the sacred forest of Flidais near Muileann chiar, where there was no hall to shut.

Work began on the fifth and last beacon at Baile chrom, and the masons were taken by the Levy from the very villages whose fields they left unworked. The ring was finished in 1870 DE: Taigh-solais Baile chrom, Baile ìseal, Muileann bheag, Àth dhearg and Tobar dhearg. It had been asked for so that ships should not be lost on the reefs. By the time it was done it served a trade that was plunder in all but name. The Baile chrom beacon was lit with an ore flame in 1870 DE, and the daybooks show the sailings doubling in the years after.

In 1873 DE the harvest failed. Gorta Baile chrom, the Great Hunger, went across thirty-four settlements, and it bit the deeper because the Levy had stripped the countryside of the hands to farm it. It was worst at Baile chrom itself. From

their empty fields its people could see the ore flame of the new tower moving on the sea at night; and the custodians recorded that more died at Baile chrom than anywhere else, and the Administration, which kept its own count, did not dispute the figure. A relief ship from an Tìr Thall lay a month at Ros dhomhain with her holds full of grain while the Residency and the Company argued over who should pay to unload her. The Mission opened kitchens meanwhile at Cathair gheal and Baile chrom, and Anne Colby, come back to the island, ran the one at Baile chrom. The Levy was suspended in the famine districts in 1876 DE, too late for the harvest. It was never repealed, and never used again, and the custodians note that it never needed to be, since the villages had learned what it meant.

Tolley retired with honours in 1877 DE. Robert Haskins, who came after him, ordered that the custodians' council be consulted on the tithe, and then set the tithe before the council had met.

In 1878 DE the custodians acted together for the first time. Nineteen settlements sent their custodians to Ceann àrsaidh, and there, meeting as one body, they drew up a formal grievance to lay before the Administration.

Peigi Ghlas, the custodian of Cill ghlais, carried it to the Residency. She was kept waiting on a bench in a stone passage that smelled of lamp-soot, and at last was shown to a young clerk at a high desk. He took the petition from her, and thanked her, and laid it on a pile, and bent to his work again. She stood a moment longer. Then she went home.

It was not answered.

From these years come the oldest Ròdach writings of grievance that survive. They are not yet resistance, only the first written word that something had gone wrong. The earliest is Leabhar Baile thais, a book of complaints kept by many hands over some years: wages, deaths, the granary, the stream at Doire mhòr. At Muileann dhearg the poet Fearchar Bàrd, who had broken ore since boyhood, made songs of the Levy and the famine. The overseers forbade them, and the forbidding is why several were written down. They were sung in the roadside houses of the east, and An Taigh-òsta Grianach became known for them, and the Company's own carters sang them over their ale without always knowing what they sang. When the Company built its deep-water quay at Ros dhomhain for the new iron steamships, which burned the island's own ore to carry it away, Fearchar made the song that is quoted most of all his songs:

Tha an long ag ithe a' chnuic gus an cnoc a ghiùlan air falbh.

The ship is eating the hill to carry the hill away.

The Company walled its pithead at Baile thais and set a gate in the wall and a watchman at the gate to count who went in, and it was the first working on Rodos walled against its own crews. Catriona nic Eachainn died at Muileann chiar in 1883 DE, a refiner of the silver guild to the end, and when the camp people of Baile thais sent a delegation to her burying, the Company docked each of them a day's pay. In 1884 DE a fire in the Company's ore sheds burned three days and took two streets of the harbour quarter with it. The Company's inquiry found no cause. The harbour quarter's own account has several. That year the council, on the death of its high custodian, could not agree on another, and sat for years with the seat empty, and Haskins wrote to an Tìr Thall that this made it easier to deal with.

X

Of the Long Drought, and the Law of One Line

In 1885 DE came Tiormachd Achadh shean, the Long Drought: three dry seasons one after another, the dry year of the east come back threefold. At Achadh shean the wells failed, and the cattle were driven west in a column the roll says was a day long and fewer than half of them reached water. The roll counted ten districts as drought country, worst at Achadh shean, Àth uaine, Achadh àrsaidh and Muileann chiar, and reaching down to Cuan ruadh and west toward Baile chaol. The Administration kept no count of its own.

The spring of Allt an Àigh, which is said never to have failed, did not fail. Pilgrims of Na Seann Spioradan came to it from all across the east, the first of them at Bealltainn. The Administration posted a watchman at the spring to charge for the water. He was called back after a single season.

A fever of bad water followed the drought into the towns. It was worst at Baile Mòr ruadh, where the wells had been dug deeper into the old middens, and two hundred and sixty died there. The Mission's report was the first to name the cause rightly, and the Mission bored deep wells at Achadh shean and Àth chrom that held. The custodians of the east entered the Mission's wells and the Company's quotas on facing pages, and wrote nothing beside either. For the quota was not

lowered. The custodians petitioned Haskins one by one, and he wrote back to each that the matter was under consideration.

In 1890 DE a case came before the Administration that fixed the law of inheritance on Rodos for the rest of the age. The claimant was Thomas Hale, grandson of the Baile dhìreach marriage of Eilidh nic Ruairidh and Samuel Hale, and he claimed a share in a customary cutting through his Ròdach grandmother. The magistrate at Ros dhomhain, Oliver Dunstan, ruled that customary rights descend only through the line the Administration recognizes, and that it recognizes only its own. Within a few years that ruling had passed eleven customary cuttings to the Company, each because some owner in the line had married a human or been born to one. The custodians stopped entering such marriages in the roll. And so the marriage that Baile dhìreach had written into both its books became, a century on, the reason marriages were written into neither.

In 1892 DE a society of pit crews that called itself the Lamp-Watch began to meet at Baile thais and Cnoc chaol under cover of a burial club. The first thing it is known to have done was to bury an old breaker who had died in the Company's lock-up.

Haskins was recalled in 1893 DE after a quarrel with the Company over steamship berths, and Edward Vane came to the Residency. He was the first Commissioner born on Rodos, at the Residency itself. He spoke Ròdais badly, but he spoke it. He laid the mule-drawn tram-road to Ros dhìreach, and before he died the Company's railway ran from the pits at Muileann chrom to the quay at Ros dhomhain, its engines burning the island's ore (22 am Màrt 1899 DE).

In 1895 DE came the night-shift order, and from then on the mountain was given no season of rest. It was felt first at Cnoc chaol, in the newest galleries, where the crews worked by ore-lamp in two shifts. The custodians' roll records that the hill was given no silence at all, and leaves the rest of the page empty. The crews at Cnoc chaol refused the night shift and were replaced within a week by crews brought from the coast. The Lamp-Watch paid the strikers' families for a season, and then its money ran out. The Mission's minister at Ros dhomhain, Matthew Dunne, preached from the chapel pulpit that the Ròdaich were right, and that even the ground must rest. The Company complained, and Dunne was called home to an Tìr Thall, and the Lamp-Watch copied his sermon and read it aloud in the camps.

A wasting sickness of the lungs spread among the night crews of Cnoc chaol and Baile thais. Unlike the Green Death it killed slowly. The Company paid the

widows a pension for a year, and then stopped. In 1898 DE Iain Maor wrote to the Company that the night shift was killing his crews faster than it paid for them. The letter survives because it was filed with his dismissal, which was reversed a month later for want of anyone else to do the work.

XI

Of the Second Child, and the Word that was Coined

In 1900 DE a second child was born who showed the same bond with the ore that Aisling had shown half a century before. His name was Fionnan. To those who kept the rolls his birth meant that the first had been no single mischance, and that the thing was being made by the pits themselves.

Seònaid nic Dhùghaill, the last master of the Deer to teach openly in the age, died at Dùn thais in 1902 DE, and the school's register ends with her. Nobody took it up again until long after the humans had gone.

In 1903 DE the custodians of the east began to send copies of their rolls to Muileann chaol, which still kept Beathag nic Thòmais's loft of papers, well out of the Residency's reach. The copying was done in the houses of three families and the copies were kept in a cellar. The library at Muileann chaol, which keeps this book among its others, grew out of that loft and that cellar together.

On 23 am Faoilleach 1905 DE the custodians met at the shrine of Cill ghlas to give the thing a name.

They came up the path in ones and twos through the evening, past the spoil-heaps, to where the oldest cutting still stood open in the hillside with Bride's lamp burning in its mouth. They sat on the benches of the shrine with their cloaks steaming, and all around them in the dark they could hear the pumps of the Company's pits.

There were two cases now, and nobody could call it chance. A wonder that comes twice is a sickness, and a sickness must have a name if a physician is to write it down.

They argued late. Some wanted an old word out of the tellings; some wanted none, for a name is a door. At last one of them put forward the plainest word there was: *fuil-ghuail*, coal-blood. It was meant for a physician's register, a word to be written in a column, with no song in it. They took it by vote. In the humans' tongue it was rendered *obsidian-touched*.

It did not stay in the column.

The Residency, hearing of the word, ordered every Ròdach child who showed the condition to be reported to the Commissioner's office. The custodians complied by reporting none.

In 1908 DE barter was abolished as lawful tender, and every bargain on the island from then on ran through the humans' coin. The barter houses of Ros dhomhain and Cathair dhearg were shut by order, and a Residency clerk wrote that the ledgers were now "complete for the first time." The hill villages borrowed marks from the Company's stores to buy seed, at interest, and within a few years most of them owed the Company more than a year's crops.

Iain Maor died in 1910 DE, and his daughter Mòrag took the staff, the first woman to hold it. The Company approved her in a letter that calls her "a safe pair of hands." Vane died at the Residency that year, and Charles Merriman came with a small company of armed constables, the first standing force the Administration had kept on Rodos. His first posts were at Muileann shean, which the townsfolk called the humans' second Residency and did not mean it kindly, and at Tobar ghorm.

In 1912 DE the Mission at Cathair gheal reported that human labourers near Baile chrom had been meeting at night in the fields to keep a silent vigil under the sign of a grey goose. They were of the Church, and took the goose for an Gàadh Fiadhaich, the wild goose of the Holy Spirit. The Mission called the vigil irregular, and supposed it a superstition picked up from the Ròdaich. The Ròdaich of Baile chrom disowned it. Manannan's priests at Ceann mhòr said the Mission was half right: the practice came from the Ròdaich, from Manannan's own harbours; Baile chrom had nothing to do with it. The human fishing families of Ceann mhòr had learned from them the night prayer to keep the sea shut, and the labourers inland had made of it a night of silence to a grey goose. The priests called it their prayer gone astray, and would not have its keepers in their house.

That year the dockers of Ros dhomhain, Ròdaich and human alike, refused for nine days to load ore over the new berth charges. It was the only strike of the age in which the two peoples stood together. Merriman's constables broke it, and the human dockers were shipped west.

In 1913 DE a third child of the condition was born, Lorccan, the first of them born in a mining town outside the camps, and the custodians knew from it that the thing had outgrown any one place. In 1914 DE a fourth was born, Cian, with-

in a year of the third: the nearest the generation of the coal-blood ever came to being born together.

XII

Of the Rending of Cill ghlais, and the First Blood

In 1915 DE the Company began to drive galleries under the hills around Cill ghlais with blasting-powder shipped from an Tìr Thall. The custodians of the shrine asked that no charge be set within sight of the old cutting. The Company's engineer marked their request on his plan, and set the charges below it.

On 9 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE, in the course of an ordinary day's work, the hills east of the capital broke.

The tellers of Cill ghlais say the ground spoke first, a long grinding under the feet like a quern turning, and then the fault tore open. That was Scàineadh Cill ghlais, the Rending. It killed dozens and shut a whole mining district for a generation. The old cutting where the rites had been kept through all the age, where Brìde's lamp had burned and the word *fuil-ghuail* had been agreed, went down into the earth with its shrine and was not seen again. The custodians' roll sets down the loss of the shrine before the loss of the dead, and a later copyist has put the order right; the copyists of Muileann chaol let both hands stand. The Company fenced the district and left Cill ghlais and its hamlets without work, and the closed country went to thorn.

Within days came the first blood between the two peoples. The fuller account of it in the roll, written up at the year's end, sets it at Muileann chrom.

Mòrag nic Iain Maor was at the pithead when they brought the seven up.

The pumps had been stopped the day before to save fuel, and in the night the gallery had filled. Now the seven lay on the wet boards in a row, and the women of the camp were coming up the track, and there was no sound but their feet and the rain.

At noon the Company's agent rode up with his constables and began to speak about the loss to the working.

The first stone took him on the shoulder. Then the air was full of them, and the constables were shouting, and Mòrag was shouting too. She saw a constable raise his rifle. She saw the smoke before she heard the sound. When it was over four Ròdaich lay in the mud beside the seven, and one constable with them.

At the inquiry she stood up in her good dark dress with the Company's staff in her hand, the staff her great-grandfather had taken from the Company, and testified that the pumps had been stopped on the agent's order. The clerk wrote it down, and then was told to strike it out.

The Lamp-Watch got a copy anyway.

In 1917 DE the grey fever came in on the ships, a fever of the chest that took the young and strong before the old, and it ran from the capital to the eastern farms. The camps, already hungry, buried more than the towns.

In 1918 DE a second petition went to the Residency, and where the first had held a plea, this one held a warning. It was drafted by Eilidh nic Raghnaill, a crew-leader of Baile thais and a member of the Lamp-Watch, and signed by custodians and crew-leaders of thirty-one settlements, and its last sentence was underlined at the Residency: that the hill would not be worked by people who were not asked. It was the first Ròdach writing the Administration troubled to answer. It answered with constables. In 1919 DE Merriman tripled the constabulary and posted companies at Muileann chrom, Baile thais, Ceann fhada and Cnoc chaol, each with a fortified store, all paid for out of the tithe; and a barracks for two hundred at Dùn chrom stood empty most of its first year for want of men to fill it.

At Seann Skell, where Murchadh Seabhag had preached the hawk's hunger in 1801 DE, the hawk-priest Ìomhar Seabhag now preached that Mòd's hunger had turned at last toward those who had eaten the hill. The hawk-shrines of the west became meeting-houses for the Lamp-Watch, and the constables did not yet know it.

The grey fever came back in 1919 DE and settled in the north-west, and there it killed humans as readily as Ròdaich. In the Mission's crowded hospital at Cathair gheal the two peoples lay in the same wards for the first time.

XIII

Of the Houses on the Roads, and the Day the Pits Stopped

The carters of the old ore roads tell these years as a tale of inns. From 1920 DE the roadside houses of the mining routes began, unbidden, to serve as waystations for a nameless militia in a war not yet declared. The singing house, An Taigh-òsta Grianach, walled its yard and set a watch on its gate. Am Buabhall Fortanach on the south-western road barred its gates at dusk and kept a

man on its roof, and its keeper Tormod Buabhall sent a list of travellers up the road every week, and never told the constables whose hands it reached. At An Taigh-seinnse Reòta on the northern road the stables were rebuilt with a loft for sleeping men, and the carters noticed that the loft was never empty and never held the same men twice. An Sligeanach Fad' às, near the silver country, became the post-house through which the Lamp-Watch sent word to Muileann chiar and the silver guild paid its rent. And An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, the carters' house that Seònaid Bhàn had opened in the first years of the extraction, was kept now by her great-grandson Aonghas. It was the busiest of the fortified houses, the one the constables searched most often and found least in.

In 1922 DE the pits stopped.

That morning the Company's chief agent stood at his window over the Ros dhomhain quay to watch the first ore-trains come down to the steamships. None came. By noon the ships still rode high at their moorings with their holds open to the rain.

Word came in by rider and by rail. Every working in the Muileann chrom district had halted at once. So had Baile thais, and Cnoc chaol, and the silver town, and the eastern pits at Ros fhionn. The signal had been a fire on the hills above Doire mhòr, which the Company took for a heath fire.

For six days the steamships lay at Ros dhomhain with empty holds. The agents wrote home that they had never known the harbour so quiet, and that the quiet frightened them more than the crowds ever had.

The stoppage was broken as the strike at Baile thais had been broken, when the constables shut the Company stores in every district at once. Forty crew-leaders were taken. Thirty-two were let go without charge. Eight were shipped west to an Tìr Thall for trial, and were never heard of again. The beacon of the stoppage had been lit on Doire mhòr's hill by the children's children of Beathag Dhubh's people, and the constables burned the heather there so that no fire could be lit on it again.

The keepers' daybooks were showing by now fewer ships from an Tìr Thall each year, and older ones. The Company's letters speak of troubles at home and do not say what they are. Of whatever was happening beyond the sea, the island saw only the emptiness in the daybooks.

In 1925 DE the Administration began to issue its orders with no Ròdach counsel sought at all, and the polite pretence of permission, kept up since the council's vote of 1781 DE, was put away. Merriman left in ill health, and Lionel

Strake, a soldier, took his place. His commission, read aloud at the Residency, made no mention of the Council of Custodians, and he did not call on it. He brought a flying machine over in the hold of a Company steamship and had it flown over the ore country to count the workings from the air. The Ròdaich called it *eun-iarainn*, the iron bird (27 am Màrt 1926 DE). He had the council hall at Cathair dhearg locked and its keys lodged at the Residency. The custodians met instead in the temple of Macha, whose priests had once blessed the humans' coin and now sheltered those who had petitioned against it.

In 1926 DE the Administration claimed the right to take any Ròdach dwelling it judged needful for the widening of the workings. Of all the wrongs of the age, the edict of seizure is the one named most often in every telling of what came after. The first houses taken under it were those of Doire mhòr, for a new shaft beneath the hill, and the last households there were carried out by constables. The village that had refused the first contract was the first to be emptied by the last. At Baile dhomhain, the first camp laid out on paper, two streets were pulled down for a spoil-tip.

XIV

Of the Breaking of the Staff

In 1927 DE the order came to Mòrag nic Iain Maor to clear the houses of her district.

She read it twice at her table in the steward's house under the slate roof. Then she took down the staff from over the hearth, the staff Raghnaill had carried, and Dòmhnall after him, and her father Iain, and walked down through Muileann chrom to the Company's office, with the townsfolk coming out of their doors behind her.

At the Company's door she broke it across her knee. It was old wood and it went with a crack like a shot. She laid the two halves on the step and walked home.

Three other overseers resigned that month, and the Company put humans in their places. So ended the office that Raghnaill mac Dhòmhnail had taken up more than a hundred years before, Raghnaill, Dòmhnall, Iain and Mòrag each in turn; and the custodians' hope that it would lapse with the first of them was granted at last by the fourth.

That summer the silver guild of Muileann chlar, still holding its seam under the compact of a century before, began to buy rifles from the raiders of the eastern waters, where no gunboat had patrolled for years, and paid them in bar silver by weight. Its ledger enters the rifles as refining tools. Custodians, crew-leaders of the Lamp-Watch and the dissenting priests of Macha met in the sacred forest at Cnoc bheag and made themselves one council for the mining country, and chose Eilidh nic Raghnaill to speak for it. No human hand wrote down that meeting. Strake learned of it all the same, and ordered the arrest of Eilidh and the forest council; and the constables went to Baile thais, and found her house empty and the town silent.

XV

Of the War of the Hills

On 20 an Gearran 1928 DE the grievance of the Ròdaich, joined at last under one council across the mining country, became war.

It opened in the hills. At first light crews under Mòrag nic Iain, who had broken the staff, rushed the fortified store at Muileann chrom, and its eleven constables gave themselves up without a shot; before noon the rifles and the grain were gone. Crews from the camps took the ore quay at Ceann fhada and sank two barges across its mouth, and no ore left the hills by water again in the age. At Baile thais the constables held the walled pithead for eleven days, the span of Catriona's strike a lifetime before, and on the twelfth, their water gone, they came out. Eilidh nic Raghnaill sent them under guard to the coast unharmed. The Residency had not looked for that, and did not return it in kind. The northern pits at Baile gharbh rose in the same season, took the constable posts at Muileann shean and Tobar ghorm, and sent the constables south on foot. Aonghas shut the gates of An Taigh-seinnse Mòr across the ore road, and the men in its loft came down armed, and the road between the capital and the hills was cut at its halfway stage and stayed cut. At Muileann dhearg the smith Uilleam Gobha made grenades of the Company's own blasting-powder cased in ore-tin, and pike-heads from the rails of the galleries, and the council's roll says it could not have fought its first season without him.

Then the capital rose. The custodians broke the Residency's locks on their hall at Cathair dhearg and sat in it again. The townsfolk held the stone bridge against

the constables sent up from the harbour, the bridge the Company had rebuilt for ore-carts, and they barricaded it with the carts. At Cathair dhomhain the townsfolk broke open the Company's warehouse, the first building the Company had ever owned on Rodos, and carried its tools to the council's companies. Strake drew the Administration back into the Residency and fortified the Company's quarter of the harbour. The city below it, Ròdach almost to a soul, neither joined the rising nor stood against it, and the constables did not trust it enough to leave their walls.

A column of constables and Company guards under Major Peter Ashdown marched up the ore road to relieve the hills, and on 5 an Dùbhlachd 1928 DE it came to the ford of Àth chiar and found the rebels on the far bank. The water was high and brown, and his men went into it to the waist with their rifles over their heads, and the fire from the far bank came down on them. Ashdown lost forty men there and all his baggage, and turned back. The rebels lost nineteen, and the council's roll names every one, as the custodians' roll had named the eleven of Cnoc fhiadhaich when the Company's report named none. Ashdown's column halted a night at the barracks of Dùn chrom, and in the morning found the town's gates shut behind it, and went on to the coast without its wounded, whom the townsfolk kept and nursed.

In the east the silver guild declared for the council, opened its armoury, and escorted the Company's agents to the coast with their papers. The guild's ledger notes that this was the one place on the island where the rising took nothing, because the humans had never held anything there to take. The constables' post at Dùn ìseal gave itself up to the guild's riflemen after a single exchange of fire, and the east was clear of human arms. Dùn dhearg declared for the council and sent it grain, and its declaration quotes the defence of the Small-Burning Law that its custodian Fionnghal nic Artair had written a hundred and twenty-seven years before. The crews of the eastern workings at Ros fhionn stopped the pumps and walked out, and let the lower galleries flood, and the bridge on the eastern ore road fell silent.

The humans struck back from the sea. In the first month of 1929 DE a Company steamship came up the Abhainn uaine and shelled the ore stage at Seann Toll to keep it from the rebels, and set the fishing town behind it burning, and twenty-three townsfolk died. It was the first time the humans turned the island's own ore, burning in their boilers, against a Ròdach town. Fishing boats from Seann Chwen and Ros ruadh, sailing by night along the south coast, boarded a

Company coaster at anchor and burned her, and the Company drew its coastal shipping back into Ros dhomhain and Ros bheag.

On the concession, Cathair gheal shut its gates and raised a militia and sent none of it south. Its magistrate asked both sides to leave it alone; the council granted it, and Strake did not reply.

That spring the council's letters to the Hawk coast went north by the hands of seven hawk-faithful crewmen of the river towns. They waited nine hours for the letters at An Cupa Dàna in Cuan dhearg (17 an Giblean 1929 DE). Each wore at his throat a hawk cast in lead from the cartridges taken at the store at Muileann chrom, and the record calls them Buidheann an t-Seabhaig Luaidhe, the Leaden Hawk company. They left at dark.

They went on foot, past the burned stage at Seann Toll, over the hills by Achadh dhomhain, down the Abhainn ìseal to Cnoc bheag and along the Hawk coast to Inis mhin. At every hawk-house on the way one of them stood up among the benches and read the letter aloud. At Inis mhin they heard that Strake's constables rode the western roads out of Ros bheag every day, so they hired a carriage and left the roads altogether. In the grasslands above Tobar dhomhain they lay eleven hours in the long grass over the road from Ros bheag and counted the constables' riders as they passed (23 an Giblean 1929 DE). There were forty-one, and none of them going north.

They came down to Inis thais eight days after they had set out. The priests of the Stone, the keepers of Clach, heard the letter in their temple and would send no men; but they shut the harbour of Inis thais to the Company's ships (25 an Giblean 1929 DE), and gave the hawk-faithful the use of the Fianna's roads. At Seann Skell Ìomhar Seabhag declared that the war was Mòd's own hunger turned back on those who had fed it, and the hawk-shrines of the west became recruiting-houses.

The keepers at Tobar dhearg put out their beacon, and Àth dhearg and Baile ìseal followed. Company ships feeling their way along the coast by night ran onto the reefs the beacons had been built to light, and two were lost. The Administration begged an Tìr Thall for troops and ships. One ship came in the war's first year, with dispatches and a few crates of cartridges, and sailed again within the week.

Through the first winter the council held the hills, the east and the capital, and Strake held the Residency, the harbour quarter below it and the western ports, and neither had the strength to break the other. Cathair dhearg went short,

its harbour held against it, and the custodians shared out the grain by household; and the roll records that they took the same share as everyone else.

In that stalemate the ledgers burned.

The first fire was at the Company's counting-house on the Ros dhomhain quay, inside Strake's lines. Dùghall Dubh and the men of the harbour quarter came to it over the roofs on a night of low cloud, in their stocking feet, and in at a garret window and down the stair in the dark. The tithe books stood in rows in the long room, calf-bound, heavy as flagstones. They carried them out into the yard in armfuls and heaped them on the cobbles, and Dùghall struck the light himself. The sentry at the front door never turned round until the whole yard was lit.

The second raid burned the tithe-house at Ceann àrsaidh, where the portion owed by every settlement of the hills had been entered since the first schedule. The clerks were let go. The custodians of Ceann àrsaidh asked that one ledger be spared for the record, and their own people refused them, and the library at Muileann chaol has been sorry for it ever since. The third burned the weigh-house at Muileann chrom, with the steelyard ledgers in which the ore of the hills had been set down by the ton since the first contract. The rebels' own chronicler writes that the fire burned green. Later chroniclers have held those fires decisive in their meaning, if small in their effect. The camps made a verse of them:

Loisc iad an leabhar, ach cha do loisc iad an cnoc.

They burned the book, but they did not burn the hill.

On 25 an Lùnastal 1929 DE Company guards and constables sallying from the harbour to win back the eastern road were driven back at Cnoc ghorm, in the hills beyond the capital, and it was the Administration's last attempt of the war to reach the mining country. The next day the Ròdaich of the Ros dhomhain harbour quarter opened the lower gates to the council's companies, and Strake held only the Residency and the Company's quays. On 21 an t-Sultain 1929 DE Strake took his officials, the Mission's clergy and the Company's agents away by water to Ros bheag. The council's companies came into the Residency the next morning and found it stripped of everything but its furniture and the letter-books, from which so much of this history is drawn, and which the humans had not troubled to take.

XVI

Of the Truce of Àth àrsaidh, and the Closing of the Crossing

Ros bheag, the western port the humans had used since the early years, became the last seat of the Administration, and the human families of the west and south, a few thousand in all, gathered behind its walls. With the roads cut and no ships from the west the town went short within months, and Strake ordered the Company's stores opened to the human families and the Ròdach townsfolk alike. It is the one deed of his that the Ròdach rolls give him credit for.

The custodians of Cuan shean, the town where the first humans had waded ashore to beg for water, shut their harbour to Company ships. The council's roll marks the turn of it and says no more, and neither shall the tellers. At Baile dhìreach the descendants of the old joint council, many of them of both peoples, were asked by each side which people they belonged to. Most of them would not answer, and neither side made them.

On 1 an t-Samhain 1929 DE, on Samhain, the last ship known to have come from an Tìr Thall anchored at Ros bheag. She brought no troops and no grain, only a sealed letter for the Commissioner, and she sailed on the next tide with as many passengers as she could hold. What the letter said, Strake kept to himself. On 2 an t-Samhain 1929 DE envoys of the council and the Administration met at Àth àrsaidh, on the edge of the northern concession, and agreed a truce: the humans remaining on Rodos would withdraw into the north-west under the council's safe-conduct, and the council would leave the concession towns standing.

On 29 an t-Samhain 1929 DE the columns went north. The human families of Ros bheag, Cuan shean, Baile dhìreach and the south-west walked up the western roads with their carts and bundles under the guard of the council's companies, and few of them had ever lived in the north. The roll records that no column was attacked, and that none was helped. At Àth chrom the custodians stood at the ford and counted them over, and that count was the last the Ròdaich made of the humans on Rodos in this age. At Àth leathan, the last stage before the northern country, the columns camped a night, and the custodians of the town record that the humans asked the name of the place, and that several of them wrote it down.

The keeper of the beacon at Baile chrom saw the last of it.

He was on the gallery of the tower on 5 an Dùbhlachd 1929 DE with his glass to his eye when the ship came up along the coast. She had sailed from Cuan shean

with Lionel Strake, the last Commissioner, and his officials, and she was the last ship on the island that could make the crossing. How the harbour that had shut itself to the Company came to let her go, the men of Cuan shean never said. The keeper watched her stand out to the west, smaller and greyer, until the sea had her. Then he went in out of the wind and wrote her down.

Nothing on Rodos records her arriving anywhere.

The council ordered the five beacons lit again, from Baile chrom round to Tobar dhearg. The keepers kept their daybooks as before, and there was nothing to put in them. The line that stands in them, in the hands of five keepers, is this:

Cha tàinig long.

No ship came.

At the year's end the custodians sent what was left of the age's rolls down to the cellars at Muileann chaol: their copies of the petitions, the book of Baile thais, and the letter-books left in the Residency. What the Administration's own clerks carried west with Strake, no one on Rodos saw again.

On 1 am Faoilleach 1930 DE the war ended with the crossing itself closed. Whatever had let the humans reach Rodos shut behind them. No one on the island knows what it was, or why it opened, or why it closed, and the chroniclers set it down as a thing that befell the sea. The humans still on the island were brought into the northern country their descendants hold today. This was the Severance. Cian and Lorccan, neither yet twenty, grew up in its wake.

The masters of the humans on Rodos, as the letter-books give them. Edmund Harrow, captain, from the Crossing until the treaty; then the Commissioners at the Residency: Josiah Pell, 1787 DE to 1803 DE; Henry Maddox, 1803 DE to 1820 DE; Arthur Lisle, 1820 DE to 1840 DE; Walter Crane, 1840 DE to 1854 DE; George Tolley, 1855 DE to 1877 DE; Robert Haskins, 1877 DE to 1893 DE; Edward Vane, 1893 DE to 1911 DE; Charles Merriman, 1911 DE to 1925 DE; Lionel Strake, 1925 DE to 1929 DE, the last.

The Stewards of Muileann chrom, as the custodians' roll gives them. Ragnall mac Dhòmhnaill, Ragnall Maor, 1815 DE to 1841 DE; Dòmhnall mac Raghnaill, 1841 DE to 1866 DE; Iain Maor, 1866 DE to 1910 DE; Mòrag nic Iain, 1910 DE to 1927 DE, who broke the staff.

Thus ended the Age of Strangers. It began with a vote that three custodians did not attend, and with forty words for the colours of the ore that the strangers

never asked to learn; and it ended with the hill cut to its roots, the Small-Burning Law a hundred and thirty years forgotten, and the tithe ledgers burning green at Muileann chrom. What was lost the rolls can count only in part: the shrine at Cill ghlas and the water of Doire mhòr, the salmon of the green river, the Deer school's hall and the barter houses, the eight who were shipped west, and all the names the Company's reports never gave. What was kept is shorter to tell: the silver of Muileann chiar, the copies in the cellar at Muileann chaol, and the four children of the coal-blood, whom the strangers' pits had made and the strangers' registers never held. The hill was the island's again. But the island knew no way to use it save the way the strangers had taught, and of that, and of the kingdom restored at Cathair dhearg, and of the same digging under new masters, and of the northerners in their new country, the next book tells, which is the book of An Aois Ùr, the New Age.

THE FIFTH BOOK

AN AOIS ÛR

the New Age

1930 – 2026 DE

Tha e scrìobhte a-nis. It is written now.

— a minute of the Moot at Caol mhòr, 6 an t-Samhain 1993 DE, entire, as the library renders it

I

Of the Severance and the Settling of the North

So the old people of the north tell it, at the hearths of Doire ghlais, when the fire is low and the children will not sleep.

In the last days of the Age of Strangers, whatever road had brought the humans over the western water shut behind their last ships, and those still on Rodos were marched north under the council's guard. That was the Severance, and it fell on the first day of 1930 DE, in the dead of winter, when the roads north were mud to the knee.

On 22 am Màrt 1930 DE, with the lambs coming, the homeland of the Tuath-aich was fixed. The children of the stranded humans were settled in the north by the council's word, and its guard stood at the head of the roads. It was a confinement, and everyone on both sides of the guard knew it. Their grandchildren would call it home all the same, having no other. Cian and Lorccan of the immortal generation grew up in the wake of those days; of them the chronicles of this age tell nothing further.

The victors began by putting things away. At Cathair dhearg the war-companies of the Severance were stood down, and their rolls went into the council's chests instead of the fire. Nobody ever abolished the companies. They lived on as names on a list, and the list lay quiet for nearly ninety years. On the roads running north, at Caol mhòr and elsewhere, stones were set to mark where the Tuathaich country began. No wall came after them. Many still stand at the roadside, since nobody has ever been paid to shift them.

That first year the north went hungry alone. The stores that had come over the water from an Tìr Thall came no more, and the grain ran out before the spring. At Doire ghlas, the old people say, more than two hundred were buried that winter; they had it from their grandmothers, and it was written down long afterwards. The Ròdaich made no count.

Meanwhile the council's clerks went through the humans' counting-houses at Cathair dhearg, Ros dhomhain and Seann Skell like rooks through stubble, and carried off every written leaf. The tithe ledgers, or what the raids of the war had left of them, they boxed unread, for few of them could make out the humans' hand. In the north-west things went otherwise. At Ceann mhòr, Cathair gheal and Inis àrsaidh the human harbour officers had sailed with the last ships and taken their keys with them. The Tuathaich fishermen took hammers to the locks of the harbour stores and shared out what they found, house by house. The north tells that part with some relish.

II

Of the Moot and the Kingdom

In the south the kingdom was making itself. On 27 an t-Iuchar 1931 DE, in the high summer, the state styled itself Rìoghachd Ròdais: a kingdom in its form, whatever it was in its working, and its own records carry that contradiction still.

A month before the council was seated, the householders of the northern towns came to Caol mhòr.

They came on foot and in carts at the tail of a wet summer, and crowded into a long low room that smelt of damp wool and fish-scale. Walter Hale stood at the back with his hat in his hands. He had been a harbour clerk under the humans, and there was still ink in the creases of his knuckles.

They argued most of the afternoon over who should speak for them. Somebody said his name, and it went round the room like a bucket passed along a line, and it stopped with him.

"We've no standing," said a man by the door. "Not in their law. They needn't hear a word of it."

"Then we'll say it where we can hear it ourselves," said Walter Hale. He sat down at the trestle, opened a book that had nothing in it yet, wetted his pen and wrote the day.

That was the Moot. It had no standing in Ròdaich law. It met all the same, and it kept minutes, and they run unbroken from that wet afternoon to the present year.

That autumn a royal council of twelve was seated at Cathair dhearg, drawn from the custodian families and the captains of the Severance war. Its minute-books are the oldest unbroken record of the state in this age, younger than the Moot's by a month.

At Ros dhomhain the first Ròdaich harbour-master, Dùghall mac Iain, kept the humans' tariff in force for want of another, and spent years turning it into Ròdais, clause by clause.

In the early summer of 1932 DE a ship was sent out past the western capes to seek the crossing the humans had used. She came home after a month of open water. She had seen no land and no sign of any passage, and no second ship was sent. At Seann Skell the priests of Manannan said that the lord of the sea had shut his sea again, as they had begged him to ever since the Crossing, and they said the old prayer at the harbour mouth:

A Mhanannain, cùm a' mhuir dùinte. Manannan, keep the sea shut.

III

Of Niall, the Shires and the Great Wave

In the long light of midsummer, on 19 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE, Niall was crowned at Cathair dhearg by Macha's rite, as the kings before the humans had been crowned. He was the first ruler of the restored kingdom and the first name in the line that the state's chronicles have kept without a break ever since. So smoothly did the crown pass to him that *mar a thàinig Niall*, "the way

Niall came", became a saying for any handing-over of power that went without a quarrel. The first place it is found written is a tavern ledger in the capital, set against a debt paid without argument.

The council drew the kingdom into shires, each *siorrachd* named for its seat, and drew them on the humans' district lines, for the humans' surveys were the only whole surveys of the island there were. The kingdom used them and did not say so. Over each shire went a *maor* to gather the Crown's dues: the head-due on every household, counted by its heads, and the market-due on every sale. Where the humans' lines stopped, at the edge of the great moss of the far north-west, the shires stopped too, and the windy coast beyond was left in no shire at all. In the Tuathaich shires the maor were Ròdaich. At Ceann mhòr the maor moved into the old human magistrate's house, and the townsfolk went on calling it by its old name.

Then the sea came in.

The Great Wave came in the short night of early summer, on 3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE, and it gave no warning at all. The south calls it Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol. In one night it wrecked Cnoc chaol, Cuan dhearg and Achadh mhin.

The relief party out of Cathair dhearg came down the coast road to Cuan dhearg, and the young clerk who carried its tally-book smelt the town before he saw it: salt, and torn weed, and something under both that he did not want to name. Where the harbour had stood there was brown water and a row of broken piles like bad teeth. He looked for the boats, until a man of the party touched his arm and pointed inland. The boats of Cuan dhearg were in the fields behind the town, keeled over among the barley, and one sat upright in a furrow with her mast still stepped, as if she had been sailed there in the dark. The clerk wrote that down, not knowing what else to do with it, and went on counting.

When the tallies from Cnoc chaol and Achadh mhin came in and were added to his, the dead of the three towns came to a little over nine hundred. The wave had run on up the gulf as far as Ros gharbh and broken its quays. That town stood high and lost few of its people, and nearly every boat.

It was the first disaster the new state met on its own terms, and it met it well. The council moved the survivors of Achadh mhin off their salted fields and paid for their seed out of the treasury, the first relief the restored kingdom ever gave. The old site is called an Tràigh Bhàthte, the drowned strand, and nobody builds there. From the survivors the south took a word: *tonn*, wave, for anything sudden

and overwhelming. *Tha e san tonn*, they say, he is in the wave of it. The south would have need of the phrase again.

In 1934 DE the human coinage was called in. In the old counting-house at Cathair dhearg, Fearchar mac Dhòmhnaill, whom men called Fearchar Bonn, set up the mint and struck the coin of the Rìoghachd. He pressed each coin's seal with an ink ground from obsidian dust, so that a clipped coin bled colour at its edge. The coin was honest and holy, and the kingdom liked it both ways.

The north paid for it. The Tuathaich households had put by their savings in human coin, and those savings were now worth their weight as metal and no more. The Moot petitioned for an exchange. The petition was received and filed. It is the first petition in this book to end that way, and not the last. At Doire mhin a smith named Joseph Marlow gathered up his neighbours' dead coin, melted it down and cast it into ploughshares, and sold the shares back to them for the price of the charcoal. The Tuathaich sing of him still in their own tongue. A library clerk once set down a verse of the song in plain prose: *he turned the king's silence into iron, and the iron into bread.*

IV

Of the Rite, the Orders and the Law

In the spring of 1935 DE, Òrd Bhrìde, the order of Bride's flame and Crom's stone, which had kept the Hall's rite since the Binding, was drawn up into ordered doctrine, where before there had been only a wide and loose reverence. It was built about the leyline and the unbroken line of the obsidian-touched, and the kingdom calls it simply the Rite. Dòmhnall mac Thormoid was named Àrd-choimheadaiche, the first high custodian of the Rite, and seated at Seann Skell on the southern coast, where the order's greatest house stands. His first labour was to write down an order of worship. In all the long keeping of the flame no one had ever written one.

The Hawk houses round Cnoc bheag would have none of it. Òrd an t-Seabhaig, the older form of the Rite, had never needed a custodian above the local altar, they said, and had no need of one now. Nobody forced them, and here begins the long quarrel between the two forms of the Rite. Only the southernmost hawk-house, at Muileann naomh, far from Cnoc bheag, took up the written order, and it has been a house of the Rite ever since. The houses of the Stone in the

south-west, whose Clach was never Crom's stone, sent no witnesses, only a letter wishing the Rite well. Òrd Mhacha, the capital's own order, which makes the kings, was given the coronation regalia to keep, as it had kept them before the humans came, and it gave the high custodian no share in them. Within a year the orthodox Rite had one house that disowned it, one that ignored it with great courtesy, and one that outranked it at court. The orders of the Old Faith stood so for the rest of the age.

In the north the Church was kept quietly. The Tuathaich held to an Eaglais, the faith their grandparents had carried over the sea, and to the fragment they call the First Canoe, the voyage of Naomh Breandan, which the Ròdaich priesthood calls superstition. The library has never been shown the fragment. It knows only that it is kept. At Baile chrom the vigil-keeper Hannah Crane kept the vigil of Rùn-dìomhair na h-Oidhche Glaise, the Mystery of the Grey Night, in the open for the first time since the Severance. The sect keeps one night of silence in the year for Sìne, the Peaceful Goose, which is its name for the wild goose of the Holy Spirit, and it tells no outsider which night that is. The Church's bishops call the vigil irregular, and they have never put it out. In the towns of the west coast, where the Tuathaich lived beside the Ròdaich of Manannan's harbours, many congregations came to preach in the humans' tongue and to read the Bible in Ròdais. How that came about the west coast has never troubled to explain.

In 1939 DE a wall between the two peoples was proposed, and the council threw it out as needless, since the peoples were keeping apart well enough without one. The minute that rejects it runs to four lines. The fourth reads *They do not come south*. Five of the twelve initialled it, and the other seven did not sign against it. The library keeps that minute under glass. It is a small leaf, and a good deal of the age is written on it.

The law came north in the same fashion. In 1937 DE, at Seann Bhrál, Eilidh nic Leòid, first of the circuit justices, ruled that land held by the Tuathaich under human title passed to the Crown, while the right to work it stayed with the holders and their heirs. The Leòid ruling is cited in nearly every land case of the age.

Seven summers later she carried it north herself.

The court at Ceann mhòr sat in the heat of late July in 1944 DE, with the windows open on the square and the flies drifting in. Eilidh nic Leòid had nineteen cases before her. Seventeen were Tuathaich suits over land, and in each the same kind of paper came up to the bench: a human title, brown at the folds, under the seal of a magistrate who had sailed west. She read every one to the end, and would

not be hurried, while the suitors stood in their best coats and sweated. Then she took up her own ruling and read that too, aloud, so that the room should hear what the law was, and gave judgment.

In fifteen of the seventeen she found for the Crown. She was exact. The law she was exact about had been made for one people, and she had made it. Her rulings became the kingdom's first law-book.

Some years before, in 1936 DE, Walter Hale had asked leave to open schools in the north that taught in the humans' tongue. The council answered that the kingdom's schools taught in Ròdais and it had no others. The Moot's minute calls the answer "clear, at least." In the middle of the winter of 1944 DE Agnes Pike opened such a school at Doire ghlas anyway, with Moot money and without leave, and within ten years there were nine. The council never licensed them and never shut them. For most of the age that was the kingdom's way with the north: it forbade little there, and helped with less.

V

Of the Mountain, the Guilds and the Fair

By 1940 DE the mine was yielding as much as it had under the humans, and then more. The work was the same work. Only the owners had changed.

The Crown granted the Sloc Mòr, the great shaft at Achadh dhomhain, to Uisdean mac Ùisdein of Cathair mhòr, whose house had held an overseer's post under the humans. The Crown took a fifth. Those were the humans' terms with the names changed. The council would not end the day-and-night working the humans had ordered, and so the mountain was still given no season of rest. The custodians entered a protest, and then went down and blessed the shafts. The hewers had a saying for it:

Cha d'fhuair a' bheinn fois a-riamb, is cha d'fhuair sinne. The mountain never got its rest, and neither did we.

Families from the hungry east came to the vein-towns for wages, and Muileann dhearg doubled in three years. The humans' railway was mended to the pithead, and in the October of 1941 DE the first ore train ran from the Sloc Mòr to Cathair dhearg, under the kingdom's name, on the humans' rails. At Muileann chrom the

families who worked the little shunting engines were counted apart and lived apart, in rows beside the lines. For forty years the public buildings of the south went up in the Sloc Mòr's grey spoil-stone, sold under the Mac Ùisdein quarry-mark.

In 1942 DE the apprentice-binding of the Holy Age was taken up again, and this time the charters said in so many words that it was for Ròdaich applicants. The Guild of Hewers came first, its oath sworn with a hand laid on a lump of ore, and the shipwrights, chandlers, lamp-makers and weavers came after. The Tuathaich boys already bound to Ròdaich masters were released from their indentures. Some went north. Most stayed on as day-labour, outside the guilds and beneath their wages. The rule kept them where the pay was worst.

Off Cathair gheal, ships that flew no flag began to raid the north-western coast, and some of their crews were men who had served the human administration. The Tuathaich towns suffered first, undefended. In 1949 DE, having asked twice and been sent nothing, the fishermen of Cathair gheal armed their own boats and drove the raiders out of the bay. The council then fined the town for bearing arms without a licence. The town paid.

On 16 an Dàmhair 1950 DE, in the reddening of the year, the fair at Muileann òg was established, and it grew to be the greatest recurring gathering on the island. Its first toll-mistress, Oighrig nic Mhathain, set down its rules, and one of them was this: that Tuathaich goods be sold only through Ròdaich factors. They are still read aloud when each fair opens. Two years after, the Còmhrag began at Ceann leathan, a yearly melee that was called a martial tradition and served more and more as an outlet for a people with few others. Two men died in the first one that anyone remembers.

On 7 an t-Ògmhios 1953 DE, in the green of early summer, there was a cluster of births among the shunting families, the generation called Splatter and Dodge's. Seachran and Brean were among them. They would grow up to be the closest allies of a man not yet born.

VI

Of the Library at Muileann chaol

O

n 1 an Cèitean 1945 DE, which was Bealltainn, the fires were lit on the hills round Muileann chaol to bring the summer in, and their smoke hung over the town all day. Ailean mac Iain spent that day in a cellar.

He had been named first keeper of the new library, and had brought the council's minute-books with him, and the remains of the humans' tithe ledgers in their boxes. Now the townsmen led him down a stair to the custodians' rolls, which had lain there since the Severance war, stacked on planks above a wet floor, the lowest gone as soft as bread. He untied one and read three lines by the light from the stair. Then he sent for lamps, and a table, and a boy to fetch and carry.

He spent years having them read. Before the year was out, *a chur san Leabharlann*, to put it in the Library, meant to make a thing settled and beyond dispute. A clerk once used it in his hearing.

"The library settles nothing," said Ailean Leabhar, for so they called him by then. "It only keeps."

The phrase outlived him all the same. The library now keeps the fullest surviving record of everything told in this book, and the reader should bear that in mind.

In 1947 DE, as the nights drew in, an office was made to keep the kingdom's record, and from its books this book is drawn. The first royal chronicler, Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill, a council clerk, kept her record at Muileann chaol and would not keep it at the capital. She wrote in her first entry that a record kept beside the throne is kept for the throne. She sent clerks to every shire to copy parish books, grave-lists and harbour rolls. The south filled forty chests. The northern shires filled one, for few of the Tuathaich would talk to the clerks.

The five lighthouses of the humans were given Ròdaich keepers. At Baile chrom, on the Tuathaich coast, the keeper's warrant bade him report what he saw by land as well as by sea. In time he reported that the Grey Night sect kept its vigil in the lighthouse's own shadow. The council took no action.

The library also dug. At Làrach an Dùin its trenches turned up walls older than any Ròdaich building and no writing at all, and the finds were catalogued as belonging to the Old Ones, purpose unknown. At Làrach an Teampaill the houses of the Seann Spioradan asked it not to dig, and the keeper entered the ruin as *measured and let be*. The obelisk near Cnoc bheag bore signs that matched no script known on the island. In this age as in every age, the Seann-Dhaoine appear only in what they left, and in what the living will not do near it.

When Ailean Leabhar died in 1969 DE, Mòrag nic Coinnich became keeper. She began the practice, kept ever since, of writing beside each item where it came from. In 1971 DE Gormshuil laid down the chronicle. Her last entry is a list of what the record did not hold: the northern towns' own accounts, the humans' treaties in their own tongue, and the Board's surveys. Her successor, Tormod mac Sheumais, called Tormod Pinn for the speed of his hand, copied that list into the front of his first book and added nothing to it. He struck nothing out, either.

VII

Of Brìghde and Eòghan, and the First Word of the Depletion

Niall died, and his daughter Brìghde was crowned on 31 an Lùnastal 1951 DE, at summer's end, and no one contested it. It was a mortal succession in an aristocracy that stood very near the undying. It seemed nothing strange then. Gormshuil wrote that the succession came *mar a thàinig Niall*, and that is the only idiom she let into the chronicle in all her years.

On 12 am Màrt 1955 DE, in the raw end of winter, the survey reports first began to say, very quietly, that the vein's yield was falling.

Iain mac Ruairidh of the Mine Board, whom the hewers called Iain Mapa, had spent long months crawling the faces of the Sloc Mòr with a lamp and a chain, and he knew what he had found before he had finished finding it. The vein was thinning to the east and to the south, and it was thinning in a way that did not argue.

He carried his survey to the Board himself, rolled and tied, and laid it on the table in front of three men who did not unroll it while he was in the room.

"It will be considered," said the one in the middle.

"I should like a receipt," said Iain Mapa.

The clerk looked at him as though he had asked for a kiss. But he wrote one, and signed it, and Iain Mapa folded it into his pocket-book and went home. The survey was filed and never circulated. Soon after, he was sent to the silver works at Muileann chiar.

The next year the Board moved its clerks to Cathair mhòr and made a rule that its surveys were to be kept there and not sent to the library. The state did nothing for years. The library could not know what it was never sent. It knows now, and it counts those years as part of the Depletion.

Brighde's reign ended young, and no cause was ever made public. Her cousin Eòghan was crowned on 11 an Gearran 1957 DE, amid the first true strife over a succession that the restored kingdom had known. The chronicler's entry gives the fact and nothing more, and no chronicler since has added to it. That December the council's minutes recorded votes against a succession for the first time. They name the councillors and not their reasons. Two of them did not sit again.

On 9 an Cèitean 1958 DE, in the green of May, Dubhan was born, mortal, into the confinement the Severance had made, decades after the war that had shut the island to the people his line came from. No chronicle of that year mentions him, and none could have.

The kingdom went on round the Depletion it had not announced. In 1962 DE the second census measured, for the first time, the gap between Ròdaich and Tuathaich living. The report was never made public. A census clerk, Seonag nic Ille-Mhoire, left a note among her papers saying that she had asked to see it and had been refused, and that note is the only mention of the report outside the council.

That year Walter Hale died, and the Moot chose Mary Coyle, a fisherman's widow, the first woman in its chair. The Còmhrag grew bloodier. In 1965 DE six fighters died, and the custodians asked for it to end. The fair-wardens of Ceann leathan, whose town lived off the crowds, refused.

On the first day of July in 1968 DE a gallery gave way under Muileann dhearg, in the reopened Cill ghlas district, along a line the surveyors had marked as sound. Thirty-one hewers died. It was small beside the Rending. It was the same fault. New rules for digging followed. They were written for Ròdaich workers, and near the Tuathaich country they were kept loosely, and by intent. At the pits round Àth leathan, where Ròdaich overseers worked Tuathaich hands, the timbering rules were posted on the pit-head door and never paid for. The overseers' books show the timber ordered and never delivered. Àth leathan will come into this book again.

VIII

Of the Search for a Second Vein

After Muileann dhearg the Guild of Hewers bound sixty apprentices to fill its rolls, and not one of them was Tuathaich. On Samhain eve of 1969 DE

fire ran through the fair at Muileann òg. Its court sat in a field the next morning, and the fair went on, and Oighrig nic Mhathain died of her burns. That winter the Rail Board refused to carry the Moot's goods, and the north's wool went south by cart, a week on the road. The north calls that way the Carters' Road. The south has no name for it.

In the dark of the year's end in 1970 DE the Moot began a register of Tuathach hewers killed or maimed in the western pits, since no Ròdaich book counted them. It has been kept ever since, and never sent south. In those years Dubhan was a child in the north, watching a caste that did not age hold every true advantage on an island to whose edge his own forebears had been pushed. The obsidian was never his to inherit.

The age had its good keepers too. When the dry years came back to Achadh shean in 1972 DE, the council sent grain up the ore line out of the Sloc Mòr's share, and nobody in the shire died of hunger. The maor had twelve wells dug to the rock, and four of them are still drawn from.

Of Ciorstaidh nic Artair it is told at Tobar dhearg that her father, the keeper of the light there, drowned going out to a boat on the reef, and that she went out after him and brought the boat's crew in. She took his warrant, and set a belled post on the reef. While she kept the light, no boat went aground there.

On 12 an t-Samhain 1975 DE, when the leaves were down, the druid schools, Scoiltean nan Draoidhean, whom many still call Feallsanachd an Fhèidh, woke out of their long sleep. Their founding question, why the vein answers some hands and not others, mattered again now that the vein was running short. Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain lectured in Flidais's sacred wood near Muileann chiar, and at Caol shean her students copied the census line on the obsidian-touched and argued over it in the open, which the Rite did not do. They set the old pillars and the obelisk side by side and found signs in common, and no meaning. Seonaid wrote that the Old Ones had been here and had said so, and that nobody living could hear them.

In 1979 DE Alasdair mac Ùisdein, grandson of the first holder of the Sloc Mòr, borrowed against his house's share to go looking for a second vein. The Board lent its surveyors and the Crown lent its name. Seonaid wrote to the Board that the search asked the wrong question. Her school had always asked why the vein answered some hands; nobody had asked why there was only one vein. The Board filed the letter.

The search failed. Forty-one shafts went down between the hills above Dùn dhearg and the moors south of Baile ruadh, and none of them struck the vein. Afterwards Mòrag nic Coinnich found in the library a list from the Holy Age that named those same hills as searched and barren. The kingdom had repeated a failure that its own library could have warned it of, had anyone thought to ask. The house of Mac Ùisdein paid part of Dùn dhearg's damages and sold half its share back to the Crown. The dry shafts at Baile ruadh were left open to the sky, and sheep fell into them, and one child, before the shire fenced them at its own cost.

In 1984 DE Mary Coyle laid down the chair, and Daniel Frayne of Muileann leathan came after her, the first speaker born after the Severance. He had taught young Tuathaich to bind books when the southern guilds would not take them. That winter the fair gave one day to northern goods. They were still sold through factors, but under the makers' own marks, and it was the first time a Tuathaich name had been written on anything sold there. The first such mark was the Doire ghlas weavers' grey twill, with a white thread at the selvedge. Within the year the weavers of Baile chiar were weaving a white thread into theirs.

On 11 am Màrt 1985 DE the Depletion could no longer be denied.

Catrìona nic Neacail, the surveyor-general, had drawn the last untouched sections of the vein, and they were smaller than anyone wished to admit. When the drawing was finished it fitted on one sheet. Because a sheet so small wanted explaining, she went down into the Board's files at Cathair mhòr to learn how long the thinning had been going on.

It took her the best part of a week, by a smoking lamp. Near the bottom of a press she found a survey of the faces of the Sloc Mòr, rolled and tied, in a hand she did not know. It showed the vein thinning to the east and the south, and it was thirty years old.

She published her map. She sent the library a copy of Iain Mapa's survey, with a note of the day the Board had received it, and within the year she resigned. Iain Mapa died at Muileann chiar the next spring. His own copy of the survey was found among his papers with the Board's receipt pinned to it. He had kept the proof that he told them.

Muileann dhearg lost a third of its households. Its Fèidh hall was shut, and its bell was sold to Caol shean, where it still rings the students in to their lectures.

IX

Of Mairead and the Failing of the Ore

Mairead was crowned on 29 an Dàmhair 1987 DE, in the fall of the leaf. Eòghan's reign had ended in the decade the Depletion came into the open, and she was heir to a kingdom whose founding wealth was plainly failing. That year the Guild of Hewers bound no apprentices, for the first time since its charter.

The north began building things that did not hang on the mountain. In 1988 DE wool mills went up at Doire ghlas with Moot money. The Rail Board refused to carry their cloth, until the circuit justice at Seann Bhral, Ruairidh mac Phàdraig, ruled that the Board was a carrier of the Crown and must carry for anyone who paid. It was the first ruling the Moot ever won in a Ròdaich court. The Board appealed, and the council let the appeal lapse without a reason given.

In 1989 DE the Crown bought the last of the house of Mac Ùisdein's working shafts, and from then on the Board worked the vein in the Crown's name alone.

On 1 an t-Iuchar 1990 DE Dubhan began his experiments, trying to make a fuel to stand in for the ore out of what the mines threw away. They all failed, and the record of those years scarcely troubles to name them. In that same month the lowest galleries of the Sloc Mòr were let flood, because the pumps cost more to run than the ore beneath them was worth. The Board's minute calls it a pause.

The chronicle of those years is full of small alarms. Panthers came across the south-west, beasts named in the Holy Age lists and not seen in living memory, and the old list named the year after them as a hungry one. At Muileann chrom the yard families stopped the ore trains for three days over cut wages; the Board settled on the fourth day and dismissed eleven men on the fifth. Then the harvest after the panthers came in good, and Tormod Pinn drew a line through his own note of the year before. This book has always liked him for it.

In the autumn of 1993 DE the third census published its figures openly, the first census in the kingdom's history to do so. It was a small reform, and nothing in the frame of the kingdom moved because of it.

A month later the figures were read at Caol mhòr. Daniel Frayne sat in the Moot's chair with his hands flat on the table, the way he sat when he meant to keep them still. The clerk read the columns in a flat voice. In every column the census clerks had chosen to take, the northern towns stood at about half the

Ròdaich measure. Nobody in the room was surprised. They had simply never heard it read aloud from the kingdom's own paper.

When the clerk had done, there was a long quiet. Then Daniel Frayne drew the minute-book towards him and wrote two words, and the words are the whole of the minute: *Now written*.

The census carried a line for the obsidian-touched, as the first one had, giving a number and nothing else. Tormod Pinn copied it into the chronicle without comment, as Gormshuil had done before him.

Tormod Pinn died at his desk in 1994 DE and Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh became royal chronicler. She was the first to add, at the foot of each year, a note of what the record could not learn. Her first concerned the northern shires. The census clerks there had been told the figures and had not counted them, and the figures they were told were the Moot's. So the kingdom's first honest census was honest in the north because the Moot had supplied the numbers.

Mòrag nic Coinnich now called the shires' record-chests in to Muileann chaol. At Seann Tarr the shire keeper burned his chest in the yard sooner than send it, saying that the shire's record belonged in the shire, and that chest is lost. In 1996 DE the library doubled its holdings, and from then on the history of Rodos was kept in one place instead of many.

No Tuathaich record was called in. The Moot's minute-books, the schools' registers and the vigil-books of Baile chrom stayed in the north in private keeping. The new wing was built of Sloc Mòr stone. The shires' chests filled three floors, and the fourth was left empty for what had not been sent. It is empty still, or near enough.

In the west the Board was drawing back. In 1997 DE it closed the branch line to Àth leathan, citing the falling yield of the western pits. The Tuathaich hewers there kept working under their own pit captains and paid the Crown's fifth by the Leòid ruling, and the Board took the payments and entered them as arrears. At Cnoc thais the pits passed to their hewers in the same way. The south did not notice; it wanted nothing in the western hills any longer.

In 1999 DE Ragnall mac Mhuirich became keeper of the library. The price of ore-fuel at the fair doubled, and at Cnoc fhiadhaich households were found picking ore off the spoil-heaps to burn. The Board posted watchmen from the town, who saw nothing.

X

Of Dubhan's Fire

On 19 an t-Ògmhios 2000 DE, about midsummer, the first working dubhan was made. It was crude, and it burned. Nobody yet traded in it; for the while it was one man's answer to a crisis that the caste in power had still not faced. At the foot of that year Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh wrote that a fuel made without the vein was reported from the north, and that she had not seen it. That is the first mention of dubhan in the royal record, and she spelled the word three ways in two lines.

In the capital the poorer streets were left dark to save ore. By 2002 DE ore was sold at the fair only by the sack, and at last only by the lump, for altars.

Cathal was crowned on 1 an Lùnastal 2002 DE, the feast of Lùnastal, by Macha's rite. Mairead's reign had ended while Dubhan's experiments still failed more often than they worked, and Cathal did not yet know how near his kingdom's answer lay. The new dies at the mint still pressed the obsidian ink into the seal.

The fuel came south within three years. In 2003 DE a company of shipmasters set up a dubhan works at Seann Skell on the southern coast, the first outside the north, and how they came by the making of it they never told. The high custodian wrote to the houses of the Rite that the new fuel was not forbidden, since it was not ore, and not blessed, since it was not ore. It sold its first year's making to the south-coast boats and the capital's lamp-houses, and the dark streets were the first to be lit again.

In 2005 DE the five coastal beacons, which had burned obsidian-lit flame for more than a century, were the first works of the kingdom to be turned over to dubhan by decree.

Ciorstaidh nic Artair was grey by then, but nobody else was let carry the lantern. Inside its thick glass the flame of Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg burned with the dark, coloured edge that only obsidian gives. She carried it into the Rite's house at Seann Skell in the late spring, down the hall between the custodians of four shires, who stood in their rows and did not speak. Her boots were loud on the flags.

At Bride's altar she set the lantern down and opened its little door. The flame leaned towards the air, and steadied. Nobody told her to go, so she stayed, and so did they, while the last of the ore burned down. It took longer than anyone had thought. When the flame shrank to a blue bead and then to nothing, a thread of

smoke went up and hung under the roof, and one of the custodians let out a breath as if he had been holding it the whole while.

The south coast has a song of that day in more than one form. This is the shortest:

Dh'fhalbh an lasair às an tùr, tha solas ann, ach chan ann leinn. The flame has gone out of the tower; there is a light there, but it is not ours.

At Baile chrom, on the Tuathaich coast, the change was made by Tuathaich fitters from Caol mhòr, because the Lighthouse Board had none of its own to send so far. The keeper's report names none of them.

After that the change came to everything, and it came fast. On 1 an Cèitean 2007 DE, Bealltainn, the Rail Board ran its first dubhan engine on the ore line. It carried no ore. The drovers sold their oxen for lorries. On 25 an t-Ògmhios 2008 DE the fitters at Seann Skell set a lorry's engine under a closed carriage for the high custodian of the Rite, the first carriage on the island that needed no horse, and on 5 an t-Iuchar 2012 DE buses began to run out of the capital to Inis mhòr and Cathair mhòr. The roadside inns put in dubhan lamps, and centuries of oil and wick were gone within a decade. At An Leòmhann Buidhe the landlord kept one wick lamp burning over the door beside the new ones, and a wick lamp over an inn door is still called a Leòmhann.

In 2007 DE Daniel Frayne died, and the Moot chose Martha Greaves of Doire ghlas, a mill manager. His old pupils rebound the Moot's minute-books from the first meeting onward. The Moot's minute says that a second set was made and hidden elsewhere. The library notes this and has not gone looking.

In 2009 DE the last working face under Muileann dhearg was closed. Its families were moved to the Hewers' Row at Seann Toll, and most of them went to work on the dubhan tanks at the river landing. Muileann dhearg was left with its chapel, its graves and a caretaker.

By 2010 DE *dubhan* meant the fuel and no longer the man, years before the trade built on it was whole. A letter of the Fèidh school at Caol shean coined *dubhan-tùsail* for a first attempt that looks like a dead end until it turns out to be the road. On 30 an Cèitean 2011 DE the Guild of Hewers dissolved itself. Its rolls, its oath-stone of ore and its sick-roll went to the library. Its last master, Tormod mac Dhonnchaidh, wrote that the guild had outlived the mountain's patience.

By 2012 DE the markets, the army's supply lines and the shipping were all going over to the new fuel. The obsidian caste watched its own source of power fail and did not object. The house of Mac Ùisdein sold the last of its share in the spoil and put its money into dubhan shipping at Ros dhomhain, the only family of the vein that moved before the vein failed it.

In 2013 DE the fitters of dubhan engines were chartered as a guild at Seann Skell. Like every guild before it, its rolls were open to Ròdaich only, and the Tuathaich fitters were let go. They went home and fitted engines without a guild. That winter the Moot voted to take up the new fuel, and the delegates of the western pit towns got up and walked out. When the northern depots opened, Martha Greaves wrote in the minute that the north now bought its fire from the south, and she did not say whether that was good.

On 5 an Cèitean 2014 DE the coinage was pegged to the making of dubhan in place of the obsidian reserves, which was a quiet way of owning which of the two now ran the kingdom. The obsidian ink was left out of the seal, and the seal was plain. Fearchar Bonn's first dies went to the library, where they lie beside the Hewers' oath-stone. The high custodian protested that a plain seal showed the vein was no longer held sacred. The council answered that the kingdom had never said it did. Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh copied both letters into the chronicle. It is one of the few places in the whole record where the kingdom said plainly what it was.

The north has a rhyme from those years, heard there in both tongues. This is its Ròdais form:

Dubh an gual, 's dubh an dubhan, ach cò leis an teine? Black the coal, and
black the dubhan; but whose is the fire?

XI

Of the Holdouts of the Western Hills

In the spring of 2015 DE the western pit towns met at Muileann àrsaidh, apart from the Moot, and agreed to go on working their seams and to sell their coal to any household in the north that would buy it. Àth naomh, with only a few old shafts to its name, joined them, saying it would rather be cold with its neighbours than warm alone. So a knot of northern towns refused to fold themselves

into the new trade. They kept to the last workable coal seams sooner than hang their fires on one man's fuel. They were Àth leathan, Muileann àrsaidh, Cnoc thais, Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg, and their spokeswoman was Ruth Calder, a pit captain's daughter from Àth leathan. The Moot neither joined nor condemned them. At Cnoc thais Tom Varley opened again two shafts that had lain abandoned since the humans' time. The coal was poor. It was theirs, and it kept the town warm.

In 2016 DE Ellen Marsh, a schoolteacher of Doire ghlas, finished eleven books of Tuathaich accounts of the Severance and the settling, taken down from the old people of the north. She asked Leabharlann Muileann chaol, formally, to keep the Tuathaich tellings beside the Ròdaich record. The request was tabled, and it lies on the table yet. Ragnall mac Mhuirich replied that it awaited the council's view on the standing of spoken witness. The council has never given one. Ellen Marsh wrote back that spoken witness had been good enough for the census clerks when they took the Moot's figures. Her letter is filed with the request. It is short, and nobody has answered it.

The holdout pits undersold dubhan across the north, and the Moot's own mills bought their coal. In 2017 DE the Board's northern revenue fell by a quarter, the first fall since the Severance, and its report named the western pits as the cause and the Leòid ruling as the cure. Eighty years after Eilidh nic Leòid gave it, her ruling was put to the use the north had always feared. The Board declared the western seams Crown property, holding that the right to work them had lapsed when the holders stopped paying the fifth. The holders answered that they had stopped paying when the Board stopped carrying the coal. Both were true. The pits were ordered shut.

A company of enforcers was posted to Seann Skell in the west, which is another town from the Rite's Seann Skell in the south. Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh noted that it was the first armed company the kingdom had sent toward the north since the Severance. Martha Greaves wrote that the western towns would not shut their pits because of a letter, and asked for a year while the Moot talked with them. Her letter was received and filed.

In the autumn of 2018 DE the first skirmishes began. Each was too small to name and none was written down, and together they ran straight into open war. At the foot of that year Beathag wrote that clashes were reported in the west, and that she had asked for the Board's reports of them. They were not given. At Muileann àrsaidh the pit-heads were walled and the road from the south was dug

across. On 25 an Dùbhlachd 2018 DE, which was Christmas Day, Ruth Calder wrote to the council for the western towns and offered the Crown's fifth in coal, if the Board would carry it and let the pits work until the seams were spent. The letter reached the library. No answer to it did.

In 2019 DE, in the depth of winter, the Moot resolved by nine votes that it was no party to the quarrel and would feed anyone who came to its towns hungry. That summer it filled its granaries at Caol mhòr and Doire ghlas beyond the usual. The minute gives no reason. It needed none.

In August Beathag laid down the office, and her clerk Sileas nic Rath became royal chronicler. It is her record of the war that the library would later seal. In October came the order to mobilise. Regiments that had not been called out since the Severance were formed again and armed again, openly, months before anyone in power would admit that a war was coming. Command went to Somhairle mac Lachlainn, who had risen among the Board's enforcers. The rolls of the Severance companies were brought out of the council's chests to name the new regiments, and the old names were read aloud before new men. The list had been kept for nearly ninety years. Now it was used.

On 25 an Dùbhlachd 2019 DE, Christmas Day again, Martha Greaves came to Cathair dhearg with the Moot's petition.

She had kept the feast on the road, in a cold carriage, and she came into the capital in the grey forenoon with the frost still white on the bridge. The Ròdaich keep no feast that day, and the council was sitting. She waited on a bench in a passage for most of an hour, the petition on her knee. Then a clerk said her name, in the Ròdais way, so that for a moment she did not know it for hers.

She was the first speaker of the Moot ever to walk into the council chamber. It was smaller than she had thought, and warm with a dubhan stove. Twelve faces turned to her. She read the petition standing. It asked that the western pits be let alone to work out their seams, which would be spent within a few years in any case. She read it to the end without hurrying, and laid it on the table.

"Received," said the clerk, and wrote.

It was filed. That winter the Rail Board carried arms and dubhan west to Seann Bhral, and the yard at Muileann chrom worked on the trains day and night.

XII

Of An Cogadh Fada, the Long War

What is told here of the war comes from the open record, the towns' reports and the Tuathaich tellings; the rest is sealed.

Late in January of 2020 DE the hewers of the five towns came together at Àth leathan, where the road from the south goes up into the hills. In the north they tell it like this. It was bitter weather, with a thin snow blowing that would not lie, and the men and women came in by the hill paths with their pit-lamps lit at noon, the sky was so dark. They slept in the pit-sheds, and in the byres with the cattle for the warmth. Ruth Calder went from fire to fire with a list, asking who was here, and who was coming. The Board's lists name her among them, and Tom Varley too.

From Cathair dhearg the regiments marched west, and their carts and lorries ran on dubhan.

The Battle of Àth leathan was fought on 11 an Giblean 2020 DE, in the spring, the first great battle of An Cogadh Fada. The state, already leaning on Dubhan's fuel to prop its fading power, moved against the holdouts with its own hand. The open record counts the kingdom's dead and not the holdouts'. The Tuathaich tellings put theirs in the hundreds. Ruth Calder's name does not appear in the open record after that day. Whether she fell there, no teller in the north will say for certain. Her name simply stops.

The holdouts gave up the southern pits and fell back into the hills round Muileann àrsaidh and Cnoc thais. The pits of Àth leathan were flooded on the Board's order, and the field was left unploughed. The seventh regiment was raised on the west coast to hold the road behind the army. Before the month was out a wartime tithe was laid on every sale of dubhan in the kingdom, for the war's sake. It was never lifted. Fleets were raised and sent round the western cape to close the Tuathaich ports of the north-west to every boat but the fishing boats, and to search those.

In June the regiments invested Muileann àrsaidh. The town held out for weeks on stored coal and potatoes, and its pit-heads were taken one at a time. Sileas nic Rath's open record gives the day it fell and nothing more. The army's dubhan was served before any other use, and the capital's poorer streets went dark again, as they had been before the fuel came.

The families of the western pits came into Caol mhòr and Doire ghlais with what they could carry. The Moot fed them from its own stores, as it had resolved to. The council sent nothing and forbade nothing. The Moot's minute records the families' names, and it is among the few Tuathaich records of the war that the library does not hold. Agnes Pike's old school at Doire ghlais was given over to them, and Ellen Marsh, who taught there, took down their accounts. This book would give a good deal to read them.

In August Cnoc thais was taken, after the regiments cut the road to its pits, and Tom Varley's two shafts were fired and sealed. The open record gives the number of holdouts taken and not the number who went on into the hills. Some went on past the hills and out onto the windy coast, beyond the shire lines, and the regiments did not follow them there. With the fleets away in the north-west, raiders out of the east took two salt-boats off Àth bheag and burned a third.

Through the autumn the kingdom went on raising regiments, as if it looked for a longer war. The fourth regiment was quartered at Ceann mhòr in the old human magistrate's house, and the Moot's protest was received.

In December the regiments came to Baile chrom on the night of the vigil.

The corporal at the head of the file had come up the coast road expecting shutters and dogs and shouting. There was nothing. Not a lamp showed in any window. No dog barked. The only sound was the sea on the stones and his own men's boots, and even they began to tread softer without being told.

He tried the first door. It was unlatched. Inside, by the grey of the window, a man and a woman and three children sat round a cold hearth with their hands in their laps. None of them spoke. He asked them, in Ròdais and then in the humans' tongue, who else was in the house, and whether there were arms. The man only shook his head, once, slowly, as a man does at a child who has asked a foolish thing in church.

It was the same in the next house, and the next, until the small hours. He wrote in the end that the whole town had been dark and silent, and that it had been searched and nothing found. The regiments' return for that month says as much, and no more.

That month Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg opened their roads without a siege. Their pits were flooded. The open record names no holdouts taken at either.

Late in October of the next year a column of holdouts, several hundred strong, came out of the western hills, and through November it moved south-east through the middle of the island toward the capital. The reason lies in the sealed

archive. The Tuathaich tellings give its leader the name Owen Barrow; the open record gives him none. On 6 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE the column passed Muileann òg and made camp on the fields by Muileann ghlas, a day's walk from Cathair dhearg, and the first and third regiments were brought down the fair road to meet it. The booths of the fair-ground were cleared for their camp, and the fair court's books for that year end without a closing entry.

The Battle of Muileann ghlas was fought on 10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE, four days after, in the short grey days before midwinter. It was the second great battle of the war, and the last. The holdouts were broken within a single year's campaigning. They were the children of humans once pushed to the island's edge, and now they were pushed back again, and the fuel that drove the lorries against them had been made by one of their own. The open record lists the first and third regiments on the field and does not count the column's dead. When word reached the hills, the holdouts still there came down to the seventh regiment's posts on the Àth leathan road. They were disarmed and sent home, and the open record counts their weapons.

So An Cogadh Fada ended on 10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE, twenty months after it began, and it has been called the Long War all the same. Nine regiments and four fleets were raised in it. All are under arms yet, and each is named for the town where it is stationed.

Before the year was out the Tuathaich had a new saying. *Chaidh am fadachadh*, they got long-warred, was said first of the defeat in the west, and then of any defeat that comes after holding out too long. It is said as a joke, and the people who say it do not laugh.

XIII

Of the Peace, and of the Present Year

The regiments were not stood down. The council kept each at the town where it had been raised and paid them out of the wartime tithe. With the last organised resistance gone, Dubhan's fuel became, in all but law, compulsory across the whole island. The last western seams were flooded and capped with concrete, and after that no coal was dug on Rodos outside the Board's own works. The holdouts taken at Muileann ghlas were marched north as far as the boundary stones, the stones set in 1930 DE that nobody had ever been paid to

move. The Moot's register gave their names a column of their own. Somhairle mac Lachlainn was given a seat on the council, the first soldier to sit there since the captains of the Severance war.

In 2022 DE the kingdom raised a stone at Cathair mhòr, beside the Mac Ùis-dein market cross, with the names of the regiments' dead. On the field of Àth leathan the Tuathaich families built a cairn without leave. The seventh regiment's patrols have let it stand, and it grows by a stone or two every time they pass. At Muileann ghlas the field was sown again, and for years its farmer turned up weapons in the furrows and handed them to the first regiment, which keeps a list.

On 14 am Faoilleach 2023 DE the library's whole record of the Long War was sealed from the public for fifty years. It is the only sealed archive in the kingdom's history. What is still open for the war years is Sileas nic Rath's list of places, the regiments present, and the counts she was allowed to give. Her full record went into the sealed room with everything else. Ailean Leabhar said once that the library settles nothing and only keeps. He never thought it would one day keep a thing it was not let read.

The war left its accounts. The Treasury carried the wartime tithe forward as a standing line under the regiments' pay, and no council minute records a decision to keep it. The fuel-fitters took the contract for the regiments' engines and doubled their rolls, and every new fitter was Ròdaich.

In June of 2024 DE Anna nic Phàil, councillor for Cathair dhomhain, brought the Moot's petition before the council: that the Tuathaich towns be paid for what they had lost in the war. She spoke for it once. On 10 an t-Ògmhios 2024 DE the proposal was raised in the capital and quietly let die without a vote. The Moot's minute on it is one line long: *Allowed to die*. Martha Greaves laid down the chair that year, and the Moot chose Peter Hale, great-grandson of its first speaker. The fourth regiment left the magistrate's house at Ceann mhòr. The Moot asked that the house be given to the town. It was given to the maor.

By 2025 DE the Tuathaich had one name for the tabled request and the dead motion together: *seann-chunntas*, an old reckoning that nobody in power will settle and nobody has struck out. Official Ròdaich usage has not taken up the word. This book uses it, since the record should hold the words of both peoples.

That year the mountain was shut, or nearly. The Board closed the upper galleries of the Sloc Mòr and kept one face open, in the Rite's custody, to cut ore for the altars. Twelve hewers were kept on to work it, the last of their trade on the island. On 10 an t-Sultain 2025 DE the last ore train ran to Cathair dhearg. The ore

line has kept its name and carries dubhan, wool and soldiers. The second regiment set a guard at the library over the sealed archive, and Raghnaill mac Mhuirich wrote to the council that the library had not asked for one. On the northern road, where the boundary stones stand, the sixth regiment keeps posts, and Tuathaich going south show a pass for the first time since the Severance. The council's minute calls the passes temporary. The reader will know by now what the kingdom's temporary measures tend to become.

The last year and this one have been like other years. Tuathaich wool was sold at Muileann òg on its northern day, through Ròdaich factors, as at the first fair. The Còmhrag was fought with staves and fists, and one man died. Ellen Marsh's eleven books have been copied by hand in the northern schools and are kept there; the library's catalogue lists the tabled request and not the books. The Moot met at Caol mhòr under Peter Hale, its minute-books unbroken since Walter Hale's wet afternoon, with no standing in Ròdaich law and no request for any. Every lamp and engine on the island, every ship and every lorry, runs on dubhan; the coinage is pegged to it, and the tithe is taken on every sale. The Treasury's roll for the year stood at 9,568 purses, two parts in three of it from the head-due. In the summer the Rite's twelve hewers cut the year's altar-ore. It filled four baskets, and the high custodian shared it among the houses by lot.

On 7 an t-Sultain 2026 DE, as the summer went out, Dubhan himself, an old man now in his sixty-ninth year, won from the council at Cathair dhearg the right to sell dubhan off the island. He had written to the council for a year and sat before it three times. It is the first leave the kingdom has given for any good of Ròdos to go beyond its waters since the Severance, and it is narrowly drawn. The Treasury sets each year's measure. The fuel is loaded only at Ros dhomhain, where a clerk of the Treasury takes the tithe on every barrel. The kingdom's depots and the Moot's are served first. The custodians of Òrd Bhrìde seal every hold, since nothing of the vein may be sold, and the Small-Burning Law is not touched by it. Dubhan has told neither the council nor the chronicler who his buyers are. The first tank-hull loaded under the charter went out past the western capes in the autumn, and at Seann Skell the priests of Manannan said the old prayer to keep the sea shut on the day she sailed. Dubhan goes out under that charter and no other.

On 22 an t-Samhain 2026 DE, with the lamps lit by mid-afternoon at Muileann chaol, Sileas nic Rath wrote at the foot of the year that the kingdom's

record is whole in every part but two: the war, which is sealed, and the north, which was not asked.

So the account stands on 21 an Dùbhlachd 2026 DE, at the turning of the year's shortest days. The coal is all but gone. The kingdom's trade runs on a name that once belonged to one man, and since the autumn a little of it has gone out past the western capes under his charter. The Ròdaich hold the capital and the sea. The Tuathaich hold the north, and their Church, and a grievance five years old, and a memory of the First Canoe that the people who twice defeated them still call folklore. The restored kingdom promised the island its own again. It kept the humans' tariff, their surveys, their rails and their terms for the mountain, and it kept the humans' children where the humans had put them. It kept faith as well with the drowned towns of the south, and its wells at Achadh shean still draw water.

Here the Fifth Book stops, at the present year, for the chronicle itself goes on. The age that follows has no name yet, because nobody can yet say what began it. It is left to the next chronicler, who will be handed the whole record and, with it, the things still missing from it: the war in its guarded room, which is to be opened fifty years from its sealing if the kingdom keeps its word; the fourth floor at Muileann chaol, built for what was not sent; the eleven books in the north; and the Moot's minutes with their hidden second set. The old reckoning is still owed. Whoever writes the next book should begin by asking for them.

PART TWO

The Annals of Rodos

AGE I · AN AOIS ÀRSAIDH

- 20 AM FAOILLEACH 12,923 BDE** — *The crack in the stone*. A mason splitting rock for a well breaks a black, glassy vein — and it bleeds color instead of dust. The closest thing Rodos keeps to a creation myth.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 12,848 BDE** — *Three wells claim the crack* (Tobar dhìreach). Tobar dhìreach, Tobar dhubh and Tobar òg each keep a telling that the mason's well was theirs. Tobar dhìreach can show a capped shaft with a dark stain on its lip; the other two can show only the telling. No chronicle has chosen between the three claims.
- 19 AM MÀRT 12,773 BDE** — *The slab over the bleeding rock* (Tobar dhìreach). The tellings agree on what the mason's people did next: they did not dig on. They laid a flat stone over the broken vein, would not draw water beside it, and cut their well again a stone's throw away.
- 14 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 12,697 BDE** — *The high snowfields shrink* (Abhainn uaine). Meltwater off the central mountains cuts the bed that Abhainn uaine still follows. Gravel terraces along its lower reach hold hearth-stones at three heights, each left as the water came up to it.
- 16 AN CÈITEAN 12,621 BDE** — *The first hearths of the high valleys* (Achadh dhìreach). Under the turf at Achadh dhìreach lie hearths of pine and heather charcoal, scrapers of grey flint, and the split bones of red deer. Nothing in them is black glass; whoever sat at them either did not have the ore or did not burn it.
- 11 AN LÙNASTAL 12,546 BDE** — *The oak comes to the lowlands* (Doire ghlas). Pollen in the bog under Doire ghlas shows the birch and pine of the cold years giving way to oak and hazel. The grove that the place is named for stands on ground that was open heath when the vein was first broken.
- 22 AN LÙNASTAL 12,473 BDE** — *The bare north-west*. When the oak comes to the lowlands it never reaches the north-western horn of the island. The gales off the north-western sea keep the horn bare, low heather and blanket bog behind the shore with no tree on it, as it is still. No hearth of that age has been found on it.
- 13 AN T-IUCHAR 12,418 BDE** — *Eilean dhubh cut off* (Eilean dhubh). The rising sea floods the low neck of land that joined Eilean dhubh to the main island. Hearths on the drowned neck lie under the sand of the sound, and the island's deer, cut off, grow smaller over the lifetimes after.
- 1 AN T-IUCHAR 12,373 BDE** — *Hunters on Eilean mhin* (Eilean mhin). Camps of seal-hunters are pitched on Eilean mhin, reached by boat: the first sure sign that anyone on Rodos crossed open water on purpose. The camps are used a season at a time and left.
- 30 AN T-SULTAIN 12,313 BDE** — *Seals on the skerries* (Eilean fhada). Hunters of the north shore go out in skin boats in the autumn gales to the skerries off Eilean fhada, where the grey seals haul out to pup, and take seals there. The seal bones in the middens of the north coast carry the same cut-marks as those of Eilean mhin. The tellings of Eilean fhada count a hard year by how many boats the gales kept on the shore.

- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 12,233 BDE** — *The flood-plain of Abhainn íseal* (Abhainn íseal). The longest river on the island, Abhainn íseal, settles into the wide bed it keeps now. Fish-weirs of hazel stakes are set across its side channels, and the stakes are renewed in the same holes for generations.
- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 12,153 BDE** — *The middens of Seann Dunn* (Seann Dunn). The oldest mound at Seann Dunn is limpet shell, seal bone and burnt weed, taller than a man and laid down over many lifetimes. It is the first sure trace of the Seann-Dhaoine. No tool in it is shaped the way any later Ròdach shaped tools.
- 26 AN T-SULTAIN 12,073 BDE** — *The notched net-weights of Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). At Seann Chwen the Seann-Dhaoine sink their nets with beach stones, and every stone is notched with the same three strokes. It is the earliest mark on Rodos that is repeated on purpose.
- 1 AN T-IUCHAR 11,994 BDE** — *The mole at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). A mole of unmortared boulders is laid out into the Abhainn naomh from the bank at Seann Skell, long enough to shelter a dozen boats from the current. Its foot is still under water at the lowest tides, and every quay wall built there since stands on it.
- 30 AN T-IUCHAR 11,914 BDE** — *The steps of Seann Bhrál* (Seann Bhrál). Two hundred and twelve steps are cut up the cliff at Seann Bhrál, from the shingle to the grazing above. The treads are worn hollow in the middle; no one has counted how many feet that took.
- 4 AN CÈITEAN 11,834 BDE** — *The dead of Seann Vell go to Eilean dhearg* (Eilean dhearg). The Seann-Dhaoine of Seann Vell row their dead out to Eilean dhearg and lay them in stone boxes that face the mainland. Forty boxes have been counted there. No grave of theirs on the mainland from this time has been found.
- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 11,754 BDE** — *The fish-channel of Seann Toll* (Seann Toll). At Seann Toll a channel is cut through a rock shelf into a pool beside the Abhainn uaine, with a slot for a gate of wattle. When the river falls the gate is dropped and the pool is emptied by hand. The slot is still sharp.
- 7 AM MÀRT 11,675 BDE** — *The shell causeway of Seann Warr* (Seann Warr). A road of crushed shell is laid across the reed marsh at Seann Warr, on the western shore of Loch chrom, a little over a mile long, raised a forearm above the reeds. It is the first made road on the island that can still be walked.
- 5 AN GIBLEAN 11,595 BDE** — *The script appears at Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). Rows of signs are cut into the cliff face above Seann Tarr, in the script that later turns up on the standing stones. It is not Ròdais and it has not been read. Not one sign of it has an agreed meaning.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 11,516 BDE** — *The fish-kilns of Seann Mhorn* (Seann Mhorn). Stone-lined pits with short flues are built above the beach at Seann Mhorn to dry the catch over peat smoke. Seven are known. They are the first buildings on Rodos made for a trade rather than for sleeping or for the dead.

- 16 AN CÈITEAN 11,436 BDE** — *The slipways of Seann Bhrenn* (Seann Bhrenn). Long ramps of flat stone run down into the water at Seann Bhrenn, wide enough for hulls bigger than any hide boat. The hulls themselves are gone, and so is any telling of where they went.
- 7 AM MÀRT 11,354 BDE** — *The lake dwellings of Loch chrom* (Loch chrom). Platforms on oak piles are raised out in the shallows of Loch chrom and joined to the shore by plank walks. Whether the Seann-Dhaoine built them, or some other people of the same years, the timbers do not say.
- 6 AN GEARRAN 11,277 BDE** — *The whale-rib houses of Seann Dunn* (Seann Dunn). A whale strands on the shore below the southern Seann Dunn and its ribs are raised as the frames of three round houses, roofed with turf. The ribs were reset in new houses at least twice before they rotted.
- 8 AM FAOILLEACH 11,197 BDE** — *The round houses of the eastern Seann Vell* (Seann Vell). At the eastern Seann Vell the Seann-Dhaoine build round houses of dry stone with a hearth sunk in the middle of each floor and a drain running out under the wall. Fourteen house-rings are counted.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 11,117 BDE** — *The tower at the north-western Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). The smallest of the Seann Skell places, on the north-west coast, has a single round tower of dry stone, hollow-walled, with a stair inside the thickness of the wall. It looks out over the water where the Sea-Watcher is later seen.
- 1 AN T-IUCHAR 11,038 BDE** — *The huts of the northern Seann Toll* (Seann Toll). On the north coast, at Seann Toll, a cluster of stone huts is built into the lee of a dune. The dune later buries them whole, and it is the sand that kept them.
- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 10,954 BDE** — *The eastern Seann Bhral* (Seann Bhral). At the Seann Bhral of the south-east coast the Seann-Dhaoine keep a landing and a line of fish-kilns like those of Seann Mhorn. The two places lie within a day's rowing of each other.
- 4 AN CÈITEAN 10,878 BDE** — *The shell beds of the southern Seann Mhorn* (Seann Mhorn). The second Seann Mhorn, on the southern coast, is almost nothing but shell: oyster, whelk and cockle, heaped over a whole headland. The oysters in its lowest layers are larger than any taken there since.
- 5 AN GIBLEAN 10,798 BDE** — *The twin landings of Seann Bhrenn* (Seann Bhrenn). A second Seann Bhrenn, far to the north-east of the first, has the same long ramps into the water. Whether the two were one people's, or the name was carried, is not known.
- 25 AN DÀMHAIR 10,719 BDE** — *The cliff-house at Seann Tarr in the east* (Seann Tarr). At the Seann Tarr of the north-eastern headlands a single long house is built into a cleft in the cliff, its back wall the living rock. The rock behind the hearth is black with soot to the height of a man.

- 26 AN T-SULTAIN 10,639 BDE** — *The north-eastern Seann Vell* (Seann Vell). The Seann Vell on the Abhainn bheag, a short way above its mouth in the north-east, is a small place of four houses and a boat-shed. It is the most north-easterly of the Seann-Dhaoine sites known on the main island.
- 22 AM MÀRT 10,554 BDE** — *The northern Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). On the north coast, at the Seann Skell below the later Ros gheal, the Seann-Dhaoine lay a second breakwater, shorter than the southern one and curved against the swell from the open sea. The two moles are built the same way, stone by stone.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 10,480 BDE** — *The western Seann Vell* (Seann Vell). At the Seann Vell of the west coast the Seann-Dhaoine dig a line of storage pits into the dune, lined with clay and lidded with slabs. Some still held fish bones when they were opened.
- 19 AN CÈITEAN 10,400 BDE** — *Làrach an Dùin-fhaire raised* (Làrach an Dùin-fhaire). On a spur above the ground where Cathair mhòr now stands, the Seann-Dhaoine build the walled outpost later called Làrach an Dùin-fhaire. Its stones are dressed on the outer face only. Its single gate faces inland, not to the sea.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 10,344 BDE** — *Làrach an Dùin raised* (Làrach an Dùin). A greater work goes up on the height near Ceann mhin: three rings of wall, a cistern cut into the bed-rock, and room inside, by later reckoning, for four hundred people with their beasts. Whether the outpost's builders built it too has never been settled.
- 16 AN T-IUCHAR 10,288 BDE** — *The kerbed way between the forts* (Àth fhionn). Stretches of a kerbed track, a cart's width and paved with flat slabs, run through the ground near Àth fhionn in the direction of both ruins. It is the only road the Seann-Dhaoine are known to have built away from the shore.
- 14 AN LÙNASTAL 10,232 BDE** — *Làrach an Teampaill raised* (Làrach an Teampaill). A stepped platform of fitted stone is built in the eastern hills, with an altar block on its top step. The altar is set square to the central mountains. Every later temple on Rodos faces some other way.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 10,176 BDE** — *The shaft of Toll-dubh in the south-east* (Toll-dubh). A shaft is sunk straight down through the rock at the eastern Toll-dubh, its walls tooled smooth as far as a lamp can show. No spoil heap lies beside it. Whatever was taken out of it was carried away, or nothing was.
- 11 AN DÀMHAIR 10,120 BDE** — *The shaft of Toll-dubh in the west* (Toll-dubh). A second shaft of the same make is cut at the western Toll-dubh, far across the island from the first. Stones thrown into either are not heard to land.
- 9 AN T-SAMHAIN 10,073 BDE** — *The First Canoe*. A suppressed, half-remembered voyaging fragment survives among coastal Tuathaich families: a named steersman, a first crossing to an isle of the blessed. Their church tells it as the voyage of Naomh Breandan. The druids of the Old Faith dismiss it as superstition.

- 8 AN DÙBHLACHD 10,008 BDE** — *Stakes in the mud below Ceann mhòr* (Ceann mhòr). The first sure boats of the north-west coast leave their trace: a row of mooring stakes and a scrap of stitched hide in the tidal mud below Ceann mhòr. Who rowed them, and from where, the mud does not say.
- 1 AN T-SULTAIN 9952 BDE** — *The Sea-Watcher first sighted* (Uilebheist na Mara). Old sailors speak of a vast creature inhabiting the waters off the northwestern coast. No wreck has ever been recovered to prove it wrong.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 9896 BDE** — *The beacon on the Baile chrom headland* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). A fire is kept on the headland where Taigh-solais Baile chrom now stands. Its ash lies a man's height deep. The tellings say it was lit to turn boats away from the water where the Sea-Watcher was seen, not to guide them in.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 9840 BDE** — *Seven boats lost off Ros ruadh* (Ros ruadh). A telling from the north-west coast counts seven boats gone from Ros ruadh in one calm season, with no storm to blame. It is the first loss for which the Sea-Watcher is named as the cause rather than feared in general.
- 30 AN T-SULTAIN 9784 BDE** — *The seal hunt moves south* (Caol mhòr). The seal-bone layers in the middens of the north-west thin out and those at Caol mhòr and Cuan bheag grow. The hunters are working the southern side of the headlands now, out of sight of the open water.
- 8 AN CÈITEAN 9728 BDE** — *Signs cut in the Doire uaine hills* (Doire uaine). Rock faces across the Doire uaine hills are cut with inscriptions, more of them than anywhere else on the island, in lines that run for yards. Some of the lines are cut over and defaced by the same kind of tool that cut them.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 9673 BDE** — *The Hollow Man of Doire uaine* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). Inscriptions in the Doire uaine hills describe something that walked without breathing, and attacked anyone who lit a fire in its sight.
- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 9616 BDE** — *The hill fires go under the ground* (Doire uaine). After the inscriptions, the hearths of the Doire uaine hills change. Fires are dug into pits and roofed with slabs, and no open hearth shows in the hills for many lifetimes. The people did not leave. They hid their light.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 9554 BDE** — *The nine at the hill camp* (Muileann chiar). Nine people lie where they fell inside a hut at the camp later built over by Muileann chiar, beside a hearth of fresh ash. No wound has been found on any bone. The hut was never reopened, and no one was buried from it.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 9504 BDE** — *Coille Naomh Muileann chiar set aside* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). A forest is marked sacred, long before any order of the Old Faith claims it formally — the trees simply understood, the old telling goes, before the people did.

- 23 AM MÀRT 9448 BDE** — *No axe in the grove* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). The charcoal in the hearths around Coille Naomh Muileann chiar comes from every wood but that one. The families at its edge carried their fuel a half-day's walk rather than cut a branch inside it.
- 11 AM MÀRT 9392 BDE** — *The white stag of the grove* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). The first telling of a white stag in Coille Naomh Muileann chiar is set in this age: seen at the edge of the trees by three hunters, none of whom drew. The stag comes back in the tellings of every age after, and the druids of later ages call it the white stag of Flidais. The tellings of this age give it no god.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 9336 BDE** — *Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag left unclaimed* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). A second forest, older-feeling than the first, is never settled, never logged, never fully mapped.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 9280 BDE** — *The paths that stop at a line of stones* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). Tracks worn into the ground lead toward Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag from three directions, and all three end at a low line of set stones some way short of the trees. Nothing is worn beyond the stones.
- 10 AN GEARRAN 9224 BDE** — *The deer-drives of the eastern forest* (Doire fhionn). Lines of stakes and brush funnel the red deer of the eastern woods toward a gully near Doire fhionn, where they are killed with spears. The hunters left the antlers of the largest stags stacked apart from the rest.
- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 9173 BDE** — *The first dog graves* (Cnoc fhionn). Dogs are buried beside people at Cnoc fhionn in the east, each with a shell at its head. It is the first time any beast is given a grave on Rodos.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 9112 BDE** — *The geese of Eilean ghorm* (Eilean ghorm). The grey geese that winter on Eilean ghorm are recorded in the tellings of this age for the first time. The tellings say they come in with the first storm and leave with the last, and are never hunted there.
- 8 AN CÈITEAN 9054 BDE** — *The widest reach of the Seann-Dhaoine* (Seann Skell). At their height the Seann-Dhaoine hold every coast of the island: the ten places whose names begin with Seann, and the islands off them. The largest of their landings is at the place now called Seann Skell, up the Abhainn naomh, where the mole already stands.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 9000 BDE** — *The warm springs used* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). Stone basins are set into the springs at Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh, and the bones of the people buried nearby show old breaks that knitted clean. It is the first place on Rodos where the sick were brought for a cure.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 8944 BDE** — *The gate of the outpost walled up* (Làrach an Dùin-fhaire). The single gate of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire is blocked with rubble from the inside. Whoever did it left by another way, or did not leave.

- 27 AN T-SAMHAIN 8888 BDE** — *The Làrach an Dùin-fhaire abandoned* (Làrach an Dùin-fhaire). An outpost, already ruined when the first reliable chronicles begin, predates every known Rodian settlement pattern. No one knows who built it.
- 4 AN GIBLEAN 8832 BDE** — *The fortress cistern fouled* (Làrach an Dùin). The cistern of Làrach an Dùin is found choked with the bones of cattle, thrown in whole. The water it held served four hundred people. After it was fouled, no one drew from it again.
- 6 AM MÀRT 8776 BDE** — *The Làrach an Dùin abandoned* (Làrach an Dùin). A fortress in the same condition and the same mystery. Whether it belonged to the same builders as the outpost has never been settled.
- 5 AN GEARRAN 8720 BDE** — *The temple altar stripped* (Làrach an Teampaill). The top stone of the altar at Làrach an Teampaill is prised off and carried away; the sockets that held it are still sharp. It has never been found. What was cut on it, if anything, is not known.
- 7 AM FAOILLEACH 8673 BDE** — *The Làrach an Teampaill abandoned* (Làrach an Teampaill). A temple older than any recorded religion, its altar oriented toward the central mountains rather than the sea — toward the vein, not the horizon.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 8608 BDE** — *The Seann-Dhaoine keep to the shore* (Seann Chwen). After the high places are left, every new work of the Seann-Dhaoine is within sight of salt water. The middens at the southern Seann Chwen begin to grow as fast as the old ones at Seann Dunn once did.
- 7 AM FAOILLEACH 8552 BDE** — *The ancient sea-way* (Seann Dunn). The boats of the Seann-Dhaoine keep a lane along the south-east coast, from the river mouth below Seann Dunn round the cape where Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg now stands to the bay of Ceann chaol. Flat landing-stones lie along it a day's rowing apart, and some still show the grooves of hauled keels. The Ròdaich call it Slighe-mhara àrsaidh, the ancient sea-way, and the fishers of that coast keep to it still.
- 10 AN T-SAMHAIN 8496 BDE** — *The hill-folk of the vein* (Àth gharbh). In the high valleys around the crack there live people who are not the Seann-Dhaoine: they bury their dead in the ground, not on islands, and cut no script. Whether they shared the island with the Seann-Dhaoine or came after them no telling knows. Their own answer, later, is that they were always there.
- 12 AN DÀMHAIR 8440 BDE** — *The first small burning* (Àth gharbh). A hearth at Àth gharbh holds, among ordinary peat ash, a sliver of black glass burnt to a bead, and the hearth-stone around it stained through with colour. It is the earliest burning of the ore anyone has found. It is also small: one sliver, one fire.
- 13 AN T-SULTAIN 8384 BDE** — *The stained cloth of Achadh dhìreach* (Achadh dhìreach). Wool from the graves at Achadh dhìreach carries streaks of colour no plant dye makes. The hill-folk were rubbing broken ore into cloth for the dead. They did it rarely: one grave in some thirty.

- 15 AN LÙNASTAL 8328 BDE** — *A sliver in a Seann Bhral midden* (Seann Bhral). A chip of the black ore, still staining the shell around it, is found in a midden at Seann Bhral on the far western coast. How a piece of the vein came to a Seann-Dhaoine rubbish heap, by gift, trade or theft, is not known.
- 17 AN T-IUCHAR 8273 BDE** — *Carragh Cnoc bheag raised* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). A standing stone, later found carved with four words: Bha teine sa chloich — "there was fire in the stone."
- 11 AN LÙNASTAL 8216 BDE** — *The older face of Carragh Cnoc bheag* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). The stone's upper face bears a line of the unread script. The four Ròdais words lie lower down, cut with a narrower tool by another hand. When that second hand came, the stone does not say.
- 9 AN T-SULTAIN 8154 BDE** — *Colbh Cnoc chiar raised* (Colbh Cnoc chiar). A second stone carries only two words: Cuimhnich an teine — "remember the fire." No one has ever explained the imperative.
- 8 AN DÀMHAIR 8104 BDE** — *A ring of fire-stones round the pillar* (Colbh Cnoc chiar). The ground round Colbh Cnoc chiar is trodden hard in a ring, and the ring is paved with fire-cracked stones. Fires were kept there, hearth-sized, again and again. Nothing else was left.
- 6 AN T-SAMHAIN 8048 BDE** — *Calbh Cnoc ghorm raised* (Calbh Cnoc ghorm). A third stone carries the doctrine itself, complete: Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann. If the doctrine has a birthplace, it may be here.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 7992 BDE** — *The gatherings at the column* (Cnoc ghorm). People come to the column at Cnoc ghorm in numbers: the ground around it holds the post-holes of shelters for some hundreds, used and rebuilt many times. Whatever was said there, it was said to a crowd.
- 16 AN CÈITEAN 7936 BDE** — *Tuam Cnoc dhìreach consecrated* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). A necropolis grows around a site nobody remembers consecrating. Its oldest graves are older than its oldest legible names.
- 14 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 7880 BDE** — *The black chip in the child's grave* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). One of the oldest graves at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach holds a child with a sliver of black glass closed in one hand. The sliver still stains the cloth it is kept in. It is the only piece of the vein found buried with the dead in this age.
- 13 AN T-IUCHAR 7824 BDE** — *The rows at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). The graves at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach begin to be laid in rows, heads toward the central mountains. The earliest rows are straight; the later ones bend to fit around graves already there that no one would disturb.
- 22 AN DÙBHLACHD 7773 BDE** — *The panther roads*. A migratory instinct in the island's great cats is first recorded — routes crossing the mountains at fixed intervals, for reasons no naturalist has explained.

- 20 AM FAOILLEACH 7712 BDE** — *The crossing season kept* (Imrich nam Pantar). The hill-folk learn the panthers' timing and keep off the high passes while the cats are crossing. Camps in the passes show a gap in their use at the same point in every year.
- 7 AN T-SULTAIN 7654 BDE** — *Eleven lost on the panther road* (Cnoc àrsaidh). A party of eleven from the southern shore, going up into the hills near Cnoc àrsaidh in the crossing season, does not come back. Their bones are found years afterward along the line the cats still use.
- 9 AN LÙNASTAL 7600 BDE** — *Ailean Mòr, first of the Stone Kings* (Dùn ìseal). The oldest of the oral king-lists, the one later called Rìghrean na Cloiche, opens with Ailean Mòr, who is said to have held the hill where Dùn ìseal now stands and to have thrown up its first ring of bank. The list gives no lengths of reign. It is older than the name Ròdaich.
- 4 AN T-SAMHAIN 7592 BDE** — *The bank of Dùn ìseal* (Dùn ìseal). The first earthwork on the hill at Dùn ìseal is a single bank and ditch, enclosing space for some forty houses. It is the oldest defended place built by the hill-folk.
- 6 AN DÀMHAIR 7583 BDE** — *Beathag Ruadh of the Red Hill* (Cathair dhearg). A second oral list, kept in the west, opens with Beathag Ruadh, who held the hill where Cathair dhearg now stands. The Red Hill list and the Stone Kings' list never mention each other until much later in both.
- I AM FAOILLEACH 7574 BDE** — *Gormshuil nic Ailein* (Dùn ìseal). The second name in the Stone Kings' list is Gormshuil nic Ailein, the first woman in any list on Rodos. The telling gives her one deed: she moved the herds of Dùn ìseal down to the warm springs in a hard winter and lost none.
- 3 AN DÙBHLACHD 7494 BDE** — *Dòmhnall Clachach sets the boundary stones* (Dùn ìseal). Dòmhnall Clachach, third of the Stone Kings, sets marker stones along the valley below the hill to divide the grazing of Dùn ìseal from its neighbours. Some are still standing, and still argued over.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 7454 BDE** — *The first named storm*. A tempest severe enough to be given a name in the oldest surviving oral king-lists — the name itself lost, only the fact of it surviving.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 7454 BDE** — *The shell road broken* (Seann Warr). The storm breaks the shell causeway of Seann Warr in three places and floods the marsh behind it with lake water. The Seann-Dhaoine do not mend it. The broken ends are still visible.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 7374 BDE** — *Fearchar Bacach* (Dùn ìseal). The Stone Kings' list sets the storm between Dòmhnall Clachach and Fearchar Bacach, the lame king, whose telling says he was carried to the Dùn ìseal gatherings in a chair of woven birch. He is the first ruler on Rodos remembered for a hurt.
- 29 AM MÀRT 7334 BDE** — *Uisdean Mòr of the Red Hill* (Cathair dhearg). Uisdean Mòr, second in the Red Hill list, digs a ditch across the neck of the hill where Cathair dhearg now stands and sets a palisade on it. The palisade burns twice in his telling and is twice rebuilt.

- 31 AN T-IUCHAR 7293 BDE** — *Strokes on the midden stones* (Seann Chwen). The Seann-Dhaoine begin cutting single strokes on flat stones set at the edges of their middens, one stone to a household. The strokes are not the script. They are simpler: a mark, and then another.
- 29 AN LÙNASTAL 7253 BDE** — *The counting of the dead begins*. The Seann-Dhaoine, whoever they were, the people who built Làrach an Dùin-fhaire and Làrach an Dùin, also began keeping count of its own losses — record-keeping as instinct, before there was a Ròdaich people to inherit it.
- 3 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 7212 BDE** — *The tally wall of Seann Warr* (Seann Warr). At the eastern Seann Warr the counting stones are built into a wall, each stone cut with its strokes, some three thousand strokes in all. The wall grows for many lifetimes.
- 2 AN T-IUCHAR 7173 BDE** — *The count at Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). The counting reaches Seann Tarr in the north-east, where the stones are cut with strokes in groups of five and set in the floor of a house. The house was lived in over its own dead.
- 6 AN GIBLEAN 7131 BDE** — *The bad years in the counts* (Seann Warr). In one stretch the tally stones at Seann Warr, Seann Tarr and Seann Chwen all thicken together: more strokes on each stone and more stones in each course. Whatever killed so many, it killed on three coasts at once. The strokes do not say what it was.
- 5 AN CÈITEAN 7091 BDE** — *The half-cut stone of Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). At the Seann Chwen near Cuan dhearg the last tally stone is left half-cut: two strokes finished, a third begun and abandoned. The chisel marks stop mid-groove.
- 7 AN GEARRAN 7050 BDE** — *The Seann-Dhaoine fall silent*. After the half-cut stone, no new work of the Seann-Dhaoine can be dated. Their middens stop growing, their harbours silt and their script is not cut again. How they ended no telling knows.
- 8 AM MÀRT 7010 BDE** — *The old names kept* (Seann Skell). The hill-folk go on calling the Seann-Dhaoine places by their Seann-Dhaoine names, putting only their own word for 'old' in front: Seann Dunn, Seann Chwen, Seann Skell and the rest. They translate nothing. The roots are still not understood.
- 11 AN DÙBHLACHD 6973 BDE** — *The old landings taken up* (Seann Skell). Hill-folk families come down the Abhainn naomh and settle in the empty river harbour at Seann Skell, using the old mole and repairing none of it. It is the first time they are known to live by the water.
- 9 AM FAOILLEACH 6929 BDE** — *Mòrag Chruaidh and the salt-flats raid* (Baile ghorm). Mòrag Chruaidh, fifth of the Stone Kings, leads a raid down to the salt-pans on the southern shore at Baile ghorm and carries off the salt. It is the first war in either list: seven dead on the hill side, a number the telling keeps.
- 12 AN GEARRAN 6918 BDE** — *The salt-pans of Baile ghorm* (Baile ghorm). The pans at Baile ghorm, shallow clay basins behind a shingle bar, are the island's first salt-works. Salt from them turns up in the hill settlements from here on.

- 13 AM MÀRT 6907 BDE** — *Seonag of the Red Hill* (Cathair dhearg). Seonag nic Uisdein holds the Red Hill after her father. The telling says she kept a count of her people by pebbles in a bag, one to a household, and knew by weight when a household had gone.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 6896 BDE** — *The first pots at Doire shean* (Doire shean). Pots of coiled clay, fired in open bonfires, turn up at Doire shean on the south-west coast before anywhere else. Within a few lifetimes the whole southern shore is using them.
- 10 AN CÈITEAN 6885 BDE** — *The dug-out at Cidhe Beag* (Cidhe Beag). A boat hollowed from a single oak trunk, long enough for six, is sunk and left at the landing on Abhainn uaine now called Cidhe Beag. It is the oldest boat on Rodos whose whole shape is known.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 6874 BDE** — *Iain Dubh killed* (Baile ghorm). Iain Dubh, sixth of the Stone Kings, goes down to the salt-pans to repeat Mòrag Chruaidh's raid and is killed on the shingle at Baile ghorm. The list says only that he was brought home.
- 7 AN T-IUCHAR 6824 BDE** — *The wave at Cnoc chaol* (Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol). A sheet of sea sand, a hand thick, lies over the hearths of a village on the site of Cnoc chaol, with the shells of deep-water creatures in it. The sea came far inland there once in this age, and the village was not rebuilt on the same ground.
- 5 AN LÙNASTAL 6774 BDE** — *The ground opens at Cill ghlais* (Scàineadh Cill ghlais). A crack a man could fall into opens across the valley at Cill ghlais and a spring moves a hundred paces downhill. The hill-folk bank the crack with stones and do not build on either side of it.
- 3 AN T-SULTAIN 6754 BDE** — *The fault-line kept clear* (Cill ghlais). A line of white stones is laid along the old crack at Cill ghlais, and no house is set within a stone's throw of it in any later layer of this age. The line is still partly there.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 6699 BDE** — *The unlit hearth*. A single dwelling, preserved by chance in the island's peat, shows a hearth never lit — the earliest evidence that someone here once chose not to burn something they easily could have.
- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 6645 BDE** — *Peat over the unlit hearth*. The house with the unlit hearth sits under three yards of peat, its hearth laid with dry wood and a slip of the ore beside it, and none of it burned. Whoever laid it went away and did not come back to light it.
- 5 AN LÙNASTAL 6590 BDE** — *The measured handful* (Àth gharbh). Across the hill settlements a custom sets in that no fire takes more of the ore than can be held in one cupped hand. It is nowhere written and everywhere kept. The Small-Burning Law of the next age is this custom hardened.
- 7 AN T-IUCHAR 6535 BDE** — *The basket burning at Achadh dhìreach* (Achadh dhìreach). A household at Achadh dhìreach burns a whole basket of the ore at once. The house burns down with three people inside, and the hearth-stone is found cracked through and running with colour. The tellings use it for ever after to explain the handful.

- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 6481 BDE** — *The watchers of the slab* (Tobar dhireach). Families near the crack begin taking turns to sit by the slab laid over it, a household at a time, through the dark half of the year. No one ever says what they are watching for.
- 10 AN CÈITEAN 6426 BDE** — *Raghnall Ceannfhionn makes peace* (Fèill Muileann òg). Raghnall Ceannfhionn, seventh of the Stone Kings, meets the Red Hill's holder at the ford where the fair of Muileann òg is held now, and they agree on salt for wool. Both lists record the meeting. It is the first time either mentions the other.
- 29 AN T-SAMHAIN 6393 BDE** — *The ford gathering* (Fèill Muileann òg). The meeting at the ford becomes a yearly gathering. Salt, flint, wool, dried fish and pots change hands there, and marriages are agreed. The trodden ground is the oldest continuous meeting-place on the island.
- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 6354 BDE** — *Murchadh Gearr of the Red Hill* (Cathair dhearg). Murchadh Gearr holds the Red Hill after Seonag and keeps the peace of the ford. His telling says he walked the salt road himself every year to be seen on it.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 6327 BDE** — *Hill-folk on the western shore* (Ros bheag). Households from the hills settle the bay at Ros bheag, the first of them on the west coast. They build in the hill manner, round and turf-roofed, a little back from the beach, and they fish from the shore rather than from boats.
- 8 AN GEARRAN 6295 BDE** — *Amber from the Hawk bay* (Seann Skell). Lumps of amber gathered from the wrack on the strands of the Hawk bay are found drilled for stringing in the middens below Seann Skell. A bead of the same amber lies in the oldest ground of the ford gathering, carried there the length of the island.
- 3 AN T-SULTAIN 6254 BDE** — *The first houses at Cathair dhombhain* (Cathair dhomhain). A cluster of round houses goes up by the harbour where Cathair dhomhain now stands, near enough the Red Hill to pay it salt. The Red Hill list counts it among the holder's households.
- 25 AM MÀRT 6222 BDE** — *Cattle in the north-west* (Cnoc ghorm). Cattle bones appear in the hearths of Cnoc ghorm in the north-west for the first time. Until now the settlements there lived on seal, fish and deer. The herds must have been walked up the flint road.
- 24 AN GEARRAN 6185 BDE** — *The long-house at Cathair gheal* (Cathair gheal). A long-house forty paces long is built on the rise at Cathair gheal, with byre and hall under one roof. It is the largest single building of this age in the north-west, and it burns and is rebuilt on the same footing twice.
- 21 AN T-IUCHAR 6149 BDE** — *A youth let down into Toll-dubh* (Toll-dubh). The tellings of the south-east keep the story of a youth let down on a rope of plaited hide into the eastern Toll-dubh, to the rope's end. He was drawn up alive, and he never said what was at the bottom. After him no one went down again in this age.

- 19 AN LÙNASTAL 6112 BDE** — *A fire lit in the Doire uaine hills* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). A herding family, new to the hills, lights an open fire at Doire uaine against the custom. The telling says the hut was found empty and the fire still burning. The custom of the covered hearth is kept stricter after.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 6076 BDE** — *The lake dwellings burn* (Loch chrom). The platforms on Loch chrom burn to the waterline, and the charred piles are left standing in the shallows. No one rebuilds on the lake in this age.
- 22 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 6039 BDE** — *Seal-oil lamps at Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). Stone lamps with a hollow for seal oil and a moss wick are in use at Caol leathan. They are the first light on Rodos that is not a hearth, and they make no smoke to speak of.
- 27 AM MÀRT 6003 BDE** — *The fish-traps of Caol fhiadhaich* (Caol fhiadhaich). Wattle fences are staked across the river-mouth at Caol fhiadhaich to trap salmon on the ebb. The same line of stake-holes is used and re-used through the rest of the age.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 5973 BDE** — *The upright looms of Muileann leathan* (Muileann leathan). Loom-weights of fired clay, lying in rows where they fell from the warp, are found in the houses at Muileann leathan in the north. Cloth is being woven there on standing frames, not twined by hand.
- 28 AM FAOILLEACH 5930 BDE** — *The first tide-count*. Someone begins marking the high-water line against a fixed rock, for reasons never recorded, in intervals later scholars recognize as suspiciously regular for a purely practical fisherman's habit.
- 26 AN GEARRAN 5893 BDE** — *A second tide-rock at Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). The high-water marking is copied at Ros dhomhain on a boulder in the harbour mouth. The marks there are cut at the same intervals as on the first rock, which means someone carried the practice, and the interval with it.
- 10 AM MÀRT 5854 BDE** — *The lake is higher* (Ros dhomhain). The marks on the Ros dhomhain rock creep upward from keeper to keeper. By the end of this age Loch chrom stands a hand higher on the rock than it did at the first cut. The keepers keep cutting.
- 8 AN GIBLEAN 5820 BDE** — *The flint of Cnoc àrsaidh* (Cnoc àrsaidh). A pit is worked for flint on the hill of Cnoc àrsaidh in the north-west, the only good flint on Rodos. Grey flakes from it are found in hearths from one end of the island to the other.
- 11 AM FAOILLEACH 5784 BDE** — *The flint road* (Àth leathan). A track worn by people carrying flint runs from Cnoc àrsaidh south and east toward the ford gathering. Stretches of it near Àth leathan are sunk a yard deep by feet.
- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 5748 BDE** — *The hawk lintel at Àth mhòr* (Àth mhòr). A lintel stone over a house door at Àth mhòr in the north is carved with a hawk, wings closed, head turned. It is the oldest hawk carving on the island and the oldest carving of any bird.
- 10 AM MÀRT 5711 BDE** — *Wolves at Tobar fhiadhaich* (Tobar fhiadhaich). The bones of wolves are found buried whole and with care at Tobar fhiadhaich, laid on their sides like people. No other beast is buried that way in this age.

- 9 **AN GEARRAN 5674 BDE** — *Sileas Bhàn and the hungry years* (Dùn ìseal). Sileas Bhàn, eighth of the Stone Kings, holds Dùn ìseal through years of failed grazing. The telling gives her no deed but survival: she held, and the list goes on after her.
- 7 **AN CÈITEAN 5635 BDE** — *The hunger at Baile chrom* (Gorta Baile chrom). The hearths of the settlement on the site of the north-western Baile chrom are found with their pots full of boiled bark and seaweed, and the grave-rows beside them doubled. It is the oldest hunger on Rodos with a place to it.
- 8 **AN GIBLEAN 5595 BDE** — *The drought at Achadh shean* (Tiormachd Achadh shean). The springs of Achadh shean in the east run dry for long enough that the field banks are abandoned and grown over. When people come back they cut new fields on a different line.
- 4 **AN T-IUCHAR 5554 BDE** — *The naming of the wind directions*. The eight-point wind system every later Ròdaich sailor still uses is fixed in this period, with names that translate awkwardly and have simply never been replaced.
- 5 **AN T-ÒGMHIOS 5517 BDE** — *The wind-stones of Ceann leathan* (Ceann leathan). Eight tall stones are set in a ring on the point at Ceann leathan, one for each of the named winds. Sailors of every later age touch the stone of the wind they want before they go out.
- 24 **AN CÈITEAN 5477 BDE** — *The wind-names carried to the islands* (Eilean fhada). The eight wind-names are in use on Eilean fhada as well as the main island: stone markers on its high point carry eight cut notches, one facing each way.
- 25 **AN GIBLEAN 5438 BDE** — *Tormod Liath* (Dùn ìseal). Tormod Liath, ninth of the Stone Kings, is remembered as old: the list says he outlived three heirs. In his time Dùn ìseal gets its second bank, doubling the enclosed ground.
- 4 **AN T-IUCHAR 5400 BDE** — *The Ròdaich name*. Somewhere in this age the hill-folk begin to call themselves Ròdaich and the island Ròdos. No one records the first use. The oldest tellings already assume both names, and the doctrine goes with them: they did not come; they were here.
- 2 **AN LÙNASTAL 5378 BDE** — *The first forbidden marriage*. A union between two lineages is refused for reasons no surviving text explains — the earliest evidence that Rodian society organized itself by bloodline before it had any obsidian-caste reason to.
- 31 **AN LÙNASTAL 5354 BDE** — *Lines recited at the ford* (Fèill Muileann òg). At the ford gathering, households begin reciting their lines aloud before any marriage is agreed, seven names back on each side. The recitations are the first genealogies on Rodos. None of them survives complete.
- 29 **AN T-SULTAIN 5334 BDE** — *The first seeking of another vein* (Cnoc dhubh). Diggers from Dùn ìseal open a trench on a hill near Cnoc dhubh in the east, looking for black rock like the vein's. They give it up unfinished when two of them are crushed by a fall. The trench is left open, and no one says what it would have found.

- 10 AN MÀRT 5312 BDE** — *The stone that would not break.* A second attempt to open a new vein elsewhere on the island fails entirely — ordinary rock, nothing beneath it. The first confirmation that the vein under the mountain is not a rule, but an exception.
- 8 AN GIBLEAN 5289 BDE** — *The prospecting ends.* After the failed second opening, no one in this age tries a third. The Ròdaich take it as a sign that the vein chooses where it lies, and that the choosing is not theirs to test.
- 7 AN CÈITEAN 5273 BDE** — *The first shared meal law.* An unwritten custom, later formalized, requiring any household with surplus food to share it before a storm season — the earliest form of the communal obligation later ages will lean on more heavily than they admit.
- 5 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 5245 BDE** — *Surplus shared at Dùn ìseal (Dùn ìseal).* At Dùn ìseal the sharing before the storm season is done in the open: every household brings its surplus to the space inside the bank and it is divided by count of mouths. The bank is the first place the custom is known to have a place.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 5223 BDE** — *A household turned out at Àth shean (Àth shean).* A household at Àth shean hides its surplus grain in a pit under the floor and brings nothing to the sharing. When the pit is found the household is put out of the settlement with what it can carry. It is the first known punishment under the custom.
- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 5201 BDE** — *Eilidh Ghlas (Dùn ìseal).* Eilidh Ghlas, tenth of the Stone Kings, sends her younger son to the Red Hill to be fostered. It is the first fosterage in either list. The son's name is not kept; only that he went, and that the peace of the ford held while he was there.
- 25 AN DÙBHLACHD 5200 BDE** — *Lachlann Ruadh takes the fosterling (Cathair dhearg).* Lachlann Ruadh, holder of the Red Hill, takes Eilidh Ghlas's son into his house. The Red Hill list gives him a byname for it, Lachlann an Altraim, 'Lachlann of the fostering', and uses it more often than his own.
- 26 AN T-SAMHAIN 5198 BDE** — *Oighrig, first keeper by lot (Tobar dhìreach).* The families who watch the slab over the crack agree to choose one keeper at a time by lot instead of taking turns by household. The first lot falls to a woman the tellings call Oighrig nic Dhòmhnaill. She keeps the slab for the rest of her life.
- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 5197 BDE** — *The keepers' house (Tobar dhìreach).* A house is built beside the slab at Tobar dhìreach for whoever holds the lot, with a door facing the stone. It is rebuilt on the same footing many times. It is the first building on Rodos that exists only to be near the vein.
- 29 AN T-SULTAIN 5196 BDE** — *The stone cup (Tobar dhìreach).* Oighrig nic Dhòmhnaill has a cup ground out of grey stone to the size of her own cupped hand, so that the handful of ore would be the same for every household. The cup is carried round the hill settlements. Whether it survived the age is not known.

- 31 AN LÙNASTAL 5194 BDE** — *The stone cup copied* (Cnoc chaol). Copies of the keeper's cup are ground at Àth gharbh, Achadh dhìreach and Cnoc chaol, each checked against the first by filling it with water. The hill settlements now measure the ore with one measure.
- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 5193 BDE** — *The meeting of the cups* (Coinneachadh nan Cupan). The keeper's cup and its three copies are carried to a spring on the moor between Àth gharbh and Tobar dhìreach, set side by side on a flat stone and filled from the spring in turn. The place is called Coinneachadh nan Cupan, the meeting of the cups, and the hill settlements come back to it whenever a cup is broken and a new one must be checked.
- 2 AN LÙNASTAL 5192 BDE** — *Gilleasbuig Beag takes ore* (Eilean chrom). A keeper by lot named Gilleasbuig Beag is found with a basket of broken ore in his own house. The households of the hills sit in judgement at the slab and row him out to Eilean chrom and leave him there without a boat. He is the first person on record exiled for the vein.
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 5190 BDE** — *The ore returned to the crack* (Tobar dhìreach). The ore found in Gilleasbuig Beag's house is not burned and not kept. It is carried back to the slab and laid under it, piece by piece, by the keeper who followed him. The tellings make much of this: the ore went home.
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 5189 BDE** — *Calum Ciar asks for the lot* (Dùn ìseal). Calum Ciar, eleventh of the Stone Kings, asks the households at the slab that the keeper's lot be drawn at Dùn ìseal in his sight. The households refuse. The list records the refusal, which is more than the list usually records of anything.
- 7 AN CÈITEAN 5185 BDE** — *The kings and the keepers* (Dùn ìseal). After Calum Ciar's refusal the lot is still drawn at the slab, and the Stone Kings go on ruling the grazing and the gatherings but not the vein. The line between the two holds for the rest of this age. It is not yet written anywhere.
- 1 AN GEARRAN 5184 BDE** — *A' Ghaoth Dhubh* (Cuan ruadh). A storm the tellings call A' Ghaoth Dhubh, the Black Wind, strips the thatch from every house on the east coast from Cuan ruadh to Ceann chiar. It is the oldest storm whose name is kept.
- 8 AN GIBLEAN 5184 BDE** — *The sharing holds after the Black Wind* (Ceann chiar). After the Black Wind, the settlements of the east coast feed the people of Cuan ruadh through a whole winter from their shared surplus. No one on that coast is recorded as dying of hunger that season.
- 2 AM MÀRT 5183 BDE** — *The beacon at Baile ìseal* (Taigh-solais Baile ìseal). A fire is built up on the eastern cape where Taigh-solais Baile ìseal now stands, kept by the households of the coast in turn. Its purpose, in the tellings, is to bring boats home in a storm, not to warn them off.
- 3 AM FAOILLEACH 5182 BDE** — *The beacon at Muileann bheag* (Taigh-solais Muileann bheag). A second shore-fire is kept on the north coast, on the point where Taigh-solais Muileann bheag stands now. The ash under the modern tower goes down through three yards of fire-reddened soil.

- 5 AN DÙBHLACHD 5182 BDE** — *The beacon at Àth dhearg* (Taigh-solais Àth dhearg). Households of the north-east coast keep a fire on the cape where Taigh-solais Àth dhearg now stands, and cut steps up to it from the shore. The steps are narrower than those at Seann Bhral and less worn.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 5181 BDE** — *The beacon at Tobar dhearg* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). On the southern cape where Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg stands a fire is kept for the boats of the south coast. With the fires at Baile chrom, Baile ìseal, Muileann bheag and Àth dhearg, the island's coasts are lit at five points.
- 31 AM MÀRT 5180 BDE** — *The Sea-Watcher seen from Seann Skell* (Uilebheist na Mara). Watchers on the north-western tower at Seann Skell report a back as long as three boats, rising and going under off the point. It is the first sighting of the Sea-Watcher that the tellings tie to a named place and a count of witnesses: four.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 5180 BDE** — *Wreckage in the western water* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Planks of stitched boats, broken small, wash up for a season along the western shore below the waters where raiders are later seen. No bodies come with them. No settlement on that coast is missing a boat.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 5179 BDE** — *Anndra Breac says 'we came'* (Fèill Muileann òg). At the ford gathering a teller from the western coast, Anndra Breac, recites a telling in which the people came to Rodos over the sea. The households of the hills shout him down and the gathering puts him out of the ford for the rest of his life. His telling is not kept, only the fact of it.
- 21 AN T-SULTAIN 5178 BDE** — *The doctrine said at the column* (Calbh Cnoc ghorm). After Anndra Breac, the saying cut on the column at Cnoc ghorm is spoken aloud at the opening of the ford gathering: we did not come; we were here. It is the first time the doctrine is known to be said as a rule rather than a belief.
- 25 AN T-IUCHAR 5177 BDE** — *The keepers of the Ros dhombhain rock* (Ros dhomhain). The tide-rock at Ros dhomhain passes to a woman remembered as Seònaid Mhòr, who cuts her marks in pairs, one for the high water and one for the low. Her pairs are still readable. The keepers after her go back to single marks.
- 20 AN DÀMHAIR 5177 BDE** — *A third tide-rock at Inis thais* (Inis thais). Households at Inis thais cut their own high-water marks on the harbour rock, at the same interval as Ros dhomhain. The three rocks now run side by side. None of them says why the interval is what it is.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 5176 BDE** — *Ros dhombhain grows* (Ros dhomhain). The settlement at Ros dhomhain becomes the largest on the shores of Loch chrom, with some sixty houses round the tide-rock. Its people fish from boats now, not from the shore.
- 23 AN LÙNASTAL 5175 BDE** — *The Red Hill's harbour* (Cathair dhearg). The Red Hill's households build a landing of laid stone on the river-mouth below the hill, where Cathair dhearg's harbour is now. It is the Red Hill's first way onto the water, and by the lake and the Abhainn gheal to the sea.

- 21 AN T-SULTAIN 5175 BDE** — *Peigi Dhubh of the Red Hill* (Cathair dhearg). Peigi Dhubh holds the Red Hill after Lachlann an Altraim. She sends the fostered son of Dùn ìseal home grown, with gifts of salt, and the ford peace holds a generation more.
- 31 AM MÀRT 5174 BDE** — *The foster-son returns* (Dùn ìseal). The son of Eilidh Ghlas comes home from the Red Hill to Dùn ìseal. The Stone Kings' list gives him no name and no reign; he is remembered only as the one who went, and for bringing western salt-songs home with him.
- 2 AM MÀRT 5173 BDE** — *The first songs kept* (Baile ghorm). The salt-songs of the south and west, work-songs for raking the pans, are the oldest songs on Rodos whose words are said to survive. What survives is a refrain of four lines that no one can fully translate.
- 14 AM MÀRT 5173 BDE** — *Bone pipes at Cnoc àrsaidh* (Cnoc àrsaidh). Pipes of hollow bird-bone, bored with four holes, are found in a house at the southern Cnoc àrsaidh near the panther road. They are the oldest instruments on the island.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 5173 BDE** — *The panthers turn back* (Imrich nam Pantar). In one season the great cats come down the panther road near Imrich nam Pantar and turn back at the foothills instead of crossing. The hill-folk take it as a sign of a hard winter and store double. The winter is hard.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 5173 BDE** — *The cattle lost in the passes* (Muileann bhàn). Herders from Muileann bhàn drive cattle up into the passes out of season, against the custom of the crossing. The panthers take thirty head in a night. The herders come down with nothing.
- 15 AM FAOILLEACH 5154 BDE** — *The panther season kept at Baile dhomhain* (Baile dhomhain). The households at Baile dhomhain in the south cut a sign on their gateposts at the start of the crossing season and scrape it off at the end. It is the island's first mark for a season.
- 13 AN GEARRAN 5154 BDE** — *The wind-stone at Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). One of the eight wind-names is cut in the Ròdaich manner on a boulder at the central Seann Chwen, over an older mark of the Seann-Dhaoine. It is one of the few places where the marks of the two peoples touch.
- 14 AN GEARRAN 5154 BDE** — *Boats named for the winds* (Caol bheag). Fishing households at Caol bheag, who fish the north coast from the mouth of the Abhainn ghorm, name their boats for the winds they fish in. A boat named for the wrong wind is thought unlucky, and one that sinks has its name never used again.
- 14 AM MÀRT 5154 BDE** — *The Tuam keepers* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). A family living by Tuam Cnoc dhìreach takes on the clearing of the thorn from the old graves. They bury no one of their own there. They only keep it.
- 12 AN GIBLEAN 5154 BDE** — *A grave at Tuam opened* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). Diggers laying a new row at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach break into an older grave than any they knew, lined with slabs cut in the Seann-Dhaoine way. They close it and move the row. No one opens that grave again.

- 11 AN CÈITEAN 5152 BDE** — *Pilgrims at Coille Naomh Muileann chiar* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). People begin to walk to the edge of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar and sit a night at the line of the trees without entering. Hearths along the edge show the visits: small fires, a single night each.
- 9 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 5150 BDE** — *A child lost in Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). A child from Cnoc bheag's settlement goes past the line of stones into Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag and is not found. The search party stops at the stones. The telling does not blame them.
- 8 AN T-IUCHAR 5148 BDE** — *The first house at Cnoc bheag* (Cnoc bheag). Settlers from the Red Hill build at Cnoc bheag, near the forest's edge. They take their timber from the far side of the river, never from the unclaimed wood.
- 6 AN LÙNASTAL 5146 BDE** — *The spring at Muileann ruadh* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). Pilgrims come to the warm springs at Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh in numbers, and a ring of shelters is built. The oldest cure-telling on Rodos is set there: a herder who came lame and walked home.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 5144 BDE** — *The Hollow Man seen again* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). Two herders driving past the Doire uaine hills after dark say they saw a figure walk the ridge without breath showing in the cold. They had no fire lit, and the telling says that is why they lived.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 5141 BDE** — *The covered hearth spreads* (Muileann chiar). The custom of the covered hearth, pit-dug and roofed, spreads from the Doire uaine hills to the settlements around Muileann chiar. The later rule that no open fire is lit on those slopes after dark starts here.
- 31 AN DÙBHLACHD 5139 BDE** — *Settlers at Caol mhòr* (Caol mhòr). Ròdaich households settle at Caol mhòr in the north-west, on the strait where the Seann-Dhaoine once hunted seal. They find the old middens and build on them.
- 2 AN DÙBHLACHD 5137 BDE** — *Settlers at Baile chrom in the north-west* (Baile chrom). The ground at Baile chrom that was emptied by the old hunger is settled again by households from Cnoc ghorm. They dig their pits for storage deeper than anyone else on the coast.
- 3 AN T-SAMHAIN 5135 BDE** — *Muileann àrsaidh settled* (Muileann àrsaidh). A cluster of houses goes up on the stream at Muileann àrsaidh in the north-west. Their flint is from Cnoc àrsaidh and their salt from the south, carried the length of the island.
- 5 AN DÀMHAIR 5133 BDE** — *The salt road to the north-west* (Muileann àrsaidh). A salt road runs from the pans of Baile ghorm through the ford gathering to the north-west. The salt reaches Muileann àrsaidh at three times its price at the pans, paid in flint and seal-skins.
- 26 AN GIBLEAN 5131 BDE** — *Doire ghlais settled* (Doire ghlais). Households move in under the oaks at Doire ghlais in the north. The settlement grows in rings, each ring of houses built outside the last as the wood is cleared back.

- 28 AM MÀRT 5128 BDE** — *The east settled at Dùn thais* (Dùn thais). The hill-folk push east and build a banked enclosure at Dùn thais, on a hill above good grazing. It is the first defended place built by the Ròdaich away from Dùn ìseal and the Red Hill.
- 27 AN GEARRAN 5126 BDE** — *Achadh chaol cleared* (Achadh chaol). Fields are cleared by fire and stone-picking at Achadh chaol in the east. The picked stones are laid in banks round each field, and the banks are still the field boundaries.
- 29 AM FAOILLEACH 5124 BDE** — *Cuan ruadh rebuilt* (Cuan ruadh). Cuan ruadh, stripped by the Black Wind, is rebuilt in stone to the height of the eaves. It is the first settlement on the east coast to build its walls against wind rather than cold.
- 13 AN CÈITEAN 5078 BDE** — *Cathair fhada on the south coast* (Cathair fhada). A settlement is founded at Cathair fhada on the south coast, between the old Seann Dunn and Seann Chwen. It takes its water from a well the Seann-Dhaoine dug and never mentions where the well came from.
- 14 AN GIBLEAN 5031 BDE** — *Caol ruadh on the southern strait* (Caol ruadh). Fishing households settle Caol ruadh on the south coast and take the strait's cod on long lines. Their middens are the first on the south coast with more fish than shell in them.
- 13 AN T-SULTAIN 4985 BDE** — *Baile Mòr mhòr in the north* (Baile Mòr mhòr). Houses are built at Baile Mòr mhòr, on the northern plain, around a spring that never freezes. The settlement is large for the age: some eighty houses at its height.
- 15 AN LÙNASTAL 4939 BDE** — *Baile gharbh in the north-east* (Baile gharbh). Households settle the rough ground at Baile gharbh and live by sheep, not cattle. Their wool goes south along the coast to the ford gathering.
- 17 AN T-IUCHAR 4892 BDE** — *Baile fhiadhaich on the west coast* (Baile fhiadhaich). Settlers at Baile fhiadhaich build on the western coast where boars run in the thickets. Boar tusks are hung over their doors, and boar is their main meat for the rest of the age.
- 18 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 4846 BDE** — *Cuan shean settled* (Cuan shean). Ròdaich households take up the harbour at Cuan shean on the west coast, next to an old landing whose builders are not known. The landing is reused without repair.
- 7 AM FAOILLEACH 4800 BDE** — *Dùn chrom raised* (Dùn chrom). A banked hill-fort is raised at Dùn chrom in the centre of the island, between the Red Hill and the hills of the vein. Its bank faces both ways.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 4754 BDE** — *Cathair mhòr below the old outpost* (Cathair mhòr). Households settle on the ground below Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, where Cathair mhòr now stands. They take no stone from the ruin above them, though it would have been the nearest quarry.
- 10 AN T-SAMHAIN 4707 BDE** — *Cnoc naomh* (Cnoc naomh). A hill called Cnoc naomh, the holy hill, is settled by households who come there for its spring. Why the hill was already called holy when they came is not known.

- 12 AN DÀMHAIR 4654 BDE** — *Tobar dhearg on the southern cape* (Tobar dhearg). The households that keep the beacon at Tobar dhearg build their settlement on the cape itself, round a well whose water runs reddish from the rock. It becomes the largest place on the south coast.
- 24 AM FAOILLEACH 4615 BDE** — *Muileann naomh founded* (Muileann naomh). A settlement is founded at Muileann naomh near the south coast, between the beacon at Tobar dhearg and the old Seann Skell. Its first houses are built on stilts over a marsh and later moved to firm ground.
- 26 AN DÙBHLACHD 4573 BDE** — *Ceann mhin on the south-eastern shore* (Ceann mhin). The south-eastern Ceann mhin is settled near Làrach an Dùin. Its people are the first to live in sight of the fortress ruin, and they will not go up to it.
- 23 AM MÀRT 4522 BDE** — *Seann Skell of the south* (Seann Skell). Ròdaich households take up the old harbour at the southern Seann Skell, keeping its old name. Within a few generations it is the busiest landing on the south coast.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 4476 BDE** — *Achadh shean resettled* (Achadh shean). After the drought, households come back to Achadh shean and cut new fields on the higher ground. They sink a deep well first and plant after, and the well does not fail again in this age.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 4429 BDE** — *Inis mhin settled* (Inis mhin). A few households settle at Inis mhin on the eastern coast. They live by eggs and birds from the cliffs, and trade feathers inland.
- 18 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 4383 BDE** — *Muileann chaol on its hill* (Muileann chaol). Households settle on the hill at Muileann chaol, above the upper reaches of the rivers. The ground where the library stands now is a cattle-fold in this age.
- 17 AN T-IUCHAR 4337 BDE** — *Cairns on the hill at Muileann chaol* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The households of Muileann chaol raise a cairn for each head of a household at his or her death, on the slope above the fold. Some forty cairns stand there by the end of the age.
- 15 AN LÙNASTAL 4290 BDE** — *Baile Mòr ruadh in the east* (Baile Mòr ruadh). A settlement grows up at Baile Mòr ruadh near the eastern Seann Dunn, on land its people call empty. The Seann Dunn middens lie a morning's walk away. The settlers do not dig into them.
- 13 AN T-SULTAIN 4244 BDE** — *The temple ruin avoided* (Làrach an Teampaill). The Ròdaich of the eastern hills pass Làrach an Teampaill on their paths without stopping and without taking stone from it. A path is worn round it at a distance.
- 12 AN DÀMHAIR 4198 BDE** — *Ceann leathan's contests* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). At Ceann leathan the gathering by the wind-stones is ended with wrestling and stone-lifting. The heaviest lifting-stone, a black boulder, is still on the point, and few have raised it.

- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 4151 BDE** — *The ford gathering grows* (Fèill Muileann òg). The ford gathering at Muileann òg now draws households from every coast. Its ground is divided into places by custom: the salt people downstream, the hill people upstream, the flint people on the far bank.
- 1 AN T-SULTAIN 4105 BDE** — *Stone axes from the north* (Àth àrsaidh). Axes of polished green stone from a quarry near Àth àrsaidh in the north-west turn up across the island. They are too fine for work, and most are found unused, in graves or under house floors.
- 13 AN GIBLEAN 4054 BDE** — *The quarry at Àth àrsaidh* (Àth àrsaidh). The green-stone quarry at Àth àrsaidh is worked by a few households who trade nothing else. The chips around it are knee-deep. The quarry is abandoned before the age ends, and the axes stop.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 4013 BDE** — *The moor takes the north* (Doire ghlas). The pollen in the bog under Doire ghlas shows the oak falling back. Heather, birch and bog-moss spread over the northern lowlands, and the groves that give the north its many Doire names shrink to the sheltered valleys, where they still stand. The tellings of the north remember it as the time the winters lengthened.
- 15 AM MÀRT 3973 BDE** — *The river crossings of Abhainn fhionn* (Abhainn fhionn). Stepping-stones are laid across Abhainn fhionn at its shallows, the first made crossing of any river on the island. They are older than the first bridges and in places lie under them.
- 10 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 3921 BDE** — *A drowning at the fords of Abhainn chaol* (Abhainn chaol). A spate on Abhainn chaol takes a party of twelve crossing with salt at its fords. After it the crossing is not made in the wet season.
- 12 AN CÈITEAN 3875 BDE** — *The Black Wind remembered at Ceann chiar* (Ceann chiar). The people of Ceann chiar, rebuilding after the Black Wind, set a stone in the middle of their settlement and cut on it one mark for every house lost: twenty-two.
- 7 AN LÙNASTAL 3830 BDE** — *A dry year on the eastern plain* (Muileann bhàn). The rivers of the eastern plain run low for a whole summer, and the households of Dùn ìseal and Muileann bhàn drive their cattle to the warm springs for water. The shared surplus holds; the tellings count no deaths.
- 9 AN T-IUCHAR 3784 BDE** — *A second wave on the south coast* (Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol). The sea comes in again over the low ground at Cnoc chaol, less far than the first time. The new houses were built higher up the slope, and none is lost.
- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 3738 BDE** — *The ground shakes at Cill ghlas again* (Scàineadh Cill ghlas). The old crack at Cill ghlas moves again and the spring shifts back uphill. The line of white stones is found broken in two places and relaid.
- 5 AN T-SULTAIN 3693 BDE** — *Cnoc bheag under the Carragh* (Cnoc bheag). Households settle on the bank of the Abhainn ìseal at Cnoc bheag, a short walk from Carragh Cnoc bheag. They set their houses so that none has its door toward the stone.

- I AN DÙBHLACHD 3646 BDE** — *The seal rocks of Inis bhàn* (Inis bhàn). The households of Inis bhàn on the lower Abhainn ìseal take seals from the skerries off the river mouth by agreement, one household to a rock. A rock taken out of turn is the commonest quarrel in their tellings.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 3601 BDE** — *Fields at Achadh mhòr* (Achadh mhòr). The wide field at Achadh mhòr, near the warm springs, is cleared and banked, the largest single field of the age. Its bank is laid with the stones of an older wall no one claims.
- 7 AN CÈITEAN 3554 BDE** — *The harbour at Baile ghlas* (Baile ghlas). Boats of the Red Hill households are drawn up at Baile ghlas, along the lake shore from the hill, in sheds of stone and turf. It becomes the Red Hill's fishing harbour.
- 5 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 3510 BDE** — *Achadh naomh's spring-fields* (Achadh naomh). Settlers at Achadh naomh in the north water their fields from a spring they will not build over, and carry the water in channels round it. The spring is fenced before any house is.
- 10 AM MÀRT 3473 BDE** — *Caol gharbh on the rough strait* (Caol gharbh). Households settle at Caol gharbh on the north-east coast and fish the strait in skin boats. Their graves hold paddles laid beside the dead.
- 8 AN GIBLEAN 3418 BDE** — *Doire chiar* (Doire chiar). A settlement grows up under the dark oaks at Doire chiar in the north. Its people pen pigs in the wood and drive them out to the acorns in the fall of the year.
- 11 AM FAOILLEACH 3373 BDE** — *The river landing at Caol shean* (Caol shean). Caol shean, on the Abhainn ìseal east of the vein, becomes the river landing for the hill households east of the vein. Salt, fish and seal-skins come up the river to it from the coast, and on from it to the keepers' country.
- 9 AN GEARRAN 3327 BDE** — *Dùn dhearg raised* (Dùn dhearg). A hill-fort with a double bank is raised at Dùn dhearg, east of the vein, by households who owe nothing to Dùn ìseal. The Stone Kings' list does not name its holders; it only says Dùn dhearg did not come to the gatherings.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 3280 BDE** — *Dùn dhearg comes to the ford* (Fèill Muileann òg). The households of Dùn dhearg come to the ford gathering for the first time in Catrìona Mhòr's time, bringing seal-skins and asking for salt. They are given their own ground on the far bank.
- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 3276 BDE** — *Settlers at Àth fhiadhaich* (Àth fhiadhaich). Households settle at Àth fhiadhaich in the south-eastern hills, by a ford where wild cattle cross. They catch the calves and raise them, and their herds are later the best in those hills.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 3273 BDE** — *Ceann àrsaidh* (Ceann àrsaidh). The point at Ceann àrsaidh on the Abhainn fhionn is settled by households from the Red Hill. They find an old river landing there and name the place for it: the ancient headland.

- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 3273 BDE** — *Cnoc thais in the north-west* (Cnoc thais). Households settle on the damp hill at Cnoc thais in the north-west and drain it with ditches. The ditches still carry water.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 3273 BDE** — *Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). Households settle Inis mhòr on the Abhainn ghorm in the north-east, and live by the fish of its sheltered river pools. Their houses are built in two rows facing each other, the oldest street on Rodos.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 3254 BDE** — *Baile gheal in the south-west* (Baile gheal). Baile gheal, on the south-western plain, is founded around a house with white-limed walls. The lime is burned from shells from the old middens along the coast.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 3254 BDE** — *Àth bheag on the eastern coast* (Àth bheag). Households settle the small ford at Àth bheag on the far eastern coast, the easternmost settlement of the age on the main island. Their boats go out to the geese on the islands.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 3254 BDE** — *Catrìona Mhòr* (Dùn ìseal). Catrìona Mhòr, twelfth of the Stone Kings and the last name the oral list gives, holds Dùn ìseal. Her telling says she knew every household of the hills by its line back seven names.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 3254 BDE** — *Seumas Òg of the Red Hill* (Cathair dhearg). Seumas Òg holds the Red Hill. He is the last name in the Red Hill's oral list; the list stops with him, and in the next age what the reciters kept of it is written down and no longer only spoken.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 3254 BDE** — *The two lists recited together* (Fèill Muileann òg). At the ford gathering in Catrìona Mhòr's time, the Stone Kings' list and the Red Hill list are recited one after the other, from first name to last. It takes from dusk to dawn. It is the first time anyone hears both whole.
- 29 AM MÀRT 3251 BDE** — *Lots drawn for the slab* (Tobar dhìreach). The lot for the keeper of the slab is now drawn among households from every part of the hills, not only those near the crack. The keeper's house at Tobar dhìreach becomes a place people walk to.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 3248 BDE** — *The keepers number nine* (Tobar dhìreach). The keepers of the slab are nine at a time, one drawn by lot for each of nine districts of the hills. They meet at the slab when a keeper dies, and not otherwise.
- 9 AN CÈITEAN 3246 BDE** — *Ore in every hearth by the handful*. Every household of the hills burns its handful of ore on one night in the dark of the year, the night later kept as Samhain, measured in a copy of the stone cup. The burning is done at once in every house, by agreement, so the colour shows on every hillside the same night.
- 10 AN GIBLEAN 3243 BDE** — *A handful refused at Cnoc dhubh* (Cnoc dhubh). The household of the Cnoc dhubh trench, the one that crushed two diggers, refuses its handful of ore for as long as anyone remembers. It is the first household on record to choose not to burn at all.

- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 3240 BDE** — *Counting the households* (Dùn ìseal). Catriona Mhòr's people count the households of the hills by knots on a cord, a knot to a hearth. The cord from Dùn ìseal is said to have had some nine hundred knots. It is the largest count made on Rodos in this age.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 3237 BDE** — *The saying on the column recut* (Calbh Cnoc ghorm). The words on the column at Cnoc ghorm, worn shallow, are recut along their old grooves by a hand from the Stone Kings' hill. Some later readers say the recutting changed a letter; no one can prove which.
- 1 AN DÙBHLACHD 3234 BDE** — *The last Seann-Dhaoine midden disturbed* (Seann Dunn). Households at the eastern Seann Dunn cut into the old midden there for a house-floor and find the tally stones. They put them back in the order they found them and build elsewhere.
- 30 AN DÙBHLACHD 3231 BDE** — *Eilean ìseal given to the dead* (Eilean ìseal). The households of the south-east coast begin to row their dead to Eilean ìseal, in the old Seann-Dhaoine manner. Whether they learned it from the Seann Vell graves on Eilean dhearg, or from nothing, no telling says.
- 10 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 3228 BDE** — *Gilleasbuig Beag's island* (Eilean chrom). Eilean chrom, where Gilleasbuig Beag was sent, is left empty and is not fished. The tellings say his fire was seen on it for three nights and then not at all.
- 9 AN T-IUCHAR 3225 BDE** — *The keepers ask to be named* (Fèill Muileann òg). The nine keepers of the slab ask Catriona Mhòr that their charge be declared before the whole ford gathering, so that no king after her can draw the lot at Dùn ìseal. She does not refuse and does not agree. The matter is carried forward.
- 7 AN LÙNASTAL 3051 BDE** — *The eve of the Binding*. At the close of this age the handful custom is everywhere in the hills, the keepers are nine, the sharing before the storms is kept on every coast, and the doctrine is said at every gathering. None of it is yet declared, and no god is yet named over the vein. The next age begins when it is.

AGE II · AN AOIS NAOMH

- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 2998 BDE** — *The Binding of the First Flame*. A formal custodianship is declared over the vein, and the first flame is bound at Dùn ìseal: Brìde's undying flame, kept over the stone of Crom Cruaich. Its keeping, Òrd Bhrìde, is the first Rodian institution recognizable as a religious-political order, centuries before anything like a king.
- 28 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2995 BDE** — *Beathag Bhàn keeps the first flame* (Dùn ìseal). At Dùn ìseal, under the central mountains, the keepers of the slab and the households who swore the Binding choose Beathag Bhàn to hold the first flame for Brìde and answer to Crom for what is taken from the vein. The Keepers' recited roll begins with her name. Nothing is remembered of her before it.
- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 2989 BDE** — *The nine hearths* (Dùn ìseal). Nine households round the mountain's foot, one for each district of the old keepers of the slab, take the flame's tending in turn, each sending a son or a daughter to sit with it through a season. The later houses of custody all claimed descent from one or another of the nine; not all of the claims can be true.
- 19 AN DÙBHLACHD 2984 BDE** — *Talla na Lasrach raised* (Dùn ìseal). A long hall of dry stone and turf is raised over the flame at Dùn ìseal, with one door facing the vein and none facing the sea. It is rebuilt many times on the same footings, and the footings are all that anyone can now swear to.
- 17 AM FAOILLEACH 2978 BDE** — *Seann Spioradan nan Ròdach established*. The island's oldest continuous folk tradition takes shape at the hearths: reverence for ancestors, for the vein, for the weather that decides the mining season, and for the sìth of the hills and mounds. It keeps no priests.
- 22 AN DÀMHAIR 2972 BDE** — *The weather-cairns of Cnoc ghlas* (Cnoc ghlas). Watchers build cairns on the ridge above Cnoc ghlas and read the cloud on the high passes from them, to tell the Hall when the galleries may be opened for the season. A wrong reading there costs the whole mountain its season, and the watchers are chosen with more care than the Keeper.
- 20 AN T-SAMHAIN 2966 BDE** — *The ban on fires in sight of Doire uaine* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). The Keepers forbid any fire, of wood or of ore, to be lit where the Doire uaine hills can see it, in obedience to the old inscriptions there. Herders who winter on those slopes eat cold for the season. The ban is never repealed, and nobody in the record admits to breaking it.
- 5 AM FAOILLEACH 2965 BDE** — *Làrach an Teampaill left unentered* (Làrach an Teampaill). Beathag Bhàn walks to Làrach an Teampaill, finds its altar already turned toward the mountain, and declares the place not the Hall's to keep. The Keepers set no foot inside it for the rest of the age. Whose it was, they did not say, and it seems they did not know.

- 3 AN GEARRAN 2955 BDE** — *Death of Beathag Bhàn* (Dùn iséal). Beathag Bhàn dies at Dùn iséal and is laid on the slope facing the vein, not the sea. The nine hearths choose Muireach Liath, her sister's son, to keep the flame after her.
- 15 AN GEARRAN 2951 BDE** — *Ore by the basket* (Dùn iséal). Muireach Liath fixes the first common measure for ore carried down from the galleries: a lidded basket of plaited heather, one to a household, filled once a season. Baskets of that weave are still made at Dùn iséal for no purpose but the making.
- 17 AM FAOILLEACH 2946 BDE** — *Allt an Àigh named* (Allt an Àigh). A stream said to grant fortune to anyone who drinks from it during a particular phase of the moon becomes a site of pilgrimage that has never fully stopped.
- 14 AN GIBLEAN 2942 BDE** — *The pilgrims' path from Caol shean* (Caol shean). A path is worn from the river landing at Caol shean up the valley to Allt an Àigh, walked by night so that pilgrims reach the water in the right quarter of the moon. Fishermen who walk it are said to lose fewer boats; the record keeps no count either way.
- 16 AM MÀRT 2940 BDE** — *The Hall declines the stream* (Allt an Àigh). Muireach Liath rules that Allt an Àigh belongs to the ancestors and the weather, not to the vein, and that the Hall will not keep it. The ruling is the first visible parting between the Keepers' rite and the older folk reverence, and both sides later cite it as proof they were right.
- 22 AN DÀMHAIR 2933 BDE** — *The sick carried to Muileann ruadh* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). The warm springs below Muileann ruadh are first used for the sick, who are carried up in litters and bathed at dawn. The Keepers allow it because the water's heat comes from the mountain without anyone breaking the stone.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 2928 BDE** — *Muileann chiar founded* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). A silver seam is found near, but distinct from, the great vein — the island's first confirmed resource that isn't obsidian.
- 20 AN T-SAMHAIN 2925 BDE** — *Fearchar Airgeadach works the silver* (Muileann chiar). Fearchar Airgeadach, a basket-carrier of the nine hearths, is the first on record to smelt the silver of Muileann chiar and hammer it into rings. His furnace is fed with wood and peat. It is the first fire in the island's record that answers to no one in the Hall.
- 19 AN DÙBHLACHD 2925 BDE** — *Silver is not holy* (Muileann chiar). Asked whether the new seam falls under the flame, Muireach Liath answers that silver does not bleed and so is not the mountain's. The ruling leaves Muileann chiar free to dig as deep as it likes, and it digs. Every later quarrel over the silver begins from this sentence.
- 28 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2915 BDE** — *Silver for salt at Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). Carriers take Muileann chiar rings down to the river quays at Ros fhionn and trade them for salt fish and sealskin. It is the first trade in the record carried on in something other than food, and the first in which a price is remembered: one ring for a boatload.

- 30 AN CÈITEAN 2910 BDE** — *Death of Muireach Liath* (Dùn ìseal). Muireach Liath dies at Dùn ìseal, keeping the flame. The nine hearths pass over three candidates of other lines and choose his daughter Gormshuil nic Mhuirich, and from her election the Keeper's office stays in the house of Muireach for many generations.
- 11 AN T-SULTAIN 2903 BDE** — *Sliochd Mhuirich named* (Dùn ìseal). Gormshuil nic Mhuirich's kin at Dùn ìseal begin to be called Sliochd Mhuirich, the house of Muireach: the first custodian house in the record known by a name rather than by a hearth. The other eight hearths do not object in any account that survives.
- 10 AN DÀMHAIR 2896 BDE** — *The first school of the druids founded*. The first of the Scoiltean nan Draoidhean, the druid schools, forms around the question of why the vein answers some hands and not others — the first attempt within the Old Faith to reason about the obsidian rather than simply revere it.
- 8 AN T-SAMHAIN 2889 BDE** — *Sileas nic Coinnich in the wood* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). Sileas nic Coinnich, a cutter from Muileann chiar in the far east, begins teaching in Coille Naomh Muileann chiar. She had noticed at the galleries that the ore bleeds colour freely under some cutters' picks and sullenly under others, and she will not leave the question alone.
- 7 AN DÙBHLACHD 2881 BDE** — *The stag in the grove* (Muileann chiar). Sileas nic Coinnich's hearers at Muileann chiar are named for a stag that is said to have stood in the grove through a whole lesson. They call themselves the stag's people. The school's later name, the stag's name Camaran, and the telling that it was the white stag of Flidais, lady of the deer, are first found in texts much younger than these events.
- 18 AN CÈITEAN 2874 BDE** — *The Hall shuts the galleries to the stag's people* (Dùn ìseal). Gormshuil nic Mhuirich forbids Sileas's hearers to cut in the galleries of Dùn ìseal, on the ground that a question asked of the vein is a demand made of it. The stag's people keep their school in the east and send no cutters to the mountain for a long time after.
- 16 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2867 BDE** — *The smoke at Cnoc dhubh* (Cnoc dhubh). A hard winter drives a household at Cnoc dhubh to burn its ore by the basketful rather than by the handful. The smoke settles in the valley; three of the household and two neighbours die of it. The Keepers are sent for, and the case is argued at Dùn ìseal for the rest of the season.
- 15 AN T-IUCHAR 2860 BDE** — *Fionnlagh Dall and the stone cup* (Dùn ìseal). Fionnlagh Dall, Keeper after Gormshuil, has the old keepers' stone cup re-cut in grey stone to hold exactly what a cupped pair of hands will hold, and sets it on the threshold of Talla na Lasrach at Dùn ìseal as the measure. A blind man, he fills it by touch before the council, and nobody afterward can say he favoured anyone's hands.
- 13 AN LÙNASTAL 2857 BDE** — *The Small-Burning Law*. A custom hardens into formal rule: no household may burn more than a measured handful of the ore in a season. It becomes the sacred law of the Keepers of Brìde's flame and Crom's stone, and it holds for centuries.

- I AN CÈITEAN 2854 BDE** — *The first sentence under the Law* (Seann Tarr). A household at Seann Tarr is found to have burned twice its measure in a season and loses its right to the ore for the season after. It is the first sentence under the Small-Burning Law in the record. The household's name is kept on the roll and its offence beside it, and its descendants petitioned for many centuries to have the offence struck out.
- 30 AN CÈITEAN 2851 BDE** — *No ore on the beacons* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The Keepers rule that no ore may feed a beacon, since a beacon burns for strangers. The fire on the headland at Tobar dhearg is kept with driftwood and seal fat, and so are all the island's sea-lights after it.
- 4 AM MÀRT 2848 BDE** — *The carriers' path to Ceann chaol* (Ceann chaol). A carriers' path is cut from the mountain down to the harbour of Ceann chaol, with steps hewn at the steep places. Along it the Hall's baskets go to the southern households and the south's dried fish comes back up.
- 3 AN GEARRAN 2845 BDE** — *The carriers drowned on the Abhainn dhombhain* (Abhainn dhomhain). Eleven carriers and their baskets are lost at a ford of the Abhainn dhomhain when the river rises in the night. The Hall mourns the ore as well as the carriers, and Fionnlagh Dall asks the council for a way across that the river cannot take.
- 5 AM FAOILLEACH 2842 BDE** — *The first bridges* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). Stone crossings begin linking the interior mining paths to the coast — ancestors of what will later be Drochaid Cathair dhearg and Drochaid Ros fhionn.
- 7 AN DÙBHLACHD 2839 BDE** — *Ailean Clachair's crossing at Ros fhionn* (Drochaid Ros fhionn). Ailean Clachair and forty masons of the nine hearths bridge the river above Ros fhionn with a single span of fitted stone, the ancestor of Drochaid Ros fhionn. Ailean sets a hearth-sign in the keystone. Every bridge the masons build after this carries one, and a bridge without one is not trusted.
- 8 AN T-SAMHAIN 2836 BDE** — *The masons' custom* (Ros dhomhain). The bridge-masons form a fellowship with its own oath, sworn on the stone cup at Dùn ìseal: no span to be closed in the dark, none to be paid for in ore. Its lodge is kept near the western crossing in the country of Ros dhomhain.
- 10 AN DÀMHAIR 2833 BDE** — *The tavern roads begin* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). The first waypoint houses appear along the mining roads — ancestors of Am Buabhall Fortanach, An Taigh-òsta Grianach, and the rest of the circuit.
- 11 AN T-SULTAIN 2830 BDE** — *Mòr nic Dhùghaill's house* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). The first keeper of the waypoint house that will become Am Buabhall Fortanach is Mòr nic Dhùghaill, a widow of Doire shean. She serves carriers juggled buffalo from her own herd, a dish the house has never stopped serving.
- 13 AN LÙNASTAL 2827 BDE** — *The house at the middle of the road* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). A second waypoint house is built where the carriers' road from the mountain meets the road to the western harbours, on the site of An Taigh-seinnse Mòr. It is a turf longhouse with a hearth at each end, one for carriers going up and one for carriers coming down.

- 22 AN DÀMHAIR 2824 BDE** — *The road-peace* (An Sligeanach Fad' às). The keepers of the waypoint houses agree that no feud may be pursued under an inn roof or within a spear's throw of its door. The custom is first recorded at the house on the site of An Sligeanach Fad' às. It is the oldest law on the island that no Keeper made.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 2821 BDE** — *Seann Mhorn resettled* (Seann Mhorn). Fishers of the nine hearths settle the harbour at Seann Mhorn and keep the name they found there, which is not in their own tongue. They say the old name came with the stones. It is the first such name the record shows being taken over rather than replaced.
- 20 AN DÀMHAIR 2818 BDE** — *Seann Warr resettled* (Seann Warr). On the western shore of Loch chrom, the harbour called Seann Warr is resettled in the same way, by families walking the new road from the mountain. They find house-footings there already and build on them, as the carriers' song has it, without asking whose.
- 23 AN LÙNASTAL 2815 BDE** — *Death of Fionnlagh Dall* (Dùn ìseal). Fionnlagh Dall dies at Dùn ìseal. By his own asking he is not laid on the slope with the Keepers before him but carried south to the old graves near Cnoc dhìreach, which no living people had yet claimed.
- 18 AN T-SAMHAIN 2815 BDE** — *Fionnlagh Dall carried to the old graves* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). The bearers take eleven days over the road with Fionnlagh Dall's body and lay it among graves older than any name at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach. The Keepers who follow him cannot agree why he asked it, and the record gives two answers without choosing.
- 21 AN T-SULTAIN 2810 BDE** — *The mausoleum consecrated*. Tuam Cnoc dhìreach, already ancient, receives its first formally recorded burial — an unclaimed necropolis becoming a claimed one.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2805 BDE** — *The grave-keepers of Cnoc dhìreach* (Cnoc dhìreach). A few families settle at Cnoc dhìreach to tend Tuam Cnoc dhìreach after the Keeper's burial there. They are paid in ore by the Hall, one handful each a season, the only payment in ore the Law ever allowed.
- 25 AN T-IUCHAR 2618 BDE** — *Eilidh nic Ìomhair keeps the flame* (Dùn ìseal). For the first time the nine hearths choose a Keeper outside the house of Muireach: Eilidh nic Ìomhair, of Dùn dhearg. Sliochd Mhuirich accepts it at Dùn ìseal after a season of refusal, on condition that the stone cup never leaves Talla na Lasrach.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 2614 BDE** — *The Four Houses sworn* (Dùn ìseal). Under Eilidh nic Ìomhair the Keepers' office is bound to four custodian houses: Sliochd Mhuirich of Dùn ìseal, Sliochd Ìomhair of Dùn dhearg, Sliochd Thormoid of Seann Dunn and Sliochd Raghnaill of Seann Tarr. The other hearths keep their seats on the council but not their claim to the flame. Most of the island's later nobility descends, or says it does, from one of the four.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 2610 BDE** — *The house of Tormod at Seann Dunn* (Seann Dunn). Sliochd Thormoid raises a hall and a shrine at Seann Dunn, facing the mountain across the river. The shrine keeps a lamp of ore burning at the Law's measure, and the other houses complain that Seann Dunn's measure is always fullest.

- 2 AM MÀRT 2606 BDE** — *The house of Raghnaill at Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). Sliochd Raghnaill takes Seann Tarr on the north-eastern coast for its seat, the same town whose household was the first sentenced under the Law. The house keeps boats rather than galleries and grows rich on the fishing.
- 31 AM MÀRT 2602 BDE** — *Round Eilean dhubh* (Eilean dhubh). Boats of Sliochd Raghnaill sail round Eilean dhubh and come home, the first voyage in the record undertaken to see a coast rather than to fish it. The steersman is named in the house's songs as Tormod Ruadh. He brings back no report beyond rock, birds and the fact of having gone.
- 26 AN T-SULTAIN 2598 BDE** — *The outlaws of the north-west waters* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Households stripped of their right under the Law for a third offence begin to take to boats and live off the north-western waters, raiding the fishing strands. They are called spùinneadairean, plunderers, and the name stays with those waters after them.
- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 2594 BDE** — *The boat lost off the north-west* (Uilebheist na Mara). A fishing boat out of Baile chrom is lost in calm water off the north-western coast, and the two men who swam home say something rose under it. The boat's village keeps a wake for it each year thereafter. Nothing further is recorded of the thing they saw.
- 23 AN T-SAMHAIN 2590 BDE** — *The fire at Baile chrom relit* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). The fishers of Baile chrom relight the old beacon on the point after the loss, fed with driftwood as the Law requires. It is the ancestor of Taigh-solais Baile chrom.
- 25 AN DÀMHAIR 2586 BDE** — *Seann Bhrenn resettled* (Seann Bhrenn). On the northern coast the harbour of Seann Bhrenn is resettled by fishers from the mountain's north side, who keep its old name as the western settlers had kept Seann Warr's. They find a stone quay under the silt and use it.
- 20 AM FAOILLEACH 2582 BDE** — *The ancestor-cairn at Cathair naomh* (Cathair naomh). The people of Cathair naomh in the north raise a cairn for their dead on the hill above the town and bring it a stone at every burial. It is the largest ancestor-cairn in the north, and it is still growing.
- 22 AN DÙBHLACHD 2578 BDE** — *The panthers let pass* (Imrich nam Pantar). The great cats' crossing of the mountains is found to run straight over the carriers' southern road. Eilidh nic Ìomhair rules that no panther may be killed on the road in its season, and the carriers wait in the waypoint houses until the crossing is done. The rule is kept because it costs the carriers only time.
- 19 AM MÀRT 2565 BDE** — *The granaries of Dùn dhearg* (Dùn dhearg). Sliochd Ìomhair builds stone granaries at Dùn dhearg and fills them from the lowland fields, holding grain against the storm season as the old unwritten custom of sharing asks. The granaries give the house the thing the Hall never had: people who owe it food.
- 18 AN GEARRAN 2551 BDE** — *Baile Mòr dhomhain at the foot of the pass* (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Carriers who take the Hall's baskets north over the high pass settle at its southern foot, where Baile Mòr dhomhain now stands, to rest their beasts before the climb. The town lives by the pass and by little else.

- 16 AN CÈITEAN 2538 BDE** — *The reverent centuries*. Generation after generation mines the same modest quantity, burns the same modest quantity, and nothing about the population changes. This is the last age in which that remains true.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 2524 BDE** — *Coinneach Mòr mac Tormoid keeps the flame* (Seann Dunn). The first Keeper of Sliochd Thormoid is Coinneach Mòr mac Tormoid of Seann Dunn. He is remembered for keeping the flame longer than any Keeper before him and changing nothing while he did.
- 5 AN T-SULTAIN 2511 BDE** — *The shepherds of Achadh chaol* (Achadh chaol). Shepherds settle the upland fields at Achadh chaol in the north-east and send their wool down to the harbours. Their headman sits on the council at Dùn ìseal for a single season, is found to hold no hearth-right, and goes home.
- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 2497 BDE** — *The Keepers' count of the old places* (Làrach an Dùin-fhaire). Coinneach Mòr sends walkers to list the ruins of the old people, and they return with Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, Làrach an Dùin, Làrach an Teampaill and the standing stones. The list says who does not own each place. It does not say who built them, and the Keepers ruled that it should not guess.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 2484 BDE** — *The fence round Carragh Cnoc bheag* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). The people of Cnoc bheag set a ring of stakes round the old obelisk above their town so that cattle will not rub against it. The ring is renewed by every generation afterward; the stone is never moved.
- 1 AN DÙBHLACHD 2470 BDE** — *The bath-house at Muileann ruadh* (Muileann ruadh). A roofed bath-house is built over the warm springs below Muileann ruadh, with sleeping-places for the sick and their carriers. The Hall appoints a keeper of the springs, the first office it creates that has nothing to do with the ore. The keeper tends the springs in the name of Dian Cècht, the healer.
- 30 AN DÙBHLACHD 2457 BDE** — *The silver weights of Muileann chiar* (Muileann chiar). The silversmiths of Muileann chiar cast a set of weights, the smallest the weight of a barley-corn and the largest of a newborn lamb, and every trader on the carriers' roads comes to use them. For the rest of the age a thing weighed at Muileann chiar is said to be weighed fairly.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 2443 BDE** — *The market under the Hall* (Dùn ìseal). A market is held under the walls of the Hall at Dùn ìseal on the four quarter days, Samhain, Là Fhèill Brìde, Bealltainn and Lùnastal, when the households of the eastern hills come up with their dues. Hides, venison, charcoal, honey and the silver of Muileann chiar change hands there, weighed on the new weights. The Keepers allow no ore to be sold on their ground, and none is.
- 28 AM FAOILLEACH 2434 BDE** — *The stag's people at Cnoc bhàn* (Cnoc bhàn). A house of the stag's people is founded at Cnoc bhàn, north of the mountain, and takes cutters again after the long exclusion. Its teachers keep Sileas nic Coinnich's question in the form she left it: why does the ore bleed for one hand and not another.

- 26 AN GEARRAN 2425 BDE** — *Seonaid Chiar reopens the galleries to the stag's people* (Dùn ìseal). Seonaid Chiar, Keeper of the house of Muireach, lets cutters trained by the stag's people back into the galleries at Dùn ìseal, on oath to ask nothing of the vein aloud. The Hall's record calls it a reconciliation. The school's own memory calls it a truce.
- 27 AM MÀRT 2420 BDE** — *Cathair mhòr walled* (Cathair mhòr). The people of Cathair mhòr on the southern coast build a wall of fitted stone around their headland town, the first town wall in the record. Nobody in the record says what they feared.
- 16 AM FAOILLEACH 2415 BDE** — *Ceann leathan's fish-market* (Ceann leathan). Ceann leathan becomes the market for the southern fishing, trading dried fish inland along the carriers' paths. Its harbour-master keeps tallies on notched sticks, and several sticks survive in the collection at Muileann chaol, the oldest counted objects there.
- 14 AN GEARRAN 2410 BDE** — *The shrine at Inis thais* (Inis thais). A shrine is raised at Inis thais on the western coast to the ancestors lost at sea. Its keepers burn their season's handful of ore on the shore rather than indoors, so that the drowned, gone west over the sea, can see it.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 2405 BDE** — *Cuan shean's salt-pans* (Cuan shean). The people of Cuan shean on the western coast dig salt-pans on the flats below the town and boil sea-water over peat. Their salt goes inland along the western road and preserves the fish of half the island.
- 31 AM MÀRT 2400 BDE** — *Baile fhiadhaich on the western heath* (Baile fhiadhaich). Baile fhiadhaich is founded on the western heath by salt-carriers from Cuan shean, on a stream that runs all summer. The heath round it is not worth ploughing, and its people keep goats.
- 2 AM MÀRT 2395 BDE** — *The sunny house* (An Taigh-òsta Grianach). A waypoint house is built on the eastern road where carriers from Cnoc leathan meet the southern coast path, on the site of An Taigh-òsta Grianach. It faces south and is known from the first for its warmth, which is the only thing its name has ever meant.
- 1 AN GEARRAN 2390 BDE** — *Cnoc leathan's market* (Cnoc leathan). Cnoc leathan, at the eastern end of the road past the sunny house, becomes the market town of the south-eastern hills. Its carriers' guild holds the right to carry for the Hall on the stretch down to the coast.
- 23 AN LÙNASTAL 2385 BDE** — *The fall in the high gallery* (Dùn ìseal). A roof falls in the highest gallery at Dùn ìseal and kills four cutters. The gallery is walled up and left. Seonaid Chiar orders props of oak in every gallery afterward, the first time the Hall spends timber on the mountain.
- 25 AN T-IUCHAR 2365 BDE** — *Cathair dhombain founded* (Cathair dhomhain). Carriers who had settled at the mouth of the western road raise a town on the rise above the harbour and call it Cathair dhomhain. Its shrine keeps the Law's measure strictly and its people are proud of it.

- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2345 BDE** — *A fishing town at Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhearg). The Red Hill's old settlement, shrunk to a small fishing town, grows again at the western bridge-foot on the Abhainn dhomhain, a little above its meeting with the Abhainn gheal below Loch chrom, on the ground later called Cathair dhearg. Its red stone gives it its name. At this time it is a place carriers pass through on their way to somewhere else.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 2325 BDE** — *Goraidh mac Ìomhair called rìgh* (Dùn dhearg). At Dùn dhearg the lowland households who eat from the granaries of Sliochd Ìomhair begin to call its head, Goraidh mac Ìomhair, their rìgh, their king. He is the first person in any record so called. Goraidh claims nothing over the vein and is careful to say so to the Hall.
- 9 AN T-SULTAIN 2305 BDE** — *The division of keeping* (Dùn ìseal). The council at Dùn ìseal and Goraidh mac Ìomhair agree on a division: the Keeper keeps the flame and the galleries, and the rìgh keeps the roads, the granaries and the peace of the lowlands. The rìgh may not enter the galleries; the Keeper may not raise spears. The division is the frame of Rodian government for the rest of the age.
- 11 AN LÙNASTAL 2285 BDE** — *Goraidh Mòr's hall* (Dùn dhearg). Goraidh mac Ìomhair, called Goraidh Mòr, builds a timber hall on the hill at Dùn dhearg with a granary at each corner. Its post-holes were still visible when the Library's surveyors walked the hill, and were measured and drawn then.
- 22 AN T-SULTAIN 2280 BDE** — *The first road-toll* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). Goraidh Mòr sets a toll on the carriers' roads, one fish in twenty or its worth, to pay for the road-guards and the upkeep of the bridges. The keepers of the waypoint houses collect it. They also keep a share of it, and the record says so.
- 21 AN DÀMHAIR 2245 BDE** — *Mòrag of the Roads* (Dùn dhearg). Goraidh Mòr's daughter Mòrag nic Ghoraidh takes the hall at Dùn dhearg after him. She is remembered as Mòrag nan Rathad, Mòrag of the Roads, for walking every carriers' road on the island in her first years and ordering the bad stretches remade.
- 26 AN T-IUCHAR 2218 BDE** — *The golden house* (An Taigh-seinnse Òir). Mòrag nan Rathad has a waypoint house built on the road north of Seann Dunn, on the site of An Taigh-seinnse Òir, to shorten the carriers' stage from the coast to the mountain. It is the first waypoint house raised by a ruler rather than a family.
- 24 AN LÙNASTAL 2205 BDE** — *The bridge-foot rebuilt* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). The western crossing of the Abhainn dhomhain is rebuilt in wider stone at Mòrag nan Rathad's order, so that two laden carriers can pass on it. The hearth-sign in its keystone is Ailean Clachair's, recut. From this rebuilding the town at the bridge-foot begins to grow.
- 16 AM FAOILLEACH 2165 BDE** — *Dòmhnall Crùbach* (Dùn dhearg). Dòmhnall Crùbach, Dòmhnall the Lamè, follows his mother Mòrag at Dùn dhearg. He cannot walk the roads as she did, and he governs through the keepers of the waypoint houses, who grow powerful in his reign.

- 14 AN GEARRAN 2136 BDE** — *The waypoint-keepers of Ceann mhin* (Ceann mhin). The keepers of the waypoint houses round the harbour town of Ceann mhin take the collection of the road-toll into their own hands in Dòmhnall Crùbach's reign and pay the rìgh what they judge fair. Their judgment is generous to themselves, and the rolls record the sums.
- 19 AN T-SAMHAIN 2120 BDE** — *Baile àrsaidh on the western beath* (Baile àrsaidh). Settlers from Cathair dhomhain take the wet heath of the west coast and found Baile àrsaidh there, where the soil is thin and the yellow scorpions are thick. They swear their oaths on a scorpion's sting kept in a box, and neighbours find the custom strange.
- 18 AN DÙBHLACHD 2120 BDE** — *The storm at Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). A storm drives the sea over the harbour at Seann Chwen and takes the boats and a third of the houses. The Keeper sends the Hall's grain from Dùn ìseal, and Dòmhnall Crùbach sends his from Dùn dhearg. The survivors remember that the Hall's came first.
- 15 AM MÀRT 2085 BDE** — *The stag-letters* (Muileann chiar). At Muileann chiar in the far east, the teachers of the stag's people turn the cutters' tally-notches into signs for sounds, so that a teaching can be kept without a teacher. These are the first letters on Rodos in use by the Ròdaich: the ogham, which the druids call the gift of Ogma. Nearly every later hand on the island descends from them.
- 12 AN CÈITEAN 2085 BDE** — *The letters set against the obelisk* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). Stag-scholars carry their new letters to Carragh Cnoc bheag and compare them with the marks on the obelisk. They match nothing. The scholars write down that the stone's writers were not their teachers, the first thing the Ròdaich ever put in writing about the old people.
- 10 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2085 BDE** — *Sileas Dhonn* (Dùn dhearg). Sileas Dhonn, Dòmhnall Crùbach's niece, holds Dùn dhearg after him. In her reign the keepers of the waypoint houses are made to render account of the tolls at her hall once a year, and several of them do.
- 14 AN GEARRAN 2008 BDE** — *The lords of Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). The harbour town of Caol leathan in the south-west grows rich on the western fishing and the southern end of the carriers' road. Its leading family, headed by Lachlann Ciar, begins to take the road-toll for itself and send none of it to Dùn dhearg.
- 12 AN CÈITEAN 2005 BDE** — *Iain Garbh* (Dùn dhearg). Iain Garbh, Iain the Rough, son of Sileas Dhonn, takes the hall at Dùn dhearg and demands the western tolls from Caol leathan. Lachlann Ciar sends back a basket of fish-bones.
- 13 AN GIBLEAN 2000 BDE** — *The War of the Roads begins at Muileann òg* (Muileann òg). Iain Garbh marches west with the road-guards and the lowland levies, and his men burn the toll-house at Muileann òg that Lachlann Ciar's people had taken. It is the first war in the record between Ròdaich and Ròdaich. The Hall refuses to bless either side.
- 19 AN T-SAMHAIN 1999 BDE** — *Uisdean mac Ruairidh's refusal* (Dùn ìseal). The Keeper Uisdean mac Ruairidh refuses Iain Garbh's messengers at Dùn ìseal the Hall's handful for the warband's hearths, saying the flame does not warm men who are going to kill. The warband winters on peat. Iain Garbh never forgives the Hall, and never enters it.

- 21 AN DÀMHAIR 1998 BDE** — *The fight at Àth fhiadhaich* (Àth fhiadhaich). The men of Caol leathan meet Iain Garbh's levies at the ford of Àth fhiadhaich and hold it for a day before giving way. Forty are dead on both sides. The ford is called by the carriers for a long time afterward the ford of the forty.
- 16 AM FAOILLEACH 1997 BDE** — *Baile ghlas burned* (Baile ghlas). Retreating toward Caol leathan, Lachlann Ciar's men burn Baile ghlas so that Iain Garbh's levies will find no grain. The town's people walk to Cathair dhomhain and many never return.
- 18 AN DÙBHLACHD 1996 BDE** — *Baile chiar holds* (Baile chiar). Baile chiar, south of the western bridge-foot, shuts its gate against both armies in the War of the Roads and feeds the burned-out people of Baile ghlas through the winter. Neither side forgives it, and neither side attacks it.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 1994 BDE** — *The siege of Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). Iain Garbh closes Caol leathan from the land for a season, but its boats bring in fish from the sea and he cannot close the harbour. His levies begin to go home for the harvest. The siege ends without an assault.
- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 1993 BDE** — *The peace at Mòr nic Dhùghaill's house* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). Iain Garbh and Lachlann Ciar meet under the roof of the waypoint house that will become Am Buabhall Fortanach, where by the road-peace neither may draw. Caol leathan keeps half its tolls and sends half to Dùn dhearg, and Lachlann Ciar swears to the Law before the Keeper's witness. The War of the Roads ends in a house built to feed carriers.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 1990 BDE** — *The wolf-sworn of Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). Men who fought for Caol leathan become its road-guards and swear their watch on a white stone carved as a wolf, which they keep at the town gate. They call themselves the wolf-sworn. Later ages will read more into the stone than they did, and call it Lia Fàil.
- 14 AN DÙBHLACHD 1963 BDE** — *Caol fhiadhaich rebuilt* (Caol fhiadhaich). Caol fhiadhaich, on the south-western shore, which had sent its boats to feed Caol leathan through the siege, is given a share of the western tolls by Lachlann Ciar in thanks. The town builds a harbour wall with it.
- 15 AN T-SAMHAIN 1955 BDE** — *Death of Iain Garbh* (Dùn dhearg). Iain Garbh dies at Dùn dhearg. His daughter Catriona has him buried in the hall's floor and not on the slope at Dùn ìseal, and the Hall does not ask for him.
- 17 AN DÀMHAIR 1953 BDE** — *Catriona Ghlic* (Dùn dhearg). Catriona Ghlic, Catriona the Wise, rules from Dùn dhearg and sends her own son to sit with the flame for a season, the first child of the royal house to do so since the division of keeping. The Hall and the hall are on speaking terms again by the end of her reign.
- 8 AN CÈITEAN 1918 BDE** — *The house on the northern road* (An Leòmhann Buidhe). Catriona Ghlic has a waypoint house built on the northern road above Inis mhòr, on the site of An Leòmhann Buidhe. It serves the carriers who take the Hall's baskets to the northern households and bring back wool.

- 9 AN GIBLEAN 1914 BDE** — *The house on the cold road* (An Taigh-seinnse Reòta). A stone house is built on the open moor on the road between Baile Mòr dhomhain and the northern coast, on the site of An Taigh-seinnse Reòta, for carriers caught by snow. Its keepers are paid by the Hall in grain and by the crown in cloth, and complain of both.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1910 BDE** — *Inis mhòr grows* (Inis mhòr). The river port at Inis mhòr in the north becomes the gathering place of the northern wool trade and outgrows every other northern town. Its people petition Catriona Ghlic for a road-guard of their own, and are given one.
- 22 AN T-SAMHAIN 1877 BDE** — *The market at the fords of Baile Mòr dhomhain* (Baile Mòr dhomhain). The lords of the deep river set a market at Baile Mòr dhomhain, where the carriers' road from the south meets the paths down from the hill pastures. Cattle, sheep, horses, hides and the white stone of the hills are sold at the fords on the day after each new moon, and the lords take one fleece in forty from the sellers.
- 10 AN GEARRAN 1833 BDE** — *Muileann shean on the northern road* (Muileann shean). A mill is built at Muileann shean, on the northern road, to grind the grain the carriers bring over the pass, and a town grows round it. The miller is paid by the Hall in grain, and pays the rìgh's toll in flour.
- 1 AN T-SULTAIN 1788 BDE** — *The unrecorded rulers* (Dùn dhearg). Between Catriona Ghlic and Ealasaid Chiar, the later king-list sets eleven names at Dùn dhearg, of which nothing is known but the names and the order. The Keepers' roll for the same years gives five Keepers, and their names also are all it gives.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 1744 BDE** — *Tormod Scriobhaiche learns the letters* (Muileann chiar). Tormod mac Iain, a younger son of the house of Tormod, is sent east to Muileann chiar to learn the stag-letters. He is the first of the royal kin to read, and is called Tormod Scriobhaiche, Tormod the Writer, for the rest of his life.
- 22 AN T-IUCHAR 1700 BDE** — *Ealasaid Chiar* (Dùn dhearg). Ealasaid Chiar takes the hall at Dùn dhearg and brings Tormod Scriobhaiche there as her clerk. She orders him to set down the names of every ruler of the hall that the reciters can give him, in order.
- 20 AN LÙNASTAL 1700 BDE** — *The first written king-list*. Rulers begin to be recorded by name rather than remembered by story — a shift the later succession records will inherit directly.
- 18 AN T-SULTAIN 1699 BDE** — *The contents of Tormod's roll* (Dùn dhearg). Tormod Scriobhaiche's roll, kept in the hall at Dùn dhearg, begins with Goraidh Mòr and runs to Ealasaid Chiar. Its earliest names come from the reciters and the later ones from living memory, and he marks which are which. The roll disagrees with the Keepers' recited roll in three places, and Tormod writes down both readings without choosing.
- 17 AN DÀMHAIR 1679 BDE** — *The Keepers' roll written down* (Dùn ìseal). Shamed, in the Hall's own words, by the rìgh's clerk, the Keepers have their recited roll set down in stag-letters at Dùn ìseal. Its first name is Beathag Bhàn, and it is longer than Tormod's by several centuries.

- 15 AN T-SAMHAIN 1430 BDE** — *The watchers of the dark wood* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). A small company settles on the edge of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, the wood nobody had ever cleared, and keeps watch there for a black horned beast they say walks in it. The people of Cathair dhearg call them the wood-watchers. None of the watchers' own accounts are older than Òrd Mhacha, the order of Macha that later claims them and takes the beast for a sign of Dubh Sainglenn, the black horse.
- 14 AN DÙBHLACHD 1423 BDE** — *The wood-watchers in the stag's grove* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). Wood-watchers come east and cut a black-barked tree in Coille Naomh Muileann chiar, saying the beast had shown it to them. The stag's people call it theft from a teaching-place. Both sides send to Dùn dhearg and to Dùn ìseal.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 1418 BDE** — *The stag's people claim the dark wood* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). In answer, the stag's people send teachers west to hold their lessons in Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, saying the first stag had come from there. Each side now claims both woods, and in each wood the two companies meet and do not speak.
- 10 AN GEARRAN 1410 BDE** — *The holy-wood dispute*. The first recorded conflict between rival religious claims to Coille Naomh Muileann chiar and Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag — settled by dividing custody rather than choosing a winner.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1404 BDE** — *The boundary stones of the woods* (Dùn dhearg). The division of the woods is made at Dùn dhearg before Fearchar Òg, right after Ealasaid Chiar, and the Keeper Calum Liath: the stag's people keep the eastern wood and the wood-watchers the western, and each may walk in the other's wood unarmed and without cutting. Boundary stones are set at both woods' edges with the terms cut on them in stag-letters. Two of the eastern stones survive.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 1397 BDE** — *Calum Liath's surveyors* (Dùn ìseal). The Keeper Calum Liath sends cutters with knotted cords and lamps into every gallery at Dùn ìseal to follow the vein as far as it can be followed and mark how it thickens and thins. The work takes the cutters out of the ore-season for three seasons, and the households go short to pay for it.
- 27 AN T-SAMHAIN 1392 BDE** — *The measuring of the vein*. The first attempt to estimate how much obsidian the mountain holds. The estimate will prove wildly optimistic.
- 26 AN DÙBHLACHD 1392 BDE** — *The reckoning of the cords* (Dùn ìseal). Calum Liath's reckoning, cut on a slab in the Hall at Dùn ìseal, holds that the mountain can give every household its handful for more generations than there are grains in the granaries of Dùn dhearg. It was read out at the council and received in silence, which the Hall took for assent.
- 22 AN GEARRAN 1378 BDE** — *The deaths in the lower gallery* (Dùn ìseal). Two youths of the nine hearths, sent into the lower gallery at Dùn ìseal without a Keeper's cutter to guide them, break the wrong face and are crushed. They had been in the galleries less than a season. Their families ask the council what the Hall owes them, and the council has no answer.
- 24 AM FAOILLEACH 1371 BDE** — *The apprentice-binding custom*. Young Rodians are first formally bound to a master custodian of the vein for seven years before being trusted near the ore themselves — the origin of every later mining guild's structure.

- 21 AN GIBLEAN 1365 BDE** — *Oighrig Bhàn's first bound* (Dùn iséal). Oighrig Bhàn, Keeper after Calum Liath, binds the first twelve apprentices under the new custom at Dùn iséal, each to a master cutter by name. They swear on the stone cup to serve seven years before touching the vein. Four of the twelve are later Keepers, which is the custom's best argument for itself.
- 23 AM MÀRT 1358 BDE** — *The stag's people take apprentices* (Cnoc bhàn). The house of the stag's people at Cnoc bhàn adopts the seven years for its own cutters and adds a teaching to it: an apprentice keeps a written account of every strike, and the account is read. These strike-books are the school's chief record for the rest of the age.
- 18 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1352 BDE** — *The long reign of Fearchar Òg* (Dùn dhearg). Fearchar Òg, who made the division of the woods, rules long at Dùn dhearg and is remembered for nothing so much as for dying old. The list gives him a byname, Òg, the young, from his accession as a boy, and it stuck.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 1345 BDE** — *The silver tokens* (Muileann chiar). Fearchar Òg's clerks begin paying the road-guards in small silver rings of Muileann chiar weight, stamped with the hall's mark. It is the first time a ruler on Rodos pays in metal. The rings travel further than the guards do.
- 8 AN CÈITEAN 1338 BDE** — *The toll-house at Àth ghlas* (Àth ghlas). A toll-house is built on the ford at Àth ghlas, where the southern road crosses the river toward Ceann leathan, and the road-guards are paid there in the new silver rings. It is the first toll-house on the island with a keeper sent from the rìgh's hall rather than chosen locally.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 1334 BDE** — *The road-guards' games at Ceann leathan* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). The road-guards of the south begin meeting at Ceann leathan each year to fight with blunted staves for a silver ring. The meeting outlives its purpose; the field it used is the one where Còmhrag Ceann leathan is later fought. The first winner the record names is a woman, Mòrag Dhubh of Cnoc mhòr.
- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 1334 BDE** — *The fair at Muileann òg* (Fèill Muileann òg). Muileann òg, burned in the War of the Roads, is rebuilt as a market town, and a fair is held there each harvest at Lùnastal for the western and southern roads to trade. The fair is the ancestor of Fèill Muileann òg.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 1334 BDE** — *The landing on the Abhainn uaine* (Cidhe Beag). A landing for river-boats is built on the Abhainn uaine at the place since called Cidhe Beag, so that grain from the lowlands can go upriver in boats rather than on carriers' backs. The carriers of the eastern road protest to Fearchar Òg and lose.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1314 BDE** — *The river-boats* (Abhainn uaine). Flat river-boats of hide over withy begin to carry grain and salt fish up the Abhainn uaine from the landing at Cidhe Beag. Boatmen become a fellowship of their own, with an oath sworn on a paddle, and they compete with the carriers for the Hall's baskets.

- 8 AN CÈITEAN 1314 BDE** — *The boatmen of Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). Muileann chrom, up the valley from the landing at Cidhe Beag, becomes the home of the river-boatmen and their fellowship. Its boatyards build the flat hide boats for every river on the island.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1314 BDE** — *Beathag Mhòr* (Dùn dhearg). Beathag Mhòr, great-granddaughter of Fearchar Òg, takes the hall at Dùn dhearg. She is the first ruler the list calls ban-rìgh, queen, rather than rìgh with a woman's name after it, and the change of word is the list's own.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 1300 BDE** — *The fleece-measure of Baile Mòr fhionn* (Baile Mòr fhionn). The lords of the western plain hold a market at Baile Mòr fhionn and make the fleece of a grown ewe its measure. Grain, wine, cattle and the horses of the plain are all priced in fleeces. The silver rings of Muileann chiar are taken there too, but reckoned in wool.
- 10 AN GEARRAN 1300 BDE** — *The hall moves to Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhearg). Beathag Mhòr moves her hall from Dùn dhearg to the town at the western bridge-foot, Cathair dhearg, so as to sit where the roads, the river and the western harbours meet. Dùn dhearg keeps the old granaries and the house of Ìomhar's graves. Cathair dhearg is the seat of rule on Rodos from this reign onward, whatever else changes.
- 22 AN GEARRAN 1300 BDE** — *Dùn dhearg after the move* (Dùn dhearg). Dùn dhearg, left behind, keeps its granaries and its pride. Its people go on calling it the rìgh's hill, and for many generations its reeves refuse to send their accounts to Cathair dhearg in any hand but their own.
- 23 AM MÀRT 1300 BDE** — *The red hall* (Cathair dhearg). Beathag Mhòr's hall at Cathair dhearg is built of the red stone that gives the town its name, on the rise above the harbour. Its foundations lie under the later citadel. The masons cut the hearth-sign into its lintel as if it were a bridge.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 1300 BDE** — *Cathair dhombain against Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhomhain). The harbour of Cathair dhomhain, older and larger, resents the new seat on its doorstep and refuses the queen's toll on its boats. Beathag Mhòr grants it a charter of its own tolls, and the two towns, a few miles apart, are rivals for the rest of the age.
- 22 AN T-IUCHAR 1300 BDE** — *Disputed hands* (Dùn ìseal). The council at Dùn ìseal is asked to judge more disputes over which households hold a right to the handful than over anything else: new households, divided households, households that claim descent from one of the nine hearths without proof. Oighrig Bhàn's successor as Keeper, Dùghall mac Raghnaill, asks the queen for a counting.
- 11 AM FAOILLEACH 1264 BDE** — *Beathag Mhòr orders the count* (Cathair dhearg). Beathag Mhòr and Dùghall mac Raghnaill agree that every household on the island claiming the handful shall be counted, its right proved or refused, and its name written. The clerks at Cathair dhearg are to write; the Keepers are to judge.

- 9 AN GEARRAN 1264 BDE** — *The waypoint houses as counting-houses* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). The census-takers use the waypoint houses as their stations, since every household on the island is within a day of one. The keepers of the houses feed the counters at the queen's cost. The census is later remembered in the houses as a good year.
- 22 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1264 BDE** — *The census of hands*. The first attempt to count, island-wide, how many households hold a customary right to burn obsidian at all — proof the reverent tradition was already being formally rationed, not simply assumed.
- 21 AN T-IUCHAR 1264 BDE** — *The count of hands* (Cathair dhearg). The census rolls kept at Cathair dhearg give eleven thousand four hundred households holding the right, and some two thousand whose claims were refused. The refused households are written on a separate roll, and it is the separate roll that later generations went looking for when they wished to prove an ancestor's standing.
- 19 AN LÙNASTAL 1264 BDE** — *The refused of Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). Most of the refused households on the north-eastern coast are fisher-families around Seann Tarr who had never burned ore at all and now found they had no right to begin. Sliochd Raghnaill takes up their cause at the council and loses it. The fisher-families burn peat and say it is warmer.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1264 BDE** — *The light at Baile iséal* (Taigh-solais Baile iséal). The old beacon on the eastern point at Baile iséal is rebuilt, kept with driftwood and seal fat as the Law requires, to bring the fishing boats of the eastern coast home in the dark. It is the ancestor of Taigh-solais Baile iséal.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 1264 BDE** — *The light at Muileann bheag* (Taigh-solais Muileann bheag). The old beacon on the northern headland at Muileann bheag is rebuilt, the ancestor of Taigh-solais Muileann bheag. Its keepers are fisher-families of the north-west who pay no toll to Cathair dhearg in return for keeping it.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 1264 BDE** — *The light at Àth dhearg* (Taigh-solais Àth dhearg). The old beacon on the north-eastern cape at Àth dhearg is rebuilt by Sliochd Raghnaill, to mark the passage in toward Seann Tarr. It is the ancestor of Taigh-solais Àth dhearg.
- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 1264 BDE** — *Death of Beathag Mhòr* (Dùn dhearg). Beathag Mhòr dies at Cathair dhearg and, by her own order, is carried back to Dùn dhearg to be buried among the house of Ìomhar. The procession between the two is the longest royal journey in the record to this point.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1263 BDE** — *Ruairidh Liath* (Cathair dhearg). Ruairidh Liath, Beathag Mhòr's son, rules from Cathair dhearg. He is already grey when he takes the hall, and his byname is the list's joke, the only one it makes.
- 19 AN LÙNASTAL 1254 BDE** — *The Silver Feud begins* (Muileann chiar). Ruairidh Liath demands one ring in five of the silver taken at Muileann chiar, saying the tokens that pay his guards should cost him nothing. Sliochd Fhearchair, the silversmiths' house, answers that silver is not holy and so not the crown's either, citing Muireach Liath's ruling. They close the workings rather than pay.

- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1253 BDE** — *The closing of the silver* (Muileann chiar). For three seasons no silver leaves Muileann chiar. The road-guards go unpaid, the fair at Muileann òg trades in grain again, and the carriers' tolls go uncollected on the eastern road. The record calls it the Silver Feud, though no one is killed in it.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 1250 BDE** — *The Keeper's judgment on the silver* (Dùn ìseal). Asked by both parties, the Keeper Dùghall mac Raghnaill rules at Dùn ìseal that Muireach Liath's words stand: silver is not the mountain's. But he rules too that the crown keeps the roads the silver travels on. Ruairidh Liath takes one ring in ten, Sliochd Fhearchair reopens the workings, and both call it a victory.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 1249 BDE** — *The Muileann chiar weight made law* (Muileann chiar). As part of the settlement, the silver weights of Muileann chiar are declared the only lawful weights on the island's roads. Copies in bronze are sent to every waypoint house, and the house of Fearchair is paid for each.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1218 BDE** — *The bronze-casters of Muileann dhearg* (Muileann dhearg). The bronze copies of the Muileann chiar weights are cast at Muileann dhearg, where a family of casters learned the work from the silversmiths. They go on casting bells, pins and lamp-bowls, and their lamp-bowls hold exactly the Law's measure.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1218 BDE** — *Seonag Chrom* (Cathair dhearg). Seonag Chrom, Ruairidh Liath's granddaughter, rules at Cathair dhearg. She has the clerks' office there given a room of its own in the red hall and a stipend in silver, and from her reign the king-list is kept year by year rather than reign by reign.
- 22 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1145 BDE** — *Inis bheag's school of letters* (Inis bheag). At Inis bheag on the Abhainn bheag in the north a teacher of the stag's people begins teaching letters to fishers' children who will never cut ore. It is the first teaching of letters for their own sake. The Hall's roll records it with the remark that fish do not need reading.
- 21 AN T-IÚCHAR 1073 BDE** — *Peigi nic Tormoid, clerk of the hall* (Cathair dhearg). Peigi nic Tormoid, a descendant of Tormod Scriobhaiche, is the first clerk of the hall at Cathair dhearg whose own hand can be told apart from the others in the surviving copies. Her entries are short and she never gives a reason when a fact will do. Much of what is known of the middle of the age is in her hand or copied from it.
- 30 AN DÙBHLACHD 1000 BDE** — *The hawk-keepers of Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). At Seann Skell on the northern coast, fowler families keep a hawk in each household and feed it before the household eats. They burn their season's handful at dawn with the hawk on the wrist, saying that the flame is a hunger and should be fed the way a hunger is fed. They call the hawk Mòd, and say it is the Hawk of Acaill, the grey hawk of time, as old as Fionntan mac Bòchra, the oldest of men, who lived through the ages as a salmon, an eagle and a hawk; between them the two remember everything. Òrd an t-Seabhaig counts its beginning from them.

28 AM FAOILLEACH 927 BDE — *The hawk-rite spreads up the Abhainn ìseal* (Inis ìseal).

The dawn burning with the hawk spreads from Seann Skell on the northern shore up the Abhainn ìseal to Inis ìseal and Cnoc bheag. The Keeper at Dùn ìseal writes that the rite keeps the measure exactly and is therefore no concern of the Hall's. It is the last time the Hall says so about any rite.

1 AM FAOILLEACH 854 BDE — *The sting-oath at Ros bheag* (Ros bheag). The custom of swearing on a scorpion's sting spreads from Baile àrsaidh up the western coast to Ros bheag, where the harbour court adopts it for every oath of trade. A merchant who will not swear on the sting is not trusted in the western harbours for the rest of the age.**3 AN DÙBHLACHD 782 BDE** — *The wolf-stone at Inis thais* (Inis thais). The wolf-sworn road-guards of Caol leathan set a second wolf-stone at the shrine of Inis thais, and the shrine's keepers begin to pray before it as well as to the drowned. The stone is white quartz and was carried from the mountain on a sledge, which cost more than the shrine.**28 AN GEARRAN 709 BDE** — *The strike-books compared* (Cnoc bhàn). A teacher of the stag's people at Cnoc bhàn, Donnchadh mac Iain, reads through generations of apprentices' strike-books and finds that the ore bleeds brighter for cutters in their later years than in their first, whatever house they come from. He argues from it that the vein answers practice. The house's elders answer that the vein answers what a cutter was born with, and that practice only shows it.**30 AM FAOILLEACH 699 BDE** — *Donnchadh mac Iain leaves Cnoc bhàn* (Muileann chaol). Donnchadh mac Iain and twenty-two of his hearers leave the house at Cnoc bhàn and settle at Muileann chaol, taking copies of the strike-books with them. The elders of Cnoc bhàn call it theft of the books. Donnchadh calls it a copying, which it was.**7 AN T-SULTAIN 682 BDE** — *The founding of the rival druid school*. A breakaway school of druids argues the vein answers effort, not birth — a quiet, centuries-early rehearsal of the argument the Long War will eventually be fought over in a very different form.**9 AN LÙNASTAL 669 BDE** — *The school at Muileann chaol* (Muileann chaol). Donnchadh mac Iain's school at Muileann chaol keeps its own strike-books and adds a rule the elder school never had: a cutter's parentage is not written in the book at all. The two schools of the stag argue by letter for the rest of the age, and the letters are kept by both.**4 AN T-SAMHAIN 633 BDE** — *The Hall hears the two schools* (Dùn ìseal). The Keeper Raonaid Dhubh hears both schools of the stag at Dùn ìseal and gives no ruling, saying the vein has not asked the Hall to decide. The Hall's roll notes the hearing and the refusal. It was the most-cited refusal in the Hall's history.**6 AN DÀMHAIR 623 BDE** — *What the people of Cnoc ghorm say of their stone* (Calbh Cnoc ghorm). Stag-scholars from Muileann chaol visit Calbh Cnoc ghorm and find they cannot read it. The people of Cnoc ghorm tell them that the stone says: we did not come; we were here. The scholars write that the people say so. Neither the stone nor the saying is explained in any later hand.

- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 613 BDE** — *The digging at Làrach an Dùin* (Làrach an Dùin). Men of Baile ghorm dig under the fallen walls of Làrach an Dùin for the riches the ruin was said to hold. They find ash and nothing else. The Keeper has them sentenced as if they had broken the Law, though no law covered it, and the sentence stands as the rule for all the old places after.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 608 BDE** — *Baile ghorm's penance* (Baile ghorm). The families of the diggers at Baile ghorm pay their penance by keeping the road from their town to Tuam Cnoc dhireach in repair. The road is still called the diggers' road in the southern hills.
- 16 AM FAOILLEACH 593 BDE** — *Lachlann Bàn* (Cathair dhearg). Lachlann Bàn takes the red hall at Cathair dhearg. He is remembered for his granaries, which he builds in every province seat that will take one, and for a law about them.
- 14 AN GEARRAN 588 BDE** — *The shared-meal law written* (Cathair dhearg). Lachlann Bàn and the Keeper Raonaid Dhubh set the old unwritten custom down as law at Cathair dhearg: any household with grain above its winter's need gives the surplus to the common granary of its district before the storm season, and the granary feeds any household of the district that runs short. Peigi nic Tormoid's successors wrote it into the rolls in full. It is the first law in the record made by rìgh and Keeper together.
- 19 AN T-SAMHAIN 574 BDE** — *The granary of Cnoc mhòr* (Cnoc mhòr). Cnoc mhòr builds its common granary under the new law before any other district, and sends word of it to Cathair dhearg. Lachlann Bàn sends back a silver ring for the reeve.
- 18 AN DÙBHLACHD 564 BDE** — *The common granaries of the mountain* (Muileann chiar). Common granaries are raised under the new law in the mountain districts round Muileann chiar, where the households live by cutting and carrying and grow little of their own. The lowland districts grumble at filling them.
- 12 AN CÈITEAN 554 BDE** — *The granary at Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). A common granary is built inside the old wall at Cathair mhòr, the first put behind a town wall. The southern fishing towns send dried fish to it as their share, since they have no grain to send.
- 10 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 544 BDE** — *Raiders in the eastern waters* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Boats of outlaws begin raiding the eastern fishing strands from the islets offshore, taking dried fish and nets. Sliochd Raghnaill arms its boats at Seann Tarr and burns two of the raiders' boats. The rest are not caught.
- 15 AM MÀRT 538 BDE** — *Oighrig nic Lachlainn* (Cathair dhearg). Oighrig nic Lachlainn, Lachlann Bàn's daughter, takes the hall at Cathair dhearg. She has no children. The houses begin to count their claims before her reign is half done.
- 13 AN GIBLEAN 527 BDE** — *The late snow on the high passes* (Cnoc ghlas). The weather-watchers on the cairns above Cnoc ghlas report snow lying on the high passes long past the time the galleries should open. The Hall keeps the galleries shut for the cutters' safety. The mountain households wait.

- 5 AN T-SULTAIN 527 BDE** — *The poor season in the mountain* (Muileann chiar). The galleries open late and close early, and the ore carried down is a third of a common season's. The mountain households of Muileann gheal, Doire uaine and Àth dhìreach, who trade their carrying for grain, have nothing to trade. By the end of the season they are eating their seed.
- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 526 BDE** — *The first recorded famine averted*. A poor mining season nearly starves three settlements before the shared-meal custom, formalized a generation earlier, holds and prevents it — the tradition's first real test.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 526 BDE** — *The granaries opened* (Muileann gheal). Under the shared-meal law the common granaries of the mountain districts are opened at Muileann gheal, and when they run low the granaries of Dùn dhearg and the southern coast send grain up the carriers' roads without being asked twice. The carriers carry it for no fee. No one in the three settlements is recorded as having died of hunger that winter.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 525 BDE** — *Àth dhìreach after the poor season* (Àth dhìreach). At Àth dhìreach, one of the three settlements the granaries fed, the carriers who brought the grain up are given the right to rest in any house of the town without payment for as long as they live. The last of them died old, and the right with him.
- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 525 BDE** — *The reeves of Dùn dhearg send the grain* (Dùn dhearg). The reeves of Dùn dhearg, who had refused Cathair dhearg their accounts for generations, open the old granaries of the house of Ìomhar to the mountain without waiting for an order. Oighrig nic Lachlainn writes that she would have given the order had they waited. Peigi nic Tormoid's successor notes that they did not.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 488 BDE** — *Death of Oighrig nic Lachlainn* (Cathair dhearg). Oighrig nic Lachlainn dies at Cathair dhearg without an heir of her body, and the line of Goraidh Mòr, as the list reckons it, ends with her. The red hall is shut and its clerks keep it.
- 10 AN GIBLEAN 486 BDE** — *The four houses meet* (Dùn ìseal). The Four Houses of custody meet at Dùn ìseal to choose a ruler, since no custom covers a hall without an heir. Sliochd Ìomhair claims it by blood, Sliochd Thormoid by the clerks, Sliochd Raghnaill by its boats. Sliochd Mhuirich, holding the Keeper's office, will not claim at all.
- 12 AM MÀRT 483 BDE** — *The election of Gilleasbuig Mòr* (Seann Dunn). The houses choose Gilleasbuig Mòr mac Tormoid of Seann Dunn, a grandson of the clerks' line, to hold the red hall. The Keeper sets the stone cup in his hands before the council, the first time a ruler is made at Dùn ìseal. Sliochd Ìomhair accepts on condition that its graves at Dùn dhearg remain the kings' burying-place.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 482 BDE** — *Gilleasbuig Mòr at Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhearg). Gilleasbuig Mòr takes the red hall. He keeps the clerks' office in his own house's hands and has the king-list recopied from the beginning, with a line drawn under Oighrig nic Lachlainn. The line is in every later copy.

- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 462 BDE** — *The shrine at Seann Dunn enlarged* (Seann Dunn). Gilleasbuig Mòr enlarges his house's shrine at Seann Dunn into a temple with a court for pilgrims. Its ore-lamp is still said by the other houses to burn fuller than the measure, and a Keeper's cutter is sent to check it every season.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 458 BDE** — *Death of Gilleasbuig Mòr* (Dùn dhearg). Gilleasbuig Mòr dies at Cathair dhearg and is buried among the house of Ìomhar at Dùn dhearg, as agreed. His son Tormod Òg succeeds him without a meeting of the houses, and nobody asks for one.
- 29 AM MÀRT 441 BDE** — *The gap in the list* (Cathair dhearg). Between Tormod Òg and Anna Ruadh the king-list kept at Cathair dhearg gives the names of nine rulers of the house of Tormod with their years and little else. Peigi nic Tormoid's successors were diligent and brief; in these reigns the rolls record mostly harvests, tolls and repairs to bridges.
- 24 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 428 BDE** — *The bridge at Cathair dhearg widened* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). The bridge at Cathair dhearg is rebuilt a third time, wide enough now for a cart, since carts have come onto the lowland roads. The hearth-sign is recut again in the keystone. The span stands on the same piers as Mòrag nan Rathad's.
- 24 AN GIBLEAN 416 BDE** — *Riders on the lowland roads* (Dùn dhearg). The road-guards of Dùn dhearg begin to ride the lowland roads on the small horses of the southern grass country. A guard can now reach a waypoint house before a quarrel there has cooled. They are the first riders the record names, and for a long time the only ones.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 401 BDE** — *The crossing at Ros fhionn repaired* (Drochaid Ros fhionn). Ailean Clachair's span above Ros fhionn is repaired after a flood takes its eastern approach. The masons find their founder's hearth-sign still sharp in the keystone and leave it untouched.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 386 BDE** — *The bridge at Dùn chrom* (Dùn chrom). The masons' fellowship bridges the river below Dùn chrom, joining the southern road to the western one without the long way round by Cathair dhearg. The toll is set at half the road-toll, and Cathair dhearg complains.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 371 BDE** — *The bridge at Ceann àrsaidh* (Ceann àrsaidh). A bridge is built at the river town of Ceann àrsaidh, the fourth stone crossing in the lowlands. The masons' roll lists the names of the forty who built it, all of them of Sliochd Raghnaill's fisher-kin, who had learned the trade because the boats were idle.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 356 BDE** — *The bridge at Doire mhin* (Doire mhin). The masons' fellowship builds a small bridge at Doire mhin to carry the southern road over a stream that floods each spring. The keystone carries the hearth-sign and, beside it, the first mason's mark in the record: the name of Beathag Clachair, who cut it.
- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 341 BDE** — *The far-off house* (An Sligeanach Fad' às). The waypoint house on the site of An Sligeanach Fad' às, the oldest house under the road-peace, is rebuilt in stone. It has become so far from any town that carriers say one is never nearer to it than halfway, and the name comes from the saying.

- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 327 BDE** — *Fire-water on the northern road* (An Leòmhann Buidhe). The house on the northern road on the site of An Leòmhann Buidhe begins serving a spirit distilled from barley that the carriers call fire-water. The Keepers rule it is not a burning and not their concern. The house's trade doubles.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 312 BDE** — *Caol mhòr in the north-west* (Caol mhòr). Fisher-families of the north-west gather at Caol mhòr under a headman of their own and send tolls to Cathair dhearg only in the years the road-guard comes to collect them. The record for the north-west in this age is thin, and most of it is complaints about that.
- 4 AN T-SAMHAIN 297 BDE** — *Seal-oil from Ceann mhòr* (Ceann mhòr). Ceann mhòr on the north-west coast begins trading seal-oil down the western coast to Ros bheag for silver rings, and its beacons burn it. The seal-oil lamps of the western harbours are the brightest light on Rodos for many generations.
- 3 AN DÙBHLACHD 282 BDE** — *The high pastures of Muileann leathan* (Muileann leathan). Herding families take the high pastures above Muileann leathan in the north and keep sheep there for the wool of Inis mhòr. They hold no right to the handful, have never held one, and are not counted in the census of hands.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 267 BDE** — *Inis mhin on the northern shore* (Inis mhin). Inis mhin, a fishing harbour on the northern shore, is recorded in the rolls for the first time, when its headman comes to Inis mhòr's wool-fair to complain about the road-guard's toll. The complaint is written down in full, and is the town's whole record for the age.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 252 BDE** — *The raid on the western strands* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Raiders from the north-western waters take a season's dried fish from the strands of the north-western coast. The sting-sworn merchants of Ros bheag pay for two armed boats to watch the strands, and the raiders move north.
- 29 AM MÀRT 238 BDE** — *The second sighting* (Uilebheist na Mara). Two boats from Baile chrom report something vast moving under them in the north-western water, the second sighting in the record. One boat does not come home. The wake kept in Baile chrom for the first loss is kept for both.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 223 BDE** — *Round the islands* (Seann Tarr). Boats of Sliochd Raghnaill sail from Seann Tarr and make the round of the offshore islands, Eilean ruadh, Eilean dhearg and Eilean fhada among them, and come home in one season. No crew of the age goes further from the coast than the islands, and none is recorded as wanting to.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 208 BDE** — *Summer berders on Eilean ruadh* (Eilean ruadh). Families from the coast begin taking sheep over to Eilean ruadh for the summer grazing and bringing them back before the storms. They build turf shelters there, which later herders reuse.
- 24 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 193 BDE** — *Anna Ruadh* (Cathair dhearg). Anna Ruadh of the house of Tormod takes the red hall at Cathair dhearg. She is the first ruler since Mòrag nan Rathad to walk the whole road circuit, and she does it twice.

- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 190 BDE** — *Anna Ruadh at Am Buabhall Fortanach* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). On her first circuit Anna Ruadh stops at the house on the site of Am Buabhall Fortanach where the War of the Roads was ended, and eats the jugged buffalo like a carrier. The house's keepers still tell it.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 186 BDE** — *Anna Ruadh at the sunny house* (An Taigh-òsta Grianach). On the eastern road Anna Ruadh stays at the house on the site of An Taigh-òsta Grianach, and grants its keepers the right to a toll of their own for the upkeep of the road to Cnoc leathan, Slighe Cnoc leathan. It is the only waypoint house on the island with a royal charter.
- 12 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 183 BDE** — *Anna Ruadh at Ceann mhin* (Ceann mhin). At Ceann mhin on the south-eastern coast Anna Ruadh hears the fishers' dispute with the carriers over who may carry dried fish up to the mountain, and rules that both may. The ruling doubles the fish going inland and halves its price at Dùn ìseal.
- 11 AN T-IUCHAR 180 BDE** — *The contest at Ceann leathan in stone* (Ceann leathan). Anna Ruadh gives the road-guards' contest at Ceann leathan a stone-walled field and a silver ring from the red hall as its prize. The contest draws fighters from across the south, and the losers are fed at the crown's cost.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 177 BDE** — *A wood-watcher in the red hall* (Cathair dhearg). Anna Ruadh keeps a wood-watcher from Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag in her household at Cathair dhearg to read the omens of the hall. It is the first sign in the capital of the wood-watchers' rite, the rite of Macha, goddess of sovereignty and of horses. The Keeper sends a protest from Dùn ìseal and receives no answer that the rolls record.
- 24 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 173 BDE** — *Cathair dhombhain and the wood-watchers* (Cathair dhomhain). The shrine at Cathair dhomhain, proud of keeping the Law strictly, refuses to take a wood-watcher, and its people say the capital has given its omens to people who sit in trees. The rivalry of the two towns takes a religious turn it never loses.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 170 BDE** — *Death of Anna Ruadh* (Cathair dhearg). Anna Ruadh dies at Cathair dhearg and is buried at Dùn dhearg with the house of Ìomhar and her own house's kings. Her son Coinneach Bànn takes the hall.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 167 BDE** — *Coinneach Bànn* (Cathair dhearg). Coinneach Bànn rules long and quietly from Cathair dhearg. In his reign the clerks of the hall begin copying the rolls for the provinces, so that each province seat has its own copy of the laws, and several of those copies survive where the originals do not.
- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 164 BDE** — *Seumas Bànn keeps the flame* (Dùn ìseal). Seumas Bànn of Sliochd Mhuirich is chosen Keeper. He finds, on reading the Hall's roll at Dùn ìseal, that more than half the Keepers of the age have been of his own house, and has the fact struck from the preface. The unstruck copy survived.

- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 161 BDE** — *The rites counted at Dùn ìseal* (Dùn ìseal). Seumas Bàn has the Hall's clerks list every rite on the island that burns the handful and every one that claims the vein, so the council can know what it is keeping. The list holds the Hall's own rite, the ancestor-keeping of the old folk, the dawn-hawk of the north coast, the wood-watchers of the west, the wolf-sworn, the sting-oath, and both schools of the stag. The clerks note that the list would not have been needed a thousand years before.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 159 BDE** — *The hawk-keepers refuse the Hall's cutter* (Seann Skell). The hawk-keepers of Seann Skell refuse the Hall's cutter who comes to check their measure, saying their measure is the hawk's and the hawk is not the Keeper's. The cutter goes home with the refusal in writing. It is the first rite to refuse the Hall's measure-check outright.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 156 BDE** — *The wolf-sworn build a hall* (Caol leathan). The wolf-sworn of Caol leathan build a hall of their own around the white wolf-stone at the town gate and take oaths there that are no longer road-guards' oaths. They say the stone watches the whole island as the guard watches the road, and will cry out under the rightful king. From this hall comes Òrd na Cloiche, the order of the Stone, and the wolf-sworn begin to be called the Fianna.
- 3 AN DÙBHLACHD 153 BDE** — *The sting-oath at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). At Seann Skell in the west the harbour court's sting-oath becomes a creed: its keepers say that one power stings the liar wherever he is, Manannan mac Lir, lord of the sea, and that the scorpion is only his sign. The Hall's roll records it as a new teaching. It is the first on the island to call itself the only true one. The oath is sworn from now on over a cup marked with the scorpion, called Manannan's Cup of Truth, which is said to break in three at three lies spoken over it and to be made whole by three truths. Òrd Mhanannain dates itself from this court.
- 4 AN T-SAMHAIN 150 BDE** — *Seann Vell swears on the sting* (Seann Vell). Seann Vell, on the western coast below Cuan shean, takes up the sting-oath of its neighbours. Its shrine keeps a scorpion carved in yellow stone, the first image of the creature made for worship rather than for swearing on.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 147 BDE** — *The dark wood keeps its own rite* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). The wood-watchers of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag stop sending to the Hall for judgment of their disputes and judge them under the trees. They hold that the black beast has two natures, one that keeps and one that devours, and that the vein has the same. The order of Macha later tells the saying of the two horses that drew one chariot, the black Dubh Sainglenn and the grey Liath Macha: two horses, one yoke.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 144 BDE** — *The common root of the orders*. A single unified folk practice begins visibly splitting into the distinct threads later ages will separately name, the orders of An Creideamh Sean, the Old Faith, and the hearth-keeping of Na Seann Spioradan, the Old Spirits — the moment 'Rodian belief' stops being one thing.

- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 141 BDE** — *The council divided by rite* (Dùn iséal). The council at Dùn iséal, which had sat by hearth and by house, begins to sit in companies by rite. Seumas Bàn complains that he now keeps the flame for eight peoples who each think they are its only keepers. The seating is kept for the rest of the age.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 139 BDE** — *Allt an Àigh keeps its pilgrims* (Allt an Àigh). Whatever their rite, pilgrims go on walking to Allt an Àigh in the right quarter of the moon, the one custom on the island that the Hall's list sets under no company. The path from Caol shean is repaved by pilgrims of four different rites in the same season.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 136 BDE** — *The springs at Muileann ruadh common to all* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). The keeper of the springs at Muileann ruadh rules that the sick of every rite shall be bathed without asking which. Her ruling is copied into the provincial rolls. It is the last ruling of the age on which every company of the council agrees.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 133 BDE** — *Cnoc dhìreach's weavers* (Cnoc dhìreach). The town of Cnoc dhìreach in the east, the one on the carriers' road south of the springs and not the grave-keepers' village by the old tombs, becomes known for a heavy undyed cloth the carriers wear on the high passes. The two Cnoc dhìreachs are told apart in the rolls by that cloth.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 130 BDE** — *The dyers of Muileann bhàn* (Muileann bhàn). The dyers of Muileann bhàn in the eastern hills learn to fix a pale blue from a hill plant, and the carriers' cloth of the whole mountain country begins to be dyed there. The Keepers wear it undyed, and say so.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 127 BDE** — *Muileann dhombain's mill* (Muileann dhomhain). A water-mill is built at Muileann dhomhain in the eastern hills to grind the grain of the mountain districts' common granaries. The miller keeps one measure in sixteen, which the rolls record as fair.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 124 BDE** — *The flood at Àth chiar* (Àth chiar). Rain on the eastern hills brings the river over the ford at Àth chiar and carries off the carriers' shelter and six of the townsfolk. The common granary of the district, built on a rise, is untouched and feeds the town through the winter.
- 24 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 121 BDE** — *The oyster-beds of Seann Bhral* (Seann Bhral). The people of Seann Bhral on the south-eastern coast begin laying oyster-beds in the shallows, a practice they say came with the name of their town. The Library's copy of the provincial roll records the claim and marks it doubtful.
- 20 AN GEARRAN 119 BDE** — *Seann Vell's harbour* (Seann Vell). Seann Vell on the south-eastern coast grows into a city on the trade of the southern fishing and the Muileann chiar silver brought down the eastern road. Its harbour is the first on the island with a stone quay.
- 22 AM FAOILLEACH 116 BDE** — *The light at Tobar dhearg rebuilt* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The old beacon at Tobar dhearg on the southern cape is rebuilt as a stone tower with the fire on its top, the first sea-light raised above the ground. It burns seal-oil from the north-west carried the whole length of the island.

- 19 AN GIBLEAN 113 BDE** — *Muileann naomh's mill-shrine* (Muileann naomh). At Muileann naomh on the southern coast a mill and a shrine share one roof, the miller keeping the shrine's handful beside his millstones. The Keeper's cutter who inspects it finds the measure kept and the flour good.
- 21 AM MÀRT 110 BDE** — *Dùn thais walled* (Dùn thais). Dùn thais in the eastern hills is walled and a temple of the stag's people is raised in it, the first built in stone rather than kept in a grove. The elder school at Cnoc bhàn sends it teachers.
- 16 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 107 BDE** — *The wool-fair of Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). Inis mhòr holds a wool-fair each shearing that draws buyers from the whole northern coast and some from Cathair dhearg. Its silver is weighed on the Muileann chiar weights sent to the northern road.
- 18 AN CÈITEAN 104 BDE** — *Baile Mòr mhòr on the northern coast* (Baile Mòr mhòr). Baile Mòr mhòr, on the northern coast west of Seann Toll, grows large enough on the fishing to send its own member to the council at Dùn ìseal. The Four Houses do not like it, and seat its member at the foot of the hall.
- 13 AN LÙNASTAL 101 BDE** — *The northern boats at Seann Toll* (Seann Toll). The harbour at Seann Toll becomes the home of the northern fishing fleet. Its boatbuilders make the longest craft on the island, meant for a day's run along the coast and never for open water.
- 15 AN T-IUCHAR 99 BDE** — *Drought at Achadh shean* (Achadh shean). A dry summer burns the pastures round Achadh shean in the east, and the district's common granary is emptied by spring. Grain is sent from Baile chaol and Cuan ruadh under the shared-meal law, and the district repays it over the following harvests.
- 10 AN DÀMHAIR 96 BDE** — *Baile chaol's repayment* (Baile chaol). The rolls at Baile chaol record Achadh shean's repayment of the drought grain, measure by measure, down to the last. The clerk adds that it is the first such debt in the rolls repaid in full.
- 11 AN T-SULTAIN 93 BDE** — *The panthers late* (Imrich nam Pantar). The great cats' crossing of the southern road comes late and fewer than the carriers remember. The weather-watchers call it a sign of a hard winter and are right. The Keepers note it without comment.
- 13 AN LÙNASTAL 90 BDE** — *The watch-tower at Baile ruadh* (Baile ruadh). A timber watch-tower is raised at Baile ruadh on the north-eastern coast to look out for raiders from the islands. It is manned by Sliochd Raghnaill's fisher-kin by turns, and it is the only tower of war the age built.
- 11 AN T-SULTAIN 87 BDE** — *Cuan ruadh's boats* (Cuan ruadh). The fishers of Cuan ruadh on the eastern coast give boats and men to the watch against the island raiders. In return Sliochd Raghnaill gives the town a place on the council at Dùn ìseal beside its own seat.
- 10 AN DÀMHAIR 84 BDE** — *The drowned-feast at Inis chrom* (Inis chrom). At Inis chrom on the western coast the families of the drowned hold a feast on the shore each year and set an empty place for each of the lost. The custom spreads to the harbours north as far as Seann Warr.

- 8 AN T-SAMHAIN 81 BDE** — *The potters of Baile ghorm* (Baile ghorm). Potters at Baile ghorm on the south-western coast begin firing a hard red ware from the local clay, and their jars carry the oil and grain of the western road. Sherds of it are found on every waypoint-house site the Library's surveyors have walked.
- 19 AN GIBLEAN 79 BDE** — *Cnoc àrsaidh's kilns* (Cnoc àrsaidh). Potters of Baile ghorm set up new kilns at Cnoc àrsaidh in the south-west, where the clay is better and the wood nearer. The red ware of the western road is made there for the rest of the age.
- 18 AN CÈITEAN 76 BDE** — *Cathair fhada founded* (Cathair fhada). Cathair fhada is raised on the southern coast by families moving out of the crowded harbours round Cathair dhearg. Its founders bring a wood-watcher with them, and a copy of the laws.
- 16 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 73 BDE** — *Cnoc naomb's ancestor-shrine* (Cnoc naombh). The people of Cnoc naombh keep a shrine to the ancestors and to the síth of the hill in the old folk way, with no hawk, wolf, sting or stag in it. The Hall's list of rites names them among the keepers of the old reverence, which by now is a company of its own.
- 15 AN T-IUCHAR 70 BDE** — *Mòr nic Coinnich crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Mòr nic Coinnich, granddaughter of Coinneach Bàn, takes the red hall at Cathair dhearg. The Keeper Catriona nic Mhuirich sets the stone cup in her hands at Dùn ìseal as the houses had done for Gilleasbuig Mòr. Her name is the last written in the king-list of the Holy Age.
- 2 AN GIBLEAN 60 BDE** — *The Hall's roll at the close of the age* (Dùn ìseal). At the close of the age the Keepers' roll holds the names of one hundred and forty Keepers from Beathag Bhàn to Catriona nic Mhuirich, and the king-list the names of more than ninety rulers from Goraidh Mòr to Mòr nic Coinnich. The Small-Burning Law has not been changed in a word since Fionnlagh Dall's stone cup. The cup is still on the threshold of Talla na Lasrach at Dùn ìseal.
- 1 AN CÈITEAN 50 BDE** — *The last age of even population*. Chroniclers later look back and note, with some unease, that this is the final stretch of Rodian history in which no single family held meaningfully more years of life than any other.

AGE III · AN AOIS SCARAI DH

- 6 AM FAOILLEACH 39 BDE** — *Land is found.* Word returns of a land across open water, unpeopled by anyone resembling the Ròdaich. No record survives of who found it first.
- 9 AN T-SAMHAIN 39 BDE** — *The report heard at Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhearg). The report of the far land is repeated at Cathair dhearg in the hall of Queen Beathag nic Dhòmhnaill, daughter of Mòr nic Coinnich, by three separate crews from the western harbours, none of whom claims to have been first. The queen's scribe takes down all three accounts and notes that they agree on the coast and on nothing else.
- 8 AN DÙBHLACHD 39 BDE** — *The Choosing.* A vote — or something the later chronicles call a vote — decides who will go. Volunteers only. No lots are drawn, no conscription recorded.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 38 BDE** — *The roll of the willing* (Seann Skell). At Seann Skell the harbour scribes open a roll for those who mean to go, entered by household rather than by name. The roll is kept on boards in the harbour-house, and a later hand notes that entries were struck out as often as they were added.
- 11 AN DÀMHAIR 38 BDE** — *The queen neither commands nor forbids* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Beathag declares that the crown will neither send anyone across the water nor keep anyone back. Her younger sister, Mòrag nic Dhòmhnaill, enters her own household on the roll at Seann Skell within the season.
- 14 AN LÙNASTAL 37 BDE** — *The custodians count the cost* (Muileann dhearg). The vein-house above Muileann dhearg, keeper of Crom's stone and heir to the Keepers' Hall at Dùn ìseal where Brìde's flame was first bound, reckons which of the households holding the customary right to burn the ore have entered the roll. The custody-book puts it at nearly one household in five, and adds that the reckoning was made twice because the first figure was not believed.
- 16 AN T-IUCHAR 35 BDE** — *The ships are built.* The island's shipwrights, used to modest coastal craft, build vessels meant to survive open water for the first time in Rodian memory.
- 14 AN LÙNASTAL 35 BDE** — *Alasdair Saor lays the first keel* (Seann Skell). On the river strand below Seann Skell, the shipwright Alasdair mac Iain, called Alasdair Saor, lays down the first deep-keeled hull ever built on Rodos. The island's craft until then were sewn-plank coasters that never slept out of sight of land.
- 26 AN LÙNASTAL 35 BDE** — *The oaks of Doire fhionn* (Doire fhionn). The oak grove that gave Doire fhionn its name is felled for the fleet's keels and carried down to the coast by ox-sled. The grove never regrew, and the village kept a name it no longer had a reason for.
- 24 AN T-SULTAIN 35 BDE** — *The shipwrights' fellowship bound* (Seann Skell). Alasdair Saor takes the wrights of the Seann Skell strand into a single fellowship, binding each apprentice for seven years in the manner of the vein custodians. The custody-book calls it Comann nan Saor-luinge, the fellowship of the ship-wrights.

- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 34 BDE** — *The trial bull lost off Inis àrsaidh's harbour* (Inis àrsaidh). The first finished hull is taken down the Abhainn naomh and sailed out past Ros àrsaidh, where the ships of Inis àrsaidh put to sea, to be tried in open water, and founders in a following sea. Eleven are drowned. Alasdair Saor changes the setting of the keel, and every later hull of the fleet is built to the changed pattern.
- 11 AN DÀMHAIR 32 BDE** — *The rope-walks of Cuan shean* (Cuan shean). Cuan shean lays out long rope-walks along its harbour front and turns its hemp fields over entirely to cordage for the fleet. The town's rope trade outlasts the Sundering by some centuries.
- 9 AN T-SAMHAIN 31 BDE** — *The sail-cloth levy* (Baile àrsaidh). Every weaving household in Siorrachd Baile àrsaidh is asked for a set length of close-woven cloth for sails, reckoned on tally-sticks at the shire seat. The tallies survive; how many households paid does not.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 27 BDE** — *The star-lore taught at Cuan ruadh* (Cuan ruadh). Old steersmen of Cuan ruadh on the eastern coast, the only sailors on the island who had ever kept a course by night, teach the fleet's pilots to hold a heading by the stars. Their lore was written down only in part, and that part has not survived.
- 19 AN CÈITEAN 22 BDE** — *The volunteers name their leaders* (Seann Skell). The households on the roll meet at Seann Skell and choose their own leaders: Mòrag nic Dhòmhnaill, the queen's sister, and Fearchar mac Ruairidh, a custodian of the vein. The custody-book records the choice and nothing of how it was made.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 15 BDE** — *The handful for the new hearth* (Muileann dhearg). The vein-house rules on whether departing custodians may carry the ore. Each ship may take one sealed measure, no more than a single household may burn in a season under the Small-Burning Law. The ruling is the only text in the custody-book addressed to people who were leaving.
- 16 AN T-IUCHAR 10 BDE** — *The west quay lengthened* (Seann Skell). The west quay at Seann Skell is lengthened with dressed stone so that the deep hulls can lie alongside it at low water. Masons are brought from the capital to do the work, and the new stones are the ones the later rite would be held on.
- 20 AN GEARRAN 2 BDE** — *The provisioning debate*. A dispute over how much of the island's stored grain the departing ships may take nearly cancels the whole expedition. It is resolved, unrecorded how, within a season.
- 21 AM MÀRT 2 BDE** — *Àth shean shuts its granaries* (Àth shean). During the dispute over the fleet's grain, the reeve of the granaries at Àth shean, Tormod mac Coinnich, bars the store-houses and sets a watch on them. The watch is kept until the matter is settled, and Tormod is not recorded as holding office afterward.
- 3 AN GIBLEAN 2 BDE** — *Grain down Abhainn dhombhain* (Abhainn dhomhain). Once the dispute is settled, grain barges are sent down Abhainn dhomhain to the capital and on by coast to Ros àrsaidh and up the Abhainn naomh to Seann Skell. A tally-keeper at Drochaid Cathair dhearg counts the barges passing and makes the count forty-one.

- 2 AN CÈITEAN 2 BDE** — *The fleet assembled* (Seann Skell). The fleet lies at Seann Skell complete. The custody-book gives it as nineteen hulls; a later hand in the margin corrects this to twenty-one, and no one since has been able to settle which is right.
- 18 AN GIBLEAN 1 DE** — *The night of lamps* (Seann Skell). On the last night before the sailing, every house along the Seann Skell waterfront sets a lamp on its sill and keeps it burning until morning. It is the first custom of the Sundering recorded as a custom, and the town kept it long after the reason was a story.
- 19 AN GIBLEAN 1 DE** — *The Setting-Out*. The volunteers depart west. The island's chronicles simply stop describing them the moment the ships clear the harbor; the Ròdaich tell that the fleet sailed into Manannan's mist, toward the Otherworld.
- 19 AN GIBLEAN 1 DE** — *The sunwise turn* (Seann Skell). Before going down the Abhainn naomh to open water the fleet goes once round the river pool of Seann Skell sunwise, diosal, for luck, and the watchers on the quay count the hulls as they pass. The harbour scribe's account of them ends at the foot of the pool.
- 22 AM FAOILLEACH 5 DE** — *The years counted from the turn* (Muileann dhearg). Donnchadh mac Thormoid, scribe of the vein-house, begins to number the years from the sunwise turn at Seann Skell, and calls them the years of the Diosal. The count is his; the crown's scribes adopt it only a generation later.
- 27 AN DÀMHAIR 5 DE** — *A report reaches Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). A report of the fleet reaches Seann Skell. The custody-book does not say how or by whom it came, only that the harbour scribe copied it in a hand that shook. The copy came down to later keepers stained by water and missing its end.
- 24 AN DÙBHLACHD 5 DE** — *Two landfalls*. What fragmentary report ever returns describes two separate coasts reached, not one — the seed, in this telling, of two later peoples rather than one.
- 1 AN LÙNASTAL 7 DE** — *Mòrag's line struck* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Beathag removes her sister Mòrag and Mòrag's children from the order of succession, as persons no longer on Rodos. The act is entered without comment between a grain ruling and the repair of a bridge.
- 3 AN T-IUCHAR 14 DE** — *The thinning*. Cut off from the vein, whatever strength the crossing required fades across the departed's own children. By the third generation abroad, nothing remains that Rodos would recognize.
- 28 AN T-SULTAIN 14 DE** — *The custodians' second reckoning* (Muileann dhearg). The vein-house counts again the households that hold the right to the ore. The loss is set down as one hand in five, and beside it Donnchadh mac Thormoid writes that the vein itself answers no differently for those who stayed.
- 1 AN LÙNASTAL 15 DE** — *The Mourning Custom*. Rodos formalizes a mourning rite for the departed that is not quite grief and not quite celebration — reused, uneasily, for a very different departure in a much later age.

- 27 AN DÀMHAIR 15 DE** — *The white sorrow first kept at court* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Beathag keeps the new mourning for her sister in undyed wool, with one place set empty at a meal that is neither feast nor fast. The court calls it an Tùrsa Geal, the white sorrow, and by the next generation it is kept in every harbour town on the island.
- 7 AM FAOILLEACH 16 DE** — *Population correction*. With a portion of the obsidian-bonded population gone, Rodian society reorganizes around a smaller, more concentrated custodian class — the shape every later aristocracy inherits.
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 16 DE** — *The seven houses of custody* (Muileann dhearg). The remaining custodian households are regrouped into seven houses, each answerable to the vein-house for its share of the ore and of the measured burning: Clann Mhuirich, Clann Fhearchair, Clann Ìomhair, Clann Raghnaill, Clann Thormoid, Clann Choinnich and Clann Lachlainn. The division is the first in the record to treat the right to the ore as something inherited by house rather than earned by apprenticeship.
- 28 AN T-IUCHAR 16 DE** — *Death of Queen Beathag* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Beathag nic Dhòmhnaill dies at Cathair dhearg, the last ruler of Rodos to have seen the fleet. Her son Raghnaill mac Uilleim is crowned in the same hall.
- 25 AN T-SAMHAIN 22 DE** — *The empty harbor rite*. A ceremony develops around the specific dock the ships departed from, still observed in reduced form on an anniversary no one can precisely date anymore.
- 24 AN DÙBHLACHD 25 DE** — *The harbour at half trade* (Seann Skell). Seann Skell's harbour-master records his berths at half their former use. The fishing households that had crewed the fleet are simply gone, and the rope-walks at Cuan shean lay off hands for the first time.
- 8 AN GEARRAN 26 DE** — *The second silence*. A rumor of a second, smaller crossing — fewer ships, no surviving record of a destination — is neither confirmed nor denied by anything that survives.
- 5 AM MÀRT 28 DE** — *The watch at Ceann mhòr* (Ceann mhòr). Fishing families at Ceann mhòr on the north-west coast keep a watch from the headland for returning sails, taking turns by household. The watch lapses within a generation, and no sail is recorded.
- 13 AM MÀRT 28 DE** — *The renaming of the west quay*. The dock the ships departed from is given a new name specifically so ordinary trade could resume using the old one without the association — an early, quiet act of managed forgetting.
- 15 AN LÙNASTAL 28 DE** — *Cidhe an Diosail* (Seann Skell). In the harbour rolls of Seann Skell the departure berth is entered as Cidhe an Diosail, the quay of the sunwise turn. The name Cidhe an Iar passes to the new fish-wharf at the north end of the strand, and within a few years the fishers use it without a thought.

- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 28 DE** — *Roghnaich takes its narrow sense.* In the custody-book the verb roghnaich, to choose, begins to appear with no object at all, meaning to have chosen the crossing. Scribes of the next century use it this way without explaining it, which is the surest sign it had become ordinary speech.
- 31 AN LÙNASTAL 28 DE** — *The first generation to never see the sea empty.* Children born just after the Setting-Out grow up never having known the harbour with those particular ships in it. For them the departure is already history.
- 8 AN T-SULTAIN 28 DE** — *Death of Alasdair Saor* (Seann Skell). Alasdair Saor, who laid the first deep keel, dies at Seann Skell. His last work was a coasting trader of the old sewn-plank kind, built for a fish merchant of Inis àrsaidh.
- 27 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 45 DE** — *The closing of the shipwrights' guild.* With no more ocean-crossing vessels needed, the guild that built the Sundering fleet quietly dissolves — its techniques half-forgotten by the time anyone thinks to need them again.
- 29 AN CÈITEAN 46 DE** — *The keel-moulds burned* (Seann Skell). The patterns and moulds of the dissolved fellowship, kept in a shed on the strand at Seann Skell, are broken up and burned as firewood during a hard season. The harbour-master notes the loss of the shed, not of what was in it.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 70 DE** — *The mountain divided among the houses* (Muileann dhearg). The seven houses draw lots at the vein-house for the galleries each will keep, and the vein-house confirms the Small-Burning measure for each of them. The lot-stones were kept in a bag at Muileann dhearg and shown to visitors for centuries after.
- 14 AN T-IUCHAR 70 DE** — *The coppice law of Doire fhionn* (Doire fhionn). With the great oaks gone to the fleet, the shire of Doire fhionn forbids the felling of any living oak without the reeve's mark and begins to cut its woods by coppice. The law spreads to every shire with a Doire in its name.
- 12 AN LÙNASTAL 70 DE** — *The lamps kept at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). The waterfront of Seann Skell keeps the night of lamps each year on the eve of the empty-harbour rite. Children are told the lamps are for ships coming home, which the priests do not correct.
- 9 AN DÀMHAIR 70 DE** — *Death of Donnchadh mac Thormoid* (Muileann dhearg). Donnchadh mac Thormoid, the vein-house scribe who began the count of years, dies at Muileann dhearg. His last entry is a list of the ore burned that season, household by household, in the same hand as his first.
- 7 AN T-SAMHAIN 86 DE** — *Raghnall dies; Ìombar crowned* (Cathair dhearg). King Raghnall mac Uilleim dies at Cathair dhearg after a long and uneventful reign, and his son Ìomhar mac Raghnall is crowned. The custody-book gives Raghnall's reign a single line.
- 6 AN DÙBHLACHD 110 DE** — *The silversmiths of Muileann chiar* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). The silver of the seam at Muileann chiar, mined since the Holy Age, is worked into neck-rings for the heads of the seven houses. The smiths' fellowship of the seam, heir to Sliochd Fhearchair, closes its methods within four families.

- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 115 DE** — *Inis mhòr's grain fleet* (Inis mhòr). Inis mhòr in the north builds a fleet of barges to carry grain down the Abhainn ghorm to Caol bheag and, from Ros chiar at the river mouth, west along the coast to Cnoc bheag. They are sewn-plank boats of the old kind, and none sleeps out of sight of land.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 117 DE** — *The coughing sickness at Caol fhiadhaich* (Caol fhiadhaich). A coughing sickness runs through Caol fhiadhaich on the south-west coast and kills some two hundred before it burns out. The shared-meal custom is kept throughout, and the town's reeve credits it with the survival of the rest.
- 3 AM MÀRT 125 DE** — *Am Buabhall Fortanach rebuilt in stone* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). The old road-house of Am Buabhall Fortanach burns to its footings and is rebuilt in stone by its keeper, Eilidh nic Chaluim. The account of her rebuilding mentions the jugged buffalo it was already known for.
- 7 AN DÀMHAIR 140 DE** — *The spirit-house at Dùn ìseal* (Dùn ìseal). The keepers of the Old Spirits, the faith of the hearths, raise a house for the ancestors at Dùn ìseal, where the names of the dead of the eastern shires are cut on wooden posts. The posts are recut every generation as the old ones rot.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 141 DE** — *Ìomhar dies without an heir* (Cathair dhearg). King Ìomhar mac Raghnaill dies at Cathair dhearg with no living child, and the line of Beathag ends with him. The heads of the seven houses are summoned to the capital to name a successor.
- 19 AN GEARRAN 143 DE** — *Fearchar mac Lachlainn chosen* (Cathair dhearg). The heads of the houses choose Fearchar mac Lachlainn of Baile Mòr dhomhain, of Clann Fhearchair, and he is crowned at Cathair dhearg. It is the first crowning in the record decided by the custodian houses rather than by descent.
- 20 AM MÀRT 155 DE** — *A court at Baile Mòr dhomhain* (Baile Mòr dhomhain). King Fearchar keeps his court for part of each year at Baile Mòr dhomhain, near the mountain, so that the vein-house may be consulted without a journey. The custom of the double court lasts as long as his house.
- 21 AN GEARRAN 170 DE** — *The fishers of Àth fhiadhaich* (Àth fhiadhaich). The fishing families of Àth fhiadhaich form a single fellowship to share boats and nets after a season of losses. It is the first fishers' fellowship on the east coast.
- 21 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 172 DE** — *Fearchar Donn crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Fearchar mac Lachlainn dies and his son, called Fearchar Donn, is crowned at Cathair dhearg without dispute.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 190 DE** — *Gormshuil of the Hawk* (Cnoc bheag). At Cnoc bheag, where the dawn-hawk rite of the Holy Age is still kept, the priestess Gormshuil nic Artair teaches that the hawk of the rite is Mòd, the Hawk of Acaill, who is as old as Fionntan mac Bòchra, the oldest of men, and remembers everything with him, and that the vein is the Hungry Hawk, who must be fed the measured handful and no more, since a hawk overfed will not hunt and a hawk starved will turn on the hand. Her followers gather the old rite into the first house of Òrd an t-Seabhaig, the order of the Hawk of Acaill.

- 22 AM MÀRT 200 DE** — *The hawk-house at Ros gheal* (Ros gheal). A second house of the Hawk is founded at Ros gheal by Gormshuil's pupils. Its priests take charge of the measured burning for the whole country between Ros gheal on the coast and Cnoc bheag up the river.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 205 DE** — *Flood at Seann Vell* (Seann Vell). The river at Seann Vell on the south-east coast breaks its banks in a wet spring and carries away the lower mills. The mill-wrights rebuild them on the higher bank.
- 5 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 212 DE** — *The sayings of Gormshuil written* (Cnoc bheag). After Gormshuil's death her sayings are written down at Cnoc bheag as Leabhar an t-Seabhaig, the Book of the Hawk. The copyist, Ùisdean mac Pàdraig, marks every saying he did not hear from her own mouth, and there are more of these than of the rest.
- 23 AN T-SAMHAIN 220 DE** — *The storm that took Seann Toll's boats* (Seann Toll). A northern storm, named in the harbour rolls Am Fuath Mòr, breaks the harbour wall of Seann Toll and sinks forty boats at their moorings. Eighteen fishers are drowned.
- 16 AN T-IUCHAR 222 DE** — *Seann Toll walls its harbour again* (Seann Toll). Seann Toll rebuilds its harbour wall higher and with a hooked end, to a plan the reeve had from the masons of the capital. The wall stands through every later storm in this age.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 222 DE** — *The walls of Dùn dhearg* (Dùn dhearg). Dùn dhearg in the eastern hills is walled in stone by Clann Ìomhair, who hold the land around it. The walls are the first on the island built by a custodian house rather than the crown.
- 11 AN DÀMHAIR 222 DE** — *Queen Sileas's measures* (Cathair dhearg). Sileas nic Fhearchair, crowned after her father Fearchar Donn, fixes a single measure for grain across the island, the firlot of Cathair dhearg, so that barter between shires need not begin with a quarrel over the size of a basket. Standard firlots of oak bound with iron are sent to every shire seat.
- 22 AN T-SULTAIN 245 DE** — *Tally-houses in the royal granaries* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Sileas sets a tally-house in each royal granary, where every exchange of grain for cloth, salt or labour is cut on paired sticks, one for each party. It is the first island-wide account of trade, and it runs entirely without coin.
- 17 AN T-SAMHAIN 248 DE** — *The market charter of Cathair fhada* (Cathair fhada). Queen Sileas grants Cathair fhada a market each week on its ridge and a tally-house for the south, the first market right cut on paired sticks. The long city's merchants carry the honey, hemp, wax and pots of the south to the capital, and they begin to go to the harvest fair at Muileann òg as one company.
- 21 AN DÀMHAIR 250 DE** — *Drochaid Cathair dhearg widened* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). The old stone bridge over Abhainn dhomhain at Cathair dhearg is widened so that two carts can pass. Queen Sileas's name is cut on the downstream parapet, where it can still be read.

- 26 AN T-IUCHAR 265 DE** — *The crossing days of the panthers* (Imrich nam Pantar). Herders in the southern hills near Imrich nam Pantar begin keeping the panther roads clear on the days the great cats cross, driving their flocks off the paths beforehand. The crossing days are the first thing the southern shires agree on in writing.
- 24 AN LÙNASTAL 265 DE** — *An Leòmhann Buidhe on the north road* (An Leòmhann Buidhe). An Leòmhann Buidhe, a road-house on the northern mining road, is recorded as serving oatcakes fried in linseed oil, and fire water, to the ore-carters. Its keeper is fined for watering the fire water.
- 29 AN CÈITEAN 275 DE** — *The house of disputation at Dùn thais* (Dùn thais). Coinneach mac Mhàrtainn, a druid of the schools of Flidais, lady of the deer, founds a house of disputation at Dùn thais where the schools' old question, Carson an làmh seo?, why the vein answers some hands and not others, is argued by rule. Pupils come from as far as Caol bheag.
- 1 AN GIBLEAN 285 DE** — *Coinneach's question* (Dùn thais). Coinneach mac Mhàrtainn asks in open disputation whether the hands that went with the fleet were the ones the vein answered best, and whether it now answers fewer. The seven houses forbid the question at their own tables, which the record notes is the first time they forbade a question rather than an act.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 285 DE** — *Baile Mòr mhòr grows* (Baile Mòr mhòr). Baile Mòr mhòr on the northern plain takes in families from the upland farms after a run of poor seasons and doubles in size within a generation. Its reeve divides the common grazing anew.
- 27 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 285 DE** — *Death of Queen Sileas* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Sileas nic Fhearchair dies at Cathair dhearg after a reign of more than half a century. Her son Uisdean mac Dhùghaill is crowned.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 305 DE** — *The deep bull that would not float true* (Inis àrsaidh). A merchant of Inis àrsaidh pays to have a deep-keeled hull built for the long coast run to the east. The wrights cannot remember how Alasdair Saor's keels were scarfed, and the hull lists so badly at launch that it is broken up for timber.
- 3 AM MÀRT 315 DE** — *Salt pans at Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). The river town of Ros fhionn in the north-east lays out salt pans at the brine springs on its river flats and begins to send salt inland over Drochaid Ros fhionn. Within a generation Ros fhionn salt is the common measure of value in the north-eastern shires.
- 18 AN T-SULTAIN 322 DE** — *The wool of Baile gharbh* (Baile gharbh). The weavers of Baile gharbh make a heavy undyed cloth that sheds rain, and it becomes the common cloak of the north-east. It is also the cloth in which the white sorrow is kept.
- 20 AN LÙNASTAL 330 DE** — *Salt over Drochaid Ros fhionn* (Drochaid Ros fhionn). Traffic over Drochaid Ros fhionn grows so heavy with salt carts that the bridge-keeper is given the right to take a handful from each load. The keeper's salt-box is recorded as holding more than some villages' granaries.

- 27 AN CÈITEAN 340 DE** — *The wells crack at Cill ghlas* (Scàineadh Cill ghlas). An earth tremor in the hills around Cill ghlas cracks three wells and brings down a byre. The custodians of the vein-house note it and note also that the galleries were untouched.
- 26 AN GIBLEAN 355 DE** — *The Hollow Man spoken of again* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). Shepherds of the Doire uaine hills refuse to light fires on the high pastures, citing the old inscriptions of Marbh-bheò Doire uaine. A reeve sent from Muileann chiar to make them see sense does not stay the night.
- 25 AN CÈITEAN 355 DE** — *Aonghas mac Uisdein crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Uisdean mac Dhùghaill dies and his son Aonghas mac Uisdein is crowned at Cathair dhearg. Aonghas is recorded as the first king to learn his letters as a child.
- 23 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 355 DE** — *Àth fhiadhaich salt fish* (Àth fhiadhaich). Àth fhiadhaich begins to salt its catch with Ros fhionn salt and send it inland to the mining towns. The mining shires eat salt fish in the lean season from this time on.
- 28 AM MÀRT 370 DE** — *Clach first preached at Inis thais* (Inis thais). Dòmhnall mac Ailein, a net-maker of Inis thais, where the wolf-sworn's stone Clach stands, preaches that the stone is Lia Fàil, the stone that cries out under the rightful king, and that its sworn guards are the Fianna, who keep the island as a wolf keeps its range. His hearers are the first congregation of Òrd na Cloiche, the order of the Stone.
- 16 AN DÙBHLACHD 380 DE** — *The wolf-house at Inis thais* (Inis thais). Dòmhnall mac Ailein's followers raise a temple at Inis thais, the first temple on the island raised to Lia Fàil by name. It is roofed with slate brought by sea from the north.
- 29 AM FAOILLEACH 390 DE** — *Hawk and wolf at Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). Priests of the Hawk and the Fianna of the Stone both claim the harbour shrine at Caol leathan. The king's reeve divides its days between them, as the Holy Age had divided the sacred woods, and the arrangement holds.
- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 396 DE** — *The market inside the new gate* (Seann Skell). Seann Skell on the Hawk bay is walled, and a market is chartered inside the new landward gate. Amber, whale-oil, honey and the sheep of the northern moors are sold there, and the amber-workers of the bay agree to sell no rough amber outside the walls.
- 31 AN DÙBHLACHD 402 DE** — *Macha at court* (Cathair dhearg). King Aonghas takes up the wood-watchers' rite of Macha, which keeps the two horses of one chariot, foaled on one night, Liath Macha, the grey, and Dubh Sainglenn, the black: two horses, one yoke; light and dark are two powers in balance, and the vein belongs to both. The court follows him, and Òrd Mhacha, the order of Macha, becomes the order of Cathair dhearg and the crown.
- 28 AM MÀRT 407 DE** — *Fire at Tobar dhearg* (Tobar dhearg). A fire in the thatch spreads through Tobar dhearg and burns most of the village. The villagers rebuild with slate from the quarries nearby, and the village is known for its slate roofs after.

- 14 AM FAOILLEACH 432 DE** — *Macha's priests in Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). The share of custody over Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, divided since the Holy Age, passes by royal grant to the priests of Macha. The other claimants withdraw from the wood without contest, and the record does not say why.
- 11 AN T-IUCHAR 440 DE** — *The druid schools keep Coille Naomh Muileann chiar* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). The druids of the schools take formal keeping of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar, the wood of Flidais's white stag, walking its bounds each year. The walk becomes the schools' one public observance.
- 29 AM FAOILLEACH 445 DE** — *The drovers of Àth chiar* (Àth chiar). Drovers from Àth chiar begin driving cattle over the eastern hills to the mining towns each year. Their routes are the first on the island to be marked with cairns.
- 23 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 445 DE** — *Eilidh Dhubh's tracts* (Doire chiar). At Doire chiar, Eilidh nic Iain, called Eilidh Dhubh, revives the teaching of the Holy Age's rival school, that the vein answers effort and not birth, and writes it out in tracts copied by her pupils. The tracts are read aloud at harvest gatherings across the north-east.
- 2 AN DÙBHLACHD 445 DE** — *The tracts burned at Muileann dhearg* (Muileann dhearg). The vein-house orders every copy of Eilidh Dhubh's tracts brought to Muileann dhearg and burned. Some hundred copies are surrendered. Eilidh herself is not punished and dies at Doire chiar, still teaching.
- 31 AN DÙBHLACHD 445 DE** — *Death of King Aonghas* (Cathair dhearg). King Aonghas mac Uisdein dies at Cathair dhearg and is buried by the rite of Macha, the first king so buried. His son Iain mac Aonghais is crowned.
- 27 AN GEARRAN 457 DE** — *Tormod Bàn crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Iain mac Aonghais dies after a short reign and his son Tormod mac Iain, called Tormod Bàn for his white hair, is crowned at Cathair dhearg. The houses swear to him without dispute.
- 8 AN LÙNASTAL 470 DE** — *Winter at An Taigh-seinnse Mòr* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, on the central mining road, becomes the house where the ox-teams of the mountain wait out the worst of the snow. Its keeper, Iain mac Mhurchaidh, builds a second byre for them and keeps a book of the teams that lodged.
- 6 AN T-SULTAIN 475 DE** — *The bell-founders of Muileann naomh* (Muileann naomh). A family at Muileann naomh casts the first bronze bell on Rodos hung in a hawk-house. The bell cracks in its first frost, and the second holds.
- 5 AM MÀRT 480 DE** — *An Gàire Dubh* (Cuan dhearg). A storm named in the south-coast rolls An Gàire Dubh, the Black Laugh, drives the sea over the waterfront of Cuan dhearg and ruins the season's salt fish. The town is rebuilt a street further back from the shore.
- 13 AN T-SULTAIN 487 DE** — *The hawk-house at Muileann naomh* (Muileann naomh). Muileann naomh in the south becomes the southernmost house of the Hawk, its bell rung at each measured burning. The Hawk's teaching holds there when it fades elsewhere in the south.

- 18 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 495 DE** — *The king's sons drowned in Abhainn fhionn* (Abhainn fhionn). Both sons of King Tormod Bàn are drowned when a ferry overturns crossing Abhainn fhionn in spate. The king has no other child.
- 8 AN T-SULTAIN 508 DE** — *Death of Tormod Bàn* (Cathair dhearg). King Tormod Bàn dies at Cathair dhearg without naming an heir. Three claims are laid before the houses at once.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 513 DE** — *The three claimants* (Cathair dhearg). The crown is claimed by Catriona nic Aonghais of Inis thais, the late king's niece; by Dùghall Garbh of Baile Mòr dhomhain, his half-brother; and by Ragnall Ruadh, head of Clann Raghnaill and master of the vein-house. The seven houses split among them and the War of the Three Claimants begins.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 514 DE** — *Seann Warr shuts its gates* (Seann Warr). Seann Warr, the port nearest the capital on the west, closes its gates to all three claimants and declares for none. It is besieged twice in the war and taken by neither.
- 22 AN GEARRAN 515 DE** — *The ford at Àth shean* (Àth shean). Dùghall Garbh's host meets Ragnall Ruadh's at the ford of Àth shean and breaks it. The custody-book counts some three hundred dead, most of them drowned in the ford.
- 24 AN T-SULTAIN 516 DE** — *The burning of Doire mhin* (Doire mhin). Ragnall Ruadh's retreating men burn the village of Doire mhin and its granary to deny it to Dùghall. The villagers winter at Cathair mhòr on the charity of Macha's priests.
- 26 AN DÙBHLACHD 518 DE** — *The siege of Cathair dhomhain* (Cathair dhomhain). Catriona nic Aonghais besieges Cathair dhomhain, which had declared for Dùghall, and takes it after forty days when its wells are poisoned by the dead of the siege lines. She lets the garrison go free on their oath.
- 24 AM FAOILLEACH 519 DE** — *The hearths refused* (Muileann dhearg). Ragnall Ruadh, holding the vein-house, refuses the measured handful of ore to every hearth and temple in the shires that stand against him. Hearths that had been lit with the ore for generations go cold, and the act turns more people against him than any battle.
- 14 AM FAOILLEACH 521 DE** — *The battle of Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). The hosts of Catriona and Dùghall, joined for the purpose, meet Ragnall Ruadh below Muileann chrom. Ragnall is killed on the field and the vein-house is opened by his own custodians the next day.
- 16 AN DÙBHLACHD 522 DE** — *Death of Dùghall Garbh* (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Dùghall Garbh dies of his wounds from Muileann chrom at Baile Mòr dhomhain. His followers go over to Catriona without a further fight.
- 13 AM MÀRT 523 DE** — *Catriona Bhuadbach crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Catriona nic Aonghais is crowned at Cathair dhearg and is known after as Catriona Bhuadbach. The War of the Three Claimants ends with her crowning, having lasted about a decade.

- 12 AN GEARRAN 526 DE** — *The ruling of the hearth* (Muileann dhearg). Catriona Bhuadhach and the vein-house fix in law that no claimant, house or king may withhold the measured handful from any lawful hearth. It is the first law in the record written to bind the custodians themselves.
- 10 AN CÈITEAN 545 DE** — *Catriona's road south* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). Queen Catriona has the road from the capital south by Baile shean and Am Buabhall Fortanach at Doire shean laid with stone, so that her own town of Inis thais may be reached in any weather. The road is known as Rathad na Banrighinn.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 555 DE** — *Seann Warr's gates honoured* (Seann Warr). Queen Catriona grants Seann Warr the right to keep its own gates and levy its own tolls, in memory of its standing aside in the war. The grant is cut over the landward gate.
- 7 AN T-IUCHAR 565 DE** — *Death of Catriona Bhuadhach* (Cathair dhearg). Catriona Bhuadhach dies at Cathair dhearg. Her son Lachlann mac Iain is crowned, and the houses swear to him in one day, which the record remarks on.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 585 DE** — *The Book of the Three Claimants* (Cathair dhearg). A clerk of Queen Catriona's household, Seònaid nic Coinnich, writes an account of the war from the custody-book and from the testimony of those who fought. It is the oldest surviving history on Rodos written as a single narrative rather than as entries.
- 3 AN T-SULTAIN 585 DE** — *The sickness at Inis chrom* (Inis chrom). A spotted fever kills some three hundred at Inis chrom on the south-west coast. The Fianna of the Stone nurse the sick and many of them die of it, and the town becomes the Stone's for good.
- 5 AN LÙNASTAL 595 DE** — *The oyster beds of Doire shean* (Doire shean). Doire shean, a village on the southern shore, lays out oyster beds in its shallow bay and sends oysters by cart to the capital. The trade makes the village rich enough to be a shire seat.
- 26 AN DÀMHAIR 605 DE** — *The feast-market at Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). The crowds that come to the ancestor shrine at Seann Tarr for the great feasts begin to hold a market on the three feast days. Its chief goods are honey, beeswax for the shrine lights and the dyes of Baile fhiadhaich. The wax lights of Seann Tarr are soon burned at ancestor shrines along the whole north-eastern coast.
- 1 AN T-SULTAIN 615 DE** — *Manannan preached at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). At Seann Skell, where the sting-creed of the Holy Age first called itself the only true one, a preacher named Mānas mac Ruairidh proclaims its one power as Manannan mac Lir, lord of the sea, whose Cup of Truth bears the yellow scorpion, and teaches that Manannan shut the western sea behind the fleet with his mist, which hides Rodos from every ship beyond it, and that it must not be tried again. His hearers are the first congregation of Òrd Mhanannain, the order of Manannan.
- 30 AN T-SULTAIN 615 DE** — *Death of Lachlann mac Iain* (Cathair dhearg). Lachlann mac Iain, son of Catriona Bhuadhach, dies at Cathair dhearg, and his daughter Anna is crowned. The record calls his reign quiet and means it as praise.

- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 635 DE** — *Manannan's order at Ros bheag and Cuan shean* (Ros bheag). The teaching of Manannan's order spreads down the west coast to Ros bheag and Cuan shean, carried by fishing families. At Cuan shean the rope-makers are among the first converts.
- 27 AN T-SAMHAIN 655 DE** — *Within sight of land* (Ros bheag). Manannan's priests at Ros bheag lay it down that no boat of the faithful may go beyond sight of the headlands. The rule is kept on the west coast for centuries, and the steering of boats by the stars, already half lost, is lost there entirely.
- 19 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 660 DE** — *The granaries of Àth shean rebuilt* (Àth shean). The royal granaries at Àth shean, old since before the Sundering, are pulled down and rebuilt in stone on raised floors against the rats. The tally-house is rebuilt with them.
- 24 AM FAOILLEACH 675 DE** — *The rope-walks shortened* (Cuan shean). Cuan shean takes up half its rope-walks and puts the ground to barley. The rope trade had lived on the fleet and then on the fishing, and the fishing no longer needs rope of that length.
- 22 AN GEARRAN 685 DE** — *Wave at Cnoc chaol* (Cnoc chaol). A great swell, with no storm behind it, runs up the beach at Cnoc chaol on the south coast and carries off the drying racks and two children. The village moves its racks further up the shore.
- II AN T-SAMHAIN 692 DE** — *The market of the eastern road* (Baile Mòr dhìreach). Baile Mòr dhìreach, the citadel on the eastern straight road, is given a market for the east coast. The fish and sail-cloth of the coast towns meet the furs, hides and dyes of the hills there, and the dyers of Baile Mòr ruadh sell their colours nowhere else.
- 23 AM MÀRT 700 DE** — *The two counts reconciled* (Muileann dhearg). The vein-house and the crown's scribes find that their counts of years since the Setting-Out differ, and settle the difference by agreement. The day of the empty-harbour rite, which each count had placed differently, is fixed by the same agreement, and later scribes stop pretending it was fixed by evidence.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 730 DE** — *The druid school at Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). A house of disputation is founded at Inis mhòr by pupils of Dùn thais, and the question of the vein is argued in the north for the first time. Its first master, Fionnlagh mac Aonghais, is remembered for refusing every answer offered him.
- 10 AN GEARRAN 730 DE** — *Queen Eilidh Bhàn crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Eilidh Bhàn, the fifth ruler of the house of Catriona, is crowned at Cathair dhearg. The record of her long reign is almost entirely one of harvests.
- 22 AN GEARRAN 730 DE** — *The bath-house at the hot springs* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). Clann Choinnich rebuilds the old bath-house over the hot springs of Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh in dressed stone and admits the sick of any house on one day in seven. The house's physicians keep a book of cures that is later lost.

- 24 AM FAOILLEACH 745 DE** — *The sea-thieves of the north-west* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Boats working out of the small islands off the north-west coast begin taking fish and grain from coasting traders. The sea-thieves are Ròdaich, men of the north-west shore, and the harbour rolls give some of their names.
- 26 AN DÙBHLACHD 750 DE** — *Baile chrom half empty* (Baile chrom). The reeve of Baile chrom on the north-west coast reports half the town's houses empty, their families gone east after the sea-thieves and the poor harvests. The crown remits the town's grain dues.
- 27 AN T-SAMHAIN 762 DE** — *The raid on Eilean dhubh* (Eilean dhubh). A force sent by Queen Eilidh Bhàn lands on Eilean dhubh and burns the sea-thieves' boats on the strand. Their leader, Uilleam Ruadh, is taken to Cathair dhearg and hanged.
- 19 AN GIBLEAN 780 DE** — *The dearth on the north-west shore* (Gorta Baile chrom). A run of failed harvests along the north-west shore brings a dearth that the shared-meal custom cannot carry. Families leave the coast for the interior and the east, and the north-west is thinly held from this time until the end of the age.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 790 DE** — *The king-list recopied* (Cathair dhearg). The scribes of Queen Eilidh Bhàn recopy the king-list of Rodos from its oldest surviving roll, adding the rulers since the Sundering. The new copy begins its account of the present age with the Choosing and not with the fleet.
- 19 AN GEARRAN 796 DE** — *The strand-market at Àth fhionn* (Àth fhionn). Àth fhionn, the ford town where the coast road crosses the clear river, holds a market on the strand for the north coast. Fish, the flesh and oil of stranded whales, wool and barley are sold there, and the fishers of the north coast stop carrying their catch to Inis mhòr.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 802 DE** — *Eilidh Bhàn dies without an heir* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Eilidh Bhàn dies at Cathair dhearg with no child, and the house of Catrìona ends with her. The seven houses meet at the vein-house rather than at the capital.
- 23 AM MÀRT 807 DE** — *Dòmhnall Ruadh crowned* (Cathair dhearg). The houses name Dòmhnall Ruadh of Clann Raghnaill, a descendant of the claimant killed at Muileann chrom. He is crowned at Cathair dhearg and keeps the mastery of the vein-house as well as the crown.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 820 DE** — *The crown and the custody joined* (Muileann dhearg). Dòmhnall Ruadh's reeves write it into the custody-book that the ruler of Rodos is also master of the vein-house. From this time the heads of the seven houses sit as the king's council, and the custodian class and the court are one body.
- I AN T-ÒGMHIOS 826 DE** — *The custody's seal on the king's letters* (Muileann dhearg). From the joining of the crown and the custody the king's letters are sealed with the vein-house's own seal: a trellis of gold on blue, which the custodians read as the galleries of the mountain, with a hollow lozenge over it for Crom's slab, laid on the first break. The crown adds a white band across the field and nothing else. From this time the seal is the arms of the kingdom.

- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 832 DE** — *Death of Dòmhnall Ruadb* (Cathair dhearg). Dòmhnall Ruadh, the first ruler to hold both the crown and the vein-house, dies at Cathair dhearg and is buried at Muileann dhearg. His son Ragnall Òg is crowned.
- 20 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 850 DE** — *The schism of the Hawk* (Cnoc bheag). A council of the Hawk at Cnoc bheag divides over whether Mòd's measure may ever be raised. Those who hold it fixed forever keep the name of the Hungry Hawk and the house at Cnoc bheag; those who hold that a larger flock may be fed a larger handful are called the Fed Hawk.
- 17 AN LÙNASTAL 860 DE** — *The harbour of Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). The port of Seann Chwen builds its harbour mole, and becomes the port for the ore-carts coming down from the mountain to the coast towns of the south.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 870 DE** — *The Fed Hawk at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). The priests of the Fed Hawk, turned out of Cnoc bheag, settle at Seann Skell on the north coast, not the western river port of that name. Their teaching is written in the custody-book as an error, and the error is recorded at length.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 880 DE** — *The Fed Hawk's petition* (Seann Skell). The Fed Hawk petitions the king's council from Seann Skell to raise the measured handful by a quarter for the hearths of the north coast. The council refuses. The petition is the first recorded request to alter the Small-Burning Law.
- 14 AN DÀMHAIR 890 DE** — *The gallery at Cill ghlas* (Cill ghlas). A second tremor in the hills of Cill ghlas brings down a gallery of the vein and kills fourteen custodians' labourers. The vein-house closes the gallery and sets a stone at its mouth with the fourteen names.
- 12 AN T-SAMHAIN 900 DE** — *The ore-roads kept by the crown* (Cathair dhearg). The king's council takes the roads from the mountain to the coast into the keeping of the crown, so that the carts carrying the measured ore to the temples may not be stopped by any house. The roads are marked with posts bearing the crown's sign: the carriers' road down to Cathair dhearg, An Rathad Tuath over the pass by Muileann fhada, Slighe Muileann dhearg south from the hills by Muileann chrom, and Slighe Baile òg down to the southern Seann Skell.
- 17 AN GEARRAN 905 DE** — *The crown's riders* (Cathair dhearg). Fresh horses are kept for the crown's riders at the waypoint houses on the ore-roads. A rider who changes horses at every house can carry the council's word from Cathair dhearg to the mountain between dawn and dark. The houses are paid for the stabling out of the ore-road tolls.
- 17 AN LÙNASTAL 910 DE** — *The high pastures of Doire uaine abandoned* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). The last shepherd families leave the high pastures of the Doire uaine hills for the valley villages. The reason given is the grazing; everyone asked also mentions the Marbh-bheò.
- 9 AN LÙNASTAL 920 DE** — *The salt fair at Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). Ros fhionn holds its great salt fair, and the reeve's count is some four thousand people on the flats in a single day. It is the town's height, and the chronicle calls it the richest place in the north-east.

- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 930 DE** — *Cathair mhòr the largest town* (Cathair mhòr). Cathair mhòr passes the capital in size, its market drawing trade from the whole south of the island. The capital remains the seat of the crown and the smaller place.
- 18 AN T-SULTAIN 940 DE** — *The stair at Toll-dubh* (Toll-dubh). Quarrymen north of the capital break into Toll-dubh, the shaft of the old tellings, long lost, and find a stair cut into the rock going down beyond their lamps. The custodians of the vein-house have the entrance walled up; the one quarryman who went down is not recorded as saying what he saw.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 955 DE** — *The copper-workers of Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). Copper-workers at Cathair mhòr begin making cooking pots that are sold on every road on the island. The pots are marked with the maker's sign, and some survive in the ground.
- 31 AM FAOILLEACH 960 DE** — *Ailean measures Làrach an Teampaill* (Làrach an Teampaill). Ailean mac Dhùghaill, a scholar of the druid school at Dùn thais, measures the ruin of Làrach an Teampaill and writes that its altar faces the central mountains and not the sea. He declines to guess who set it so.
- 20 AN T-IUCHAR 972 DE** — *Ailean's tables of the old ruins* (Làrach an Dùin-fhaire). Ailean mac Dhùghaill completes his tables of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, Làrach an Dùin and Làrach an Teampaill, giving their measures, their stone and the lie of each. He concludes that he cannot say whether one people built all three, and his tables are the reason later scholars could not say either.
- 23 AM FAOILLEACH 980 DE** — *Queen Mòrag Ruadh crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Mòrag Ruadh, of Clann Raghnaill, is crowned at Cathair dhearg. She is the first ruler whose household accounts survive whole.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 995 DE** — *The obelisk at Carragh Cnoc bheag cleaned* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). The priests of the Hawk at Cnoc bheag clear the moss from the obelisk of Carragh Cnoc bheag and try to read the old letters on it. They cannot, and they record the attempt.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 1000 DE** — *Caol shean's fishing year* (Caol shean). Caol shean, whose boats fish the east coast from the mouth of the Abhainn chaol, lands the largest catch in its roll, so large that salt runs short and half is dried in the wind. The dried fish sells poorly and the town goes back to salting.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 1000 DE** — *The thousandth year* (Seann Skell). The vein-house marks the thousandth year of its count with a single measured burning of the ore on Cidhe an Di-osail at Seann Skell. Queen Mòrag Ruadh attends. The record says the flame burned the colour of the vein and that the crowd went home without a word.
- 28 AN GIBLEAN 1012 DE** — *The market above the mill-race* (Cnoc bhàn). The hill-lords of Baile ghorm hold a market at Cnoc bhàn, above the long mill-race of Muileann fhada, for the farms of the south-east. Grain, clay and honey are its common goods. Its rare good is pearls, which the women of the shore take from the mussel beds in the shallows and which are sold in no other market.

- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 1025 DE** — *The blue dyers of Baile ghorm* (Baile ghorm). The dyers of Baile ghorm in the south-east make a fast blue from a marsh plant and a mordant of their own. Cloth of Baile ghorm blue becomes the dress of the seven houses on feast days.
- 29 AN LÙNASTAL 1040 DE** — *The swallowing cough at Muileann dhomhain* (Muileann dhomhain). A sickness that closes the throat breaks out at Muileann dhomhain and moves along the coast road. The town loses near a third of its people.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 1042 DE** — *The cough at Seann Bhral* (Seann Bhral). The swallowing cough reaches the port of Seann Bhral. The harbour is closed by the townsfolk themselves, and the shared-meal custom is kept by leaving food at the town's gate.
- 7 AN T-IUCHAR 1043 DE** — *Queen Beathag Fhionn's closing of the roads* (Cathair dhearg). Beathag Fhionn, crowned after her mother Mòrag, closes the coast road between Seann Bhral and Muileann dhomhain and sets reeves at the fords to turn back travellers. The cough goes no further west.
- 5 AN LÙNASTAL 1065 DE** — *Muileann dhomhain resettled* (Muileann dhomhain). Muileann dhomhain, emptied by the swallowing cough, is resettled by families from the hills around it, who take the empty houses by lot. The town's older families say they never again knew half their neighbours.
- 13 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1080 DE** — *Drochaid Ros fhionn repaired* (Drochaid Ros fhionn). The arches of Drochaid Ros fhionn, worn by seven centuries of salt carts, are rebuilt at the cost of the Ros fhionn salt-masters. Their names are cut on the keystones.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 1090 DE** — *Death of Queen Beathag Fhionn* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Beathag Fhionn, who closed the coast road against the cough, dies at Cathair dhearg. Her son Ailean is crowned, the first of four kings of that name in the house of Raghnaill.
- 13 AN MÀRT 1100 DE** — *The Baile ghorm blue fades* (Baile ghorm). The last dyer who knew the Baile ghorm mordant dies without apprentices, having quarrelled with both of hers. The blue that comes after is the ordinary blue of the rest of the island.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 1110 DE** — *The ancestor-posts of Dùn ìseal burned* (Dùn ìseal). The ancestor-posts at Dùn ìseal burn in a lightning fire. The keepers recut the names from memory and from the custody-book, and admit in their roll that some are guesses.
- 29 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1120 DE** — *The silting of Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). The Abhainn bheag silts up behind a shifting bar below Ros fhionn, and the salt barges can no longer reach the quays. The salt-masters move their trade to Caol gharbh on the coast.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1130 DE** — *Caol gharbh takes the salt* (Caol gharbh). Caol gharbh, a fishing village, becomes the salt port of the north-east, and its harbour is dug out and walled with the Ros fhionn masters' money.

- 25 AN DÙBHLACHD 1130 DE** — *The stone on the neck* (Coinneachadh na h-Amhaich). Caol gharbh and Caol chrom, the two harbours of the strait, send their headmen to a stone on the neck of land between them and settle the dues the salt-boats pay to each. They meet at the same stone over every quarrel about the strait after, and it is called Coinneachadh na h-Amhaich, the meeting of the neck.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 1140 DE** — *Traffic falls on Drochaid Ros fhionn* (Drochaid Ros fhionn). With the salt going by sea from Caol gharbh, the carts stop crossing Drochaid Ros fhionn. The bridge-keeper's office is abolished, and the bridge is little used from this time.
- 16 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1145 DE** — *The market-court stays at Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). The salt-masters take their ships to Caol gharbh but leave their market-court on the headland at Ros fhionn, where the weights and the tally-sticks are kept. The farms and forges of the north-eastern hills go on bringing their goods to it, and the town keeps its market after it has lost its harbour.
- 25 AM MÀRT 1150 DE** — *Seòlaid Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). With the salt of Ros fhionn going by sea, its boats run down the river past Caol gharbh, round the north-east cape, south along the eastern shore past Seann Tarr and Àth bheag, and back west into the bay below Caol shean, where the salt goes inland. The lane is called Seòlaid Ros fhionn after the town whose salt made it, and the eastern boats keep it long after the salt-pans fail.
- 15 AN T-IUCHAR 1150 DE** — *The millers of Muileann shean* (Muileann shean). The mills of Muileann shean are fitted with a new kind of gearing, cut in oak, that turns two stones from one wheel. The gearing spreads to the mills of the north within a lifetime.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 1160 DE** — *The Sea-Watcher off the north-west* (Uilebheist na Mara). Fishers from the thinned north-west coast report the Sea-Watcher, Uilebheist na Mara, close enough to foul their nets. The few boats still working those waters draw further in.
- 29 AN T-SAMHAIN 1170 DE** — *The table of years at Dùn thais* (Dùn thais). A scholar of the druid school at Dùn thais, Raghnaill mac Chaluim, sets out a table showing that the heads of the custodian houses live on average a few years longer than the tenants of their lands. He asks whether the vein answers the hand that holds it. The record notes the finding with unease and without an answer.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 1180 DE** — *The table forbidden* (Muileann dhearg). The king's council forbids the copying of Raghnaill mac Chaluim's table of years, and the house of disputation at Dùn thais is closed for a generation. Raghnaill's own copy is kept in the vein-house and entered in its inventory.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 1190 DE** — *The great gale at Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). A gale out of the north-east drives the sea up the river at Inis mhòr before the autumn grain fleet has sailed, higher than anyone then living had seen it. Boats are crushed at their moorings and the grain fleet does not sail until the spring.

- 3 AN T-SULTAIN 1207 DE** — *Baile ruadh's quarrel with Achadh naomh* (Baile ruadh). Baile ruadh and Achadh naomh in the far north-east go to law over the grazing on the hills between them. The case is heard three times at Cathair dhearg and settled by dividing the hills along a stream.
- 10 AN T-SAMHAIN 1220 DE** — *Pilgrims at Allt an Àigh* (Allt an Àigh). The keepers of the Old Spirits renew the pilgrimage to Allt an Àigh, and a guest-house is built beside the stream for those who come to drink at the proper phase of the moon. The guest-house book records pilgrims from every shire.
- 7 AN T-IUCHAR 1227 DE** — *Death of King Ailean mac Raghnaill* (Cathair dhearg). King Ailean mac Raghnaill dies at Cathair dhearg, leaving two sons of different mothers, Iain Ciar and Alasdair Bàn, each of whom has been told he is the heir.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1231 DE** — *The battle of Cnoc naomh* (Cnoc naomh). The brothers' war opens when Alasdair Bàn's men seize Cnoc naomh and Iain Ciar retakes it. The houses divide, four to three, and Cogadh nam Bràithrean, the Brothers' War, is named from this battle.
- 17 AN LÙNASTAL 1233 DE** — *The fire at Ceann mhin* (Ceann mhin). Alasdair Bàn's ships burn the waterfront of Ceann mhin, which held for his brother. The fire takes the rope stores and the granary, and the town begs its bread from Cathair mhòr.
- 19 AN T-IUCHAR 1235 DE** — *The battle of Muileann ghlas* (Muileann ghlas). Iain Ciar defeats Alasdair Bàn below Muileann ghlas. Alasdair is taken alive, and his captains are allowed to go home.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 1237 DE** — *The brothers' peace at An Taigh-seinnse Mòr* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). The brothers make peace at An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, on neutral ground between their lands. Alasdair Bàn gives up his claim and receives the lordship of Seann Chwen for life. Iain Ciar is crowned.
- 8 AN DÀMHAIR 1252 DE** — *Death of Alasdair Bàn* (Seann Chwen). Alasdair Bàn dies at Seann Chwen, having kept the peace he made. His lordship returns to the crown.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 1256 DE** — *White stone from Baile Mòr dhombhain* (Baile Mòr dhombhain). Masons from Ceann leathan buy a veined white stone from the hills above Baile Mòr dhombhain for the new front of their temple. The quarry is worked from this time on, and its marble goes south by the carriers' road to every town that can pay for it.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1260 DE** — *Iain Ciar's grain law* (Cathair dhearg). King Iain Ciar orders that every shire seat keep a year's grain in store against the next war, having seen Ceann mhin beg its bread. The law is enforced for as long as he lives.
- 14 AN LÙNASTAL 1265 DE** — *The account of the Brothers' War* (Cathair dhearg). A clerk of King Iain Ciar, Pàdraig mac Ruairidh, writes the account of the Brothers' War. It praises the king at every turn and is the only account that survives, which later readers have found inconvenient.

- 28 AN GIBLEAN 1280 DE** — *The inns of the mining roads chartered* (An Sligeanach Fad' às). The crown grants a charter to the seven great road-houses of the mining circuit, An Sligeanach Fad' às among them, making their keepers answerable for the roads between them. The keepers meet once a year at An Sligeanach Fad' às to settle their accounts.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1287 DE** — *Death of Iain Ciar* (Cathair dhearg). King Iain Ciar dies at Cathair dhearg. His grain law lapses within a few years of his death, as he had foreseen in a note in his own hand.
- 22 AM MÀRT 1300 DE** — *An Taigh-seinnse Òir's beef* (An Taigh-seinnse Òir). An Taigh-seinnse Òir, on the eastern end of the circuit, is written into the charter-roll as keeping syrupped beef for the custodians' reeves on their rounds. It is the first recorded dish of that house; the rest of the entry is a complaint about the price.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1310 DE** — *An Taigh-seinnse Reòta* (An Taigh-seinnse Reòta). An Taigh-seinnse Reòta, the road-house on the bare northern road, is snowed in for a whole season with a party of custodians' reeves inside. They live on its pickled spinach and fire milk, and their complaint to the charter-roll is recorded in full.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1320 DE** — *The bull that sank at launch* (Seann Skell). Seumas mac Iain, a boat-builder of Seann Skell, sets out to rebuild a deep-keeled hull from the scraps of the Sundering fellowship's lore still remembered on the strand. The hull fills and sinks at its launch, and Manannan's priests preach on it for a year.
- 31 AN CÈITEAN 1330 DE** — *The Caol iséal fishers go east* (Caol iséal). Fishing families of Caol iséal on the north coast move east to Caol bheag after their own harbour silts. Caol iséal becomes a farming town.
- 4 AN GEARRAN 1350 DE** — *The southern lane* (Caol fhiadhaich). The fishers of Caol fhiadhaich, on the wild strait of the west coast, take their boats round into the southern sea and along the whole south coast to the mouth of the Abhainn uaine, and up it to the landing of Cidhe Beag below Baile thais, where they sell dried fish for grain. The older harbours of the south coast, which had not sailed beyond their own capes, begin to follow them. The lane is named for its first sailors: Slighe-mhara Caol fhiadhaich.
- 5 AM MÀRT 1350 DE** — *The keel-song of Cuan shean* (Cuan shean). A folk-collector of the royal household, Iseabail nic Lachlainn, takes down a work-song still sung by the ropemakers of Cuan shean that names the parts of a deep keel. Half its words have no meaning to anyone who sings it. It is the only record of the Sundering fleet's techniques that survives in any form.
- 25 AN DÙBHLACHD 1350 DE** — *The Stone's schism at Inis thais* (Inis thais). The Stone's congregation at Inis thais divides over whether the dead may be prayed for at Clach. Those who say not keep the temple; the others build a second house at Baile gheal.
- 3 AN GEARRAN 1360 DE** — *The grey storm at Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). A storm named Gaillleann Ghlas comes in from the east and destroys the harbour of Seann Tarr. The village is rebuilt, but the harbour is not, and its boats move to Cuan ruadh.

- 8 AN LÙNASTAL 1360 DE** — *The second wolf-house at Baile gheal* (Baile gheal). The dissenters from Inis thais raise their house at Baile gheal and pray there for the dead by name. The two houses of the Stone are not reconciled in this age.
- 29 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1370 DE** — *Cuan ruadh's new harbour* (Cuan ruadh). Cuan ruadh builds a second harbour arm to take the boats from Seann Tarr. The town prospers on the east-coast fishing for the rest of the age.
- 31 AN CÈITEAN 1390 DE** — *Queen Catriona Bheag crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Catriona Bheag, of Clann Raghnaill, is crowned at Cathair dhearg, the first queen in more than three centuries. The record notes that she was small, and that no one said so twice.
- 26 AN LÙNASTAL 1400 DE** — *The grey glaze of Muileann gheal* (Muileann gheal). The potters of Muileann gheal make a grey-green glaze that no other kiln on the island can match, and the custodian houses buy it for their tables. The secret is kept within one family, Clann Mhic Phàil.
- 28 AN T-IUCHAR 1410 DE** — *The oath of the seven* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Catriona Bheag has the heads of the seven houses swear to the ruling of the hearth in her presence, the first renewal of the oath since Catriona Bhuadhach. Clann Choinnich swears last.
- 14 AM MÀRT 1420 DE** — *Macha's great house at Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). The priests of Macha raise their great house at Cathair mhòr, the largest roofed building on Rodos in this age. Its black and white floor took eleven years to lay.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1430 DE** — *The eastern Toll-dubh* (Toll-dubh). Charcoal-burners in the east find again the eastern Toll-dubh of the old tellings, with the same cut stair as the one walled up in the west. The custodians wall this one too, and the two entries in the custody-book are cross-referenced by the scribe.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 1440 DE** — *The dry years at Achadh shean* (Tiormachd Achadh shean). Three dry seasons in succession empty the wells of the eastern shires around Achadh shean. The shared-meal custom holds, and grain is carted in from the south by the crown.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 1450 DE** — *The water-rights of Achadh shean* (Achadh shean). The reeves of Achadh shean divide the use of the deep wells among the households by lot and by turn, and write the division on a board at the well-head. The board is renewed each generation and the lots are never redrawn.
- 24 AN T-SULTAIN 1460 DE** — *The firlot of Àth shean* (Àth shean). The granary of Àth shean discovers its firlot has been worn smaller than the standard of Cathair dhearg, and has been for generations. The reeve's accounts are corrected back as far as anyone can reckon.
- 30 AN DÙBHLACHD 1470 DE** — *The grey glaze lost* (Muileann gheal). The last of Clann Mhic Phàil dies at Muileann gheal without passing on the glaze. Potters of the town try for a generation to match it and fail.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 1480 DE** — *Baile Mòr ruadh's fair* (Baile Mòr ruadh). Baile Mòr ruadh in the east holds a cattle fair drawing drovers from Àth chiar and the eastern hills. The fair becomes yearly and is the largest in the east.

- 9 **AN T-IUCHAR 1490 DE** — *Queen Sileas Òg crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Sileas Òg, of Clann Raghnaill, is crowned at Cathair dhearg, named for the queen of the firloot. She is the first ruler in the record to have visited every shire seat.
- 4 **AN DÀMHAIR 1500 DE** — *Sileas Òg's census of hands* (Muileann dhearg). Queen Sileas Òg orders a new count of every household holding the right to the ore. The count is smaller than any before it, the right having narrowed into fewer and larger households, and the queen has it entered without comment.
- 5 **AN T-SULTAIN 1510 DE** — *The fire of Ceann mhin* (Ceann mhin). A second great fire burns Ceann mhin, this time without a war to blame. The town is rebuilt with stone gable walls between houses by order of its reeve.
- 31 **AN LÙNASTAL 1520 DE** — *The silver smelt refused* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). Clann Choinnich asks leave to burn the ore beyond the measured handful to smelt silver at Muileann chiar, on the ground that the ore burns hotter than charcoal. The council refuses. It is the first request to burn the ore for work rather than worship.
- 22 **AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1530 DE** — *The lost smithing at Dùn dhearg* (Dùn dhearg). The smiths of Dùn dhearg, who had made the custodian houses' ceremonial blades since the walls were built, lose the last man who knew how their layered steel was folded. Later blades from Dùn dhearg are ordinary.
- 2 **AN DÙBHLACHD 1540 DE** — *The houses bury at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). The custodian houses begin to bury their heads at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach, among graves older than any name on them. The tenants of the surrounding land call it an unwise thing to do and continue to bury their own dead elsewhere.
- 9 **AN T-IUCHAR 1550 DE** — *King Ailean the Fourth crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Ailean mac Raghnaill, the fourth king of that name, is crowned at Cathair dhearg. He is remembered only because his reign is the shortest in the king-list.
- 13 **AN GIBLEAN 1551 DE** — *The synod of Manannan's order* (Seann Skell). The priests of Manannan meet at Seann Skell and restate the rule of sight-of-land. They add a prayer, said at the foot of the river pool, asking Manannan to keep the sea shut: A Mhanannain, cùm a' mhuir dùinte.
- 12 **AN CÈITEAN 1551 DE** — *Queen Mòrag nic Ailein crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Ailean's sister Mòrag nic Ailein is crowned after him. She reigns for forty years and leaves the king-list its longest run of entries recording nothing but good harvests and the rite.
- 16 **AN T-SAMHAIN 1580 DE** — *The ferry at Cidhe Beag* (Cidhe Beag). A ferry family sets up at Cidhe Beag on Abhainn uaine, taking passengers and goods down the river by canoe. The family holds the landing for the rest of the age.
- 1 **AN DÀMHAIR 1587 DE** — *The dark wine of Àth shean* (Àth shean). The growers on the slopes above Àth shean press blaeberry and bramble into a dark wine that keeps a year in the cask. It is sold along the eastern road, and the road-houses serve it as black wine.

- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 1595 DE** — *Inis mhòr's grain fleet laid up* (Inis mhòr). The coasting grain barges of Inis mhòr, which had sailed Slighe-uisce fhuar, the cold way along the north coast from Ros chiar to Caol mhin, since the Holy Age, are laid up for good as the roads improve. The last of them is kept on the strand as a curiosity.
- 7 AN LÙNASTAL 1610 DE** — *Earthquake at Dùn ìseal* (Dùn ìseal). An earthquake shakes Dùn ìseal and cracks the spirit-house. No one is killed, and the keepers read it as a warning without being able to agree what of.
- 21 AN CÈITEAN 1620 DE** — *Beathag nic Thòmais gathers the old copies* (Muileann chaol). Beathag nic Thòmais, a mill-owner's widow of Muileann chaol, begins to buy up old copies of the custody-book and the harbour rolls from the houses that no longer read them. She keeps them in a loft over her mill.
- 28 AM FAOILLEACH 1635 DE** — *The paper mill at Muileann chaol* (Muileann chaol). A mill at Muileann chaol begins making paper from rags, the first on Rodos. The custody-book is copied onto paper for the first time in this generation.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1640 DE** — *Three copies of the landfall report* (Muileann chaol). Among her papers Beathag nic Thòmais finds three copies of the report of the two landfalls. They differ in the order of the coasts and in the number of hulls. She writes out all three side by side and does not choose between them.
- 3 AN CÈITEAN 1655 DE** — *The north-west coast charted* (Baile chrom). The crown sends a reeve to list the households of the thinned north-west coast between Baile chrom and Ceann mhòr. He counts fewer households than there are harbour berths.
- 24 AN LÙNASTAL 1660 DE** — *The loft at Muileann chaol* (Muileann chaol). Beathag nic Thòmais dies and leaves her loft of papers to the town of Muileann chaol, on condition that nothing in it is burned. The town keeps the condition and very little else of her wishes.
- 6 AM MÀRT 1670 DE** — *King Tormod mac Ruairidh crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Tormod mac Ruairidh, of Clann Raghnaill, is crowned at Cathair dhearg. His reign is remembered for its roads and for its length.
- 5 AN GEARRAN 1675 DE** — *Manannan's harbour prayer* (Seann Skell). The priests of Manannan at Seann Skell begin saying their prayer to keep the sea shut on the same day as the empty-harbour rite, so that the two are kept together on Cidhe an Diosail. Neither side is pleased.
- 6 AM MÀRT 1680 DE** — *Tormod's bridges* (Cnoc ìseal). King Tormod has stone bridges built across the fords of the south-central shires, one of them at Cnoc ìseal. Ferry-keepers who lose their living are given land in compensation.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 1690 DE** — *The panther year* (Imrich nam Pantar). The panthers cross the southern roads in numbers no herder can remember, and for a whole season the crossing days run into one another. Flocks are kept in folds from Cnoc àrsaidh to the coast.

- 10 AN T-SAMHAIN 1695 DE** — *Caol gharbh loses the salt* (Caol gharbh). The salt pans of Caol gharbh fail as the sea rises over them, and salt comes to the north-east from the south instead. The town that took Ros fhionn's trade is poorer than Ros fhionn had been.
- 12 AN DÀMHAIR 1700 DE** — *Storm at Baile ghorm* (Baile ghorm). A south-westerly storm floods the low town of Baile ghorm and drowns twenty-three. The town raises its sea-wall by the height of a man.
- 22 AN CÈITEAN 1710 DE** — *The rite kept by few* (Seann Skell). The empty-harbour rite on Cidhe an Diosail at Seann Skell is kept by the harbour priests and a few old families. A visiting scribe writes that no one present could say on which day the fleet had actually sailed.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 1715 DE** — *Cuan dhearg flooded again* (Cuan dhearg). The sea comes over the waterfront of Cuan dhearg a second time, and the street moved back after An Gàire Dubh is flooded to the thresholds. The town builds a sea-wall and does not move again.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1720 DE** — *The house at Dùn thais reopened* (Dùn thais). The house of disputation at Dùn thais, closed and reopened more than once since the table of years, is opened again on condition that the question of longer lives is not raised. The druids of the schools accept the condition and argue about the vein instead.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 1727 DE** — *Death of King Tormod* (Cathair dhearg). King Tormod mac Ruairidh dies at Cathair dhearg after a reign of more than fifty years. His daughter Gormshuil nic Thormoid is crowned.
- 12 AN GIBLEAN 1732 DE** — *Queen Gormshuil's progress* (Cathair dhearg). Queen Gormshuil nic Thormoid makes a progress round every shire seat on the island, the first ruler to do so since Sileas Òg. Her clerks record the grievances of each shire and the queen answers none of them in writing.
- 5 AN GEARRAN 1737 DE** — *The second silver petition* (Muileann dhearg). Clann Choinnich again asks to burn the ore beyond the measure for the silver smelt at Muileann chiar, now with the support of three of the seven houses. Queen Gormshuil's council refuses by one voice. The record gives the name of the member who changed his vote and not his reason.
- 25 AN MÀRT 1747 DE** — *An Taigh-òsta Grianach's spinach* (An Taigh-òsta Grianach). An Taigh-òsta Grianach, on the eastern road, is recorded in the charter-roll as feeding the queen's progress with pan-fried spinach and black wine. The keeper, Peigi nic Dhonnchaidh, is excused her road dues for a year.
- 27 AN GEARRAN 1752 DE** — *The last census of hands* (Muileann dhearg). The vein-house counts the households holding the right to the ore for the last time in this age. They are fewer than at any count before, and larger. The custody-book notes that three of the seven houses now hold more than half the right between them.
- 22 AN CÈITEAN 1755 DE** — *Timber from the west* (Ceann mhòr). A worked timber, longer than any tree on the island and fastened with nails of a make no smith on Rodos recognizes, comes ashore at Ceann mhòr on the north-west coast, from beyond Manannan's mist, as the fishers say. It is carried to Seann Skell, shown to Manannan's priests, and burned.

- 24 AN DÀMHAIR 1760 DE** — *The lamps at Seann Skell go out* (Seann Skell). The night of lamps is kept at Seann Skell by fewer and fewer houses, and at last by none on the waterfront. An old woman sets a lamp in a window of the harbour-house, and the scribe records that it was she and not the town.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1764 DE** — *The empty-harbour rite, last entry of the age* (Seann Skell). The empty-harbour rite is kept at Seann Skell by eleven people. The harbour scribe enters their number, the weather and the state of the tide, and nothing else.
- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 1767 DE** — *The silver petition laid aside* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). Clann Choinnich does not bring its silver petition to the council again, the member who had turned it having died. The petition is left in the vein-house unanswered, and the record of the age ends with the Small-Burning Law still kept.
- 27 AN DÀMHAIR 1774 DE** — *The mist thins* (Seann Skell). The priests of Manannan at Seann Skell record that the mist on the western sea, which has hidden Rodos from every ship beyond it since the fleet of the Sundering sailed into it, lies thinner each winter. They say their prayer, A Mhanannain, cùm a' mhuir dùinte, at every tide, and the fishers of the west coast begin to see the line of the open sea beyond the headlands on still mornings.

AGE IV · AN AOIS CHOIGREACH

- 5 AM FAOILLEACH 1780 DE** — *The Crossing*. Humans make landfall on Rodos, bringing their Church with them, and are granted permission to stay — the first contact since the Sundering.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 1780 DE** — *The ships met off the north-west* (Coinneachadh nan Long). That winter the mist that had lain on the western sea since the fleet of the Sundering sailed into it lifts. Two fishing boats out of Achadh àrsaidh, working the water off the north-west cape where the Sea-Watcher is seen, meet three ships coming out of the thin grey of it from the west and hail them. Neither side understands the other. The fishers turn south and the ships follow them down the coast toward Cuan shean. The fishers call the place of the meeting Coinneachadh nan Long, the meeting of the ships, and the boats of Achadh àrsaidh still slow there.
- 5 AN GEARRAN 1780 DE** — *Three ships off Cuan shean* (Cuan shean). Three ships out of the west anchor off Cuan shean, the first hulls of their size seen from Rodos since the Sundering fleet. Their master, a captain the record calls Edmund Harrow, comes ashore unarmed with eleven men and asks by signs for water.
- 16 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1780 DE** — *Forty days on the dunes* (Cuan shean). The custodians of Cuan shean send inland to the capital for counsel rather than decide alone. For forty days the strangers are fed on the beach and not allowed beyond the dunes.
- 10 AN T-IUCHAR 1780 DE** — *The custodian of Baile fhiadhaich rides south* (Baile fhiadhaich). Word of the ships reaches Baile fhiadhaich, up the western coast, in three days. Its custodian rides south to see them for himself and writes to the council that the strangers' ropes are better than ours and their manners worse.
- 11 AM FAOILLEACH 1781 DE** — *The Council of Custodians grants leave* (Cathair dhearg). The Council of Custodians at Cathair dhearg, which has sat in the crown's place since the crown fell vacant at the close of the Sundering age, under the high custodian Tormod mac Ailein, confirms the strangers' leave to stay. The council roll records the vote as unanimous; a later hand has written in the margin that three custodians were absent.
- 9 AN GEARRAN 1781 DE** — *The quarter of sea they came from* (Cuan shean). Old sailors at Cuan shean remark that the strangers came in from the same quarter of sea the Sundering fleet once sailed into. The council forbids the remark in its hall. It is written down anyway, and never answered.
- 26 AN GEARRAN 1781 DE** — *The land beyond*. The strangers name their homeland in their own tongue, but no Ròdaich scribe sets the word down. From the first season the record calls it an Tìr Thall, the land beyond, and calls its people simply the humans.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1781 DE** — *The first translation attempts*. Clerics of the humans' Church and Rodian custodians spend a full season trying to build a shared vocabulary. Neither side's account of what was actually agreed to survives intact.

- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 1781 DE** — *Wren's word-lists* (Cathair dhearg). The humans' cleric Samuel Wren and the custodian Gormshuil nic Fhearchair keep parallel word-lists through the season of translation. Wren's list survives in the Administration's letter-books. Gormshuil's was lost; only its first leaf, with forty words for the colours of broken ore, is known from a copy.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 1782 DE** — *One word for the ore* (Cathair dhearg). The humans have a single word for the black ore, and it is the word for the fuel they burn at home. Gormshuil's copyist notes that no Ròda's word in either list answers to it, and that the humans did not ask for one.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1782 DE** — *Trade begins*. Early exchange is genuinely reciprocal: Rodian goods for tools and knowledge the isolated island lacks. For a few years, the arrangement looks sustainable.
- 22 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1782 DE** — *The trading post at Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). The humans set up a trading post at Ros dhomhain, the capital's harbour: iron tools, window glass, lamp-oil and paper against wool, salt fish, hides and dyed cloth. The first tally-book of the post, kept by the trader Thomas Pike, balances evenly across its first year.
- 21 AN T-IUCHAR 1782 DE** — *The first hull on Loch chrom* (Abhainn gheal). Pilots of Caol leathan bring the first of the strangers' ships up the Abhainn gheal into Loch chrom, towing her through the shallows below Baile ghlas with boats. She anchors off Ros dhomhain. From then on the humans' goods come to the capital shore by water, and the pilots charge a stranger's hull twice the toll of a Ròdaich boat.
- 19 AN LÙNASTAL 1782 DE** — *Cathair naomh sends its wool* (Cathair naomh). Cathair naomh, the city above Seann Toll on the northern coast, sends its first wool south to the humans' post by coasting boat. Its custodians ask for their payment in paper and ink, and use it to begin the town's roll afresh.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1782 DE** — *Iron in the smithies* (Cathair dhearg). The smiths of Cathair dhearg take the humans' bar-iron gladly and learn to temper it in a winter. Within a few seasons the old bronze hoes are melted down for bells.
- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 1783 DE** — *Dyes for Baile Mòr mhòr* (Baile Mòr mhòr). The weavers of Baile Mòr mhòr, on the northern coast, trade their cloth for the humans' dyes, a red and a blue brighter than any the island could make. Within a few years the old madder fields around the town are let go to grass.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 1783 DE** — *Harrow's second voyage* (Cuan shean). Harrow sails west with hides and dyed cloth and returns with four ships instead of three. He brings carpenters, a surgeon, and a letter from a trading house in an Tìr Thall asking what else the island has.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 1783 DE** — *The shipwrights of Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). The shipwrights of Inis mhòr come to look at the humans' hulls and measure them with knotted cords. Their guild had built nothing larger than a coaster since the fleet of the Sundering, and its old methods of building for deep water had been half forgotten.

- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 1783 DE** — *The surgeon Jonas Tull* (Cuan shean). The humans' surgeon, Jonas Tull, sets the broken leg of a Cuan shean fisherman who had been given up as lame. The town's custodian enters it in the roll as the first debt owed to a stranger.
- 30 AM MÀRT 1784 DE** — *Salt from Seann Warr* (Seann Warr). The salt-pans of Seann Warr begin selling to Pike's post by the barrel. It is the first Ròdaich trade the humans come back asking for twice.
- 14 AN GIBLEAN 1784 DE** — *Wool at Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). The walled harbour of Caol leathan sends its first wool-ship to the humans' post. Its merchants insist on being paid in iron by weight rather than in goods, and the post's tally-book notes that they are the hardest bargainers on the island.
- 22 AN GIBLEAN 1784 DE** — *The first mixed settlement*. A small coastal town accepts both Rodian and human residents under a single administration — an experiment later history will not repeat.
- 10 AN DÀMHAIR 1784 DE** — *Baile dhìreach under one council* (Baile dhìreach). The small port of Baile dhìreach, on the south-west coast, takes Ròdaich and human residents under a single council of six, three of each. Its founding compact is written twice, once in each tongue, the only such compact on record in the age.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 1784 DE** — *The first council of Baile dhìreach* (Baile dhìreach). The council is chaired in alternate years by the fisherman Iain mac Chaluim and the human carpenter William Rook. Harbour dues go half to the custodians at Cathair dhearg and half to the humans' post.
- 1 AM FAOILLEACH 1785 DE** — *Inis thais declines the compact* (Inis thais). The city of Inis thais, whose harbour lies a few miles from Baile dhìreach, is invited to join the joint council and declines. Its custodian writes that one town may be an experiment but two would be a policy.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 1785 DE** — *A supply ship lost on the western reefs* (Muir Mhanannain). A human supply ship strikes the reefs off the western coast in fog, and nine of her crew drown. Her master had been sailing by a chart drawn from memory, the humans' letter-books complain, on a coast lit only by the old driftwood fires.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1785 DE** — *The lighthouses proposed*. Human navigators, unused to Rodos's coastline, request permanent beacons. Ròdaich engineers agree, not yet understanding what the request will enable.
- 29 AM MÀRT 1785 DE** — *Surveying the beacon headlands* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The human navigator James Fenn and the Ròdaich mason Torcall Clachair walk the coast together to choose sites for the new beacons. They mark the five headlands of the old fires. Fenn's chart survives; Torcall's cairns mostly do not.

- 26 AN GIBLEAN 1786 DE** — *Fenn's line* (Ròdos). On the same survey James Fenn runs a line of sights across the whole island, from the open sea off the north-west, where ships from the west first raise the land, to the water off the eastern cape. He measures it at two hundred and twenty-one miles, some forty-five of them sea at the western end. It is the first measure of Rodos from side to side, and every chart the Company draws afterwards is scaled to it.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 1786 DE** — *A marriage in two tongues* (Baile dhìreach). At Baile dhìreach the net-maker Eilidh nic Ruairidh marries the human cooper Samuel Hale. The council enters the marriage in both its books, and the custodians at Cathair dhearg, asked for a ruling, send none.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1787 DE** — *The first written treaty*. Terms of the human presence are set down formally for the first time — in the humans' language only, a detail no one on the Rodian side objects to at the time.
- 7 AN CÈITEAN 1787 DE** — *The treaty signed at Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhearg). The treaty is signed in the council hall at Cathair dhearg by Tormod mac Ailein for the custodians and by Josiah Pell, newly come as the humans' first Commissioner, for the Administration. Tormod could not read the tongue it was written in. The record does not say who read it to him.
- 10 AN CÈITEAN 1788 DE** — *The Residency above Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). Josiah Pell builds a house of dressed stone on the rise above Ros dhomhain and calls it the Residency. Captain Harrow, no longer needed ashore, returns to the sea trade.
- 18 AN CÈITEAN 1788 DE** — *The Company chartered* (Ros dhomhain). Harrow and Pike form a trading house licensed by the Administration, known on Rodos simply as the Company. Its charter grants it first refusal on "all fuels, ores and minerals the island may yield."
- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 1788 DE** — *The warehouse at Cathair dhomhain* (Cathair dhomhain). The Company leases a stone warehouse at Cathair dhomhain, along the lake shore from the capital, to store tools out of reach of the harbour thieves of Ros dhomhain. It is the first building on Rodos the Company owns outright.
- 5 AN T-SAMHAIN 1788 DE** — *The strangers' fever* (Cuan shean). A fever comes ashore with a crowded ship at Cuan shean and runs down the west coast. Ninety-one Ròdaich are recorded dead and eleven humans. The custodians close the town to ships for a season, and Pell protests the closure in writing.
- 9 AN GEARRAN 1789 DE** — *The fever at Baile àrsaidh* (Baile àrsaidh). The strangers' fever reaches Baile àrsaidh, a day's walk up the coast, and kills its custodian and both of her sons. The town has no human residents at all, and the custodians of the west note the fact.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 1789 DE** — *The fever turned back at Cnoc àrsaidh* (Cnoc àrsaidh). At Cnoc àrsaidh in the south-west the townsfolk block the road with carts and turn back every traveller for a season. The fever does not reach them. The Administration fines the town for obstructing trade.

- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 1789 DE** — *Prospectors in the central hills* (Muileann chrom). The Company sends two prospectors, Abel Stone and Hugh Mercer, into the hills east of the capital. They return with sacks of broken ore and a report that the black seam runs "further than can be walked in a day."
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1790 DE** — *The sacks returned to the rock* (Muileann chrom). The custodians of the vein demand the broken ore back, to be laid in the rock again with the proper words. The Company returns half of it. The custodians' roll records the other half as "carried west."
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 1790 DE** — *First extraction contracts*. What begins as trade curdles into arrangement: Rodian labor mines the vein at a scale no reverent tradition ever used.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 1790 DE** — *The first pit at Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). Under the first contract a Ròdaich crew of thirty opens a working at Muileann chrom, paid by the ton in iron tools and lamp-oil. The custodians' own cuttings had never been measured by weight at all.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 1791 DE** — *An ore quay at Ceann fhada* (Ceann fhada). The Company builds a stone quay at Ceann fhada, a fishing hamlet below the hills, for loading ore onto coasting barges. The fishermen are paid for their foreshore in iron nails, by weight.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 1791 DE** — *Wren's grammar* (Ros dhomhain). Samuel Wren completes a grammar of Ròdais for the use of the Mission, the house of the humans' Church on Rodos. It is careful and accurate in most particulars, and it renders the word for the vein's custodians as "keepers of the coal."
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 1792 DE** — *The hawk-priests read Wren* (Cnoc bheag). The hawk-priests of Cnoc bheag ask the Mission for a copy of Wren's grammar so that they may read what the humans write about them. The Mission sends one. It is the most annotated copy to survive.
- 30 AN DÙBHLACHD 1792 DE** — *The Mission chapel* (Ros dhomhain). The Mission raises a timber chapel on the quay at Ros dhomhain, the first church on the island. Its bell is the first iron bell on the island, and the custodians ask that it not be rung before the fishing fleet is out.
- 29 AN MÀRT 1793 DE** — *The first refusal*. A single mining settlement declines to sign an extraction contract. It is quietly bypassed rather than punished — for now.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1793 DE** — *Beathag Dhubh of Doire mhòr* (Doire mhòr). The settlement that refused was Doire mhòr, in the hills above Muileann chrom, and its custodian was Beathag Dhubh. Her answer to the Company's agent survives only in his paraphrase: that the hill was not hers to sell and not his to buy.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1794 DE** — *The road around Doire mhòr* (Cnoc fhiadhaich). The Company opens its next working at Cnoc fhiadhaich instead, and runs its cart-road around Doire mhòr's fields rather than through them.

- 9 AN CÈITEAN 1794 DE** — *Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg lit* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The first of the new beacons is finished on the southern headland at Tobar dhearg, a round tower of grey stone raised over the old fire-tower, with a Ròdaich keeper, paid for by the Company. Torcall Clachair builds it; James Fenn sets its lens.
- 29 AM MÀRT 1795 DE** — *The first keeper of Tobar dhearg* (Tobar dhearg). The first keeper of the southern beacon is Anna nic Dhòmhnaill of Tobar dhearg village, a fisherman's widow, who climbs the tower twice a night for the rest of her life. The village takes the keepership as a trust and keeps it in its own families through the age.
- 10 AN GIBLEAN 1795 DE** — *Raiders in the north-western waters* (Spùinneadairean-mara). A Company brig is boarded off the north-west coast and stripped of her cargo of tools. The raiders are never identified; the Administration blames the custodians of the coast, and the custodians say the waters there have always had their own law.
- 5 AN GEARRAN 1796 DE** — *The obelisk at Cnoc bheag copied* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). Samuel Wren copies the inscription on the obelisk near Cnoc bheag and sends it west to the scholars of an Tìr Thall. No reply is recorded. The custodians tell him the stone is older than the Ròdaich and that nobody living can read it.
- 13 AN GEARRAN 1796 DE** — *The currency reform*. Human coinage is introduced alongside traditional barter, ostensibly for convenience. Within a decade it is the only accepted form of payment for anything requiring imported tools.
- 10 AN LÙNASTAL 1796 DE** — *The mark and its hundred pence* (Ros dhomhain). The coins are struck at Ros dhomhain from silver and copper shipped in from an Tìr Thall: the mark and its hundred pence. The first issue bears a ship on one face and nothing Rodian on either.
- 1 AM FAOILLEACH 1797 DE** — *Cathair mhòr refuses the mark* (Cathair mhòr). The market of Cathair mhòr, the largest below the hills east of the capital, refuses the humans' coin for a full year. The custodians of the town give way when the Company's tool-sellers refuse to cross their bridge.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 1797 DE** — *Two books at the capital market* (Cathair dhearg). At Cathair dhearg's market, tool-sellers take only marks, while cloth and fish still go by barter. The custodians' clerks begin keeping two sets of books, and complain of it in both.
- 3 AN DÙBHLACHD 1797 DE** — *Wren's winter at Dùn thais* (Dùn thais). At Dùn thais the masters of the druid school receive Samuel Wren for a winter of disputation. He asks them why the vein should be holy; they ask him why his fuel should be burned. Neither account of the winter records a winner.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1798 DE** — *Drochaid Cathair dhearg rebuilt* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). Company masons rebuild the old stone bridge over Abhainn dhomhain at Cathair dhearg in dressed stone, wide enough for ore-carts to pass two abreast.

- 30 AN T-SULTAIN 1798 DE** — *The Commissioner's carriage* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). Company wheelwrights build a closed carriage for Josiah Pell, and he drives in it over the rebuilt bridge from the Residency to the council at Cathair dhearg. It is the first carriage on the island. The custodians go on walking to the council, and say so.
- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 1798 DE** — *The Harbour Articles* (Ros dhomhain). A second agreement, the Harbour Articles, fixes dues and anchorages at Ros dhomhain in the Company's favour. Like the first treaty it is written in the humans' tongue only, and this time two custodians refuse to sign.
- 5 AN DÀMHAIR 1799 DE** — *The fishermen of Baile ghlas* (Baile ghlas). The fishermen of Baile ghlas, whose boats had anchored free at Ros dhomhain since anyone could remember, are charged anchorage under the Harbour Articles. They move their catch to their own small harbour and sell it there to anyone but the Company.
- 3 AN T-SAMHAIN 1799 DE** — *The northern concession* (Muileann àrsaidh). The council grants the Administration upland pasture in the north-west, around Muileann àrsaidh, for human families who will not work in the pits. The grant is for grazing; the families build houses of stone.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 1799 DE** — *Death of Tormod mac Ailein* (Cathair dhearg). The high custodian who signed the first treaty dies at Cathair dhearg. The council chooses Coinneach Glas of Ceann àrsaidh to follow him, a man who had never met a human before the Crossing and had dealt with little else since.
- 10 AN T-IUCHAR 1800 DE** — *Harrow lost at sea* (Muir Mhanannain). Edmund Harrow's ship does not return from the western crossing. The Company passes wholly into Thomas Pike's hands, and the humans' letter-books mourn Harrow as the man who found Rodos.
- 2 AN DÙBHLACHD 1800 DE** — *The Small-Burning Law lapses*. Centuries of measured restraint end within a single generation. No formal repeal is recorded — it simply stops being enforced once it stops being profitable to enforce.
- 31 AN DÙBHLACHD 1800 DE** — *The last count at Doire mhin* (Doire mhin). The custodians of Doire mhin keep the old count of the Small-Burning Law, the measure of ore that might be burned in a year, one season longer than anyone else. The count is entered in their roll with the note that nobody asked for it.
- 11 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1801 DE** — *A defence of the Law at Dùn dhearg* (Dùn dhearg). A custodian of Dùn dhearg, Fionnghal nic Artair, writes a defence of the Small-Burning Law addressed to the council. It is the only such defence to survive. It argues that the Law was never about the ore but about the people who would become whatever the burning made them.
- 6 AN T-SULTAIN 1801 DE** — *Murchadh Seabhag preaches at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). At Seann Skell the hawk-priest Murchadh Seabhag preaches that Mòd, the Hungry Hawk of Acaill, starves those who eat faster than the land can feed them. The sermon is copied and carried to the camps, where it is the first Ròdaich text the Company's agents are told to confiscate.

- 16 AM MÀRT 1802 DE** — *The hearths of Achadh naomh* (Achadh naomh). The households of Achadh naomh, in the hills north of the workings, who keep Na Seann Spioradan, refuse to light their hearths with ore bought from the Company. They burn peat, as their grandparents did, and their elders teach that ore burned for wages is ore burned without the ancestors' leave.
- 8 AN LÙNASTAL 1802 DE** — *Burning by the cartload* (Muileann chrom). The Company's furnaces at Muileann chrom burn ore by the cartload to drive the new pumps, and the custodians' tally of what the hill may give in a year is not consulted. Coinneach Glas's council asks for the tally to be observed and receives a copy of the Company's accounts instead.
- 15 AN GEARRAN 1803 DE** — *Henry Maddox Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). Josiah Pell sails home to an Tìr Thall and does not come back. His successor, Henry Maddox, arrives with instructions to double the yield and a letter from the Company promising him a share of it.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1803 DE** — *The oaks of Cathair fhada* (Cathair fhada). Maddox buys the oak woods around Cathair fhada for pit-props. The woods had been cut sparingly by the town for generations. They are gone within the working life of the men who felled them.
- 26 AN GIBLEAN 1804 DE** — *The first mining deaths blamed on speed*. A tunnel collapse, worked faster than any Rodian crew would have chosen to work it, kills eleven. It is recorded as an accident.
- 14 AN DÀMHAIR 1804 DE** — *The eleven of Cnoc fhiadhaich* (Cnoc fhiadhaich). The collapse was at Cnoc fhiadhaich, in a gallery driven forward without the timbering the Ròdaich crews had asked for. The custodians' roll names all eleven dead. The Company's report names none and calls the gallery "unsound ground."
- 11 AN GEARRAN 1805 DE** — *The coughing sickness* (Muileann chrom). A dry cough runs through the camps at Muileann chrom and Cnoc fhiadhaich, worst among the boys who break ore at the pit-mouth. Thirty-eight die of it. The Mission's surgeon calls it a winter complaint; it lasts through the summer.
- 6 AN T-IUCHAR 1806 DE** — *The orphans of Cill thais* (Cill thais). The village of Cill thais takes in children orphaned by the coughing sickness, and keeps a house for them paid for by its own custodians. The Company, asked for a contribution, sends a crate of Mission primers.
- 4 AN LÙNASTAL 1806 DE** — *Taigh-solais Baile ìseal lit* (Taigh-solais Baile ìseal). The second beacon is lit on the eastern shore at Baile ìseal. Torcall Clachair, too old now to climb, directs its building from a chair at the foot of the headland.
- 9 AN CÈITEAN 1807 DE** — *The keepers of Baile ìseal* (Baile ìseal). The keepers of the eastern beacon are drawn from the fishing families of Baile ìseal. The town's custodians ask for, and get, a rule that the lamp will be lowered on the nights the boats go out to the deep grounds, so the fish will not be frightened. The rule lapses without anyone recording when.

- 23 AN GIBLEAN 1808 DE** — *Seòlaid Ceann òg* (Ceann òg). The traders' boats from the new quay at Ceann òg go down the Abhainn ìseal past Cnoc bheag and Inis bhàn to the north coast, west along it, round the western capes, and south past Inis thais into the capital's water. Their lane is called Seòlaid Ceann òg after the quay. Off the north-west it swings far out into open sea, and there the ships bound for an Tìr Thall leave it and the ships from the west come in.
- 6 AN DÀMHAIR 1808 DE** — *The camp at Àth ìseal* (Àth ìseal). The Company founds a camp of timber huts at Àth ìseal, at the ford below the new workings, for crews brought in from the coast. It is the first settlement on Rodos built for no purpose but the pit.
- 23 AN T-IUCHAR 1809 DE** — *Doire mhòr's water taken* (Doire mhòr). The Company diverts the stream that watered Doire mhòr to wash ore at Cnoc fhiadhaich. No order is recorded; the stream is simply dammed one season and not released. Beathag Dhubh's people carry water by hand for two summers and then begin to leave.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 1809 DE** — *The short hunger in the hills* (Muileann chrom). With men drawn from the farms into the pits, the hill villages of Muileann chrom lose their oat harvest to rain nobody was home to cut ahead of. The Company sells meal at the camp stores for marks; the villages have few.
- 15 AN DÀMHAIR 1810 DE** — *Meal-carts at Doire fhiadhaich* (Doire fhiadhaich). The villages of Doire fhiadhaich in the south send carts of meal north to the hill villages, as the old custom of the Holy Age required in a hungry year. The Company's agents at Àth ìseal buy up two of the carts on the road.
- 13 AN T-SAMHAIN 1810 DE** — *Mass excavation begins in earnest*. The mountain is worked by the ton for the first time in Rodian history, for purposes no Rodian tradition would have chosen.
- 12 AN DÙBHLACHD 1810 DE** — *Rope for the winding-gear* (Dùn chrom). The rope-walks of Dùn chrom, which had made cable for fishing boats, turn over entirely to winding-rope for the pit-heads. The Company pays well, and the town grows by half.
- 7 AN GIBLEAN 1811 DE** — *The Company's second charter* (Ros dhomhain). The Company is rechartered in an Tìr Thall with new capital and a new name the Ròdaich never adopt. Its agents at Ros dhomhain now outnumber the Administration's own clerks four to one.
- 16 AN T-SULTAIN 1811 DE** — *Barges at Cidhe Beag* (Cidhe Beag). Ore barges begin loading at Cidhe Beag on Abhainn uaine, floating the black ore downriver to the coast. The old canoe landing, used since before the Sundering, is widened with cut stone and its shrine moved uphill.
- 27 AN FAOILLEACH 1812 DE** — *Abhainn uaine silts black* (Abhainn uaine). The washing of ore upstream silts Abhainn uaine with a black slurry, and the salmon runs at its mouth fail within a few seasons. The river's Ròdais name, the green river, is kept, and the fishermen use it bitterly.

- I AN LÙNASTAL 1812 DE** — *Baile Mòr dhombhain a barge town* (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Baile Mòr dhomhain, on the river road, grows into the busiest barge town of the north as the ore comes down to it from Cidhe Beag. Its population doubles, mostly with bargemen from the coast.
- 10 AM FAOILLEACH 1813 DE** — *Baile dhombhain raised as a camp town* (Baile dhomhain). A second camp, Baile dhomhain, is laid out on a grid by a Company surveyor, the first Ròdaich town drawn on paper before it was built. It is housing four hundred within two seasons.
- I AN LÙNASTAL 1813 DE** — *An Taigh-seinnse Mòr reopens* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). The old carters' house at the halfway stage of the ore road between the capital and the hills is rebuilt, opens its doors at Lùnastal, and keeps the name An Taigh-seinnse Mòr. Its first keeper, Seònaid Bhàn, takes both marks and barter and is the only innkeeper on the road who will.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1813 DE** — *Rathad na Mèinne* (Àth chiar). The Company's road-gangs finish metalling the carriers' road from Cathair dhearg by Doire chaol and the ford of Àth chiar to the workings at Achadh dhomhain, wide enough for ore-carts to pass both ways. The carters call it Rathad na Mèinne, the ore road. The posts with the crown's sign that had marked it since the Age of Sundering are left standing along it.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1814 DE** — *The carters of Doire chaol* (Doire chaol). The carters of Doire chaol, on the road just east of the capital, form a guild to bargain with the Company over rates for hauling ore. It is the first Ròdaich guild formed in the age, and the Company recognizes it because it is cheaper than breaking it.
- 3 AN T-IUCHAR 1814 DE** — *Seann Toll made an ore landing* (Seann Toll). The Company takes over the river landing at Seann Toll, below the workings, and builds a loading stage there for the barges that carry the ore down the Abhainn uaine to Ceann leathan. The town's fishing boats are moved to the next reach.
- 31 AM FAOILLEACH 1815 DE** — *The ore ships' lane* (Ceann leathan). From the landing at Seann Toll the ore barges go down the Abhainn uaine to Ceann leathan, where the Company's ships load at the river mouth and go out by the southern lane, Slighe-mhara Caol fhiadhaich, west along the south coast to the wild strait and the open sea. The fishers of the south coast, who had used the lane for five hundred years, learn to keep out of the ore ships' way.
- 19 AN CÈITEAN 1815 DE** — *The first Rodian overseer appointed*. A Ròdaich is given authority over other Rodian miners, answerable to human administrators — the first visible fracture within Rodian society itself, not just between it and the humans.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1815 DE** — *Raghnall Maor* (Muileann chrom). The first overseer is Raghnall mac Dhòmhnaill of Muileann chrom, a crew-leader who had worked the pits since the first contract. He is given the Company's staff and a house with a slate roof, and from this office the Ròdaich give him his byname: Raghnall Maor, Raghnall the steward.

- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 1816 DE** — *The overseers multiply* (Muileann chrom). Within a few years there are overseers at every working in the district, all Ròdaich, all answerable to the Company's agents. The custodians' roll stops recording their names and records only their number.
- 14 AN LÙNASTAL 1817 DE** — *Seumas Dubh killed at Cnoc mhòr* (Cnoc mhòr). The overseer of the new pits at Cnoc mhòr, Seumas Dubh, is killed by his own crew after a boy is crushed on a haulage he had ordered hurried. The Company hangs two men at Ros dhomhain, the first hanging carried out by the Administration on Rodos.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 1817 DE** — *Hawk-priests barred from the camps* (Muileann chrom). Henry Maddox bars the priests of Òrd an t-Seabhaig from the camps, on the ground that their preaching slows the work. The order is enforced by the overseers. Several of them are hawk-faithful themselves, and the roll says so. The Mission's chaplains, who keep a chapel in every camp, are not barred.
- 11 AN DÀMHAIR 1818 DE** — *The pox at Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). A spotted pox comes ashore on a Company ship at Ros dhomhain and moves up the ore road into the camps. The Mission counts four hundred and six dead; the custodians count more, and write the difference in the margin of the Mission's list.
- 9 AN T-SAMHAIN 1819 DE** — *The pox in the south* (Baile chiar). The pox spreads south from the harbour to Baile chiar and the villages round it. The custodians there keep a list of the dead on the lintel of the council house, cut into the stone, and it can still be read.
- 31 AM FAOILLEACH 1820 DE** — *Baile dhìreach loses its harbour dues* (Baile dhìreach). The Administration moves its customs house from Baile dhìreach to Ros dhomhain and ends the division of harbour dues. The mixed council, left with half an income, cuts its members from six to four.
- 28 AN T-IUCHAR 1820 DE** — *Arthur Lisle Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). Henry Maddox leaves Rodos a rich man. Arthur Lisle, a lawyer, replaces him, and his first act is to have every agreement since the first treaty copied into a single bound book.
- 2 AM MÀRT 1821 DE** — *A customs house at Ros gheal* (Ros gheal). Lisle opens a second customs house at Ros gheal on the northern coast, where hawk-faithful fishing towns had been trading with Company ships without paying dues. The customs officer is chased out of the town twice in his first year.
- 3 AM FAOILLEACH 1822 DE** — *The Muileann chiar silver dispute* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). Human interests attempt to claim the silver seam at Muileann chiar as well. It is one of the few resources the Ròdaich successfully keep fully under their own control throughout this age.
- 31 AM MÀRT 1822 DE** — *Ùna nic Choinnich and the silver guild* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). The silver seam was held for the town by its guild of refiners, and the guild was led by Ùna nic Choinnich. When the Company's surveyors came she met them at the adit with the guild's whole membership and the guild's ledgers, and asked them to find the humans' name anywhere in either.

- 1 AN GEARRAN 1823 DE** — *The Silver Compact* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). Arthur Lisle, reading the treaties closely, finds nothing in them that covers silver. On Là Fhèill Bhrìde he signs a compact with the silver guild leaving the seam to the town, the first document of the age in which the Ròdaich side keeps the better terms.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1823 DE** — *Seann Bhral the silver port* (Seann Bhral). The silver guild sends its bars to the sea through the old port of Seann Bhral rather than the Company's quays, and pays the port's custodians in silver for the use of it. The Company does not object, having no ground in the compact to object on.
- 21 AM FAOILLEACH 1824 DE** — *The carters of Baile gheal* (Baile gheal). The carters of Baile gheal in the south-west take up the haul of Seann Warr brine-salt round the lake to the capital, a trade the Company does not bother to claim. It keeps the town's people out of the pits for the whole age.
- 10 AN T-IUCHAR 1824 DE** — *Taigh-solais Àth dhearg lit* (Taigh-solais Àth dhearg). The third beacon is lit on the north-east coast at Àth dhearg. Its keeper, Tormod mac Pheadair, keeps a daybook of every ship he sees, and it is from his book that the number of human sailings in these years is known.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 1825 DE** — *Àth dhearg builds the tower* (Àth dhearg). The masons of the beacon at Àth dhearg are townsmen of Àth dhearg, paid half in marks and half in the promise that the tower will guide their own boats home. Tormod mac Pheadair, the keeper, is one of them.
- 20 AN DÀMHAIR 1825 DE** — *Pirates off the eastern coast* (Spùinneadairean-mara). A Company ore ship is taken off the eastern coast by raiders in low black boats and burned to the waterline, cargo and all. The Company says the raiders were paid by the silver guild. The silver guild says nothing.
- 25 AN T-IUCHAR 1826 DE** — *A cove burned near Ceann leathan* (Ceann leathan). A Company gunboat hunts the raiders to a cove near Ceann leathan and burns every boat drawn up on the shingle there. Most of them belonged to the town's fishermen. The raiders are not found.
- 23 AN LÙNASTAL 1826 DE** — *The end of the joint council* (Baile dhìreach). The mixed council of Baile dhìreach breaks up in a quarrel over a boundary wall and is not reconvened. The human families move to Ros bheag and Ros dhomhain; the Ròdaich families stay. Those households that were both split or went quiet, and the record does not say which.
- 18 AN T-SAMHAIN 1826 DE** — *The boatyard moves to Inis chrom* (Inis chrom). The human boatbuilders of Baile dhìreach move their yard to Inis chrom, a day's sail east, where the Company has promised them timber. The town takes them in without a joint council or any other arrangement, and the record of their presence there fades within a generation.
- 21 AN T-SULTAIN 1827 DE** — *The dry year in the east* (Achadh shean). Rain fails over the eastern farmlands around Achadh shean for a single season. It is remembered afterward as a warning nobody heeded, since the next dry spell, long after, came three years together.

- 20 AN DÀMHAIR 1827 DE** — *Baile ruadh loses its seed* (Baile ruadh). At Baile ruadh in the east the dry season kills the seed corn in the ground, and the town borrows seed from the Company's store at Seann Dunn at a price paid back over five harvests. It is the first Ròdaich town to owe the Company a debt in grain.
- 19 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1828 DE** — *Aonghas mac Coinnich's question* (Dùn thais). At Dùn thais the druid master Aonghas mac Coinnich puts a question to his students that the school's register calls new: why the humans cannot see the colour in broken ore that every Ròdaich child sees. He does not answer it, and the register notes that he said it was the wrong question.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 1828 DE** — *The druid students of Baile Mòr uaine* (Baile Mòr uaine). Students of Aonghas mac Coinnich carry his question to Baile Mòr uaine and teach it in the town's hall of disputation. The hall's record of the argument runs to four hundred leaves and ends, like his, without an answer.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 1829 DE** — *Cathair gheal on the concession* (Cathair gheal). The human families of the northern concession found a market town at Cathair gheal, with a stone hall for their magistrate and a chapel. Its charter is issued by the Administration without reference to the custodians.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1829 DE** — *Human farms at Cnoc ghorm* (Cnoc ghorm). Human farmers of the concession clear land beside the Ròdaich village of Cnoc ghorm, in the upland north-west, and build a mill. The villagers sell them grain until the mill is working and then stop.
- 14 AM MÀRT 1830 DE** — *A fishing station at Ceann mhòr* (Ceann mhòr). A few human fishing families of the concession settle at Ceann mhòr, the harbour under the north-western headland. They are the first humans to fish the island's waters for a living rather than for the Company's table.
- 10 AN GIBLEAN 1830 DE** — *The first Rodian child sent abroad*. A single family, hoping to secure better treatment, sends a son to be educated in the humans' home country. He is never recorded returning.
- 12 AN GIBLEAN 1830 DE** — *The family of Eachann Mòr* (Ceann àrsaidh). The family that sent its son away was that of Eachann Mòr, a custodian of Ceann àrsaidh who had lost his place on the council. The boy, Calum, sailed west on a Company ship with a letter of introduction from the Mission and a purse of marks.
- 9 AN CÈITEAN 1830 DE** — *The Mission school* (Ros dhomhain). The Mission opens a school at Ros dhomhain for Ròdaich children, taught in the humans' tongue. It takes thirty pupils in its first year, most of them the children of overseers, and the Mission counts its first Ròdaich converts among them.
- 7 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1831 DE** — *Schooling at Inis bhàn* (Inis bhàn). The custodians of Inis bhàn in the north open a school of their own in answer to the Mission's, teaching the old reckoning, the rolls and the names of the hills. The Mission complains that the pupils come to its own school the next year already knowing how to argue.

- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 1831 DE** — *Tobacco on the concession farms* (Ceann mhòr). Human farmers of the northern concession plant tobacco on the sheltered slopes behind Ceann mhòr and sell the dried leaf to the Company's ships. It is the one crop the humans brought that is still grown on Rodos.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 1832 DE** — *Drochaid Ros fhionn* (Drochaid Ros fhionn). The Company rebuilds the old bridge over the river at Ros fhionn to carry the eastern ore road. For as long as the carts run, it is the busiest crossing on that side of the island.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 1832 DE** — *Ore through Inis bheag* (Inis bheag). Ore from the eastern workings is carted over the new bridge and down to the river quays of Inis bheag, to go by barge to Caol chrom at the river mouth for shipment. The river is deepened at the quays by the Company, and the town's old fish market is moved to make room for the ore stage.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 1833 DE** — *Baile mhin ships the eastern ore* (Baile mhin). The river quays of Baile mhin, below Inis bheag on the Abhainn bheag, take the overflow of eastern ore that Inis bheag cannot load. The townsfolk are paid by the barge and the town builds its first stone houses on the proceeds.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 1833 DE** — *Caol gharbh bypassed* (Caol gharbh). The ore road to Inis bheag passes Caol gharbh by a mile, and the town, which had hoped for the traffic, gets only its dust. Its custodians write that they had not known a town could be damaged by a road it was not on.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1834 DE** — *The thing in the north-western sea* (Uilebheist na Mara). The crew of a Company brig report a beast larger than their ship off the north-western headlands. The Administration's clerk files the report with the complaints about pirates, and the Ròdaich sailors of the coast say they had wondered when the humans would see it.
- 13 AN T-SULTAIN 1834 DE** — *A brig lost in the mist* (Caol bheag). A Company brig bound for the northern landing with tools is caught by a spring gale in sea mist off Eilean fhada and driven onto the skerries. Her crew wade ashore at low water and walk to the harbour at Caol bheag. After it the Company's charts mark the northern passage closed to its ships from midwinter to the end of spring, the season of the gales.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 1834 DE** — *Whale-boats out of Àth fhionn* (Àth fhionn). Human fishermen of the concession teach the boats of Àth fhionn to hunt whales with the hand-lance instead of waiting for them to strand. The oil is sold to the Company for its lamps, and whale-boats go out from the north coast every summer after this.
- 21 AN LÙNASTAL 1835 DE** — *Surveyors lost at Doire uaine* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). Two Company surveyors go up into the hills at Doire uaine against the advice of the villagers and are not seen again. The Company sends a search party, which comes back after a day and refuses to go further.

- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 1835 DE** — *The offerings at Doire uaine* (Doire uaine). The villagers of Doire uaine leave offerings of salt and ore for the sith at the foot of the hills after the surveyors are lost, as they had in their grandparents' time after any death on the high ground. The Company forbids ore to be left lying and has the offerings collected, and the villagers change to salt alone.
- 16 AN GEARRAN 1836 DE** — *The tithe increase*. The portion of mined obsidian claimed by human administrators rises sharply, with no corresponding rise in what Rodian communities receive.
- 13 AN LÙNASTAL 1836 DE** — *Lisle's tithe schedule* (Ros dhomhain). The new schedule is issued at the Residency over Arthur Lisle's signature, raising the Administration's portion from one part in five to one part in three. The custodians receive a copy in the humans' tongue and a translation made by a Mission pupil.
- 4 AN LÙNASTAL 1837 DE** — *Weighing the grain at Dùn fhiadhaich* (Dùn fhiadhaich). At Dùn fhiadhaich the tithe-collectors begin weighing grain as well as ore, on the ground that the town's farms feed the pits and share in the pits' profit. The custodians' roll calls this the tithe on the tithe.
- 6 AN T-IUCHAR 1838 DE** — *The flux at Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). A bloody flux breaks out in the crowded quarters at the Ros dhomhain quays. The Mission's nurse, Anne Colby, sets up a sick-house in the chapel, and the record credits her with keeping the dead to under two hundred.
- 7 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1839 DE** — *The flux reaches Seann Vell* (Seann Vell). The flux spreads to Seann Vell, the river port east of the capital on the Abhainn fhionn, carried by the ore barges. The custodians of the town close the barge landing for a season and are fined for it by the Company.
- 3 AM MÀRT 1840 DE** — *Walter Crane Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). Arthur Lisle dies at the Residency of a fever of the heart. Walter Crane, who had been the Company's chief agent at the pits, is appointed Commissioner in his place, the first to hold both offices in succession.
- 6 AN T-SULTAIN 1840 DE** — *The pay office at Ceann mhin* (Ceann mhin). Crane moves the Company's pay office for the southern workings to Ceann mhin, and has the crews walk there to be paid rather than send the paymaster to them. The walk is a day each way. The crews are not paid for it.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1841 DE** — *Dòmhnall mac Raghnail Maor* (Muileann chrom). Raghnall Maor dies, and the Company gives his staff to his son Dòmhnall. The overseer's office, which the custodians had hoped would lapse with the man, becomes a family's inheritance.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 1842 DE** — *Taigh-solais Muileann bheag lit* (Taigh-solais Muileann bheag). The fourth beacon is lit on the northern shore at Muileann bheag. It is the first to burn ore instead of oil, and the keepers report that its flame throws a colour on the water no oil lamp ever did.

- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 1843 DE** — *The fishermen of Muileann bheag* (Muileann bheag). The fishermen of Muileann bheag complain that the ore flame of the new beacon casts a colour on the water that drives the herring off. The keepers do not change the lamp. The herring come back within a season, and the complaint is withdrawn in a letter that the Company keeps.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1843 DE** — *The dig at Làrach an Teampaill* (Làrach an Teampaill). The Mission cleric Edwin Lowe digs at Làrach an Teampaill for a season with Company labourers, looking for proof of an older faith on the island. He finds cut stone, burnt bone and marks he cannot read, and writes that the ruin's builders "were not the present race." The custodians agree, and add nothing.
- 9 AN LÙNASTAL 1844 DE** — *The pillar at Cnoc chiar* (Colbh Cnoc chiar). Edwin Lowe copies the inscription on the pillar near Cnoc chiar and compares it with Wren's copy of the obelisk at Cnoc bheag. He decides the two scripts are not the same and that neither is Ròdaich. His notes stop there.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1845 DE** — *The column at Cnoc ghorm* (Calbh Cnoc ghorm). Lowe's last copy is of the column near Cnoc ghorm, and he writes beside it that its marks resemble the pillar's but not closely enough to help. He leaves Rodos the next year, and his notebooks go with him.
- 8 AN LÙNASTAL 1845 DE** — *The glass-house at Baile Mòr dhìreach* (Baile Mòr dhìreach). Peter Voss, a glazier left behind when his Company contract ended, builds a glass-house at Baile Mòr dhìreach and melts the white sand of Cuan ruadh with charcoal from the hills. It is the first glass made on Rodos. His Ròdaich apprentices take the craft to the towns of the capital shore within a generation.
- 29 AM MÀRT 1846 DE** — *The silver guild refuses again* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). A Company agent, Martha Gale, offers the silver guild of Muileann chiar a partnership, on terms the guild's ledger calls generous. Ùna nic Choinnich, now very old, has the offer read aloud twice in the guild hall and then refused by show of hands.
- 1 AM FAOILLEACH 1847 DE** — *The camp at Achadh dhomhain* (Achadh dhomhain). A new camp is opened at Achadh dhomhain for the deep galleries under the hill, and within a few seasons it is the most crowded settlement in the district. Its houses are built of spoil.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 1847 DE** — *Cloth for the camps at Dùn chiar* (Dùn chiar). The weavers of Dùn chiar take a Company contract to supply canvas for the camp tents and sacks for the ore. The town prospers on it, and its custodians note that it is the first time the town has made anything for a use it did not approve of.
- 7 AM MÀRT 1848 DE** — *The first of the immortal generation*. A child born into the mining camps is exposed to more raw ore across her lifetime than any Rodian in living memory — and does not age the way the people around her do. Her name is Aisling.

- 26 AN T-IUCHAR 1848 DE** — *The coach to the camps* (Muileann chrom). The Company puts a coach on the road between the quay at Ros dhomhain and the camps at Muileann chrom, twice a week each way, changing horses at the old waypoint houses. Its passengers are clerks and overseers. The crews walk.
- 3 AN DÙBHLACHD 1849 DE** — *The ore weighed at the quay* (Ros dhomhain). The Company installs a great steelyard at the Ros dhomhain quay, and from now on the island's yield is known by the ton and the hundredweight. The custodians' old count, kept in seasons of labour, stops being entered in the roll.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 1849 DE** — *Ros dhìreach the second ore port* (Ros dhìreach). The Company opens a second ore stage at Ros dhìreach on the southern coast for the workings south of the hills. Its first cargo is lost in a squall off the harbour mouth, and the fishermen who had been moved to make room for the stage refuse to go out after it.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 1850 DE** — *The condition goes unnamed*. Whatever is happening to the child born two years earlier has no word yet, in any language spoken on the island. It will be decades before anyone tries to coin one.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 1850 DE** — *The first steamer* (Ros dhomhain). The first ship driven by an engine comes into Ros dhomhain, a Company paddle-steamer out of an Tìr Thall. The fishermen row out to look at a ship moving against the wind with no sail set. Within a generation the Company's ore goes out in nothing else.
- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 1851 DE** — *The shrine at Cill dhìreach* (Cill dhìreach). At Cill dhìreach, a village on the edge of the workings, the custodians keep a small shrine where the pit crews leave the first piece of ore of each new gallery. The Company tolerates the custom because it costs a stone a gallery.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 1851 DE** — *The keepers of Cill ghlas* (Cill ghlas). The custodians of the shrine at Cill ghlas, in the hills among the workings, keep the old rites at the mouth of the oldest cutting while the Company's pits deepen around them. It is the last shrine in the district still visited on the old feast days by the pit crews.
- 9 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1852 DE** — *A' Phlàigh Uaine*. The Green Death moves through the mining camps — the ore dust itself is blamed, though no formal study is ever completed. Twenty-six settlements record cases.
- 5 AN DÙBHLACHD 1852 DE** — *The first cases at Achadh dhombhain* (Achadh dhomhain). The Green Death is first noticed at Achadh dhomhain: a greenish pallor, then a cough that brings up dark dust, then weakness. The camp buries forty in its first month, in a field outside the spoil-heaps that is still called the green acre.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 1853 DE** — *Twenty-six settlements* (A' Phlàigh Uaine). The sickness spreads along the ore roads from the camps at Muileann chrom, Àth ìseal and Cnoc fhiadhaich, and falls hardest on Ros dhìreach, Ceann òg, Inis ìseal, Baile dhomhain, Achadh fhada, Cnoc bheag, Muileann uaine, Cuan àrsaidh and Inis bhàn. The custodians' roll lists the twenty-six settlements that record cases and leaves a blank line after the last, as if expecting another.

- 11 AN GEARRAN 1853 DE** — *The Green Death at Baile chrom* (Baile chrom). The Green Death reaches Baile chrom in the hills, not the town of the same name in the north-west. The record distinguishes them with care, because in later years the names become confused in the retelling of the island's hungers.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1853 DE** — *Àth ghlas burns its huts* (Àth ghlas). At Àth ghlas the custodians order every hut in which a death has occurred burned with its bedding. The Company protests the loss of its property. The custodians note that the sickness stops at Àth ghlas sooner than anywhere else.
- 10 AN GIBLEAN 1853 DE** — *The dead of Cnoc naomh* (Cnoc naomh). At Cnoc naomh the dead of the Green Death are buried in the burial ground of the town's old shrine until the ground is full, and then in a field outside it. The field is never ploughed again.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 1854 DE** — *Doctor Bright's study* (Muileann chrom). The Administration's physician, Nathaniel Bright, begins a study of the sickness at Muileann chrom, weighing the dust in the lungs of the dead. He falls ill in the second season of his work, and his notebooks break off in the middle of a table.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1854 DE** — *Walter Crane dies of the Green Death* (Ros dhomhain). Commissioner Crane, who had walked the camps during the worst of the sickness, dies of it at the Residency. The Company's agent at Ros dhomhain, Martha Gale, holds his seal for the months until a successor arrives.
- 13 AM MÀRT 1855 DE** — *George Tolley Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). George Tolley arrives from an Tìr Thall with orders that the yield must not fall because of the sickness. He does not visit the camps. His letter-book blames the dust, the Ròdaich custom of sleeping near the fire, and the custodians' shrines, in that order.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 1855 DE** — *Quarantine at Caol mhin* (Caol mhin). Tolley sets up a quarantine station at Caol mhin on the northern coast for ships arriving from an Tìr Thall, holding them offshore until their crews are inspected. It is the first order of his administration the Ròdaich approve of, and they say so.
- 10 AN CÈITEAN 1855 DE** — *The camps turn to the hawk* (Muileann chrom). With the hawk-priests still barred from the camps, their sermons are carried in by the crews themselves. The overseers' reports of these years list hawk-feathers nailed above hut doors as a disciplinary matter.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 1856 DE** — *Anne Colby's sick-houses* (Ros dhomhain). Anne Colby opens sick-houses at Àth ìseal and Achadh dhomhain and nurses there until the sickness ebbs. She is the only human the camp people name in their own accounts of the plague, and they name her kindly.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1856 DE** — *The huts of Cnoc gharbh* (Cnoc gharbh). Cnoc gharbh, whose people had worked the southern galleries, abandons its camp huts after the sickness and moves back to the old village on the hill. The Company rebuilds the huts the next year and brings in crews from the west.

- 13 AN DÀMHAIR 1856 DE** — *The first work-refusal strike.* An entire mining settlement halts extraction for eleven days over conditions worsened by the plague two years prior. It ends when food supplies, controlled by human administrators, run out.
- 21 AN DÀMHAIR 1856 DE** — *The strike at Baile thais* (Baile thais). The settlement was Baile thais, below Cill ghlais, and the halt was called by the crew-leader Catriona nic Eachainn after the Company refused to close the galleries where the Green Death had been worst. For eleven days no ore left the town. On the twelfth the Company's store, the only store, was empty.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 1857 DE** — *The Company's granary* (Baile thais). After the strike the Company builds a granary of its own at Muileann chrom and forbids the camps to keep grain beyond a week's ration. The order is enforced by the overseers and signed by Dòmhnall mac Raghnaill Maor.
- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 1858 DE** — *Fish smuggled from Ros gharbh* (Ros gharbh). The fishermen of Ros gharbh carry salt fish up to the camps by night, past the Company's granary rule. The custodians' roll calls it the only trade of the decade that ran in the right direction.
- 29 AN T-SAMHAIN 1858 DE** — *Catriona goes to the silver town* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). Turned out of Baile thais and refused work at every Company pit, Catriona nic Eachainn goes east to Muileann chiar, where the silver guild takes her on as a refiner. The Company asks for her to be sent back. The guild's reply is filed but not preserved.
- 3 AN T-SULTAIN 1859 DE** — *The springs at Muileann ruadh* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). The Administration builds a new bath-house at the hot springs near Muileann ruadh for officials recovering from fevers. Ròdaich who had bathed there for centuries are admitted on certain days and charged a penny.
- II AM MÀRT 1860 DE** — *Muileann chiar expands* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). The silver town grows alongside the obsidian operation, human demand for both metals accelerating extraction the reverent tradition never would have permitted.
- 7 AN T-IUCHAR 1861 DE** — *A second Muileann chiar* (Muileann chiar). The growth of the silver trade crowds the old town, and the guild founds a daughter settlement to the west for its refiners and carters, which takes the same name. The record calls them the old town and the new, and does not always say which it means.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1862 DE** — *Silver for marks* (Muileann chiar). The silver guild begins selling bar silver to the Company for marks at a price the guild fixes. It is the only commodity on Rodos in the age priced by Ròdaich hands, and the guild's hall fills with human coin.
- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 1863 DE** — *Silversmiths at Muileann bhàn* (Muileann bhàn). Silversmiths settle at Muileann bhàn on the road to the silver town and make a living working the guild's bar into ornaments for the humans' market. Their work is the one Ròdaich craft sold in an Tìr Thall under a Ròdaich name.

- 24 AN GEARRAN 1864 DE** — *Macha's priests bless the coin* (Cathair dhearg). The priests of Òrd Mhacha at Cathair dhearg, the order of the capital and the crown, bless the Residency's new coin at Tolley's request. Macha's priesthood teaches that the two horses of her rite, Dubh Sainglenn the black and Liath Macha the grey, each have their due; the dissenting priests say the coin is only one of them.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 1865 DE** — *The second currency reform*. Rodian barter goods are formally devalued against human coinage a second time, on terms set entirely by the human administration.
- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 1865 DE** — *Wool devalued at Baile Mòr fhionn* (Baile Mòr fhionn). At Baile Mòr fhionn, where wool had been the measure of every bargain, a fleece is now worth by the Residency's table what a half-fleece was worth before. The town's weavers stop bringing wool to market and send it overseas on their own account, until the Company refuses them freight.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 1866 DE** — *The boats of Caol fhiadhaich sold* (Caol fhiadhaich). The fishing fleet of Caol fhiadhaich, unable to pay the new harbour dues in marks, sells half its boats to the Company. The men who sailed them go into the pits under the next year's contracts.
- 25 AM MÀRT 1866 DE** — *The dissenters go to Cnoc bheag* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). Priests of Macha who refused the blessing leave the capital's temple and settle in the sacred forest at Cnoc bheag. Their community there keeps the older reading of Macha's two horses, and becomes a place where custodians who have lost their seats are received.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 1866 DE** — *Iain Maor* (Muileann chrom). Dòmhnall mac Raghnaill Maor dies, and his son Iain takes the overseer's staff. Iain Maor is the first overseer to have been schooled at the Mission; he keeps his reports in the humans' tongue and his household in Ròdais.
- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 1867 DE** — *The Levy* (Ros dhomhain). Tolley issues an ordinance, the Levy, requiring every farming village in the west and north to send one in five of its able adults to the pits for a term of two years. The villages are compensated in marks, at the new rate.
- 3 AM MÀRT 1867 DE** — *Levy officers at Caol mhòr* (Caol mhòr). The Levy's officers take their first quota at Caol mhòr in the north-west, reading the names of the chosen from a list in the humans' tongue. The custodians of the town take down the names again in Ròdais, so that they will know whom to look for.
- 6 AN DÙBHLACHD 1867 DE** — *The Levy in the north-west* (Muileann àrsaidh). The Levy falls hardest on the villages around Baile chrom and the northern concession, which had never sent crews to the pits. The Ròdaich of the concession are taken; the human farmers of the concession are exempt.
- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1868 DE** — *Baile ìseal sends its people* (Baile ìseal). Baile ìseal sends forty-one of its people to the pits under the Levy. Nineteen come back when their term ends. The custodians' roll gives the names of the other twenty-two and the camps they were sent to.

- 6 AN DÙBHLACHD 1868 DE** — *Muileann naomh buys its way out* (Muileann naomh). The custodians of Muileann naomh pay the Levy's officers in silver to reduce the town's quota by half. The officers take the silver and the full quota. The complaint is lodged at the Residency and filed.
- 14 AN DÙBHLACHD 1868 DE** — *The druid school's hall closed* (Dùn thais). George Tolley closes the hall of the druid school at Dùn thais, citing a lecture on whether the humans' blindness to the ore's colour is a kind of sickness. The masters go on teaching in their own houses, to smaller rooms each year.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 1869 DE** — *The last disputation at Doire chiar* (Doire chiar). At Doire chiar, a village of the druid schools north of the eastern workings, the masters hold the last public disputation of the school in the open air on the eve of Bealltainn, in the village's threshing-floor. Its subject is whether a question may be forbidden. The Administration's clerk who attends records that it may.
- 15 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1869 DE** — *Teaching in the sacred forest* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). Druid masters who can no longer teach in a hall begin teaching in the sacred forest of Flidais near Muileann chiar, under the trees, where the Administration has no building to close.
- 14 AN T-IUCHAR 1869 DE** — *Building the last beacon at Baile chrom* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). Work begins on the fifth and last beacon, on the north-western headland at Baile chrom, with masons drawn by the Levy from the same villages whose fields they leave unworked.
- 27 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1870 DE** — *The masons of Cnoc thais* (Cnoc thais). The masons of Cnoc thais are taken by the Levy to build the beacon at Baile chrom. Their foreman, Dùghall Clachair, cuts the names of his crew into the lintel of the lamp-room. It is the only inscription on any of the five towers.
- 26 AN T-IUCHAR 1870 DE** — *The five lighthouses complete* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). Taigh-solais Baile chrom, Baile iséal, Muileann bheag, Àth dhearg and Tobar dhearg — the full ring of coastal beacons is finished, built to serve trade that is by now extraction in every way but name.
- 24 AN LÙNASTAL 1870 DE** — *Cuan ruadh loses its trade* (Cuan ruadh). With the ring of beacons finished, Company steamers round the island without stopping, and the old coastal trade of Cuan ruadh, which had carried goods up and down the eastern shore, dies within a few years.
- 22 AN T-SULTAIN 1870 DE** — *Taigh-solais Baile chrom lit* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). The beacon at Baile chrom is lit with an ore flame, completing the ring. The Company's ships can now round the island by night, and the keepers' daybooks record the sailings doubling in the next few years.
- 3 AM MÀRT 1873 DE** — *Gorta Baile chrom*. The Great Hunger follows a failed harvest across thirty-four settlements, worsened by a mining workforce too depleted by mass conscription to farm its own land.

- 1 AN GIBLEAN 1873 DE** — *Baile chrom goes hungry* (Baile chrom). The hunger is worst at Baile chrom itself, whose people could see the new beacon from their empty fields. The custodians record that more died there than in any other settlement, and the Administration, which kept its own count, does not dispute the figure.
- 22 AN CÈITEAN 1873 DE** — *The famine country* (Gorta Baile chrom). The custodians' roll draws the line of the famine country along the north-west shore and the hills behind it. Inside it lie Baile chrom in its own shire; Ceann mhòr, Àth fhionn and Àth dhearg in the shire of Ceann mhòr; Muileann àrsaidh in the shire of Cnoc thais; and Achadh àrsaidh in the shire of Muileann àrsaidh. Thirty-four settlements are counted within the line, and the roll gives the dead of each.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 1874 DE** — *The hunger at Doire ghlas* (Doire ghlas). At Doire ghlas in the north the hunger takes the old and the very young first. The village sends its young to the camps for the Company's rations and is half empty by the end of the year.
- 29 AN CÈITEAN 1874 DE** — *Inis mhin eats its seed* (Inis mhin). At Inis mhin on the north coast the townsfolk eat their seed corn in the second winter of the hunger. The Mission kitchen at the harbour feeds three hundred a day for a season.
- 7 AN T-SAMHAIN 1875 DE** — *The hunger reaches Seann Bhrenn* (Seann Bhrenn). The hunger reaches as far east as Seann Bhrenn, where the custodians open the old grain-pits of the Holy Age, which had not been filled in living memory. They are found to hold only dust.
- 6 AN DÙHLACHD 1875 DE** — *The relief ship* (Ros dhomhain). A relief ship with grain from an Tìr Thall is held at Ros dhomhain for a month while the Residency and the Company argue over who is to pay for its unloading. The Mission opens kitchens at Cathair gheal and Baile chrom meanwhile, and Anne Colby, returned to the island, runs the one at Baile chrom.
- 20 AN GEARRAN 1876 DE** — *The Levy suspended* (Baile chrom). The Levy is suspended in the famine districts, too late for the harvest. It is not repealed. The custodians note that it was never used again, and that it never needed to be, since the villages had learned what it meant.
- 17 AN LÙNASTAL 1876 DE** — *Cnoc mhòr walks south* (Cnoc mhòr). The families of Cnoc mhòr in the north walk south to the camps rather than starve, and take work under the Company. Their village stands empty for a generation.
- 9 AN DÀMHAIR 1877 DE** — *Robert Haskins Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). George Tolley retires with honours. Robert Haskins, his successor, orders that the custodians' council be consulted on the tithe, then sets the tithe before the council has met.
- 7 AN T-SAMHAIN 1877 DE** — *Customs at Seann Dunn* (Seann Dunn). Haskins opens a customs house at Seann Dunn on the eastern coast and a Company store with it. The store sells the east its seed and its tools, and within a few years its ledgers hold the debts of half the district.

- 4 **AM FAOILLEACH 1878 DE** — *The first organized petition.* Rodian custodians, for the first time acting jointly rather than settlement by settlement, submit a formal grievance to the human administration. It is not answered.
- 3 **AM MÀRT 1878 DE** — *The conclave at Ceann àrsaidh* (Ceann àrsaidh). The petition was drawn up at Ceann àrsaidh by custodians from nineteen settlements, meeting for the first time as one body. It was carried to the Residency by the custodian of Cill ghlas, a woman named Peigi Ghlas, and handed to a clerk.
- 6 **AN DÙBHLACHD 1878 DE** — *Àth fhionn signs* (Àth fhionn). The custodian of Àth fhionn in the south-east, Ruairidh mac Thormoid, is the oldest of those who signed the petition. He had been born before the humans' coin was struck, and he says so beside his signature.
- 27 **AM FAOILLEACH 1880 DE** — *Resentment first recorded.* The earliest surviving Ròdaich grievance texts date from this period — not yet organized resistance, but the first written acknowledgment that something has gone wrong.
- 18 **AN T-SULTAIN 1880 DE** — *Leabhar Baile thais* (Baile thais). The earliest grievance text to survive is a book of complaints kept at Baile thais, set down by many hands over some years: wages, deaths, the granary, the stream at Doire mhòr. The custodians' copyists call it Leabhar Baile thais.
- 17 **AM FAOILLEACH 1881 DE** — *The songs of Fearchar Bàrd* (Muileann dhearg). The poet Fearchar Bàrd, a breaker of ore at Muileann dhearg since boyhood, makes songs of the Levy and the famine that are sung in the camps. The overseers forbid them, and the prohibition is the reason several of them were written down.
- 23 **AN DÙBHLACHD 1881 DE** — *Songs at An Taigh-òsta Grianach* (An Taigh-òsta Grianach). The songs of Fearchar Bàrd are sung in the roadside houses of the east, and An Taigh-òsta Grianach becomes known for them. The Company's carters sing them too, the keeper records, without always knowing what they are singing.
- 15 **AN GEARRAN 1882 DE** — *The Company's deep-water quay* (Ros dhomhain). The Company builds a deep-water quay at Ros dhomhain able to take the new iron steamships, which burn the island's own ore to carry it away. Fearchar Bàrd makes a song of that, and it is the one of his most often quoted.
- 20 **AN T-SAMHAIN 1882 DE** — *The deep quay at Ceann chaol* (Ceann chaol). A second deep-water quay is built at Ceann chaol in the south-east for the eastern ore. Its builders are brought from the coast, and the town, which had been a village of forty houses, is a town of four hundred.
- 23 **AN T-SULTAIN 1883 DE** — *Baile thais walls its pithead* (Baile thais). The Company rings the pithead at Baile thais with a stone wall and a gate, with a watchman paid to keep count of who goes in. It is the first working on Rodos to be walled against its own crews.

- 19 AN DÙBHLACHD 1883 DE** — *Catrìona nic Eachainn dies at the silver town* (Baile thais). Catriona nic Eachainn dies at Muileann chiar, a refiner of the silver guild to the end. The camp people of Baile thais send a delegation to her burying, and the Company docks each of them a day's pay.
- 4 AN GIBLEAN 1884 DE** — *The quay fire* (Ros dhomhain). A fire starts in the Company's ore sheds at Ros dhomhain and burns for three days, taking two streets of the harbour quarter with it. The Company's investigation finds no cause; the harbour quarter's own account has several.
- 22 AN T-SULTAIN 1884 DE** — *The council meets without a high custodian* (Cathair dhearg). The Council of Custodians fails to agree on a new high custodian after the death of the last, and sits for years with the seat empty. Robert Haskins writes to an Tìr Thall that this makes the council easier to deal with.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1885 DE** — *Tiormachd Achadh shean*. The Long Drought settles over the island's dry season for three consecutive years, straining a population already stretched thin by extraction quotas.
- 28 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1886 DE** — *The wells of Achadh shean* (Achadh shean). At Achadh shean, whose name the drought bears, the wells fail in the second summer and the cattle are driven west in a column that the roll says was a day long. Fewer than half of them reach water.
- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 1886 DE** — *The dry country* (Tiormachd Achadh shean). Ten districts of the east are counted as drought country by the custodians' roll, worst at Achadh shean, Àth uaine, Achadh àrsaidh and Muileann chiar, and reaching down to Cuan ruadh and west toward Baile chaol. The Administration keeps no count of its own.
- 6 AN T-SULTAIN 1886 DE** — *The cattle of Baile chaol* (Baile chaol). At Baile chaol the herds are slaughtered in the second summer of the drought rather than watched to die. The salted meat is sold to the Company for the camps, at a price the Company names.
- 5 AN DÀMHAIR 1886 DE** — *Doire fhionn walks for water* (Doire fhionn). At Doire fhionn in the east the women walk to the spring at Àth ruadh and back each day for water, a journey of half a day. The custodians record this for the three dry years and then stop recording it.
- 1 AN CÈITEAN 1887 DE** — *Pilgrims at Allt an Àigh* (Allt an Àigh). The spring of Allt an Àigh, said never to have failed, keeps running through all three dry years. Pilgrims who keep Na Seann Spioradan come to it from across the east, the first of them at Bealltainn, and the Administration posts a watchman to charge them for the water. He is recalled after a single season.
- 30 AN CÈITEAN 1887 DE** — *The pilgrims' road at Inis uaine* (Inis uaine). Pilgrims bound for Allt an Àigh gather at Inis uaine, and the town's people feed them without charge, as the Old Spirits require. The town's own wells are low, and it gives away more water than it keeps.

- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1888 DE** — *Drought-fever at Baile Mòr ruadh* (Baile Mòr ruadh). A fever of bad water follows the drought into the towns, worst at Baile Mòr ruadh, where the wells had been deepened into the old middens. Two hundred and sixty die. The Mission's report is the first to name the cause correctly.
- 3 AN CÈITEAN 1888 DE** — *The fever at Cnoc shean* (Cnoc shean). The drought-fever spreads to Cnoc shean, where the town's single well is found to be tainted. The custodians close it and the town drinks from carts for a year.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 1888 DE** — *The Mission's wells* (Achadh shean). The Mission digs deep wells at Achadh shean and Àth chrom with a boring-rig brought from an Tìr Thall. They hold. The custodians of the east record the Mission's wells alongside the Company's quotas, without comment, on facing pages.
- 16 AM MÀRT 1889 DE** — *Achadh chaol goes to the pits* (Achadh chaol). The people of Achadh chaol in the north-east, their fields burned out by the drought, go to the pits for wages. They are the first villagers of the eastern farming country to do so, and their custodian records it as the end of the village rather than a move.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1889 DE** — *The quota not lowered* (Baile Mòr dhìreach). The ore quota is not lowered during the drought. The custodians of the east petition Haskins singly, since the joint petition had not been answered; he replies to each that the matter is under consideration.
- 3 AN GEARRAN 1890 DE** — *The petition of Àth mhòr* (Àth mhòr). The custodian of Àth mhòr, Iseabail nic Leòid, writes the longest of the single petitions, forty pages cataloguing her town's dead animals. Haskins replies in two lines. Both documents survive, bound together by a later clerk.
- 15 AN GEARRAN 1890 DE** — *The first mixed-blood inheritance dispute*. A legal case over whether a child of one Rodian and one human parent may inherit customary mining rights sets a precedent the administration writes entirely to its own benefit.
- 4 AM MÀRT 1890 DE** — *The case of Thomas Hale* (Ros dhomhain). The child in the case was Thomas Hale, a grandson of the Baile dhìreach marriage of Eilidh nic Ruairidh and Samuel Hale, who claimed a share in a customary cutting through his Ròdaich grandmother. The magistrate at Ros dhomhain, Oliver Dunstan, ruled that customary rights descend only through the line the Administration recognizes, and that it recognizes only its own.
- 2 AN GIBLEAN 1891 DE** — *Dunstan's rule applied* (Ros dhomhain). Within a few years Dunstan's ruling has been used to transfer eleven customary cuttings to the Company, each on the ground that some owner in the line had married a human or been born to one. The custodians stop entering such marriages in the roll.
- 25 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1892 DE** — *A cutting at Cnoc dhubh transferred* (Cnoc dhubh). Among the cuttings transferred under Dunstan's rule is the old customary working at Cnoc dhubh, held by the same family since the Holy Age. A great-grandmother in the line had married a human sailor; that is enough.

- 29 AN DÙBHLACHD 1892 DE** — *The Lamp-Watch* (Baile thais). A society of pit crews calling itself the Lamp-Watch begins meeting at Baile thais and Cnoc chaol under cover of a burial club. Its first known act is to pay for the burial of an old breaker who had died in the Company's lock-up.
- 28 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1893 DE** — *Edward Vane Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). Robert Haskins is recalled after a quarrel with the Company over the price of steamship berths. Edward Vane replaces him. Vane is the first Commissioner to have been born on Rodos, at the Residency, and he speaks Ròdais badly, but at all.
- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 1894 DE** — *The tram-road to Ros dhireach* (Ros dhireach). Vane lays an iron tram-road from the southern workings down to the ore port at Ros dhireach, drawn by mules. It halves the cost of shipping ore and ends the carting trade of the villages along the old road.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1895 DE** — *The night-shift order*. Extraction is extended to run continuously, day and night, for the first time — the mountain given no season of rest at all.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 1895 DE** — *The night crews at Cnoc chaol* (Cnoc chaol). The order is felt first at Cnoc chaol, where the Company's newest galleries are opened to crews working by ore-lamp in two shifts. The custodians' roll records that the hill was given no silence at all, and then leaves the rest of the page blank.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 1896 DE** — *The night-shift strike* (Cnoc chaol). The crews at Cnoc chaol refuse the night shift and are replaced within a week by crews brought from the coast under the Company's new contracts. The Lamp-Watch pays the strikers' families for a season and runs out of money.
- 5 AN DÙBHLACHD 1896 DE** — *The strikebreakers of Muileann dhombhain* (Muileann dhomhain). The crews that replace the strikers at Cnoc chaol are brought through Muileann dhomhain, where the townsfolk turn them away from every door. They sleep in the Company's barns, and several go home the next season.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1897 DE** — *Matthew Dunne's sermon* (Ros dhomhain). The Mission's minister at Ros dhomhain, Matthew Dunne, preaches against the night-shift order from the chapel pulpit, saying the Ròdaich are right that even the ground must rest. The Company complains to the Mission. Dunne is recalled to an Tìr Thall, and the sermon is copied by the Lamp-Watch and read in the camps.
- 14 AN LÙNASTAL 1898 DE** — *The lung-rot at Cnoc chaol* (Cnoc chaol). A wasting sickness of the lungs spreads among the night crews at Cnoc chaol and Baile thais. Unlike the Green Death, it kills slowly. The Company pays a pension to widows for a year, then stops.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 1898 DE** — *Iain Maor and the night shift* (Muileann chrom). Iain Maor, overseer at Muileann chrom, writes to the Company that the night shift is killing his crews faster than it is paying for them. The letter survives because the Company filed it with his dismissal, which was reversed a month later for want of anyone else.

- 22 AM MÀRT 1899 DE** — *The ore line* (Muileann chrom). The Company opens its railway from the pits at Muileann chrom down by Cathair dhearg to the deep-water quay at Ros dhomhain. Its engines burn the island's own ore, as the steamships do, and the tram-road to Ros dhìreach is left to the mules. The carters' guild of Doire chaol, which had hauled the ore on Rathad na Mèinne for eighty years, loses the long haul within a year. The Ròdaich call the engine carbad-iarainn, the iron chariot, and the railway the ore line from its first day.
- 18 AN GIBLEAN 1899 DE** — *Ore-lamps from Baile ghorm* (Baile ghorm). The potteries of Baile ghorm take a contract for clay lamp-bodies for the night crews, thousands in a year. The potters' own record notes that they are the first lamps ever made on the island for work in the dark by order.
- 21 AN GEARRAN 1900 DE** — *Fionnan born*. A second child manifests the same unprecedented bonding Aisling did half a century earlier. The exposure is not a one-time accident. It is an ongoing industrial condition.
- 19 AN CÈITEAN 1901 DE** — *The Administration's census* (Ros dhomhain). The Administration counts the people of Rodos by district for the first time. Its figures for the humans are precise to the household; its figures for the Ròdaich are round to the hundred, and in the hill districts to the thousand.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1902 DE** — *The district of the outer coasts* (Seann Vell). The Administration makes the outer coasts a single district and governs it from the harbour office at Seann Vell on Eilean ruadh, where its revenue cutters lie: the islands of the west and south, Eilean bhàn with Cuan dhearg and Cnoc chaol, and the southern edge of the windy coast in the far north-west. Its surveyors walk to the edge of the great moss there, which no chain can cross, and go no farther. Beyond it the district map is left blank.
- 6 AN LÙNASTAL 1902 DE** — *Seònaid nic Dhùghaill, last of the druid masters* (Dùn thais). The last master of Scoiltean nan Draoidhean to teach openly in the colonial age, Seònaid nic Dhùghaill, dies at Dùn thais. No successor is named, and the school's register ends with her death. It will be taken up again only long after the humans are gone.
- 5 AM MÀRT 1903 DE** — *The custodians' records at Muileann chaol* (Muileann chaol). The custodians of the east begin sending copies of their rolls to the town of Muileann chaol, which still kept Beathag nic Thòmais's loft of papers, for safekeeping, away from the Residency's reach. The copying is done in the houses of three families and kept in a cellar.
- 5 AM FAOILLEACH 1904 DE** — *The second Muileann chaol* (Muileann chaol). Some of the copies bound for Muileann chaol go by error to the smaller town of the same name further north, and are kept there for years before the mistake is found. The custodians' record of them notes that they were kept just as well.
- 23 AM FAOILLEACH 1905 DE** — *The word finally coined*. Facing two confirmed cases, Rodian custodians settle on a term for what's happening: fuil-ghuail, "coal-blood" — rendered in the humans' tongue as obsidian-touched. It is meant clinically. It will outlive that intention.

- 21 AN GEARRAN 1905 DE** — *The custodians who named it* (Cill ghlas). The word was agreed by a meeting of custodians held at the shrine of Cill ghlas, where the oldest cutting still stood open. They chose a plain word for a medical register. The roll records the vote and does not record who proposed it.
- 26 AN T-SAMHAIN 1906 DE** — *The Administration's register* (Ros dhomhain). The Residency, hearing of the word, orders that any Ròdaich child showing the condition be reported to the Commissioner's office. The custodians comply by reporting none.
- 7 AN GIBLEAN 1908 DE** — *The third currency reform*. Traditional Rodian barter is formally abolished as legal tender entirely. Every transaction on the island now runs through human coinage.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1908 DE** — *The barter houses closed* (Ros dhomhain). The barter houses at Ros dhomhain and Cathair dhearg, where cloth and fish had changed hands without coin since before the Crossing, are closed by order. A clerk of the Residency notes that the ledgers are now "complete for the first time."
- 22 AM MÀRT 1909 DE** — *The fishwives of Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). The fishwives of Inis mhòr, who had sold by barter at the river steps since before the Crossing, refuse to take coin for a week in protest at the barter houses' closing. They give their fish away instead. The Company's clerks record it as a glut.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1909 DE** — *Marks borrowed at interest* (Cathair dhearg). With barter abolished, the hill villages borrow marks from the Company's stores to buy seed, at interest. Within a few years most of the villages of Muileann chrom owe the Company more than a year's crops.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1910 DE** — *The old market at Muileann òg* (Muileann òg). The old barter market at Muileann òg, where hill and coast had met to trade since the Holy Age, closes after its last season. The ground stands empty until it is used, long after, for a fair.
- 12 AN T-SULTAIN 1910 DE** — *Mòrag nic Iain Maor* (Muileann chrom). Iain Maor dies, and his daughter Mòrag takes the overseer's staff at Muileann chrom, the first woman to hold it. The Company approves her appointment in a letter that calls her "a safe pair of hands."
- 24 AN LÙNASTAL 1911 DE** — *Charles Merriman Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). Edward Vane dies at the Residency. His successor, Charles Merriman, arrives with a small company of armed constables, the first standing force the Administration has kept on Rodos.
- 11 AN DÀMHAIR 1911 DE** — *The constable post at Muileann shean* (Muileann shean). Merri-man's first constable post is built at Muileann shean on the northern ore road, a stone house with a yard for horses. The townsfolk call it the humans' second Residency, and do not mean it kindly.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1912 DE** — *A barracks at Tobar ghorm* (Tobar ghorm). A second post is raised at Tobar ghorm, near the northern workings. The village's custodian is paid a rent for the ground and uses it, the record notes, to buy the village out of its debts to the Company store.

- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 1912 DE** — *A grey-night vigil at Baile chrom* (Baile chrom). The Mission at Cathair gheal reports that human labourers near Baile chrom have been keeping a vigil at night in the fields, praying in silence under the sign of a grey goose, which they call the wild goose of the Spirit. The Mission cannot find the source of the practice and calls it irregular, a superstition learned from the Ròdaich. The Ròdaich of Baile chrom disown it.
- 21 AN DÀMHAIR 1912 DE** — *Manannan's priests on the grey night* (Ceann mhòr). The priests of Òrd Mhanannain at Ceann mhòr answer the Mission's report on the grey-night vigils. The practice owes something to the Ròdaich, they say, but to their own harbours and not to Baile chrom: the human fishing families of Ceann mhòr learned the night prayer to keep the sea shut from them, and the labourers inland keep it as a Christian vigil, a night of silence under the wild goose of the Spirit instead of a prayer to Manannan. The priests call it Manannan's prayer gone astray and do not admit its keepers to their house.
- 1 AN GIBLEAN 1913 DE** — *The dockers' strike at Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). The dockers at Ros dhomhain, Ròdaich and human alike, refuse to load ore for nine days over the new berth charges. It is the only strike of the age in which human workers join Ròdaich ones. Merriman's constables end it, and the human dockers are shipped west.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 1913 DE** — *Seann Vell's dockers stay out* (Seann Vell). The dockers of Seann Vell, the harbour next to Ros dhomhain, refuse to load the ore diverted to them during the strike. When it ends they are not shipped west, having no humans among them, but they are not hired again either.
- 29 AN CÈITEAN 1913 DE** — *Lorccan born*. A third case, born into a mining town rather than a mining camp — proof the phenomenon has outgrown any single site.
- 3 AM MÀRT 1914 DE** — *Cian born*. A fourth, within a year of the third — the closest the immortal generation comes to being born in a cluster rather than a scatter.
- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 1915 DE** — *Blasting-powder at Cill ghlais* (Cill ghlais). The Company begins driving galleries under the hills around Cill ghlais with blasting-powder shipped from an Tìr Thall. The custodians of the shrine ask that no charge be set within sight of the old cutting. The Company's engineer marks their request on his plan and sets the charges below it.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 1915 DE** — *Powder landed at Caol ìseal* (Caol ìseal). The blasting-powder for the new galleries is landed at Caol ìseal on the northern coast, away from the crowded southern harbours, and carted inland under guard. The town's custodians ask what is in the barrels and are told it is lamp-oil.
- 9 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1916 DE** — *Scàineadh Cill ghlais*. The Rending — a fault line tears open in the hills east of the capital, around Cill ghlais during a routine excavation, killing dozens and closing an entire mining district for a generation.
- 17 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1916 DE** — *The first open confrontation*. A mining accident, blamed by Rodian workers on human indifference to safety, becomes the first recorded violent clash between the two populations.

- 3 AN T-IUCHAR 1916 DE** — *The shrine at Cill ghlas lost* (Cill ghlas). The old cutting at Cill ghlas, where the custodians had kept the rites through the whole age, is swallowed by the Rending with its shrine. The custodians' roll records the loss of the shrine before the loss of the dead, and a later copyist has corrected the order.
- 13 AN T-SAMHAIN 1916 DE** — *The district closed* (Scàineadh Cill ghlas). The Company closes the whole district of the Rending and fences it, leaving Cill ghlas, Àth chaol and their hamlets in the shires of Muileann dhearg and Muileann chiar without work. The villages empty toward Baile thais and Muileann dhearg, and the closed district is left to thorn.
- 22 AN T-SAMHAIN 1916 DE** — *The meeting on the moor road* (Coinneachadh an Fhearainn). The people turned out of the closed district send their eldest to the custodians of Muileann dhomhain, who meet them at a standing stone on the moor road below the town rather than let the Company's clerks see them in the town hall. At the stone the custodians lend them the land at the edge of the fenced ground. The place is called Coinneachadh an Fhearainn, the meeting of the land.
- 5 AN DÙBHLACHD 1916 DE** — *Achadh chaol raised by the displaced* (Achadh chaol). People of the closed district build a new village at Achadh chaol, on the edge of the fenced ground, on land lent by the custodians of Muileann dhomhain. It is the only settlement founded in the age by Ròdaich for Ròdaich without a Company surveyor's hand in it.
- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 1916 DE** — *The clash at Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). The accident that began the clash was a flooded gallery at Muileann chrom, in which seven died after the pumps were stopped to save fuel. When the Company's agent came to the pithead the crews stoned him and his constables, and the constables fired. Four Ròdaich and one constable were killed.
- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 1917 DE** — *Mòrag Maor at the inquiry* (Muileann chrom). At the Administration's inquiry into the clash, the overseer Mòrag nic Iain Maor testifies that the pumps were stopped on the agent's order. Her evidence is struck from the record. The Lamp-Watch obtains a copy of it anyway.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 1917 DE** — *The grey fever* (Baile thais). A fever of the chest comes in on the ships and runs across the whole island, from the capital to the eastern farms. It kills the young and strong more than the old, the Mission notes with alarm. The camps, already hungry, bury more than the towns.
- 14 AN T-IUCHAR 1917 DE** — *The grey fever at Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). At Cathair mhòr the grey fever closes the market for the first time in the town's memory. The custodians' roll records the dead by street, and the longest list is the street where the carters lived.
- 6 AN DÙBHLACHD 1917 DE** — *The grey fever at Dùn thais* (Dùn thais). At Dùn thais the fever takes the physician who had been sent by the Administration to treat it, and two of the Mission's nurses. The druid masters' old houses are opened as sick-rooms.
- 27 AM FAOILLEACH 1918 DE** — *The second organized petition*. This one includes an implicit threat rather than a plea. It is the first Rodian document the human administration bothers to respond to — with increased security, not concessions.

- 12 AN LÙNASTAL 1918 DE** — *The signatories of Cnoc dhìreach* (Cnoc dhìreach). The custodian of Cnoc dhìreach, Coinneach Ruadh, signs the second petition and is dismissed from his post as clerk to the Company store the same week. He is one of eleven signatories who lose Company work over it.
- 29 AN DÙBHLACHD 1918 DE** — *Eilidh nic Raghnaill* (Baile thais). The second petition was drafted by Eilidh nic Raghnaill, a crew-leader of Baile thais and a member of the Lamp-Watch, and signed by custodians and crew-leaders from thirty-one settlements. It ends with a sentence the Residency underlined: that the hill would not be worked by people who were not asked.
- 25 AN GEARRAN 1919 DE** — *The constabulary enlarged* (Ros dhomhain). Merriman's answer is to triple the constabulary and post companies at Muileann chrom, Baile thais, Ceann fhada and Cnoc chaol, with a fortified store at each. The constables are paid from the tithe.
- 26 AM MÀRT 1919 DE** — *Barracks at Dùn chrom* (Dùn chrom). A constabulary barracks is built at Dùn chrom, on the capital side of the hills, with room for two hundred men. It stands empty for most of its first year for want of constables to fill it.
- 24 AN GIBLEAN 1919 DE** — *Ìomhar Seabhag* (Seann Skell). At Seann Skell the hawk-priest Ìomhar Seabhag preaches that Mòd's hunger has turned toward those who have eaten the hill. The hawk-shrines of the west begin to serve as meeting houses for the Lamp-Watch, and the constables do not yet know it.
- 23 AN CÈITEAN 1919 DE** — *The hawk-faithful of Ros gheal* (Ros gheal). At Ros gheal the hawk-faithful fishing families, who had chased out the Company's customs officers a century before, raise a shrine to Mòd on the harbour wall. The constables order it down. It is rebuilt three times in a single season.
- 21 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1919 DE** — *The hawk and the druids at Inis bhàn* (Inis bhàn). At Inis bhàn the priests of the hawk and a few who still keep the druid school's questions in private meet for a disputation, the first between the two in living memory. The record calls it inconclusive, and notes that both sides afterward signed the petition.
- 20 AN T-IUCHAR 1919 DE** — *The grey fever in the north-west* (Baile chrom). The grey fever returns and settles in the north-west, around Baile chrom and the concession towns, where it kills humans as readily as Ròdaich. The Mission's hospital at Cathair gheal overflows, and Ròdaich and human patients lie in the same wards for the first time.
- 6 AM MÀRT 1920 DE** — *Muileann fhionn shut in* (Muileann fhionn). Muileann fhionn, a Ròdaich mill town in the north-west, closes its roads against the fever and keeps them closed for a season. Human carters of the concession are turned back with their loads at the town's edge.
- 18 AN GIBLEAN 1920 DE** — *The fever at Tobar fhiadhaich* (Tobar fhiadhaich). At Tobar fhiadhaich in the north the fever takes one household in three. The custodians of the village burn no huts, having heard of Àth ghlas in their grandparents' time but judging it too late.

- 9 AN T-SULTAIN 1920 DE** — *The taverns fortify* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). Roadside houses along the old mining routes begin doubling as informal militia waypoints — infrastructure quietly repurposing itself for a conflict not yet declared.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1920 DE** — *An Taigh-seinnse Òir* (An Taigh-seinnse Òir). An Taigh-seinnse Òir, the great house on the eastern road beyond Dùn dhearg, digs a well in its yard and builds a wall round the well. The keeper tells the Company's carters it is against thieves.
- 14 AN DÀMHAIR 1920 DE** — *An Leòmhann Buidhe* (An Leòmhann Buidhe). An Leòmhann Buidhe, the roadside house on the northern road through the druid country, takes on six new ostlers in a single season, none of whom know anything about horses.
- 22 AM FAOILLEACH 1921 DE** — *An Taigh-òsta Grianach walled* (An Taigh-òsta Grianach). An Taigh-òsta Grianach, known since the songs of Fearchar Bàrd as the singing house, raises a wall around its yard and puts a watch on its gate.
- 3 AN T-IUCHAR 1921 DE** — *Am Buabhall Fortanach barred* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). Am Buabhall Fortanach, the great roadside tavern on the south-western road, takes to barring its gates at dusk and keeping a watch on the roof. Its keeper, Tormod Buabhall, keeps a list of travellers that he sends up the road each week, to whom the record does not say.
- 30 AN LÙNASTAL 1921 DE** — *The harbour of Doire shean* (Doire shean). The little harbour of Doire shean, below Am Buabhall Fortanach, becomes the landing place for the goods the house cannot take by road. The fishermen of Doire shean are paid in silver from the east.
- 28 AN T-SULTAIN 1921 DE** — *An Taigh-seinnse Reòta* (An Taigh-seinnse Reòta). At An Taigh-seinnse Reòta, on the northern road, the stables are rebuilt with a loft for sleeping men. The Company's carters notice that the loft is never empty and never has the same men in it.
- 27 AN DÀMHAIR 1921 DE** — *An Sligeanach Fad' às* (An Sligeanach Fad' às). An Sligeanach Fad' às, on the eastern road near the silver country, becomes the post-house through which the Lamp-Watch sends word from the camps to Muileann chiar. The silver guild pays its keeper's rent.
- 25 AN T-SAMHAIN 1921 DE** — *The runners of Àth fhiadhaich* (Àth fhiadhaich). Runners from Àth fhiadhaich carry the Lamp-Watch's letters from An Sligeanach Fad' às to the silver town. They are boys of twelve and thirteen, too young to be stopped by constables.
- 28 AM FAOILLEACH 1922 DE** — *Achadh mhòr keeps the ledgers* (Achadh mhòr). The Lamp-Watch's ledgers of money received from the silver guild are kept at Achadh mhòr, a village near the house on the eastern road, in the roof of the village's shrine.
- 26 AN GEARRAN 1922 DE** — *Seònaid's house* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, the carters' house on the ore road reopened by Seònaid Bhàn in the early years of the extraction, is kept now by her great-grandson Aonghas. It is the busiest of the fortified houses, and the one the constables search most often and find least in.

- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *The first coordinated work stoppage.* Multiple mining regions halt extraction on the same day for the first time — proof that Rodian resistance, for all its scattering, could act as one when it chose to.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *Muileann bheag in the north-east* (Muileann bheag). The workings at Muileann bheag in the north-east, among the druid villages, stop with the rest. The town's custodian writes that it was the first thing the town had done in concert with the hills in a hundred years.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *The northern pits at Àth dhombhain* (Àth dhomhain). The pits north of the hills at Àth dhomhain stop with the rest on the day of the stoppage, having received the signal by a runner rather than the beacon. Their crew-leaders are among those shipped west.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *Ceann bheag stops* (Ceann bheag). The ore stage at Ceann bheag on the northern coast stops loading the same day. Its dockers had not been told of the stoppage in advance; they stop because the ore stops arriving.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *The quarrymen of Cnoc gheal* (Cnoc gheal). The quarrymen of Cnoc gheal in the north-east, who cut stone for the Company's buildings, put down their tools on the day of the stoppage without being asked. Nobody in the record says why.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *The day the pits stopped* (Muileann chrom). On the day of the stoppage every working in the Muileann chrom district halted at once, together with Baile thais, Cnoc chaol, the silver town and the eastern pits at Ros fhionn. The signal was a beacon fire lit on the hills above Doire mhòr, which the Company took for a heath fire.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1922 DE** — *The ore ships wait* (Ros dhomhain). The Company's steamships wait at Ros dhomhain for six days with empty holds. The agents at the quay write that they have never before seen the harbour so quiet, and that it frightened them more than the crowds.
- 30 AN DÙBHLACHD 1922 DE** — *The stoppage broken* (Ros dhomhain). The stoppage ends when the constables close the Company stores in every district at once. Forty crew-leaders are arrested; thirty-two are released without charge, eight are shipped west to an Tìr Thall for trial and are not heard of again.
- 28 AM FAOILLEACH 1923 DE** — *Beacon hill at Doire mhòr* (Doire mhòr). Doire mhòr, which had refused the first contract and then lost its water, has by now only a few households. The beacon of the stoppage was lit on its hill by the descendants of Beathag Dhubh's people, and the constables burn the hill's heather to deny it to them.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1923 DE** — *Fewer ships from the west* (Muir Mhanannain). The keepers' daybooks at the five beacons record fewer ships arriving from an Tìr Thall each year, and the ships that come are older. The Company's letters speak of troubles at home that they do not describe.

- 13 AN GIBLEAN 1924 DE** — *Caol leathan's idle harbour* (Caol leathan). At Caol leathan the wool-ships for the humans' market wait for cargo space that does not come. The merchants of the town begin selling their wool inland again, by barter, which is illegal.
- 9 AN DÀMHAIR 1924 DE** — *Caol bheag's empty quay* (Caol bheag). The Company's quay at Caol bheag on the northern coast, built for the eastern trade, handles one ship in a season. The Company's agent there writes that he has been forgotten.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1925 DE** — *Imperial overreach begins openly*. Human administrators begin issuing directives with no Rodian counsel sought at all — the polite fiction of permission finally dropped.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 1925 DE** — *Lionel Strake Commissioner* (Ros dhomhain). Charles Merri-man leaves Rodos in ill health. Lionel Strake, a soldier, replaces him. His commission, read aloud at the Residency, makes no mention of the Council of Custodians, and he does not call on it.
- 26 AN GEARRAN 1926 DE** — *The council locked out* (Cathair dhearg). Strake has the council hall at Cathair dhearg locked and its keys lodged at the Residency. The custodians meet instead in Macha's temple, whose priests, who had blessed the humans' coin, now shelter those who had petitioned against it.
- 27 AM MÀRT 1926 DE** — *The iron bird* (Ros dhomhain). Strake brings a flying machine from an Tìr Thall in the hold of a Company steamship and has it flown from a field above the Residency over the ore country, to count the workings from the air. The Ròdaich call it eun-iarainn, the iron bird. The custodians enter it in the roll as the first thing seen over Rodos that flew and was not alive.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1926 DE** — *The confiscation edict*. Human authorities formally claim the right to seize any Rodian dwelling deemed necessary for extraction expansion. It is the single most-cited grievance in every surviving account of what came next.
- 17 AN T-SULTAIN 1926 DE** — *The seizure of Doire mhòr* (Doire mhòr). The first dwellings taken under the edict are those of Doire mhòr, for a new shaft beneath the hill. The last households are carried out by constables. The village that refused the first contract is the first to be emptied by the last.
- 19 AN DÀMHAIR 1926 DE** — *Evictions at Baile dhombain* (Baile dhomhain). At Baile dhomhain, the first camp laid out on paper, two streets are pulled down for a spoil-tip. The families are offered huts at Àth ìseal and marks for their timber; most go to kin in the hill villages instead.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1927 DE** — *Mòrag Maor lays down the staff* (Muileann chrom). Mòrag nic Iain Maor, fourth of her line to hold the overseer's staff at Muileann chrom, refuses to carry out evictions in her district and breaks the staff at the Company's door. Three other overseers resign in the same month. The Company appoints humans to their places.

- 21 AN T-IUCHAR 1927 DE** — *The silver guild arms* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). The silver guild of Muileann chiar, still holding its seam under the compact made a century before, begins buying rifles through the eastern pirates. Its ledger enters them as refining tools.
- 19 AN LÙNASTAL 1927 DE** — *Rifles by way of the pirates* (Spùinneadairean-mara). The rifles for the silver guild come ashore from the raiders' boats in the eastern waters, where no Company gunboat has patrolled for years. The raiders take payment in silver bar, by weight.
- 20 AN LÙNASTAL 1927 DE** — *The council at Cnoc bheag forest* (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag). Custodians, crew-leaders of the Lamp-Watch and the dissenting priests of Macha meet in the sacred forest at Cnoc bheag and form a single council for the mining regions. Eilidh nic Raghnaill is chosen to speak for it. The meeting is not recorded by any human source.
- 3 AM FAOILLEACH 1928 DE** — *The arrest order* (Ros dhomhain). Strake orders the arrest of Eilidh nic Raghnaill and the members of the forest council. The constables go to Baile thais and find the house empty and the town silent.
- 20 AN GEARRAN 1928 DE** — *War declared*. Rodian resistance, coordinated for the first time across multiple mining regions, moves from grievance to open conflict.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1928 DE** — *The stores taken at Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). The war opens in the hills. At Muileann chrom the fortified store is rushed at first light by crews under Mòrag nic Iain, and its eleven constables surrender without a shot fired. The store's rifles and its grain are carried off before noon.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1928 DE** — *The quay at Ceann fhada seized* (Ceann fhada). Crews from the camps take the Company's ore quay at Ceann fhada and sink two barges across its mouth. No ore leaves the hills by water again in the age.
- 1 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1928 DE** — *The siege of the store at Baile thais* (Baile thais). At Baile thais the constables hold their walled pithead against the town for eleven days, the same span as the first strike a lifetime before. They surrender on the twelfth, when their water runs out. Eilidh nic Raghnaill sends them under guard to the coast unharmed, an order the Residency did not expect and did not reciprocate.
- 9 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1928 DE** — *The crews meet on the moor* (Coinneachadh a' Mhonaidh). Crew-leaders from Baile gharbh and the other northern pits meet at night on the moor above Cnoc naomh and fix the week of their rising. Each brings a stone of spoil from his own pit, and the stones are left in a cairn. The place is called Coinneachadh a' Mhonaidh, the meeting of the moor.
- 30 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1928 DE** — *The northern pits rise* (Baile gharbh). The crews at Baile gharbh and the northern pits rise in the same week, take the constable posts at Muileann shean and Tobar ghorm, and send the constables south on foot.

- 9 AN LÙNASTAL 1928 DE** — *The ore road cut* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). Aonghas, keeper of An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, closes the gates of the house across the ore road, and the men in its loft come down armed. The road between the capital and the hills is cut at its halfway stage and stays cut.
- 17 AN LÙNASTAL 1928 DE** — *Uilleam Gobha's forge* (Muileann dhearg). At Muileann dhearg the smith Uilleam Gobha turns the Company's own blasting-powder into grenades cased in ore-tin, and forges pike-heads from rails torn up in the galleries. The rebels' council records that it could not have fought its first season without him.
- 18 AN LÙNASTAL 1928 DE** — *The capital rises* (Cathair dhearg). At Cathair dhearg the custodians break the Residency's locks on their council hall and sit in it again. The townsfolk hold Drochaid Cathair dhearg against the constables sent up from the harbour, and the bridge built for ore-carts is barricaded with them.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1928 DE** — *Cathair dhombhain joins* (Cathair dhomhain). At Cathair dhomhain the townsfolk break open the Company's warehouse, the first building on Rodos the Company ever owned, and carry off its tools for the council's companies.
- 19 AN T-SAMHAIN 1928 DE** — *Muileann mhin takes sides* (Muileann mhin). At Muileann mhin, a river port just east of the capital, the townsfolk argue for three days and then send boats to the council. The boats carry food down the Abhainn fhionn to the capital through the winter.
- 27 AN T-SAMHAIN 1928 DE** — *The Residency fortified* (Ros dhomhain). Lionel Strake withdraws the Administration into the Residency above Ros dhomhain and fortifies the Company's quarter of the harbour. The city below it, overwhelmingly Ròdaich, neither joins the rising nor opposes it, and the constables do not trust it enough to leave the walls.
- 5 AN DÙBHLACHD 1928 DE** — *The fight at the ford of Àth chiar* (Àth chiar). A column of constables and Company guards under Major Peter Ashdown marches up the ore road to relieve the hills and is met at the ford of Àth chiar. The rebels hold the far bank. Ashdown loses forty men and his baggage and turns back; the rebels lose nineteen, whose names the council's roll gives in full.
- 3 AM FAOILLEACH 1929 DE** — *Ashdown's retreat through Dùn chrom* (Dùn chrom). Ashdown's column falls back through Dùn chrom and stops at the barracks there for a night. In the morning the town has closed its gates behind them, and the column continues to the coast without its wounded, whom the townsfolk keep and nurse.
- 15 AM FAOILLEACH 1929 DE** — *The silver town rises* (Muileann chiar). The silver guild of Muileann chiar declares for the council and opens its armoury. The Company agents in the town are escorted to the coast with their papers. It is the only place on the island where the rising took nothing, the guild's ledger notes, because the humans had never held anything there to take.
- 17 AM FAOILLEACH 1929 DE** — *The surrender at Dùn ìseal* (Dùn ìseal). The small constabulary post at Dùn ìseal, cut off by the rising at the silver town, surrenders to the silver guild's riflemen after a single exchange of fire. The east of the island is clear of human arms.

- 27 AM FAOILLEACH 1929 DE** — *Dùn dhearg declares* (Dùn dhearg). The custodians of Dùn dhearg declare for the council and send it grain. It is the town whose custodian had written the only surviving defence of the Small-Burning Law, and the declaration quotes it.
- 1 AN GEARRAN 1929 DE** — *Cnoc leathan's riflemen* (Cnoc leathan). Riflemen raised at Cnoc leathan in the east join the silver guild's companies and garrison the eastern road. The Company's carters on the road are allowed to go home with their carts.
- 13 AN GEARRAN 1929 DE** — *The eastern pits at Ros fhionn* (Ros fhionn). The crews of the eastern workings around Ros fhionn stop the pumps and walk out, letting the lower galleries flood. The Company's engineers there go down the Abhainn chaol and take ship at Seann Mhorn for Ros dhomhain. The bridge on the eastern ore road falls silent.
- 15 AN GEARRAN 1929 DE** — *Seann Toll shelled* (Seann Toll). A Company steamship, come up the Abhainn uaine, shells the ore stage at Seann Toll to deny it to the rebels, and sets the fishing town behind it burning. Twenty-three townsfolk die. It is the first time the humans turn the island's own ore, burning in their boilers, against a Ròdaich town.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 1929 DE** — *The Leaden Hawk company* (Cuan dhearg). At An Cupa Dàna, the inn at Cuan dhearg, seven hawk-faithful crewmen of the river towns wait nine hours for the council's letters to the Hawk coast, and leave with them at dark. Each wears a hawk cast in lead from the cartridges taken at the store at Muileann chrom, and the record calls them Buidheann an t-Seabhaig Luaidhe, the Leaden Hawk company.
- 20 AN GIBLEAN 1929 DE** — *The Leaden Hawk walks to the Hawk coast* (Cnoc bheag). The company goes on foot and lightly laden: past the burned stage at Seann Toll, through Baile thais, up over the hills by Achadh dhomhain and Cuan bheag, down the Abhainn ìseal by Ceann òg and Inis ìseal to Cnoc bheag, and along the Hawk coast by Inis bhàn, Ros gheal and Seann Skell to Inis mhin, some eighty miles in a little over three days. At every hawk-house on the way they read the council's letter aloud, and at Seann Skell they leave it with Ìomhar Seabhag.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 1929 DE** — *Rumours at Inis mhin* (Inis mhin). At Inis mhin, the northern landing the humans had walled, the company lies twelve hours in a boat-shed and hears that Strake's constables ride the western roads out of Ros bheag every day. They hire a carriage from a carter of the town and leave the roads altogether.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 1929 DE** — *The watch in the grasslands* (Tobar dhomhain). Two days by carriage across country, off every road, bring the company to the grasslands above Tobar dhomhain in the western hills. They lie eleven hours in the long grass over the road from Ros bheag to the concession and count the constables' riders who pass. The company's own list gives forty-one riders, and none of them going north.

- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1929 DE** — *The Leaden Hawk at Inis thais* (Inis thais). Two more days by carriage, still off the roads, bring the company down to Inis thais, eight days after it left Cuan dhearg. The priests of Òrd na Cloiche hear the council's letter in the temple of the Stone. They will send no men, but they close the harbour of Inis thais to the Company's ships and give the hawk-faithful the use of the Fianna's roads. The Leaden Hawk ends its road there, and its seven join the hawk company when it is mustered at the western Seann Skell.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 1929 DE** — *Coaling from Inis mhòr* (Inis mhòr). The Company steamships coal from the ore stacked on the quays of Inis mhòr, the river port just east of the capital, which its barges carry down the Abhainn fhionn to the ships at Cathair dhomhain. Townsfolk set the stacks alight. The ships put in at Ros dhomhain instead, and burn their own stores.
- 10 AN CÈITEAN 1929 DE** — *The fishermen of Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). Fishing boats from Seann Chwen and Ros ruadh, sailing by night along the south coast, board a Company coaster at anchor and burn her. The Company withdraws its coastal shipping to the harbours of Ros dhomhain and Ros bheag.
- 11 AN CÈITEAN 1929 DE** — *The other Seann Chwen* (Seann Chwen). The fishermen of the other Seann Chwen, on the south coast further west, join the raids along the shore. The record keeps the two towns apart by naming their boats.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 1929 DE** — *Cathair gheal behind its walls* (Cathair gheal). The human town of Cathair gheal, on the northern concession, closes its gates and raises a militia, but sends none of it south to the Residency. Its magistrate writes to both sides asking to be left alone. The council grants it; Strake does not reply.
- 28 AN CÈITEAN 1929 DE** — *Muileann àrsaidh closes its road* (Muileann àrsaidh). The concession town of Muileann àrsaidh closes its road with carts and keeps a watch on it, against both sides. No one attacks it. The watch is kept for the rest of the war.
- 5 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1929 DE** — *The hawk-shrines open* (Seann Skell). Ìomhar Seabhag declares from the shrine at Seann Skell that the war is Mòd's own hunger turned back on those who fed it. Hawk-shrines across the west become recruiting houses, and a company of the hawk-faithful marches south to join the council.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1929 DE** — *The hawk company at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). The company of the hawk-faithful is mustered at Seann Skell, the western city, from which the human port of Ros bheag lies a short march to the south-west. It holds the road between Ros bheag and the north-west for the rest of the war.
- 9 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1929 DE** — *The southern beacon dark* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The keepers at Tobar dhearg put out the beacon, and the keepers at Àth dhearg and Baile ìseal follow. Company ships feeling their way along the coast by night run on the reefs the beacons were built to light, and two are lost.

- 10 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1929 DE** — *No relief from the west* (Muir Mhanannain). The Administration's letter-books record repeated requests for troops and ships from an Tìr Thall. One ship arrives in the whole first year of the war, carrying dispatches and a few crates of cartridges, and sails again within the week.
- 26 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1929 DE** — *The winter lines* (Ros dhomhain). Through the first winter of the war the council holds the hills, the east and the capital; Strake holds the Residency, the quarter of the harbour below it, and the western ports. Neither side has the strength to attack the other.
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 1929 DE** — *Grain from Seann Warr* (Seann Warr). The farming town of Seann Warr in the south-east, not the salt port of the same name in the west, sends grain to the hills through the winter by the eastern roads. The council's roll lists the carts.
- 8 AN T-IUCHAR 1929 DE** — *Hunger in the capital* (Cathair dhearg). Cathair dhearg goes short through the winter, its harbour held by the Residency. The custodians share out the grain by household. The roll records that the custodians took the same share as everyone else.
- 9 AN T-IUCHAR 1929 DE** — *The burning of the third currency's records*. Rebels destroy the human administration's tithe ledgers in three separate raids — an act later chroniclers treat as symbolically decisive even though its practical effect was small.
- 5 AN LÙNASTAL 1929 DE** — *The counting-house at Ros dhombhain* (Ros dhomhain). The first raid was on the Company's counting-house at the Ros dhomhain quay, inside the lines. Men of the harbour quarter led by Dùghall Dubh came in over the roofs, carried the tithe books into the yard and burned them.
- 6 AN LÙNASTAL 1929 DE** — *The tithe-house at Ceann àrsaidh* (Ceann àrsaidh). The second raid burned the Administration's tithe-house at Ceann àrsaidh, where the portion owed by every settlement in the hills had been entered since the first schedule. The clerks were let go. The custodians of Ceann àrsaidh asked that one ledger be spared for the record, and were refused by their own people.
- 7 AN LÙNASTAL 1929 DE** — *The weigh-house at Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). The third raid burned the Company's weigh-house at Muileann chrom with its steelyard ledgers. The ore of the hills since the first contract had been entered there by the ton. The rebels' own chronicler writes that the fire burned green.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1929 DE** — *The fight at Cnoc ghorm* (Cnoc ghorm). Company guards and constables sallying from the capital's harbour to recover the eastern road are driven back at Cnoc ghorm, in the hills beyond the capital. It is the last attempt of the war by the Administration to reach the mining district.

- 4 AN T-SULTAIN 1929 DE** — *The harbour quarter changes sides* (Ros dhomhain). The Ròdaich of the Ros dhomhain harbour quarter, after the counting-house raid, open the lower gates to the council's companies. Strake is left holding the Residency and the Company's quays alone. The same night men of the harbour quarter burn the Company's flying machine in its shed above the town. It had not flown since the war began, for want of the spirit its engine burned, and nothing has flown over Rodos since that was not a bird.
- 5 AN T-SULTAIN 1929 DE** — *Cuan uaine opens its quays* (Cuan uaine). The river quays of Cuan uaine, east of the capital, open to the council's boats. With them and the Ros dhomhain harbour quarter both lost, the Residency can be supplied only by water, up the Abhainn gheal from the sea.
- 21 AN T-SULTAIN 1929 DE** — *Strake abandons the Residency* (Ros dhomhain). Lionel Strake evacuates the Residency by water, down the Abhainn gheal, with his officials, the Mission's clergy and the Company's agents, and removes the Administration to Ros bheag. The council's companies enter the Residency the next morning and find it stripped of everything but its furniture.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 1929 DE** — *Ros bheag the last seat* (Ros bheag). At Ros bheag, the western port the humans had used since the early years, Strake sets up what remains of the Administration. The human families of the west and the south, a few thousand in all, gather behind its walls.
- 3 AN DÀMHAIR 1929 DE** — *Outposts at Ros àrsaidh* (Ros àrsaidh). Strake posts constables at Ros àrsaidh, north of Ros bheag, to hold the coast road, Ceum Ros àrsaidh. The townsfolk bring them food and news, and the news is always a day old.
- 4 AN DÀMHAIR 1929 DE** — *Hunger in Ros bheag* (Ros bheag). With the roads cut and no ships from the west, Ros bheag runs short of food within months. The Company's stores are opened to the human families and to the Ròdaich townsfolk alike, on Strake's order, the one act of his that the Ròdaich record credits.
- 20 AN DÀMHAIR 1929 DE** — *Cuan shean refuses the humans* (Cuan shean). The custodians of Cuan shean, the town where the first humans came ashore, close its harbour to Company ships. The council's roll notes the irony without comment.
- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 1929 DE** — *The families of Baile dhìreach* (Baile dhìreach). At Baile dhìreach the descendants of the old joint council, many of them of both peoples, are asked by each side which they are. The record says most of them refused to answer, and that neither side forced them.
- 1 AN T-SAMHAIN 1929 DE** — *The last ship from the west* (Muir Mhanannain). The last ship recorded arriving from an Tìr Thall anchors at Ros bheag on Samhain. She brings no troops and no grain, only a sealed letter for the Commissioner, and she sails again on the next tide with as many passengers as she can hold.

- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 1929 DE** — *The truce of Àth àrsaidh* (Àth àrsaidh). Envoys of the council and of the Administration meet at Àth àrsaidh, on the edge of the northern concession. They agree a truce: the humans remaining on Rodos to withdraw into the north-west under the council's safe-conduct, the council to leave the concession towns standing.
- 20 AN T-SAMHAIN 1929 DE** — *Baile Mòr ruadh receives the columns* (Baile Mòr ruadh). Baile Mòr ruadh, the largest town of the north-west, is named in the truce as the place where the columns will be received. Its Ròdaich people are given the choice of staying or going south. The record gives the numbers of each and they are close.
- 29 AN T-SAMHAIN 1929 DE** — *The columns go north* (Cuan shean). The human families of Ros bheag, Cuan shean, Baile dhìreach and the south-west march north along the western roads under guard of the council's companies. Few of them had ever lived in the north. The roll records that no column was attacked, and that none was helped.
- 30 AN T-SAMHAIN 1929 DE** — *The columns at Àth chrom* (Àth chrom). The columns cross the ford at Àth chrom on the way north. The custodians of the town stand at the ford and count them over, and the count is the last the Ròdaich make of the humans on Rodos in this age.
- I AN DÙBHLACHD 1929 DE** — *Àth leathan* (Àth leathan). At Àth leathan, on the last stage before the northern territory, the columns camp for a night. The custodians of the town record that the humans asked the name of the place, and that the name was written down by several of them.
- 5 AN DÙBHLACHD 1929 DE** — *The ship that sailed west* (Cuan shean). Lionel Strake, the last Commissioner, sails west from Cuan shean with his officials in the last ship on the island that could make the crossing. The keeper at Taigh-solais Baile chrom records her passing in his daybook. Nothing on Rodos records her arriving anywhere.
- 19 AN DÙBHLACHD 1929 DE** — *The beacons relit* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). The council orders the five beacons lit again, from Baile chrom round to Tobar dhearg. The keepers' daybooks, which had counted human ships since the ring was finished, continue to be kept, with nothing in them.
- 29 AN DÙBHLACHD 1929 DE** — *The rolls sent to Muileann chaol* (Muileann chaol). The custodians send what survives of the age's rolls, their copies of the petitions, the book of Baile thais and the letter-books left in the Residency, to the cellars at Muileann chaol. What the Administration's own clerks carried west with Strake is not known.
- I AM FAOILLEACH 1930 DE** — *The Severance*. The war ends with the crossing itself closed. Whatever let humans reach Rodos shuts. The humans still on the island are shepherded to the northern territory their descendants hold today. Cian and Lorccan, not yet twenty, grow up in its immediate wake.

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- 22 AM MÀRT 1930 DE** — *The Tuathaich homeland fixed.* Human descendants stranded by the Severance are formally settled in the island's north — a confinement, not a homecoming, though later generations will simply call it home.
- 3 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1930 DE** — *The Severance companies stood down* (Cathair dhearg). The war-companies that fought the last campaign against the human administration are disbanded at Cathair dhearg. Their rolls are handed to the council rather than burned, and the companies are never formally abolished; they survive as names on a list.
- 31 AN T-IUCHAR 1930 DE** — *The boundary stones set* (Caol mhòr). Stones are set on the roads running north to mark where the Tuathaich territory begins. No wall follows them. Many still stand at the roadside, and nobody has been paid to move them.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 1930 DE** — *The hungry year at Doire ghlas* (Doire ghlas). Cut off from the stores that used to come over the water from an Tìr Thall, the northern settlements go short of grain in their first year alone. Tuathaich memory, taken down long afterwards, puts the dead at Doire ghlas above two hundred. No Ròdaich count was made.
- 11 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1931 DE** — *The human counting-houses emptied* (Ros dhomhain). Council clerks enter the human administration's counting-houses at Cathair dhearg, Ros dhomhain and Seann Skell and carry off everything written. What the raids of the war left of the tithe ledgers is boxed with the rest, unread, because few of the clerks can read the humans' hand.
- 10 AN T-IUCHAR 1931 DE** — *The north-west ports without a master* (Inis àrsaidh). At Ceann mhòr, Cathair gheal and Inis àrsaidh, the humans' harbour officers leave with the last ships before the crossing closes, taking their keys. The Tuathaich fishermen break the locks on the harbour stores and share out what they find by household.
- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 1931 DE** — *Rìoghachd Ròdais declared* (Cathair dhearg). The state formally restyles itself a kingdom in form, whatever it remains in function — the same contradiction its own records still carry today.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1931 DE** — *The Moot at Caol mhòr* (Caol mhòr). Tuathaich householders from the northern towns meet at Caol mhòr and choose a speaker, Walter Hale, a former harbour clerk. The Moot has no standing in Ròdaich law. It meets anyway and keeps its own minutes, which run unbroken from this meeting to the present.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 1931 DE** — *The council of the kingdom seated* (Cathair dhearg). A royal council of twelve is seated at Cathair dhearg, drawn from the custodian families and the captains of the Severance war. Its minute-books are the oldest continuous record of the state in this age.
- 8 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1932 DE** — *The harbour-houses of Ros dhomhain taken over* (Ros dhomhain). The customs sheds the humans built at Ros dhomhain, the kingdom's largest port, pass to Ròdaich harbour-masters. The first of them, Dùghall mac Iain, keeps the humans' tariff in force for want of another and translates it line by line over the following years.

- 11 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1932 DE** — *The ship sent west* (Muir Mhanannain). The council sends a ship out past the western capes to look for the crossing the humans used. It comes back after a month of open water and reports nothing: no land, no ship, no sign of the passage. No second ship is sent. The priests of Manannan at Seann Skell say that the lord of the sea has shut the western sea again, as they have prayed him to since the Crossing.
- 19 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1932 DE** — *Niall crowned* (Cathair dhearg). The first ruler of the restored kingdom takes the throne at Cathair dhearg by Macha's rite — the opening name in the line the state's own chronicles keep unbroken from here forward.
- 7 AN DÙBHLACHD 1932 DE** — *A saying enters speech* (Cathair dhearg). The crowning passes with so little dispute that 'mar a thàinig Niall', the way Niall came, becomes a saying for any smooth handing-over of power. Its first written use is in a Cathair dhearg tavern ledger, set against a debt settled without argument.
- 12 AN DÙBHLACHD 1932 DE** — *The shires drawn* (Cathair dhearg). The council divides the kingdom into siorrachdan, each named for its seat, and keeps most of the human administration's district lines under the new names. The humans' surveys are the only complete ones on the island; the kingdom uses them and does not say so.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 1932 DE** — *The windy coast left out* (Seann Vell). The shire lines stop where the humans' survey stopped, at the edge of the great moss of the far north-west. The windy coast beyond, an Oirthir Ghaothach, with its sealers and fowlers, is put in no shire and given no maor. The council's minute says only that it 'is not in the survey'.
- 20 AN DÙBHLACHD 1932 DE** — *The island shires* (Eilean dhìreach). Two rocks that each kept a customs station of the Administration, Eilean dhìreach off the Tuathaich coast and Eilean iséal off the east coast, are kept as shires of their own, since the council has no rule for folding a district into its neighbour. Neither has a town to name it, and each shire takes its island's name.
- 23 AN DÙBHLACHD 1932 DE** — *The market of Ceann mhòr* (Ceann mhòr). When the shires are drawn, the Tuathaich of Ceann mhòr are given a market right for the north-west coast. Its court sits in the harbour store whose locks the fishermen had broken. Fish, whale-oil, seal-oil, amber, dyes and the tobacco of the concession farms are sold there.
- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 1933 DE** — *The maor appointed* (Ceann mhòr). A maor is appointed to each shire to collect the Crown's dues and keep its peace. In the Tuathaich shires the maor are Ròdaich, lodged in the seat towns; at Ceann mhòr the maor's house is the old human magistrate's, and the townspeople call it by the old name.
- 21 AM FAOILLEACH 1933 DE** — *The Crown's dues set* (Cathair dhearg). The council sets the dues the maor are to collect: a head-due, cìs-cinn, on every household by the number of its heads, and a market-due, cìs-margaidh, on every sale made by a seller of the kingdom. The humans' harbour tariff at Ros dhomhain stays in force until the kingdom has a coin of its own to take the market-due in.

- 2 AN GEARRAN 1933 DE** — *The roll of arms* (Cathair dhearg). The council's clerks make Clàr nan Suaicheantas, a roll of arms, so that each maor can seal his court's letters. The kingdom's arms are cut again from the custody's old seal, and every shire is given arms of its own. Many of the charges are copied from a book of arms left at the Residency, and so lions, parrots and crocodiles appear on the seals of shires where no one has ever seen one. The Ròdaich shires take the pointed shield of the custody's seal. The Tuathaich shires keep the rounded shield of the humans' district seals. At Seann Skell in the west the house of Òrd Mhanannain asks for its badge, the yellow scorpion of Manannan's cup, and that shire's arms are the only ones on the roll to carry a scorpion.
- 8 AM MÀRT 1933 DE** — *The maor of Baile Mòr mhòr* (Baile Mòr mhòr). The first maor of Siorrachd Baile Mòr mhòr, Coinneach mac Ailein, holds his court under the market roof of the town, since the humans' courthouse has burned. He keeps the court there after the new courthouse is built, and so do his successors.
- 3 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1933 DE** — *Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol*. The Great Wave strikes the southern coast without warning, devastating Cnoc chaol, Cuan dhearg and Achadh mhin in a single night — the first disaster the new state responds to on its own terms.
- 24 AN T-SAMHAIN 1933 DE** — *The dead of the Great Wave counted* (Cuan dhearg). Relief parties from Cathair dhearg reach Cuan dhearg on the southern coast and count the dead of the three settlements at a little over nine hundred. The harbour at Cuan dhearg is gone. Its boats are found in the fields behind the town. The wave has run on up the gulf as far as Ros gharbh, the seat of its shire, broken its quays and thrown the gulf's fishing fleet onto the headland; the town stands high and has lost few people, and nearly every boat.
- 6 AN DÙBHLACHD 1933 DE** — *Achadh mhin under salt* (Achadh mhin). The fields of Achadh mhin lie under salt and will not bear. The council moves the survivors to higher ground and pays for their seed from the treasury, the first relief the restored kingdom ever grants.
- 23 AN DÙBHLACHD 1933 DE** — *Cnoc chaol rebuilt on the hill* (Cnoc chaol). Cnoc chaol is rebuilt on the slope behind the old town, out of the wave's reach. The old site is left as the water left it. The townspeople call it an Tràigh Bhàthte, the drowned strand, and do not build there.
- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 1934 DE** — *Tonn* (Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol). The accounts gathered from survivors by the relief parties use 'tonn', wave, for anything sudden and overwhelming. Within a generation the sense is heard across the south: 'tha e san tonn', he is in the wave of it.
- 1 AN GIBLEAN 1934 DE** — *The wave's reach on Eilean mhin* (Eilean mhin). The Great Wave also crosses the low island of Eilean mhin off the southern coast, where no one then lived year-round. The shepherds who summered there do not go back.
- 30 AN GIBLEAN 1934 DE** — *The old human coinage withdrawn*. Every remaining piece of human currency is formally demonetized. A new Rìoghachd coinage, minted with obsidian-dust ink in its seal, replaces it within a year.

- 9 AN DÀMHAIR 1934 DE** — *The mint at Cathair dhearg* (Cathair dhearg). A mint is set up in the old human counting-house at Cathair dhearg under Fearchar mac Dhòmhnaill, called Fearchar Bonn. The seal of each coin is pressed with an ink ground from obsidian dust, so that a clipped coin shows the colour at its edge.
- 7 AN T-SAMHAIN 1934 DE** — *The northern savings voided* (Caol mhòr). Tuathaich households kept what savings they had in the humans' coin. With its withdrawal those savings are worth their metal by weight and no more. The Moot at Caol mhòr petitions the council for an exchange. The petition is received and filed.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 1935 DE** — *Joseph Marlow's ploughshares* (Doire mhin). At Doire mhin in the north a smith named Joseph Marlow melts down his neighbours' withdrawn coin and casts it into ploughshares, which he sells back to them at the cost of the charcoal. Tuathaich songs still name him.
- 3 AM MÀRT 1935 DE** — *The coin at Inis thais* (Inis thais). At Inis thais on the south-west coast the new coin is short for most of the year and the town's merchants trade in chits written on the paper of the house of the Stone. The chits are redeemed at the house's door when the coin arrives, and the house keeps a tenth.
- 18 AN GIBLEAN 1935 DE** — *Òrd Bhrìde formalized*. The Obsidian Rite, Òrd Bhrìde, the order that keeps Brìde's flame and Crom's stone, becomes organized doctrine within the Old Faith rather than diffuse folk reverence, built around the leyline and the unbroken line of the obsidian-touched.
- 17 AN CÈITEAN 1935 DE** — *The first high custodian of the Rite* (Seann Skell). Dòmhnall mac Thormoid is named Àrd-choimheadaiche of Òrd Bhrìde and seated at Seann Skell on the southern coast, where the order's largest house stands. His first charge is a written order of worship. There had never been one.
- 23 AN CÈITEAN 1935 DE** — *The Hawk houses refuse* (Cnoc bheag). The houses of Òrd an t-Seabhaig around Cnoc bheag decline the new order of worship, holding that the Old Faith's older form needs no custodian above the local altar. They are not compelled. The long quarrel between the Hawk and the Rite begins here.
- 29 AN CÈITEAN 1935 DE** — *The hawk-house at Muileann naomh takes the order* (Muileann naomh). The hawk-house at Muileann naomh, the southernmost of the Hawk's houses and the farthest from Cnoc bheag, accepts the Rite's written order of worship and becomes a house of Òrd Bhrìde. Its bell, the first hung in a hawk-house, is rung now at the Rite's measured burnings. No other house of the Hawk follows it.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 1936 DE** — *The houses of the Stone stand aside* (Baile Mòr fhionn). The houses of Òrd na Cloiche in the south-west, whose Clach, the Lia Fàil, is not Crom's stone, are asked to send witnesses to the formalizing of the Rite at Seann Skell. They send none, and a letter saying they wish it well.

- 10 AN GEARRAN 1936 DE** — *The Moot's schoolhouse petition* (Caol mhòr). Walter Hale asks the council for leave to open schools in the north that teach in the humans' tongue. The council answers that the kingdom's schools teach in Ròdais and that it has no others. The Moot's minute calls the answer 'clear, at least'.
- 26 AN GEARRAN 1936 DE** — *The crown's order and the court* (Cathair dhearg). The house of Òrd Mhacha at Cathair dhearg, the order of the capital and the crown, is given the keeping of the coronation regalia, as it had been before the humans came. The Rite's high custodian asks for a share of the keeping and is refused.
- 29 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1936 DE** — *The first post-Severance census*. The state counts its own population for the first time since reclaiming the island — and quietly notes, without further comment, exactly how few obsidian-touched individuals actually exist.
- 30 AN T-IUCHAR 1936 DE** — *The census of the faiths* (Baile chrom). The first census of the restored kingdom enters every town under the faith its people keep, the Old Faith, the Old Spirits or the Church, the first such roll since Seumas Bàn's clerks counted the rites at Dùn iséal. On the far north-western cape beyond Baile chrom, where there is no town, the clerks find scattered families with no house of any faith, and on Eilean ghorm and the smallest islets no one to ask. They enter all of it as *gun chreideamb*, without a faith.
- 15 AN LÙNASTAL 1936 DE** — *The count taken from the road* (Doire ghlas). Ròdaich census clerks count the Tuathaich towns of Siorrachd Doire ghlas from the road, without entering most houses. The Moot keeps its own tally the same year. The two totals differ by nearly a fifth, and each side keeps its own.
- 23 AN LÙNASTAL 1936 DE** — *The circuit justices* (Cathair dhomhain). Justices are appointed to ride circuit among the shires, the first of them Eilidh nic Leòid of Cathair dhomhain. Her circuit covers eleven shires of the south-west and takes most of a year to ride once.
- 27 AN T-SULTAIN 1936 DE** — *The head-due first collected* (Cathair dhearg). The maor collect the head-due for the first time, on the households the census counted, at eighteen purses on every hundred thousand heads, and take it with the harbour dues.
- 3 AM MÀRT 1937 DE** — *Muileann bhàn's waterworks* (Muileann bhàn). Muileann bhàn, on the southern plain, builds the first public waterworks of the restored kingdom: a stone tank on the hill fed by the mill-race, with lead pipes to four street wells. The Guild of Hewers sends its surveyors to learn how it was done.
- 10 AN T-SULTAIN 1937 DE** — *The Leòid ruling* (Seann Bhrál). Sitting at Seann Bhrál, Eilidh nic Leòid rules that land held by Tuathaich under human title passes to the Crown, while the right to work it stays with the holders and their heirs. The ruling is cited in nearly every land case of the age that follows.
- 9 AN DÀMHAIR 1937 DE** — *The ore line repaired* (Muileann chrom). The railway the humans built from the central mountains to the sea, broken in three places during the Severance war, is repaired as far as Muileann chrom. A Rail Board is formed at Cathair dhearg to run it, with a clerk, two engineers and the humans' timetable.

- 17 AN DÙBHLACHD 1937 DE** — *The bridge at Cathair dhearg re-dedicated* (Drochaid Cathair dhearg). The stone bridge over the Abhainn dhomhain below the capital, rebuilt under the humans, is re-dedicated with a Ròdais name-stone. The humans' stone is not removed. It is turned to face the river.
- 15 AM FAOILLEACH 1938 DE** — *The necropolis at Cnoc dhìreach* (Tuam Cnoc dhìreach). The shire of Ceann mhin closes the old burial ground at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach to new graves, since the vines have broken too many stones to find room. Families of the town still tend the old graves, and some say the place is not empty after dark.
- 13 AN GEARRAN 1938 DE** — *Eaglais nan Tuathach persists*. Tuathaich communities keep their Church alive in the north — including, quietly, the telling of the First Canoe, the voyage of Naomh Breandan to the Isle of the Blessed, which the Ròdaich priesthood still calls superstition.
- 14 AM MÀRT 1938 DE** — *The Grey Night kept openly* (Baile chrom). At Baile chrom in the far north-west, the vigil-keeper Hannah Crane holds the vigil of Rùn-diomhair na h-Oidhche Glaise in the open for the first time since the Severance. The sect keeps one night of silence in the year under Sine, the Peaceful Goose, its name for the wild goose of the Holy Spirit. The Church's bishops call the vigil irregular. Outsiders are not told which night it is.
- 30 AM MÀRT 1938 DE** — *The churches of the north* (Cnoc ghorm). Most Tuathaich towns keep An Eaglais, the Church their forebears brought at the Crossing, while the Ròdaich of the west coast beside them keep Manannan's order. A church is built at Cnoc ghorm, the largest in the north.
- 12 AN GIBLEAN 1938 DE** — *The cattle-market at Muileann fhionn* (Muileann fhionn). Muileann fhionn, the mill-town the humans built to guard the northern landing, takes a market right for the north-western interior. The Tuathaich drovers bring their cattle and sheep to it, and the droves go south from it to Ceann leathan and the south-eastern farms. It becomes the largest cattle-market on the island.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 1939 DE** — *The church school at Cnoc ghorm* (Cnoc ghorm). The church at Cnoc ghorm opens a school for its priests, teaching in the humans' tongue and reading the Bible in the Ròdais text its preachers use on the west coast. It is the only place in the north where both are taught.
- 11 AN CÈITEAN 1939 DE** — *The border wall proposed*. A formal boundary between Ròdaich and Tuathaich territory is proposed for the first time. It is rejected — not out of principle, records suggest, but because it's considered unnecessary. The two populations are already staying apart on their own.
- 9 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1939 DE** — *The minute on the wall* (Cathair dhearg). The council minute that rejects the boundary wall runs to four lines. The fourth reads: 'They do not come south.' It is initialled by five of the twelve councillors, and the other seven did not sign against it.

- 8 AN T-IUCHAR 1939 DE** — *The Allt an Àigh walk* (Allt an Àigh). Followers of Na Seann Spioradan keep up their yearly walk to the holy well called Allt an Àigh in the east, whose water the old tales say brings fortune. The custodians of the Rite discourage the walk and do not forbid it.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 1940 DE** — *The walkers at Achadh gharbh* (Achadh gharbh). The walkers to Allt an Àigh lodge at Achadh gharbh on the way, and the village builds a long hall for them. The hall's keeper writes each walker's shire in a book, which by the end of the decade holds names from fifty shires.
- 15 AN CÈITEAN 1940 DE** — *Extraction resumes at full scale*. The mine's post-Severance yield matches, then exceeds, its colonial-era output. Nothing about the method changed. Only who profits did.
- 23 AN CÈITEAN 1940 DE** — *The Sloc Mòr concession* (Achadh dhomhain). The Crown grants the working of the Sloc Mòr, the great shaft at Achadh dhomhain, to Uisdean mac Ùisdein of Cathair mhòr, whose house held an overseer's post under the humans. The terms give the Crown a fifth of the yield. They are the humans' terms with the names changed.
- 18 AN T-SAMHAIN 1940 DE** — *The night-shift kept* (Cnoc fhiadhaich). The council declines to end the continuous working of the vein, day and night, that the humans ordered two generations before. The mountain is still given no season of rest. The custodians of the Rite enter a protest and then bless the shafts.
- 14 AM MÀRT 1941 DE** — *The pit towns fill* (Muileann dhearg). Ròdaich families from the hungry east move to the vein-towns for wages. Muileann dhearg doubles in size within three years, and its hall of the druid school, shut since the humans' time, is taken for a hewers' lodging and enlarged twice in the same span.
- 6 AN LÙNASTAL 1941 DE** — *Baile thais grows on the ore road* (Baile thais). Baile thais, where the ore road from the central mountains comes down to the Abhainn uaine above the gulf, takes on carters, inns and a ropewalk. Its population doubles in a decade, and the town is given a shire court.
- 4 AN T-SULTAIN 1941 DE** — *Raiders off Cathair gheal* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Ships that no longer fly any flag, some crewed by men who once served the human administration, begin raiding the coast off Cathair gheal in the north-west. The Tuathaich towns suffer first and are not defended.
- 3 AN DÀMHAIR 1941 DE** — *The ore line reaches the Sloc Mòr* (Achadh dhomhain). The repaired railway is carried up the valley to the pithead at Achadh dhomhain. The first ore train from the Sloc Mòr to Cathair dhearg runs under the kingdom's name and on the humans' rails.
- 25 AN CÈITEAN 1942 DE** — *The quarry at Achadh dhomhain* (Achadh dhomhain). The spoil of the Sloc Mòr, a black-veined grey stone, is cut and sold as building stone under the house of Mac Ùisdein's quarry-mark. It is used for public buildings across the south for the next forty years.

- 8 AN T-IUCHAR 1942 DE** — *The shunting yards at Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). The Rail Board lays new sidings at Muileann chrom, where ore trains from the Sloc Mòr are broken up and made up again for the ports. The yard's families, who work the small engines that move the wagons, are counted separately by the Board and live apart in rows by the lines.
- 21 AN T-SULTAIN 1942 DE** — *The western branch* (Seann Bhral). The Rail Board carries a branch of the ore line west from Cathair dhearg to the port of Seann Bhral, with a spur north to the pits at Àth leathan, so that the western workings can send their ore east by rail.
- 20 AN DÀMHAIR 1942 DE** — *The guild system restored*. The old apprentice-binding custom from the Holy Age is revived in modified form, now explicitly reserved for Ròdaich applicants only.
- 6 AN T-SAMHAIN 1942 DE** — *The Guild of Hewers chartered* (Achadh dhomhain). The first guild under the restored custom, the Guild of Hewers, is chartered at Achadh dhomhain. Its oath is taken with a hand on a piece of ore. Its rolls are open to Ròdaich only, as the charter requires.
- 29 AM FAOILLEACH 1943 DE** — *The shipwrights of Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). The shipwrights of Ros dhomhain take a guild charter of their own and bind their first thirty apprentices in a single day on the slipway.
- 28 AM MÀRT 1943 DE** — *The indentures broken* (Cuan shean). At Cuan shean and Seann Bhral, Tuathaich boys already bound to Ròdaich masters are released from their indentures under the charter rule. Some go north. Most stay on as day-labour, outside the guilds and their wages.
- 26 AN GIBLEAN 1943 DE** — *The chandlers of Ceann àrsaidh* (Ceann àrsaidh). The ship-chandlers of Ceann àrsaidh, on the Abhainn fhionn east of the capital, take a guild charter and a monopoly of supplying the Crown's patrol boats. The monopoly outlasts the patrol boats.
- 23 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1943 DE** — *The lamp-makers of Muileann mhin* (Muileann mhin). The lamp-makers of Muileann mhin, who make the ore lamps used in every shaft on the island, are chartered as a guild. Their mark, a flame over a hammer, is stamped on every lamp and is the only guild mark the humans' traders had ever copied.
- 6 AM FAOILLEACH 1944 DE** — *The weavers of Baile chiar* (Baile chiar). The weavers of Baile chiar are chartered as a guild. Their cloth, woven from southern wool, undersells the northern cloth at the fair until the mills of Doire ghlas are built.
- 14 AM FAOILLEACH 1944 DE** — *Agnes Pike's school* (Doire ghlas). Agnes Pike, a Tuathaich teacher, opens a school at Doire ghlas that teaches in the humans' tongue, with Moot money and without the council's leave. Within a decade there are nine such schools in the north. The council never licenses them and never closes them.

- 19 AN T-IUCHAR 1944 DE** — *The Cill ghlas district reopened* (Scàineadh Cill ghlas). The mining district closed since the Rending is surveyed and declared safe to work. The first new shafts are cut well back from the old fault line, on the surveyors' word.
- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 1944 DE** — *The Leòid circuit in the north* (Ceann mhòr). Eilidh nic Leòid rides the northern circuit for the first time and holds court at Ceann mhòr. Of the nineteen cases brought before her, seventeen are Tuathaich suits over land. She finds for the Crown in fifteen, citing her own ruling.
- 2 AN GIBLEAN 1945 DE** — *Eilidh nic Leòid dies* (Cathair dhomhain). Eilidh nic Leòid dies at Cathair dhomhain. Her rulings are bound as a single book, the first law-book of the restored kingdom, and every circuit justice after her carries a copy.
- 1 AN CÈITEAN 1945 DE** — *Leabharlann Muileann chaol founded* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). A great library is established at Muileann chaol — the institution that will eventually keep the most complete surviving record of everything in this chronicle.
- 28 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1945 DE** — *Ailean Leabhar, first keeper* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Ailean mac Iain, called Ailean Leabhar, is appointed the first keeper of Leabharlann Muileann chaol. He brings with him the council's minute-books and what survived of the humans' tithe ledgers, takes in the custodians' rolls kept in the town's cellars since the Severance war, and spends his first years having them read.
- 3 AN T-SAMHAIN 1945 DE** — *A chur san Leabharlann* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Within a few years, 'a chur san Leabharlann', to put it in the Library, is said of anything made settled and beyond dispute. Ailean Leabhar is recorded as disliking the phrase, on the ground that the library settles nothing and only keeps it.
- 30 AN CÈITEAN 1946 DE** — *The first readers* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The library's first reading room opens to anyone who can show a letter from a shire maor. The first reader entered in its book is a shipwright of Ros dhomhain, asking for the humans' plans of their hulls.
- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 1946 DE** — *The bath-house at the hot springs* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). A new bath-house is built over the hot springs near Muileann ruadh, paid for by the Guild of Hewers for miners sick with the dust. The guild's sick-roll for its first year lists four hundred men by name and shift.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 1946 DE** — *The keepers of the five lights* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). The five lighthouses built under the humans are given Ròdaich keepers by royal warrant. At Taigh-solais Baile chrom, on the Tuathaich coast, the keeper is a Ròdaich man lodged in a Tuathaich town, and his warrant tells him to report what he sees on land as well as at sea.
- 22 AN DÀMHAIR 1946 DE** — *The Muileann chaol town grows* (Muileann chaol). Copyists, binders and paper-makers settle in Muileann chaol around the library. The town takes a market charter, and its first market day is held in the library's yard.

- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 1947 DE** — *The paper-mill at Tobar dhìreach* (Tobar dhìreach). A paper-mill is built at Tobar dhìreach, a few miles from the library, on the stream below the village. For the next half-century nearly every page of the royal chronicle is written on its paper.
- 20 AN T-SAMHAIN 1947 DE** — *The first royal chronicler appointed* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). A formal office is created specifically to maintain the kingdom's records — the direct ancestor of the archive this very document draws from.
- 19 AN DÙBHLACHD 1947 DE** — *Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The first royal chronicler is Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill, a clerk of the council. She keeps her record at Muileann chaol, not at the capital, and writes in her first entry that a record kept beside the throne is kept for the throne.
- 25 AM MÀRT 1948 DE** — *The first chronicle circuit* (Àth àrsaidh). Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill sends clerks to every shire to copy parish books, grave-lists and harbour rolls. The returns from the south fill forty chests. The returns from Siorrachd Àth àrsaidh and the other northern shires fill one; few Tuathaich will speak to the clerks.
- 2 AN GIBLEAN 1948 DE** — *The town arms copied* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The clerks of the first chronicle circuit copy the seal of every town they visit into the roll of arms, and the roll comes to hold the arms of five hundred and five places. In the north most are copied from the humans' old town seals, since few Tuathaich will show the clerks their own.
- II AN CÈITEAN 1948 DE** — *The chest from Inis bheag* (Inis bheag). The chronicle clerks at Inis bheag in the north-east are shown a parish book going back before the humans' coming, kept in the Seann Spioradan house there. The keeper lets it be copied and not taken.
- 28 AN T-SULTAIN 1948 DE** — *Boats lost off Cuan bheag* (Cuan bheag). A storm out of the west drowns eleven Tuathaich fishermen off Cuan bheag in the north. The village has no lifeboat. The Moot buys one by subscription and asks the council to pay half; the council pays a third.
- 9 AN GEARRAN 1949 DE** — *The thing off the north-west cape* (Uilebheist na Mara). Fishermen out of Achadh àrsaidh report a creature longer than their boats in the waters off the north-west cape. Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill records the report and adds that the same waters are where the raiders shelter.
- 10 AM MÀRT 1949 DE** — *The Eilean dhubh sheep-count* (Eilean dhubh). A royal clerk is sent to count the flocks on Eilean dhubh, the largest of the outer isles, to set the island's dues. The islanders count them for him, and the dues are set on their count.
- 8 AN GIBLEAN 1949 DE** — *Cathair gheal arms its boats* (Cathair gheal). The Tuathaich fishermen of Cathair gheal arm their own boats and drive the raiders out of the bay. The council, asked for help twice, had sent none. It later fines the town for bearing arms without licence, and the fine is paid.
- 31 AN LÙNASTAL 1949 DE** — *The market cross at Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). A market cross is raised at Cathair mhòr, paid for by the house of Mac Ùisdein, with the house's name cut on all four faces. The town's wool and ore markets are moved to its foot.

- 7 AN CÈITEAN 1950 DE** — *The house of the Stone at Caol leathan* (Caol leathan). The house of Òrd na Cloiche at Caol leathan, the largest of the order, is rebuilt with a tower from which a bell rings at the hours. The town sets its market and its courts by the bell.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 1950 DE** — *Fèill Muileann òg established* (Fèill Muileann òg). An annual fair becomes the island's largest recurring gathering, drawing trade from every province the state controls.
- 14 AN T-SAMHAIN 1950 DE** — *Oighrig nic Mhathain's rules* (Fèill Muileann òg). The first toll-mistress of the fair at Muileann òg, Oighrig nic Mhathain, sets its rules: a stall-fee in coin, a court of the fair for disputes, and Tuathaich goods sold only through Ròdaich factors. The rules are read aloud at each fair's opening to this day.
- 26 AN T-SAMHAIN 1950 DE** — *The fair's road* (Dùn chrom). The road from Cathair dhearg to Muileann òg is widened and metalled for the fair's carts, passing Dùn chrom, which takes a toll at its gate and grows on it. As far as Muileann ghlas it runs on the old ore road; the new stretches are called Rathad na Fèille.
- 2 AN LÙNASTAL 1951 DE** — *Dùn chrom's gate-toll* (Dùn chrom). The toll taken at Dùn chrom's gate on the fair road pays for a new wall on the town's southern side. The townspeople call it the fair's wall, and the fair's carters call it something else.
- 31 AN LÙNASTAL 1951 DE** — *Niall dies; Brìghde crowned* (Cathair dhearg). His daughter succeeds him without contest — mortal succession within an immortal-adjacent aristocracy, unremarkable at the time, unusual in hindsight.
- 29 AN T-SULTAIN 1951 DE** — *The chronicler's use of the saying* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill writes that the succession came 'mar a thàinig Niall', the first time the saying appears in the royal record. It is the only idiom she allows into the chronicle in her whole tenure.
- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 1951 DE** — *The ancestors' hall at Seann Dunn* (Seann Dunn). The Seann Spioradan houses of the east coast build a common hall at Seann Dunn, where the ancestors of forty families are named aloud each year by their living heads. The list is copied to the library the next year and grows by a few names every year after.
- 25 AN GEARRAN 1952 DE** — *Cuan ruadh's harbour light* (Cuan ruadh). Cuan ruadh on the east coast, which has no lighthouse of the five, raises a harbour light of its own on the mole, lit with ore bought by the town. The Lighthouse Board declines to take it on.
- 4 AM MÀRT 1952 DE** — *Còmhrag Ceann leathan established* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). A brutal annual melee tournament begins at Ceann leathan, ostensibly a martial tradition, increasingly a release valve for a population with fewer and fewer other outlets.
- 22 AN LÙNASTAL 1952 DE** — *Calum Ruadh* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). The first champion of the Còmhrag the record remembers is Calum mac Aonghais, called Calum Ruadh, a hewer from Muileann chrom. Two men die in the melee he wins. The prize is a year's wages and the right to carry arms in any shire.

- 30 AN LÙNASTAL 1952 DE** — *Ceann leathan's inns* (Ceann leathan). Ceann leathan builds four new inns for the Còmhrag crowds. The fair-wardens of the town, who take a share of every room, become the Còmhrag's keepers in all but name.
- 10 AM MÀRT 1953 DE** — *The ore-ships of Ros gheal* (Ros gheal). Ros gheal on the north-central coast builds a dock for the grain-ships of the Hawk country. The Hawk houses bless the dock and ask a tithe of the dues. The shire gives them a twentieth.
- 7 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1953 DE** — *Splatter and Dodge's generation born*. A cluster of births in the Class-o8-adjacent shunting families — the generation that will grow up to become Dubhan's closest allies, Seachran and Brean among them.
- 6 AN T-IUCHAR 1953 DE** — *Seann Bhral in the south* (Seann Bhral). Seann Bhral on the south coast, not to be confused with its namesake in the west, becomes the kingdom's largest fishing port, landing more fish than Ros dhomhain. Its curing-sheds run the length of the harbour.
- 4 AN LÙNASTAL 1954 DE** — *The circus at Seann Chwen* (An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn). The travelling show that calls itself An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn is first recorded, pitched near Seann Chwen on the southern coast. The chronicler's clerk could not say what the acts were meant to show. Neither, the clerk adds, could the crowd, which came back the next night.
- 2 AN T-SULTAIN 1954 DE** — *Manannan's feast at Seann Bhral* (Seann Bhral). The house of Òrd Mhanannain at Seann Bhral, one of the oldest on the west coast, refuses to admit Tuathaich from the north who come for its feast of the sea, as their forebears had learned to from the Ròdaich harbours. Its keeper says the sea is the same and the house is not.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 1955 DE** — *The northern sea-feast* (Cnoc ghorm). Turned away at Seann Bhral, the Tuathaich keep the feast at the church at Cnoc ghorm instead, as a blessing of the boats. It is kept there every year after, and the northern feast is larger than the western within a generation.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1955 DE** — *The Depletion first acknowledged*. Survey reports begin quietly noting the vein's declining yield. The state does not act on them for years.
- 9 AN CÈITEAN 1955 DE** — *Iain Mapa's survey* (Achadh dhomhain). The survey behind the report is the work of Iain mac Ruairidh, called Iain Mapa, of the Mine Board. His measurements of the faces of the Sloc Mòr show the vein thinning to the east and south. The Board files the survey without circulating it, and Iain Mapa is moved to the silver works at Muileann chiar.
- 4 AM FAOILLEACH 1956 DE** — *The Mine Board at Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). The Mine Board, which had sat at Cathair dhearg since the Sloc Mòr concession, moves its clerks to Cathair mhòr to be nearer the mountain. Its surveys are kept there, not sent to the library, by the Board's own rule.

- 15 AN GEARRAN 1956 DE** — *The scent-makers of Seann Vell* (Seann Vell). The glass-houses of the capital shore begin to make small flasks, and the women of Seann Vell sell in them the waters they distil from bog-myrtle, meadowsweet and heather honey. Within a few years scent is sold in every market town, and the towns of the western plain take up the trade.
- 15 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1956 DE** — *The Grey Night forbidden* (Baile chrom). A Ròdaich magistrate at Baile chrom forbids the gatherings of the Grey Night sect as disorderly. Hannah Crane is fined. The vigil moves indoors and goes on.
- 9 AN T-IUCHAR 1956 DE** — *The harbour at Cuan dhearg reopened* (Cuan dhearg). The harbour at Cuan dhearg, lost to the Great Wave, is reopened with a new mole of dressed stone. The first boat in is one of those found in the fields behind the old town, refloated and kept by the harbour-master as a relic.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 1957 DE** — *Achadh mhin resettled* (Achadh mhin). The fields of Achadh mhin bear again, and a few of the families moved away after the Great Wave come back to them. The shire gives them their old boundaries from the humans' survey.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 1957 DE** — *Eòghan crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Brìghde's reign ends young — no cause is recorded publicly. Her cousin Eòghan takes the throne amid the first real succession tension the restored kingdom has faced.
- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 1957 DE** — *The succession entry* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The royal chronicler's entry for the succession gives the fact and nothing more. The chroniclers who followed Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill have added nothing to it.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 1957 DE** — *Dissent recorded in council* (Cathair dhearg). For the first time the council's minutes record votes against a succession. They name the councillors who voted and not their reasons. Two of them do not sit again.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1958 DE** — *Inis bhàn's fire* (Inis bhàn). Fire takes the warehouse quarter of Inis bhàn on the Abhainn ìseal in the north-central country and burns for two days. The town's Hawk house takes in the homeless. The fire-bell the town buys afterwards is the loudest in the kingdom.
- 9 AN CÈITEAN 1958 DE** — *Dubhan born*. Born mortal, into the exact confinement the Severance created, decades after the war that closed the island to the people his line descends from.
- 7 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1958 DE** — *The Tuathaich schools counted* (Doire ghlas). The Moot counts eleven schools in the north teaching in the humans' tongue, and three that have begun to teach Ròdais as well, at the parents' asking. Agnes Pike's school at Doire ghlas is among the three.
- 10 AN GIBLEAN 1959 DE** — *The stone house of Mac Ùisdein* (Cathair mhòr). Uisdean mac Ùisdein's house at Cathair mhòr is rebuilt in stone quarried from the spoil of the Sloc Mòr, the largest private house in the kingdom. The Guild of Hewers holds its feast in the new hall.

- 26 AN CÈITEAN 1959 DE** — *The northern fishing grounds* (Caol mhòr). Licences to fish the waters south and east of Caol mhòr are reserved to Ròdaich boats. The Tuathaich boats are left the northern grounds, which the raiders also work.
- 24 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1959 DE** — *Doire shean's harbour* (Doire shean). Doire shean in the south-west builds a stone harbour for the fishing boats of the Stone's country, the first new harbour since the Severance not paid for by the Crown. The house of the Stone lends the money and takes the harbour dues.
- 3 AN GIBLEAN 1960 DE** — *Trenches at Làrach an Dùin* (Làrach an Dùin). Diggers sent by the library open trenches at Làrach an Dùin on the south-east coast. They find walls older than any Ròdaich building and no writing at all. Ailean Leabhar orders the finds catalogued as of the Old Ones, purpose unknown.
- 7 AN DÀMHAIR 1960 DE** — *Làrach an Teampaill measured* (Làrach an Teampaill). The library's diggers measure the ruin called Làrach an Teampaill in the east but do not dig it, at the asking of the Seann Spioradan houses of the district. The keeper enters it as measured and let be.
- 29 AM MÀRT 1961 DE** — *The obelisk at Cnoc bheag copied* (Carragh Cnoc bheag). A scribe of the library copies the inscription on the obelisk near Cnoc bheag, stroke by stroke. It matches no script known on the island. The copy is filed and the obelisk is fenced.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1961 DE** — *A lighthouse on the Tuathaich coast* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). The Ròdaich keeper of Taigh-solais Baile chrom reports to the council that the Grey Night sect keeps its vigil in the dark of the lighthouse's own shadow. The council takes no action.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 1961 DE** — *Salt-pans of Àth bheag* (Àth bheag). Salt-pans are dug on the flats below Àth bheag on the east coast, and within a few years the town supplies the whole eastern seaboard. The salt is carried inland by the old drove road past Baile ìseal.
- 1 AM FAOILLEACH 1962 DE** — *Cathair fhada's grain-store* (Cathair fhada). Cathair fhada on the southern plain builds a Crown grain-store large enough to feed the south for a season. It is filled from the south's own harvests, and first opened in the dry years at Achadh shean.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 1962 DE** — *The second post-Severance census*. The gap between Ròdaich and Tuathaich living standards is, for the first time, measured rather than simply observed. The report is not made public.
- 28 AN GEARRAN 1962 DE** — *Walter Hale dies* (Caol mhòr). Walter Hale, first speaker of the Moot, dies at Caol mhòr. The Moot chooses Mary Coyle, a fisherman's widow, to follow him. She is the first woman to hold the chair.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 1963 DE** — *The census clerks' private note* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). One of the census clerks, Seonag nic Ille-Mhoire, leaves among her papers a note that she had asked to see the gap report and been refused. The note reached the library with her papers after her death and is the only mention of the report outside the council.

- 11 AN GEARRAN 1963 DE** — *The Tuathaich doctors* (Àth àrsaidh). The Moot pays for two Tuathaich women to be taught medicine by a Ròdaich physician at Àth àrsaidh, who takes them in defiance of his guild. He is struck from the guild's rolls. They practise in the north for forty years.
- 12 AM MÀRT 1963 DE** — *The Abhainn ìseal floods* (Abhainn ìseal). The Abhainn ìseal, the longest river on the island, breaks its banks along its lower reach, carrying away three bridges and a stretch of the ore line's embankment. The line is closed for most of a year and the ports live on stored ore.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 1964 DE** — *The Hawk houses' own custodian* (Inis ìseal). The Hawk houses of Siorrachd Cnoc bheag name a custodian of their own, Raonaid nic Iain, and seat her at Inis ìseal. The high custodian at Seann Skell refuses to recognise her. The houses carry on as if he had.
- 23 AN T-SAMHAIN 1964 DE** — *Raonaid nic Iain at Inis ìseal* (Inis ìseal). Raonaid nic Iain, custodian of the Hawk houses, writes out the Hawk's order of worship, which had been said and never written. The Hawk houses read it aloud once a year and keep the written copy locked away.
- 29 AN T-SAMHAIN 1964 DE** — *A hawk for Siorrachd Cnoc bheag* (Cnoc bheag). The Hawk houses of Siorrachd Cnoc bheag ask the council to put a hawk on the shire's arms in place of the white billet the roll had given it. The council agrees, and the maor's seal is recut with a white hawk among its twelve crescents. It is the first change made to the roll at an order's asking.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1965 DE** — *Six dead at the Còmhrag* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). Six fighters die at the Còmhrag, the most in any year yet. The custodians of the Rite petition for it to end. The fair-wardens of Ceann leathan, whose town lives off the crowds, refuse.
- 6 AN DÀMHAIR 1965 DE** — *The circus at Ceann leathan* (Ceann leathan). An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn pitches at Ceann leathan in the year of the Còmhrag's six dead and plays to the crowds who stay on after the melee. The fair-wardens are said to have paid it to come.
- 4 AN T-SAMHAIN 1965 DE** — *The ore line reaches Ceann leathan* (Ceann leathan). The railway is carried through to the port of Ceann leathan, so that ore can be shipped from a second harbour. Ceann leathan's quays are rebuilt for ore ships, and the town outgrows its walls.
- 3 AN DÙBHLACHD 1965 DE** — *Ros bheag's shipyard* (Ros bheag). Ros bheag on the west coast opens a shipyard for ore-ships, so that the western ports need no longer send to Ros dhomhain for hulls. The shipwrights of Ros dhomhain protest to the guild court and lose.
- 1 AM FAOILLEACH 1966 DE** — *The silver at depth* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). The silver seam at Muileann chiar, which the Ròdaich kept from the humans, is found richer at depth than anyone expected. The town's old silver guild takes a charter under the restored custom. Iain Mapa, working there since the Board moved him, measures the new faces.

- 19 AN T-SULTAIN 1966 DE** — *The eastern blank-houses* (Baile dhìreach). With more silver coming up from Muileann chiar than the mint at Cathair dhearg can refine, the Crown contracts the villages of the eastern hills to refine the guild's bar, and the gold washed from the stream below Baile dhìreach, into blanks for the realm-coin. The mint strikes them. The villages are paid by weight.
- 3 AN DÀMHAIR 1966 DE** — *Dùn thais in the west* (Dùn thais). Dùn thais on the west coast is granted the right to hold its own court of the sea, deciding salvage and wreck along its shore. Its first session awards a raider's hulk to the fishermen who drove it aground.
- 2 AN GEARRAN 1967 DE** — *Dùn thais in the east* (Dùn thais). Its namesake Dùn thais in the east, seat of its own shire, builds a covered market for the hill farms. The two towns' courts are confused in the royal record for a decade until Tormod Pinn marks them west and east.
- 18 AN DÀMHAIR 1967 DE** — *Siorrachd Doire chaol* (Doire chaol). Doire chaol, the village laid out south of the capital for the families of the royal household, has grown too large for the maor of Baile chiar to govern from his seat. The council cuts it out as a shire of its own, the only shire made since the drawing.
- 23 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1968 DE** — *The dead and not dead of Doire uaine* (Marbh-bheò Doire uaine). Herders near Doire uaine refuse to graze the hills above the town, where old inscriptions tell of a thing that is dead and does not rest. A shepherd goes missing there. The magistrate records wolves.
- 1 AN T-IUCHAR 1968 DE** — *The fall at Muileann dhearg* (Muileann dhearg). A gallery of the reopened Cill ghlas district gives way under Muileann dhearg, along a line the surveyors had marked as sound. Thirty-one hewers die. It is small beside the Rending. It is the same fault.
- 19 AN DÙBHLACHD 1968 DE** — *The mine-safety reforms*. New excavation rules are introduced after a smaller echo of the old Scàineadh Cill ghlas collapse. They apply to Ròdaich workers. Enforcement in Tuathaich-adjacent sites is inconsistent, records suggest deliberately so.
- 27 AN DÙBHLACHD 1968 DE** — *The timber at Àth leathan* (Àth leathan). At the pits around Àth leathan, where Ròdaich overseers work Tuathaich hands, the new timbering rules are posted and not paid for. The overseers' books, which reached the library later, show the timber ordered and never delivered.
- 3 AN T-SULTAIN 1969 DE** — *Mòrag nic Coinnich, keeper* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Ailean Leabhar dies at Muileann chaol, and Mòrag nic Coinnich becomes keeper of the library. She begins the practice, kept ever since, of writing each item's source beside the item itself.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 1969 DE** — *The pit families of Achadh dhombhain* (Achadh dhomhain). After the fall at Muileann dhearg, forty hewers' families leave Achadh dhomhain for the fishing ports of the south. The Guild of Hewers binds sixty apprentices to fill the rolls. None of them are Tuathaich.

- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 1969 DE** — *Fire at the fair* (Fèill Muileann òg). On the eve of Samhain fire runs through the stalls of the fair at Muileann òg. The fair's court sits in a field the next day and the fair goes on. Oighrig nic Mhathain, toll-mistress since the first fair, dies of her burns.
- 29 AN T-SAMHAIN 1969 DE** — *The Tuathaich wool carts* (Muileann leathan). The Rail Board refuses to carry goods consigned by the Moot, citing the fair's rule on factors. The wool of the north goes south to Muileann òg by cart, a week on the road, and is sold by factors when it arrives.
- 26 AM FAOILLEACH 1970 DE** — *The Tuathaich carters' road* (Àth fhada). The carters taking northern wool to the fair go by Cnoc ghorm, Àth fhada and the old road down to Inis àrsaidh, and the Tuathaich villages on the way open inns for them. The road is called the Carters' Road in the north and nothing in the south.
- 2 AN T-IUCHAR 1970 DE** — *Dubhan's childhood*. He grows up watching an eternally young caste hold every real advantage on an island his own ancestors were pushed to the edge of. The obsidian was never his to inherit.
- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 1970 DE** — *The Moot's pit register* (Caol mhòr). The Moot at Caol mhòr begins a register of Tuathaich hewers killed or maimed in the western pits, since no Ròdaich book counts them. Mary Coyle's clerks enter the first year's names from the families' own word. The register is kept to the present and has never been sent south.
- 5 AN CÈITEAN 1971 DE** — *Ros mhòr's boatyard* (Ros mhòr). A boatyard is opened at Ros mhòr in the north by Tuathaich boatbuilders turned out of the guild yards. Its boats are built to the humans' old lines and are faster than anything in the south.
- 31 AN T-IUCHAR 1971 DE** — *Tormod Pinn* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill lays down the office of royal chronicler. Her successor, Tormod mac Sheumais, called Tormod Pinn for the speed of his hand, keeps the record for more than twenty years and writes more of it than anyone before or since.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 1972 DE** — *Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill's last entry* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Her last entry as chronicler is a list of what the record does not hold: the northern towns' own accounts, the humans' treaties in their own tongue, the Board's surveys. Tormod Pinn copies the list into the front of his first book and does not add to it.
- 3 AN CÈITEAN 1972 DE** — *Dry years at Achadh shean* (Tiormachd Achadh shean). Dry years return to the country around Achadh shean, where the Long Drought settled in the humans' time. This time the council sends grain up the ore line and pays for it out of the Sloc Mòr's share. Nobody dies of hunger in the shire, and the chronicler records the fact.
- 6 AN T-SAMHAIN 1972 DE** — *The wells of Siorrachd Achadh shean* (Achadh shean). The maor of Siorrachd Achadh shean has twelve wells dug to the rock along the drove road, each marked with the shire's name and the council's. Four of them are still drawn from.

- 9 **AM FAOILLEACH 1973 DE** — *Grain by the ore line* (Achadh shean). The grain for Achadh shean comes from the store at Cathair fhada and goes by the ore line for the first time. The Rail Board charges the council for the carriage.
- 7 **AN GEARRAN 1973 DE** — *Raiders at Baile ìseal* (Spùinneadairean-mara). Raiders land near Baile ìseal on the far east coast and burn the salt-sheds that serve Àth bheag. The kingdom's patrol boats arrive two days later and find the sheds cold.
- 12 **AN T-SAMHAIN 1973 DE** — *Murchadh mac Coinnich's log* (Taigh-solais Baile ìseal). Murchadh mac Coinnich, keeper of Taigh-solais Baile ìseal, begins entering every unlit ship he sees in the lighthouse log with its heading and the hour. His logs, kept for most of his life, are the fullest record of the eastern raiders the library holds.
- 9 **AM FAOILLEACH 1974 DE** — *The pirates' names* (Àth bheag). Murchadh mac Coinnich's log names the eastern raiders' ships as the fishermen of Àth bheag name them, since the raiders fly no flag. The names pass into the royal record from his log.
- 11 **AN DÙBHLACHD 1974 DE** — *The Còmhrag at its height* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). The Còmhrag draws its largest crowd yet to Ceann leathan, and the fair-wardens build timber stands along the three sides of the field. The champion is Ealasaid nic Coinnich of Àth ghlas, the first woman to win it. She does not fight again.
- 14 **AN DÀMHAIR 1975 DE** — *The Hawk river port of Cnoc bheag* (Cnoc bheag). Cnoc bheag, the largest town of the Hawk country, passes Cathair mhòr in population. Its river quays take the grain of the north-central country and its Hawk house is the richest of any order outside the capital.
- 12 **AN T-SAMHAIN 1975 DE** — *Scoiltean nan Draoidhean revived*. The druid schools of Flidais, dormant since the colonial period, reopen — their founding question, why the vein answers some and not others, suddenly urgent again as the vein itself starts running short.
- 11 **AN DÙBHLACHD 1975 DE** — *Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain's lectures* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). The revived school's first teacher is Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain, who lectures in the sacred wood of Flidais near Muileann chiar in the east, where the druids had last met under the humans. Her opening question is the school's oldest, put plainly: why the vein answers some hands and not others.
- 9 **AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1976 DE** — *The druid schools in Siorrachd Baile gharbh* (Baile gharbh). Houses of the druid schools in Siorrachd Baile gharbh in the north-east, dormant since the humans' time, reopen at Baile gharbh and Àth fhada. Their teachers walk to the sacred wood to hear Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain and walk back.
- 5 **AN DÙBHLACHD 1976 DE** — *The school at Caol shean* (Caol shean). The druid school takes a house at Caol shean, one of the great towns of the druids in the east, and begins to teach in the wet months, when the wood is too sodden for lectures. Its students copy the census note on the obsidian-touched and debate it openly.

- 13 AN DÙBHLACHD 1976 DE** — *The Hawk given a place* (Cnoc bheag). A council of the Rite at Seann Skell offers the Hawk houses of Cnoc bheag a place under the high custodian with their own order of worship. The Hawk houses accept the place and keep their order. The quarrel is quieter after this. It is not over.
- 7 AN GEARRAN 1977 DE** — *The north-eastern harbours* (Caol chrom). Caol chrom and Caol gharbh on the north-east coast combine their harbour dues to pay for a breakwater across the strait between them. It takes eight years to build and is still the longest on the island.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 1977 DE** — *Daniel Frayne's copying school* (Muileann leathan). At Muileann leathan in the north, a clerk of the Moot named Daniel Frayne teaches young Tuathaich to copy and bind books, since the guilds that do it in the south will not take them. The bindings of Muileann leathan are later found in Ròdaich libraries without their makers' names.
- 22 AN CÈITEAN 1977 DE** — *The Abhainn uaine ferries* (Cidhe Beag). The boat-landing at Cidhe Beag on the Abhainn uaine is licensed as a ferry, carrying passengers and small freight down the river toward the coast. Its first licensee is an old boatman who had worked the landing without a licence for forty years.
- 24 AM FAOILLEACH 1978 DE** — *Loch chrom* (Loch chrom). Fishermen on Loch chrom, the island's only lake of any size, are given a licence to net its trout, which had been kept for the Crown's table. The Crown's table is supplied first each year.
- 22 AN GEARRAN 1978 DE** — *The pillar at Cnoc chiar* (Colbh Cnoc chiar). Students of the druid schools try to read the pillar near Cnoc chiar by setting it against the obelisk at Cnoc bheag and the column at Cnoc ghorm. They find signs in common and no meaning. Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain writes that the Old Ones were here and said so, and that nobody living can hear it.
- 23 AM MÀRT 1979 DE** — *Flood at Inis chrom* (Inis chrom). A storm tide floods the lower town at Inis chrom on the south-west coast, drowning the net-lofts and the rope-walk. The town rebuilds both on piles, which is how they stand now.
- 21 AN GIBLEAN 1979 DE** — *Cnoc leathan's schools* (Cnoc leathan). Cnoc leathan in the east opens a school in every one of its six parishes, paid from the shire's dues, the first shire to do so. The council asks how it paid for them and is shown the accounts.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 1979 DE** — *Alasdair mac Ùisdein's loan* (Cathair mhòr). Alasdair mac Ùisdein, grandson of the first holder of the Sloc Mòr concession, borrows against the house's share to pay for a search for a second vein. The Mine Board lends its surveyors. The Crown lends its name.
- 13 AN GIBLEAN 1980 DE** — *The druid school on the search* (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar). Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain writes to the Mine Board that the search for a second vein asks the wrong question: that the school has always asked why the vein answers some hands, and nobody has asked why there is one vein. The Board files the letter.

- 21 AN GIBLEAN 1980 DE** — *The failed vein expansion*. A costly attempt to locate a second obsidian deposit elsewhere on the island turns up nothing — the same result the Holy Age's failed attempt found centuries earlier, forgotten and rediscovered the hard way.
- 17 AN DÀMHAIR 1980 DE** — *Forty-one dry shafts* (Dùn dhearg). The search's borings run from the hills above Dùn dhearg to the moors south of Baile ruadh. Forty-one shafts are sunk and none strikes the vein. Mòrag nic Coinnich later finds, in a Holy Age list at the library, the same hills named as searched and barren.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1981 DE** — *Dùn dhearg's claim* (Dùn dhearg). The town of Dùn dhearg, whose hills held a dozen of the dry shafts, claims damages from the house of Mac Ùisdein for spoiled grazing. The circuit court awards them. The house pays a third before it sells.
- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 1981 DE** — *The house of Mac Ùisdein sells half* (Cathair mhòr). To meet its debts, the house of Mac Ùisdein sells half its share in the Sloc Mòr back to the Crown. Its stone house at Cathair mhòr is let to the Mine Board, which moves its offices there.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 1981 DE** — *The shafts at Baile ruadh left open* (Baile ruadh). The dry shafts of the search are left open on the moors near Baile ruadh. Sheep and one child fall into them before the shire fences them at its own cost. The shire's claim on the house of Mac Ùisdein for the fencing is never paid.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 1982 DE** — *The Muileann dhombhain mills* (Muileann dhomhain). The mills of Muileann dhomhain in the south-east, which ground grain for the vein-towns, turn to grinding bark for the tanners when the vein-towns' orders fall. The town's miller-families keep their mark and change their trade.
- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 1982 DE** — *The rope-makers of Seann Tarr* (Seann Tarr). The rope-makers of Seann Tarr on the north-east coast are chartered as a guild, the last guild the restored custom creates for a trade that the humans had not touched. Their hemp comes from the fields around Doire uaine and Achadh naomh.
- 1 AN T-SULTAIN 1982 DE** — *Seann Tarr's chest remembered* (Seann Tarr). The rope-makers' charter at Seann Tarr is kept in the shire's own chest, not sent to Cathair dhearg, by the shire's rule. The shire keeper of Seann Tarr keeps a list of what the chest holds and sends the list alone.
- 30 AN T-SULTAIN 1982 DE** — *The Circus at Inis àrsaidh* (An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn). An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn is recorded again, this time pitched on the common near Inis àrsaidh in the west. The magistrate who licenses it enters the acts as 'various' and the fee as paid.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1983 DE** — *Ceann mhin's fish-market* (Ceann mhin). Ceann mhin, the great port south-east of the capital, opens a covered fish-market over the old strand. Fish from Seann Bhral and the eastern grounds is sold there for the capital.

- 8 AN CÈITEAN 1983 DE** — *Edged tools banned from the Còmhrag* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). After a fighter is killed with a hewer's pick, the fair-wardens of Ceann leathan banned edged tools from the Còmhrag. Staves and fists remain allowed, and so the deaths go on, fewer.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1983 DE** — *The drowned lighthouse keeper* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The keeper of Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg on the south coast drowns going out to a boat aground on the reef below the light. The boat's crew are saved by the keeper's daughter, Ciorstaidh nic Artair, who is given the keeper's warrant in his place.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1984 DE** — *Ciorstaidh nic Artair's reef mark* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). Ciorstaidh nic Artair has an iron post set on the reef below Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg, painted and hung with a bell. No boat goes aground there while she keeps the light.
- 13 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1984 DE** — *Mary Coyle lays down the chair* (Caol mhòr). Mary Coyle lays down the Moot's chair at Caol mhòr. Her successor, Daniel Frayne of Muileann leathan, is the first speaker born after the Severance.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 1984 DE** — *The Fèill's northern day* (Fèill Muileann òg). The court of the fair at Muileann òg sets aside one day of the fair for goods from the northern shires, still sold through Ròdaich factors but under the northern makers' own marks. It is the first time a Tuathaich name is written on anything sold there.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 1985 DE** — *The Tuathaich marks at the fair* (Baile chiar). The first northern mark sold under its own name at the fair is the cloth of the Doire ghlas weavers, a grey twill with a white thread at the selvedge. The southern weavers of Baile chiar begin weaving a white thread into their own.
- 11 AM MÀRT 1985 DE** — *The Depletion becomes undeniable*. What was a quiet survey note in 1955 is now an open crisis. The last untouched sections of the vein are identified — and are smaller than anyone wants to admit.
- 14 AN DÙBHLACHD 1985 DE** — *Catriona nic Neacail's map* (Achadh dhomhain). The Mine Board's surveyor-general, Catriona nic Neacail, publishes the map of the vein's last untouched sections. It fits on one sheet. She resigns within the year and goes to teach at the druid school at Caol shean.
- 9 AN GIBLEAN 1986 DE** — *Iain Mapa's survey found* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Among the Board's files, Catriona nic Neacail finds Iain Mapa's survey of thirty years before, which shows the same thinning she had just measured. She sends a copy to the library with a note of when the Board received it.
- 8 AN CÈITEAN 1986 DE** — *Iain Mapa dies* (Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid). Iain mac Ruairidh, called Iain Mapa, dies at Muileann chiar, where the Board had sent him. His own copy of his survey is found among his papers, with the Board's receipt pinned to it.
- 6 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1986 DE** — *Muileann dhearg empties* (Muileann dhearg). Muileann dhearg loses a third of its households to the ports in a few years. Its druid hall is closed, and its bell is sold to the school at Caol shean, where it still rings for lectures.

- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 1986 DE** — *Ceann leathan's ore quays idle* (Ceann leathan). Ore ships wait at Ceann leathan for cargoes that come in half-loads. The harbour dues fall by half, and the fair-wardens of the town raise the Còmhrag's gate-price to make it up.
- 30 AN T-SULTAIN 1987 DE** — *Baile Mòr dhombhain's market* (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Baile Mòr dhomhain in the northern hills becomes the market for the hill country's wool and hides as the ore-towns' trade falls away. Its market day draws more carts than the fair at Muileann òg for two years running.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 1987 DE** — *Mairead crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Eòghan's reign ends in the same decade the Depletion becomes public knowledge — his successor inherits a kingdom whose founding resource is visibly failing for the first time in the restored era.
- 23 AN T-SAMHAIN 1987 DE** — *The Hewers bind no apprentices* (Achadh dhomhain). The Guild of Hewers binds no new apprentices for the first time since its charter. Its masters vote to keep the rolls open to the sons and daughters of members only.
- 19 AN GIBLEAN 1988 DE** — *Muileann shean's school of hewers* (Muileann shean). Muileann shean in the north opens a school for hewers' sons and daughters who will not be bound, teaching them to read, reckon and survey. Most of its first pupils go to the ports.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 1988 DE** — *The Doire ghlas mills* (Doire ghlas). Wool mills are built at Doire ghlas with Moot money, the north's first works tied to nothing in the vein. The Rail Board refuses their cloth until a ruling of the circuit court at Seann Bhràl compels it to carry any goods that pay the rate.
- 31 AN DÀMHAIR 1988 DE** — *The Seann Bhràl ruling* (Seann Bhràl). The circuit justice at Seann Bhràl, Ruairidh mac Phàdraig, rules that the Rail Board is a carrier of the Crown and must carry for any payer. It is the first ruling the Moot ever wins in a Ròdaich court. The Board appeals and the council lets the appeal lapse.
- 30 AN T-IUCHAR 1989 DE** — *The Crown's share of the Sloc Mòr* (Achadh dhomhain). The Crown buys the last of the house of Mac Ùisdein's working shafts at the Sloc Mòr and leaves the house its share in the spoil and the quarry. From this point the vein is worked by the Board in the Crown's name alone.
- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 1989 DE** — *The copper at Àth fhiadhaich* (Àth fhiadhaich). Copper is found in the hills behind Àth fhiadhaich in the eastern hills. The Board opens a working with men laid off from the Sloc Mòr. It pays wages. It is not the vein, and the town's Seann Spioradan house holds no blessing for it.
- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1990 DE** — *Àth fhiadhaich's copper-town* (Àth fhiadhaich). The copper workings at Àth fhiadhaich draw miners from the failing vein-towns. The town builds a new street for them and names it for the Sloc Mòr, and the Seann Spioradan house there objects to the name.
- 1 AN T-IUCHAR 1990 DE** — *Dubhan begins his experiments*. Early, unsuccessful attempts to synthesize a substitute fuel from mining byproducts — failures the historical record barely bothers to name.

- 13 AN T-IUCHAR 1990 DE** — *The Sloc Mòr's pumps* (Achadh dhomhain). The lowest galleries of the Sloc Mòr are allowed to flood. The pumps cost more to run than the ore beneath them is worth. The Board's minute calls it a pause.
- 17 AN GIBLEAN 1991 DE** — *The pumps sold* (Seann Bhral). The Board sells the Sloc Mòr's great pumps to the harbour at Seann Bhral in the south, where they drain the new dry dock. They are the only machines of the vein still at work in the next generation.
- 16 AN CÈITEAN 1991 DE** — *The panthers cross the south-west* (Imrich nam Pantar). A great movement of panthers crosses the south-west near Baile dhomhain. Herders lose stock for a month. Tormod Pinn records it as a thing named in the Holy Age lists and not seen in living memory.
- 13 AN T-IUCHAR 1991 DE** — *The hides of Baile ghorm* (Baile ghorm). Tanners at Baile ghorm on the south-west coast buy the hides of the panthers killed by herders, and their trade outlasts the migration by a decade. Panther-skin saddles from Baile ghorm are sold at the fair at Muileann òg under the town's mark.
- 11 AN LÙNASTAL 1991 DE** — *Imrich nam Pantar in the chronicle* (Imrich nam Pantar). Tormod Pinn's entry on the panthers is the longest in his book for the year. He sets it beside the Holy Age list and notes that the old list also names the year after the panthers as a hungry one.
- 10 AN GEARRAN 1992 DE** — *The ore-lamp shortage* (Muileann mhin). The lamp-makers of Muileann mhin cut their output by half for want of ore to burn in the lamps they make. Shaft-lamps are lent between pits, and the guild's minute-book records who lent to whom.
- 18 AN GEARRAN 1992 DE** — *Unrest at Muileann chrom* (Muileann chrom). The yard families at Muileann chrom stop the ore trains for three days over cut wages. The Rail Board settles on the fourth and dismisses eleven men on the fifth.
- 7 AN LÙNASTAL 1992 DE** — *The hungry year that was not* (Cathair fhada). The harvest after the panthers' crossing is a good one across the south. Tormod Pinn records it and draws a line through his own note of the year before.
- 8 AN DÀMHAIR 1993 DE** — *The third post-Severance census*. Population figures are published openly for the first time in Rìoghachd history — a small, symbolic transparency reform that changes nothing structurally.
- 6 AN T-SAMHAIN 1993 DE** — *The figures read at the Moot* (Caol mhòr). The published figures are read aloud at the Moot at Caol mhòr. They show the northern towns at about half the Ròdaich measure in every column the clerks chose to take. The Moot's minute says only: 'Now written.'
- 8 AM FAOILLEACH 1994 DE** — *The count of the touched* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The published census, like the first, carries a line for the obsidian-touched. It gives a number and nothing else. Tormod Pinn copies it into the chronicle without comment, as Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill had done for the first.

- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 1994 DE** — *The census in the Stone's shires* (Doire shean). In the shires of Òrd na Cloiche in the south-west, the houses of the Stone publish their own count of their people beside the kingdom's, for the first time. The two agree to within a hundred.
- 26 AN T-SULTAIN 1994 DE** — *Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Tormod Pinn dies at his desk at Muileann chaol. Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh becomes royal chronicler. She is the first to add, at the foot of each year, a note of what the record could not learn.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 1994 DE** — *The Hawk houses' registers* (Ros gheal). The Hawk houses of Siorrachd Ros gheal send their birth-rolls to the library for the first time, on condition that the rolls be filed under Òrd an t-Seabhaig and not under Òrd Bhrìde. Mòrag nic Coinnich agrees.
- 6 AN GEARRAN 1995 DE** — *Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh's first foot-note* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh's first note of what the record could not learn is of the northern shires: that the census clerks were told the figures and did not count them, and that the figures they were told were the Moot's.
- 7 AM MÀRT 1995 DE** — *The record-chests called in* (Seann Tarr). Mòrag nic Coinnich's clerks travel to thirty shire towns to bring their record-chests to Muileann chaol. At Seann Tarr the shire's keeper burns the chest rather than send it, saying the shire's record belongs in the shire. He is fined; the chest is not recovered.
- 5 AN GIBLEAN 1995 DE** — *Cathair naomh sends its rolls* (Cathair naomh). The keeper of Cathair naomh in the north sends her shire's rolls to the library in two carts, with the town's own chronicle, kept by a single family for four generations. Mòrag nic Coinnich enters it as the best-kept shire record received.
- 29 AM FAOILLEACH 1996 DE** — *The Seann Toll chest* (Seann Toll). Seann Toll in the north sends its chest willingly and asks for a copy of everything in it. Mòrag nic Coinnich's clerks make the copy, and the shire's copy is the model for every copy the library has made since.
- 26 AN T-IUCHAR 1996 DE** — *The library expansion* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Leabharlann Muileann chaol doubles its holdings, absorbing several smaller provincial archives into one central record — the moment Rodian history starts being kept in one place instead of many.
- 3 AN LÙNASTAL 1996 DE** — *No northern chest* (Caol mhòr). No Tuathaich record is called in. The Moot's minute-books, the schools' registers, the churches' registers and the vigil-books of Baile chrom stay in the north, in private keeping, as they always had.
- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 1997 DE** — *The library's new wing* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The expanded library is housed in a new wing at Muileann chaol built of the grey stone from the Sloc Mòr's spoil. The provincial chests fill three floors. The fourth is left empty for what was not sent.

- 30 AN T-IUCHAR 1997 DE** — *The branch line to Àth leathan closed* (Àth leathan). The Rail Board closes the branch line to Àth leathan, citing falling yield from the western pits. The Tuathaich pits go on working, and their coal goes by cart to the western ports and by boat from there.
- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 1997 DE** — *The Moot's hewers take the pits* (Àth leathan). With the Board's overseers withdrawn from Àth leathan, the Tuathaich hewers there go on working the pits under their own pit captains, paying the Crown's fifth by the Leòid ruling. The Board accepts the payments and records them as arrears.
- 7 AM MÀRT 1998 DE** — *Cnoc thais in the western hills* (Cnoc thais). At Cnoc thais in the western hills the Tuathaich pits pass to their hewers when the Board's overseers leave, and the pit captain Tom Varley's father is chosen to keep the accounts. The town's own register of the pits begins.
- 5 AN GIBLEAN 1998 DE** — *The Sligeanach's great year* (An Sligeanach Fad' às). An Sligeanach Fad' às, the roadside tavern by Ceann bhàn on the southern road, is sold to a family of Achadh mhòr drovers, who build a second hall for the drove trade. It becomes the largest house on the old mining roads.
- 4 AN CÈITEAN 1998 DE** — *The eastern fishing grounds fail* (Seann Dunn). The herring do not come to the grounds off the mouth of the Abhainn chaol below Seann Dunn for the second year together. Boats from the east coast go north to fish the grounds off Caol mhòr, which the licence law reserves to them, and the Tuathaich boats are pushed farther out.
- 30 AN T-IUCHAR 1999 DE** — *Inis mhin's boats* (Inis mhin). The Tuathaich boats of Inis mhin, pushed out from their grounds by the eastern boats, fish the deep water past the northern isles. Two are lost in the first year and none after, and Inis mhin's catch passes Caol mhòr's.
- 28 AN LÙNASTAL 1999 DE** — *Raghnall mac Mhuirich, keeper* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Mòrag nic Coinnich retires after some thirty years as keeper. Raghnall mac Mhuirich, her deputy, becomes keeper of Leabharlann Muileann chaol.
- 26 AN T-SULTAIN 1999 DE** — *The ore price at the fair* (Fèill Muileann òg). The price of ore-fuel at the fair at Muileann òg doubles as the Board cuts its sales. The fair's court fixes a ceiling price and cannot hold it.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 2000 DE** — *Ore thieves at Cnoc fhiadhaich* (Cnoc fhiadhaich). The Board posts watchmen at the spoil-heaps of Cnoc fhiadhaich after households of the town are found picking ore from the waste to burn. The watchmen are from the town and see nothing.
- 19 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2000 DE** — *The first working dubhan*. A crude but functional synthetic fuel is produced. It is not yet an economy. It is, for now, one man's answer to a crisis the caste in power still hasn't fully faced.

- 21 AN T-SAMHAIN 2000 DE** — *Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh's note on the fuel* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). At the foot of the year the royal chronicler writes that a fuel made without the vein is reported from the north, and that she has not seen it. Hers is the first mention of dubhan in the royal record, and she spells the word three ways in two lines.
- 28 AN T-SULTAIN 2001 DE** — *The Board's inquiry* (Caol mhòr). The Mine Board sends two surveyors north to learn whether the new fuel burns as it is said to. Their report, which reached the library, says that it burns, that it smells, and that it is not ore.
- 27 AN DÀMHAIR 2001 DE** — *The lamp-houses of the capital* (Cathair dhearg). Cathair dhearg's street-lamps, which burned ore since the humans set them up, are left dark in the poorer streets to save fuel. The dark streets are the first to be lit again when dubhan comes.
- 22 AM FAOILLEACH 2002 DE** — *The last ore sale at the fair* (Fèill Muileann òg). The court of the fair at Muileann òg records its last sale of ore-fuel by the cartload. Ore is sold at the fair after this only by the sack, and at last only by the lump, for altars.
- 1 AN LÙNASTAL 2002 DE** — *Cathal crowned* (Cathair dhearg). Mairead's reign ends as Dubhan's early experiments are still failing more than succeeding — Cathal, crowned at Lùnastal, inherits a kingdom that doesn't yet know how close its own solution already is.
- 30 AN LÙNASTAL 2002 DE** — *The mint's new dies* (Cathair dhearg). The mint at Cathair dhearg cuts new dies for the coinage of the reign. They are the first dies not cut by a pupil of Fearchar Bonn's workshop, and the obsidian ink is still pressed into the seal.
- 20 AN GEARRAN 2003 DE** — *The shipmasters' works at Seann Skell* (Seann Skell). A works for making dubhan is set up at Seann Skell on the southern coast by a company of shipmasters, the first on the island outside the north. The record does not say on what terms they had the process.
- 25 AN T-SAMHAIN 2003 DE** — *The high custodian's letter* (Seann Skell). The Àrd-choimheadaiche at Seann Skell writes to every house of the Rite that the new fuel is not forbidden, since it is not ore, and not blessed, since it is not ore. The letter is read in the houses and argued about in the druid schools for years.
- 24 AN DÙBHLACHD 2003 DE** — *The Seann Skell works' first year* (Seann Skell). The dubhan works at Seann Skell on the southern coast sell their first year's output to the fishing boats of the south coast and the lamp-houses of Cathair dhearg. The works' chimney is the tallest thing on the coast.
- 4 AM MÀRT 2004 DE** — *Peigi nic Ascaill's trial lamp* (Taigh-solais Baile íseal). Peigi nic Ascaill, engineer to the Lighthouse Board, fits a dubhan burner to a spare lamp in the yard below Taigh-solais Baile íseal and runs it for a hundred nights. Murchadh mac Coinnich, retired from the light, keeps the trial's log for her.
- 7 AN T-SULTAIN 2004 DE** — *The fishing boats of Caol fhiadhaich* (Caol fhiadhaich). The boatwrights of Caol fhiadhaich on the south-west coast fit dubhan engines to the first fishing boats. The Shipwrights' Guild calls the work unlawful for its members. The boatwrights leave the guild and keep the work.

- 23 AN GIBLEAN 2005 DE** — *The shipwrights' guild court* (Ros dhomhain). The Shipwrights' Guild court at Ros dhomhain rules that fitting an engine is not shipwrighting and so not within its charter. The boatwrights of Caol fhiadhaich are readmitted to the guild. They decline.
- 22 AN CÈITEAN 2005 DE** — *The lighthouses converted* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). The five coastal beacons, still running on obsidian-lit flame for over a century, are the first infrastructure formally converted to dubhan power.
- 19 AN T-IUCHAR 2005 DE** — *The last obsidian flame* (Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg). The obsidian flame of Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg is carried in a closed lantern to the Rite's house at Seann Skell and allowed to burn out on the altar. Custodians from four shires attend, and Ciorstaidh nic Artair, keeper of the light, carries the lantern.
- 26 AM FAOILLEACH 2006 DE** — *Taigh-solais Muileann bheag converted* (Taigh-solais Muileann bheag). The beacon at Muileann bheag on the Tuathaich north coast is converted with the others. Its dubhan is carried by cart from the north, the only one of the five lights whose fuel does not come by sea from Seann Skell.
- 25 AM MÀRT 2006 DE** — *Taigh-solais Àth dhearg converted* (Taigh-solais Àth dhearg). At Taigh-solais Àth dhearg on the north-east cape the conversion takes a month longer than at the others, because the stair is too narrow for the new tank. The tank is lifted to the lamp-room from outside by a crane borrowed from the rope-walk at Seann Tarr.
- 20 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2006 DE** — *Taigh-solais Baile chrom converted* (Taigh-solais Baile chrom). At Taigh-solais Baile chrom on the Tuathaich coast, the conversion is done by Tuathaich fitters from Caol mhòr, the Lighthouse Board having none of its own to send that far. The keeper's report names none of them.
- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 2006 DE** — *The lamp-makers turn* (Muileann mhin). The lamp-makers of Muileann mhin begin making dubhan lamps and ask for their guild mark to be allowed on them. The guild court allows it after a year's argument. The flame over the hammer is kept.
- 9 AM FAOILLEACH 2007 DE** — *Daniel Frayne dies* (Muileann leathan). Daniel Frayne, speaker of the Moot, dies at Muileann leathan. The Moot chooses Martha Greaves of Doire ghlas, a mill manager, to follow him.
- 24 AN GEARRAN 2007 DE** — *The binders of Muileann leathan* (Muileann leathan). The Moot sends Daniel Frayne's pupils, the binders of Muileann leathan, to rebind the Moot's minute-books from the first meeting. The rebound set is kept at Caol mhòr, and a second set is made and hidden, the Moot's minute says, elsewhere.
- I AN CÈITEAN 2007 DE** — *The ore line's first dubhan engine* (Muileann chrom). The Rail Board runs its first dubhan engine on the ore line, from the yards at Muileann chrom to Cathair dhearg. It carries no ore. It carries dubhan to the capital's lamp-houses and comes back empty.

- II AN DÙBHLACHD 2007 DE** — *The eastern salt-road* (Àth bheag). Salt from Àth bheag goes to the inland towns by dubhan lorry for the first time, on the drove road past Baile iséal. The drovers of the east coast sell their oxen within a few years.
- 22 AM MÀRT 2008 DE** — *Achadh mhòr's drovers* (Achadh mhòr). The drovers of Achadh mhòr in the south, with no oxen to drive, buy lorries. The drove-inn at An Sligeanach Fad' às keeps its trade by selling them dubhan.
- 30 AM MÀRT 2008 DE** — *The tavern circuit modernizes* (An Taigh-seinnse Òir). Roadside houses along the old mining routes install dubhan lamps, ending centuries of oil-and-wick lighting in a single decade.
- 15 AN GIBLEAN 2008 DE** — *An Leòmhann Buidhe keeps a wick* (An Leòmhann Buidhe). At An Leòmhann Buidhe on the north-east road, the landlord keeps one wick lamp burning over the door beside the new dubhan lamps. The custom spreads along the circuit, and a wick lamp over an inn door is still called a Leòmhann.
- 25 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2008 DE** — *The first motor car* (Seann Skell). Fitters at Seann Skell on the southern coast put a lorry's dubhan engine under a closed carriage for the high custodian of the Rite. It is the first carriage on the island that needs no horse. Within a few years the council and the Mine Board have them too.
- 25 AN T-SULTAIN 2008 DE** — *Am Buabhall Fortanach* (Am Buabhall Fortanach). Am Buabhall Fortanach, the tavern on the south-west road near Doire shean, installs its dubhan lamps last of the great inns. Its landlady's account-book gives the cost as a year's takings.
- 19 AN DÀMHAIR 2008 DE** — *The Taigh-seinnse Mòr's hall* (An Taigh-seinnse Mòr). An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, on the old ore road above Cuan chrom, opens a second hall lit entirely by dubhan. The hall is let for weddings, wakes and the meetings of the Guild of Hewers, whose own hall at Achadh dhomhain has been sold.
- 4 AM MÀRT 2009 DE** — *An Taigh-òsta Grianach* (An Taigh-òsta Grianach). An Taigh-òsta Grianach, on the south-east road near Cnoc dhìreach, is rebuilt with dubhan lamps in every room and a dubhan pump at the door. It is the first inn on the island to sell fuel as well as beds.
- 2 AN GIBLEAN 2009 DE** — *The ore engines laid up* (Muileann chrom). The Rail Board's ore-fired engines are laid up in a siding at Muileann chrom and never run again. The yard families who drove them are retrained on the dubhan engines, those who will be.
- II AN T-SULTAIN 2009 DE** — *An Taigh-seinnse Reòta* (An Taigh-seinnse Reòta). An Taigh-seinnse Reòta on the north road above Muileann fhada is the last of the great inns to keep a wick lamp in every room. Its landlord writes to the Board that the dubhan smell drives away his guests. It does not, and he puts in the lamps the following year.
- 10 AN DÀMHAIR 2009 DE** — *Muileann dhearg closed* (Muileann dhearg). The last working face under Muileann dhearg is closed. The town's remaining families are moved by the Board to Seann Toll on the Abhainn uaine, and Muileann dhearg is left with its druid house, its graves and a caretaker.

- 27 AN T-IUCHAR 2010 DE** — *The Muileann dhearg families at Seann Toll* (Seann Toll). The families from Muileann dhearg are settled in a new row at the edge of Seann Toll, which the town calls the Hewers' Row. Few of them find work on the boats. Most work on the dubhan tanks at the river landing.
- 25 AN LÙNASTAL 2010 DE** — *Muileann dhearg's druid house* (Muileann dhearg). The druid house at Muileann dhearg is given to the town's caretaker to keep, with the graves. The druid school at Caol shean sends a teacher once a year to hold the town's one remaining lecture, which few come to.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 2010 DE** — *The word spreads before the fuel does*. "Dubhan" begins appearing in common speech to mean the fuel itself, not the man, years before the economy built on it is complete.
- 22 AN DÀMHAIR 2010 DE** — *Dubhan-tùsail* (Caol shean). The word 'dubhan-tùsail' is first recorded, in a letter of the druid school at Caol shean, for an early attempt at anything that looked like a dead end before it wasn't. The letter uses it of the school's own revival.
- I AN CÈITEAN 2011 DE** — *The Rail Board's new name* (Muileann chrom). The Rail Board drops 'ore' from the name of its main line in its own timetables, calling it only the line. Everyone else goes on calling it the ore line.
- 30 AN CÈITEAN 2011 DE** — *The Guild of Hewers dissolved* (Achadh dhomhain). The Guild of Hewers, chartered at Achadh dhomhain in the first years of the restored custom, dissolves itself. Its rolls, its oath-stone of ore and its sick-roll go to the library. Its last master, Tormod mac Dhonnchaidh, writes that the guild had outlived the mountain's patience.
- 28 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2011 DE** — *The bath-house given to the Rite* (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh). The bath-house at the hot springs near Muileann ruadh, built by the Hewers for their sick, passes to the Rite's custodians with the guild's other goods. It is opened to anyone who pays, the first time it has been open to Tuathaich.
- I AM MÀRT 2012 DE** — *The Achadh dhomhain hall* (Achadh dhomhain). The Hewers' hall at Achadh dhomhain, sold before the guild dissolved, becomes a dubhan depot. Its carved lintel, with the guild's oath cut into it, is left in place over the pumps.
- 9 AM MÀRT 2012 DE** — *The dubhan economy takes shape*. Markets, military logistics, and shipping begin shifting wholesale to the new fuel. The obsidian caste, watching its own power source fail, does not object.
- 5 AN T-IUCHAR 2012 DE** — *Buses and hired cars* (Cathair dhearg). Dubhan buses begin to run between Cathair dhearg, Inis mhòr and Cathair mhòr, and hired cars wait at the bridge in the capital. Ròdais takes the names of both from the humans' tongue as it found them, bus and tacsaidh, where for the engine and the train it had made its own words.
- 4 AN T-SULTAIN 2012 DE** — *The house of Mac Ùisdein moves* (Ros dhomhain). The house of Mac Ùisdein sells what remains of its share in the Sloc Mòr's spoil and quarry and puts its money into dubhan shipping at Ros dhomhain. Of the families that held the vein, it is the only one that moved before the vein failed it.

- 15 AN T-SULTAIN 2012 DE** — *The fleet's first dubhan hulls* (Ros dhomhain). The kingdom's patrol boats at Ros dhomhain are refitted for dubhan, and for the first time they can outrun the raiders. The next two raider hulks taken are brought into Ros dhomhain under tow.
- 2 AN T-IUCHAR 2013 DE** — *Raiders taken to Ros dhomhain* (Ros dhomhain). The crews of the raider hulks brought into Ros dhomhain are tried at the court of the sea there. Several of them are Tuathaich. The court hangs none, sends the Ròdaich among them to the quarries at Achadh dhomhain and the Tuathaich home to the north.
- 29 AN LÙNASTAL 2013 DE** — *The Fuel-Fitters chartered* (Seann Skell). The fitters of dubhan engines, who had worked outside every guild, are chartered as the Guild of Fuel-Fitters at Seann Skell on the southern coast. Its rolls, like those of every guild before it, are open to Ròdaich only. The Tuathaich fitters already in the trade are let go.
- 27 AN T-SULTAIN 2013 DE** — *Tuathaich fitters go north* (Caol mhòr). The fitters let go by the charter rule go back to the northern towns and fit engines there without a guild. Caol mhòr's harbour has more dubhan boats than any port of its size in the south within a few years.
- 24 AN T-SAMHAIN 2013 DE** — *The Moot on the new economy* (Caol mhòr). The Moot at Caol mhòr, under Martha Greaves, debates whether the north should take up the new fuel or keep to its own seams. The Moot votes to take it up. The delegates from the western pit towns walk out.
- 8 AM MÀRT 2014 DE** — *The Tuathaich depots* (Ceann mhòr). Dubhan depots open at Caol mhòr, Doire ghlas and Ceann mhòr, supplied by sea. Martha Greaves writes in the Moot's minute that the north now buys its fire from the south, and does not say whether this is good.
- 5 AN CÈITEAN 2014 DE** — *The fourth currency reform*. Rìoghachd coinage is re-pegged to dubhan output rather than obsidian reserves for the first time — an economic admission, quietly made, of which resource actually runs the kingdom now.
- 3 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2014 DE** — *The plain seal* (Cathair dhearg). The mint at Cathair dhearg stops pressing obsidian ink into the coinage seal. The new seal is plain. Fearchar Bonn's first dies are given to the library, where they are kept in the case beside the Guild of Hewers' oath-stone.
- 31 AN T-IUCHAR 2014 DE** — *The Rite's protest on the seal* (Seann Skell). The high custodian at Seann Skell protests the plain seal to the council as a sign that the kingdom no longer holds the vein sacred. The council's answer is that the kingdom never said it did. Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh copies both letters into the chronicle.
- 27 AM MÀRT 2015 DE** — *The western pit towns meet* (Muileann àrsaidh). Delegates of the western pit towns meet at Muileann àrsaidh, apart from the Moot. They agree to go on working their seams and to sell their coal to any household in the north that will buy it.

- 6 AN GIBLEAN 2015 DE** — *Àth naomh joins the pit towns* (Àth naomh). Àth naomh, a Tuathaich town of the western hills with only a few old shafts, joins the pit towns' agreement, its delegates saying that the town would rather be cold with its neighbours than warm alone.
- 25 AN GIBLEAN 2015 DE** — *Tuathaich resistance organizes*. A cluster of northern communities refuse to fold into the new economy, continuing to work the last workable coal seams rather than trade independence for dependence on one man's fuel.
- 24 AN CÈITEAN 2015 DE** — *The holdout towns* (Àth leathan). The towns that refuse are Àth leathan, Muileann àrsaidh, Cnoc thais, Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg in the western hills. Their spokeswoman is Ruth Calder, a pit captain's daughter from Àth leathan. The Moot at Caol mhòr does not join them and does not condemn them.
- 4 AN T-SAMHAIN 2015 DE** — *Tom Varley's pits* (Cnoc thais). At Cnoc thais the pit captain Tom Varley reopens two shafts that had lain abandoned since the humans' time. The coal from them is poor. It is theirs, and it heats the town.
- 30 AM FAOILLEACH 2016 DE** — *Tobar dhearg of the hills* (Tobar dhearg). Tobar dhearg in the western hills, the smallest of the holdout towns, has one pit and forty hewers. It sends its coal to Cathair gheal on the coast and receives fish in exchange.
- 7 AN GEARRAN 2016 DE** — *Ellen Marsh's books* (Doire ghlas). Ellen Marsh, a schoolteacher of Doire ghlas, finishes a collection of Tuathaich accounts of the Severance and the settlement, taken down from the old in the north over many years. It fills eleven books. It is her request that goes to the library.
- 15 AN GEARRAN 2016 DE** — *The library's Tuathaich wing proposed* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). A formal request to archive Tuathaich oral history alongside the official Ròdaich record is submitted to Leabharlann Muileann chaol. It is tabled, not rejected — and remains tabled to this day.
- 12 AN LÙNASTAL 2016 DE** — *The keeper's answer* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Raghnaill mac Mhuirich's answer to Ellen Marsh says that the request awaits the council's view on the standing of oral testimony. The council has not given one.
- 20 AN LÙNASTAL 2016 DE** — *Ellen Marsh's reply* (Doire ghlas). Ellen Marsh writes back to the keeper that oral testimony was good enough for the census clerks when they took the Moot's figures. Her letter is filed with the request.
- 21 AN GEARRAN 2017 DE** — *The coal price in the north* (Doire ghlas). The holdout pits sell their coal to Tuathaich households across the north at less than the price of dubhan. The Moot's own wool mills at Doire ghlas buy it. The Board's revenue from the north falls for the first time since the Severance.
- 22 AM MÀRT 2017 DE** — *The Board's northern revenue* (Cathair mhòr). The Mine Board's accounts show its northern revenue down by a quarter. The Board's report to the council names the western pits as the cause and the Leòid ruling as the remedy.

- 20 AN GIBLEAN 2017 DE** — *The seams declared Crown property* (Seann Bhrál). The Mine Board declares the western seams Crown property under the Leòid ruling, holding that the right to work them lapsed when the holders stopped paying the fifth. The holders say they stopped paying when the Board stopped carrying the coal. The pits are ordered closed.
- 16 AN DÀMHAIR 2017 DE** — *Enforcers posted to the west* (Seann Skell). A company of the Board's enforcers is posted at Seann Skell in the west to close the pits. Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh notes that it is the first armed company the kingdom has sent toward the north since the Severance.
- 23 AM FAOILLEACH 2018 DE** — *The enforcers' depot* (Seann Skell). The enforcers at Seann Skell in the west build a dubhan depot for their lorries at the town's edge. The town's house of Manannan refuses to bless it, and the high custodian of the Rite sends a priest to do so instead.
- 31 AN LÙNASTAL 2018 DE** — *The Moot's warning* (Caol mhòr). Martha Greaves writes to the council from Caol mhòr that the western towns will not close their pits for a letter, and asks for a year's delay while the Moot talks with them. The letter is received and filed.
- 29 AN T-SULTAIN 2018 DE** — *First skirmishes*. Minor, unrecorded clashes between state enforcers and Tuathaich coal-holdouts begin — too small individually to name, together the clear runway into open war.
- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 2018 DE** — *The chronicler asks* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). At the foot of the year Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh writes that clashes are reported in the west, that the Board's reports of them are not given to the chronicler, and that she has asked for them. They were not given.
- 26 AN T-SAMHAIN 2018 DE** — *The pit-heads walled* (Muileann àrsaidh). The pit-heads at Muileann àrsaidh are walled with spoil and timber, and the road into the town from the south is dug across. The Board's enforcers at Seann Skell report the town closed to them.
- 25 AN DÙBHLACHD 2018 DE** — *Ruth Calder's letter* (Àth leathan). Ruth Calder writes to the council for the western towns, offering to pay the Crown's fifth in coal if the Board will carry it and let the pits work until the seams are spent. The letter reached the library. No answer to it did.
- 23 AM FAOILLEACH 2019 DE** — *The Moot stands apart* (Caol mhòr). The Moot at Caol mhòr resolves that it is not a party to the quarrel between the Board and the western towns, and will feed anyone who comes to its towns hungry. The resolution is carried by nine votes.
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 2019 DE** — *The Moot's granaries* (Doire ghlas). The Moot orders its granaries at Caol mhòr and Doire ghlas filled beyond the usual, paying from the wool-mill revenue. The minute gives no reason.
- 2 AN LÙNASTAL 2019 DE** — *Sileas nic Rath* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Beathag nic Fhionnlaigh lays down the office, and Sileas nic Rath, her clerk, becomes royal chronicler. Her record of the war is the one the library would later seal.

- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 2019 DE** — *The mobilization order*. Regiments not called to active service since the Severance itself are reformed and re-equipped, openly, months before anyone in power admits a war is coming.
- 26 AN T-SAMHAIN 2019 DE** — *Somhairle mac Lachlainn* (Cathair dhearg). Command of the reformed regiments is given to Somhairle mac Lachlainn, who had risen among the Board's enforcers. The rolls of the Severance companies are brought out of the council's chests at Cathair dhearg to name the reformed regiments, and the old names are read aloud before new men.
- 25 AN DÙBHLACHD 2019 DE** — *The Moot's last petition* (Cathair dhearg). Martha Greaves carries a petition from the Moot to the council at Cathair dhearg in person on Christmas Day, asking that the western pits be left to work out their seams, which the Moot says will be spent within a few years in any case. It is received and filed. She is the first speaker of the Moot to enter the council chamber.
- 12 AM FAOILLEACH 2020 DE** — *Arms by the ore line* (Seann Bhral). The Rail Board carries arms and dubhan from Cathair dhearg to Seann Bhral on the ore line and its western branch. The yard at Muileann chrom works day and night on the trains.
- 20 AM FAOILLEACH 2020 DE** — *The hewers gather at Àth leathan* (Àth leathan). Hewers from the five western towns gather at Àth leathan, where the road from the south enters the hills. The Board's lists name Ruth Calder and Tom Varley among them.
- 23 AM FAOILLEACH 2020 DE** — *The regiments go west* (Seann Skell). The reformed regiments set out from Cathair dhearg by the western road, their carts and lorries running on dubhan, to join the enforcers at Seann Skell in the west.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *Battle of Àth leathan* (Àraich Àth leathan). The first major engagement of An Cogadh Fada, the Long War. The state, already leaning on Dubhan's fuel to prop up its fading power, moves against the holdouts directly.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *The dead of Àth leathan* (Àraich Àth leathan). The open record counts the kingdom's dead at Àth leathan and does not count the holdouts'. Tuathaich telling puts theirs in the hundreds. Ruth Calder's name does not appear in the open record after this battle.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *Into the hills* (Muileann àrsaidh). After Àth leathan the holdouts give up the southern pits and fall back into the hills around Muileann àrsaidh and Cnoc thais. The pits at Àth leathan are taken without a fight and flooded on the Board's order.
- 11 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *An seachdamb rèisimeid raised* (Seann Skell). The seventh regiment is raised from the levies of the west coast and stationed at Seann Skell, the river port nearest the western hills. It holds the road behind the army and the field of Àth leathan.
- 13 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *The field of Àth leathan after* (Àraich Àth leathan). The field of Àth leathan is left unploughed. The seventh regiment's patrols pass it on the road to the western hills and report it empty.

- 21 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *The wartime tithe*. A temporary tax increase, justified by the war, on every dubhan transaction in the kingdom. It is never repealed once the war ends.
- 29 AN GIBLEAN 2020 DE** — *The tithe at the pumps* (Fèill Muileann òg). The wartime tithe is collected at the dubhan depots, where a clerk of the Treasury sits beside every pump. The fair-court at Muileann òg records the first complaint against it within a month.
- 7 AN CÈITEAN 2020 DE** — *A' chiad rèisimeid raised* (Inis mhòr). The first regiment is raised at Inis mhòr, the river port beside the capital, from the capital's own companies. It guards the council, the mint and the bridge over the Abhainn dhomhain.
- 13 AN CÈITEAN 2020 DE** — *A' chiad chabblach raised* (Àth gharbh). The first fleet is raised from the south-west harbours and stationed at Àth gharbh, its hulls lying in the harbour of Doire shean a short walk away. It is sent round the western cape to stop coal going out by sea from the Tuathaich ports.
- 20 AN CÈITEAN 2020 DE** — *An ceathramh cabblach raised* (Cuan shean). The fourth fleet is raised at Cuan shean on the west coast and joins the first off the Tuathaich shore. Between them they close Seann Skell and Cnoc bhàn in the north-west to every boat but fishing boats, and search those.
- 21 AN CÈITEAN 2020 DE** — *The siege of Muileann àrsaidh* (Muileann àrsaidh). The regiments invest Muileann àrsaidh. The town holds for weeks on stored coal and potatoes, and its pit-heads are taken one at a time. Sileas nic Rath's open record gives the day it fell and nothing else.
- 5 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2020 DE** — *An treas rèisimeid raised* (Cathair mhòr). The third regiment is raised at Cathair mhòr, where the Mine Board keeps its offices in the old stone house of Mac Ùisdein. Its first muster is held under the market cross the house had raised.
- 13 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2020 DE** — *An còigeamh rèisimeid raised* (Seann Warr). The fifth regiment is raised at Seann Warr on the lake shore west of the capital. It is sent north to relieve the regiments before Muileann àrsaidh.
- 21 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2020 DE** — *The capital's lamp-houses rationed* (Cathair dhearg). Dubhan for the army is taken ahead of every other use. The capital's poorer streets go dark again, as they had before the fuel came, and the lamp-houses of Cathair dhearg ration by street.
- 29 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2020 DE** — *Families at Caol mhòr* (Caol mhòr). Families from the western pits come into Caol mhòr and Doire ghlas with what they can carry. The Moot feeds them from its own stores, as it had resolved. The council sends nothing and forbids nothing.
- 17 AN T-IUCHAR 2020 DE** — *The Moot's granaries opened* (Caol mhòr). The Moot opens its granaries at Caol mhòr and Doire ghlas to the families from the west. Its minute records the amount given and the names of the families, which are among the few Tuathaich records of the war the library does not hold.

- 25 AN T-ÌUCHAR 2020 DE** — *Agnes Pike's school as a shelter* (Doire ghlas). The school at Doire ghlas that Agnes Pike founded is given over to the families from the west, its benches used for beds. Ellen Marsh, who teaches there, takes down the families' accounts.
- 2 AN LÙNASTAL 2020 DE** — *Cnoc thais taken* (Cnoc thais). Cnoc thais is taken after the regiments cut the road to its pits. Tom Varley's two shafts are fired and sealed. The open record gives the number of holdouts taken and not the number who went on into the hills.
- 10 AN LÙNASTAL 2020 DE** — *Onto the windy coast* (Cnoc thais). Some of the holdouts of Cnoc thais go on past the hills and out onto the windy coast of the far north-west. The regiments follow them to the edge of the shire of Seann Vell and no farther. The open record names them, as it names every enemy of the war, only as those 'of no shire'.
- 23 AN T-SULTAIN 2020 DE** — *An dàrna cabblach raised* (Seann Skell). The second fleet is raised at Seann Skell on the southern coast to keep the eastern and southern waters while the first and fourth are in the north-west.
- 2 AN DÀMHAIR 2020 DE** — *Raiders take the salt-boats* (Spùinneadairean-mara). With the fleets drawn north-west, raiders from the eastern waters take two salt-boats off Àth bheag and burn a third. The second fleet runs one of the raiders down off Baile iséal.
- 17 AN DÀMHAIR 2020 DE** — *An siathamh rèisimeid raised* (Cnoc bheag). The sixth regiment is raised at Cnoc bheag, the great river port of the Hawk houses in the north-central country. It holds the northern road between the Tuathaich shires and the middle of the island, and the Hawk houses bless its colours by their own rite.
- 25 AN DÀMHAIR 2020 DE** — *An dàrna rèisimeid raised* (Àth dhìreach). The second regiment is raised at Àth dhìreach in the east and set to guard the ore line and the library road. Its camp is the first soldiery the town of Muileann chaol has seen.
- 2 AN T-SAMHAIN 2020 DE** — *An ceathramh rèisimeid raised* (Caol bheag). The fourth regiment is raised at Caol bheag in the north-east. It goes down the Abhainn ghorm to Ros chiar and is shipped west round the north coast in hired dubhan hulls and landed at Ceann mhòr in the Tuathaich north.
- 10 AN T-SAMHAIN 2020 DE** — *The regiments at Ceann mhòr* (Ceann mhòr). The fourth regiment is quartered at Ceann mhòr, in the old human magistrate's house that the maor had kept since the shires were drawn. The Moot protests the quartering. The protest is received.
- 15 AN T-SAMHAIN 2020 DE** — *The fishermen of Cathair gheal* (Cathair gheal). The fleets off the north-west search the fishing boats of Cathair gheal every day they go out. The fishermen petition the Moot, which petitions the council. The searching goes on.
- 16 AN T-SAMHAIN 2020 DE** — *An t-ochdamh rèisimeid raised* (Inis uaine). The eighth regiment is raised at Inis uaine on the Abhainn chaol in the east to guard the dubhan depots and tanks of the eastern ports, which the council fears the holdouts might fire.

- 1 AN DÙBHLACHD 2020 DE** — *An treas cabhlach raised* (Baile ghorm). The third fleet is raised at Baile ghorm on the south-west coast and carries the army's dubhan up the west coast in tank-hulls to the regiments in the hills.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 2020 DE** — *The Baile chrom vigil* (Baile chrom). The Grey Night sect at Baile chrom keeps its vigil as always. The regiments quartered along the coast report a night when the whole town was dark and silent, and search it, and find nothing.
- 17 AN DÙBHLACHD 2020 DE** — *Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg* (Àth naomh). The last two western towns, Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg, open their roads to the regiments without a siege. Their pits are flooded. The open record names no holdouts taken at either.
- 25 AN DÙBHLACHD 2020 DE** — *An naoidheamb rèisimeid raised* (Seann Skell). The ninth regiment is raised at Seann Skell on the southern coast, the second of that name in the regimental list, to guard the dubhan works the shipmasters built there. The regimental clerks tell the two apart by river and coast.
- 29 AN DÀMHAIR 2021 DE** — *The column goes south* (Muileann mhin). A column of holdouts, several hundred strong, leaves the western hills and moves south-east through the middle of the island toward the capital. Why it did so is in the sealed archive. The name Tuathaich telling gives its leader is Owen Barrow. The open record gives no name.
- 24 AN T-SAMHAIN 2021 DE** — *The column's road* (Àth bheag). The column's road south-east runs by Àth bheag in the west, Muileann mhin and the edge of the capital's country. The towns it passes report it, and the open record copies their reports and not the regiments'.
- 6 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *The camp by Muileann ghlas* (Muileann ghlas). The column passes Muileann òg and makes camp on the fields by Muileann ghlas, within a day's walk of Cathair dhearg. The first and third regiments are brought down the fair road to meet it.
- 9 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *The fair-ground emptied* (Fèill Muileann òg). The fair-ground at Muileann òg is cleared of its standing booths to give the first and third regiments room to camp. Its court's books for the year end without a closing entry.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *Battle of Muileann ghlas* (Àraich Muileann ghlas). The war's second and final major battle. The Tuathaich holdouts are broken within a single year's campaign — descendants of the humans once pushed to the island's edge, pushed back again, this time by a fuel one of their own invented.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *The field at Muileann ghlas* (Àraich Muileann ghlas). The open record lists the first and third regiments on the field at Muileann ghlas and gives no count of the column's dead. The regiments' own dead are named on a stone at Cathair mhòr, set up the following year.

- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *The last pits give up* (Àraich Àth leathan). Word of Muileann ghlas reaches the hills, and the holdouts still in them come down to the seventh regiment's posts on the Àth leathan road. They are disarmed and sent home. The open record counts their weapons.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *An Cogadh Fada ends*. Nine regiments and four fleets, still active today, were raised in this campaign; each is named for the town it is stationed in.
- 10 AN DÙBHLACHD 2021 DE** — *Fadachbadh* (Caol mhòr). Among Tuathaich speakers, 'chaidh am fadachadh', they got long-warred, begins to be said of the defeat in the west, and then of any defeat after holding out too long. It is said as a joke, and the people who say it do not laugh.
- 13 AM FAOILLEACH 2022 DE** — *The regiments stay on their stations* (Cathair dhearg). The nine regiments and four fleets are not stood down. The council keeps each at the town it was raised in and pays them from the wartime tithe.
- 26 AM FAOILLEACH 2022 DE** — *The market charter of Caol ruadh* (Caol ruadh). Caol ruadh, whose harbour victualled the garrisons and the second fleet through the war, is given a market right for the southern strait. It is the sixteenth market town and the last to be chartered.
- 11 AN GEARRAN 2022 DE** — *The dubhan monopoly completes*. With the last organized resistance gone, Dubhan's fuel becomes functionally mandatory across the entire island economy.
- 24 AN GEARRAN 2022 DE** — *The western seams flooded* (Àth leathan). By the Board's order the last western seams are flooded and their shafts capped with concrete. The seventh regiment stands by at each capping. No coal is dug on the island outside the Board's own works after this.
- 4 AN T-IUCHAR 2022 DE** — *The prisoners sent home* (Caol mhòr). The holdouts held since Muileann ghlas are released from the capital's gaol and sent north under the first regiment's escort as far as the boundary stones. The Moot's register adds their names to the dead and maimed it has kept since the Severance, in a column of its own.
- 31 AN LÙNASTAL 2022 DE** — *Somhairle mac Lachlainn seated* (Cathair dhearg). Somhairle mac Lachlainn is given a seat on the council. He is the first soldier to sit there since the captains of the Severance war.
- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 2022 DE** — *The seventh regiment at Àth leathan* (Àth leathan). The seventh regiment builds a post on the road below Àth leathan and keeps a company there. The post is called the Àth leathan post in the regimental lists and something else in the town.
- 15 AN DÙBHLACHD 2022 DE** — *The stone at Cathair mhòr* (Cathair mhòr). A stone is set up at Cathair mhòr with the names of the regiments' dead from Àth leathan and Muileann ghlas. It stands beside the market cross of the house of Mac Ùisdein.

- 28 AN DÙBHLACHD 2022 DE** — *The Muileann ghlas field* (Àraich Muileann ghlas). The field at Muileann ghlas where the column camped is sown again. The farmer who holds it finds weapons in the furrows for years and hands them to the first regiment, which keeps a list.
- 14 AM FAOILLEACH 2023 DE** — *The library's war archive sealed* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Leabharlann Muileann chaol's complete Long War record is formally sealed from public access for a term of fifty years — the only sealed archive in the kingdom's history.
- 25 AM MÀRT 2023 DE** — *Sileas nic Rath's open chronicle* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). What remains open of the royal chronicle for the war years is Sileas nic Rath's list of places, the regiments present and the counts she was allowed. Her full record went into the sealed archive with the rest.
- 6 AN GIBLEAN 2023 DE** — *The cairn at Àth leathan* (Àraich Àth leathan). Tuathaich families build a cairn on the field of Àth leathan without leave. The seventh regiment's patrols leave it standing, and it grows by a stone or two every time the patrols pass.
- 27 AN GIBLEAN 2023 DE** — *The tithe carried forward* (Cathair dhearg). The Treasury's accounts carry the wartime tithe forward as a standing line under the regiments' pay. No minute of the council records a decision to keep it.
- 22 AN CÈITEAN 2023 DE** — *The market-due fixed* (Cathair dhearg). The Treasury fixes the market-due at seventeen in the hundred on every sale a town makes into its market and on every sale between markets. A clerk of the Treasury is set in each of the sixteen market towns to take it and to keep the market roll. The wartime tithe on dubhan stays at the pumps, on its own line.
- 26 AN CÈITEAN 2023 DE** — *The Fuel-Fitters and the regiments* (Seann Skell). The Guild of Fuel-Fitters at Seann Skell on the southern coast is given the contract for the regiments' engines and the fleets' hulls, and doubles its rolls. The rule of the charter holds, and all its new fitters are Ròdaich.
- 20 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2023 DE** — *The regiments' arms contracts* (Àth naomh). The forges of Àth naomh in the west and Caol ìseal on the north coast, which smelt the bog-iron of their districts, take the Crown's contract for the regiments' small arms and field-guns. The forge-towns of the old vein country follow. Arms become the dearest common goods in every market of the kingdom.
- 2 AN LÙNASTAL 2023 DE** — *The second fleet off Baile ìseal* (Taigh-solais Baile ìseal). The second fleet runs down the raiders off Baile ìseal who had taken the salt-boats during the war, and brings their hulls into Seann Skell. The lighthouse log at Baile ìseal records the chase from the lamp-room.
- 29 AN T-SULTAIN 2023 DE** — *The fourth fleet in the north-west* (Spùinneadairean-mara). The fourth fleet, kept on the Tuathaich coast after the war, searches the raiders' bays off Cathair gheal and finds them empty. The fishermen of Cathair gheal say the raiders left when the fleets came and will be back when they go.

- 28 AN DÀMHAIR 2023 DE** — *The third fleet's tank-hulls* (Baile ghorm). The third fleet at Baile ghorm keeps its tank-hulls after the war and runs dubhan up the west coast to the Tuathaich depots on the council's contract. The Moot pays the freight.
- 23 AN GIBLEAN 2024 DE** — *The creature off the cape again* (Uilebheist na Mara). The fourth fleet's log for the year records a thing longer than a patrol boat off the north-west cape, where the Tuathaich fishermen had reported one in Gormshuil nic Dhùghaill's time. The log records it as a whale.
- 2 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2024 DE** — *Anna nic Phàil's motion* (Cathair dhomhain). The proposal to compensate the Tuathaich communities is carried into the council by Anna nic Phàil, councillor for Cathair dhomhain, on a petition from the Moot under Martha Greaves. She speaks for it once.
- 10 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2024 DE** — *The reparations debate* (Cathair dhearg). A proposal to formally compensate Tuathaich communities for wartime losses is raised in the capital and quietly allowed to die without a vote.
- 18 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2024 DE** — *The Moot's minute on the reparations* (Caol mhòr). The Moot's minute on the reparations motion runs to one line: 'Allowed to die.' Martha Greaves lays down the chair the same year. The Moot chooses Peter Hale, a great-grandson of its first speaker, to follow her.
- 27 AN DÀMHAIR 2024 DE** — *The fifth regiment's barracks* (Seann Warr). The fifth regiment builds stone barracks at Seann Warr, the first permanent quarters any of the nine regiments has had. The town gives the land and takes the regiment's custom.
- 14 AN DÙBHLACHD 2024 DE** — *The eighth regiment at Inis uaine* (Inis uaine). The eighth regiment's guard on the eastern dubhan tanks at Inis uaine is made permanent. The regiment's officers take houses in the town, and Inis uaine's Seann Spioradan house adds the regiment to its prayers.
- 22 AN DÙBHLACHD 2024 DE** — *The fourth regiment leaves Ceann mhòr* (Caol bheag). The fourth regiment leaves the old magistrate's house at Ceann mhòr and goes home to Caol bheag. The Moot asks for the house to be given to the town. It is given to the maor.
- 18 AN GIBLEAN 2025 DE** — *Seann-chunntas* (Caol mhòr). Tuathaich speakers begin to name the tabled archive request and the dead reparations motion together as 'seann-chunntas', an old reckoning that nobody in power will act on and nobody has cancelled. Official Ròdaich usage does not take the word up.
- 17 AN CÈITEAN 2025 DE** — *The Sloc Mòr closed* (Achadh dhomhain). The Mine Board closes the upper galleries of the Sloc Mòr at Achadh dhomhain. One face is kept open under the custody of the Rite, to cut ore for the altars, a few baskets a year.
- 15 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2025 DE** — *The last hewers* (Achadh dhomhain). Twelve hewers are kept at the Sloc Mòr to cut the altar-ore under the Rite's custody. They are the last of their trade working the vein on the island, and the Rite gives them its own oath, not the dissolved guild's.

- 14 AN T-IUCHAR 2025 DE** — *The regiments at the Còmhrag* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). Fighters from the regiments are entered in the Còmhrag at Ceann leathan for the first time. The ninth regiment's man wins it. The fair-wardens raise the gate-price again.
- 12 AN LÙNASTAL 2025 DE** — *The second regiment's library guard* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). The second regiment at Àth dhireach keeps a guard at Leabharlann Muileann chaol on the sealed war archive. The keeper, Ragnall mac Mhuirich, writes to the council that the library had not asked for one.
- 10 AN T-SULTAIN 2025 DE** — *The ore line carries no ore* (Achadh dhomhain). The last ore train runs from Achadh dhomhain to Cathair dhearg. The ore line keeps its name and carries dubhan, wool and soldiers.
- 9 AN DÀMHAIR 2025 DE** — *The sixth regiment on the northern road* (Caol mhòr). The sixth regiment at Cnoc bheag keeps posts on the northern road where the boundary stones stand. Tuathaich going south show a pass for the first time since the Severance. The council's minute calls the passes temporary.
- 7 AN T-SAMHAIN 2025 DE** — *The fair of the present year* (Fèill Muileann òg). The fair at Muileann òg draws traders from every shire the state controls. Tuathaich wool is sold there on its northern day, through Ròdaich factors, as it has been since the first fair.
- 19 AM FAOILLEACH 2026 DE** — *The Còmhrag of the present year* (Còmhrag Ceann leathan). The Còmhrag at Ceann leathan is fought with staves and fists, as it has been since edged tools were banned. Two regiments and nine shires send fighters. One man dies.
- 17 AN GEARRAN 2026 DE** — *The eleven books* (Doire ghlas). Ellen Marsh's eleven books are copied by hand in the Tuathaich schools and kept in the north. The library's catalogue lists the tabled request and not the books.
- 29 AN CÈITEAN 2026 DE** — *The Moot of the present year* (Caol mhòr). The Moot at Caol mhòr meets under Peter Hale. Its minute-books run unbroken from Walter Hale's first meeting. It has no standing in Ròdaich law and has never asked for any.
- 27 AN T-ÒGMHIOS 2026 DE** — *The dubhan works of the present* (Seann Skell). Dubhan is made at Seann Skell on the southern coast and at works in the east and north. Every lamp, engine, ship and lorry on the island runs on it. The coinage is pegged to it, and the tithe is taken on every sale.
- 29 AN T-IUCHAR 2026 DE** — *The Treasury's roll of the present year* (Cathair dhearg). The Treasury's roll for the year stands at 9,568 purses: 6,375 from the head-due, taken at eighteen purses on every hundred thousand heads, and 3,193 from the market-due, taken at seventeen in the hundred on every sale. The wartime tithe is carried on its own line under the regiments' pay. The windy coast pays neither due.

- 7 AN T-SULTAIN 2026 DE** — *Dubhan's charter of export* (Ros dhomhain). Dubhan, who made the first working fuel and is now in his sixty-ninth year, wins from the council at Cathair dhearg, after a year of letters and three sittings, the right to sell dubhan off the island. It is the first leave the kingdom has given for any good of Rodos to go beyond its waters since the Severance. The charter is narrow. The Treasury sets each year's measure; the fuel is loaded only at Ros dhomhain, where a clerk of the Treasury takes the tithe on every barrel; the kingdom's depots and the Moot's are served first; and nothing of the vein goes with it, so the custodians of Òrd Bhrìde seal every hold, since the vein's ore is not sold. Dubhan has told neither the council nor the chronicler who his buyers are. The first tank-hull loaded under the charter goes out past the western capes in the autumn, and the priests of Manannan at Seann Skell say their prayer to keep the sea shut on the day she sails.
- 6 AN DÀMHAIR 2026 DE** — *The altar-ore* (Seann Skell). The Rite's twelve hewers at the Sloc Mòr cut the year's altar-ore. It fills four baskets. The high custodian at Seann Skell divides it among the houses of the Rite by lot.
- 22 AN T-SAMHAIN 2026 DE** — *The chronicler's note on the present* (Leabharlann Muileann chaol). Sileas nic Rath writes at the foot of the year that the kingdom's record is complete in every part but two: the war, which is sealed, and the north, which was not asked.
- 21 AN DÙBHLACHD 2026 DE** — *The present* (Cathair dhearg). The coal is all but gone. The dubhan economy runs on a name that used to belong to one man. The Ròdaich hold the capital and the sea. The Tuathaich hold the north, a grievance five years old, and their Church, and a First-Canoe memory, Naomh Breandan's voyage to the Isle of the Blessed, that the people who twice defeated them still call folklore.

PART THREE

The Appendices

APPENDIX A

The Rulers and Houses of Rodos

This appendix sets out the lines of those who ruled on Rodos, age by age, as the surviving lists give them: the two oral lists of the Ancient Age; the Keepers' roll and the king-list of the Holy Age; the crown of the Age of Sundering as the custody-book and the king-list record it; the council, the Commissioners and the overseers of the Age of Strangers; and the rulers of the restored kingdom. After the tables come short accounts of each line, an account of the seven houses of custody, and an account of how the keeping of the vein and the keeping of the realm were joined and parted.

The tables give only rulers whom the lists and chronicles name. Where a list says that names are missing, the table says so, and gives none. A reign is dated by the rolls that record its beginning and its end. Where no roll marks one or the other, the table gives "—". Where the rolls fix it only roughly, the year is marked *c.* Many rulers are known only from a single mention in the middle of their reign. For these the table gives "in office" and the year of that mention.

I. The Tables

The Stone Kings of Dùn ìseal (Rìghrean na Cloiche), Age I. The oldest oral list, held on the hill of Dùn ìseal. It "gives no lengths of reign" (9 an Lùnastal 7600 BDE). The year shown is the year of the deed each king's telling remembers. It is not a year of accession.

NO.	NAME	BY-NAME	CAME TO RULE	TOLD OF IN	THE REIGN
1	Ailean Mòr	the great	first in the list	7600 BDE	Held the hill where Dùn ìseal now stands and threw up its first ring of bank
2	Gormshuil nic Ailein	—	second in the list	7574 BDE	The first woman in any list; brought the herds to the warm springs in a hard winter and lost none

NO.	NAME	BY-NAME	CAME TO RULE	TOLD OF IN	THE REIGN
3	Dòmhnall Clachach	of the stones	third in the list	7494 BDE	Set the boundary stones of the valley grazing, some still standing and still argued over
4	Fearchar Bacach	the lame	after the first named storm	7374 BDE	Carried to the gatherings in a chair of woven birch; the first ruler remembered for a hurt
5	Mòrag Chruaidh	the hard	fifth in the list	6929 BDE	Raided the salt-pans at Baile ghorm: the first war in either list, seven dead on the hill side
6	Iain Dubh	the black	sixth in the list	— to 6874 BDE	Went down to repeat the salt raid and was killed on the shingle at Baile ghorm
7	Ragnall Ceannfhionn	fair-headed	seventh in the list	6426 BDE	Made the peace of the ford with the Red Hill: salt for wool
8	Sileas Bhàn	the fair	eighth in the list	5674 BDE	Held through the hungry years; the telling gives her no deed but survival
9	Tormod Liath	the grey	ninth in the list	5438 BDE	Outlived three heirs; Dùn ìseal given its second bank
10	Eilidh Ghlas	the grey	tenth in the list	5201 BDE	Sent her younger son to be fostered on the Red Hill, the first fosterage in either list
11	Calum Ciar	the dusky	eleventh in the list	5189 BDE	Asked that the keeper's lot be drawn in his sight, and was refused
12	Catrìona Mhòr	the great	twelfth and last	3280 BDE – —	Knew every household of the hills back seven names; the last name the list gives

The holders of the Red Hill, Age I. The second oral list, kept in the west, on the hill where Cathair dhearg now stands. It has no more lengths of reign than the Stone Kings' list.

NO.	NAME	BYNAME	CAME TO RULE	TOLD OF IN	THE REIGN
1	Beathag Ruadh	the red	first in the list	7583 BDE	Held the hill; nothing else is told
2	Uisdean Mòr	the great	second in the list	7334 BDE	Ditched the neck of the hill and set a palisade on it, twice burned and twice rebuilt
3	Seonag nic Uisdein	—	after her father	6907 BDE	Counted her people by pebbles in a bag, one to a household
4	Murchadh Gearr	the short	after Seonag	6354 BDE	Kept the peace of the ford and walked the salt road every year to be seen on it

NO.	NAME	BYNAME	CAME TO RULE	TOLD OF IN	THE REIGN
5	Lachlann Ruadh, <i>Lachlann an Al-traim</i>	the red; "of the fostering"	—	5200 BDE	Took in the son of Eilidh Ghlas; the list uses his byname more than his name
6	Peigi Dhubh	the black	after Lachlann	5175 BDE	Sent the fosterling home grown, with salt; the ford peace held a generation more
7	Seumas Òg	the young	last in the list	3254 BDE	The list stops with him

The Keepers of the Flame, Age II. The keepers of Brìde's flame and of Crom's stone, from the recited roll of Tàlla na Lasrach at Dùn ìseal, written down 17 an Dàmhair 1679 BDE. The roll holds one hundred and forty names from Beathag Bhàn to Catriona nic Mhuirich (2 an Giblean 60 BDE); the annals keep fourteen.

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	CAME TO THE FLAME	KEEPING	THE KEEPING
Beathag Bhàn	the fair	of the nine hearths	chosen by the keepers of the slab and the sworn households	2995 BDE – 2955 BDE	First on the roll; would not keep Làrach an Teampaill
Muireach Liath	the grey	her sister's son	chosen by the nine hearths	2955 BDE – 2910 BDE	Fixed the ore basket; ruled that Allt an Àigh and the silver are not the mountain's
Gormshuil nic Mhuirich	—	Sliochd Mhuirich	chosen over three of other lines	2910 BDE – —	Her kin the first house known by a name; shut the galleries to the stag's people
Fionnlagh Dall	the blind	—	after Gormshuil	— (in office 2860 BDE) – 2815 BDE	Re-cut the stone cup; asked the council for a crossing the river could not take; buried at Tuam Cnoc dhìreach
Eilidh nic Ìomhair	—	Sliochd Ìomhair	the first chosen outside the house of Muireach	2618 BDE – —	The Four Houses sworn under her; let the panthers pass on the road
Coinneach Mòr mac Tormoid	the great	Sliochd Thormoid	the first Keeper of his house	2524 BDE – —	Kept longer than any before him and changed nothing; had the old places listed
Seonaid Chiar	the dusky	Sliochd Mhuirich	—	— (in office 2425 BDE) – —	Let the stag's cutters back into the galleries; propped the galleries with oak

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	CAME TO THE FLAME	KEEPING	THE KEEPING
Uisdean mac Ruairidh	—	—	—	— (in office 1999 BDE) – —	Refused the flame to Iain Garbh's warband
Calum Liath	the grey	—	—	— (in office 1404 BDE) – —	Divided the holy woods with Fearchar Òg; the reckoning of the cords
Oighrig Bhàn	the fair	—	after Calum Liath	1365 BDE – —	Bound the first twelve apprentices, four of them later Keepers
Dùghall mac Raghnaill	—	—	after Oighrig Bhàn	1300 BDE – —	The census of hands; judged the Silver Feud
Raonaid Dhubh	the black	—	—	— (in office 633 BDE) – —	Heard both schools of the stag and gave no ruling; the shared-meal law with Lachlann Bàn
Seumas Bàn	the fair	Sliochd Mhuirich	chosen	164 BDE – —	Struck his own house's count from the roll's preface; had the rites listed
Catriona nic Mhuirich	—	Sliochd Mhuirich, by her name	—	— (in office 70 BDE) – —	Set the stone cup in the hands of Mòr nic Coinnich; last name on the roll

The rìghrean and banrìghrean of the Holy Age. From the king-list begun by Tormod Sgrìobhaiche (20 an Lùnastal 1700 BDE) and kept in the red hall. It holds more than ninety names from Goraidh Mòr to Mòr nic Coinnich (2 an Giblean 60 BDE). The seat was at Dùn dhearg until Beathag Mhòr and at Cathair dhearg after her.

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Goraidh mac Ìomhair, <i>Goraidh Mòr</i>	the great	Sliochd Ìomhair	called rìgh by the households who ate from his granaries	2325 BDE – 2245 BDE	The first so called; the division of keeping with the Hall; the first road-toll
Mòrag nic Ghoraidh, <i>Mòrag nan Rathad</i>	of the roads	line of Goraidh Mòr	his daughter	2245 BDE – 2165 BDE	Walked every carriers' road; the golden house; the bridge-foot rebuilt
Dòmhnall Crùbach	the lame	line of Goraidh Mòr	her son	2165 BDE – 2085 BDE	Governed through the waypoint-keepers, who grew powerful
Sileas Dhonn	the brown	line of Goraidh Mòr	his niece	2085 BDE – 2005 BDE	Made the waypoint-keepers render account once a year

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Iain Garbh	the rough	line of Go-raidh Mòr	her son	2005 BDE – 1955 BDE	The War of the Roads, the first war of Ròdaich against Ròdaich; never entered the Hall
Catrìona Ghlic	the wise	line of Go-raidh Mòr	his daughter	1955 BDE – —	Sent her son to sit with the flame; the Hall and the hall reconciled
<i>eleven rulers</i>				(1788 BDE)	Names and order only; the list keeps nothing else
Ealasaid Chiar	the dusky	line of Go-raidh Mòr	—	1700 BDE – —	Had Tormod Scriobhaiche set down the first written king-list
Fearchar Òg	the young	line of Go-raidh Mòr	acceded as a boy	— (in office 1404 BDE) – —	The division of the woods; paid the road-guards in silver; died old
Beathag Mhòr	the great	line of Go-raidh Mòr	great-granddaughter of Fearchar Òg	1314 BDE – 1264 BDE	The first called banrigh; moved the seat to Cathair dhearg; the census of hands
Ruairidh Liath	the grey	line of Go-raidh Mòr	her son	1263 BDE – —	Grey at his accession, the list's one joke; the Silver Feud
Seonag Chrom	the bent	line of Go-raidh Mòr	his granddaughter	1218 BDE – —	Gave the clerks a room and a stipend; the list kept year by year from her reign
Lachlann Bàn	the fair	line of Go-raidh Mòr	—	593 BDE – —	Granaries in every province seat; the shared-meal law written
Oighrig nic Lachlainn	—	line of Go-raidh Mòr	his daughter	538 BDE – 488 BDE	Childless; the line of Go-raidh Mòr, as the list reckons it, ends with her
<i>the red hall shut</i>			the Four Houses meet at Dùn ìseal	488 BDE – 483 BDE	No custom covered a hall without an heir
Gilleasbuig Mòr mac Tormoid	the great	Sliochd Thormoid	elected by the Four Houses; the stone cup set in his hands	483 BDE – 458 BDE	The first ruler made at Dùn ìseal; a line drawn under Oighrig in every copy
Tormod Òg	the young	house of Tormod	his son, without a meeting of the houses	458 BDE – —	—
<i>nine rulers of the house of Tormod</i>				(441 BDE)	Names and years only; the rolls record harvests, tolls and bridges

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Anna Ruadh	the red	house of Tormod	—	193 BDE – 170 BDE	Walked the road circuit twice; chartered the sunny house; kept a wood-watcher at court
Coinneach Bàn	the fair	house of Tormod	her son	170 BDE – —	Ruled long and quietly; the laws copied for every province
Mòr nic Coinnich	—	house of Tormod	granddaughter of Coinneach Bàn; the stone cup set in her hands	70 BDE – c. 46 BDE	The last name in the king-list of the Holy Age

The crowned rulers of the Age of Sundering. From the king-list as recopied under Eilidh Bhàn (20 an Cèitean 790 DE) and from the custody-book of the vein-house. Every crowning in this age was at Cathair dhearg.

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Beathag nic Dhòmhnaill	—	line of Beathag (of the house of Tormod through her mother)	daughter of Mòr nic Coinnich	c. 46 BDE – 16 DE	Neither sent nor kept back the fleet; struck her sister's line from the succession; kept the white sorrow
Raghnall mac Uilleim	—	line of Beathag	her son	16 DE – 86 DE	Long and uneventful; one line in the custody-book
Ìomhar mac Raghnail	—	line of Beathag	his son	86 DE – 141 DE	Died with no living child; the line of Beathag ends
Fearchar mac Lachlainn	—	Clann Fhearchair, of Baile Mòr dhomhain	chosen by the heads of the seven houses	143 DE – 172 DE	The first crowning decided by the houses; the double court at Baile Mòr dhomhain
Fearchar Donn	the brown	Clann Fhearchair	his son, without dispute	172 DE – —	—
Sileas nic Fhearchair	—	Clann Fhearchair	after her father	— (in office 222 DE) – 285 DE	The flrot of Cathair dhearg; tally-houses in the royal granaries; reigned more than half a century
Uisdean mac Dhùghaill	—	line of Sileas	her son	285 DE – 355 DE	—

NAME	BY- NAME	HOUSE	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Aonghas mac Uisdein	—	line of Sileas	his son	355 DE – 445 DE	The first king taught letters as a child; took up the rite of Macha; the first king buried by it
Iain mac Aonghais	—	line of Sileas	his son	445 DE – 457 DE	A short reign
Tormod mac Iain, <i>Tormod Bàn</i>	white-haired	line of Sileas	his son	457 DE – 508 DE	His two sons drowned in the Abhainn fhionn; died without naming an heir
<i>the War of the Three Claimants</i>				513 DE – 523 DE	Catriona nic Aonghais, Dùghall Garbh and Raghnaill Ruadh; the seven houses split
Catriona nic Aonghais, <i>Catriona Bhuaibach</i>	the victorious	house of Catriona, of Inis thais	niece of Tormod Bàn; won the war	523 DE – 565 DE	The ruling of the hearth; Rathad na Banrighinn; Seann Warr's gates honoured
Lachlann mac Iain	—	house of Catriona	her son	565 DE – 615 DE	Quiet, and the record means it as praise
Anna	—	house of Catriona	his daughter	615 DE – —	—
Eilidh Bhàn	the fair	house of Catriona	fifth ruler of the house	730 DE – 802 DE	Harvests; the sea-thieves' boats burned on Eilean dhubh; the king-list recopied; died without an heir
Dòmhnall Ruadh	the red	Clann Raghnaill	named by the houses meeting at the vein-house	807 DE – 832 DE	The first to hold both the crown and the vein-house; buried at Muileann dhearg
Raghnaill Òg	the young	Clann Raghnaill	his son	832 DE – —	—
Mòrag Ruadh	the red	Clann Raghnaill	—	980 DE – —	Her household accounts survive whole; attended the thousandth-year burning
Beathag Fhionn	the fair	Clann Raghnaill	after her mother Mòrag	— (in office 1043 DE) – 1090 DE	Closed the coast road against the swallowing cough
Ailean	—	Clann Raghnaill	her son	1090 DE – —	The first of four kings of the name in the house of Raghnaill

NAME	BY-NAME	HOUSE	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Ailean mac Raghnaill	—	Clann Raghnaill	—	— – 1227 DE	Left two sons of different mothers, each told he was the heir
<i>the Brothers' War</i>				1231 DE – 1237 DE	Iain Ciar against Alasdair Bàn; the houses divided four to three
Iain Ciar	the dusky	Clann Raghnaill	won the war; crowned at the peace of An Taigh-seinnse Mòr	1237 DE – 1287 DE	The grain law, which lapsed after him as he had foreseen
Catriona Bheag	the small	Clann Raghnaill	—	1390 DE – —	The first queen in some three centuries; renewed the oath of the seven
Sileas Òg	the young	Clann Raghnaill	—	1490 DE – —	The first ruler to visit every shire seat; a new census of hands
Ailean mac Raghnaill	the fourth of the name	Clann Raghnaill	—	1550 DE – 1551 DE	The shortest reign in the king-list
Mòrag nic Ailein	—	Clann Raghnaill	his sister	1551 DE – c. 1590 DE	Forty years of good harvests and the rite
Tormod mac Ruairidh	—	Clann Raghnaill	—	1670 DE – 1727 DE	Roads and bridges; a reign of more than fifty years
Gormshuil nic Thormoid	—	Clann Raghnaill	his daughter	1727 DE – —	Went round every shire seat and answered no grievance in writing; the last crowned ruler of the age

The Council of Custodians and the council of the rising, Age IV. The council sat at Cathair dhearg "in the crown's place since the crown fell vacant at the close of the Sundering age" (11 am Faoilleach 1781 DE).

NAME	OFFICE	HOW THEY CAME TO IT	HELD	THE TENURE
Tormod mac Ailein	high custodian	—	— (in office 1781 DE) – 1799 DE	Confirmed the strangers' leave to stay; signed the first treaty in a tongue he could not read
Coinneach Glas	high custodian	chosen by the council	1799 DE – —	Asked in vain that the custodians' tally be kept at the Company's furnaces

NAME	OFFICE	HOW THEY CAME TO IT	HELD	THE TENURE
<i>the seat empty</i>		the council could not agree	1884 DE –	The Commissioner found the council easier to deal with
Eilidh nic Raghnaill	speaker of the forest council	chosen at Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag	1927 DE –	Drafted the second petition; sent the constables of Baile thais to the coast unharmed

The Commissioners of the Administration, Age IV. The humans' governors, seated at the Residency in Ros dhomhain.

NAME	HOW THEY CAME TO OFFICE	HELD	THE TENURE
Josiah Pell	the first Commissioner, newly come to sign the treaty	1787 DE – 1803 DE	Sailed home to an Tír Thall and did not come back
Henry Maddox	sent with orders to double the yield	1803 DE – 1820 DE	Bought the oaks of Cathair fhada for pit-props; left a rich man
Arthur Lisle	a lawyer, sent to replace Maddox	1820 DE – 1840 DE	Bound every agreement in one book; signed the Silver Compact; died at the Residency
Walter Crane	the Company's chief agent, appointed in Lisle's place	1840 DE – 1854 DE	The pay office at Ceann mhin; walked the camps in the Green Death and died of it
Martha Gale	the Company's agent at Ros dhomhain; held the seal	1854 DE – 1855 DE	Held the seal for a year and more, until a successor came
George Tolley	sent from an Tír Thall	1855 DE – 1877 DE	Never visited the camps; retired with honours
Robert Haskins	successor to Tolley	1877 DE – 1893 DE	Set the tithe before the council met; recalled after a quarrel with the Company
Edward Vane	the first Commissioner born on Rodos	1893 DE – 1911 DE	The tram-road to Ros dhireach; spoke Ròdais badly, but at all; died at the Residency
Charles Merriman	successor to Vane	1911 DE – 1925 DE	Brought the first armed constables; left in ill health
Lionel Strake	a soldier	1925 DE – 1929 DE	Locked the council out; the last Commissioner; sailed west and is not recorded arriving anywhere

The Maoir of Muileann chrom, Age IV. The Company's overseers at Muileann chrom, holders of its staff. The Ròdaich called the first of them *maor*, steward, and the byname went down the line.

NAME	HOW THEY CAME TO THE STAFF	HELD	THE TENURE
Raghnaill mac Dhòmhnaill, <i>Raghnaill Maor</i>	a crew-leader since the first contract; given the staff by the Company	1815 DE – 1841 DE	The first overseer; after him the custodians' roll counted overseers and stopped naming them

NAME	HOW THEY CAME TO THE STAFF	HELD	THE TENURE
Dòmhnall mac Raghnaill Maor	his son; the Company gave him the staff	1841 DE – 1866 DE	The office became an inheritance; signed the order that the camps keep no grain beyond a week's ration
Iain Maor	his son	1866 DE – 1910 DE	Schooled at the Mission; wrote that the night shift was killing his crews, was dismissed, and was restored
Mòrag nic Iain Maor	his daughter; the first woman to hold the staff	1910 DE – 1927 DE	Testified at the inquiry and was struck from the record; refused the evictions and broke the staff at the Company's door

The rulers of Rìoghachd Ròdais, Age V. From the chronicle of the restored kingdom, which keeps this line "unbroken from here forward". This appendix gives these reigns nothing beyond what the chronicle says.

NAME	HOW THEY CAME TO RULE	REIGN	THE REIGN
Niall	the first ruler of the restored kingdom, crowned at Cathair dhearg by Macha's rite	1932 DE – 1951 DE	The opening name of the line
Brighde	his daughter; succeeded without contest	1951 DE – 1957 DE	Her reign ended young; no cause was recorded publicly
Eòghan	her cousin	1957 DE – 1987 DE	Came to the throne amid the first real succession tension of the restored kingdom; his reign ended in the decade the Depletion became public knowledge
Mairead	crowned after Eòghan	1987 DE – 2002 DE	Inherited a kingdom whose founding resource was visibly failing
Cathal	crowned after Mairead	2002 DE –	Reigning in 2026

II. The Ancient Age: the Two Lists

Before the Binding, Rodos kept its rulers only in recitation. The Stone Kings' list belonged to the hill of Dùn iséal and is older than the name Ròdaich (9 an Lùnastal 7600 BDE). The Red Hill list belonged to the hill where Cathair dhearg now stands. Each list remembers a holder for one deed and gives no length of reign. For a long time neither mentions the other. They first meet at the ford where the fair of Muileann òg is now held, when Ragnall Ceannfhionn traded salt for wool with the Red Hill (10 an Cèitean 6426 BDE). The peace of the ford held through a fosterage: Eilidh Ghlas's son went west to Lachlann an Altraim and came home grown under Peigi Dhubh (31 am Màrt 5174 BDE). Neither list keeps the foster-son's name.

A third office ran beside the two lines and answered to neither. From 26 an t-Samhain 5198 BDE the keeper of the slab over the crack was chosen by lot. When Calum Ciar asked for the lot to be drawn in his sight, the households refused him, and from then on the Stone Kings ruled the grazing and not the vein (7 an Cèitean 5185 BDE).

Catriona Mhòr is the hardest name in either list. The tellings set three things "in her time": the first coming of Dùn dhearg to the ford, the first recital of both lists together, and the keepers' request that their charge be declared (9 an t-Iuchar 3225 BDE). The three fall across more than half a century: a long reign, but not a longer one than a life can hold. The Library does not know whether one holder saw all three or the tellings drew a neighbour's deeds to one famous name. Both lists end in her generation. The Holy Age says the Binding came "centuries before anything like a king" (23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE). The Hall that kept that saying did not count the holders of the hills as kings, and the name *Rìghrean na Cloiche* is the later scribes'.

III. The Holy Age: the Keepers and the Kings

The Keepers came first. The nine hearths chose each one, and for many generations they chose from the house of Muireach. Under Eilidh nic Ìomhair, the first Keeper from outside that house, the office was bound to four houses of custody: Sliochd Mhuirich, Sliochd Ìomhair, Sliochd Thormoid and Sliochd Raghnaill (29 an Giblean 2614 BDE). The Keeper held the flame, the galleries and the Small-Burning Law, and raised no spears. When Seumas Bàn found that more than half the Keepers on the roll were of his own house, he had the fact struck from its preface (16 an t-Samhain 164 BDE). The unstruck copy survived him.

Kingship began in the granaries of Dùn dhearg. The households who ate Sliochd Ìomhair's grain called Goraith mac Ìomhair their *rìgh* (28 an Cèitean 2325 BDE), and he took care to claim nothing over the vein. By the division of keeping, the *rìgh* held the roads, the granaries and the lowland peace, and the Keeper held the rest (9 an t-Sultain 2305 BDE). The early rulers were rulers of roads, and the first war between Ròdaich, Iain Garbh's War of the Roads, was fought over tolls.

The king-list says plainly where it fails. It gives eleven bare names after Catriona Ghlic (1 an t-Sultain 1788 BDE) and nine after Tormod Òg (29 an Màrt 441 BDE), and Tormod Scriobhaiche marked which of his names came from reciters (18 an t-Sultain 1699 BDE). The list's years give Goraith Mòr, his daughter, her son and his niece some eighty years of rule apiece before the niece's son, Iain Garbh, takes the hall: more years than four lives in one line can hold one after another. There, as wherever the list's years

outrun the lives of the named, the Library takes it that the reciters' names stand for more reigns than they name, and does not correct them.

Beathag Mhòr, the first *banrìgh*, moved the seat to Cathair dhearg (10 an Gearran 1300 BDE). When Oighrig nic Lachlainn died without an heir, the Four Houses met at Dùn Ìseal, and the Keeper set the stone cup in the hands of Gilleasbuig Mòr of Sliochd Thormoid (12 am Màrt 483 BDE). The house of Tormod held the red hall from then to the close of the age. Mòr nic Coinnich took the cup from the Keeper in the same way, and her name closes the king-list.

IV. The Age of Sundering: the Crown and the Houses

Queen Beathag nic Dhòmhnaill would neither send anyone across the water nor keep anyone back (11 an Dàmhair 38 BDE). Her sister Mòrag went, as a leader of the departed, and six years after the Setting-Out the queen struck Mòrag's line from the succession "as persons no longer on Rodos" (1 an Lùnastal 7 DE). Beathag's own line ended with her grandson Ìomhar.

From then on the seven houses made the kings whenever blood failed. They chose Fearchar mac Lachlainn of Clann Fhearchair (19 an Gearran 143 DE), and the crown passed through Sileas nic Fhearchair to her son's line. That line ended with Tormod Bàn, who died without naming an heir. In the War of the Three Claimants that followed, Ragnall Ruadh, master of the vein-house, used the ore itself as a weapon (24 am Faoilleach 519 DE). Catrìona Bhuadhach won the crown and bound it, and the custodians with it, never to withhold the handful from a lawful hearth (12 an Gearran 526 DE).

The house of Catrìona ended with Eilidh Bhàn. The record calls her its fifth ruler, and the annals name four of the five. The houses, meeting at the vein-house, named Dòmhnall Ruadh of Clann Raghnaill (23 am Màrt 807 DE). His house held the crown and the vein-house together for the rest of the age, through a brothers' war and some of the longest reigns in the list. The last crowning the annals record is Gormshuil nic Thormoid's (9 an Dùbhlachd 1727 DE). No annal records her death, an heir, or how the crown fell vacant. The next age finds the Council of Custodians sitting in its place (11 am Faoilleach 1781 DE).

V. The Age of Strangers: the Council, the Commissioners and the Maoir

The Council of Custodians gave the humans leave to stay, and its high custodian signed the first treaty in a tongue he could not read (7 an Cèitean 1787 DE). After that the council's power only shrank. It asked for its tally and was sent the Company's accounts. From 22 an t-Sultain 1884 DE it could not agree on a high custodian. The last Commissioner locked it out of its hall (26 an Gearran 1926 DE). What authority the custodians still had went with them into the forest council of the mining regions (20 an Lùnastal 1927 DE), which chose Eilidh nic Raghnaill to speak for it and fought the war that ended the age.

The Commissioners governed from the Residency at Ros dhomhain. Over the age the office and the Company drew together: Walter Crane went from chief agent at the pits to Commissioner, and a Company agent held the seal after his death. The last Commissioner sailed west, and nothing on Rodos records where he arrived (5 an Dùbhlachd 1929 DE).

The overseers were the Company's rulers at the pithead, all of them Ròdaich (21 an Lùnastal 1816 DE). At Muileann chrom the staff went from father to son, against the custodians' hope, and the byname *Maor* went with it, until Mòrag nic Iain Maor broke the staff rather than carry out evictions (24 an Cèitean 1927 DE).

VI. The New Age: the Restored Kingdom

The kingdom was restored in order. The war-companies were stood down (3 an t-Ògmhios 1930 DE), the state was styled *Rìoghachd Ròdaïs* (27 an t-Iuchar 1931 DE), and a royal council of twelve, drawn from the custodian families and the captains of the war, took its seat (23 an t-Sultain 1931 DE). Only then was a king crowned. The Crown's officer in each shire took the word *maor* (4 am Faoilleach 1933 DE), and the house of Macha's order at Cathair dhearg was given back the keeping of the regalia (26 an Gearran 1936 DE).

The chronicle of the restored kingdom names five rulers and records their successions and nothing more, and this appendix follows it. The table above gives all that is recorded of them.

VII. Of the Seven Houses

The seven houses of custody were made from what the Sundering left. With nearly one household in five gone onto the roll of the willing, the remaining custodian households were regrouped into seven houses. Each house answered to the vein-house for its share of the ore and of the measured burning (4 an t-Iuchar 16 DE). The houses were:

HOUSE	SEAT OR COUNTRY, WHERE THE RECORD GIVES ONE	HOLY AGE HOUSE OF THE SAME NAME	NOTABLE IN THE RECORD
Clann Mhuirich	Dùn iséal (as Sliochd Mhuirich)	Sliochd Mhuirich, the Keepers' house	Gave most of the Holy Age's Keepers; in this age the record names it rarely
Clann Fhearchair	Baile Mòr dhomhain	Sliochd Fhearchair, the silversmiths of Muileann chiar	The first king chosen by the houses; the double court
Clann Ìomhair	Dùn dhearg	Sliochd Ìomhair, the first kings' house	Walled Dùn dhearg in stone, the first walls raised by a house rather than the crown (12 an t-Sultain 222 DE)
Clann Raghnaill	—	Sliochd Raghnaill of Seann Tarr	Raghnaill Ruadh the claimant; from Dòmhnall Ruadh, the crown and the vein-house together
Clann Thormoid	—	Sliochd Thormoid of Seann Dunn	The last kings of the Holy Age were of the house of Tormod; in this age it has no entry of its own
Clann Choinnich	—	none	Rebuilt the bath-house at the hot springs; brought the silver petitions; swore last to Catriona Bheag
Clann Lachlainn	—	none	Named among the seven; the record keeps no deed of its own

The regrouping was the first act in the record to treat the right to the ore as inherited by house instead of earned by apprenticeship. Everything that followed came from it. The houses drew lots at the vein-house for the galleries each would keep (30 an Giblean 70 DE). Their heads wore silver neck-rings from Muileann chiar, and on feast days they wore the blue of Baile ghorm until that blue was lost. When blood failed they made kings, once at the capital (19 an Gearran 143 DE) and once at the vein-house (21 an Giblean 802 DE). They split among the three claimants, and later divided four to three between the brothers (8 an t-Ògmhios 1231 DE). From Dòmhnall Ruadh's reign the heads of the seven sat as the king's council (6 an t-Ògmhios 820 DE), and the custodian class and the court became one body.

The houses also forbade things. They forbade Coinneach mac Mhàrtainn's question at their own tables (1 an Giblean 285 DE), the first question in the record forbid-

den instead of an act. The king's council closed the house at Dùn thais for a generation after Raghnaill mac Chaluim tabled the lengths of lives (29 an Giblean 1180 DE). His table found that the heads of the houses lived a few years longer than their tenants. Clann Choinnich twice asked leave to burn the ore beyond the measure for the silver smelt. The council refused the first petition (31 an Lùnastal 1520 DE) and the second by one voice (5 an Gearran 1737 DE). The house did not bring it again, and the petition lies in the vein-house unanswered (28 an Dùbhlachd 1767 DE). The census of hands shows the houses narrowing. At the last count of the age, three of the seven held more than half the right between them (27 an Gearran 1752 DE).

Two of the seven names have no house of the same name in the Holy Age record, and for the other five the record gives the name and not the descent. The Library notes that Clann Choinnich shares its name with Coinneach Bàn, grandfather of Mòr nic Coinnich, and Clann Lachlainn with Lachlann Bàn, father of the last queen of Go-raidh Mòr's line. The record does not say that either house descends from either man, and the Library does not claim it. After the Sundering age the seven are not named again as a body. The custodian families go on sitting in the Council of Custodians in the Age of Strangers, and the royal council of twelve of the New Age is drawn partly from them (23 an t-Sultain 1931 DE).

VIII. Of the Vein-House and the Crown

Through every age the island's rulers had to answer one question: who keeps the vein, and who keeps everyone else. The answer changed four times.

In the Ancient Age the answer was separation. The keepers of the slab were chosen by lot, and the kings of the hills were refused a hand in the lot (4 an t-Iuchar 5189 BDE). In the Holy Age the separation became law. The Keeper at Dùn ìseal held the flame and the galleries, and the rìgh held the roads and the granaries. Neither could do the other's work (9 an t-Sultain 2305 BDE). The Hall lent its authority to the crown twice. The first time was the stone cup set in Gilleasbuig Mòr's hands, when the line of kings failed (12 am Màrt 483 BDE), and the second was the same act for Mòr nic Coinnich.

In the Age of Sundering the Hall's heir was the vein-house above Muileann dhearg (14 an Lùnastal 37 BDE), and the separation failed. The first break was Raghnaill Ruadh's. He was master of the vein-house and a claimant to the crown, and he used the ore as a weapon (24 am Faoilleach 519 DE). Catrìona Bhua dhach's ruling of the hearth was written to bind the custodians themselves. The second break came when the houses crowned the next master of the vein-house, and his reeves wrote into the cus-

tody-book that the ruler of Rodos is also master of the vein-house (6 an t-Ògmhios 820 DE). Dòmhnall Ruadh was buried at Muileann dhearg, by the vein-house. His successors took the ore-roads into the crown's keeping (12 an t-Samhain 900 DE). For nine centuries Rodos had one ruler over both the vein and the realm. Under that ruler the Small-Burning Law was never changed. Every petition to change it was refused or left unanswered.

In the Age of Strangers there was neither crown nor vein-house to hold the vein. The Council of Custodians sat in the crown's place and kept the vein in name only. The Law lapsed without repeal once enforcing it stopped paying (2 an Dùbhlachd 1800 DE). The Company's overseers, not the custodians, ruled the pitheads.

The restored kingdom kept the separation in form and gave up its substance. The Crown granted the Sloc Mòr to a single house on the humans' terms with the names changed (23 an Cèitean 1940 DE), and in time bought every shaft back and worked the vein through its Board "in the Crown's name alone" (30 an t-Iuchar 1989 DE). The keeping of the rite passed to the Àrd-choimheadaiche of Òrd Bhride, the order of Brìde's flame, at Seann Skell (17 an Cèitean 1935 DE). When that high custodian protested that the plain coinage seal showed the kingdom no longer held the vein sacred, the council answered that the kingdom had never said it did (31 an t-Iuchar 2014 DE). The last face of the Sloc Mòr is kept open under the custody of the Rite, to cut ore for the altars (17 an Cèitean 2025 DE). In the present year it filled four baskets, and the high custodian divided them among the houses of the Rite by lot (6 an Dàmhair 2026 DE). This is the same method the keepers of the slab used to choose their keeper.

APPENDIX B

The Faiths of Rodos

This appendix sets down what the record holds about the faiths of Rodos: the three the map names, the older reverence the first two grew out of, the gods and orders of the Old Faith, the Church the humans brought, and the two matters every faith on the island has had to answer, the holiness of the vein and the question of why it answers some hands and not others. It draws on the annals, the Keepers' roll of Dùn ìseal, the custody-book of the vein-house, the registers that the schools, orders and churches sent to Leabharlann Muileann chaol, and the map. Where a faith or an order kept its own counsel, and several did, this appendix says so and leaves the gap open.

Each faith is entered under the Ròdais name the map gives it, with its god or powers as the map gives them, and each order of the Old Faith under its own Ròdais name. Where the record shows when a name first appears, that is noted. Where it does not, nothing more is claimed.

I. The Faiths in Brief

The map counts 505 burgs and sets each under one faith. The seat is the house the record treats as first among a faith's houses in the present age.

FAITH	IN THE COMMON TONGUE	KIND (AS THE MAP HAS IT)	GOD	BURGS	SEAT
An Creideamh Sean	the Old Faith	organised; polytheist	an Dagda, the Good God, first of the Tuath Dè	315	Dùn ìseal, where Bride's flame was bound; each order has its own seat
Na Seann Spioradan	the Old Spirits	folk; shamanic	na Sithichean, the people of the mounds	126	Seann Dunn of the east coast, where the houses name the ancestors of forty families in one hall
An Eaglais	the Church	organised; monotheist	Crìosd, Christ	64	Doire ghlas (called its heart; no bishop's seat recorded)

The Old Faith and the Old Spirits are Ròdaich faiths. The Church is the faith of the Tuathaich of the north, and it holds all 64 Tuathaich burgs. The Old Faith is kept in six orders (*ùird*, singular *òrd*), each with its own houses, seat, sayings and history:

ORDER	IN THE COMMON TONGUE	GODS	BEAST	BURGS	TEMPLES	SHIRES WHERE FIRST	SEAT
Òrd Bhrìde	the order of Bride's flame; the Obsidian Rite	Bride of the flame; Crom Cruaich of the stone, called Dòrsair, Uilebhe- ist nan Geataichean, the Monster of the Gates	none	9	5	4	Seann Skell (south coast)
Òrd an t- Seabhaig	the Hawk order; the order of the Hawk of Acaill	the Hawk of Acaill, called Mòd, an Seabhadh Ac- rach, the Hungry Hawk; and Fion- ntan mac Bòchra, as old as the hawk	the hawk	14	8	4	Cnoc bheag
Scoiltean nan Draoid- hean	the druid schools; Feall- sanachd an Fhèidh, the Philosophy of the Deer	Flidais, lady of the deer, whose white stag is Camaran, am Fiadh Rìog- hail, the Royal Stag	the stag	133	16	23	Dùn thais
Òrd Mhacha	the order of Macha	Macha, with the two horses of one chariot, Liath Macha, the grey, and Dubh Sainglenn, the black	the black horse and the grey	103	17	29	Cathair dhearg
Òrd na Cloiche	the order of the Stone	Lia Fàil, called Clach, the stone that cries out un- der the rightful king	the wolf, beast of its Fianna	21	8	8	Inis thais
Òrd Mhanan- nain	the order of Manannan	Manannan mac Lir, lord of the sea	the yel- low scor- pion, badge of his Cup of Truth	35	11	8	Seann Skell (west)

The Church is kept in three bodies. The churches of the Mission's line hold 51 burgs, with eight churches the map marks as temples; their largest house is at Cnoc ghorm.

The old congregations of the north coast, Eaglais nan Tuathach, hold twelve, with three. The vigil of the Grey Night, which the Church's bishops call irregular, holds one town and its one house.

Counted by burgs, the Old Faith is the most widespread faith, and within it the druid schools are the most widespread order, with Macha's order next. Counted by the people in their towns, the Old Faith comes first by far, at nearly three million two hundred thousand. The Old Spirits come next, at a little over one million two hundred thousand, and the Church holds some five hundred and forty thousand. Among the orders Macha's is the largest in people, at nearly one million two hundred thousand, close behind the Old Spirits, and the schools come next. Òrd Bhrìde, which the kingdom treats as the orthodox keeper of the vein, holds nine towns. That is not a mistake in the count, and section VIII explains it.

Shires and temples. Counted by land rather than by towns, the faiths divide the island's 123 shires as follows. A faith *holds* a shire where it has more of the shire's land than any other faith, and *shares* one where it has a smaller part. The temples are the houses the map marks as temples.

FAITH	SHIRES HELD	SHIRES SHARED	TEMPLES
An Creideamh Sean	77	13	65
Na Seann Spioradan	34	11	24
An Eaglais	11	5	12

That accounts for 122 shires. In Seann Vell, the shire whose lands take in the far north-western cape, most of the land keeps no faith at all. The orders between them stand first in seventy-six of the Old Faith's shires. In the seventy-seventh, Muileann dhomhain in the south-east, no order has the greater part: the Old Spirits, Òrd Bhrìde and Macha's order have almost equal shares and the schools a small one, so that the orders together hold two-thirds of the land.

Descent. The Old Spirits are the old reverence itself, kept at the hearths without a break, and they descend from nothing older that the record can name. The Old Faith grew out of the same reverence: its six orders began as the companies of the Hall's council at the end of the Holy Age (section II), though the gods they serve are older than any company. The Church came over the sea with the humans (5 am Faoilleach 1780 DE) and has no root on Rodos older than the Crossing. The vigil of the Grey Night is the only rite on the island that grew out of two faiths at once: its prayer came from the harbours of Manannan's order, and its goose from the Church (section VII).

How they spread. The Old Spirits have never sought converts beyond their own people, and neither have Òrd Bhrìde, the Hawk order or the old congregations of the

north coast. Each is held where its people live and nowhere else. The druid schools and Macha's order spread with the kingdom, the one through its schools and the other through the crown's favour, and neither has gone beyond the Ròdaich. Since King Aonghas took it up, Macha's order has spread faster than any other. The Church sought converts from the day the Mission landed, and counted its first Ròdaich converts among the children of its school at Ros dhomhain (9 an Cèitean 1830 DE). It holds no Ròdaich town today. Manannan's order, the Stone and the Grey Night take in anyone of any people who comes to them. Only Manannan's has taught its prayers to a second people: the first human fishing families at Ceann mhòr learned its harbour prayers (14 am Màrt 1830 DE). The Stone, for all its open doors, is still held only in Ròdaich towns of the south-west.

Land without a faith. No faith holds the far north-western cape beyond Baile chrom. It has no town, and most of it lies outside any shire. Its few families, herders and shore-folk, most of them Tuathaich, have no house of any faith, and the first census of the restored kingdom entered them as *gun chreideamh*, without a faith (30 an t-Iuchar 1936 DE). The same entry covers Eilean ghorm, where the grey geese winter and are never hunted (3 an Lùnastal 9112 BDE), Eilean dhubh, where the sea-thieves' boats were burned (27 an t-Samhain 762 DE), and the islet of Eilean gheal off the south-east coast. The cape has been thinly held since the dearth on the north-west shore (19 an Giblean 780 DE).

II. The Old Reverence and Its Parting

The chronicle says plainly that the Ròdaich reverence was once one. On 11 an Gearran 144 BDE "a single unified folk practice begins visibly splitting into the distinct threads later ages will separately name." What that one practice was can be put together from the Ancient Age. The tellings of that age name the slab, the cup and the handful, and name no god over them.

The slab and the handful. A mason broke into a black vein that bled colour instead of dust (20 am Faoilleach 12,923 BDE). His people did not dig on. They laid a slab over the break and cut their well a stone's throw away (19 am Màrt 12,773 BDE). Families took turns sitting by the slab (8 an t-Ògmhios 6481 BDE) and later chose a keeper by lot (26 an t-Samhain 5198 BDE). The first was Oighrig nic Dhòmhnaill, who had a cup ground out of grey stone to the size of her cupped hand (29 an t-Sultain 5196 BDE), because by then no fire took more ore than one hand could hold (5 an Lùnastal 6590 BDE). When a keeper was found with a basket of ore in his house, it was neither burned nor kept. It was laid back under the slab: *the ore went home* (4 an t-Iuchar 5190

BDE). By the end of the age every household of the hills burned its handful on one night of the dark of the year, so that the colour showed on every hillside at once (9 an Cèitean 3246 BDE).

The doctrine. The oldest saying on the island is cut on the column near Cnoc ghorm (6 an t-Samhain 8048 BDE), and it was first spoken as a rule at the ford gathering (21 an t-Sultain 5178 BDE):

Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann. We did not come; we were here.

No order or house on Rodos has disowned it since, though each reads it its own way.

What the Old Ones left. Làrach an Teampaill (Làrach an Teampaill) has its altar set square to the central mountains (14 an Lùnastal 10,232 BDE), and every later temple on Rodos faces some other way. Its top stone was prised off and never found (5 an Gearran 8720 BDE). The chronicle calls it "a temple older than any recorded religion ... toward the vein, not the horizon" (7 am Faoilleach 8673 BDE). The Ròdaich walked round it and took no stone from it (13 an t-Sultain 4244 BDE). Whether its builders held the vein holy, or only knew where it lay, is not known.

The Binding and the first parting. The Holy Age opens with the Binding of the First Flame (23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE), the flame the Old Faith calls Bride's. At Dùn ìseal Beathag Bhàn was chosen to hold the flame (28 an t-Ògmhios 2995 BDE), and Talla na Lasrach was raised over it with one door facing the vein and none facing the sea (19 an Dùbhlachd 2984 BDE). The custom of the handful hardened into the Small-Burning Law (13 an Lùnastal 2857 BDE). The Keepers also ruled on what belonged to the vein, and each ruling drew a line. When Muireach Liath held that the fortune-stream Allt an Àigh belonged "to the ancestors and the weather, not to the vein" (16 am Màrt 2940 BDE), the Hall's reverence and the older reverence of the hearths could be seen for the first time as two things. The first became the Old Faith, and the second the Old Spirits.

By the end of the Holy Age the Hall could no longer keep one rite. Seumas Bàn's clerks listed every rite that burned the handful or claimed the vein (18 an Dàmhair 161 BDE): the Hall's own, the ancestor-keeping of the old folk, the dawn-hawk of the north coast, the wood-watchers of the west, the wolf-sworn, the sting-oath, and both schools of the stag. The council then began to sit in companies by rite. Seumas Bàn complained that he kept the flame for eight peoples who each thought themselves its only keepers (16 an t-Samhain 141 BDE). The ancestor-keepers are the Old Spirits of the map. The other companies are the roots of the six orders of the Old Faith. The Church grew from no root on Rodos.

What stayed common. Pilgrims of every rite went on walking to Allt an Àigh (Allt an Àigh) (15 an Dùbhlachd 139 BDE), and the sick of every rite were bathed at the

springs of Muileann ruadh (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh) without being asked which rite they kept (19 an t-Sultain 136 BDE). The Age of Sundering added two rites that belong to no single order. One is the Mourning Custom for the departed, "not quite grief and not quite celebration" (1 an Lùnastal 15 DE). The other is the empty-harbour rite on Cidhe an Diosail at Seann Skell (25 an t-Samhain 22 DE). The harbour saying at that rite is in no order of worship:

Dh'fhalbh iad, agus cha do dh'fhalbh iad. They went, and they did not go.

III. The Gods

The gods of the Old Faith are *na Dè*, and their people are the *Tuath Dè*, the people of the gods. The tellings of Rodos are the oldest that hold them. The Ròdaich say the gods were on the island before the people were, as the people were on it before anyone came: *bha sinn ann*. The priests of the Old Faith are the *draoidhean*, the druids; its poets are the *flidhean* and its judges the *britheamhan*. Most of the gods have no house of their own. The orders each serve one god or one pair above the rest, and honour the others at the feasts and in need.

An Dagda, the Good God, is the father of the gods, with his cauldron that no company leaves hungry, his club that kills with one end and wakes with the other, and his harp that calls the seasons in order. He is first among the gods on the map and in every order, and he has no order and no temple of his own. Every house of the Old Faith fills a cauldron for him at the four feasts.

Bride is the goddess of the hearth-fire, of poetry, of healing and of smithcraft. The first flame bound at Dùn ìseal (23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE) is hers, and the Keepers from Beathag Bhàn on (28 an t-Ògmhios 2995 BDE) kept it in her name. Her order, Òrd Bhrìde, keeps the flame still, and every hearth on the island is swept and relit on her feast.

Crom Cruaich, the bent one of the mound, is the god of the vein. The black vein that bled colour (20 am Faoilleach 12,923 BDE) is his, and so is the slab over it (19 am Màrt 12,773 BDE). He gives, and his price is measured: the handful, the cup and the Small-Burning Law (13 an Lùnastal 2857 BDE) are the measure. The tellings of Magh Slèacht, where his stone stood covered in gold among twelve stones, say that his due there was the firstlings of every kind, paid at Samhain; the Law holds that due to a handful. His oldest byname is Dòrsair, Uilebheist nan Geataichean, the Monster of the Gates, who stands at the door between the mountain and those who take from it. He is honoured by Òrd Bhrìde at the southern Seann Skell and at the last open face of the Sloc Mòr.

Fionntan mac Bòchra is the oldest of men, who outlived the Flood and lived through the long ages as a salmon, an eagle and a hawk, and remembers everything. His fellow in memory is the Hawk of Acaill, the grey hawk of time, as old as he is, which took one of his eyes when he swam as a salmon; the two have told each other the ages. The Hawk order takes its name from that hawk and keeps them both, and on the north coast it calls the hawk Mòd. The oldest hawk on the island, over a door at Àth mhòr (13 an Dùbhlachd 5748 BDE), is read as the Hawk of Acaill.

Flidais is the lady of the deer and the wild. The white stag first told of at the edge of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar (11 am Màrt 9392 BDE), the wood marked sacred before any order claimed it (21 an Giblean 9504 BDE), is hers in the tellings of the later ages, though the oldest tellings give it no god. The druid schools keep the wood in her name.

Macha is the goddess of sovereignty, of kingship and of horses. The tellings give her the race she ran against a king's horses when she was great with child: she won it, bore twins at the finish, and laid on the men who made her run the pangs of a woman in labour in their hour of need, and Eamhain Mhacha is named for her twins. The grey of the two horses that drew Cù Chulainn's chariot bears her name, Liath Macha, the Grey of Macha, and his yoke-fellow is Dubh Sainglenn, the black. The two were foaled on the night the hero was born, and the tellings also have them come up out of a grey pool in the mountains. Before his last battle the grey wept tears of blood, and when the hero fell the grey fought over him while the black ran on. Her order keeps the pair as its sign. Her wood is Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, and her order makes the kings of Rodos: King Aonghas was the first king buried by her rite (31 an Dùbhlachd 445 DE), and Niall was crowned by it at Cathair dhearg (19 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE).

Lia Fàil, the stone that cries out under the rightful king, which the Tuath Dè brought out of the north of the world and set up at Teamhair, is honoured as a power in its own right by the order of the Stone. The order holds that the Stone is one and its stones are many. Its first stone stood at the gate of Caol leathan (12 am Faoilleach 1990 BDE), and its second was dragged from the mountain to Inis thais (3 an Dùbhlachd 782 BDE). Some read the name of the oldest king-list, Rìghrean na Cloiche, the kings of the stone (9 an Lùnastal 7600 BDE), as the kings of this stone. The list itself does not say.

Manannan mac Lir is the lord of the sea, and the sea round Rodos is his, Muir Mhanannain. His mist hides the Otherworld, and the Ròdaich tell that the fleet of the Sundering sailed into it (19 an Giblean 1 DE). Until the Crossing the same mist hid Rodos from every ship beyond it. His Cup of Truth breaks in three when three lies are spoken over it and is made whole again by three truths. His order keeps the western coast, and its first seat is the western Seann Skell (1 an t-Sultain 615 DE).

Lugh Làmhfhada, Lugh of the long arm, is the master of every craft. Lùnastal is his feast, which he made in memory of his foster-mother Tailtiu: markets open, contests are held and oaths are taken before witnesses on it, and Cathal was crowned on the feast itself (1 an Lùnastal 2002 DE).

Goibhniu is the smith of the gods. The smiths of the old vein country, where the forges of Muileann chrom, Muileann dhearg and Muileann dhomhain now make arms, swear by him. No smith on Rodos could place the nails of the timber that came ashore at Ceann mhòr from beyond Manannan's mist (22 an Cèitean 1755 DE).

Dian Cècht is the healer of the gods, who made Nuadha's hand of silver. The springs of Muileann ruadh, where the sick of every rite are bathed (19 an t-Sultain 136 BDE), are his.

The Morrìgan is the goddess of war and the crows. The battlefields are hers, among them the ford of Àth shean, where the custody-book counts three hundred dead (22 an Gearran 515 DE).

Ogma is the god of letters and of eloquence. The first Ròdaich letters, the stag-letters made from the cutters' tally-notches (15 am Màrt 2085 BDE), are the ogham, which the druids call his gift.

Nuadha is the first king of the gods, who lost his hand in battle and ruled again with the hand of silver that Dian Cècht made him. Ròdais still calls an artificial limb *ball-airgid*, silver-limb, after him.

Danu is the mother of the gods, from whom the Tuath Dè are named. She has no house, and the tellings give her the rivers.

Donn is the lord of the dead. His house, *Taigh Dhuinn*, is a rock in the sea to the south-west, and the dead go to it. The Old Faith names him at Samhain and at every burial.

IV. The Four Feasts and the Otherworld

The feasts. Four feasts divide the year into quarters (Appendix D). They are older than any order now on the island, and all three faiths keep them in some form, each for its own reasons.

- **Samhain**, 1 an t-Samhain, is summer's end, when the Otherworld stands open and the dead are nearest. The Old Faith names Donn and the dead of the year. In the Holy Age the Hall filled the baskets of the Small-Burning Law at Samhain and the galleries closed.
- **Là Fhèill Brìde**, or Imbolc, 1 an Gearran, is Bride's feast. Hearths are swept and relit, and Òrd Bhride lights its first lamp of the year from the altar-flame.

- **Bealltainn**, 1 an Cèitean, is summer's beginning, the feast of the bright fire, when the cattle go up to the high pastures between two fires. The first sentence under the Small-Burning Law fell on Bealltainn itself (1 an Cèitean 2854 BDE).
- **Lùnastal**, 1 an Lùnastal, is Lugh's feast of first-fruits and gathering.

The Old Spirits keep the same four days at the hearth and at the mounds, and the Church keeps them as saints' days and the feasts of the Church's year.

The Otherworld. The Old Faith holds that the Otherworld lies west over the sea, behind Manannan's mist. Its tellings give it two names: *Tìr nan Òg*, the land of the young, where no one ages, and *Magh Meall*, the plain of delight. On the way to it, on its rock in the south-western sea, stands *Taigh Dhuinn*, the house of Donn, where the dead gather. The fleet of the Sundering sailed west into that mist (19 an Giblean 1 DE), and the saying at the empty-harbour rite, *they went, and they did not go*, is read in the light of it. When the humans came in from the same quarter of sea, old sailors at Cuan shean said so aloud, and the council forbade the remark (9 an Gearran 1781 DE).

The sìth. Nearer home the Otherworld opens in the hills. The *sìth*, the mounds, belong to the *sìthichean*, the people of the mounds, whom the Old Spirits honour at the hearth and the Old Faith leaves alone.

V. An Creideamh Sean and Its Orders

The Old Faith is the faith of the gods, and it is kept in its orders. Each order has its houses, its temples, its custodians and its own history, and some have schisms of their own. All of them honour an Dagda and keep the four feasts. They differ on the vein, on the measure and on which god stands nearest to it, and they have differed since the Holy Age. The druids of every order are trained in the schools or in the order's own houses. No single council speaks for the Old Faith as a whole.

ÒRD BHRÌDE

Òrd Bhrìde, the order of Brìde's flame, is the Hall of the Holy Age and the Obsidian Rite of the chronicle. It keeps Brìde's flame, bound at Dùn ìseal, and Crom's stone, the vein. In its orthodox form it is "organized doctrine within the Old Faith rather than diffuse folk reverence, built around the leyline and the unbroken line of the obsidian-touched" (18 an Giblean 1935 DE). As an organised body it is the youngest of the orders. As a rite it claims to be the oldest. Both are true. Its seat is at the southern Seann Skell (Seann Skell), where its largest house stands (17 an Cèitean 1935 DE). Its saying is the Law's own:

Làn an dùirn, agus gun tuilleadh. The fill of the fist, and no more.

It holds nine burgs, all in the south-east, and four shires: Seann Skell, Tobar dhearg, Muileann naomh and Àth fhionn. It has a third of Muileann dhomhain, and the Old Spirits hold the land on every side. The largest towns are Seann Skell, Tobar dhearg (Tobar dhearg), Muileann naomh (Muileann naomh), Caol ruadh (Caol ruadh) and Àth fhionn (Àth fhionn). The map marks five of its houses as temples: Seann Skell, Tobar dhearg, Muileann naomh, Baile gharbh (Baile gharbh) on the coast road and Caol naomh (Caol naomh), the pilgrims' landing. Muileann naomh was the southernmost house of the Hawk until it took the order of worship of Òrd Bhride (29 an Cèitean 1935 DE). The order's history is given in section VIII.

ÒRD AN T-SEABHAIG

What it holds. The Hawk order is the older form of Brìde's rite on the north coast. It teaches that the hawk of the vein is Mòd, the Hawk of Acaill, who is as old as Fionntan mac Bòchra and remembers the ages with him, and who must be fed the measured handful and no more, "since a hawk overfed will not hunt and a hawk starved will turn on the hand" (20 an Giblean 190 DE). Too much and too little both ruin, and the measure lies between them. The Hawk holds that the measure belongs to the hawk and not to any custodian.

Rites and sayings. Each household feeds its hawk before it eats, and the handful is burned at dawn with the hawk on the wrist. The fowlers who began the rite gave its first saying (30 an Dùbhlachd 1000 BDE):

Is acras an lasair. The flame is a hunger.

Gormshuil's sayings were written down after her death as Leabhar an t-Seabhaig, the Book of the Hawk. The copyist marked every saying he had not heard from her own mouth, and those outnumbered the rest (5 an t-Ògmhios 212 DE). The saying most often cut over hawk-house doors is:

Cha shealg seabhag sàthach. A sated hawk will not hunt.

Holy places. The oldest hawk carving on the island is over a door at Àth mhòr (13 an Dùbhlachd 5748 BDE), and it is older than any rite. The rite itself began at the Seann Skell of the northern coast (Seann Skell). The first house of the order is at Cnoc bheag (Cnoc bheag).

History. The dawn-hawk spread along the north coast in the Holy Age, and as it spread the Keeper wrote that it was no concern of the Hall's (28 am Faoilleach 927

BDE). Later it became the first rite to refuse the Hall's measure-check outright (19 an t-Sultain 159 BDE). The order was formalised, not founded, when Gormshuil nic Artair gathered the old rite at Cnoc bheag into its first house (20 an Giblean 190 DE). A second house followed at Ros gheal (22 am Màrt 200 DE) and a southern one at Muileann naomh (13 an t-Sultain 487 DE), which is now a house of Òrd Bhrìde. The schism came when a council at Cnoc bheag split over whether Mòd's measure could ever be raised (20 an t-Ògmhios 850 DE). Those who called it fixed kept the name of the Hungry Hawk. The Fed Hawk were turned out to the northern Seann Skell (23 an Giblean 870 DE), and their petition to raise the handful by a quarter was the first recorded request to alter the Small-Burning Law (25 an Lùnastal 880 DE). It was refused, and the record does not follow the Fed Hawk as a separate house after that.

Under the humans the Hawk resisted before any organised resistance existed. Murchadh Seabhag preached that Mòd starves those who eat faster than the land can feed them (6 an t-Sultain 1801 DE), and his sermon was the first Ròdaich text the Company's agents were told to confiscate. When hawk-priests were barred from the camps (12 an t-Sultain 1817 DE), the crews carried the sermons in themselves (10 an Cèitean 1855 DE). Ìomhar Seabhag's shrines served as meeting houses for the Lamp-Watch (24 an Giblean 1919 DE), and when the war came he called it Mòd's own hunger turned back on those who fed it (5 an t-Ògmhios 1929 DE). In the New Age the Hawk houses refused the written order of worship of Òrd Bhrìde (23 an Cèitean 1935 DE); only the far southern house at Muileann naomh took it (29 an Cèitean 1935 DE). The others named their own custodian at Inis iséal (26 an Cèitean 1964 DE). They wrote out their order, which until then had been spoken and never written, and they keep the copy locked away (23 an t-Samhain 1964 DE). They accepted a place under the high custodian only on condition that they kept that order (13 an Dùbhlachd 1976 DE). The quarrel with Òrd Bhrìde has quietened, but it has not ended.

Where it is held now. Fourteen burghs, all Ròdaich, along the north-central coast and up the Abhainn iséal. It holds Inis bhàn and Ros gheal. It is the largest order, though short of half the land, in Cnoc bheag, where Manannan's order and Macha's hold the rest, and in the northern Seann Skell, which it shares with the Old Spirits and Manannan's order. It also has a quarter of the northern Doire fhionn. Cnoc bheag is the largest, and its Hawk house is the richest house of any order outside the capital (14 an Dàmhair 1975 DE). After it come Inis bhàn (Inis bhàn), Ros gheal (Ros gheal), the northern Seann Skell and Ros leathan (Ros leathan). The map marks eight of its houses as temples: Cnoc bheag, Inis bhàn, Ros gheal and the northern Seann Skell; Àth shean on the northern march (Àth shean); the Hawk mill of Muileann uaine (Muileann uaine) and its field village Achadh fhada (Achadh fhada); and Inis iséal (Inis iséal), where the Hawk's own custodian sits.

SCOILTEAN NAN DRAOIDHEAN

What it holds. The druid schools are the reasoning order of the Old Faith, and they call themselves by their oldest name, Feallsanachd an Fhèidh, the Philosophy of the Deer. They are schools more than a church. They formed around one question, why the vein answers some hands and not others (10 an Dàmhair 2896 BDE): "the first attempt within the Old Faith to reason about the obsidian rather than simply revere it." They do not deny that the vein is holy. They ask what the holiness does. Their patron is Flidais, lady of the deer and the wild, whose white stag walks in their sacred wood. None of the schools' records in the library show the stag, Camaran, being worshipped. His name first appears "in texts much younger than these events" (7 an Dùbhlachd 2881 BDE). The schools are counted among the orders of the Old Faith, and they have not objected.

Rites and sayings. Their one public observance is the yearly walking of the bounds of Flidais's wood (11 an t-Iuchar 440 DE). Everything else they do is argument. Their oldest question, as the masters put it to beginners, is:

Carson an làmh seo? Why this hand?

A student who thinks he has solved it is given Aonghas mac Coinnich's answer (19 an t-Ògmhios 1828 DE):

Chan e sin a' cheist. That is not the question.

Holy places. Coille Naomh Muileann chiar (Coille Naomh Muileann chiar), "marked sacred, long before any order of the Old Faith claims it formally" (21 an Giblean 9504 BDE), where the white stag was first seen (11 am Màrt 9392 BDE). The wood lies outside the schools' own country, among Old Spirits towns in the shire of Baile chaol, and the people of Cnoc uaine (Cnoc uaine) and Àth dhearg (Àth dhearg) on its edge, who keep the ancestors, share its keeping. Dùn thais (Dùn thais) has the first stone temple of the stag's people (21 am Màrt 110 BDE). Caol shean (Caol shean) is the schools' house in the New Age.

Where it is held now. 133 burghs, all Ròdaich, in the north-east and the eastern hills; the east coast itself belongs to the Old Spirits. The schools stand first in twenty-three shires, a block running from Tobar ghorm and Àth mhòr in the north through Caol bheag, Baile gharbh and Dùn thais to Caol shean, Muileann chiar and Muileann dhearg in the hills, and west to Baile Mòr dhomhain in the middle of the island. They share ten more, most of them with the Old Spirits along the line where the two faiths meet, and they have nearly half of Cnoc dhubh, Dùn iséal and Cnoc gheal. The largest towns are Caol bheag (Caol bheag), Baile gharbh (Baile gharbh), Dùn thais, Caol

shean and Caol gharbh (Caol gharbh). The map marks sixteen of the schools' houses as temples, though the schools call them halls: among them Dùn thais, Caol shean, Caol bheag, Ros fhionn (Ros fhionn) and the church villages whose chapels served the silver-miners and the old bridge. Muileann chaol (Muileann chaol), the library town, is a school town. The schools' history is given in section IX.

ÒRD MHACHA

What it holds. Macha's order holds that "light and dark are two powers in balance, and the vein belongs to both" (31 an Dùbhlachd 402 DE). The wood-watchers held that their black beast has two natures, one that keeps and one that devours, and that so has the vein (13 am Faoilleach 147 BDE); the order tells it of the two horses that drew one chariot, the black Dubh Sainglenn and the grey Liath Macha. It is the order of the capital and the court, and the kings of Rodos are made by its rite. Its oldest saying is the wood-watchers':

Tha dà nàdar aig a' bhèist, agus aig an fhèith. The beast has two natures, and so has the vein.

Its own saying is of the pair:

Dà each, aon chuing. Two horses, one yoke.

Rites and holy places. Its priests read omens for rulers and bury by their own rite. King Aonghas mac Uisdein was the first king buried that way (31 an Dùbhlachd 445 DE). Its floors are laid in black and white, and the floor of its great house at Cathair mhòr (Cathair mhòr) took eleven years (14 am Màrt 1420 DE). Its sacred wood is Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag (Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag), near the lesser Cnoc bheag south of the capital (Cnoc bheag). That town is not the Hawk river port of the same name.

History. The order began as a watch. A small company settled at the edge of a wood no one had ever cleared and watched for a black horned beast that walked in it (15 an t-Samhain 1430 BDE), the beast the order takes for a sign of Dubh Sainglenn, the black horse. Its quarrel with the stag's people over both sacred woods became the holy-wood dispute, "settled by dividing custody rather than choosing a winner" (10 an Gearran 1410 BDE). Anna Ruadh took a wood-watcher into her household at Cathair dhearg to read the omens (23 an t-Iuchar 177 BDE). Cathair dhomhain refused one, and the rivalry between the two towns took a religious turn "it never loses" (24 an t-Ògmhios 173 BDE). Cathair dhomhain is a town of Macha's order now, with its own temple. The order was formalised when King Aonghas took up the wood-watchers'

rite of Macha (31 an Dùbhlachd 402 DE). By royal grant its priests then took sole custody of the western wood, and the other claimants withdrew for reasons the record does not give (14 am Faoilleach 432 DE).

Under the humans it split over the Residency's coin. The priests at Cathair dhearg blessed it (24 an Gearran 1864 DE). Those who refused went to the sacred forest, where they received custodians who had lost their seats (25 am Màrt 1866 DE). Sixty years later the capital's temple sheltered the council that Strake had locked out (26 an Gearran 1926 DE). In the forest the dissenters sat with custodians and the Lamp-Watch when the council of the mining regions was formed (20 an Lùnastal 1927 DE). In the restored kingdom the house at Cathair dhearg got back the keeping of the regalia and refused Òrd Bhrìde a share of it (26 an Gearran 1936 DE).

Where it is held now. 103 burghs, all Ròdaich, across the middle and south of the island. It stands first in twenty-nine shires in one block, from the capital's own shire (Cathair dhearg) and its neighbours in the middle of the island south to Ros dhomhain, Cathair fhada and Doire fhiadhaich, and east to Cathair mhòr and Seann Chwen. Manannan's order holds more than a third of Cathair dhomhain, the shire of the capital's old rival, and in Baile ghlas the Stone holds most of the land, though the harbour town is Macha's. The largest towns are Ros dhomhain (Ros dhomhain), Cathair mhòr, Àth shean (Àth shean), Seann Chwen (Seann Chwen) and Baile ghlas (Baile ghlas). The map marks seventeen of its temples. Five are the great houses of Cathair mhòr, Cathair dhomhain (Cathair dhomhain), Cathair dhearg (Cathair dhearg), Ceann leathan (Ceann leathan) and Cuan uaine (Cuan uaine); the others are the priests' towns, such as Cathair naomh (Cathair naomh) and Cnoc bhàn (Cnoc bhàn), where acolytes are trained for the capital's temples, and the chapels along the roads to the capital. Cnoc naomh, whose people once kept the old reverence "with no hawk, wolf, sting or stag in it" (16 an t-Ògmhios 73 BDE), is a town of Macha's order on the map.

ÒRD NA CLOICHE

What it holds. The order of the Stone holds that the Stone watches the whole island as a guard watches a road, and will cry out under the rightful king (21 an Lùnastal 156 BDE). The Stone is Lia Fàil, and its sworn guards are the Fianna, "who keep the island as a wolf keeps its range" (28 am Màrt 370 DE). The Stone's plain name is Clach, the common word for *stone*. The first stone was a white stone carved as a wolf at the gate of Caol leathan, on which road-guards swore their watch, and the annals say that "later ages will read more into the stone than they did" (12 am Faoilleach 1990 BDE). The tales of Fionn and his Fianna are the order's own. The record does not show the Stone

claiming the vein. When Òrd Bhrìde was formalised, the houses of the Stone sent no witnesses, only "a letter saying they wish it well" (2 an Gearran 1936 DE).

Rites and sayings. Oaths are taken before the Stone. The houses of the Stone nurse the sick. At Inis chrom the Fianna died doing it, "and the town becomes the Stone's for good" (3 an t-Sultain 585 DE). Its saying comes from the road-guards:

Mar a ghlèidheas am freiceadan an rathad, gleidhidh Clach an t-eilean. As the guard keeps the road, Clach keeps the island.

Holy places. Caol leathan (Caol leathan), whose house of the Stone is the largest of the order and rings a bell for the hours (7 an Cèitean 1950 DE); Inis thais (Inis thais), where a second stone of white quartz was dragged from the mountain (3 an Dùbhlachd 782 BDE) and the first temple to Lia Fàil by name was built (16 an Dùbhlachd 380 DE); and Baile gheal (Baile gheal).

History. The wolf-sworn were soldiers before they were an order. The order was formalised when Dòmhnall mac Ailein, a net-maker of Inis thais, preached that their stone was Lia Fàil and its guards the Fianna (28 am Màrt 370 DE). Its schism was over the dead. Those who would not pray to the Stone for the dead kept the temple at Inis thais, and those who would built a house at Baile gheal (25 an Dùbhlachd 1350 DE, 8 an Lùnastal 1360 DE). The record does not say the two houses have been reconciled. In the New Age the houses of the Stone have acted as banks as well as churches. They issued chits on house paper when coin ran short (3 am Màrt 1935 DE) and lent the money for Doire shean's harbour (24 an t-Ògmhios 1959 DE). They also published a count of their own people that matched the kingdom's to within a hundred (28 an Lùnastal 1994 DE).

Where it is held now. 21 burgs, all Ròdaich, in the south-west. It holds six shires outright, Doire shean, Inis chrom, Baile ghorm, Caol fhiadhaich, Cnoc àrsaidh and Baile gheal, and most of Caol leathan and Baile ghlas. In Inis thais, the shire of its chief shrine, Manannan's order holds three-fifths of the land. The Stone also has a share of Seann Dunn, Baile chiar and Seann Warr, where Seann Warr is a town of the Stone in Manannan's country. The largest are Doire shean (Doire shean), Inis thais, Inis chrom (Inis chrom), Baile ghorm (Baile ghorm) and Seann Warr (Seann Warr). The map marks temples in eight of its towns: Inis thais, still the chief shrine of the order, Caol leathan, Baile gheal, Doire shean, Inis chrom, Caol fhiadhaich (Caol fhiadhaich), Baile Mòr fhionn (Baile Mòr fhionn) and Cnoc àrsaidh (Cnoc àrsaidh), which holds the oldest shrines of the Stone.

ÒRD MHANANNAIN

What it holds. Manannan's order holds that the lord of the sea sees the liar wherever he is, and that his Cup of Truth breaks at the lies spoken over it and is whole again at the truth; the yellow scorpion is the old sign on the Cup, and the order's badge. It was the first teaching on the island to call itself the only true one (3 an Dùbhlachd 153 BDE). Its central teaching is about the sea: Manannan shut the western sea behind the fleet of the Sundering with his mist, which hid the island from every ship beyond it, and it must not be tried again (1 an t-Sultain 615 DE). The order keeps the sea shut by prayer. Its priests recorded the mist thinning in the last years of the Age of Sundering (27 an Dàmhair 1774 DE), and it lifted in the winter the humans' ships came out of it (13 am Faoilleach 1780 DE). They held the Crossing to be the price of a prayer grown slack. When no ship came from the west after the Severance, and the council's ship found only open water, they said the lord of the sea had shut the sea again (11 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE).

Rites and sayings. Oaths of trade were first sworn on a scorpion's sting kept in a box (19 an t-Samhain 2120 BDE). Since the sting-oath became a creed they have been sworn over a cup marked with the scorpion, Manannan's Cup of Truth. No boat of the faithful may go out of sight of the headlands, and on the west coast steering by the stars was lost entirely (27 an t-Samhain 655 DE). At the harbour mouth the priests pray (13 an Giblean 1551 DE):

A Mhanannain, cùm a' mhuir dùinte. Manannan, keep the sea shut.

Since 1675 DE that prayer has been said on the day of the empty-harbour rite. So on one quay, on one day, some mourn the departed and some pray that no one follows them. Neither side is pleased.

Holy places. Seann Skell in the west (Seann Skell), where the teaching was declared; Baile àrsaidh (Baile àrsaidh), where the sting-oath began; and Seann Vell (Seann Vell), which has the first scorpion carved in yellow stone for worship (4 an t-Samhain 150 BDE).

History. The sting-oath went from Baile àrsaidh up the coast to Ros bheag (1 am Faoilleach 854 BDE) and became a creed at Seann Skell. The order was formalised when Mànas mac Ruairidh named its power Manannan mac Lir (1 an t-Sultain 615 DE). A worked timber longer than any tree on the island, held with nails no smith on Rodos could place, came ashore at Ceann mhòr. It was carried to Seann Skell, shown to Manannan's priests, and burned (22 an Cèitean 1755 DE). That was twenty-five years before the humans came. The first human fishing families on the north-west coast learned the order's harbour prayers at Ceann mhòr (14 am Màrt 1830 DE), and its

priests there say the Grey Night grew from them (section VII). In the New Age the house at Seann Bhral turned away the Tuathaich of the north who came for its feast of the sea, and the northerners made a feast of their own at Cnoc ghorm (2 an t-Sultain 1954 DE, 11 an Gearran 1955 DE); that quarrel belongs to the Church's history. On the eve of the Long War Manannan's house at Seann Skell refused to bless the enforcers' depot (23 am Faoilleach 2018 DE). In the present year its priests said the prayer to keep the sea shut on the day the first dubhan was shipped off the island under Dubhan's charter (7 an t-Sultain 2026 DE).

Where it is held now. 35 burgs, all Ròdaich, on the west coast. Its seat, the western Seann Skell, is the largest town on Rodos. It stands first in eight shires in the west, from Muileann naomh and Baile fhiadhaich south through Seann Skell, Ros bheag and Baile àrsaidh to Cuan shean and the Stone's holy shire of Inis thais, with Seann Warr inland. It also has more than a third of Cnoc bheag and Cathair dhomhain in the middle of the island and a quarter of Caol leathan. The map marks eleven of its houses as temples; besides the holy places above they include Ros bheag (Ros bheag) and the western Seann Bhral (Seann Bhral). After Seann Skell its largest towns are Cuan shean (Cuan shean) and Baile fhiadhaich (Baile fhiadhaich).

VI. Na Seann Spioradan

What it holds. The Old Spirits keep the reverence of the hearths as it was before the Hall: "reverence for ancestors, for the vein, for the weather that decides the mining season" (17 am Faoilleach 2978 BDE). The chronicle calls it the island's oldest continuous tradition. It keeps no priests, no order of worship and no council. Its powers, as the map gives them, are na Sìthichean, the people of the mounds, and its tellings speak of the ancestors, the sìth of the hills and mounds, and the spirits of weather, wells and streams, not of any one power over them. The gods belong to the Old Faith. When the hearths first called the powers of the mounds by that name, or who first did, is not known.

Rites and sayings. The living heads of families name their ancestors aloud. The names of the dead are cut on wooden posts, which are recut each generation as the old ones rot (7 an Dàmhair 140 DE). The faith keeps the walk to Allt an Àigh as its own, and after the Keepers declined the stream it took Muireach Liath's ruling for its saying:

Buinidh an t-allt do na sinnsearan agus don t-side. The stream belongs to the ancestors and to the weather.

It blesses what comes from the vein and nothing else. When copper was found behind Àth fhiadhaich, the town's Seann Spioradan house held no blessing for it (28 an Lùnastal 1989 DE).

Holy places. Dùn ìseal (Dùn ìseal) and its spirit-house; Seann Dunn (Seann Dunn), where the east-coast houses built a common hall for naming the ancestors of forty families (28 an Dàmhair 1951 DE); Allt an Àigh, which lies in the schools' country behind Caol shean, with the walkers' hall at Achadh gharbh, a school village (11 an Gearran 1940 DE); and Làrach an Teampaill, which at the houses' request was entered by the library as "measured and let be" (7 an Dàmhair 1960 DE).

History. By the end of the Holy Age the Hall's list counted the old folk as "a company of its own" (16 an t-Ògmhios 73 BDE). In the Age of Sundering they built a guest-house at the stream, and its book records pilgrims from every shire (10 an t-Samhain 1220 DE). Under the humans this was the first faith to refuse the Company's ore on principle. The households of Achadh naomh burned peat, and their elders taught "that ore burned for wages is ore burned without the ancestors' leave" (16 am Màrt 1802 DE). In the Long Drought the Administration's watchman at Allt an Àigh, posted to charge pilgrims for the water, was recalled after one season (1 an Cèitean 1887 DE). In the New Age the custodians of Òrd Bhride discouraged the walk and did not forbid it (8 an t-Iuchar 1939 DE).

Where it is held now. 126 burgs, all Ròdaich, and more land than any single order of the Old Faith. It holds thirty-four shires: the whole south-east, from Seann Bhral and Achadh mhòr to Baile ghorm and Ceann mhin; the east coast from Ceann leathan north through Seann Tarr and Achadh shean to Baile ruadh; the hills round Dùn ìseal, where the schools hold nearly as much (Dùn ìseal, Cnoc dhubh, Cnoc dhìreach); and a band of the north coast between the Hawk and the schools, from Baile Mòr mhòr and Seann Bhrenn to Seann Toll and Caol ìseal. It has a share of eleven more, among them Muileann bheag, which it divides almost evenly with the schools. The largest are Seann Bhral (Seann Bhral), Achadh mhòr (Achadh mhòr), Baile Mòr mhòr (Baile Mòr mhòr), Muileann bhàn (Muileann bhàn), Achadh naomh (Achadh naomh) and Dùn dhearg (Dùn dhearg). The map marks temples in twenty-four of its towns, more than for any single order. The chief are Dùn ìseal, Seann Dunn, Seann Tarr (Seann Tarr), whose shrine draws the whole north-east at the great feasts, and Cathair naomh (Cathair naomh), whose elders the shrine-keepers of the north answer to. The rest are the shrines of wells, springs, fords and holy woods, and the houses of the largest towns.

VII. An Eaglais

What it holds. The Church is the faith the humans brought over the sea at the Crossing (5 am Faoilleach 1780 DE). It holds that there is one God, *Dia*, and that Crìosd, Christ, is his son. Its book is *am Bioball*, the Bible. Its clergy are *sagairt* and *ministear-an*, priests and ministers, under *easbaigean*, bishops; it has had *manaich*, monks, and it keeps the days of its *naoimh*, its saints. On Rodos it is the faith of the human labourers and the Residency in the Age of Strangers, and of the Tuathaich, their descendants, since.

The Mission. The Church came to the Ròdaich as the Mission. It raised a timber chapel on the quay at Ros dhomhain, the first church on the island (30 an Dùbhlachd 1792 DE), and ran a school there that taught Ròdach children in the humans' tongue (9 an Cèitean 1830 DE). Samuel Wren made his grammar of Ròdais for its use (21 an Lùnastal 1791 DE), and the hawk-priests of Cnoc bheag asked it for a copy (4 an t-Iuchar 1792 DE). The Mission kept lists of the dead in the camps, and the custodians wrote their own count in its margins (11 an Dàmhair 1818 DE). Samuel Wren asked the masters of the schools why the vein should be holy, and they asked him why his fuel should be burned (3 an Dùbhlachd 1797 DE). The Mission's house in the north was at Cathair gheal (Cathair gheal).

The churches of the north. Most Tuathaich towns keep the Church their forebears brought at the Crossing, in the line the Mission left, while the Ròdaich of the west coast beside them keep Manannan's order (30 am Màrt 1938 DE). How the churches of the Mission's line came to outnumber the older congregations of the north coast the record does not say. Their largest house is at Cnoc ghorm (Cnoc ghorm). It opened a school for its priests that taught in the humans' tongue and read the Bible in the Ròdais text its preachers use on the west coast, the only place in the north where both are taught (29 an Giblean 1939 DE). In the early New Age the northerners came south to the feast of the sea at Seann Bhral, as their forebears had learned to from the Ròdaich harbours. The house of Manannan's order there turned them away, and its keeper said "the sea is the same and the house is not" (2 an t-Sultain 1954 DE). They kept the feast at the church at Cnoc ghorm instead, as a blessing of the boats, and within a generation it was the larger of the two (11 an Gearran 1955 DE).

These churches hold 51 burgs. They hold seven shires in the north-west, Cnoc ghorm, Ceann mhòr, Cnoc thais, Muileann àrsaidh and Baile iséal, and on the north coast Caol mhòr and Àth àrsaidh. The map marks eight of their houses as temples, among them Cnoc ghorm and Cathair gheal. Their largest towns are Caol mhòr (Caol mhòr), the Moot's town, Ceann mhòr (Ceann mhòr) and Cnoc ghorm.

Eaglais nan Tuathach and the voyage of Naomh Breandan. The old congregations of the north coast keep the Church in their own way (13 an Gearran 1938 DE), "including, quietly, the telling of the First Canoe, the voyage of Naomh Breandan to the Isle of the Blessed, which the Ròdaich priesthood still calls superstition." Beyond that the record holds almost nothing, and what it has comes from outside them. Few Tuathaich would speak to the chronicle clerks (25 am Màrt 1948 DE). The north's books stayed in private keeping (3 an Lùnastal 1996 DE). The request to archive Tuathaich oral history at the library was tabled rather than rejected, and it is still tabled (15 an Gearran 2016 DE). This appendix does not know their rites or their sayings, or how far they differ from the churches of the Mission's line. Of their holy places it knows three, the houses the map marks as temples: Doire ghlas, called the heart of the Church in the north, whose keepers are said to hold the First Canoe fragment and have not let the library copy it; Muileann leathan; and Cill chaol (Cill chaol), a Ròdaich chapel village whose chapel the Tuathaich made a church, leaving the old carvings on its doorposts beside their own.

The only one of their tellings known outside the north is the fragment its tellers set in the Ancient Age: "a named steersman, a first crossing" (9 an t-Samhain 10,073 BDE). The steersman is Naomh Breandan, Saint Brendan the Navigator of the humans' Church, who sailed west from an Tìr Thall in a boat of hides to the Isle of the Blessed, and the north's tellers say that isle was Rodos. His name is in no Ròdaich record. His voyage has a mist at sea and an island of the blessed in the west, as the Ròdaich tellings of Manannan's sea have, and the Library notes the likeness and draws nothing from it. The record does not say how families whose forebears came over the water in 1780 DE came to keep a telling of a crossing set so long before the Sundering. This appendix leaves it where its tellers set it, notes that the north still keeps it in the present day (21 an Dùbhlachd 2026 DE), and does not resolve it.

The old congregations hold twelve burghs, all Tuathaich, along the north. They hold three shires, Doire ghlas, Muileann leathan and the island shire of Eilean dhìreach off the coast to the west of them, and have a share of six more, among them the land west of Baile chrom on the north-western cape, a quarter of Àth àrsaidh and a sixth of Inis mhin and Caol mhòr. The largest are Doire ghlas (Doire ghlas), Muileann leathan (Muileann leathan), Inis mhin (Inis mhin) and Baile ghlas in Siorrachd Àth àrsaidh (Baile ghlas).

Rùn-dìomhair na h-Oidhche Glaise. Of the Mystery of the Grey Night the record knows the name, the goose, one custom and one town. The goose is Sìne, an Gèadh Sìtheil, the Peaceful Goose, the keepers' name for an Gèadh Fiadhaich, the wild goose of the Holy Spirit. The custom is "one night of silence in the year", a vigil, and outsiders are not told which night it is (14 am Màrt 1938 DE). No saying is known.

The vigil first appears in a Mission report that human labourers near Baile chrom were keeping a vigil at night in the fields, praying in silence under the sign of a grey goose, which they called the wild goose of the Spirit (28 an Lùnastal 1912 DE). The Mission called it irregular, a superstition learned from the Ròdaich, and the Ròdaich of Baile chrom disowned it. Manannan's priests at Ceann mhòr said the Mission was half right. The first human fishing families on that coast had settled at Ceann mhòr (14 am Màrt 1830 DE) and learned Manannan's night prayer to keep the sea shut there, and the labourers inland kept it as a Christian vigil, a night of silence under the wild goose of the Spirit instead of a prayer to Manannan. The priests called it Manannan's prayer gone astray and would not have its keepers in their house (21 an Dàmhair 1912 DE). The Church's bishops call the vigil irregular and have not put it out. From the Ancient Age the record keeps a telling of the grey geese that winter on Eilean ghorm and are never hunted there (3 an Lùnastal 9112 BDE). The record does not connect the two, and this appendix does not either. After the Severance the vigil-keeper Hannah Crane held the vigil openly (14 am Màrt 1938 DE). A magistrate fined her, and the vigil moved indoors (15 an t-Ògmhios 1956 DE). The keeper of Taigh-solais Baile chrom (Taigh-solais Baile chrom) reported that the vigil was kept in the lighthouse's shadow (27 an Giblean 1961 DE). In the Long War soldiers searched the town on a night when it was wholly dark and silent, and they found nothing (9 an Dùbhlachd 2020 DE).

The vigil holds one burg, Baile chrom in the far north-west (Baile chrom), and with it the whole of its shire (Baile chrom) and a tenth of Ceann mhòr next door. It is not the Baile chrom in the hills (Baile chrom), and the record takes care to keep the two apart (11 an Gearran 1853 DE).

Where the Church is held now. 64 burgs, every Tuathaich town on the map, and eleven shires, all in the north and north-west. It has a share of five more: a quarter of Seann Skell and of Seann Vell, a sixth of Inis mhin, and smaller parts of Baile fhiadhaich and Muileann naomh. The map marks twelve of its churches as temples.

VIII. Of the Obsidian Rite

The Rite is older than any name for it. Its root is the slab over the crack and the handful in the cup. What the chronicle calls the Obsidian Rite, and the Old Faith calls Òrd Bhrìde, is the part of the old reverence that holds the vein itself to be sacred. The vein is Crom's, and Bride's flame is lit from what it gives, but the Rite does not hold it to be the sign of a god or the seat of a spirit. It is the holy thing.

The vein as sacred. The Rite holds that the vein bleeds because it is alive in some way the Ròdaich are not asked to understand. What is broken from it must be burned

in measure or returned. The vein answers a line of people, and that answering is itself holy. The doctrine of 1935 is "built around the leyline and the unbroken line of the obsidian-touched" (18 an Giblean 1935 DE): the vein under the ground and the blood of those it has answered. Fionnghal nic Artair's defence of the Small-Burning Law, the only one that survives, argued that "the Law was never about the ore but about the people who would become whatever the burning made them" (11 an t-Ògmhios 1801 DE). She wrote it two generations before Aisling was born, and it has been read as prophecy since. She did not claim to be prophesying.

Under the Keepers. In the Holy Age the Rite belonged to the Hall. The Keepers held the cup, took the census of hands (22 an t-Ògmhios 1264 BDE) and sentenced households that burned beyond the measure (1 an Cèitean 2854 BDE). Their roll holds one hundred and forty names (2 an Giblean 60 BDE).

Under the vein-house. Each ship of the Sundering carried one sealed measure of ore and no more (17 an t-Ògmhios 15 BDE). The vein-house above Muileann dhearg kept the custody-book, and in 820 DE the crown and the custody were joined. The Rite's worst hour in that age came in war, not heresy. Raghnaill Ruadh, holding the vein-house, refused the handful to every hearth in the shires that stood against him, "and the act turns more people against him than any battle" (24 am Faoilleach 519 DE). The council refused the Fed Hawk's petition and refused Clann Choinnich's request to smelt silver with the ore (31 an Lùnastal 1520 DE), "the first request to burn the ore for work rather than worship."

Under the humans. The Small-Burning Law lapsed without repeal "once it stops being profitable to enforce" (2 an Dùbhlachd 1800 DE). The Rite lived on in shrines at the pit mouths. At Cill dhìreach the crews left the first piece of ore from each new gallery, and the Company allowed it "because it costs a stone a gallery" (19 an t-Sultain 1851 DE). At Cill ghlas the custodians kept the rites at the mouth of the oldest cutting (18 an Dàmhair 1851 DE). They agreed the word *fuil-ghuail* there (21 an Gearran 1905 DE), and the Rending swallowed that shrine (3 an t-Iuchar 1916 DE).

Formalised. The Rite was formalised on 18 an Giblean 1935 DE. Dòmhnall mac Thormoid was seated at the southern Seann Skell as Àrd-choimheadaiche, and his first charge was a written order of worship: "there had never been one" (17 an Cèitean 1935 DE). The Hawk refused the order and the Stone stood aside. When the council kept the night shift, the custodians "enter a protest and then bless the shafts" (18 an t-Samhain 1940 DE). The Rite has worked that way ever since. It protests how the kingdom uses the vein, and then it blesses it.

The Depletion. The high custodian ruled that dubhan was "not forbidden, since it is not ore, and not blessed, since it is not ore" (25 an t-Samhain 2003 DE). When the beacons were converted (22 an Cèitean 2005 DE), the obsidian flame of Taigh-solais

Tobar dhearg was carried to Seann Skell and left to burn out on the altar (19 an t-Iuchar 2005 DE). When the coinage seal lost its obsidian ink, the high custodian protested. The council replied that the kingdom had never said it held the vein sacred (31 an t-Iuchar 2014 DE).

The Rite now. One face of the Sloc Mòr is kept open under the Rite's custody (17 an Cèitean 2025 DE). Twelve hewers work it, the last of their trade (15 an t-Ògmhios 2025 DE). On 6 an Dàmhair 2026 DE they cut the year's altar-ore. It filled four baskets, and the high custodian divided it among the houses by lot.

That is why Òrd Bhrìde holds only nine burgs. Most Ròdaich who hold the vein sacred keep it at the hearth, as the Old Spirits do, or at the local altar, as the Hawk does. The Rite is their orthodoxy in name, and it is their whole practice in only nine towns. It was formalised after the vein had begun to fail. In less than a century it went from an order of worship for the whole island to four baskets of ore.

IX. Of the Schools' Question

Carson an làmh seo?

The druid schools began with one question, asked at Muileann chiar in the Holy Age: why does the vein answer some hands and not others (10 an Dàmhair 2896 BDE)? Some have made much of how close *feidh*, deer, sounds to *feith*, vein. The schools' own texts do not.

Forbidden and allowed. The Hall shut the galleries to the stag's people "on the ground that a question asked of the vein is a demand made of it" (18 an Cèitean 2874 BDE). They were later let back in on an oath "to ask nothing of the vein aloud" (26 an Gearran 2425 BDE). The Hall called that a reconciliation, and the schools called it a truce. Long after the truce the stag's people made the first Ròdaich letters out of cutters' tally-notches (15 am Màrt 2085 BDE), the letters the schools call ogham, and nearly every later hand on the island descends from them.

Birth or effort. Apprentices kept strike-books, written accounts of every blow (23 am Màrt 1358 BDE). Reading them, Donnchadh mac Iain found that the ore bled brighter for older cutters, whatever house they came from (28 an Gearran 709 BDE). The chronicle records the split that followed: "a breakaway school of druids argues the vein answers effort, not birth — a quiet, centuries-early rehearsal of the argument the Long War will eventually be fought over" (7 an t-Sultain 682 BDE). The breakaway school at Muileann chaol did not write a cutter's parentage in the book at all (9 an Lùnastal 669 BDE). The Keeper Raonaid Dhubh heard both schools and gave no ruling, "saying the vein has not asked the Hall to decide" (4 an t-Samhain 633 BDE).

The years of disputation. At Dùn thais the question was argued by rule (29 an Cèitean 275 DE). Eilidh Dhubh's tracts for the effort-school were read aloud at harvest gatherings across the north-east (23 an t-Ògmhios 445 DE). Then Raghnaill mac Chaluim showed that the heads of the custodian houses lived a few years longer than their tenants, and asked whether the vein answers the hand that holds it (29 an t-Samhain 1170 DE). The house was later reopened only on condition that the question of longer lives was not raised (20 an Giblean 1720 DE). His table is nearly seven hundred years older than the first of the immortal generation.

Under the humans. Samuel Wren asked the masters why the vein should be holy. They asked him why his fuel should be burned (3 an Dùbhlachd 1797 DE). Aonghas mac Coinnich asked why the humans cannot see the colour in broken ore, and said it was the wrong question (19 an t-Ògmhios 1828 DE). Tolley closed the hall at Dùn thais (14 an Dùbhlachd 1868 DE). The last public disputation asked whether a question may be forbidden, and the Administration's clerk recorded that it may (30 an Giblean 1869 DE). After that the masters taught under the trees (15 an t-Ògmhios 1869 DE), until the last of them died in 1902 DE.

The revival. The schools reopened in 1975 DE, when their question became "suddenly urgent again as the vein itself starts running short." Seonaid nic Ghill-Eathain lectured in the sacred wood (11 an Dùbhlachd 1975 DE), and the schools took a house at Caol shean, where students debated the census note on the obsidian-touched openly (5 an Dùbhlachd 1976 DE). When the Mine Board searched for a second vein, she wrote that "nobody has asked why there is one vein" (13 an Giblean 1980 DE). The Board filed her letter, and the search found nothing (21 an Giblean 1980 DE). The schools' own word for their revival is *dubhan-tùsail* (22 an Dàmhair 2010 DE).

What the question has come to. In the Holy Age it asked whether the ore bled for birth or for practice. In the Age of Sundering it asked whether the vein lengthened lives. Under the humans it asked why the humans could not see the colour. Since 1905 DE, when the custodians agreed a plain word for what the vein had begun to do to a few children, the answer has had a name but no reason. The masters do not claim that the question caused the Long War, and no one has accused them of it. They would say only that it was asked in the Holy Age and has not been answered since.

APPENDIX C

Hosts, Wars and Calamities

This appendix gathers from the annals every war and armed struggle the record keeps, the hosts that stand on the map today, and the calamities that have fallen on the island, whether sent by the sea, the ground, the weather or the vein. It adds nothing the annals do not hold. Where the annals disagree with one another the entries are given as they stand. Where the record is sealed, or was never made, this appendix says so and goes no further.

The reader should know how much is missing. The Ancient Age cut its dead on tally stones and did not say what killed them. The Age of Sundering left two histories of its wars, and one was written to praise a king. For the Age of Strangers the custodians' rolls, the Mission's lists and the Residency's letter-books seldom give the same number. The complete record of the Long War is sealed at Leabharlann Muileann chaol until the fifty years run out (14 am Faoilleach 2023 DE).

Part I. The Wars

Before the wars

The oldest act of force the record knows is not a war, and nobody knows who did it. On 29 an Dàmhair 8944 BDE the single gate of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire was blocked with rubble from the inside, by people who left by another way or did not leave. More than a century later the cistern of Làrach an Dùin, which had served four hundred people, was found choked with the bones of whole cattle (4 an Giblean 8832 BDE). Both are works of the Seann-Dhaoine. The record will not guess at what was being fought over there, or by whom.

The first war in either of the oral king-lists is **the salt-flats raid**. On 9 am Faoilleach 6929 BDE Mòrag Chruaidh, fifth of the Stone Kings, led the hill-folk down to the salt-pans at Baile ghorm and carried the salt away. Seven died on the hill side, and the telling keeps that number. Her successor Iain Dubh went down to repeat the

raid and was killed on the shingle (8 an t-Ògmhios 6874 BDE). The list says only that he was brought home. After him the Ancient Age records no war.

The War of the Roads

Cause. In the Holy Age the carriers' road ran from the mountain to the sea, and its tolls went to the rìgh of Dùn dhearg. Lachlann Ciar, head of the leading family of the harbour town of Caol leathan, began to keep the southern tolls for himself and send none of them to Dùn dhearg (14 an Gearran 2008 BDE). Iain Garbh, son of Sileas Dhonn, took the hall at Dùn dhearg and demanded the western tolls, and Lachlann Ciar sent him back a basket of fish-bones (12 an Cèitean 2005 BDE).

Sides. On one side were Iain Garbh of Dùn dhearg, the road-guards and the low-land levies. On the other were Lachlann Ciar and the men of Caol leathan. The Hall at Dùn ìseal refused to bless either side.

Course. On 13 an Giblean 2000 BDE Iain Garbh marched west and burned the toll-house at Muileann òg, which Lachlann Ciar's people had taken. The annals call this the first war between Ròdaich and Ròdaich. At the ford of Àth fhiadhaich the men of Caol leathan held Iain Garbh's levies for a day before they gave way (21 an Dàmhair 1998 BDE). Forty were dead on the two sides together, and for a long time afterward the carriers called it the ford of the forty. Falling back, Lachlann Ciar's men burned Baile ghlas so that the levies would find no grain there (16 am Faoilleach 1997 BDE). Its people walked to Cathair dhomhain, and many of them never came home. Baile chlar shut its gate against both armies and fed the burned-out people of Baile ghlas through the winter (18 an Dùbhlachd 1996 BDE). Neither side forgave it and neither side attacked it. Iain Garbh then closed Caol leathan from the landward side for a season, but its boats brought in fish and he could not close the harbour. His levies drifted home for the harvest, and the siege ended without an assault (2 an t-Samhain 1994 BDE).

End. The two leaders met under the roof of the waypoint house that would later be called Am Buabhall Fortanach, where by the road-peace neither of them could draw (4 an Dàmhair 1993 BDE). Caol leathan kept half its tolls and sent the other half to Dùn dhearg, and Lachlann Ciar swore to the Law with the Keeper as witness. So the war ended in a house built to feed carriers. Muileann òg was rebuilt as a market town, and its fair is the ancestor of Fèill Muileann òg (5 an t-Iuchar 1334 BDE).

Lesser strife of the Holy Age

The **Silver Feud** (17 an t-Sultain 1253 BDE) was a closing and not a war. For three seasons no silver left Muileann chiar. The road-guards went unpaid and the eastern tolls went uncollected. The record gives the feud its name while noting that no one was killed in it. At sea, outlaw boats from the eastern islets began raiding the fishing strands. Sliochd Raghnaill armed its boats at Seann Tarr and burned two of them (10 an t-Ògmhios 544 BDE), and the rest were never caught. Late in the age raiders from the north-western waters took a season's dried fish from the north-western strands. The sting-sworn merchants of Ros bheag paid for two armed boats to watch the shore, and the raiders moved north (28 an Gearran 252 BDE).

The War of the Three Claimants

Cause. King Tormod Bàn's two sons were drowned together when a ferry overturned on Abhainn fhionn (18 an t-Ògmhios 495 DE). The king died at Cathair dhearg without naming an heir (8 an t-Sultain 508 DE), and three claims were laid before the houses at once.

Sides. The claimants were Catriona nic Aonghais of Inis thais, the late king's niece; Dùghall Garbh of Baile Mòr dhomhain, his half-brother; and Raghnaill Ruadh, head of Clann Raghnaill and master of the vein-house above Muileann dhearg (21 an Giblean 513 DE). The seven houses divided among the three. Seann Warr, the western port nearest the capital, shut its gates to all three and declared for none (20 an Cèitean 514 DE). It was besieged twice during the war and taken by neither claimant.

Course. Dùghall's host broke Raghnaill's at the ford of Àth shean on 22 an Gearran 515 DE. The custody-book counts some three hundred dead, most of them drowned in the ford. Raghnaill's men burned Doire mhin and its granary as they fell back (24 an t-Sultain 516 DE), and the villagers spent the winter at Cathair mhòr on the charity of Macha's priests. Catriona besieged Cathair dhomhain, which had declared for Dùghall, and took it after forty days, when the dead of the siege lines had poisoned its wells (26 an Dùbhlachd 518 DE). She let the garrison go free on their oath. Raghnaill, who held the vein-house, then refused the measured handful of ore to every hearth and temple in the shires that stood against him (24 am Faoilleach 519 DE). Hearths that had burned ore for generations went cold. The annals judge that this act turned more people against him than any battle did. Catriona and Dùghall joined their hosts for the purpose and met Raghnaill below Muileann chrom on 14 am Faoilleach 521 DE. Raghnaill was killed on the field, and his own custodians opened the vein-house the next day.

End. Catriona was crowned at Cathair dhearg on 13 am Màrt 523 DE and was known afterward as Catriona Bhuadhach. The war had lasted about a decade. Her first great law bound the custodians themselves: no claimant, house or king could withhold the handful from a lawful hearth (12 an Gearran 526 DE). Seann Warr's neutral gates were later honoured by the crown (11 an Giblean 555 DE). Seònaid nic Coinnich's *Book of the Three Claimants* (8 an t-Ògmhios 585 DE) is the oldest history on Rodos written as one narrative rather than as a list of entries.

The sea-thieves of the north-west

Boats working out of the small islands off the north-west coast began to take fish and grain from coasting traders (24 am Faoilleach 745 DE). The thieves were Ròdaich, men of the north-west shore, and the harbour rolls give some of their names. A force sent by Queen Eilidh Bhàn landed on Eilean dhubh and burned their boats on the strand (27 an t-Samhain 762 DE). Their leader, Uilleam Ruadh, was taken to Cathair dhearg and hanged.

The Brothers' War, Cogadh nam Bràithrean

Cause. King Ailean mac Raghnaill died at Cathair dhearg leaving two sons by different mothers, Iain Ciar and Alasdair Bàn, and each of them had been told that he was the heir (7 an t-Iuchar 1227 DE).

Sides. The seven houses divided four to three between the brothers.

Course. Alasdair Bàn's men seized Cnoc naomh, and Iain Ciar took it back on 8 an t-Ògmhios 1231 DE. The war is named from that battle. Alasdair's ships burned the waterfront of Ceann mhin, which held for his brother, taking the rope stores and the granary, and the town had to beg its bread from Cathair mhòr (17 an Lùnastal 1233 DE). Iain Ciar defeated Alasdair below Muileann ghlas on 19 an t-Iuchar 1235 DE. Alasdair was taken alive, and his captains were allowed to go home.

End. The brothers made peace at An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, on neutral ground between their lands (12 an t-Sultain 1237 DE). Alasdair gave up his claim and was given the lordship of Seann Chwen for life. Iain Ciar was crowned. Alasdair kept the peace until his death (8 an Dàmhair 1252 DE), and his lordship went back to the crown. Iain Ciar, having seen Ceann mhin beg for bread, ordered every shire seat to keep a year's grain in store against the next war (20 an Giblean 1260 DE). The only surviving account of the war was written by his clerk Pàdraig mac Ruairidh (14 an Lùnastal 1265 DE). It praises the king at every turn, and later readers have found it inconvenient.

The humans' campaigns and the forerunners of war

For most of the Age of Strangers the humans made war only at sea. Raiders stripped a Company brig off the north-west coast (10 an Giblean 1795 DE) and burned an ore ship off the east (20 an Dàmhair 1825 DE). The Company's first armed reply was a gunboat that burned every boat on the shingle of a cove near Ceann leathan (25 an t-Iuchar 1826 DE). Most of them belonged to the town's own fishermen, and the raiders were not found.

On land the Administration kept no standing force until Charles Merriman brought a company of armed constables (24 an Lùnastal 1911 DE). They broke the dockers' strike at Ros dhomhain (1 an Giblean 1913 DE). After the Rending the roll records the first violent clash between the two peoples (17 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE), placed by its fuller entry at Muileann chrom (13 an Dùbhlachd 1916 DE): a gallery drowned seven when the pumps were stopped to save fuel, the crews stoned the Company's agent, and the constables fired. Four Ròdaich and one constable died. Merriman answered the second petition by tripling the constabulary and fortifying the stores of four mining towns (25 an Gearran 1919 DE). The roadside houses became waypoints for a militia with no name (9 an t-Sultain 1920 DE). The first coordinated stoppage was broken by closing the Company stores (30 an Dùbhlachd 1922 DE). After the confiscation edict (25 an Giblean 1926 DE) the silver guild began buying rifles from the eastern pirates (21 an t-Iuchar 1927 DE), a council for the mining regions met in the sacred forest at Cnoc bheag (20 an Lùnastal 1927 DE), and Strake ordered its arrest (3 am Faoilleach 1928 DE).

The War of the Hills

This history calls it the War of the Hills, after the country where it began. Later rolls call it the Severance war, after the way it ended.

Cause. On 20 an Gearran 1928 DE Ròdaich resistance, coordinated for the first time across several mining regions, passed from grievance to open war. The grievances are those listed above. The one cited most often is the confiscation edict.

Sides. On the Ròdaich side stood the council of custodians and crew-leaders under Eilidh nic Raghnaill, with the crews of the camps, the Lamp-Watch, the silver guild of Muileann chiar and its riflemen, the riflemen of Cnoc leathan (1 an Gearran 1929 DE), the company of the Hawk order's faithful mustered at Seann Skell (8 an t-Ògmhios

1929 DE), and the towns that declared for the council one after another. On the Administration's side stood Commissioner Strake, the constabulary, the Company's guards, and the Company's steamships and coasters. Some towns held apart. The human town of Cathair gheal shut its gates and raised a militia that it sent to neither side (24 an Cèitean 1929 DE). The concession town of Muileann àrsaidh closed its road against both sides for the rest of the war (28 an Cèitean 1929 DE). The Ròdaich city of Ros dhomhain, below the Residency, neither joined the rising nor opposed it until late in the war.

Course. The war opened in the hills. Crews under Mòrag nic Iain rushed the store at Muileann chrom at first light, and its eleven constables surrendered without a shot (28 an Gearran 1928 DE). Crews sank two barges across the mouth of the ore quay at Ceann fhada (24 an Cèitean 1928 DE). At Baile thais the constables held their walled pithead for eleven days and surrendered on the twelfth, when their water ran out, and Eilidh nic Raghnaill sent them to the coast unharmed (1 an t-Ògmhios 1928 DE). The northern pits rose (30 an t-Ògmhios 1928 DE), and An Taigh-seinnse Mòr shut its gates across the ore road, which stayed cut (9 an Lùnastal 1928 DE). The capital rose next and barricaded Drochaid Cathair dhearg with ore-carts (18 an Lùnastal 1928 DE), and Strake drew the Administration into the Residency above Ros dhomhain (27 an t-Samhain 1928 DE).

The first relief column, under Major Peter Ashdown, was met at the ford of Àth chiar on 5 an Dùbhlachd 1928 DE. Ashdown lost forty men and his baggage. The rebels lost nineteen, and the council's roll names them all. Dùn chrom shut its gates behind the retreating column and nursed the wounded it left (3 am Faoilleach 1929 DE). In the east the silver town rose (15 am Faoilleach 1929 DE), and the post at Dùn iséal surrendered after one exchange of fire (17 am Faoilleach 1929 DE).

The humans struck back from the sea. A Company steamship came up the Abhainn uaine and shelled the ore stage at Seann Toll and burned the town behind it, killing twenty-three (15 an Gearran 1929 DE). On 10 an Cèitean 1929 DE fishing boats from Seann Chwen and Ros ruadh burned a Company coaster at anchor. The keepers of the southern beacons put out their fires, and two Company ships were lost on the reefs (9 an t-Ògmhios 1929 DE).

Through the first winter neither side could attack the other (26 an t-Ògmhios 1929 DE), and the capital went hungry (8 an t-Iuchar 1929 DE). In the stalemate the rebels burned the tithe ledgers in three raids (9 an t-Iuchar 1929 DE), at Ros dhomhain, Ceann àrsaidh and Muileann chrom. The Administration's last sally toward the mining country was driven back at Cnoc ghorm on 25 an Lùnastal 1929 DE. The Ros dhomhain harbour quarter opened its gates to the council (4 an t-Sultain 1929 DE), Strake left the Residency by water (21 an t-Sultain 1929 DE), and Ros bheag became

the last seat of the Administration (23 an t-Sultain 1929 DE), where the human families went hungry within weeks (4 an Dàmhair 1929 DE).

End. The last ship recorded from an Tìr Thall came to Ros bheag with a sealed letter and left on the next tide (1 an t-Samhain 1929 DE). Envoys met at Àth àrsaidh and agreed a truce (2 an t-Samhain 1929 DE). The humans still on Rodos would go into the north-west under the council's safe-conduct, and the council would leave the concession towns standing. The columns went north (29 an t-Samhain 1929 DE) and camped a night at Àth leathan (1 an Dùbhlachd 1929 DE), where several of the humans wrote down the name of the place. Strake sailed west in the last ship able to make the crossing (5 an Dùbhlachd 1929 DE). On 1 am Faoilleach 1930 DE the war ended with the crossing itself closed. That is the Severance. The war-companies were stood down, but never formally abolished (3 an t-Ògmhios 1930 DE).

Raiders in the New Age

After the Severance, ships flying no flag, some crewed by men who had served the Administration, raided the coast off Cathair gheal (4 an t-Sultain 1941 DE). The council sent no help, and in the end the fishermen armed their own boats, drove the raiders out, and were fined for bearing arms without licence (8 an Giblean 1949 DE). Only after the patrol boats were refitted for dubhan could they outrun the raiders (15 an t-Sultain 2012 DE).

An Cogadh Fada, the Long War

Cause. Some northern communities refused to take their place in the new economy (25 an Giblean 2015 DE) and kept working the last coal seams rather than depend on one man's fuel. When the Mine Board's northern revenue fell by a quarter (22 am Màrt 2017 DE), it declared the western seams Crown property and ordered the pits closed. Enforcers were posted at Seann Skell (16 an Dàmhair 2017 DE), the first armed company sent north since the Severance. Skirmishes too small to name followed (29 an t-Sultain 2018 DE). Ruth Calder's offer to pay the Crown's fifth in coal went unanswered (25 an Dùbhlachd 2018 DE). The mobilization order reformed the regiments (28 an Dàmhair 2019 DE) under Somhairle mac Lachlainn (26 an t-Samhain 2019 DE), and the Moot's last petition was filed (25 an Dùbhlachd 2019 DE).

Sides. On the kingdom's side were the Board's enforcers, the reformed regiments and later the fleets, all running on dubhan, in the reign of Cathal. On the other side were the holdouts of five western towns, Àth leathan, Muileann àrsaidh, Cnoc thais,

Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg, with Ruth Calder and Tom Varley named among them. The Moot stood apart and fed the hungry.

Course. Arms went west by the ore line (12 am Faoilleach 2020 DE). The hewers gathered at Àth leathan (20 am Faoilleach 2020 DE), and the regiments marched west (23 am Faoilleach 2020 DE). The **Battle of Àth leathan**, fought on 11 an Giblean 2020 DE at Àraich Àth leathan, was the first great engagement of the war. The open record counts only the kingdom's dead. Tuathaich telling puts the holdouts' in the hundreds, and Ruth Calder's name does not appear in the open record again (11 an Giblean 2020 DE). The holdouts fell back into the hills (11 an Giblean 2020 DE). The regiments besieged Muileann àrsaidh, which held for weeks on stored coal and potatoes (21 an Cèitean 2020 DE). Cnoc thais was taken after its road was cut (2 an Lùnastal 2020 DE), and Àth naomh and Tobar dhearg opened their roads without a siege (17 an Dùbhlachd 2020 DE). In the autumn of the next year a column of several hundred holdouts left the hills and moved south-east toward the capital (29 an Dàmhair 2021 DE). Why it did so is in the sealed archive. Tuathaich telling names its leader Owen Barrow, and the open record gives no name. It made camp by Muileann ghlas, a day's walk from the capital (6 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE), and the first and third regiments were brought down the fair road to meet it. The **Battle of Muileann ghlas**, fought on 10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE at Àraich Muileann ghlas, was the second and last great battle of the war. The open record gives no count of the column's dead (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE). It is the second battle fought below Muileann ghlas that the annals record. The first was fought there in the Brothers' War.

End. When word of the battle reached the hills, the last holdouts came down to the seventh regiment's posts and were disarmed and sent home (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE). An Cogadh Fada ended on 10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE, and nine regiments and four fleets remained on their stations. By the Board's order the western seams were flooded and capped (24 an Gearran 2022 DE). The wartime tithe (21 an Giblean 2020 DE) was carried forward in the Treasury's accounts, and no council minute records a decision to keep it (27 an Giblean 2023 DE). Tuathaich families built a cairn on the field of Àth leathan (6 an Giblean 2023 DE). The kingdom raised a stone with the regiments' dead at Cathair mhòr (15 an Dùbhlachd 2022 DE).

Table of battles

BATTLE OR AC-TION	DATE	PLACE	WAR	OUTCOME AND DEAD, AS RECORDED
Salt-flats raid	9 am Faoilleach 6929 BDE	Baile ghorm	Stone Kings	Salt carried off; seven dead on the hill side

BATTLE OR ACTION	DATE	PLACE	WAR	OUTCOME AND DEAD, AS RECORDED
Death of Iain Dubh	8 an t-Ògmhios 6874 BDE	Baile ghorm	Stone Kings	The king killed on the shingle
Fight at Àth fhiadhaich	21 an Dàmhair 1998 BDE	Àth fhiadhaich	War of the Roads	Ford held a day, then lost; forty dead
Siege of Caol leathan	2 an t-Samhain 1994 BDE	Caol leathan	War of the Roads	Harbour not closed; ended without assault
Ford at Àth shean	22 an Gearran 515 DE	Àth shean	Three Claimants	Ragnall's host broken; some three hundred dead
Siege of Cathair dhomhain	26 an Dùbhlachd 518 DE	Cathair dhomhain	Three Claimants	Taken after forty days; garrison freed on oath
Battle of Muileann chrom	14 am Faoilleach 521 DE	Muileann chrom	Three Claimants	Ragnall Ruadh killed; the war decided
Raid on Eilean dhubh	27 an t-Samhain 762 DE	Eilean dhubh	Sea-thieves	Boats burned; Uilleam Ruadh hanged
Battle of Cnoc naomh	8 an t-Ògmhios 1231 DE	Cnoc naomh	Brothers' War	Iain Ciar retakes the town
Fire at Ceann mhin	17 an Lùnastal 1233 DE	Ceann mhin	Brothers' War	Waterfront, rope stores and granary burned
Battle of Muileann ghlas	19 an t-Iuchar 1235 DE	Muileann ghlas	Brothers' War	Alasdair Bàn taken alive
Cove burned	25 an t-Iuchar 1826 DE	Ceann leathan	Company and raiders	Fishermen's boats burned; raiders not found
First open confrontation	17 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE	Muileann chrom	Forerunners	Four Ròdaich and one constable killed
Store at Muileann chrom	28 an Gearran 1928 DE	Muileann chrom	War of the Hills	Eleven constables surrender unharmed
Siege of the store at Baile thais	1 an t-Ògmhios 1928 DE	Baile thais	War of the Hills	Surrender on the twelfth day
Ford of Àth chiar	5 an Dùbhlachd 1928 DE	Àth chiar	War of the Hills	Ashdown turned back; forty and nineteen dead
Surrender at Dùn iséal	17 am Faoilleach 1929 DE	Dùn iséal	War of the Hills	The east cleared of human arms
Shelling of Seann Toll	15 an Gearran 1929 DE	Seann Toll	War of the Hills	Twenty-three townsfolk dead
The fishermen of Seann Chwen	10 an Cèitean 1929 DE	Seann Chwen	War of the Hills	Company coaster burned
Fight at Cnoc ghorm	25 an Lùnastal 1929 DE	Cnoc ghorm	War of the Hills	Last sally of the Administration repulsed
Battle of Àth leathan	11 an Giblean 2020 DE	Àraich Àth leathan	An Cogadh Fada	Holdouts' dead in the hundreds (Tuathaich telling)

BATTLE OR ACTION	DATE	PLACE	WAR	OUTCOME AND DEAD, AS RECORDED
Siege of Muileann àrsaidh	21 an Cèitean 2020 DE	Muileann àrsaidh	An Cogadh Fada	Pit-heads taken one by one
Cnoc thais taken	2 an Lùnastal 2020 DE	Cnoc thais	An Cogadh Fada	Shafts fired and sealed
Battle of Muileann ghlas	10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE	Àraich Muileann ghlas	An Cogadh Fada	Column broken; its dead not counted

Part II. The Hosts

The older hosts

Until the Long War the island kept no standing host. In the Holy Age the rìgh of Dùn dhearg fought with road-guards and with levies raised from the lowland farms, and those levies went home at harvest whether the war was over or not (2 an t-Samhain 1994 BDE). The claimants and the brothers of the Age of Sundering fought with the followings of the seven houses. The queen who burned the sea-thieves' boats sent a force raised for that one purpose (27 an t-Samhain 762 DE). In the Age of Strangers the only standing force on the island belonged to the humans: Merriman's constables and the Company's guards and gunboats. The Ròdaich fought the War of the Hills with companies raised by the council, the silver guild and the hawk-houses. Those companies were stood down in 1930 DE and kept only as names on a roll. For ninety years the kingdom kept its regiments only on paper and guarded its coast with patrol boats. The first armed company it sent north after the Severance was a company of Board enforcers (16 an Dàmhair 2017 DE).

The regiments and fleets

The thirteen hosts on the map were all raised in 2020 DE, the first year of An Cogadh Fada, and none has been stood down (13 am Faoilleach 2022 DE). Each takes its name from the town where it is stationed. The numbers do not follow the order in which the hosts were raised. The seventh regiment was raised first and the ninth last, and the fleets were raised first, fourth, second and third. The record does not explain the numbering. The rolls of the Severance companies were read out when the regiments were reformed (26 an t-Samhain 2019 DE), and the numbers may have been taken from those rolls, but the open record does not say so. There are two towns named Seann

Skell. The seventh regiment stands at the western one. The ninth regiment and the second fleet stand at the one on the southern coast. The regimental clerks tell them apart by river and coast (25 an Dùbhlachd 2020 DE).

HOST	STA-TION	RAISED	WHAT THE ANNALS RECORD OF IT
An seach-damh rèisimeid , the seventh	Seann Skell	11 an Giblean 2020 DE	First raised, from the west-coast levies, two days after Àth leathan. Held the road behind the army; the last holdouts came down to its posts (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE); stood by at every capping of the western seams (24 an Gearran 2022 DE). Keeps the Àth leathan post (28 an Dàmhair 2022 DE) and leaves the Tuathaich cairn standing (6 an Giblean 2023 DE).
A' chiad rèisimeid , the first	Inis mhòr	7 an Cèitean 2020 DE	Raised from the capital's own companies to guard the council, the mint and the bridge over the Abhainn dhomhain. Fought at Muileann ghlas (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE); escorted the prisoners north to the boundary stones (4 an t-Iuchar 2022 DE); keeps the list of weapons turned up on the Muileann ghlas field (28 an Dùbhlachd 2022 DE).
A' chiad chabhlach , the first fleet	Àth gharbh	13 an Cèitean 2020 DE	Raised from the south-west harbours and sent round the western cape to stop coal leaving the Tuathaich ports by sea. Its hulls lie in the harbour of Doire shean, a short walk from the town.
An ceathramh cabhlach , the fourth fleet	Cuan shean	20 an Cèitean 2020 DE	With the first, closed Seann Skell and Cnoc bhàn to all but searched fishing boats. Still on the Tuathaich coast (29 an t-Sultain 2023 DE); its log records a thing longer than a patrol boat off the north-west cape, and calls it a whale (23 an Giblean 2024 DE).
An treas rèisimeid , the third	Cathair mhòr	5 an t-Ògmhios 2020 DE	First mustered under the Mac Ùisdein market cross, by the Mine Board's offices. Fought at Muileann ghlas. The stone of the regiments' dead stands in its town (15 an Dùbhlachd 2022 DE).
An còigeamh rèisimeid , the fifth	Seann Warr	13 an t-Ògmhios 2020 DE	Sent north to relieve the regiments before Muileann àrsaidh. Built the first permanent barracks of any regiment (27 an Dàmhair 2024 DE).
An dàrna cabhlach , the second fleet	Seann Skell	23 an t-Sultain 2020 DE	Kept the eastern and southern waters; ran a raider down off Baile iséal in the war (2 an Dàmhair 2020 DE) and the rest of them after it (2 an Lùnastal 2023 DE).
An siathamh rèisimeid , the sixth	Cnoc bheag	17 an Dàmhair 2020 DE	Its colours blessed by the Hawk houses in their own order. Holds the northern road; keeps the pass posts at the boundary stones (9 an Dàmhair 2025 DE).
An dàrna rèisimeid , the second	Àth dhìreach	25 an Dàmhair 2020 DE	Guarded the ore line and the library road, the first soldiery Muileann chaol had seen. Keeps a guard on the sealed archive, which the library did not ask for (12 an Lùnastal 2025 DE).
An ceathramh rèisimeid , the fourth	Caol bheag	2 an t-Samhain 2020 DE	Shipped round the north coast in hired dubhan hulls and quartered in the magistrate's house at Ceann mhòr over the Moot's protest (10 an t-Samhain 2020 DE). Went home to Caol bheag (22 an Dùbhlachd 2024 DE).

HOST	STA- TION	RAISED	WHAT THE ANNALS RECORD OF IT
An t-och-damh reïsimeid , the eighth	Inis uaine	16 an t-Samhain 2020 DE	Raised to guard the eastern dubhan depots against fire. The guard was made permanent, and the town's Seann Spioradan house prays for the regiment (14 an Dùbhlachd 2024 DE).
An treas-cabhlach , the third fleet	Baile ghorm	1 an Dùbhlachd 2020 DE	Carried the army's dubhan up the west coast in tank-hulls; still carries it to the Tuathaich depots, and the Moot pays the freight (28 an Dàmhair 2023 DE).
An naoid-heamh reïsimeid , the ninth	Seann Skell	25 an Dùbhlachd 2020 DE	Last raised, to guard the dubhan works. Its fighter won the first Còmhrag the regiments entered (14 an t-Iuchar 2025 DE).

The regimental rolls of the present year count 5,577 foot, 3,022 riflemen and 2,322 horse in the nine regiments, with seventy-nine guns. The first regiment is the largest, at 1,818 men, and the eighth and ninth are the smallest, at about 850 each. The horse are kept for the hill roads of the west and the north, where lorries cannot go and the dubhan depots are far apart. The four fleets are small. The first and second have two hulls each and the third and fourth one each, with about a hundred men to a hull.

Part III. The Calamities

The five shaded zones

The map shades five districts, each for the calamity that named it. All five came to a head in the Age of Strangers or the New Age, and in each the annals show the same ground struck before.

A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death. *Struck:* Ros dhìreach, Ceann òg, Inis ìseal, Baile dhomhain, Achadh fhada, Cnoc bheag, Muileann uaine, Cuan àrsaidh, Inis bhàn, all but the last two in the shire of Cnoc bheag. From 9 an t-Ògmhios 1852 DE the Green Death moved through the mining camps, and the ore dust was blamed, though no study was ever finished. At Achadh dhomhain, where it was first noticed, forty were buried in the first month in a field still called the green acre (5 an Dùbhlachd 1852 DE). It spread along the ore roads to these nine towns and to twenty-six settlements in all, and the custodians' roll leaves a blank line after the last (13 am Faoilleach 1853 DE). Àth ghlas burned the huts of its dead and was free of it soonest (12 am Màrt 1853 DE). No total of the dead survives. Its aftermath was the first strike, at Baile thais, over the galleries where it had been worst (21 an Dàmhair 1856 DE).

Gorta Baile chrom, the Great Hunger. *Struck:* Baile chrom, Àth fhionn, Ceann mhòr, Àth dhearg, Muileann àrsaidh, Achadh àrsaidh, all Tuathaich towns today, in the shires of Ceann mhòr, Muileann àrsaidh, Baile chrom and Cnoc thais (22 an Cèitean 1873 DE). The oldest hunger on Rodos with a place to it was here, in pots of boiled bark and doubled grave-rows (7 an Cèitean 5635 BDE), and a dearth emptied the same shore in the Age of Sundering (19 an Giblean 780 DE). The Great Hunger began on 3 am Màrt 1873 DE, after a failed harvest across thirty-four settlements, worsened by a workforce too depleted by conscription to farm its own land. It was worst at Baile chrom, whose people could see the new beacon from their empty fields (1 an Giblean 1873 DE); the Administration did not dispute the count. At Seann Bhrenn the grain-pits of the Holy Age were opened and held only dust (7 an t-Samhain 1875 DE). The Levy was suspended too late for the harvest and never repealed (20 an Gearran 1876 DE).

Tiormachd Achadh shean, the Long Drought. *Struck:* Achadh shean, Àth uaine, Achadh àrsaidh, Muileann chiar, in the shires of Achadh shean and Doire fhionn. The springs of Achadh shean failed in the Ancient Age (8 an Giblean 5595 BDE), and dry years came again in the Holy Age (15 an t-Iuchar 99 BDE) and the Age of Sundering (2 an Dàmhair 1440 DE); each time the shared grain carried the district. The Long Drought began on 25 an Lùnastal 1885 DE and held three years. Fewer than half of Achadh shean's cattle reached water (28 an t-Ògmhios 1886 DE), and the custodians counted ten districts as drought country while the Administration kept no count (27 an t-Iuchar 1886 DE). The fever of bad water that followed killed two hundred and sixty at Baile Mòr ruadh (25 an Giblean 1888 DE). When dry years returned in the New Age the council sent grain up the ore line, and nobody died of hunger (3 an Cèitean 1972 DE).

Scàineadh Cill ghlas, the Rending. *Struck:* Cill ghlas, Àth chaol, Achadh chaol, in the shires of Muileann dhearg, Muileann chiar and Muileann dhomhain. The ground here has moved in every age: a crack across the valley (5 an Lùnastal 6774 BDE), cracked wells (27 an Cèitean 340 DE), a fallen gallery with fourteen names on a stone at its mouth (14 an Dàmhair 890 DE). The Rending came on 9 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE, during a routine excavation driven with blasting-powder. It killed dozens, swallowed the old cutting and its shrine (3 an t-Iuchar 1916 DE), and closed the district for a generation behind the Company's fence (13 an t-Samhain 1916 DE). The displaced built Achadh chaol on the edge of the fenced ground (5 an Dùbhlachd 1916 DE). The district was reopened (19 an t-Iuchar 1944 DE), and on 1 an t-Iuchar 1968 DE a gallery under Muileann dhearg gave way along a line the surveyors had called sound, and thirty-one hewers died. The annals note that it was the same fault.

Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol, the Great Wave. *Struck:* Cnoc chaol, Cuan dhearg, Achadh mhin, Ros gharbh, on the coasts of the shires of Seann Vell, Cnoc naomh and Ros gharbh. Sea sand a hand thick lies over an Ancient Age village at Cnoc chaol (7 an t-Iuchar 6824 BDE), a swell took two children there in the Age of Sundering (22 an Gearran 685 DE), and Cuan dhearg was twice flooded before it built its sea-wall (23 an Giblean 1715 DE). The Great Wave struck without warning on 3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE and wrecked the three towns in one night, the first disaster the new state answered on its own terms. The relief parties counted a little over nine hundred dead (24 an t-Samhain 1933 DE). The wave ran on up the gulf to Ros gharbh and broke its quays, though the town on its headland lost few (24 an t-Samhain 1933 DE). Cuan dhearg's harbour was gone and its boats lay in the fields. The shepherds of Eilean mhin did not go back (1 an Giblean 1934 DE).

Other calamities of the annals

Plagues. A coughing sickness killed some two hundred at Caol fhiadhaich (2 an Gearran 117 DE); a spotted fever some three hundred at Inis chrom, where the Fianna of the Stone nursed the sick and died of it (3 an t-Sultain 585 DE); the swallowing cough near a third of Muileann dhomhain (29 an Lùnastal 1040 DE). The strangers' fever came ashore with a crowded ship and killed ninety-one Ròdaich and eleven humans (5 an t-Samhain 1788 DE). The spotted pox at Ros dhomhain killed four hundred and six by the Mission's count, and more by the custodians' (11 an Dàmhair 1818 DE). The grey fever (2 an Gearran 1917 DE) killed the young and strong before the old, and in the north-west put Ròdaich and humans in the same wards for the first time (20 an t-Iuchar 1919 DE).

Famines. The first famine recorded as averted (4 an Dàmhair 526 BDE) was the shared-meal custom's first test, and it held. Beyond the Great Hunger the annals record hunger in the capital and in Ros bheag during the War of the Hills (8 an t-Iuchar 1929 DE, 4 an Dàmhair 1929 DE), and the north's first year alone, when Tuathaich memory puts the dead at Doire ghlas above two hundred and no Ròdaich count was made (9 an Dùbhlachd 1930 DE).

Storms, floods and fires. The first storm given a name is remembered only for the naming (30 am Faoilleach 7454 BDE); the oldest whose name survives is A' Ghaoth Dhubh (1 an Gearran 5184 BDE). Am Fuath Mòr drowned eighteen at Seann Toll (23 an t-Samhain 220 DE), a storm drowned twenty-three at Baile ghorm (12 an Dàmhair 1700 DE), and another eleven Tuathaich off Cuan bheag (28 an t-Sultain 1948 DE). The Abhainn ìseal cut the ore line for most of a year (12 am Màrt 1963 DE). Fire

burned Ceann mhin twice (5 an t-Sultain 1510 DE) and the fair at Muileann òg once (31 an Dàmhair 1969 DE).

The vein's own dead. The mountain has killed its workers in every age, from the basket burning at Achadh dhìreach (7 an t-Iuchar 6535 BDE) to the first deaths blamed on the humans' pace of work, eleven, entered as an accident (26 an Giblean 1804 DE).

Table of calamities

CALAMITY	BEGAN	PLACE	DEAD, AS RECORDED	AFTERMATH
First named storm	30 am Faoilleach 7454 BDE	unknown	not recorded	Name lost; the fact kept
Hunger at Baile chrom	7 an Cèitean 5635 BDE	Gorta Baile chrom	grave-rows doubled	Oldest hunger with a place
Swallowing cough	29 an Lùnastal 1040 DE	Muileann dhomhain	near a third of the town	Seann Bhral closes itself
Strangers' fever	5 an t-Samhain 1788 DE	Cuan shean	91 Ròdaich, 11 humans	Town closed to ships
Spotted pox	11 an Dàmhair 1818 DE	Ros dhomhain	406 by the Mission; more by the custodians	Dead cut on the lintel at Baile chiar
A' Phlàigh Uaine	9 an t-Ògmhios 1852 DE	A' Phlàigh Uaine	not totalled; 26 settlements	The first strike
Gorta Baile chrom	3 am Màrt 1873 DE	Gorta Baile chrom	worst at Baile chrom; not totalled	Levy suspended
Tiormachd Achadh shean	25 an Lùnastal 1885 DE	Tiormachd Achadh shean	260 of drought-fever at Baile Mòr ruadh	Cause first named rightly
Scàineadh Cill ghlas	9 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE	Scàineadh Cill ghlas	dozens	District closed a generation
Grey fever	2 an Gearran 1917 DE	island-wide	not totalled	Shared wards at Cathair gheal
Hungry year in the north	9 an Dùbhlachd 1930 DE	Doire ghlas	above 200 (Tuathaich memory)	No Ròdaich count
Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol	3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE	Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol	a little over 900	Cuan dhearg's harbour lost
Fall at Muileann dhearg	1 an t-Iuchar 1968 DE	Muileann dhearg	31	The same fault

The library does not claim that this list is complete. It holds only what the rolls kept, and the rolls counted some dead and left others uncoun-
ted.

APPENDIX D

The Reckoning of Years

This appendix sets out how the years of Rodos are counted today, how each age counted them before that, and how the copyists and the library at Muileann chaol joined the counts into one; then the months, the days, and the feasts of the year.

I. The Diosal Era

Rodos counts its years in the **Diosal Era**, written DE. Year 1 DE is the year of the Setting-Out, when the ships of the Sundering left Seann Skell. Years before it are written BDE, *before the Diosal Era*. There is no year 0: 1 BDE is followed by 1 DE, and anyone reckoning across the boundary must subtract one.

Diosal is the Rodos form of the old word *deiseal*, the sunwise turn: the way a hand moves, a boat rounds a point, or a procession goes about a cairn, with the right shoulder toward the centre and the course following the sun. Before going down the Abhainn naomh to open water the fleet went once round the river pool of Seann Skell sunwise, for luck, and the watchers on the quay counted the hulls as they passed. The harbour scribe's entry for the turn is the last thing any roll says of the departed, and the island has counted its years from that turn ever since.

The count was not made at the time. On 22 am Faoilleach 5 DE Donnchadh mac Thormoid, scribe of the vein-house above Muileann dhearg, began to number the years from the sunwise turn and called them *bliadhnaichean an Diosail*, the years of the Diosal. By his own reckoning only a few of them had yet passed. The count was his alone at first. The crown's scribes at Cathair dhearg took it up about a generation later, and for more than six hundred years afterwards the vein-house and the crown each kept their own version of it (section II).

The harbour scribe gives the day of the Setting-Out as 19 an Giblean 1 DE and the day of the sunwise turn as 19 an Giblean 1 DE. The two fall on one day. The custody-book, however, enters the turn under a later day than the sailing, after the next Samhain. No account explains that gap of half a year, and the keepers have left both entries

where they stand. Section II gives what the gap did to the count. The count now kept on Rodos follows the harbour scribe and sets both in 1 DE.

II. How the Ages Reckoned Before the Diosal

The Ancient Age. The Ancient Age kept no count of years that anyone has found. Its people counted other things. The Seann-Dhaoine cut strokes on stones at the edges of their middens, one stone to a household, and the counting of the dead began on 29 an Lùnastal 7253 BDE. The tally wall at Seann Warr grew to some three thousand strokes, and in one stretch the tallies of three coasts thicken together (6 an Giblean 7131 BDE). These are counts of the dead. None of them has been read as a count of years.

The first tide-count (28 am Faoilleach 5930 BDE), a rock on which someone marked the high-water line, comes nearer. Its marks fall at intervals regular enough that later scholars have suspected a calendar in them. The practice was carried to Ros dhomhain with the interval unchanged. Nobody knows what the interval was for, and the Library has declined to guess. The hill-folk also knew the crossing season of the great cats and kept off the passes while the panthers went over (20 am Faoilleach 7712 BDE). That was a season they kept every year, but they did not number the years.

The oldest oral king-list, *Rìghrean na Cloiche*, begins with Ailean Mòr (9 an Lùnastal 7600 BDE) and "gives no lengths of reign." The Red Hill list is the same. When both lists were recited together at the ford gathering (23 an t-Iuchar 3254 BDE), the recital took from dusk to dawn, but it measured only a succession of names. The tellings of the age give no order finer than that. They tie a few things firmly to one another, and where a telling binds several deeds together they are remembered as falling in one year or a few. Between those points the tellings keep the order of things and little of the distance between them, and the years of the age are known only as well as the tellings know them.

The Holy Age. The Holy Age counted in two ways, and neither of them ran from a fixed beginning.

The first was **by reigns**. From the Binding of the First Flame (23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE) the Keepers of the flame were remembered in a recited roll that begins with Beathag Bhàn. After Goraidh mac Ìomhair was first called *rìgh* at Dùn dhearg (28 an Cèitean 2325 BDE), the rulers of the lowlands had a list of their own. A year was named by whoever held it: "the ninth year of Iain Garbh," "the third winter of the Keeper Seumas Bàn." That served for a debt within living memory and was useless for the distance between two reigns, since the recited lists gave no lengths. The first written king-list, Tormod Scriobhaiche's roll (20 an Lùnastal 1700 BDE), marks which

names came from reciters and which from living memory. The Keepers had their own roll set down in answer (17 an Dàmhair 1679 BDE), and it proved several centuries longer than Tormod's. From the reign of Seonag Chrom the clerks of the red hall kept the king-list year by year. Between Tormod Òg and Anna Ruadh the list gives "nine rulers of the house of Tormod with their years" (29 am Màrt 441 BDE). Those years were counted within each reign and did not run on from one reign to the next.

The second was **by burnings**. From the Small-Burning Law (13 an Lùnastal 2857 BDE), a household might burn no more than its measured handful of ore in a season, and the Hall at Dùn ìseal kept the record of those seasons. It counted them from the Law: the first burning, the second, and on through the centuries. A Small-Burning year ran from one filling of the baskets to the next. The Hall filled them at Samhain, when the galleries closed and the hearths began to need the ore. The first sentence under the Law (1 an Cèitean 2854 BDE) took from a household its right "for the season after," and it was entered by the burning in which it fell. Of all the island's counts the count of burnings came nearest to an era, because it ran from a single act and was meant never to stop. It outlived the age by a long way. The Law was never repealed; it lapsed (2 an Dùbhlachd 1800 DE), and the custodians of Doire mhin kept the old count one season longer than anyone else (31 an Dùbhlachd 1800 DE), with the note that nobody had asked for it.

By the close of the age the Keepers' roll held one hundred and forty names and the king-list more than ninety (2 an Giblean 60 BDE). The two did not agree in every place, and the Hall's count of burnings did not always agree with either.

The Age of Sundering. The Diosal count was born in this age, and at first it existed in two versions. Donnchadh mac Thormoid counted from the turn at the harbour, as the custody-book entered it. The crown's scribes took up the count a generation later, when the court remembered the departure as a single thing, and they counted from the year the ships sailed. Both versions began each year at the old Samhain, as the Hall had done. The custody-book sets the turn after the Samhain that followed the sailing, so by the old year the sailing and the turn lay in different years, and the two counts stood a year apart. The Library believes this is how the counts came to differ. The rolls do not prove it, and it does not explain why the turn is entered so long after the sailing.

The difference stood until 23 am Màrt 700 DE, when the vein-house and the crown's scribes found that their counts disagreed and settled the matter by agreement. The same agreement fixed the day of the empty-harbour rite, which the two counts had placed differently. A later hand in the custody-book adds that the scribes afterwards "stop pretending it was fixed by evidence." From that day there was one Diosal count on Rodos, and the vein-house marked its thousandth year (15 an Dùbhlachd

1000 DE) with a single measured burning on Cidhe an Diosail, the quay of the sun-wise turn.

III. The Setting of the Ages into One Count

By the seventeenth century of the Diosal the island's records kept time by Keepers, by reigns, by burnings and by the Diosal, and the tellings of the Ancient Age by nothing at all. The work of joining these counts began with Beathag nic Thòmais, the mill-owner's widow who bought up old copies of the custody-book and the harbour rolls and kept them in a loft over her mill at Muileann chaol (21 an Cèitean 1620 DE). She did not reckon years. She did set conflicting copies side by side and decline to choose between them (27 an Giblean 1640 DE), and that became the method of everyone who worked in Muileann chaol after her. She left her loft to the town on condition that nothing in it be burned (24 an Lùnastal 1660 DE).

The joining itself was done in the cellar. From 5 am Màrt 1903 DE the custodians of the east sent copies of their rolls to Muileann chaol for safekeeping, away from the Residency's reach, and three families did the copying. While they copied, they laid the counts against each other. Where the king-list gave a ruler's years and the Hall's roll gave the burnings of the same reign, the two could be made to meet, and each meeting fixed a stretch of the older count against the newer. The copyists called the result *Clàr nan Aoisean*, the table of the ages. It is the first document that runs one numbered sequence of years from the Binding to the copyists' own day. It is also the first to divide the island's past into ages, and to set before the Holy Age an older age whose length the table admits it cannot measure. When the custodians sent what survived of the Age of Strangers to the same cellars (29 an Dùbhlachd 1929 DE), the table was carried through to the Severance, and in that form it gave the five ages the bounds that historians of Rodos still use.

Leabharlann Muileann chaol, founded 1 an Cèitean 1945 DE, took the table as one of its first possessions and extended it. When the library absorbed the provincial archives (26 an t-Iuchar 1996 DE), the table was checked against them and corrected where the archives knew better. The first keeper, Ailean Leabhar, disliked the saying *a chur san Leabharlann*, "to put it in the Library," on the ground that the library settles nothing and only keeps it (3 an t-Samhain 1945 DE). The table should be read in the same spirit.

IV. The Twelve Months

The months of Rodos are the twelve Gaelic months, and they correspond one to one with the months of the humans' calendar, beginning with am Faoilleach. The meanings of several names were already disputed when the Hall first wrote them down. The glosses below are those the Library holds most likely. The work of each month is the island's work as the rolls of every age describe it.

NO.	MONTH	DAYS	MEANING OF THE NAME	THE WORK OF THE MONTH ON RODOS
1	am Faoilleach	31	the wolf-month; the storm-time at the year's dead end	Nets and boats mended ashore; the ore-hearths at their fullest; the high passes shut
2	an Gearran	28 (29)	the short month, or the gelding's month; the Library does not choose	Là Fhèill Bride on the first; the first ploughing in the lowlands; lambing in the south
3	am Màrt	31	the seed-time, the month of work	Sowing; the carters back on the roads; repairs to the bridges before the spring floods
4	an Giblean	30	obscure; the old folk said "the gap", the month between the last of the stores and the first of the green	The hungry weeks of a poor year; granaries opened where the shared-meal law requires it
5	an Cèitean	31	the first of summer	Bealltainn on the first; cattle to the high pastures; in the Holy Age, the galleries opened when the cairn-watchers allowed
6	an t-Ògmhios	30	the young month	Peat cut and stacked; salt-pans worked on the south and west coasts
7	an t-Iuchar	31	the hot month	Hay; the herring off the north-west; the drovers of Àth Chiar on the eastern hills
8	an Lùnastal	31	the month of the Lùnastal gathering	Lùnastal on the first; first-fruits; the harvest fair at Muileann òg in its season
9	an t-Sultain	30	the month of plenty	The main harvest; the grain carried to the granaries; accounts rendered
10	an Dàmhair	31	the rut of the deer	The stags heard in the eastern forest; the druid schools walking the bounds of Flidais's wood; boats hauled up
11	an t-Samhain	30	summer's end	Samhain on the first; in the Holy Age the baskets filled and the galleries closed; the empty-harbour rite at Seann Skell
12	an Dùbhlachd	31	the black month, the dark of the year	Midwinter; the drowned remembered in the western harbours; the panther roads closed for the year

An Gearran takes a twenty-ninth day in every fourth year, as the humans' calendar has it. It is not certain that the vein-house kept such a day before 1780. The custody-book dates by feast and by month and seldom by day, so the question cannot be settled from it.

V. The Seven Days

The week, *seachdain*, has seven days. The names below are given in the forms the royal chronicler uses. The oldest roll to name them is the Hall's list of turns in the galleries, and by then the names were already old.

DAY	RÒDAIS	THE NAME AS THE LIBRARY READS IT
1	Didòmh-naich	the lord's day. The Hall said the lord was the vein; the crown said it was the king. No ore was cut on it.
2	Diluain	the moon's day. The tide-keepers began their reckonings on it.
3	Dimàirt	the day of Màrt, of work, the same root as the sowing-month
4	Diciadain	the day of the first fast
5	Diardaoin	the day between the fasts
6	Dihaoine	the day of the fast
7	Disathairne	not known. Its root is found nowhere else in the tongue.

Diciadain, Diardaoin and Dihaoine name fasts that nobody on Rodos now keeps. The Library's opinion is that they were fasts from fire rather than from food. On two days of the week a Holy Age household left its hearth unlit, which fits the Small-Burning Law and the custom of the measured handful before it. The unlit hearth found under the peat (2 an Dàmhair 6699 BDE) is sometimes cited for this. It proves nothing about weeks. The other opinion, that they were fasts from meat as the humans' Mission taught, rests only on the Mission's word.

When the humans came they also kept a week of seven days, and they also rested on the first day of it. The Mission made a great deal of this. The custodians made little of it, and the rolls add nothing.

VI. The Quarter-Days

Four feasts divide the year into quarters. They are the great feasts of the Old Faith and older than any order now on the island, and all three faiths on Rodos keep them in some form, though each gives them its own reasons (Appendix B).

Là Fhèill Bhrìde, 1 an Gearran, also called Imbolc, is the feast of Bhrìde, whose flame was bound at Dùn Ìseal. Every hearth is swept and relit and the year's first work in the fields begins. The followers of Na Seann Spioradan set a sheaf by the door. Òrd Bhrìde and the Hawk order, the two forms of her rite, light their first lamp of the year from the altar-flame. The Church keeps the day as the feast of a saint of the same name.

Bealltainn, 1 an Cèitean, takes its name from a bright fire, and it is the feast of summer's beginning, when the Otherworld stands near. Cattle go up to the high pastures between two fires. In the Holy Age this was the day the Hall asked the cairn-watchers of Cnoc ghlas whether the galleries might open. The first sentence under the Small-Burning Law is dated 1 an Cèitean 2854 BDE, on Bealltainn itself. The roll does not say whether the day was chosen for the sentence.

Lùnastal, 1 an Lùnastal, is Lugh's feast of first-fruits and gathering, which he made in memory of his foster-mother Tailtiu, and the month is named for it. Markets open, contests are held, and oaths are taken before witnesses. Cathal was crowned on the feast itself, 1 an Lùnastal 2002 DE.

Samhain, 1 an t-Samhain, marks summer's end, when the Otherworld stands open, the sith of the mounds are abroad, and the Old Faith names Donn and the dead of the year. Before the humans came it was also the beginning of the Ròdaich year. The Hall filled the baskets of the Small-Burning Law at Samhain, the galleries closed, and the dead were thought nearest. The Tuathaich, whose calendar came to them from an Tìr Thall, keep the day with the rest of the island, in the Church's way, as the feast of all the saints and the day of the dead. They have never counted the year from it.

VII. Feasts and Days Particular to Rodos

Beside the quarter-days Rodos keeps days rooted in its own history. The table gives those the chronicles attest. The column "since" gives the day on which the custom is first recorded.

DAY	WHERE	WHAT IS KEPT	SINCE
24 an t-Samhain, at night	Seann Skell water-front	The night of lamps: a lamp on every sill until morning. Children are told the lamps are for ships coming home.	18 an Giblean 1 DE; kept each year from 12 an Lùnastal 70 DE
25 an t-Samhain	Cidhe an Diosail, Seann Skell	The empty-harbour rite, on the day the old counts agreed; in the harbour towns called Là an Diosail	25 an t-Samhain 22 DE; the day fixed 23 am Màrt 700 DE
no fixed day	the harbour towns, the court	<i>An Tùrsa Geal</i> , the white sorrow: undyed wool and one place set empty at a meal that is neither feast nor fast	27 an Dàmhair 15 DE

DAY	WHERE	WHAT IS KEPT	SINCE
yearly, on the shore	Inis chrom and the harbours north to Seann Warr	The drowned-feast, an empty place for each of the lost	10 an Dàmhair 84 BDE
yearly	Baile chrom	The wake for the boat lost off the north-west	28 an Lùnastal 2594 BDE
the crossing days	the southern hills, Imrich nam Pantar	The panther roads kept clear, flocks driven off the paths	26 an t-Iuchar 265 DE
yearly	Coille Naomh Muileann chiar	The druid schools walk the bounds of Flidais's wood	11 an t-Iuchar 440 DE
harvest	Fèill Muileann òg	The great fair, with its northern day	5 an t-Iuchar 1334 BDE; the fair established 16 an Dàmhair 1950 DE
yearly	Còmhrag Ceann leathan	The contest with staves, since edged tools were banned	9 an Giblean 1334 BDE; established 4 am Màrt 1952 DE
yearly	Allt an Àigh	The walk of the Old Spirits to the healing water	8 an t-Iuchar 1939 DE
yearly	Seann Dunn	The ancestors of forty families named aloud by their living heads	28 an Dàmhair 1951 DE
yearly	Cnoc ghorm	The northern feast of the sea, kept at the church as a blessing of the boats	11 an Gearran 1955 DE
one night, undisclosed	Baile chrom and the north	The vigil of the Grey Night under Sine, the Peaceful Goose, the wild goose of the Spirit; outsiders are not told which night	14 am Màrt 1938 DE

The day of the Setting-Out has never been kept as a feast. The chronicles stop describing the departed the moment the ships clear the harbour, and the island has kept its remembrance of them at the harbour, where the rolls stop, on the day the custody-book gives for the turn and not on the day they sailed. Since 23 am Màrt 700 DE the empty-harbour rite has fallen on that day, 25 an t-Samhain, though the harbour scribe, whose count the island follows, sets the turn on the day of the sailing. The Library is aware that the custody-book may have taken its day from the rite rather than the rite from the book. By the last entry of the Age of Sundering the rite was kept by eleven people (17 an t-Sultain 1764 DE). The chronicles of the later ages do not say how many keep it now.

The Severance, 1 am Faoilleach 1930 DE, is kept at Cathair dhearg by the council as the day the kingdom's modern history begins. The chronicle says the Mourning Custom of the Sundering, first made for a chosen parting, was reused uneasily for a very different departure in a later age, and the council's keeping of this day is the use

most often meant. In the north the day is not kept. It is worked through like any other, and the Tuathaich say that this is their way of keeping it.

The Long War left two days. The Battle of Àth leathan, 11 an Giblean 2020 DE, opened *An Cogadh Fada*. Tuathaich families have raised a cairn without leave on the field at Àraich Àth leathan, and it grows by a stone or two whenever the patrols pass; whether they come on the day of the battle nobody has written down. The Battle of Muileann ghlas, 10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE, ended the war, and the regiments raised in the campaign keep that day at their stations. So the two days are kept by two peoples, and the library, whose war archive is sealed (14 am Faoilleach 2023 DE), holds what it can of both.

VIII. The Reckoning of the Humans, and Its Reconciling

The humans who came at the Crossing (5 am Faoilleach 1780 DE) brought a calendar of their own, and in most respects it was close to the island's. Their year had twelve months of the same lengths in the same order, with the same extra day in the second month every fourth year. Samuel Wren's word-lists (13 an Dùbhlachd 1781 DE), which survive in the Administration's letter-books, give the month-names in the two tongues side by side, and the clerks needed nothing more than that list to convert months. The chronicle notes that the humans crossed "the water the Rodians once crossed." Whether the likeness between the calendars has anything to do with that, nobody on Rodos knows, and the chronicles do not say.

The calendars differed in two things. The first was the beginning of the year. The humans began theirs at am Faoilleach, and the Ròdaich had begun theirs at Samhain since the Hall first filled the baskets. The second was the count of years. The humans numbered theirs from an epoch in their own land, which they named and did not explain, and their numbers were much larger than the island's. No Ròdaich scribe set down the name of that land (26 an Gearran 1781 DE), and the letter-books do not explain the epoch either.

The first written treaty (27 an Giblean 1787 DE) was drawn up in the humans' tongue only and dated by the humans' year only. The custodians entered it in their roll under its Diosal year and the month in which it was signed, and left the day to the Administration. The Harbour Articles, the Company's charter, and every contract for extraction were dated the same way. The same clerks who kept two sets of books for coin and barter (30 am Faoilleach 1797 DE) came to keep two dates at the head of every

page, the humans' year above and the Diosal year beneath, and they complained about both.

By the third currency reform (7 an Giblean 1908 DE) every contract on the island ran from am Faoilleach, and the Ròdaich civil year had moved to the humans' beginning without any decree. The old Samhain year survived in the shrines, in the Hall's count of burnings until it lapsed, and among the custodians of Inis bhàn, who taught "the old reckoning" in their school (7 an t-Ògmhios 1831 DE). The Administration's census (19 an Cèitean 1901 DE) and its register (26 an t-Samhain 1906 DE) were dated by the humans' year alone.

The reconciling was finished after the Severance, when the humans no longer had any say in it. The council's clerks emptied the counting-houses (11 an t-Ògmhios 1931 DE) and boxed the ledgers unread, because few of them could read the humans' hand. Ailean Leabhar, the library's first keeper, spent his first years having them read (28 an t-Ògmhios 1945 DE). He had every date in them converted to the Diosal count, using the double-dated pages of the custodians' clerks as the key, and he kept the new year at am Faoilleach. His reason was that a century of contracts, ledgers and letters already stood on that footing. The kingdom has kept it since. Every year on Rodos, in every age, is therefore now counted from am Faoilleach to an Dùbhlachd. The people who lived before 1780 began their years at Samhain, and a reader of the old rolls should remember that.

The Tuathaich keep the Diosal count in their dealings with the kingdom. What count the northern parish books keep among themselves the library cannot say, since it receives few of them.

IX. The Five Ages

The five ages are the divisions of *Clàr nan Aoisean* as the library received and extended it. The table gives the first and the last thing remembered in each.

AGE	RÒDAIS NAME	ENGLISH	SPAN	FIRST EVENT	LAST EVENT
I	An Aois Àr-saidh	the Ancient Age	12,999 – 3,001 BDE	The crack in the stone, 20 am Faoilleach 12,923 BDE	The eve of the Binding, 7 an Lùnastal 3051 BDE
II	An Aois Na-omh	the Holy Age	3,000 – 40 BDE	The Binding of the First Flame, 23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE	The last age of even population, 1 an Cèitean 50 BDE
III	An Aois Scaraidh	the Age of Sundering	39 BDE – 1779 DE	Land is found, 6 am Faoilleach 39 BDE	The silver petition laid aside, 28 an Dùbhlachd 1767 DE

AGE	RÒDAIS NAME	ENGLISH	SPAN	FIRST EVENT	LAST EVENT
IV	An Aois Choigreach	the Age of Strangers	1780 – 1929 DE	The Crossing, 5 am Faoilleach 1780 DE	The Severance, 1 am Faoilleach 1930 DE
V	An Aois Ùr	the New Age	1930 – 2026 DE	The Tuathaich homeland fixed, 22 am Màrt 1930 DE	The present, 21 an Dùbhlachd 2026 DE

Three things in the table need a word.

The span of the Ancient Age opens in 12,999 BDE, but its first event, the crack in the stone, falls some decades later. The span is the table's round beginning for an age that has none. The event is the oldest thing the island remembers.

The Age of Sundering is usually said to open with the Choosing, but the Choosing (8 an Dùbhlachd 39 BDE) is not the first thing in it. The age opens with the finding of the land (6 am Faoilleach 39 BDE), without which there would have been nothing to choose.

The Severance closes the Age of Strangers but falls in 1930, the first year of the New Age. The first events of the New Age follow it within that same year. The copyists of the cellar drew the boundary at the end of 1929, when the war had been decided and the columns had gone north, and they entered the Severance as the last act of the age it ended. The library has left the overlap as it found it.

X. Where the Dates Come From

Every event in this history carries a day, a month and a year, and they come from different places in different ages.

For the New Age and the Age of Strangers the days are remembered: they come from rolls, ledgers, letter-books and the chroniclers' own entries. For the Age of Sundering they are remembered more thinly, from the custody-book, the harbour rolls and the crown's king-list, and a good many were settled by agreement, as the day of the empty-harbour rite was. For the Holy Age the years come from the Keepers' roll, the king-lists and the Hall's count of burnings, which do not always agree, and the days mostly from the feasts and seasons the rolls name. For the Ancient Age everything rests on the tellings, the king-lists without lengths of reign, the tally walls and the tide-count. The tellings keep the order of things well and the distance between them poorly. Where they agree, the date is as sure as they are; where they disagree or fall silent, it is not, and such a date is safer for the order it keeps than for its year.

APPENDIX E

Words BORN FROM History

This appendix gathers the words, names and sayings of Ròdais that the island's history made, or bent to a new sense. It is set out as a historical dictionary. Each entry gives the headword and its part of speech, what it says word for word, what it has come to mean, the event that gave it that meaning, and a line from the annals or the five books.

The chronicle's own list of *Words Born from History* is the core, and every word on it appears here with the meaning the chronicle gives it. The rest come from the annals and the books: titles and offices, laws and customs, the names of storms, places and quarrels, and the sayings the record quotes. A few are the words Ròdais built for the strangers' things. Ròdais took few loanwords from the humans, and most of those late (Appendix F); where the humans said *train*, *engine* or *strike*, it made a name from old roots, and some of those names are entered here under the years when the annals first needed them.

How to Read an Entry

The headword is given in full. An article (*an*, *am*, *a'*) is written with it but not counted in the order, which is the Gaelic order of eighteen letters, *a b c d e f g h i l m n o p r s t u*, with the grave accent ignored. Dates are given in the Diosal count (Appendix D). Where no annal marks the first use of a word, the entry says so and gives only the event the word comes from. Citations are given as the sources give them: the annals in English, as this history renders their prose, the verses in Ròdais (Appendix F, *Of Translation*).

n. noun · *m., f.* masculine, feminine · *pl.* plural · *v.* verb · *v.n.* verbal noun · *adj.* adjective · *phr.* phrase or saying · *lit.* literally

The Glossary

A

a chur san Leabharlann *phr.* · lit. "to put it in the Library" To make a thing official and past dispute. From the founding of Leabharlann Muileann chaol (1 an Cèitean 1945 DE); within a few years it was said of anything settled (3 an t-Samhain 1945 DE).

"Ailean Leabhar is recorded as disliking the phrase, on the ground that the library settles nothing and only keeps it." — annals, 1945 DE

Aisling-aois *n. f.* · lit. "Aisling-age" An unnaturally long youth in anyone; said half in jest of ordinary people who look young for their years. From the first of the immortal generation, born in the mining camps (7 am Màrt 1848 DE). No annal marks its first use. It is the one word on the chronicle's list in which the joke and the myth are the same word.

"...and does not age the way the people around her do. Her name is Aisling."
— annals, 1848 DE

Àrd-choimheadaiche *n. m.* · lit. "high watcher" The high custodian of Òrd Bhrìde, the order of Brìde's flame, seated at Seann Skell. The office came with the formalizing of the Rite (18 an Giblean 1935 DE), and Dòmhnall mac Thormoid was the first to hold it (17 an Cèitean 1935 DE). It is not the "high custodian" of the Age of Strangers, who headed the Council of Custodians; the two share an English name and nothing else.

"The Àrd-choimheadaiche at Seann Skell writes to every house of the Rite that the new fuel is not forbidden, since it is not ore, and not blessed, since it is not ore." — annals, 2003 DE

B

bonn-rioghachd *n. m.* · lit. "realm-coin" Currency. Under the humans the coin was the mark, and barter was pushed out in three reforms (13 an Gearran 1796 DE, 2 an Dàmhair 1865 DE, 7 an Giblean 1908 DE). The Ròdais word belongs to the coinage struck when the humans' coin was withdrawn (30 an Giblean 1934 DE). Its first mint-master was called Fearchar Bonn from his work (9 an Dàmhair 1934 DE). After the re-pegging to dubhan (5 an Cèitean 2014 DE) the realm-coin no longer rested on the vein.

"A new Rìoghachd coinage, minted with obsidian-dust ink in its seal, replaces it within a year." — annals, 1934 DE

C

carbad-iarainn *n. m.* · lit. "iron-chariot" A train; the first of the *iarainn* words Ròdais made for machines. The kingdom mended the humans' ore line (9 an Dàmhair 1937 DE) and ran its own first train on 3 an Dàmhair 1941 DE.

"The first ore train from the Sloc Mòr to Cathair dhearg runs under the kingdom's name and on the humans' rails." — annals, 1941 DE

Cha do chaill sinn blàr, ach chaill sinn an teine *phr.* · lit. "we did not lose a battle, but we lost the fire" A defeat without fighting. An unsigned verse of the cold shires, from the day Raghnaill Ruadh refused the measured handful to every hearth that stood against him (24 am Faoilleach 519 DE).

"...the act turns more people against him than any battle." — annals, 519 DE

Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann *phr.* · lit. "we did not come; we were here" The doctrine of the Ancient Age, complete on Calbh Cnoc ghorm (6 an t-Samhain 8048 BDE). Who cut it is not known.

"If the doctrine has a birthplace, it may be here." — annals, 8048 BDE

Cha loisc clach na beinne do choigrich *phr.* · lit. "the mountain's stone will not burn for strangers" The Keepers' ruling that no ore might feed a beacon (30 an Cèitean 2851 BDE). It held until the humans' towers were lit with an ore flame (22 an t-Sultain 1870 DE).

"The Keepers rule that no ore may feed a beacon, since a beacon burns for strangers." — annals, 2851 BDE

Cha tàinig long *phr.* · lit. "no ship came" The entry in the beacon-keepers' daybooks from the Severance on, after the council had the five beacons relit (19 an Dùbhlachd 1929 DE).

"The keepers' daybooks, which had counted human ships since the ring was finished, continue to be kept, with nothing in them." — annals, 1929 DE

Chaidh a' mhèinn dhachaigh *phr.* · lit. "the ore went home" The tellings' words for the ore taken by Gilleasbuig Beag (2 an Lùnastal 5192 BDE), which was neither burned nor kept but laid back under the slab (4 an t-Iuchar 5190 BDE).

"The tellings make much of this: the ore went home." — annals, 5190 BDE

Cidhe an Diosail *n. m.* · lit. "the quay of the sunwise turn" The berth at Seann Skell from which the fleet of the Sundering sailed. Its old name, Cidhe an Iar, passed to a new fish-wharf so that trade could go on without the memory (13 am Màrt 28 DE, 15 an Lùnastal 28 DE).

"In the harbour rolls of Seann Skell the departure berth is entered as Cidhe an Diosail, the quay of the sunwise turn." — annals, 28 DE

Cogadh nam Bràithrean *n. m.* · lit. "the war of the brothers" The war between Iain Ciar and Alasdair Bàn, named from its first battle (8 an t-Ògmhios 1231 DE).

"The houses divide, four to three, and Cogadh nam Bràithrean, the Brothers' War, is named from this battle." — annals, 1231 DE

Comann nan Saor-luinge *n. m.* · lit. "the fellowship of the ship-wrights" The guild that built the fleet of the Sundering (24 an t-Sultain 35 BDE). It quietly dissolved when no one needed ocean-going hulls (27 an t-Ògmhios 45 DE).

"The custody-book calls it Comann nan Saor-luinge, the fellowship of the ship-wrights." — annals, 35 BDE

Còmhrag *n. f.* · lit. "combat" With the article, the yearly melee at Ceann leathan (4 am Màrt 1952 DE), fought on the field of the Holy Age road-guards' games (9 an Giblean 1334 BDE).

"Two men die in the melee he wins." — annals, of the first champion, 1952 DE

cridhe-iarainn *n. m.* · lit. "iron-heart" An engine. The annals first need it for the shunting engines at Muileann chrom (8 an t-Iuchar 1942 DE), and again when the Shipwrights' Guild court ruled that fitting one to a boat was not shipwrighting (23 an Giblean 2005 DE).

"The yard's families, who work the small engines that move the wagons, are counted separately by the Board." — annals, 1942 DE

cuimhne-coinneimh *n. f.* · lit. "meeting-memory" Minutes. Above all, those of the Moot at Caol mhòr, which has no standing in Ròdach law and has kept its minutes since its first sitting (25 an Lùnastal 1931 DE). See *Tha e scrìobhte a-nis*.

"It meets anyway and keeps its own minutes, which run unbroken from this meeting to the present." — annals, 1931 DE

D

diosal *adv., n. m.* · lit. "sunwise" The sunwise turn; the Rodos form of *deiseal*. The fleet went once round the river pool of Seann Skell sunwise (19 an Giblean 1 DE), and the years were counted from that turn (22 am Faoilleach 5 DE).

"Before going down the Abhainn naomh to open water the fleet went once round the river pool of Seann Skell sunwise, *diosal*, for luck." — the Third Book

dòrlach *n. m.* · lit. "a handful" The sealed measure of ore. The vein-house allowed one to each departing ship (17 an t-Ògmhios 15 BDE). See *Làn na glaise*.

Dòrlach airson an teallaich ùir, / is an seann teallach fhathast blàth. "A handful for the new hearth, and the old hearth still warm." — the Third Book

Dubh an gual, 's dubh an dubhan *phr.* · lit. "black the coal, and black the dubhan" A rhyme of the north, heard in both tongues, from the years when the coinage was pegged to the new fuel (5 an Cèitean 2014 DE).

Dubh an gual, 's dubh an dubhan, / ach cò leis an teine? "Black the coal, and black the dubhan; but whose is the fire?" — the Fifth Book

dubhan *n. m.* · lit. "the black one" (*dubh* + *-an*) The synthetic fuel, written with a small letter. From the name of Dubhan, born 1958 DE, whose first working fuel came on 19 an t-Ògmhios 2000 DE. The man's name wore down into a common noun, as a title may wear down into the name of a dish.

"'Dubhan' begins appearing in common speech to mean the fuel itself, not the man." — annals, 2010 DE

dubhan-tùsail *n. m.* · lit. "dubhan of the beginning" A rough first attempt that looked like a dead end and later mattered; used in any field. From Dubhan's failed experiments

(1 an t-Iuchar 1990 DE). First recorded in a letter of the druid school at Caol shean, of the school's own revival (22 an Dàmhair 2010 DE).

"...for an early attempt at anything that looked like a dead end before it wasn't." — annals, 2010 DE

F

fadachadh *v.n. m.* · lit. "lengthening", from *fadaich*, *fada* To be crushed after holding out too long; *am fadachadh*, a total and final defeat. Narrowed by An Cogadh Fada, from Àth leathan (11 an Giblean 2020 DE) to Muileann ghlas (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE), and first heard among Tuathaich speakers of their own defeat (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE).

"...'chaidh am fadachadh', they got long-warred... It is said as a joke, and the people who say it do not laugh." — annals, 2021 DE

faire-obrach *n. f.* · lit. "work-watch" A shift. The annals first need it for the humans' night-shift order (25 an Lùnastal 1895 DE), which the kingdom kept (18 an t-Samhain 1940 DE).

Cha d'fhuair a' bheinn fois a-riamh, / is cha d'fhuair sinne. "The mountain never got its rest, and neither did we." — the hewers' saying, the Fifth Book

Fèill *n. f.* · lit. "feast-day, fair" With a town's name, a fair; above all Fèill Muileann òg (16 an Dàmhair 1950 DE), heir to the harvest fair held there after the War of the Roads (5 an t-Iuchar 1334 BDE).

"An annual fair becomes the island's largest recurring gathering." — annals, 1950 DE

Fo mhullach an taighe, chan eil nàmh ann *phr.* · lit. "under the roof of the house there is no enemy" The road-peace, the oldest law on the island that no Keeper made (22 an Dàmhair 2824 BDE). The War of the Roads ended under such a roof (4 an Dàmhair 1993 BDE).

"...no feud may be pursued under an inn roof or within a spear's throw of its door." — annals, 2824 BDE

fuil-ghuail *n. f.* · lit. "coal-blood" The condition of those who bond with the vein and do not age as others do, and the people who have it. It had no word for half a century

(13 am Faoilleach 1850 DE) until the custodians coined this one (23 am Faoilleach 1905 DE). The humans rendered it *obsidian-touched*.

"It is meant clinically. It will outlive that intention." — annals, 1905 DE

G

Gaoth Dhubh, A' n. f. · lit. "the black wind" The oldest storm whose name is kept (1 an Gearran 5184 BDE); the first named storm lost its name (30 am Faoilleach 7454 BDE). The harbour rolls went on naming storms: Am Fuath Mòr, "the great hate" (23 an t-Samhain 220 DE), and An Gàire Dubh, "the black laugh" (5 am Màrt 480 DE).

"It is the oldest storm whose name is kept." — annals, 5184 BDE

gun chreideamh *adj. phr.* · lit. "without a faith" Of land or people that keep none of the three faiths. The first census of the restored kingdom so entered the far north-western cape beyond Baile chrom, Eilean ghorm and the smallest islets (30 an t-Iuchar 1936 DE); the phrase has stood on the map for that land since.

"They enter all of it as *gun chreideamh*, without a faith." — annals, 1936 DE

I

Ithidh Mòd an neach a dh'itheas an cnoc *phr.* · lit. "Mòd will eat whoever eats the hill" The saying of the feathered doors, from the years when the hawk-priests were barred and the crews carried the Hawk order's sermons themselves (10 an Cèitean 1855 DE). Mòd is the Hawk of Acaill, as old as Fionntan mac Bòchra, and the hill is the vein.

"The overseers' reports of these years list hawk-feathers nailed above hut doors as a disciplinary matter." — annals, 1855 DE

L

Lagh an Loscaidh Bhig *n. m.* · lit. "the law of the small burning" The Small-Burning Law: no household might burn more than a measured handful of ore in a season (13 an Lùnastal 2857 BDE). The ruling of the hearth bound the custodians never to withhold that handful (12 an Gearran 526 DE). The Law was never repealed; it lapsed (2 an Dùbhlachd 1800 DE).

"No formal repeal is recorded — it simply stops being enforced once it stops being profitable to enforce." — annals, 1800 DE

Làn na glaise, 's gun tuilleadh *phr.* · lit. "the fill of the hollow hand, and no more" The measure of the Ancient Age (5 an Lùnastal 6590 BDE). When Fionnlagh Dall recut the stone cup to hold two palms (15 an t-Iuchar 2860 BDE), the saying became *Làn an dà bhois, agus gun tuilleadh*.

"It is nowhere written and everywhere kept." — annals, 6590 BDE

Loisc iad an leabhar, ach cha do loisc iad an cnoc *phr.* · lit. "they burned the book, but they did not burn the hill" Said of the raids on the tithe ledgers (9 an t-Iuchar 1929 DE).

"...symbolically decisive even though its practical effect was small." — annals, 1929 DE

M

maor *n. m., pl. maoir* · lit. "steward" Under the humans, an overseer: a Ròdach set over Ròdach for the Company. Ragnall mac Dhòmhnail took his byname from the office (19 an Cèitean 1815 DE, 17 an t-Ògmhios 1815 DE). The kingdom gave the word to the Crown's officer in each shire (4 am Faoilleach 1933 DE). The kenning *maor-obrach*, "work-steward", is a manager.

"...from this office the Ròdach give him his byname: Ragnall Maor, Ragnall the steward." — annals, 1815 DE

mar a thàinig Niall *phr.* · lit. "the way Niall came" Any unusually smooth transfer of power. From Niall's crowning (19 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE), which passed without dispute (7 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE).

"Its first written use is in a Cathair dhearg tavern ledger, set against a debt settled without argument." — annals, 1932 DE

Marbh-bheò *n. m.* · lit. "dead-alive" The Hollow Man of the Doire uaine hills, which attacked anyone who lit a fire in its sight (9 an Giblean 9673 BDE). The rule against open fires after dark came from it (26 an t-Ògmhios 5141 BDE), and shepherds still named it when they left the high pastures (17 an Lùnastal 910 DE).

Na las teine far am faic e thu. "Light no fire where it can see you." — the First Book

O

ogham *n. m.* · lit. "Ogma's letters" The letters of Rodos. The teachers of the stag's people made them from the cutters' tally-notches (15 an Màrt 2085 BDE), and the druids name them for Ogma, god of letters. Nearly every later hand on the island descends from them (Appendix F).

"These are the first letters on Rodos in use by the Ròdaich: the ogham, which the druids call the gift of Ogma." — annals, 2085 BDE

R

rìgh *n. m.* · lit. "king" A ruler of the lowlands, as against the Keeper of the flame. Go-raidh mac Ìomhair was the first so called (28 an Cèitean 2325 BDE); under the division of keeping the rìgh had the roads and the granaries, the Keeper the flame (9 an t-Sultain 2305 BDE).

"He is the first person in any record so called." — annals, 2325 BDE

Rìghrean na Cloiche *n. pl.* · lit. "the kings of the stone" The oldest oral king-list, opening with Ailean Mòr (9 an Lùnastal 7600 BDE). The name was given to it later.

"The list gives no lengths of reign. It is older than the name Ròdaich." — annals, 7600 BDE

roghnaich *v.* · lit. "choose" With no object: to have chosen the crossing, to choose exile for good. From the Choosing (8 an Dùbhlachd 39 BDE); the narrow sense is in the custody-book from 21 an Lùnastal 28 DE. The plain sense was never lost.

Roghnaich iadsan, agus dh'fhuirich sinne. "They chose, and we stayed." — the Third Book

S

scàinte *adj.* · lit. "rent, split" Reeling, shaken, of a person as well as a building. From Scàineadh Cill ghlas, the Rending (9 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE). No annal marks its first use.

"...killing dozens and closing an entire mining district for a generation." — annals, 1916 DE

Scaradh, a' *n. m.* · lit. "the parting" The Sundering (19 an Giblean 1 DE); loosely, any permanent, chosen parting between people who belonged together. It was later applied to the Severance (1 am Faoilleach 1930 DE), which was not chosen, so one word serves two wounds.

"The island's chronicles simply stop describing them the moment the ships clear the harbor." — annals, 1 DE

seann-chunntas *n. m.* · lit. "old account" A grievance nobody in power acts on and nobody cancels. Tuathaich speakers coined it (18 an Giblean 2025 DE) for the tabled archive request (15 an Gearran 2016 DE) and the reparations motion left to die (10 an t-Ògmhios 2024 DE).

"Official Ròdaich usage does not take the word up." — annals, 2025 DE

Seann-Dhaoine *n. pl.* · lit. "old people" The Old Ones, the people before the Ròdaich. The name is a Ròdais description, and no annal dates it. Their first sure trace is the midden at Seann Dunn (28 an Lùnastal 12,153 BDE).

"The Seann-Dhaoine, whoever they were, the people who built Làrach an Dùin-fhaire and Làrach an Dùin..." — annals, 7253 BDE

siorrachd *n. f., pl. siorrachdan* · lit. "shire" Named in the annals from the Age of Sundering (9 an t-Samhain 31 BDE). The kingdom redrew the shires on the humans' district lines (12 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE), and has had a hundred and twenty-three since 1967 DE (Appendix H).

"...the kingdom uses them and does not say so." — annals, 1932 DE

sliochd *n. m.* · lit. "seed, offspring" A house of custody known by a founder's name, not a hearth. Sliochd Mhuirich was the first (11 an t-Sultain 2903 BDE); four were bound to the Keepers' office (29 an Giblean 2614 BDE).

"...the first custodian house in the record known by a name rather than by a hearth." — annals, 2903 BDE

stad-oibre *n. m.* · lit. "work-halt" A strike. The first lasted eleven days (13 an Dàmhair 1856 DE); the first held in several regions on one day came in 1922 DE.

"It ends when food supplies, controlled by human administrators, run out."
— annals, 1856 DE

T

Tha an long ag ithe a' chnuic *phr.* · lit. "the ship is eating the hill" Fearchar Bàrd's most quoted song, made when the Company's steamships began to burn the island's ore to carry it away (15 an Gearran 1882 DE).

Tha an long ag ithe a' chnuic / gus an cnoc a ghiùlan air falbh. "The ship is eating the hill to carry the hill away." — the Fourth Book

Tha e scrìobhte a-nis *phr.* · lit. "it is written now" The Moot's whole minute on the day the census figures were read at Caol mhòr (6 an t-Samhain 1993 DE). The Fifth Book takes it for its epigraph.

"The Moot's minute says only: 'Now written.'" — annals, 1993 DE

Tìr Thall, an n. f. · lit. "the land beyond" The humans' homeland, whose own name no Ròdach scribe set down (26 an Gearran 1781 DE).

"From the first season the record calls it an Tìr Thall, the land beyond, and calls its people simply the humans." — annals, 1781 DE

tonn *n. m.* · lit. "wave" A sudden, overwhelming change: *tha e san tonn*, "he is in the wave of it". From Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol (3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE), by way of the survivors' accounts (4 am Faoilleach 1934 DE).

"Within a generation the sense is heard across the south." — annals, 1934 DE

Tràigh Bhàthte, an n. f. · lit. "the drowned strand" The old site of Cnoc chaol, left as the Great Wave left it (23 an Dùbhlachd 1933 DE).

"The townspeople call it an Tràigh Bhàthte, the drowned strand, and do not build there." — annals, 1933 DE

Tùrsa Geal, an n. m. · lit. "the white sorrow" The mourning for the departed, "not quite grief and not quite celebration" (1 an Lùnastal 15 DE), first kept at court by Queen Beathag for her sister (27 an Dàmhair 15 DE). The chronicle says it was reused, uneasily, for a very different departure in a much later age.

"...with one place set empty at a meal that is neither feast nor fast." — annals,
15 DE

U

uaine *adj.* · lit. "green" Beside its plain sense, sickly, plague-marked. From A' Phlàigh Uaine (9 an t-Ògmhios 1852 DE), first seen as a greenish pallor at Achadh dhomhain (5 an Dùbhlachd 1852 DE).

"...in a field outside the spoil-heaps that is still called the green acre." — annals,
1852 DE

Of What the Record Does Not Hold

The record can prove fewer first uses than a reader might want. *Scàinte*, *Aisling-aois* and the loose sense of *a' Scaradh* stand on the chronicle's list, but no annal marks the day any of them was first said. The rope-makers of Cuan shean sing a keel-song whose words have lost their sense (5 am Màrt 1350 DE). The Tuathaich's own memory of the Long War is filed as folklore, and the northern towns' own accounts are among the things the royal record says it does not hold (25 an Giblean 1972 DE). Where a word's history is missing, this appendix leaves the gap as it is.

APPENDIX F

The Tongues and Peoples of Rodos

This appendix gathers what the rolls and chronicles hold about the peoples who have lived on Rodos and the speech they used. It draws on the royal chronicles, the rolls and custody-books copied into Leabharlann Muileann chaol, the map of the kingdom, and the word-lists that survive from the Age of Strangers. Where the sources are silent this appendix says so, and it does not fill the silence.

I

The Peoples

Five peoples, or kinds of people, stand in the island's history. Two of them are gone. One of them, the *fuil-ghuail*, is not a people at all in the ordinary sense, but the chronicles have come to treat it as one, and so it is set down here with the rest.

PEOPLE	RÔDAIS NAME	IN THE CHRON- ICLES	ON THE MAP TODAY
The Old Ones	<i>na Seann-Dhaoine</i>	Age I; their works end before the Holy Age	no burg; thirty burgs and thirteen shires bear their names
The people of Rodos	<i>na Ròdaich</i> (sg. <i>Ròdach</i>)	every age	441 of 505 burgs; the capital and the sea
The humans	the chronicles' plain name for them	Age IV	none by that name; their descendants are the Tuathaich
The northern-ers	<i>na Tuathaich</i> (sg. <i>Tuathach</i>)	Age V	64 burgs in the north and north-west
The coal-blooded	<i>an fbuil-ghuail</i> ; in the humans' tongue, <i>obsidian-touched</i>	from Age IV	not counted on the map; counted, briefly, in the censuses

The Seann-Dhaoine

The Ròdaich call the people before them *na Seann-Dhaoine*, the Old Ones. The name is a Ròdais description, not the Old Ones' own; what they called themselves is not known and cannot now be known.

What survives of them is stone, shell and names. The oldest sure trace is the midden at Seann Dunn (28 an Lùnastal 12,153 BDE): limpet shell, seal bone and burnt weed, laid down over many lifetimes, with no tool in it shaped the way any later Ròdach shaped tools. After it come the notched net-weights of Seann Chwen, every stone cut with the same three strokes (26 an t-Sultain 12,073 BDE); the unmortared mole at Seann Skell on which every later quay wall there stands (1 an t-Iuchar 11,994 BDE); the two hundred and twelve steps of Seann Bhral (30 an t-Iuchar 11,914 BDE); the stone boxes on Eilean dhearg to which the dead of Seann Vell were rowed (4 an Cèitean 11,834 BDE); the fish-channel of Seann Toll (2 an t-Ògmhios 11,754 BDE); the shell causeway of Seann Warr, the first made road on the island that can still be walked (7 am Màrt 11,675 BDE); the fish-kilns of Seann Mhorn (17 an Giblean 11,516 BDE); and the slipways of Seann Bhrenn, wide enough for hulls bigger than any hide boat, whose hulls are gone with any telling of where they went (16 an Cèitean 11,436 BDE).

At their widest reach (8 an Cèitean 9054 BDE) they held every coast of the island: the ten places whose names begin with *Seann*, and the islands off them. Their largest landing was at the place now called Seann Skell, on the Abhainn naomh.

The ruins inland are theirs by the oldest tellings. The telling of the counting of the dead (29 an Lùnastal 7253 BDE) names the Seann-Dhaoine as "the people who built Làrach an Dùin-fhaire and Làrach an Dùin". Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, the walled outpost on the spur above the ground where Cathair mhòr now stands, has its single gate facing inland and not to the sea (19 an Cèitean 10,400 BDE); Làrach an Dùin, near Ceann mhin, had three rings of wall and room inside for some four hundred people with their beasts (17 an t-Ògmhios 10,344 BDE); and Làrach an Teampaill, in the eastern hills, has its altar set square to the central mountains (14 an Lùnastal 10,232 BDE), "toward the vein, not the horizon". All three were already ruined when the first reliable chronicles begin (27 an t-Samhain 8888 BDE, 6 am Màrt 8776 BDE, 7 am Faoilleach 8673 BDE). Whether the builders of the outpost built the fortress too has never been settled. After the high places were left, every new work of the Seann-Dhaoine lies within sight of salt water (9 an Dùbhlachd 8608 BDE).

The standing stones are harder. Carragh Cnoc bheag, Colbh Cnoc chiar and Calbh Cnoc ghorm were raised in the Ancient Age (17 an t-Iuchar 8273 BDE, 9 an t-Sultain 8154 BDE, 6 an t-Samhain 8048 BDE), and no telling says by whom. The up-

per face of Carragh Cnoc bheag bears a line of the unread script; the four Ròdais words, *Bha teine sa chloich*, "there was fire in the stone", lie lower down, cut with a narrower tool by another hand, and "when that second hand came, the stone does not say" (11 an Lùnastal 8216 BDE). The stones are therefore the one place where the marks of two peoples lie on the same face. The wind-stone at the central Seann Chwen is another: a Ròdais wind-name cut over an older mark of the Seann-Dhaoine (13 an Gearran 5154 BDE).

Their counting. Late in their time the Seann-Dhaoine began cutting single strokes on flat stones at the edges of their middens, one stone to a household (31 an t-Iuchar 7293 BDE). At the eastern Seann Warr the counting stones were built into a wall of some three thousand strokes (3 an t-Ògmhios 7212 BDE); at Seann Tarr in the north-east they were cut in fives and set in the floor of a house (2 an t-Iuchar 7173 BDE). At the Seann Chwen near Cuan dhearg the last tally stone was left half-cut: two strokes finished, a third begun and abandoned (5 an Cèitean 7091 BDE).

Their end. After the half-cut stone no new work of the Seann-Dhaoine can be dated. Their middens stop growing, their harbours silt, and their script is not cut again (7 an Gearran 7050 BDE). How they ended no telling knows, and this appendix will not guess. Nothing in the chronicles says they were driven out, and nothing says they were not; nothing says they died, and nothing says their blood did not run on in some later people. The reader who wants an answer will not find one here.

The hill-folk. Alongside, or after, the Seann-Dhaoine the tellings set a second people: the hill-folk of the high valleys around the crack (10 an t-Samhain 8496 BDE), who buried their dead in the ground and not on islands, and cut no script. They burned the ore, though sparingly: one sliver, one fire, at Àth gharbh (12 an Dàmhair 8440 BDE). Whether they shared the island with the Old Ones or came after them no telling knows. Their own answer, given later, is that they were always there, and it is the answer the Ròdaich give of themselves in the doctrine carried on Calbh Cnoc ghorm: *Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann*, "we did not come; we were here." When stag-scholars came to Calbh Cnoc ghorm in the Holy Age and could not read it, the people of Cnoc ghorm told them what it said, and "the scholars write that the people say so" (6 an Dàmhair 623 BDE).

The Ròdaich

The Ròdaich are the people of Rodos: the majority in every age of the island's history, the holders of the capital, Cathair dhearg (Cathair dhearg), and of the sea. Their name is the island's name with the people-ending *-aich*; a single person is a *Ròdach*. English

writers of the humans' time used *Rodian*, and this history keeps that word as the English adjective.

Custodians. The Ròdaich enter history as custodians. In the Ancient Age a custom set in across the hill settlements that no fire should take more of the ore than one cupped hand could hold. The Binding of the First Flame (23 an t-Sultain 2998 BDE) made the custodianship of the vein a formal order, "centuries before anything like a king", and the Small-Burning Law (13 an Lùnastal 2857 BDE) made the custom into rule. The first person in any record to be called *righ* was Goraidh mac Ìomhair at Dùn dhearg (28 an Cèitean 2325 BDE), and he claimed nothing over the vein. For the whole of the Holy Age the kings ruled the grazing and the gatherings, and the Keepers at Dùn ìseal ruled the mountain. The Holy Age closes on the last age of even population (1 an Cèitean 50 BDE), the last stretch of Rodian history, the chroniclers note with some unease, in which no family held more years of life than any other.

The kingdom. After the Severance the state restyled itself Rìoghachd Ròdais, the Kingdom of Rodos (27 an t-Iuchar 1931 DE), and Niall was crowned at Cathair dhearg (19 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE). The rulers since are set down elsewhere in these appendices. Here it is enough to say that the kingdom is a Ròdach kingdom: its schools teach in Ròdais "and it has no others" (10 an Gearran 1936 DE), and the old apprentice-binding custom, when it was revived, was reserved for Ròdaich applicants only (20 an Dàmhair 1942 DE).

The sea. The Ròdaich have always been a coastal people as well as a mountain one. The largest towns on the map today stand on the sea or on the rivers that run down to it, and the two largest carry a name older than Ròdais:

BURG	SHIRE	FAITH (ORDER)	POPULATION
Seann Skell (Seann Skell)	Seann Skell	An Creideamh Sean (Òrd Mhanannain)	74,120
Seann Skell (Seann Skell)	Seann Skell	An Creideamh Sean (Òrd Bhrìde)	57,907
Ros dhomhain (Ros dhomhain)	Ros dhomhain	An Creideamh Sean (Òrd Mhacha)	51,589
Seann Bhral (Seann Bhral)	Seann Bhral	Na Seann Spioradan	49,681
Cnoc bheag (Cnoc bheag)	Cnoc bheag	An Creideamh Sean (Òrd an t-Seabhaig)	49,661
Cathair mhòr (Cathair mhòr)	Cathair mhòr	An Creideamh Sean (Òrd Mhacha)	49,298
Caol bheag (Caol bheag)	Caol bheag	An Creideamh Sean (Scoiltean nan Draoidhean)	42,649
Achadh mhòr (Achadh mhòr)	Achadh mhòr	Na Seann Spioradan	42,136

The capital itself is not among them. Cathair dhearg is counted at 10,274; its harbour, Ros dhomhain, is five times its size.

The departed. Part of the Ròdaich people is not on Rodos. Land was found across the water (6 am Faoilleach 39 BDE); volunteers chose to go, by a vote "or something the later chronicles call a vote" (8 an Dùbhlachd 39 BDE); the fleet set out, turning sunwise round the river pool at Seann Skell, in the first year of the Diosal Era (19 an Giblean 1 DE). A fragmentary report told of two landfalls, not one (24 an Dùbhlachd 5 DE), and of the thinning: cut off from the vein, "by the third generation abroad, nothing remains that Rodos would recognize" (3 an t-Iuchar 14 DE). The departed are a people of the chronicles only by their absence. The island kept them in rites (the empty-harbour rite, 25 an t-Samhain 22 DE; the white sorrow, *an Tùrsa Geal*, 27 an Dàmhair 15 DE) and in words, of which more below. When the humans came, old sailors at Cuan shean remarked that the strangers had come in from the same quarter of sea the Sundering fleet once sailed into. The council forbade the remark in its hall; it was written down anyway, and never answered (9 an Gearran 1781 DE). Nobody on Rodos knows whether the humans descend from the departed, and this appendix does not know either.

The humans of an Tìr Thall

The Crossing. Humans made landfall on Rodos and were granted leave to stay (5 am Faoilleach 1780 DE): the first contact since the Sundering. Three ships out of the west anchored off Cuan shean, and their master, whom the chronicles call Edmund Harrow, came ashore unarmed and asked by signs for water (5 an Gearran 1780 DE). That is the first exchange between the two peoples, and it was not in words.

Their homeland. The strangers named their homeland in their own tongue, but no Ròdach scribe set the word down. From the first season the chronicles call it *an Tìr Thall*, the land beyond, and calls its people simply the humans (26 an Gearran 1781 DE). Their own name for their country is not on Rodos in any hand, and it will not be recovered from here.

What they called things. The humans' names for the island's things were few, plain and, to Ròdach ears, careless. They had a single word for the black ore, and it was the word for the fuel they burned at home; Gormshuil nic Fhearchair's copyist noted that no Ròdais word answered to it, and that the humans did not ask for one (23 an Giblean 1782 DE). So the vein became, in their tongue, *coal*, and the custodians of the vein became, in Samuel Wren's otherwise careful grammar, "keepers of the coal" (21 an Lùnastal 1791 DE). Their institutions came with English names and kept them: the

Company, the Administration, the Mission, the Residency above Ros dhomhain (10 an Cèitean 1788 DE), the Commissioner, the Levy, the constable posts. Their faith was the Church, which the Ròdaich call *an Eaglais*, and the Mission was its house on Rodos. Their coin was the *mark*. The townsfolk of Muileann shean called the constable post there "the humans' second Residency", and did not mean it kindly (11 an Dàmhair 1911 DE).

The camps. What the humans built for themselves on Rodos was built for the pit. The camp of timber huts at Àth ìseal was the first settlement on Rodos built for no purpose but the pit (6 an Dàmhair 1808 DE); Baile dhomhain was laid out on a grid by a Company surveyor, the first Ròdach town drawn on paper before it was built (10 am Faoilleach 1813 DE); the camp at Achadh dhomhain was built of spoil (1 am Faoilleach 1847 DE). The camps were Ròdach in their labour and human in their rule, and the record of them is kept in two tongues that seldom agree: the Mission counts four hundred and six dead of the spotted pox, and the custodians count more, and write the difference in the margin of the Mission's list (11 an Dàmhair 1818 DE). Human families lived on Rodos as well as human officers: upland pasture in the north-west, around Muileann àrsaidh, was granted for human families who would not work in the pits (3 an t-Samhain 1799 DE). It is the first human settlement in the north, and the north is where their descendants were sent.

Mixing. The first mixed settlement (22 an Giblean 1784 DE) was Baile dhìreach on the south-west coast, under a council of three Ròdaich and three humans, whose founding compact was written twice, once in each tongue, the only such compact on record in the age (10 an Dàmhair 1784 DE). There the net-maker Eilidh nic Ruairidh married the human cooper Samuel Hale, and the council entered the marriage in both its books (26 an Cèitean 1786 DE). Later history did not repeat the experiment, and the first mixed-blood inheritance case (15 an Gearran 1890 DE) was decided by the Administration entirely in its own favour.

The going north. War was declared in 1928 DE. Before the end, the human families of Ros bheag, Cuan shean, Baile dhìreach and the south-west marched north along the western roads under guard of the council's companies; few of them had ever lived in the north; no column was attacked, and none was helped (29 an t-Samhain 1929 DE). The war ended with the crossing itself closed (1 am Faoilleach 1930 DE). Whatever let humans reach Rodos shut, and the humans still on the island were shepherded to the northern territory their descendants hold today.

The Tuathaich

From the Severance the chronicles stop calling them humans. The descendants of those left on Rodos are *na Tuathaich*, the northerners, from *tuath*, north, by the same *-aich* that makes *Ròdaich*, so that on the page the two names read as siblings even though their circumstances do not. Their homeland in the north was fixed formally (22 am Màrt 1930 DE): "a confinement, not a homecoming, though later generations will simply call it home." A formal wall between the two peoples was proposed and rejected as unnecessary, because the two were already keeping apart on their own (11 an Cèitean 1939 DE).

What the Tuathaich call themselves in their own speech the chronicles do not say. The name in this appendix is the kingdom's name for them.

Their burgs. The map counts sixty-four Tuathaich burgs, all in the north and north-west, with some 543,000 people in them. The Ròdaich hold the other 441. The Tuathaich country is some fifteen parts in a hundred of the island's land, the windy coast of the far north-west among it, and the Ròdaich country the other eighty-five (Appendix H). The largest Tuathaich towns:

BURG	SHIRE	FAITH	POPULATION
Caol mhòr (Caol mhòr)	Caol mhòr	An Eaglais	42,002
Doire ghlas (Doire ghlas)	Doire ghlas	An Eaglais (Eaglais nan Tuathach)	40,740
Ceann mhòr (Ceann mhòr)	Ceann mhòr	An Eaglais	32,420
Baile chrom (Baile chrom)	Baile chrom	An Eaglais (the vigil of the Grey Night)	27,319
Cnoc ghorm (Cnoc ghorm)	Cnoc ghorm	An Eaglais	25,112

Every Tuathaich town but one bears a Ròdais name, and most of them were Ròdach towns before the Severance; the north-west had been thinly held since the dearth on that shore in the Age of Sundering (19 an Giblean 780 DE). One of them, Seann Skell (Seann Skell) in the shire of Muileann àrsaidh, bears an Old One's name. The Tuathaich have added no names of their own to the map.

Their assembly. Tuathaich householders from the northern towns met at Caol mhòr and chose a speaker, Walter Hale, a former harbour clerk (25 an Lùnastal 1931 DE). The Moot has no standing in Ròdach law; it meets anyway, and its minutes run unbroken from that meeting to the present.

Their faith. All sixty-four Tuathaich burgs keep An Eaglais, the Church, which their forebears brought over the sea at the Crossing; no Ròdach town keeps it. Fifty-one keep it in the line the Mission left, and their largest church is at Cnoc ghorm.

Twelve are the old congregations of the north coast, Eaglais nan Tuathach, whose towns lie together in the shires of Doire ghlais, Muileann leathan, Inis mhin and Àth àrsaidh. One, Baile chrom, keeps the vigil of the Grey Night, Rùn-dìomhair na h-Oidhche Glaise, which the Church's bishops call irregular. The old congregations keep, quietly, the First Canoe fragment (13 an Gearran 1938 DE): among coastal Tuathaich families, "a named steersman, a first crossing", which their church tells as the voyage of Naomh Breandan to the Isle of the Blessed, and which the druids of the Old Faith dismiss as superstition (9 an t-Samhain 10,073 BDE). The fragment belongs at the head of the Ancient Age, because that is where its tellers place it. The Library neither endorses it nor refutes it. It is one of the two suppressed histories that bracket the island's story, and it is not resolved here.

The fuil-ghuail

This section holds to what the rolls and chronicles say.

A child born into the mining camps was exposed to more raw ore across her lifetime than any Rodian in living memory, and did not age the way the people around her did. Her name is Aisling (7 am Màrt 1848 DE). What was happening to her had no word, in any language spoken on the island (13 am Faoilleach 1850 DE). A second case, Fionnan, was born half a century later (21 an Gearran 1900 DE), and it became plain that the exposure was not a single accident but an ongoing industrial condition. Facing two confirmed cases, Ròdach custodians settled on a term (23 am Faoilleach 1905 DE): *fuil-ghuail*, "coal-blood", rendered in the humans' tongue as *obsidian-touched*. It was meant clinically. It was agreed at a meeting of custodians at the shrine of Cill ghlais, and the roll records the vote but not who proposed it (21 an Gearran 1905 DE). The Residency ordered every Ròdach child showing the condition to be reported; the custodians complied by reporting none (26 an t-Samhain 1906 DE). A third case, Lorccan, was born in a mining town (29 an Cèitean 1913 DE), and a fourth, Cian, within a year of him (3 am Màrt 1914 DE).

After the Severance the Obsidian Rite, Òrd Bhrìde, was formalized within the Old Faith, built around the leyline and "the unbroken line of the obsidian-touched" (18 an Giblean 1935 DE). The first census of the kingdom noted, without further comment, exactly how few such people exist (29 an t-Ògmhios 1936 DE), and the published census of a later generation gave a number and nothing else (8 am Faoilleach 1994 DE). The number is printed nowhere else, and this appendix does not print it either.

Whether the *fuil-ghuail* are a people is a question of words. They are born to Ròdach families; in Ròdach speech the word names the gift that sets the Ròdaich apart

from the Tuathaich; and the druid schools have asked since the Holy Age why the vein answers some hands and not others. The chronicles do not settle it.

II

The Tongues

Ròdais

Ròdais is the Gaelic of Rodos. Of the humans' tongues it most resembles Scottish Gaelic, Irish and Manx, and it is closest to Scottish Gaelic in grammar and core vocabulary; its look on the page is its own. Three marks distinguish it:

FEATURE	RÒDAIS	EXAMPLE
Long vowels	grave accent only: à è ì ò ù	<i>mòr, sìth, Ròdais</i>
The cluster /sk/	written sc , never <i>sg</i>	<i>uisce, scoil, sceul, Scàineadh</i>
"City"	<i>cathair</i>	<i>Cathair dhearg</i>

Its greeting of thanks is *gu robh math agad*. Its verbs come first in the sentence (*Chunnaic Cian an long*, "Cian saw the ship"); it has no word for "a", no words for yes and no, and two initial mutations.

Lenition. After many words an initial consonant softens, and the change is written with *b*: *b* > *bh*, *c* > *ch*, *d* > *dh*, *f* > *fh*, *g* > *gh*, *m* > *mh*, *p* > *ph*, *s* > *sh*, *t* > *th*. The possessives, the past tense, a feminine noun after the article, an adjective after a feminine noun, most simple prepositions and the second element of a name all cause it. It does not touch vowels, nor *l*, *n*, *r* in writing, nor the clusters *sc*, *sp*, *st*, *sm*; and after a word ending in *n* it spares *d*, *t* and *s*, which is why the map has *Seann Dunn* and *Seann Toll* but *Seann Bhrál*.

Broad and slender. Vowels are broad (*a o u à ò ù*) or slender (*e i è ì*), and within one word a consonant takes vowels of the same class on both sides: *caol le caol, leathan le leathan*, slender with slender, broad with broad. That is why so many endings come in pairs, and why the small rivers are *Ciaras* but *Àrsaidheas*.

Sounds. For the reader who meets these names aloud:

WRITTEN	SAID	EXAMPLE
bh, mh	v	<i>Seann Bhrál</i>
ch	as in <i>loch</i>	<i>Seann Chwen</i>
dh, gh	a voiced <i>ch</i> before broad vowels; <i>y</i> before slender	<i>Cathair dhearg</i>

WRITTEN	SAID	EXAMPLE
fh	silent	<i>Àth fhada</i>
sh, th	h	<i>Dùn thais</i>
sc	sk	<i>Scàineadh</i>

The stress falls on the first syllable.

How Ròdais names new things. Ròdais is an old dialect, long cut off, and it took few of the loanwords that other Gaelic took for new things, fewer than Scottish Gaelic took. The humans brought many new things, and the kingdom after them more. In the first generations after the Crossing the Ròdaich named nearly all of them from old roots, naming the thing by what it does or what it is like: head first, the describer after, hyphenated, two elements and seldom three. Many of these kennings are still the usual words. The loans Ròdais did take came mostly later, for such things as the bus (*bus*), the taxi (*tacsaidh*) and the radio (*rèidio*), and for many words of the sciences, such as *ogsaidean*, oxygen, and the names of the elements. A selection of the kennings, with the literal sense and the word the Gaelic of other lands uses:

ENGLISH	RÒDAIS	LITERALLY	ELSEWHERE
train	<i>carbad-iarainn</i>	iron-chariot	<i>trèana</i>
engine	<i>cridhe-iarainn</i>	iron-heart	<i>einnsean</i>
computer	<i>inntinn-iarainn</i>	iron-mind	<i>coimpiutair</i>
aeroplane	<i>eun-iarainn</i>	iron-bird	<i>plèana</i>
telephone	<i>guth-sreinge</i>	string-voice	<i>fòn</i>
cable	<i>sreang-theine</i>	fire-string	<i>càball</i>
socket	<i>tobar-dealanaich</i>	lightning-well	<i>socaid</i>
battery	<i>ciste-spionnaidh</i>	strength-chest	<i>bataraidh</i>
heater	<i>teine-gun-lasair</i>	flameless-fire	<i>teasadair</i>
camera	<i>ciste-scàile</i>	shadow-chest	<i>camara</i>
film	<i>seul-scàile</i>	shadow-tale	<i>film</i>
novel	<i>leabhar-sceòil</i>	tale-book	<i>nobbail</i>
documentary	<i>seul-firinne</i>	truth-tale	<i>prògram aithriseach</i>
plastic	<i>cèir-chruaidh</i>	hard-wax	<i>plastaig</i>
inflation	<i>lobhadh-airgid</i>	money-rot	<i>atmhorachd</i>
internet	<i>lion-fiosa</i>	tidings-net	<i>eadar-lion</i>
crossing (street)	<i>àth-coise</i>	foot-ford	<i>slighe-choisichean</i>
tyre	<i>bròg-cuibhle</i>	wheel-shoe	<i>taidhr</i>

Families form of themselves: machines are *iarrainn*, of iron; screens and pictures are *scàil* and *scàthan*, shadow and mirror; electricity is *dealan*, spark, and *dealanach*, lightning. A crossing for feet is a ford, *àth*, the same word the map uses for a town at a river.

Words born of the island's history. Ròdais has also given old words new senses from the events it lived through. The royal chroniclers keep a list of these, and the rolls date the first use of most.

WORD	PLAIN SENSE	SENSE GIVEN BY HISTORY	FIRST RECORDED
<i>roghnaich</i>	to choose	to have chosen the crossing; to choose exile	21 an Lùnastal 28 DE
<i>a' Scaradb</i>	the Sundering	any chosen, permanent parting; later used of the Severance	Age of Sundering
<i>uaine</i>	green	sickly, plague-marked, after A' Phlàigh Uaine (9 an t-Ògmhios 1852 DE)	Age of Strangers
<i>scàinte</i>	rent, cracked	shaken, of a person, after Scàineadh Cill ghlas (9 an t-Ògmhios 1916 DE)	Age of Strangers
<i>Aisling-aois</i>	Aisling's age	an unnaturally long youth in anyone, said half in jest	Age of Strangers
<i>mar a thàinig Niall</i>	the way Niall came	any smooth handing-over of power	7 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE
<i>tonn</i>	wave	a sudden, overwhelming change: <i>tha e san tonn</i>	4 am Faoilleach 1934 DE
<i>a chur san Le-abharlann</i>	to put it in the Library	to make a thing settled and official	3 an t-Samhain 1945 DE
<i>dubhan</i>	a man's name	the synthetic fuel	23 an t-Sultain 2010 DE
<i>dubhan-tùsail</i>	dubhan of the beginning	a first attempt that looked like a dead end before it wasn't	22 an Dàmhair 2010 DE
<i>fadachadh</i>	lengthening	to be crushed after holding out too long: <i>chaidh am fadachadh</i>	10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE
<i>seann-chunntas</i>	old account	a grievance nobody in power acts on and nobody cancels	18 an Giblean 2025 DE

Of the Sundering the language also keeps one strange relic. A work-song of the rope-makers of Cuan shean names the parts of a deep keel, and half its words have no meaning to anyone who sings it (5 am Màrt 1350 DE). It is the only record of the fleet's techniques to survive in any form. Whether the lost words are old Ròdais, wrights' cant, or something else, no one has shown.

The tongue of the Seann-Dhaoine

Of the Old Ones' speech nothing survives but names. Ten roots are known, each standing after the Ròdais word *seann*, "old", which lenites it where Ròdais lenites:

ROOT	AS WRITTEN ON THE MAP	BURGS BEARING IT	SHIRES NAMED FROM IT
Dunn	Seann Dunn	3	yes
Cwen	Seann Chwen	3	yes
Skell	Seann Skell	4	yes (three)
Bral	Seann Bhral	3	yes
Tarr	Seann Tarr	3	yes
Vell	Seann Vell	5	yes (three)
Morn	Seann Mhorn	2	—
Brenn	Seann Bhrenn	2	yes
Toll	Seann Toll	3	yes
Warr	Seann Warr	2	yes

Thirty burgs on the map bear these names, and thirteen shires are named from them. The Ròdaich did not translate these names; they took them over. The fishers who resettled Seann Mhorn in the Holy Age kept "the name they found there, which is not in their own tongue", and said the old name came with the stones (23 an t-Sultain 2821 BDE). It is the first such taking-over on record. The pattern is the one other lands know, where an older people's harbour-names outlive them inside a newer tongue: borrowed and fossilized, not translated.

What can be said. The roots are single syllables. Seven of the ten end in a doubled consonant (*-nn*, *-ll*, *-rr*). Three of them hold letters that Ròdais writes nowhere else: *k* in *Skell*, *v* in *Vell*, *w* in *Cwen* and *Warr*. Ròdais spelling turns every *sg* into *sc*, but it has never turned Seann Skell into Seann Scell; the scribes kept the foreign *k* as they found it, and the grammar counts *sk-* among the clusters that do not lenite.

What cannot be known. What any root meant. Whether *seann* was ever the Old Ones' own element, or only the Ròdaich's label for places they found already named (the second is the usual reading, and the likelier, but it is a reading). Whether the roots come from one tongue or several. Two of them look like Ròdais words, *toll*, a hole, and *dunn* beside *dùn*, a fort; the resemblance has tempted scholars in every age and proves nothing, and the Library does not take a side.

The script. The Seann-Dhaoine also cut signs. Rows of them stand on the cliff above Seann Tarr (5 an Giblean 11,595 BDE), in the script that turns up again on the

standing stones. It is not Ròdais, and it has not been read. Not one sign of it has an agreed meaning. The stag-scholars of the Holy Age set their own new letters against the obelisk at Carragh Cnoc bheag and found that they matched nothing, and wrote down that the stone's writers were not their teachers (12 an Cèitean 2085 BDE). Samuel Wren copied the obelisk and sent it west to the scholars of an Tìr Thall; no reply is recorded (5 an Gearran 1796 DE). Edwin Lowe copied the pillar near Cnoc chiar, compared it with Wren's copy, and decided that the two were not the same script and that neither was Ròdach; his notes stop there (9 an Lùnastal 1844 DE). The strokes on the midden stones are not this script; they are a count. Whether the script records the Old Ones' tongue, or some other, or no tongue at all, is not known.

The humans' tongue

The humans spoke a plain tongue, and this history renders it in English (see *Of Translation* below). The names they carried were names of that tongue: Edmund Harrow, Thomas Pike, Samuel Wren, Josiah Pell, Henry Maddox, Arthur Lisle, Samuel Hale, Edwin Lowe.

The season of translation. Human clerics and Ròdach custodians spent a full season trying to build a shared vocabulary, and neither side's account of what was agreed survives intact (27 am Màrt 1781 DE). Samuel Wren and the custodian Gormshuil nic Fhearchair kept parallel word-lists. Wren's survives in the Administration's letter-books; Gormshuil's was lost, and only its first leaf is known from a copy: forty words for the colours of broken ore (13 an Dùbhlachd 1781 DE). Against those forty the humans had one word, and it was *coal*.

The tongue of rule. The humans wrote their agreements in their own tongue only. The first written treaty (27 an Giblean 1787 DE) was signed at Cathair dhearg by Tormod mac Ailein, who could not read the tongue it was written in; the record does not say who read it to him (7 an Cèitean 1787 DE). The Harbour Articles were written the same way, and that time two custodians refused to sign (16 an t-Samhain 1798 DE). The Mission's school at Ros dhomhain taught Ròdach children in the humans' tongue (9 an Cèitean 1830 DE); a generation later Iain Maor, the first overseer schooled there, kept his reports in the humans' tongue and his household in Ròdais (23 an Giblean 1866 DE). The Levy's officers read the names of the chosen at Caol mhòr from a list in the humans' tongue, and the custodians took the names down again in Ròdais, "so that they will know whom to look for" (3 am Màrt 1867 DE).

Loanwords. Few crossed, and most of those late. In the first generations Ròdais took the humans' goods and named them in its own way, as above, and kept few of the

humans' words for them. The humans, for their part, so far as the record shows, used the Ròdais names of places as they found them, and took *fuil-ghuail* not as a loan but as a translation, *obsidian-touched*; that word, and not the Ròdais, is the one the kingdom's own later entries use of the Rite's "unbroken line". What went the other way, into the humans' speech, is best seen after the Severance, in the north.

The Ròdais word for the humans' country, *an Tìr Thall*, is the only name the island has for it.

Tuathaich speech

The speech of the north is a mixed speech, and the chronicles describe it only in passing. They say this much:

The Tuathaich kept the humans' tongue. Walter Hale asked the council for leave to open schools in the north teaching in it, and was refused (10 an Gearran 1936 DE); Agnes Pike opened one at Doire ghlas anyway, with Moot money and without the council's leave, and within a decade there were nine (14 am Faoilleach 1944 DE). The Moot later counted eleven such schools, and three that had begun to teach Ròdais as well, at the parents' asking (7 an t-Ògmhios 1958 DE). The church at Cnoc ghorm taught its priests in the humans' tongue while reading the Bible in the Ròdais text its preachers use on the west coast: the only place in the north where both are taught (29 an Giblean 1939 DE).

The Tuathaich live among Ròdais names and use Ròdais words. The words the north has added to the island's speech in the present age are Ròdais in form: *fadachadh*, from *fada*, long, the name of the war they lost (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE), and *seann-chunntas*, an old reckoning, which official Ròdach usage pointedly does not take up (18 an Giblean 2025 DE). The word *dubhan* for the fuel came out of the north, from the name of Dubhan, a Tuathach, and it spread before the fuel did (23 an t-Sultain 2010 DE); the royal chronicler who first set it down spelled it three ways in two lines (21 an t-Samhain 2000 DE).

Beyond this the chronicles do not go. The northern towns' own accounts are among the things the royal record says it does not hold (25 an Giblean 1972 DE). How far the humans' tongue has drifted in the north since the crossing closed, how much Ròdais is spoken at a Tuathach hearth, and in which tongue the First Canoe is told: this archive does not know, and it would be wrong to pretend otherwise.

Names and naming

Personal names. Ròdach names are Gaelic personal names: Ailean, Beathag, Ca-triona, Dòmhnall, Eilidh, Fearchar, Gormshuil, Iain, Mòrag, Raghnaill, Sileas, Tormod. A person is further named from the father, with *mac*, son, or *nic*, daughter, and the father's name in the genitive, lenited where Ròdais lenites: Tormod mac Iain; Eilidh nic Iain; Gormshuil nic Fhearchair; Donnchadh mac Thormoid; Mòrag nic Dhòmhnail; Oighrig nic Lachlainn.

Bynames are as common as patronymics and often outlast them. They name a colour, a trade, a size or a deed. After a woman's name the byname is lenited, after a man's it is not: Seònaid Mhòr, Eilidh Dhubh, Beathag Bhàn, but Ailean Mòr, Calum Liath, Dùghall Garbh. Trade-names are nouns and stand as they are: Alasdair Saor, the wright; Iain Maor, the overseer. Some bynames are earned: Tormod mac Iain, the first of the royal kin to read, was called Tormod Scriobhaiche, Tormod the Writer, for the rest of his life (3 an Lùnastal 1744 BDE).

Kindreds take *Sliochd*, the seed or line, or *Clann*, the children, with a founder's name in the genitive: Sliochd Ìomhair, Sliochd Mhuirich, Clann Choinnich.

Human and Tuathaich names are of the humans' tongue and are kept in their own spelling: Walter Hale, Agnes Pike. Unlike the humans' names for the island's things, the humans' names for themselves survived the Severance.

Place names. Ròdach places are named by a generic noun and a describing word after it. On the map the describer is always lenited, whatever the gender of the generic (*Baile ghorm*, *Cnoc bheag*, *Dùn thais*); in speech it would not be after a masculine noun, and the map's form is a fixed naming pattern, kept as one might keep an old compound. The generics:

GENERIC	SENSE	USED FOR
<i>Cathair</i>	stone fort; city	capital, city
<i>Dùn</i>	fortified hill	capital, city
<i>Baile Mòr</i>	great settlement	city
<i>Baile</i>	settlement, town	town
<i>Àth</i>	ford	town
<i>Cnoc</i>	hill	town
<i>Muileann</i>	mill	town
<i>Cill</i>	holy cell, shrine	village, hamlet
<i>Tobar</i>	well	village, hamlet
<i>Achadh</i>	field	village

GENERIC	SENSE	USED FOR
<i>Doire</i>	oak grove	village
<i>Carraig</i>	rock	hamlet
<i>Ros</i>	headland	port
<i>Ceann</i>	head, point	port
<i>Cuan</i>	harbour	port
<i>Caol</i>	strait	port
<i>Inis</i>	island	port

The describers are colour, size and character words: *mòr, beag, dubh, geal, bàn, dearg, ruadh, uaine, glas, fada, dombain, ìseal, fiadhaich, naomb, fionn, ciar, gorm, sean, òg, garbh, min, caol, leathan, crom, dìreach, àrsaidh*. The great rivers are *Abhainn* with a describer; the small ones take a root and the ending *-as* or *-eas* by broad and slender. A shire, *siorrachd*, takes the name of its seat, or, where it has no town, of its island (Appendix H). Names repeat freely; there are four Baile chrom and four Seann Skell, and the rolls tell them apart by where they are.

Beside these stand the Old Ones' names, which follow none of the rules above except that the Ròdaich put *seann* before them.

Writing

Before letters. The first marks on Rodos made on purpose are the Seann-Dhaoine's: the notched net-weights of Seann Chwen, their unread script, and their tally strokes. The Ròdaich's forebears kept counts too, but not in letters. Someone began marking the high-water line against a fixed rock in the Ancient Age (28 am Faoilleach 5930 BDE), and at Ros dhomhain Seònaid Mhòr cut her marks in pairs, one for the high water and one for the low (25 an t-Iuchar 5177 BDE). The king-lists of that age were oral, and the Small-Burning custom was "nowhere written and everywhere kept".

The Ròdais words on the stones. *Bha teine sa chloich* on Carragh Cnoc bheag, *Cuimbnich an teine* on Colbh Cnoc chiar, *Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann* on Calbh Cnoc ghorm: these are the oldest Ròdais words in stone. When they were cut no roll says. The stones were raised in the Ancient Age; the Ròdais on Carragh Cnoc bheag was cut later, by another hand. The words on Calbh Cnoc ghorm were recut along their old grooves by a hand from the Stone Kings' hill, and some later readers say the recutting changed a letter (2 an t-Samhain 3237 BDE). That there were letters to change then is not proved by this; the Library keeps the claim and makes no judgment on it.

The stag-letters. The first letters in use by the Ròdaich were made at Muileann chiar in the far east, where the teachers of the stag's people, the first of the druid schools, later called Feallsanachd an Fhèidh, turned the cutters' tally-notches into signs for sounds, "so that a teaching can be kept without a teacher" (15 am Màrt 2085 BDE). The druids call them the ogham, the gift of Ogma, god of letters. Nearly every later hand on the island descends from them. From these came the first written king-list (20 an Lùnastal 1700 BDE), kept by Tormod Scriobhaiche at Dùn dhearg; the Keepers' own roll, written down at Dùn ìseal in answer to it (17 an Dàmhair 1679 BDE); boundary stones cut with treaty terms (11 am Màrt 1404 BDE); and the first teaching of letters for their own sake, to fishers' children at Inis bheag, which the Hall recorded with the remark that fish do not need reading (22 an t-Ògmhios 1145 BDE).

Books and paper. The Age of Sundering is the age of the custody-book, kept by the vein-house, and of the first books: Leabhar an t-Seabhaig, the sayings of Gormshuil (5 an t-Ògmhios 212 DE), and Seònaid nic Coinnich's Book of the Three Claimants, the oldest surviving history on Rodos written as one narrative (8 an t-Ògmhios 585 DE). Aonghas mac Uisdein was the first king to learn his letters as a child (25 an Cèitean 355 DE). A mill at Muileann chaol began making paper from rags, the first on Rodos, and the custody-book was copied onto paper in that generation (28 am Faoilleach 1635 DE).

Two tongues of record. The humans brought paper in quantity, and the custodians of Cathair naomh asked for their first payment in paper and ink (19 an Lùnastal 1782 DE). They brought, too, a written tongue the Ròdaich could not read, and for a century the island kept its records in two. Whether the humans' letters and the stag-letters share their shapes, the record does not say. The earliest Ròdach grievance text to survive, Leabhar Baile thais, was set down in Ròdais by many hands (18 an t-Sultain 1880 DE).

The kingdom's record. After the Severance the kingdom founded Leabharlann Muileann chaol (1 an Cèitean 1945 DE) and the office of royal chronicler (20 an t-Samhain 1947 DE), and in time drew the provincial archives into one place (26 an t-Iuchar 1996 DE). This appendix is written from that library.

Of Translation

This history is written in English for the next reader, and some account is owed of what that has done to the tongues it describes.

The humans' speech is rendered in English. The humans did not speak English. They spoke the tongue of an Tìr Thall, whose name for itself, like the name of their country, is not recorded on Rodos. It was a plain tongue, as English is plain be-

side Ròdais; its speakers were strangers to the island and its things; and it has become, in the north, the ordinary speech of the Tuathaich. For those reasons it is given here as English, and its names are given as English names, as the letter- books would have them. When this history says the humans called the ore *coal*, it means that they used their ordinary word for their ordinary fuel, and that *coal* is the nearest English word for what they meant. When it gives a custodian's title as "keepers of the coal", it is rendering Wren's rendering. *Obsidian-touched* is likewise an English stand-in for the humans' word, chosen because it keeps the plainness of the original and the error in it. The ore is not obsidian, and it is not coal.

Ròdais is kept as it is. The Ròdaich are the people of this history and Ròdais is its first tongue, and it is not translated into something else here. Names of places, persons, faiths, laws and offices are left in Ròdais spelling, with the grave accent and the *sc*, and with their lenitions: *Cathair dhearg*, not "Red City"; *fuil-ghuail*, not "coal-blood", except where a gloss is wanted. Where a Ròdais phrase is translated, the translation follows it in quotation marks and is meant as a help, not a replacement. The five ages have Ròdais names and are also given English ones for convenience; the English names are this archive's, not the chroniclers'. The adjective *Rodian* is English, and is used as such.

The island's own name. Written in Ròdais it is *Ròdos*, with the accent. In the English text of this history it is written *Rodos*, the form the humans used and the form in which most readers will have met it. It is the same word.

The Seann tongue is not translated, because it cannot be. Its ten roots are given as the Ròdaich wrote them, with the foreign letters the Ròdaich kept. No meaning is offered for any of them.

What has been lost in the rendering. Some things do not cross. The forty colour-words on Gormshuil's leaf are one; the Tuathaich jokes about being long-warred are another, since *fadachadh* is funny, and not funny, only in a tongue where *fada* is also the name of the war. Where this history has had to choose between a translation that reads easily and one that keeps what the words did, it has tried to keep what they did.

APPENDIX G

The Goods and Markets of Rodos

This appendix describes what the island grows, digs, catches and makes; the sixteen market towns through which almost all of it is bought and sold; the main roads of trade between them; and the taxes the Treasury takes on that trade. The present-day account is drawn from the Treasury's market roll for the last full year, which the clerks of the market-due keep in each of the sixteen market towns and send to Cathair dhearg, and from the books of the fair-court at Muileann òg. The older history is drawn from the annals, and where a trade has a first date in them the date is given.

The roll counts goods in the measures the markets use: grain, fish, clay and sand by the wain; timber by the pile; stone by the pallet; ore by the wagon; silver and gold by the bar; cattle, sheep, horses and oxen by the head; oil, dubhan, wine, honey and tar by the barrel; salt and dyes by the bag; cloth by the bolt; books by the volume. Prices in this appendix are in the realm-coin.

I. The Countries of the Island and What They Grow

Rodos is a wet and windy island, mild for its northern place, and most of it is forest and moor. Its farming follows five kinds of country.

The high bare north. Along the northern coast from Ceann mhòr to Seann Tarr, and inland over the moors behind the Hawk bay, the ground is bare and windswept, with snow on the high moor in winter. It still grows more than its look suggests. Barley and oats are sown in every sheltered hollow, hemp grows in the valley bottoms, and the heather feeds bees and sheep. The shore is the richer half. The northern and north-western waters hold the island's herring grounds and its whales, and amber is gathered from the wrack on the strands of the Hawk bay and the north-west. The market towns of this country are Ceann mhòr, Seann Skell, Àth fhionn, Muileann fhionn and Seann Tarr.

The birch and pine hills. The largest single country on the island is the belt of birch, pine and hill pasture that runs from the western plain across the middle of Rodos into the eastern hills. It is cattle and sheep country before anything else, and it also gives timber, venison, honey and a dark wine pressed from blaeberry and bramble. Almost all of the island's ore-bearing ground lies in these hills: the silver of Muileann chiar — baile mèinne airgid and of the hills of Cuan ghlas, the copper and tin of Ceann àrsaidh, Cnoc bhàn and Doire fhionn, the gemstones of the Muileann dhearg hills, the marble of Baile Mòr dhomhain, the old spoil-heaps where dubhan is made for the forges, and the charcoal woods that fed the forges before it. Copper was little worked before the New Age. The humans shipped theirs in for the first coinage (10 an Lùnastal 1796 DE), and the first great working is the copper-town of Àth fhiadhaich (2 an t-Ògmhios 1990 DE). The market towns of the hills are Baile Mòr dhomhain, Ros fhionn, Dùn ìseal, Baile Mòr dhìreach and Ros bheag.

The wet western and southern woods. South and west of the capital the forest is oak, alder and hazel, dripping for half the year. Timber, game, clay, white sand, hemp and honey are its chief goods, with barley on the cleared ground. The potteries and glass-houses stand in this country because its clay and sand are the best on Rodos, and the dyers of the south take their colours from its plants. Its market towns are Baile Mòr fhionn, Cathair fhada, Cnoc bhàn and Caol ruadh.

The oak country of the capital and the east. Around the capital and along the eastern road the woods are broad-leaved and the soil is deeper. This is the island's best mixed farming: cattle and sheep, grain, wine, hemp, and the horses of the Doire chaol country. Its farms sell through Cathair dhomhain, Ceann leathan and Dùn ìseal.

The eastern plain and the mosses. The open grassland east of Dùn ìseal, where the herders of the Ancient Age drove their cattle to the warm springs (7 an Lùnastal 3830 BDE), is thin pasture and bees. The wet mosses of the west coast and the western plain give peat, reeds and wildfowl, and at Baile ghorm the salt-pans the Stone Kings fought over (12 an Gearran 6918 BDE).

Some goods grow in only one or two places. Flax grows only in the lake-shore fields of Seann Warr, and its seed is pressed there for linseed oil, in which the road-houses were frying their oatcakes as early as 265 DE. Tobacco grows only on the old concession farms behind Ceann mhòr, where the humans first planted it (31 an Dàmhair 1831 DE). Gold is washed only from the streams below Baile dhìreach and Cnoc dhìreach, and the pearl-mussels lie only in the shallows of the south-eastern coast off Cnoc bhàn and Caol ruadh.

Rodos grows no spices, tea, sugar, silk or dates, and has no camels or elephants. Before the Severance the ships of an Tìr Thall brought small amounts of spice, tea and sugar to the Company's stores. No ship has come from the west since the last one

sailed from Ros bheag (1 an t-Samhain 1929 DE), and those goods are not sold on the island now.

THE RAW GOODS OF RODOS

GOOD	WHERE IT COMES FROM	MARKET MEASURE
Grain (barley, oats)	Everywhere below the high moors; most in the north coast and the western plain	wain
Timber	The birch and pine hills and the wet woods	pile
Game and venison	Every forest; most in the eastern hills	wain
Hemp	Valley bottoms everywhere; cheapest of all goods in every market	wain
Honey and wax	The heather of the north and the eastern plain; Seann Tarr, Cathair mhòr, Cathair fhada	barrel
Cattle	The birch and pine hills, the north-west and the plain of Caol leathan	head
Sheep and wool	The hills, the northern moors and the outer isles	head
Wine	The birch and pine hills and the oak country; Àth shean and Baile Mòr fhionn	barrel
Fish	The northern and north-western grounds, the eastern narrows, the southern strait	wain
Whale-oil	Drift and hunted whales of the northern waters	barrel
Seal-oil	The skerries of the north-west, and a few places on the southern and eastern shores	barrel
Clay	River banks and shores of the south and west; Dùn fhiadhaich, Ros dhìreach, Àth bheag, Cuan shean	wain
White sand	Cuan ruadh, Ceann mhòr, Inis mhòr and the southern Seann Skell	wain
Dyes	The wet woods and the east; Baile Mòr ruadh, Baile fhiadhaich, Cnoc ghorm, Seann Vell	bag
Salt	The pans of Baile ghorm, Seann Warr, Caol iséal and Àth bheag	bag
Stone and marble	The hills; marble from Baile Mòr dhomhain	pallet
Iron	Bog-iron of the west and north; Àth naomh and Caol iséal	wagon
Copper and tin	The eastern and central hills; Àth fhiadhaich	wagon
Silver	Muileann chìar, and small workings in the Cuan ghlas hills	bar
Gold	The streams below Baile dhìreach and Cnoc dhìreach	bar
Gemstones	The hills of Muileann dhearg and Seann Vell	stone
Amber	The strands of the Hawk bay and the north-west; Cill àrsaidh, Muileann leathan	stone

GOOD	WHERE IT COMES FROM	MARKET MEASURE
Pearls	The mussel beds of the south-eastern shallows	pearl
Furs and hides	The eastern hills; Àth ruadh	pelt
Horses and oxen	The plain of Caol leathan, Baile àrsaidh and the Doire chaol country	head
Dubhan	The works on the spoil-heaps of the hills, and at Seann Skell on the southern coast	barrel
Flax and lin-seed oil	Seann Warr only	bale; the oil by the barrel
Tobacco	The concession farms behind Ceann mhòr only	bag

The vein itself no longer appears in the roll. Ore-fuel from the Sloc Mòr was sold at the fair by the cartload until 22 am Faoilleach 2002 DE, and the western coal seams sold their coal to the north until the Board closed them. The western seams were flooded and capped in 2022 DE, the upper galleries of the Sloc Mòr were closed in 2025 DE, and the few baskets of altar-ore cut each year under the Rite's custody are not sold in any market. Dubhan, the fuel that took the ore's place (19 an t-Ògmhios 2000 DE), is the one wrought good the roll counts among the raw goods. It is made from the spoil of the old workings (1 an t-Iuchar 1990 DE) at the works of Seann Skell on the southern coast and in the east and north (27 an t-Ògmhios 2026 DE). The works sell it by the barrel into the markets for the forges, kilns and glass-houses, which burned charcoal from the hill woods before it, as the charcoal-burners of the eastern woods had burned it since the Age of Sundering (17 an t-Ògmhios 1430 DE). Lamps, engines and lorries buy it at the works' own depots and pumps and at the inns that keep a pump (4 am Màrt 2009 DE), and the wartime tithe on it is taken at the pump by a clerk of the Treasury (29 an Giblean 2020 DE).

Dubhan is also the one good of Rodos sold off the island. In the present year Dubhan, who made the first working fuel, won from the council the right to export it (7 an t-Sultain 2026 DE), the first leave for any good to go beyond the kingdom's waters since the Severance. The export is held to a measure the Treasury sets each year and is loaded only at the quay of Ros dhomhain, where a clerk of the Treasury takes the tithe on every barrel and the custodians of Òrd Bhrìde seal every hold, so that nothing of the vein goes with it. The kingdom's own depots and the Moot's are served first. As of the present year dubhan is exported under that charter, and under no other.

II. The Wrought Goods

Most of the value that passes through the markets is in goods made in the towns rather than in raw goods. In order of value in the last roll they are these.

Salted and smoked food. Salt fish, salt meat and smoked meat are made in almost every town and are the largest trade on the island by value. Salting is as old as the fish-kilns of Seann Mhòr (17 an Giblean 11,516 BDE) and the salt road of the Ancient Age (5 an Dàmhair 5133 BDE); the mining shires have eaten salt fish in the lean season since 355 DE. The biggest salting towns are Cathair mhòr, Dùn ìseal, Seann Dunn and the harbours of the gulf.

Arms and field-guns. The forges of the old vein country, of Àth naomh in the west and of Caol ìseal on the north coast smelt bog-iron and bronze into arms, and a few of them cast field-guns. Every market in the kingdom sells arms back to its towns, where the regiments and fleets raised in An Cogadh Fada are stationed. The trade is recent. It grew from the Crown's contracts for the regiments (20 an t-Ògmhios 2023 DE), and arms are now the dearest common goods in every market. The forge-town of Muileann dhearg, where Uilleam Gobha made the rebels' grenades (17 an Lùnastal 1928 DE), stands in the same hills.

Books, paper and ink. Rodos is a country of copyists. Paper has been made from rags and hemp at Muileann chaol since 1635 DE and at Tobar dhìreach since 1947 DE, and books are bound and sold in more than eighty towns. The largest trade in books is at Dùn ìseal, Cathair dhomhain, Baile Mòr ruadh, Inis àrsaidh and Dùn chrom.

Soap and candles. Soap is boiled from tallow and seal-oil, and candles are dipped from beeswax and tallow, in most towns of the north and the gulf. The wax lights of the ancestor shrines were the first of this trade (26 an Dàmhair 605 DE).

Ships, sails and rope. Seagoing ships are built at nine yards: the two Seann Dunns on the east coast, Inis thais, Seann Skell of the Hawk bay, Ros fhionn, Inis ìseal, Ceann leathan, the royal quays of Cathair dhearg and Inis mhòr. Their sails are cut from hemp cloth in the same towns, and their rope comes from the rope-walks of Baile ghlas and Seann Tarr. The first deep keels since the Sundering were measured from the humans' hulls at Inis mhòr (14 an t-Samhain 1783 DE).

Glass and pottery. Glass is blown from the white sand of Cuan ruadh, Ceann mhòr and the southern Seann Skell in some seventy towns, most of all at Cathair mhòr on the north road, Baile Mòr dhìreach and Seann Vell. The first glass-house on Rodos was built at Baile Mòr dhìreach in 1845 DE. Pottery is older. The red ware of the western road was fired at Baile ghorm and Cnoc àrsaidh in the Holy Age (8 an t-Samhain 81

BDE, 19 an Giblean 79 BDE). Today the largest potteries are at Dùn fhiadhaich, Ros dhìreach and Àth bheag, and Cathair fhada sells their ware to the north.

Cloth, garments and leather. Wool is spun and woven in every sheep country. The chartered weavers are those of Baile chiar (6 am Faoilleach 1944 DE) and the mills of Doire ghlas (27 an Giblean 1988 DE). Hides are tanned at Baile ghorm (13 an t-Iuchar 1991 DE) and Muileann dhomhain (9 an Giblean 1982 DE), and boots and harness are made in most of the market towns.

Scent. Scent waters are distilled from bog-myrtle, meadowsweet and heather honey and sold in small glass flasks. This trade belongs to the capital shore and the western plain: Seann Vell, Caol fhiadhaich, Cnoc àrsaidh, Baile ghlas and Doire shean. It began at Seann Vell in the first years of the restored kingdom (15 an Gearran 1956 DE).

Drink and cheese. Barley spirit, the fire-water of the northern road (15 an Dùbhlachd 327 BDE), is distilled in some forty towns. Ale is brewed for sale only at Ceann chaol, Muileann fhada and Seann Bhral in the south-east. Cheese is made in the cattle towns, most of all at Ceann leathan and Cathair fhada.

Coin. The realm-coin is struck only at the mint at Cathair dhearg (9 an Dàmhair 1934 DE). The blanks it is struck from are refined in the villages of the eastern hills from the silver of Muileann chiar and the gold of Baile dhìreach (19 an t-Sultain 1966 DE), and the Treasury counts those blanks among the goods of the Dùn ìseal market.

III. The Sixteen Market Towns

Every town on Rodos belongs to one of sixteen markets. A town sells its surplus into its market and buys what it lacks there. The market town holds the market-court, weighs goods on the Crown's weights and keeps the clerk of the market-due. Each of the sixteen has a market square, and so do some hundred and seventy lesser towns that hold a weekly market of their own. Only the market towns keep a tithe-clerk.

MARKET TOWN	TOWNS IN ITS REACH	ITS COUNTRY	WHAT ITS TOWNS SELL INTO IT	WHAT IT SENDS TO OTHER MARKETS	MARKET RIGHT
Ceann leathan	52	the gulf and the old vein country	salted food, arms and field-guns, soap, candles, books, glass	nothing	2415 BDE
Cathair dhomhain	31	the capital shore	salted food, scent, glass, books, ships	scent, cattle, horses	1300 BDE
Ros fhionn	53	the north-eastern hills	arms, salted food, field-guns, tools, ships, coin-blanks	nothing	920 DE

MARKET TOWN	TOWNS IN ITS REACH	ITS COUNTRY	WHAT ITS TOWNS SELL INTO IT	WHAT IT SENDS TO OTHER MARKETS	MARKET RIGHT
Seann Skell	47	the Hawk bay and the north-central coast	salted food, soap, ships, candles, books	amber	396 DE
Ros bheag	25	the west coast	salted food, arms, scent, books, pottery	cattle, sheep	854 BDE
Seann Tarr	27	the north-eastern coast	salted food, books, candles, boots	nothing	605 DE
Dùn iséal	47	the eastern hills and plain	salted food, coin-blanks, arms, books	coin-blanks, copper	2443 BDE
Baile Mòr dhomhain	24	the northern hills	arms, salted food, glass, candles	cattle, sheep, venison, marble, horses, glass	1877 BDE
Baile Mòr dhìreach	42	the east coast	salted food, arms, ships, tools, sails	pearls, clay	692 DE
Baile Mòr fhionn	27	the western plain	arms, scent, salted food, books, ships	scent, oxen, lin-seed oil	1300 BDE
Cathair fhada	24	the south	salted food, books, candles, pottery, spirits	pottery	248 DE
Ceann mhòr	28	the north-west coast	arms, salted food, books, tools	amber, arms, seal-oil, dyes, tobacco, whale-oil	1932 DE
Àth fhionn	28	the north coast	salted food, books, candles, garments	nothing	796 DE
Muileann fhionn	24	the north-western interior	books, salted food, soap, candles	cattle, sheep, venison, soap, horses	1938 DE
Cnoc bhàn	17	the south-eastern farms	arms, tools, field-guns, candles, ale	pearls, clay, amber	1012 DE
Caol ruadh	9	the southern strait	arms, glass, salted food, spirits	venison	2022 DE

Ceann leathan is the largest and dearest market on the island. Its reach runs from the gulf shore up into the old vein country of Muileann chrom, Muileann dhearg and Muileann dhomhain, whose forges now make arms where their pits once sent up ore. It became the market of the southern fishing in the Holy Age (16 am Faoilleach 2415 BDE), and its harbour-master's notched tallies are the oldest counted objects in the library. Today the crowds of the Còmhrag keep its prices the highest on Rodos. Grain, timber, honey and wine all cost it nearly twice what they cost on the south coast. It sells nothing to other markets and buys from eight of them: scent from the capital,

amber from the Hawk bay and the north-west, pearls from Cnoc bhàn, cattle, sheep and venison from the northern hills, coin-blanks from Dùn ìseal, oxen and linseed oil from the western plain, and seal-oil, whale-oil and dyes from Ceann mhòr.

Cathair dhomhain is the market of the capital shore: the three harbour towns of Cathair dhomhain, Ros dhomhain and Baile ghlas, the royal precinct of Cathair dhearg, and the farms of Baile chiar and Àth shean behind them. Its right to its own tolls dates from the rivalry with the new royal seat (9 an Giblean 1300 BDE). Its scent-makers and glass-houses make it the chief seller of scent to the rest of the island, and the horses of Doire chaol go from it to three other markets.

Ros fhionn has the most towns of any market, fifty-three, from Muileann chaol and the library in the south to Caol bheag on the north coast. The salt that made the town (3 am Màrt 315 DE, 9 an Lùnastal 920 DE) left it when the harbour silted (29 an t-Ògmhios 1120 DE), but the market-court the salt-masters had set up stayed on the headland (16 an t-Ògmhios 1145 DE), and the hill towns still bring their goods to it. The forge-towns of Baile Mòr uaine and Baile Mòr dhìreach make it the first market in arms. It has no goods of its own to spare for other markets and buys scent, pottery, pearls and amber from them.

Seann Skell of the Hawk bay gathers the north-central coast from Doire ghlas and Muileann leathan to Seann Toll. The amber of its strands has been prized since the Ancient Age (8 an Gearran 6295 BDE), and it is the one good the market sends out, mostly to Ceann leathan. Whale-oil, honey and sheep are its other raw goods. The Tuathaich towns of the Doire ghlas country are in its reach and sell their cloth through it.

Ros bheag is the market of the west coast between Cuan shean and the western Seann Skell. Its harbour court was swearing trade oaths on the scorpion's sting by 854 BDE. Its clay, honey and the bog-iron of Àth naomh are worked into pottery and arms, and its surplus cattle and sheep go north to Seann Skell.

Seann Tarr is the smallest of the northern markets in people. It began as the feast-market of the ancestor shrine (26 an Dàmhair 605 DE) and is still busiest at the great feasts. Honey and wax, the dyes of Baile fhiadhaich and the hemp of Doire uaine and Achadh naomh are its goods. The hemp goes to the rope-makers chartered there in 1982 DE.

Dùn ìseal holds the market of the eastern hills under the old Hall (10 an Dùbhlachd 2443 BDE). Its reach takes in the silver town, the gold stream of Baile dhìreach, the copper-town of Àth fhiadhaich (2 an t-Ògmhios 1990 DE) and the mills of Muileann bhàn and Muileann gheal. It sends coin-blanks and copper to Baile Mòr dhìreach, Ceann leathan and Seann Skell.

Baile Mòr dhomhain is the market of the northern hills (22 an t-Samhain 1877 BDE) and the island's second exporter of livestock. When the ore trade fell away its market day drew more carts than the fair at Muileann òg (30 an t-Sultain 1987 DE). Cattle, sheep, venison, horses, the marble of its hills (29 an Dàmhair 1256 DE) and glass go from it to five other markets.

Baile Mòr dhìreach gathers the east coast from Seann Tarr's southern country to Àth bheag. Its shipyards at the two Seann Dunns build more hulls than any other market's, its glass-houses are the oldest on Rodos (8 an Lùnastal 1845 DE), and the dyers of Baile Mòr ruadh and the furriers of Àth ruadh sell through it. It buys cattle, sheep, horses and coin-blanks from the hill markets.

Baile Mòr fhionn is the chief market of the western plain. Wool was the measure of every bargain there from the Holy Age (12 am Faoilleach 1300 BDE) until the second currency reform (31 an Dàmhair 1865 DE). Its country grows grain, wine and cattle and breeds the island's horses and draught oxen. The old salt-pans of Baile ghorm and Seann Warr and the flax-fields of Seann Warr are in its reach, and its scent-makers send scent to Cathair fhada and Seann Skell.

Cathair fhada is the market of the south. Its charter dates from Queen Sileas's tally-houses (17 an t-Samhain 248 DE), and its merchants have run the fair at Muileann òg since the fair was first held in the restored kingdom (16 an Dàmhair 1950 DE). It sends the pottery of Dùn fhiadhaich north to Ros fhionn and Seann Skell. The Crown grain-store built there in 1962 DE is the reserve of the south.

Ceann mhòr is the market of the Tuathaich north-west. It was chartered when the humans' harbour officers had gone (23 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE), and it keeps its court in the old harbour store. It has the most varied goods of any market: grain, fish, whale-oil and seal-oil (4 an t-Samhain 297 BDE), amber, dyes, the tobacco of the concession farms and the tools of Cathair gheal. It sends out more kinds of goods than any other market and buys none.

Àth fhionn is the market of the north coast from Inis mhòr's country to Caol mhin. The north coast's fish, whales and sheep come to it, and the whale-boats that go out from it learned their trade from the humans (9 an Dùbhlachd 1834 DE). Its own market dates from the Age of Sundering (19 an Gearran 796 DE).

Muileann fhionn began as a fort and mill of the human administration and became a Tuathaich market town after the Severance (12 an Giblean 1938 DE). It is the island's greatest cattle market. Its droves of cattle and sheep go south to Ceann leathan, Cnoc bhàn, Seann Tarr and Caol ruadh, and it buys arms from Ceann mhòr.

Cnoc bhàn is the market of the south-eastern farms above the long mill-race of Muileann fhada (28 an Giblean 1012 DE). It sells pearls, clay and amber to the other

markets. Its forge-towns make tools and field-guns, and its towns are the only ones on Rodos that brew ale for sale.

Caol ruadh is the youngest and smallest market. It was chartered after An Cogadh Fada to victual the garrisons and the second fleet at the southern Seann Skell (26 am Faoilleach 2022 DE). The glass of Seann Skell and the venison of the strait's woods are its goods.

The **Fèill Muileann òg** is not one of the sixteen. It is a yearly fair with a court of its own (14 an t-Samhain 1950 DE), held on the old ford-ground where salt was first traded for wool (10 an Cèitean 6426 BDE). Traders from every shire come to it, and the northern day set aside in 1984 DE is the only place where Tuathaich goods are sold under their makers' own marks.

IV. The Roads of Trade

In the last roll the market-courts recorded 8,058 dealings. In 6,235 of them a market sold goods to one of its towns. In 1,759 a town sold its goods into its market. Only 64 were sales from one market to another. Almost all trade on Rodos is local. The dealings between markets are few, but they carry the goods one country has and another lacks, and six roads stand out.

1. **Livestock south from the northern hills.** The largest trade between markets is in cattle, sheep, horses and venison. It runs from Muileann fhionn, Baile Mòr dhomhain and the capital shore south and east to Ceann leathan, Baile Mòr dhìreach, Seann Tarr, Cnoc bhàn and Cathair fhada. Its drove roads are the ones the drovers of Àth chiar first marked with cairns (29 am Faoilleach 445 DE). The dubhan lorries have now replaced the droves on most of them (22 am Màrt 2008 DE).
2. **Scent from the capital shore and the western plain.** Scent is the costliest good that goes between markets. It goes from Cathair dhomhain and Baile Mòr fhionn to Ceann leathan, Ros fhionn, Seann Skell and Cathair fhada.
3. **Amber, pearls and whale-oil to the gulf.** The luxuries of the coasts go to the dearest market. Amber goes from the Hawk bay and Ceann mhòr, pearls from Cnoc bhàn and Baile Mòr dhìreach, and seal-oil and whale-oil from the north-west, and Ceann leathan takes most of all of them.
4. **Coin-blanks and copper from the eastern hills.** Dùn ìseal sends the blanks of the silver and gold refiners, and the copper of Àth fhiadhaich, to Baile Mòr dhìreach, Ceann leathan and Seann Skell.

5. **Pottery and clay.** Cathair fhada's pottery goes north to Ros fhionn and Seann Skell, and the clay of Cnoc bhàn and Baile Mòr dhìreach goes to the kilns of the north.
6. **Arms from the north-west to the north-western interior.** Ceann mhòr's smiths sell arms to Muileann fhionn, the only road of the arms trade that crosses between markets.

Two things are sold everywhere and seldom carried far: hemp, the cheapest good in every market, and grain. Grain is dearest at Ceann leathan and cheapest at Caol ruadh; hemp is cheapest at Cnoc bhàn.

V. Taxes and the Treasury

The Crown takes two dues, both set by the council in the first weeks of the kingdom (21 am Faoilleach 1933 DE) and collected by the maoir of the shires (Appendix H). The Treasury reckons them in purses of the realm-coin.

The market-due. Seventeen in every hundred of the price is taken on every sale a town makes into its market and on every sale between markets. Sales from a market back to its own towns are not charged. The Treasury fixed the due at that rate after An Cogadh Fada and set a clerk in each of the sixteen market towns to take it and keep the market roll (22 an Cèitean 2023 DE). It is kept apart from the wartime tithe on every sale of dubhan (21 an Giblean 2020 DE), which is still taken at the pumps (29 an Giblean 2020 DE) and which the Treasury carried forward after the war as a line of its own under the regiments' pay (27 an Giblean 2023 DE). In the last roll the towns' sales into their markets were worth about 18,580 purses, the markets' sales back to their towns about 9,700 and the sales between markets about 1,200, and the market-due brought the Treasury 3,193 purses.

The head-due. Each household pays the head-due for every head in it. It was first collected on the count of 1936 DE (27 an t-Sultain 1936 DE) and stands at eighteen purses on every hundred thousand heads. It brought in 6,375 purses in the last roll, two parts in three of the Crown's money.

The Treasury's roll for the present year comes to 9,568 purses (29 an t-Iuchar 2026 DE). The towns' own chests hold about 12,660 purses together, and the towns' yearly product is about 11,460.

Earlier taxes and currencies. The first toll on Rodos was Goraidh Mòr's road-toll of one fish in twenty (22 an t-Sultain 2280 BDE). The silver weights of Muileann chiar gave the carriers' roads a common measure (30 an Dùbhlachd 2457 BDE), and the Hall's clerks first paid in stamped silver rings (20 an Cèitean 1345 BDE). In the Age of

Sundering Queen Sileas fixed the firloft of Cathair dhearg as the measure of grain (11 an Dàmhair 222 DE) and set up the tally-houses, the first account of trade kept across the whole island (22 an t-Sultain 245 DE). Ros fhionn salt was the measure of value in the north-east (3 am Màrt 315 DE), and wool was the measure on the western plain. The humans' mark and its hundred pence were struck at Ros dhomhain (10 an Lùnastal 1796 DE), and three currency reforms pushed barter out (13 an Gearran 1796 DE, 2 an Dàmhair 1865 DE, 7 an Giblean 1908 DE). The Company's tithe on ore rose without any matching return (16 an Gearran 1836 DE) and was extended to grain (4 an Lùnastal 1837 DE). The rebels burned the tithe ledgers (9 an t-Iuchar 1929 DE). The restored kingdom struck its own realm-coin (30 an Giblean 1934 DE) and pegged it to dubhan in 2014 DE.

VI. A Chronology of Trade

- 17 an Giblean 11,516 BDE — the fish-kilns of Seann Mhòr, the first buildings made for a trade.
- 12 an Gearran 6918 BDE — the salt-pans of Baile ghorm.
- 29 an t-Samhain 6393 BDE — the ford gathering at Muileann òg: salt, flint, wool, dried fish and pots.
- 8 an Gearran 6295 BDE — amber from the Hawk bay.
- 5 an Dàmhair 5133 BDE — the salt road to the north-west.
- 28 an t-Ògmhios 2915 BDE — silver for salt at Ros fhionn, the first remembered price.
- 10 an Dùbhlachd 2443 BDE — the market under the Hall at Dùn iséal.
- 16 am Faoilleach 2415 BDE — Ceann leathan's fish-market.
- 22 an t-Sultain 2280 BDE — the first road-toll.
- 22 an t-Samhain 1877 BDE — the market at the fords of Baile Mòr dhomhain.
- 5 an t-Iuchar 1334 BDE — the harvest fair at Muileann òg.
- 12 am Faoilleach 1300 BDE — the fleece-measure of Baile Mòr fhionn.
- 9 an Giblean 1300 BDE — Cathair dhomhain's charter of its own tolls.
- 1 am Faoilleach 854 BDE — the sting-oath of trade at Ros bheag.
- 4 an t-Samhain 297 BDE — seal-oil from Ceann mhòr.
- 11 an Dàmhair 32 BDE — the rope-walks of Cuan shean.

- 22 an t-Sultain 245 DE — Queen Sileas's tally-houses; 17 an t-Samhain 248 DE, the market charter of Cathair fhada.
- 3 am Màrt 315 DE — salt pans at Ros fhionn.
- 28 an Dùbhlachd 396 DE — the market inside the new gate of Seann Skell.
- 5 an Lùnastal 595 DE — the oyster beds of Doire shean; 26 an Dàmhair 605 DE, the feast-market at Seann Tarr.
- 11 an t-Samhain 692 DE — the market of the eastern road at Baile Mòr dhìreach.
- 19 an Gearran 796 DE — the strand-market at Àth fhionn.
- 9 an Lùnastal 920 DE — the great salt fair at Ros fhionn.
- 28 an Giblean 1012 DE — the market above the mill-race at Cnoc bhàn.
- 16 an t-Ògmhios 1145 DE — the market-court stays at Ros fhionn.
- 29 an Dàmhair 1256 DE — marble from Baile Mòr dhomhain.
- 18 an Dàmhair 1480 DE — the cattle fair of Baile Mòr ruadh.
- 1 an Dàmhair 1587 DE — the dark wine of Àth shean.
- 28 am Faoilleach 1635 DE — the paper mill at Muileann chaol.
- 22 an t-Ògmhios 1782 DE — the humans' trading post at Ros dhomhain.
- 18 an Cèitean 1788 DE — the Company chartered.
- 10 an Lùnastal 1796 DE — the mark and its hundred pence.
- 31 an Dàmhair 1831 DE — tobacco on the concession farms.
- 9 an Dùbhlachd 1834 DE — the first whale-boats of Àth fhionn.
- 8 an Lùnastal 1845 DE — the first glass-house, at Baile Mòr dhìreach.
- 7 an Giblean 1908 DE — barter abolished.
- 23 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE — the market charter of Ceann mhòr.
- 21 am Faoilleach 1933 DE — the Crown's dues set: the head-due and the market-due.
- 9 an Dàmhair 1934 DE — the mint at Cathair dhearg.
- 27 an t-Sultain 1936 DE — the head-due first collected.
- 12 an Giblean 1938 DE — the cattle-market at Muileann fhionn.
- 16 an Dàmhair 1950 DE — Fèill Muileann òg.
- 15 an Gearran 1956 DE — the scent-makers of Seann Vell.
- 26 an Cèitean 1961 DE — the salt-pans of Àth bheag.
- 19 an t-Sultain 1966 DE — the eastern blank-houses.

- 2 an t-Ògmhios 1990 DE — the copper-town of Àth fhiadhaich.
- 21 an Giblean 2020 DE — the wartime tithe.
- 26 am Faoilleach 2022 DE — the market charter of Caol ruadh.
- 22 an Cèitean 2023 DE — the market-due fixed at seventeen in the hundred.
- 20 an t-Ògmhios 2023 DE — the regiments' arms contracts.
- 7 an t-Sultain 2026 DE — Dubhan's charter: dubhan exported from Ros dhomhain.

APPENDIX H

The Shires of Rodos

This appendix sets out how Rìoghachd Ròdais is divided and governed: the shires, their seats and how they came to be; the Crown's dues and the Treasury; the windy coast of the far north-west, which no shire holds; and the extent of the island's peoples in the present year. It is drawn from the council's minute-books, the Treasury's rolls, the shire record-chests called in to Leabharlann Muileann chaol (7 am Màrt 1995 DE), and the humans' district surveys the kingdom inherited.

I. The Kingdom

The state styled itself Rìoghachd Ròdais, the Kingdom of Rodos, on 27 an t-Iuchar 1931 DE, and Niall was crowned at Cathair dhearg on 19 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE. It is a monarchy in form. The crown, a royal council of twelve (23 an t-Sultain 1931 DE) and the Treasury sit at Cathair dhearg, and Cathal reigns in the present year. The kingdom counts its years in the Diosal Era, and the present year is 2026 DE (Appendix D).

The kingdom holds every coast of Rodos and every island off it but one stretch of windswept shore in the far north-west (§ V). It has no neighbour but that shore and the sea. Since the crossing closed there has been no other state within reach of its ships (11 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE), and it keeps no envoys and makes no treaties. Its one war has been fought on its own ground, against its own people: An Cogadh Fada, the Long War of 2020 and 2021 (Appendix C). The regiments raised for it were not stood down (13 am Faoilleach 2022 DE).

The kingdom grew along the island's waters, as the island's people always had. Three shire seats in five stand on the sea or on a river, and so do nearly half of all the burgs.

II. How the Shires Came to Be

The provinces of the Holy Age. The first divisions of the island were the rìghrean's, and they were made for grain and roads. The census-takers of Beathag Mhòr worked

from the waypoint houses, since every household on the island was within a day of one (9 an Gearran 1264 BDE). Lachlann Bàn built a granary in every province seat that would take one (16 am Faoilleach 593 BDE), and under Coinneach Bàn the clerks of the red hall copied the rolls for the provinces, so that every seat had its own copy of the laws (27 an Giblean 167 BDE). The Library holds several of those provincial rolls where the originals are lost (24 an t-Ògmhios 121 BDE). Most of the shire seats of the present day were already towns in the Holy Age, and many of them were seats then.

The shires of the Sundering. The word *siorrachd* first appears in the sail-cloth levy, when the weaving households of Siorrachd Baile àrsaidh were asked for cloth for the fleet, reckoned on tally-sticks at the shire seat (9 an t-Samhain 31 BDE). Through that age the shire was the unit in which the crown's measures were kept. The coppice law of Doire fhionn spread shire by shire (14 an t-Iuchar 70 DE); Queen Sileas fixed the firloft of Cathair dhearg so that the shires need not quarrel over baskets (11 an Dàmhair 222 DE); Iain Ciar ordered a year's grain in store at every shire seat (20 an Giblean 1260 DE). Two rulers, Sileas Òg and Gormshuil nic Thormoid, went round every shire seat in person (9 an t-Iuchar 1490 DE, 12 an Giblean 1732 DE). Doire shean became a shire seat on the wealth of its oyster beds (5 an Lùnastal 595 DE), the only raising of a seat in that age that the annals record.

The districts of the humans. The Administration did not use the shires. It governed by districts drawn for the pits, the customs and the Levy, counted the people by district for the first time (19 an Cèitean 1901 DE), and set district seats where its clerks found it convenient: at Cnoc bhàn and at Baile Mòr ruadh on the eastern road, among others. It kept one district that was not land at all. The outer coasts, the islands and the southern edge of the windy coast in the far north-west, where its revenue cutters chased the raiders, were governed from the harbour office at Seann Vell on Eilean ruadh (20 an Giblean 1902 DE). Its surveyors went no farther north-west than the edge of the great moss. Beyond that the district map is blank.

The drawing. On 12 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE the council divided the kingdom into shires, each named for its seat, and kept most of the human district lines under the new names. The humans' surveys were the only complete ones on the island. Where the council did not keep a district seat it chose the old shire seat instead; so in the shire of Seann Tarr the seat went back from Baile Mòr ruadh, the humans' district town, to the old harbour. A *maor* was appointed to each shire to collect the Crown's dues and keep its peace (4 am Faoilleach 1933 DE). In the Tuathaich shires the maor were Ròdaich, lodged in the seat towns. Circuit justices were set to ride among the shires a few years later (23 an Lùnastal 1936 DE).

The drawing made one hundred and twenty-two shires. One more was cut later: Doire chaol, the village of the royal household south of the capital, was taken out of

the shire of Baile chiar once it had grown large enough to need its own maor (18 an Dàmhair 1967 DE). Rìoghachd Ròdais has had one hundred and twenty-three shires since then, and the number has not changed.

III. The Shape of the Shires

Names. A shire takes the name of its seat, and the island's names repeat, so the shires' names repeat too. Eleven names belong to more than one shire. There are three shires of Seann Skell, three of Seann Vell and three of Ceann mhin, and two each of Caol bheag, Àth shean, Baile ghorm, Achadh naomh, Muileann dhearg, Muileann dhomhain, Doire fhionn and Muileann naomh. The rolls tell them apart by where they lie, as the table in § VII does. Thirteen shires are named from the Old Ones' harbours (Appendix F).

The island shires. Two shires have no town at all. Eilean dhìreach, a rock off the Tuathaich coast, and Eilean ìseal, off the east coast, each kept a customs station of the Administration and was a district of its own. The council kept both as shires, having no rule for folding a district into its neighbour, and since neither has a town to name it, each is named for its island (20 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE). They are the only shires on Rodos not named for a seat.

Scattered shires. The shire of Seann Vell of the west is the Administration's district of the outer coasts, kept whole. Its seat is a small harbour on Eilean ruadh off the west coast. Its towns, Cuan dhearg and Cnoc chaol, stand on Eilean bhàn, hard by the southern coast, where the Great Wave struck (3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE). Its largest land is the southern edge of the windy coast in the far north-west, where no town stands and the maor goes by boat. With it goes Eilean ghorm. The shire of Seann Vell of the south-east holds Eilean dhearg, the old island of the dead (Appendix F), with Eilean gheal and Eilean mhin, except for a corner of Eilean dhearg that belongs to Àth fhionn. Caol bheag of the north-east lies on Eilean fhada with Eilean bheag, and Caol mhin on Eilean chrom with Eilean dhubh. On the main island, one town of the shire of Tobar ghorm, Baile gheal, lies apart from the rest.

Seats that are not the largest town. In five shires the seat is smaller than another town in the same shire. Caol leathan, the strait town, is the seat and not Baile Mòr fhionn, the lords' city of the western plain. Baile àrsaidh is the seat and not Seann Bhral of the west coast. Cnoc dhubh of the charcoal-burners is the seat and not Doire fhiadhaich, the citadel village of the same hills. Baile Mòr dhomhain is the seat and not Cuan bheag. Seann Vell of the west is the seat and not Cuan dhearg. In each case the

council kept the seat the humans' district had, or the older shire had, and did not follow the growth of the towns.

The Tuathaich shires. Eleven shires lie wholly or mostly in the Tuathaich north and north-west: Caol mhòr, Ceann mhòr, Doire ghlas, Baile chrom, Cnoc ghorm, Cnoc thais, Àth àrsaidh, Muileann leathan, Muileann àrsaidh, Baile ìseal and the island shire of Eilean dhìreach. Two of them keep one Ròdaich town each: Baile dhubh in Cnoc ghorm, and Achadh fhiadhaich in Muileann àrsaidh. Three Ròdaich shires have one Tuathaich town: Seann Skell of the west has Àth leathan, Muileann naomh of the west has Àth chrom, and Inis mhin on the northern shore has one town of each people. The windy coast in Seann Vell of the west is Tuathaich country too, though the shire's towns are Ròdaich. The boundary stones on the roads north (31 an t-Iuchar 1930 DE) mark where the Tuathaich country begins, not where any shire ends. The Moot at Caol mhòr has no standing in any shire court (25 an Lùnastal 1931 DE).

One kind of shire. Every shire is a *siorrachd*, and the kingdom knows no other kind of division. The capital's shire, the Tuathaich shires, the island shires and the scattered shires have the same standing, the same officer and the same dues. The humans' distinctions of district, concession and Residency ground were dropped at the drawing.

IV. The Crown's Dues and the Treasury

The maor of each shire collects two dues for the Crown, set by the council in the first weeks of the kingdom (21 am Faoilleach 1933 DE). The head-due, *cis-cinn*, is laid on every household by the number of its heads, and so falls on the whole people of the kingdom, in town and country alike. The market-due, *cis-margaidh*, is taken on every sale made by a seller of the kingdom, in a market or out of one. The humans' tariff, which the harbour-masters of Ros dhomhain kept in force for want of another (8 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE), was folded into the market-due when the kingdom's own coin replaced the humans' mark (30 an Giblean 1934 DE).

Beside the two dues the Treasury carries the wartime tithe on every sale of dubhan, laid "for the war" in 2020 DE and never repealed (27 an Giblean 2023 DE), which pays the regiments. The shires keep what the council allows them for their own works: Cnoc leathan paid for a school in every parish from the shire's dues (21 an Giblean 1979 DE), and the shire of Baile ruadh fenced the open shafts at its own cost (3 an Lùnastal 1981 DE). The first relief the kingdom ever granted came from the Treasury: seed for the survivors of Achadh mhin when their fields lay under salt (6 an Dùbhlachd 1933 DE).

The Treasury reckons in purses, *sporain*, of the realm's coin. Its roll for the present year (29 an t-Iuchar 2026 DE) stands as follows:

DUE	RATE	YIELD IN THE PRESENT YEAR
Head-due (<i>cis-cinn</i>)	eighteen purses on every hundred thousand heads	6,375 purses
Market-due (<i>cis-mar-gaidh</i>)	seventeen in the hundred of the price	3,193 purses
The roll		9,568 purses

Two parts in three of the Crown's money come from heads and one from trade. The kingdom counted 35,415,000 heads for the head-due in the present year. The head-due has stood at its rate since it was first collected (27 an t-Sultain 1936 DE), and the market-due at seventeen in the hundred since the Treasury fixed it after the Long War (22 an Cèitean 2023 DE). The windy coast pays neither due, and the roll carries no line for it.

V. The Windy Coast

In the far north-west, beyond the Tuathaich shires and past the northern edge of Seann Vell's lands, lies a low shore of heather moor, blanket bog and bare rock, open to the gales off the north-western sea, that no shire holds. The Ròdaich call it *an Oirthir Ghaothach*, the windy coast. It is a little under two parts in a hundred of the island's land, some 190 square miles, in two pieces: a long stretch of shore, and a small cape to the east of it. Its bays open on the waters where the raiders have sheltered since the Age of Strangers (10 an Giblean 1795 DE, 4 an t-Sultain 1941 DE), and the sea-beast of the north-west cape is reported off it (12 an Màrt 1834 DE, 9 an Gearran 1949 DE).

Why no one holds it. The humans' surveyors stopped at the edge of the great moss, which no chain can cross (20 an Giblean 1902 DE), and when the council drew the shires on the humans' lines it drew nothing where there were no lines. Its minute says only that the windy coast "is not in the survey" (15 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE). No council since has taken it in. There is no ore there, no field and no harbour the kingdom would use. A shire there would need a maor, and a maor there would need the fleet to keep the raiders' bays, and when the raiders came to Cathair gheal the council, asked twice, sent no help (8 an Giblean 1949 DE). The Moot claims no land of its own and has never asked for this.

Who lives there. Tuathaich families keep the windy coast: sealers, fowlers, and herders on the moor's edge, in no town. The kingdom has never counted them. The

Moot’s tallies put them near nine thousand, a figure the royal clerks do not accept. No maor, justice or census clerk has gone there, and they pay no due.

In the Long War. When Cnoc thais fell, some of its holdouts went on past the hills and out onto the windy coast, and the regiments did not follow them beyond the shire line (10 an Lùnastal 2020 DE). The open record of the war names the kingdom’s enemy only as those “of no shire”. The holdouts who came down to the seventh regiment’s posts after Muileann ghlas (10 an Dùbhlachd 2021 DE) came from the hills, and the record does not say whether any came back from the coast.

VI. The Peoples on the Land

The land of Rodos, with its islands, is some 10,900 square miles, of which the shires hold some 10,720. The two living peoples divide it between them roughly as the burgs divide it. The Old Ones hold none of it. Their names remain on thirty burgs and thirteen shires, and no household of theirs is counted anywhere (Appendix F).

PEOPLE	BURGS	SHARE OF THE ISLAND’S LAND	IN THE BURGS	IN THE COUNTRY
Ròdaich	441	some eighty-five parts in a hundred (about 9,220 square miles)	4,411,000	27,224,000
Tuathaich	64	some fifteen parts in a hundred (about 1,680 square miles), of which the windy coast is nearly two	543,000	3,237,000 within the shires; the windy coast uncounted
Seann-Dhaoine	none	none	—	—

The figures are the kingdom’s count for the present year, on which the head-due is laid. The Ròdaich country is the capital’s shire and every shire of the south, the east and the centre. The Tuathaich country is the north and north-west, and its middle lies in the shire of Cnoc ghorm. Together the two peoples number some 35,415,000 within the shires, one in seven of them in a burg.

VII. The Table of Shires

The shires are listed in the order of the council’s roll, which begins with the capital. *Seat founded* gives the age in which the seat town was founded, from the gazetteer. *People of its burgs* gives the people of the shire’s towns; where a shire has towns of both, the number of each.

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
1	Cathair dhearg	Cathair dhearg	1	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The royal shire, the smallest of the great seats; the capital and nothing else
2	Caol leathan	Caol leathan	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Baile Mòr fhionn, the lords' city of the western plain, is larger than the seat; the shire kept the strait town, where the tolls were taken
3	Seann Skell	Seann Skell	7	Ròdaich 6, Tuathaich 1	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The western Seann Skell, the great river port; its one Tuathaich town is Àth leathan, the pit town where the Long War began
4	Seann Skell	Seann Skell	3	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The southern Seann Skell, the fleet harbour and the Rite's house
5	Ros dhomhain	Ros dhomhain	3	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	The Residency stood above the seat in the Age of Strangers
6	Cnoc bheag	Cnoc bheag	9	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The carved stone and the Sixth Regiment
7	Caol mhòr	Caol mhòr	14	Tuathaich	Holy Age	Tuathaich; the Moot meets at the seat (25 an Lùnastal 1931 DE); the boundary stones stand on its southern roads (31 an t-Iuchar 1930 DE)
8	Caol bheag	Caol bheag	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Caol bheag of the Abhainn ghorm
9	Inis bhàn	Inis bhàn	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	White-island river port and Hawk shrines
10	Doire shean	Doire shean	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The oyster trade made the seat rich enough to be a shire seat in the Age of Sundering (5 an Lùnastal 595 DE)
11	Àth shean	Àth shean	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Àth shean of the south
12	Achadh mhòr	Achadh mhòr	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The great granary fields
13	Seann Bhral	Seann Bhral	2	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The south-east's great walled harbour
14	Ceann mhòr	Ceann mhòr	6	Tuathaich	Holy Age	Tuathaich; the maor keeps the old human magistrate's house (4 am Faoilleach 1933 DE)
15	Inis thais	Inis thais	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The shires of the Stone in the south-west count their own people (28 an Lùnastal 1994 DE)

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
16	Dùn thais	Dùn thais	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Dùn thais of the east; the rolls mark it east against the western Dùn thais in the shire of Ros bheag (2 an Gearran 1967 DE)
17	Inis chrom	Inis chrom	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Bent isle harbour and the Fianna's sailors
18	Doire mhin	Doire mhin	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The great grove-village of the north road
19	Doire fhi-adhaich	Doire fhi-adhaich	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Timber for Cathair fhada
20	Baile ghar-bh	Baile ghar-bh	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Rough-town wool market
21	Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Ceann mhin of the south
22	Baile ghlas	Baile ghlas	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Rope-walks and sail-lofts
23	Doire ghlas	Doire ghlas	3	Tuathaich	Age of Sundering	Tuathaich; the heart of the Church in the north; counted from the road (15 an Lùnastal 1936 DE)
24	Cathair mhòr	Cathair mhòr	1	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The great city beside the old out-post
25	Baile ghorm	Baile ghorm	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Baile ghorm of the south
26	Achadh naomh	Achadh naomh	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Achadh naomh of the north-central country
27	Baile Mòr mhòr	Baile Mòr mhòr	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Its first maor held court under the market roof (8 am Màrt 1933 DE)
28	Baile chrom	Baile chrom	1	Tuathaich	Holy Age	Tuathaich; one town only, beside the north-western lighthouse
29	Muileann mhin	Muileann mhin	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The capital's flour mills
30	Caol ghar-bh	Caol ghar-bh	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Boatyards on the rough strait
31	Seann Chwen	Seann Chwen	9	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The Còmhrag is fought at Ceann leathan in this shire
32	Cathair dhomhain	Cathair dhomhain	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Deep-water harbour beside the capital
33	Àth shean	Àth shean	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Àth shean of the centre

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
34	Muileann bhàn	Muileann bhàn	3	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	White mills and citadel of the ore road
35	Dùn ìseal	Dùn ìseal	8	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The great temple of the Old Spir- its, on the hill of Bride's flame
36	Cnoc ghorm	Cnoc ghorm	6	Ròdaich 1, Tuathaich 5	Holy Age	Tuathaich but for one Ròdaich town, Baile dhubh; the middle of the Tuathaich country lies in this shire
37	Cnoc leathan	Cnoc leath- an	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The first shire to open a school in every parish, from the shire's dues (21 an Giblean 1979 DE)
38	Cuan shean	Cuan shean	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The fourth fleet's harbour
39	Àth chiar	Àth chiar	3	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	The rebels' keep and southern cattle-market
40	Doire fhada	Doire fhada	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Ship-timber and the fenced oak
41	Achadh naomh	Achadh na- omh	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Achadh naomh of the north-east
42	Muileann dhearg	Muileann dhearg	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Muileann dhearg by Cathair mhòr
43	Baile ghorm	Baile ghorm	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Baile ghorm of the south-east, the market of its shire
44	Dùn chrom	Dùn chrom	7	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The citadel above Muileann ghlas
45	Ros gheal	Ros gheal	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The Hawk houses' birth-rolls (10 an Dùbhlachd 1994 DE)
46	Cill dhìreach	Cill dhìreach	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Chapel-town of the Ceann leath- an melee
47	Doire chiar	Doire chiar	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Disputations under the oaks
48	Caol shean	Caol shean	9	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The great eastern river port, pil- grims' landing
49	Cathair fhada	Cathair fhada	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Merchants of the Fèill Muileann òg
50	Baile mhin	Baile mhin	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Sheltered river quays of the north- east
51	Seann Skell	Seann Skell	4	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	Seann Skell of the Hawk bay

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
52	Baile chiar	Baile chiar	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Market of the capital's southern country
53	Cnoc mhòr	Cnoc mhòr	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Cattle market below Cathair mhòr
54	Tobar fhi-adhaich	Tobar fhi-adhaich	7	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Wild spring and moorland grazing
55	Ros gharbh	Ros gharbh	3	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	The gulf's fishing fleet
56	Tobar ghorm	Tobar ghorm	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	One town, Baile gheal, lies apart from the rest of the shire, cut off by the shire of Muileann bheag
57	Àth fhi-adhaich	Àth fhi-adhaich	1	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Wild ford of the eastern road, in the south-eastern hills
58	Baile chaol	Baile chaol	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Terraced houses and the valley toll
59	Muileann dhomhain	Muileann dhomhain	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Muileann dhomhain of the south-east
60	Seann Tarr	Seann Tarr	7	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The humans' district seat was Baile Mòr ruadh; the kingdom set the seat back at the old harbour. The shire's chest was burned rather than sent (7 am Màrt 1995 DE)
61	Achadh shean	Achadh shean	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The twelve wells of the drove road (6 an t-Samhain 1972 DE)
62	Muileann shean	Muileann shean	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The oldest mill-wheel in the north
63	Tobar dhearg	Tobar dhearg	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The southern lighthouse and red well
64	Baile àr-saidh	Baile àr-saidh	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The sail-cloth levy was reckoned at the seat (9 an t-Samhain 31 BDE); Seann Bhral of the west coast, in this shire, is a little larger than the seat
65	Cuan ghlas	Cuan ghlas	7	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The grey river port and its citadel
66	Doire fhionn	Doire fhionn	7	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Doire fhionn of the east
67	Doire chaol	Doire chaol	2	Ròdaich	New Age	Cut from the shire of Baile chiar in 1967 DE, the only shire made after the drawing
68	Seann Toll	Seann Toll	4	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	Sea-caves and the north-coast her-ring

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
69	Baile ru- adh	Baile ruadh	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Red-earth fields of the east
70	Àth bheag	Àth bheag	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	East-coast ford under pirate watch
71	Ceann àr- saidh	Ceann àr- saidh	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Ancient headland on the capital's river road to the east
72	Caol fhi- adhaich	Caol fhi- adhaich	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Strait-pilots and the harbour wolf- stone
73	Baile fhi- adhaich	Baile fhi- adhaich	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	West-coast market harbour
74	Seann Vell	Seann Vell	3	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	Seann Vell of the capital's east
75	Cnoc thais	Cnoc thais	4	Tuathaich	Holy Age	Tuathaich; taken in the Long War (2 an Lùnastal 2020 DE)
76	Muileann chrom	Muileann chrom	11	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The overseers' town; the stoppage began here (27 am Màrt 1922 DE)
77	Ros bheag	Ros bheag	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Citadel harbour of the western coast
78	Cnoc àr- saidh	Cnoc àr- saidh	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Shrines of the Stone and the pan- ther watch
79	Inis bheag	Inis bheag	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Boatyards of the small isle
80	Àth fhionn	Àth fhionn	1	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Holds a corner of Eilean dhearg, whose larger part lies in the south- eastern Seann Vell
81	Achadh àr- saidh	Achadh àr- saidh	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The river quays that feed the capit- al
82	Cuan ru- adh	Cuan ruadh	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The island's easternmost harbour
83	Seann Bhrenn	Seann Bhrenn	2	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The northern Seann-Dhaoine har- bour
84	Cnoc shean	Cnoc shean	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Old hill market of the granary fields
85	Dùn dhearg	Dùn dhearg	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Red hill-fort city of the east
86	Àth àr- saidh	Àth àrsaidh	8	Tuathaich	Holy Age	Tuathaich; the truce of the Sever- ance was made at the seat (2 an t- Samhain 1929 DE)
87	Cnoc dhìreach	Cnoc dhìreach	2	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	Walled seat of the mining district

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
88	Muileann leathan	Muileann leathan	6	Tuathaich	Holy Age	Tuathaich; the high pastures (3 an Dùbhlachd 282 BDE)
89	Achadh chaol	Achadh chaol	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Narrow barley fields
90	Muileann dhomhain	Muileann dhomhain	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Muileann dhomhain of the central country
91	Inis mhin	Inis mhin	2	Ròdaich 1, Tuathaich 1	Age of Sundering	Ròdaich and Tuathaich, one town each
92	Caol iséal	Caol iséal	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Salt pans of the low strait
93	Cnoc na- omh	Cnoc na- omh	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The priests who buried Muileann ghlàs's dead
94	Àth ghlàs	Àth ghlàs	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Grey ford below the ruined out-post
95	Seann Warr	Seann Warr	1	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The Fifth Regiment's walled harbour
96	Muileann dhearg	Muileann dhearg	4	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	Baile thais, in this shire, holds a shire court of its own (6 an Lùnastal 1941 DE)
97	Àth dhomhain	Àth dhom- hain	3	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	The citadel seat since the troubles before the Severance
98	Inis mhòr	Inis mhòr	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	North-eastern river fleet and debating halls
99	Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Ceann mhin of the north-east
100	Seann Dunn	Seann Dunn	4	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The Seann-Dhaoine harbour-mole
101	Ceann leathan	Ceann leathan	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Broad headland harbour of the east
102	Cnoc gheal	Cnoc gheal	6	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The white hill market of the north-east
103	Muileann bheag	Muileann bheag	9	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Flour for the north-east harbours
104	Ceann bheag	Ceann bheag	4	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Citadel harbour of the north-east

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
105	Muileann àrsaidh	Muileann àrsaidh	11	Ròdaich 1, Tuathaich 10	Holy Age	Tuathaich but for one Ròdaich town; the northern concession (3 an t-Samhain 1799 DE); the seat is the elder of the two Muileann àrsaidh
106	Cill thais	Cill thais	3	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Wardens of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag
107	Baile ìseal	Baile ìseal	4	Tuathaich	Age of Sundering	Tuathaich
108	Baile gheal	Baile gheal	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	White cloth of the western plain
109	Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Ceann mhin of the south-east, rival of Ceann chaol
110	Cnoc dhubh	Cnoc dhubh	17	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	The seat is the charcoal-burners' Cnoc dhubb; Doire fhiadhaich, the citadel village, is larger; a second Cnoc dhubb, the walled market, lies in the shire
111	Baile Mòr dhomhain	Baile Mòr dhomhain	13	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Cuan bheag, the river mooring, is a little larger than the seat
112	Muileann chiar	Muileann chiar	5	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	Ore mills of the eastern district
113	Doire fhionn	Doire fhionn	5	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Doire fhionn of the north; the coppice law began here (14 an t-Iuchar 70 DE)
114	Cnoc bhàn	Cnoc bhàn	9	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The seat was a district seat of the Administration
115	Àth mhòr	Àth mhòr	2	Ròdaich	Holy Age	Walled great ford of the north
116	Muileann naomh	Muileann naomh	2	Ròdaich	Age of Sundering	Muileann naomh of the south
117	Muileann naomh	Muileann naomh	7	Ròdaich 6, Tuathaich 1	Holy Age	Muileann naomh of the west; one Tuathaich town
118	Caol bheag	Caol bheag	1	Ròdaich	Holy Age	The second Caol bheag, on Eilean fhada, with Eilean bheag
119	Caol mhin	Caol mhin	1	Ròdaich	Holy Age	On Eilean chrom, with Eilean dhubb

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	BURGS	PEOPLE OF ITS BURGS	SEAT FOUN- DED	NOTES
120	Seann Vell	Seann Vell	3	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	The shire of the outer coasts: its seat on Eilean ruadh off the west coast, Eilean bhàn with Cuan dhearg and Cnoc chaol in the south, Eilean ghorm, and the southern edge of the windy coast in the far north-west
121	Seann Vell	Seann Vell	1	Ròdaich	Ancient Age (Old Ones)	Seann Vell of the south-east: Eilean dhearg, Eilean gheal and Eilean mhin
122	Eilean dhìreach	— (the is- land Eilean dhìreach)	0	Tuathaich (no town)	—	An island shire with no town, named for its island
123	Eilean ìseal	— (the is- land Eilean ìseal)	0	Ròdaich (no town)	—	An island shire with no town, named for its island

APPENDIX I

The Land and Waters of Rodos

This appendix describes the ground the history happened on: the size and shape of the island, its countries and what covers them, the central mountains and the lesser hills, the rivers and their courses, Loch chrom, the offshore islands, the climate, and the sea and its mist. The measurements are those of the humans' surveys, which the council kept when it drew the shires, and the heights are the surveyors' heights above the sea. Where the annals record a change in the land, the date is given.

The island

Rodos is a little over two hundred miles from the capes of the far north-west to the eastern cape, and nowhere much more than a hundred miles from the north coast to the south. The main island covers about eleven thousand square miles. Twelve small islands lie off its coasts, and the largest of them is under seventeen square miles. One sea surrounds all of it, and the Ròdaich call it by one name on every coast, north and south: *Muir Mhanannain*, Manannan's sea, for the lord of the sea whose mist lay on it and hid the island from every ship beyond until the humans came out of the west (13 am Faoilleach 1780 DE, 5 an Gearran 1780 DE).

The coasts differ from one another. The north coast is long and broken, cut by straits and sounds into headlands and near-islands, and most of the places named *Caol* (strait), *Ros* (headland) and *Ceann* (point) lie along it. Its one wide bay is the Hawk bay, shared by Ros gheal, Ros leathan and Seann Skell. The south coast is shorter and more sheltered. Its great inlet is the gulf, which the Abhainn uaine reaches at Cathair mhòr and whose mouth Ros bhàn guards from its white headland. On the west coast the Abhainn gheal comes down to the sea at Inis thais and Caol leathan, and every boat bound for the capital's waters passes between them. The east coast runs from the eastern narrows round the eastern cape, where the light of Baile ìseal stands (Taigh-solais Baile ìseal).

The sea has taken land more than once. In the Ancient Age it rose over the low neck that joined Eilean dhubh to the main island (13 an t-Iuchar 12,418 BDE). A storm

drove it over the harbour of Seann Chwen (18 an Dùbhlachd 2120 BDE), and in the first years of the new kingdom the Great Wave came in over the southern coast in a single night (3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE).

The countries and what covers them

About two parts in five of Rodos is open moor, heather, bog and short grass with no trees on it except in the valleys. Three parts in ten are birch and pine. A fifth is wet woodland of oak, alder and hazel. Something under a tenth is the drier oak woods of the east and the capital's country. The fens, the grass plateau of Dùn dhearg and the rough grazing at the north-western end of the shire of Seann Vell make up the rest.

The northern moors. The whole northern third of the island, from the Tuathach country in the north-west to the harbours of the north-east, is low moor, most of it under a hundred and fifty feet. The winters there are long, wet and windy, snow lies on the moor for days at a time and on the higher ground for weeks, and the summers are short and dry. Trees grow only in the sheltered valleys. The groves that give so many northern villages their *Doire* names are some of these: oak, birch and hazel in the hollows, with bog and heather between them. The pollen in the bog under Doire ghlais shows that the oak came to these lowlands after the cold years (11 an Lùnastal 12,546 BDE), and that it fell back again when the winters lengthened (19 an t-Sultain 4013 BDE). The groves have stood in the valleys ever since. The moor is sheep country. It keeps the wool fairs of Tobar ghorm and Baile gharbh, the peat banks of Achadh gharbh and Cnoc dhubh, and barley and oats in every hollow that will take them. The north's largest towns are all on the coast or close to it: Caol mhòr, Doire ghlais, Baile Mòr mhòr on its northern plain (13 an t-Sultain 4985 BDE), and the harbours of the Hawk bay.

The windy coast. At the far north-western horn of the island the moor gives out onto an *Oirthir Ghaothach*, the windy coast, about a hundred and ninety square miles that no shire holds, and onto the rough grazing at the northern end of Seann Vell's shire beside it. It is the barest ground on Rodos: low heather moor and blanket bog with no tree on it, open to the gales off the north-western sea, which have kept it bare since the oak came to the rest of the island (22 an Lùnastal 12,473 BDE). Behind the shore lies the great moss, bog that no cart and no surveyor's chain can cross. The shore itself has seal-rocks, skerries and fowling cliffs, and sea mist lies on it for days together in summer. The windy coast keeps about nine thousand people, sealers, fowlers and herders, in no town, and the northern end of Seann Vell's shire about twice as many.

The birch and pine country. South of the moors a broad belt of birch and pine crosses the island from the western plain to the eastern hills, rising from under two hundred feet in the west to the skirts of the central mountains. It is the largest single stretch of woodland on Rodos, with hill pasture in its clearings. The Abhainn ìseal runs through the middle of it, past Inis bhàn and Cnoc bheag, and the western hills rise at its south-western edge.

The central mountains. East of the middle of the island the ground rises into the central mountains, a single massif about seventy miles from west to east and thirty-five from north to south, from the hills behind the capital's country to the eastern foothills. The Doire uaine hills are its heart. The highest ground stands a little under three thousand six hundred feet, above Muileann gheal. Dùn ìseal, where the flame was kept, stands at about two thousand six hundred feet under the summit ridge (28 an t-Ògmhios 2995 BDE), and the silver town of Muileann chiar at nearly three thousand. The vein lies under this massif. The crack at Tobar dhìreach is at about two thousand six hundred feet, and the high valleys round it, where the first hearths lie under the turf at Achadh dhìreach, are the oldest settled ground in the record (16 an Cèitean 12,621 BDE). The high ground is birch and pine below and bare moor above. Snowfields lay on the summits in the cold years (14 an t-Ògmhios 12,697 BDE), and snow still lies late on the high passes in a hard spring (13 an Giblean 527 BDE). The warm springs below Muileann ruadh (Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh) come up on the south-eastern side of the massif. On the eastern shoulder, round Dùn dhearg and Cnoc ghlas, is the only open grassland on the island, a dry plateau between fifteen hundred and two thousand feet in the lee of the mountains. It is the eastern plain of the annals (7 an Lùnastal 3830 BDE), and its granaries fed the mountain districts in hard years (19 am Màrt 2565 BDE, 15 an Dùbhlachd 526 BDE). The ground in the massif has moved in every age, most of all in the hills round Cill ghlas east of the capital.

The lesser hills. The hills east of the capital, the country of Muileann chrom and Cill ghlas, are the western foothills of the massif. The towns there stand between a thousand and thirteen hundred feet, with higher ground behind them. The western hills are low: round Àth leathan, where the road from the south enters them, and north to Muileann àrsaidh and Cnoc thais, they rarely rise above four hundred feet, but they are broken, wooded and easy to hide in, as the holdouts found (11 an Giblean 2020 DE).

The capital's country. Around Cathair dhearg and Loch chrom the land is low and fertile, under wet oak woods to the west and south and drier oak woods to the east. The capital itself stands on a low rise above the water (23 am Màrt 1300 BDE).

The wet west. West of the lake and along the west coast the woods are wet oak, alder and hazel, and the island's largest fens lie behind the coast from Muileann naomh

north to Baile fhiadhaich and Muileann àrsaidh. The heath of the west is wet heath on thin soil, good for goats and not worth ploughing (31 am Màrt 2400 BDE). With the south, this coast has the most rain on the island.

The south. The south coast from Inis chrom to Seann Bhral is the warmest and wettest part of Rodos, almost all of it wet woodland. Behind Baile ghorm lie the fens of the south-west, whose marsh plants gave the dyers of Baile ghorm their blue, and whose salt-pans the Stone Kings fought over (9 am Faoilleach 6929 BDE).

The eastern oak country. From the eastern foothills of the massif to the east coast the woods are broad-leaved and the ground is drier: oak and hazel with pasture between, and the best cattle ground on the island. The Black Wind came in on this coast (1 an Gearran 5184 BDE).

The rivers

A hundred and fifty-seven rivers and streams are named on Rodos. A hundred and fifteen are rivers in their own right. The rest are forks and branches that join a larger river, and creeks, brooks and streams too short to carry a boat. The larger rivers are all called *Abhainn* with a describing word after it, and the small ones take the endings *-as* and *-eas*. The describing words are few, so the names repeat: there are three rivers called *Abhainn ìseal* and three called *Abhainn naomh*, and the record names each by the towns on it. Most of the rivers are short. They rise in the central mountains or the moors and reach the sea within a day or two's walk.

Abhainn ìseal, the longest river on Rodos, about fifty-three miles. It rises in the northern foothills of the massif near Àth ghlais, at about seven hundred and forty feet, and runs north-west through the birch and pine country past Cuan bheag, Inis bhàn, the river-island of Inis ìseal, Cnoc bheag and Ceann òg, to the north coast below Ros gheal. It settled into its present wide bed in the Ancient Age (2 an t-Ògmhios 12,233 BDE), the dawn-burning of the Hawk went up it from the coast (28 am Faoilleach 927 BDE), and it last broke its banks along its lower reach in 1963 DE.

Abhainn fhionn, about forty-five miles. It rises in the east near Baile chrom, at about nine hundred and fifty feet, and runs west past Ceann àrsaidh, Cuan chrom, Muileann mhin, Inis mhòr, Cuan uaine and Achadh àrsaidh into Loch chrom at Cathair dhomhain. It is the capital's river road to the east. Its shallows had the first made crossing of any river on the island (15 am Màrt 3973 BDE), and King Tormod Bàn's sons drowned in it in spate (18 an t-Ògmhios 495 DE).

Abhainn uaine, about forty miles. It rises in the central mountains near Doire mhòr and runs south past Ceann fhada, Baile thais, the landing of Cidhe Beag (Cidhe

Beag), Seann Toll, Cuan dhearg and Ros bhàn to the gulf at Cathair mhòr. Meltwater off the mountains cut its bed (14 an t-Ògmhios 12,697 BDE), and the washing of the Company's ore upstream silted it black (27 am Faoilleach 1812 DE).

Abhainn chaol, about thirty-four miles. It rises high in the massif near Baile dhìreach, at nearly three thousand feet, and runs east to the sea below Seann Dunn. Its fork, the eastern Abhainn ìseal, joins it below Caol shean. The river towns of Ros fhionn, Ceann ghorm and the river-island of Inis uaine stand on it. It is fast and dangerous in the wet season (10 an t-Ògmhios 3921 BDE).

Abhainn gheal, the northern, about thirty-one miles. It rises in the massif near Àth gharbh and runs north to the north coast near Muileann fhada.

Abhainn dhomhain, the capital's river, about thirty miles. It rises in the low country south of the capital near Baile ìseal and runs north past Àth fhiadhaich and Doire chaol to Cathair dhearg, where Drochaid Cathair dhearg (Drochaid Cathair dhearg) crosses it. A little below the capital it joins the Abhainn gheal under Loch chrom. Its fords took the carriers in the Holy Age (3 an Gearran 2845 BDE), and the grain barges came down it to the capital (3 an Giblean 2 BDE).

Abhainn naomh, the western, about thirty miles. It rises on the low ground of the west near Achadh gheal and runs past Inis àrsaidh, Seann Skell and Àth chrom to the sea at Ros àrsaidh. After the Abhainn gheal it carries more water than any river on the island, and its deep pool at Seann Skell made that town the great river port of the west (1 an t-Iuchar 11,994 BDE).

Abhainn gheal, the lake river, about twenty-four miles. It is the outflow of Loch chrom. It leaves the lake by Seann Warr and runs short, deep and slow past Baile ghlas to the sea between Inis thais and Caol leathan. It carries more water than any other river on Rodos, and sea-going hulls can come up it into the lake (21 an t-Iuchar 1782 DE). The pilots of Caol leathan have taken a toll on it since the Holy Age.

Abhainn ghorm, the north-eastern, about twenty-seven miles. It rises in the northern massif and runs north past Inis mhòr and Caol bheag to the sea at Ros chiar, and the north-eastern grain went down it in barges (4 am Faoilleach 115 DE).

The mountain rivers of the south. The Abhainn mhòr, Abhainn dhubh, Abhainn bhàn and Abhainn chiar all rise high in the massif and fall south to the south coast in twenty miles or less. The Abhainn gheal of the east joins the Abhainn bhàn at Ceann bhàn. They rise fast after rain on the eastern hills (26 an Cèitean 124 BDE).

The rivers of the north-east. The Abhainn bheag rises below the library at Muileann chaol and runs north-east past Ros fhionn of the old bridge and Inis bheag to the sea at Caol chrom. The north-eastern Abhainn naomh runs past Ceann dhomhain to the library's landing at Ceann mhin.

Loch chrom

Loch chrom is the island's only lake of any size (24 am Faoilleach 1978 DE). It lies in the low country just north of the capital, about seventy-four square miles of fresh water. The Abhainn fhionn and the lesser Abhainn ìseal come into it from the east, the lesser Abhainn naomh from the north, and a dozen streams from the moors. Its one outflow is the Abhainn gheal.

The lake is the capital's harbour. The towns of the capital shore stand round its southern and western edge: Cathair dhomhain at the mouth of the Abhainn fhionn, Ros dhomhain, Seann Vell, Doire fhiadhaich, Doire fhada, Baile ghlas, and Seann Warr on the western shore, where brine springs rise in the reed marsh behind the town. Ceann gheal stands on the northern shore. Sea-going ships reach the lake from the west coast by the Abhainn gheal, and the lake towns have fitted, loaded and built ships for the capital since the Holy Age.

The lake rises and falls with the seasons. The keepers at Ros dhomhain began to cut its high-water line on a boulder in the harbour mouth in the Ancient Age (26 an Gearran 5893 BDE), and the rock is still called the tide-rock, though Loch chrom has no tide. By the end of that age the lake stood a hand higher on the rock than at the first cut (10 am Màrt 5854 BDE). The oldest works on the lake are the platforms on oak piles in its shallows (7 am Màrt 11,354 BDE), which burned to the waterline (24 an Cèitean 6076 BDE). Its trout were kept for the Crown's table until 1978 DE.

The islands

ISLAND	WHERE	SQUARE MILES	IN THE RECORD
Eilean ghorm	off the west coast	17	Pine and fen; the grey geese winter there and are never hunted (3 an Lùnastal 9112 BDE)
Eilean bhàn	off the south coast	16	Wet woodland; the towns of Cuan dhearg and Cnoc chaol, struck by the Great Wave (3 an t-Ògmhios 1933 DE)
Eilean gheal	off the south-east coast	10	Fen; no town
Eilean fhada	off the north coast	7	The elder Caol bheag on the northern strait; the eight wind-names cut on its high point (24 an Cèitean 5477 BDE)
Eilean dhearg	off the south-east coast	7	The town of Seann Vell; the Seann-Dhaoine rowed their dead here (4 an Cèitean 11,834 BDE)
Eilean mhin	off the south coast	5	Fen; the first seal-hunters' camps (1 an t-Iuchar 12,373 BDE); crossed by the Great Wave (1 an Giblean 1934 DE)

ISLAND	WHERE	SQUARE MILES	IN THE RECORD
Eilean chrom	off the north coast	5	Caol mhin, the harbour of Baile Mòr mhòr; Gilleasbuig Beag's exile (10 an t-Ògmhios 3228 BDE)
Eilean bheag	off the north-east coast	4	Moor; no town
Eilean dhubh	off the north coast	3	Cut off from the main island by the rising sea (13 an t-Iuchar 12,418 BDE); first voyage round it (31 an Màrt 2602 BDE)
Eilean ìseal	off the east coast	2	Given to the dead of the south-east coast (30 an Dùbhlachd 3231 BDE)
Eilean dhìreach	off the Tuatha-ich coast	2	Moor; no town
Eilean ruadh	off the west coast	2	The town of Seann Vell; summer grazing (26 an Cèitean 208 BDE)

Sliochd Raghnaill's boats made the round of the offshore islands in a single season (27 an Giblean 223 BDE). Besides these twelve there are skerries, tidal islets and river-islands too small for the surveyors' charts. Inis mhin, Inis naomh and Inis bheag of the north coast stand on tidal islets, and Inis mhòr, Inis ìseal, Inis uaine, Inis chrom and Inis leathan on islands in their rivers.

The climate

Rodos is a mild, wet and windy island for its northern place, with cool summers and winters that are seldom hard. At sea level the year averages about forty-eight degrees of the humans' scale on every coast, a little more on the south coast than on the north, and the harbours do not freeze. The cold is in the height. The towns of the hills east of the capital, at about a thousand feet, average near forty-four; Dùn ìseal, under the summit ridge, near thirty-nine; and the summits of the massif near thirty-six. Snow lies on the high tops and the high passes through the winter and on the northern moors for days at a time, and frost is common inland from the first of an t-Samhain to the end of the spring. Winter is the long season in the north, and it is a season of gales more than of frost: a gale that drove the sea up the river before the grain fleet had sailed was remembered at Inis mhòr for generations (2 an Dàmhair 1190 DE).

The rain comes in off the western ocean. The west coast and the south get the most, and the fens lie there. The central mountains take much of what is left, so the eastern plateau and the northern moors lie in their lee and are dry. The north has springs that never fail, and the towns built round them are remembered for it (13 an t-Sultain 4985 BDE), because its summers can go without rain. Droughts come to the

east: the springs of Achadh shean failed in the Ancient Age (8 an Giblean 5595 BDE), and the Long Drought lay over the island for three years in the Age of Strangers (25 an Lùnastal 1885 DE). The storm season comes at the end of the year, and the oldest law on Rodos was written for it (7 an Cèitean 5273 BDE).

The sea and the mist

Muir Mhanannain is a grey, short-tempered sea. The gales come in off it from the west and north-west, most of all between Samhain and the spring, and sea mist lies on the coasts in still weather, thickest on the north and north-west in early summer. The hunters of the north shore took seals on the skerries off Eilean fhada in the autumn gales in the Ancient Age (30 an t-Sultain 12,313 BDE), and the whale-boats of the north coast still go out in summer. The northern passage is dangerous in winter. After a Company brig was driven onto the skerries off Eilean fhada in mist and a spring gale (13 an t-Sultain 1834 DE), it was held closed from midwinter to the end of spring.

Beyond the headlands to the west lay Manannan's own mist. The Ròdaich tell that the fleet of the Sundering sailed into it (19 an Giblean 1 DE), and the order of Manannan teaches that he shut the western sea behind the fleet with it and hid the island from every ship beyond (Appendix B; 1 an t-Sultain 615 DE). The priests of Manannan recorded it thinning in the last years of the Age of Sundering (27 an Dàmhair 1774 DE), and it lifted in the winter of the Crossing, when the humans' ships came out of it (13 am Faoilleach 1780 DE). Since the Severance no ship has come from the west, and the priests say the lord of the sea has shut it again (11 an t-Ògmhios 1932 DE).

There is no lasting ice on Rodos. The snowfields that lay on the central mountains in the cold years have been seasonal since the oak came (14 an t-Ògmhios 12,697 BDE), and the snow of the high tops is gone by the summer.

APPENDIX J

The Arms of Rodos

This appendix sets down the arms of the kingdom, of its hundred and twenty-three shires and of its towns, as Clàr nan Suaicheantas, the roll of arms kept by the council and copied to Leabharlann Muileann chaol, records them. It gives each shire's arms in full, the arms of the capital and of the great cities, and an account of the town arms by kind. Where the record says what a charge means, or when and why it was granted, this appendix says so. Where it does not, the arms are given and nothing more is claimed.

I. How Rodos came by its arms

Signs before arms. Rodos had carved signs long before it had arms. The oldest is the hawk over a door at Àth mhòr, older than any rite (13 an Dùbhlachd 5748 BDE). The road-guards of Caol leathan swore on a white stone carved as a wolf (12 am Faoilleach 1990 BDE). At Seann Vell a scorpion was cut in yellow stone for worship (4 an t-Samhain 150 BDE), and the harbours of the order of the Stone still line their quays with wolf-head posts. These are the signs of the orders and of towns. None of them was borne on a shield, and none of them is a grant.

The custody's seal. The first arms on the island were the seal of the vein-house above Muileann dhearg: a trellis of gold on blue with a hollow lozenge, the mascle, laid over it. The custodians read the trellis as the galleries of the mountain and the mascle as the slab laid over the first break (19 am Màrt 12,773 BDE). No roll says when the seal was first cut. When the crown and the custody were joined, the king's letters were sealed with it, and the crown added only a white band across the field (1 an t-Ògmhios 826 DE). Those are the arms of the kingdom still. The seven houses of custody sealed with the custody's seal and kept no badges of their own that the record knows.

Under the humans. The Residency and the Company sealed with their own devices, and the custody's seal went out of use. The Administration's district seals were cut in the humans' manner, on a shield with a rounded foot.

The roll of arms. When the council drew the shires (12 an Dùbhlachd 1932 DE) and set a maor over each (4 am Faoilleach 1933 DE), every maor needed a seal for his

court. The council's clerks made the roll of arms for them (2 an Gearran 1933 DE). The kingdom's arms were cut again from the custody's seal, and each shire was given arms of its own. The Ròdaich shires took the pointed wedge of the custody's seal. The Tuathaich shires kept the heater of the district seals they had used before, and every Tuathaich town has kept it since. Many of the charges on the roll were drawn from a book of arms left at the Residency, as the shire lines were drawn from the humans' surveys. That is why lions, parrots, dragons and crocodiles stand on the seals of shires where no one has ever seen one.

The town arms. The clerks of the first chronicle circuit copied the seal of every town they visited into the roll (2 an Giblean 1948 DE), and from then on the roll held the arms of all five hundred and five places. In the north most of the arms were copied from the humans' old town seals, because few Tuathaich would show the clerks their own.

Changes since. The roll has been changed once at an order's asking. The Hawk houses of Siorrachd Cnoc bheag, having seated their own custodian, asked for a hawk on the shire's arms, and the council granted it (29 an t-Samhain 1964 DE). The coinage seal lost its obsidian ink (3 an t-Ògmhios 2014 DE), but the arms on it were not changed, and the high custodian's protest was about the ink (31 an t-Iuchar 2014 DE).

II. How the arms are read

The arms are given here in plain heraldic English. The field is named first, then any partition, then the ordinaries (the broad bands and crosses), then the charges. The colours are:

TINCTURE	COLOUR
Or	gold or yellow
argent	silver or white
gules	red
azure	blue
sable	black
vert	green
purpure	purple
sanguine	blood-red

Trellised is the custody's trellis. A *mascle* is a lozenge with its middle cut away, the hollow stone. A shield is a wedge unless the entry says otherwise. Where a shire's name is shared with another shire, the entry names the part of the island it lies in.

III. The arms of the kingdom

Rìoghachd Ròdais. *Azure trellised Or, a fess cotised argent, over all a mascle argent.*

The trellis and the mascle are the custody's. The fess, a white band between two thin ones, is the crown's addition at the joining (1 an t-Ògmhios 826 DE). Macha's order had been the court's order for four centuries before the joining (31 an Dùbhlachd 402 DE), and no king put her horses on the seal. The house of Òrd Mhacha at Cathair dhearg keeps the regalia (26 an Gearran 1936 DE), and the seal has never been in its keeping.

Nineteen shires and a hundred and five towns bear the crown's trellis in their own arms, and sixty-seven towns bear the mascle. The roll says only that the trellis was granted where a shire asked for the crown's colours. It does not say why these asked and others did not. No Tuathaich town bears the trellis. The mascle is on the arms of one Tuathaich shire, Siorrachd Caol mhòr, and of two Tuathaich towns, Caol mhòr and Cnoc uaine.

IV. The arms of the shires

The shires are given in the order of the roll.

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
1	Cathair dhearg	Cathair dhearg	Per fess gules and argent, in chief a horseman Or, in base a salmon sable.	The capital's shire.
2	Caol leathan	Caol leathan	Argent, on a fess cotised gules three lions passant argent.	The roll calls the three beasts on the fess lions. In Caol leathan they are called the wolves of the gate, after the white stone on which the road-guards swore their watch (12 am Faoilleach 1990 BDE).
3	Seann Skell	Seann Skell	Per bend sinister azure and argent, a point in base counter-changed, over all a scorpion Or.	Seann Skell of the west. The shire of Manannan's order, whose teaching was declared at Seann Skell (1 an t-Sultain 615 DE). The scorpion, badge of Manannan's Cup of Truth, was set over the arms at the house's asking when the roll was made (2 an Gearran 1933 DE). No other shire bears one.

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
4	Seann Skell	Seann Skell	Per fess barbed azure and argent, a pair of bones in saltire Or in chief, a compass rose gules in base.	Seann Skell of the south. The seat of the high custodian of Òrd Bhride (17 an Cèitean 1935 DE).
5	Ros dhomhain	Ros dhomhain	Gules, three Maltese crosses Or, two and one.	
6	Cnoc bheag	Cnoc bheag	Per fess gules and Or, within an orle of twelve crescent moons argent a falcon argent.	The shire of the Hawk order. The roll first gave it a white billet. The hawk replaced it at the Hawk houses' asking (29 an t-Samhain 1964 DE).
7	Caol mhòr	Caol mhòr	Argent, three mascles purpure, two and one.	Heater shield.
8	Caol bheag	Caol bheag	Per pale azure and Or, on the dexter side an anchor argent, on the sinister side a feather vert.	Caol bheag of the north-east.
9	Inis bhàn	Inis bhàn	Argent, a pall sable, four billets argent, two in chief and two on the pall.	
10	Doire shean	Doire shean	Sanguine, three falcons argent in pale.	The roll does not say why a shire of the Stone bears falcons, and the houses of the Stone have never asked for them to be changed. The town was made a shire seat on the wealth of its oyster beds (5 an Lùnastal 595 DE).
11	Àth shean	Àth shean	Per fess invected Or and azure semy of hearts argent, an apple sable in chief, an anvil purpure in base.	Àth shean of the south.
12	Achadh mhòr	Achadh mhòr	Azure mailed argent, a dragon rampant argent.	
13	Seann Bhral	Seann Bhral	Quarterly engrailed purpure and argent masoned azure, two crosses formy Or in chief.	
14	Ceann mhòr	Ceann mhòr	Azure, a wolf's head erased Or.	Heater shield. The wolf's head was the device of the human magistrate at Ceann mhòr, whose house the maor took over (4 am Faoilleach 1933 DE). It has nothing to do with the Stone or its Fianna.
15	Inis thais	Inis thais	Argent masoned sable, an anchor gules.	The chief shrine of the Stone (16 an Dùbhlachd 380 DE). The shire reads its masoned field as Lia Fàil, since the Stone's plain name, Clach, is the common word for stone. The anchor is taken for the net-makers', among whom Lia Fàil was first preached (28 am Màrt 370 DE).

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
16	Dùn thais	Dùn thais	Per pile engrailed Or and vert, four fleurs-de-lis sable, two, one and one.	The seat of the druid schools. It bears no stag. The schools have never worshipped Flidais's stag and asked for none.
17	Inis chrom	Inis chrom	Argent chained purpure, a chevron purpure.	
18	Doire mhin	Doire mhin	Or, on a fess cotised indented purpure a sun in splendour Or.	
19	Doire fhi-adhaich	Doire fhi-adhaich	Gules, three ploughs contourny argent in chief.	
20	Baile gharbh	Baile gharbh	Gules honeycombed Or, on a chief Or three keys gules.	
21	Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	Per pale azure trellised Or and Or, on the dexter side a mascle argent, on the sinister side a sun gules.	Ceann mhin of the gulf.
22	Baile ghlas	Baile ghlas	Sable, on a fess double cotised Or an anchor azure.	
23	Doire ghlas	Doire ghlas	Or, a cock vert.	Heater shield. The largest Tuathaich place and the heart of the Church in the north.
24	Cathair mhòr	Cathair mhòr	Per fess barbed gules and Or, a cross paty argent in chief, a hand vert in base.	
25	Baile ghorm	Baile ghorm	Azure trellised Or, a cross humetty argent.	Baile ghorm of the south-west.
26	Achadh naomh	Achadh naomh	Quarterly potency azure and argent, a hatchet Or.	Achadh naomh of the north-central country.
27	Baile Mòr mhòr	Baile Mòr mhòr	Azure trellised Or, a chevron reversed argent.	
28	Baile chrom	Baile chrom	Azure, two triangles Or in pale.	Heater shield. The one town of the Grey Night vigil. Its arms show nothing of the goose.
29	Muileann mhin	Muileann mhin	Vert, nine fleurs-de-lis argent, three, three and three.	
30	Caol gharbh	Caol gharbh	Or, three ships' wheels sable, two and one.	
31	Seann Chwen	Seann Chwen	Per saltire, paly gules and Or, and argent, an orle Or.	
32	Cathair dhomhain	Cathair dhomhain	Argent, a bone sable.	
33	Àth shean	Àth shean	Or, a stag passant vert.	Àth shean of the north.

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
34	Muileann bhàn	Muileann bhàn	Ermine, a plaice azure.	
35	Dùn iséal	Dùn iséal	Argent, three parrots azure in pale.	The hill of the Keepers' Hall (19 an Dùbhlachd 2984 BDE) and the seat of the Old Spirits. The parrots are birds no one on Rodos has seen.
36	Cnoc ghorm	Cnoc ghorm	Per fess, chequy Or and gules, and sable, a chevron reversed vert.	Heater shield.
37	Cnoc leathan	Cnoc leathan	Azure, a pair of scales Or.	
38	Cuan shean	Cuan shean	Per fess dancetty sable and argent, a fusil Or in chief, an inescutcheon gules in base.	
39	Àth chiar	Àth chiar	Per fess azure trellised Or and Or, a pall argent.	
40	Doire fhada	Doire fhada	Azure, a cross argent between four caravels Or.	
41	Achadh naomh	Achadh naomh	Sable, on a pale wavy argent three parrots vert.	Achadh naomh of the north-east.
42	Muileann dhearg	Muileann dhearg	Gules, six mascles Or in orle.	Muileann dhearg of the centre. Six mascles, the hollow stone of the custody, in gold on red.
43	Baile ghorm	Baile ghorm	Gules, a scythe argent.	Baile ghorm of the south-east.
44	Dùn chrom	Dùn chrom	Azure trellised Or, a cross humetty argent.	
45	Ros gheal	Ros gheal	Azure trellised Or, a terrace in base Or.	
46	Cill dhìreach	Cill dhìreach	Or, a pile gules, a castle Or in chief.	
47	Doire chiar	Doire chiar	Argent, three maple leaves purple, two and one.	
48	Caol shean	Caol shean	Argent, a pile in bend azure, two billets gules in bend sinister.	
49	Cathair fhada	Cathair fhada	Per chevron azure trellised Or and argent, a mount in base Or.	

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
50	Baile mhin	Baile mhin	Quarterly argent and purpure, in the first quarter a griffin rampant azure; in the second quarter a sun Or; in the third quarter an arm embowed in armour argent; in the fourth quarter a wyvern vert.	
51	Seann Skell	Seann Skell	Azure trellised Or, an armillary sphere Or.	Seann Skell of the north. Where the dawn-hawk rite began (30 an Dùbhlachd 1000 BDE) and where the Fed Hawk were sent (23 an Giblean 870 DE). It bears the crown's field and no hawk.
52	Baile chiar	Baile chiar	Or, on a canton sable a mascle Or.	The crown's mascle in a canton.
53	Cnoc mhòr	Cnoc mhòr	Sable, three bulls' heads caboshed Or, two and one.	
54	Tobar fhiadhaich	Tobar fhiadhaich	Quarterly dentilly purpure and argent, in the first quarter a cross of Toulouse Or; in the second quarter a rabbit sejant purpure; in the third quarter a dragon passant azure; in the fourth quarter an orb argent.	
55	Ros gharbh	Ros gharbh	Azure, a longship argent.	
56	Tobar ghorm	Tobar ghorm	Argent, a stirrup azure.	
57	Àth fhiadhaich	Àth fhiadhaich	Papelonny gules and argent, a pall argent.	
58	Baile chaol	Baile chaol	Argent, a ram's head erased vert.	
59	Muileann dhomhain	Muileann dhomhain	Azure trellised Or, a carreau Or.	Muileann dhomhain of the south-east.
60	Seann Tarr	Seann Tarr	Argent, a bendlet sinister engrailed purpure, a heart sable in dexter chief.	
61	Achadh shean	Achadh shean	Per pale dentilly argent and azure, a cannon sable on the dexter side, an escallop Or on the sinister side.	
62	Muileann shean	Muileann shean	Sable, on a quarter Or an inescutcheon sable charged with a dove Or.	
63	Tobar dhearg	Tobar dhearg	Chevronny argent and purpure, a trefoil gules.	

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
64	Baile àr-saidh	Baile àr-saidh	Argent, a goutte gules.	Where the sting-oath began (19 an t-Samhain 2120 BDE). The town reads the red drop as the drop the sting draws.
65	Cuan gh-las	Cuan gh-las	Purple, a lymphad argent.	
66	Doire fhionn	Doire fhionn	Or, a mullet azure.	Doire fhionn of the north-east.
67	Doire chaol	Doire chaol	Argent, a terrace in base ray-onny gules, three crosses fleury gules in fess.	
68	Seann Tòll	Seann Tòll	Azure, an escallop Or.	
69	Baile ru-adh	Baile ru-adh	Per bend sable and argent, a crescent reversed counter-changed.	
70	Àth bheag	Àth bheag	Argent, three roses sable, two and one.	
71	Ceann àr-saidh	Ceann àr-saidh	Purple, an armillary sphere argent.	
72	Caol fhi-adhaich	Caol fhi-adhaich	Vert, on a saltire undy Or five anchors gules.	
73	Baile fhi-adhaich	Baile fhi-adhaich	Gules, a cross parted argent, over all a lance with a pennon gules.	
74	Seann Vell	Seann Vell	Per saltire argent and azure, four compass roses counter-changed in cross.	Seann Vell of the capital's east.
75	Cnoc thais	Cnoc thais	Sable, on a bendlet sinister embattled Or three skulls azure.	Heater shield.
76	Muileann chrom	Muileann chrom	Azure, on a pale argent a patriarchal cross azure.	
77	Ros bheag	Ros bheag	Sable, a cross indented Or between four mascles argent.	
78	Cnoc àr-saidh	Cnoc àr-saidh	Or, a mount in base gules, over all a cannon gules.	
79	Inis bheag	Inis bheag	Per fess potency purple and Or, an anchor argent in chief, a fly azure in base.	
80	Àth fhionn	Àth fhionn	Azure trellised Or, a crescent Or.	
81	Achadh àrsaidh	Achadh àrsaidh	Per fess nowy azure and argent, two anchors Or in pale.	

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
82	Cuan ru-adh	Cuan ru-adh	Argent, on a chief embattled gules an angel Or.	
83	Seann Bhrenn	Seann Bhrenn	Argent, three bees vert, two and one.	
84	Cnoc shean	Cnoc shean	Azure, a thistle Or.	
85	Dùn dhearg	Dùn dhearg	Argent, a lion rampant azure.	
86	Àth àr-saidh	Àth àr-saidh	Per pale Or and gules, a bow and arrow azure on the dexter side, a rake Or on the sinister side.	Heater shield.
87	Cnoc dhìreach	Cnoc dhìreach	Vert, on a cross argent five apples gules.	
88	Muileann leathan	Muileann leathan	Azure, a horse passant argent.	Heater shield.
89	Achadh chaol	Achadh chaol	Per bend fir-twigged gules and Or, an apple argent in sinister chief, a scythe sable in dexter base.	
90	Muileann dhomhain	Muileann dhomhain	Sable, a cross clechy Or.	Muileann dhomhain of the east.
91	Inis mhin	Inis mhin	Sable, a fess argent, four lions' heads erased argent, three in chief and one in base.	Heater shield.
92	Caol iséal	Caol iséal	Per fess argent and gules, a bendlet purpure.	
93	Cnoc namh	Cnoc namh	Or, a bordure gules.	
94	Àth ghlas	Àth ghlas	Per fess azure trellised Or and Or, an annulet argent in chief, a bee azure in base.	
95	Seann Warr	Seann Warr	Or, an anchor purpure.	
96	Muileann dhearg	Muileann dhearg	Azure trellised Or, a pale Or.	The shire of the vein-house above Muileann dhearg (17 an t-Ògmhios 15 BDE). It bears the custody's field with a pale of gold and nothing more.
97	Àth dhomhain	Àth dhomhain	Azure trellised Or, a bell argent.	
98	Inis mhòr	Inis mhòr	Azure, three escallops argent, two and one.	

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
99	Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	Or, a saltire parted indented azure, over all on an inescutcheon Or a fleur-de-lis purpure.	Ceann mhin of the north-east.
100	Seann Dunn	Seann Dunn	Argent, two eagles vert in pale.	
101	Ceann leathan	Ceann leathan	Argent, a label purpure, two pairs of bones in saltire sable in pale.	
102	Cnoc gheal	Cnoc gheal	Per pale wavy Or and sable.	
103	Muileann bheag	Muileann bheag	Per fess azure trellised Or and argent, a bear rampant Or in chief, a sheaf of arrows sable in base.	
104	Ceann bheag	Ceann bheag	Gules, a comet Or.	
105	Muileann àrsaidh	Muileann àrsaidh	Azure, a saltire embattled Or, over all a serpent gules.	Heater shield.
106	Cill thais	Cill thais	Vert, a salmon argent.	
107	Baile ìseal	Baile ìseal	Argent, three portcullises purpure, two and one.	Heater shield.
108	Baile gheal	Baile gheal	Purpure, five annulets argent in saltire.	The seat of the second house of the Stone (8 an Lùnastal 1360 DE).
109	Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	Per bend sinister argent and gules, a lighthouse counter-changed.	Ceann mhin of the south-east.
110	Cnoc dhubh	Cnoc dhubh	Purpure, a lozenge ploye argent.	
111	Baile Mòr dhomhain	Baile Mòr dhomhain	Azure, a wing argent.	The seat of Clann Fhearchair, the first house to give Rodos a chosen king (19 an Gearran 143 DE). The house roll does not say whether the wing was ever the house's.
112	Muileann chiar	Muileann chiar	Vert, on a chief potency argent three inescutcheons purpure.	
113	Doire fhionn	Doire fhionn	Argent, three parrots gules, two and one.	Doire fhionn of the north.
114	Cnoc bhàn	Cnoc bhàn	Per fess argent and vert, in chief a palace azure, in base a paschal lamb Or.	

NO.	SHIRE	SEAT	ARMS	NOTES
115	Àth mhòr	Àth mhòr	Argent, three ploughshares purple in pale.	The oldest hawk carving on the island is over a door in this town (13 an Dùbhlachd 5748 BDE). Neither the shire nor the town bears a hawk.
116	Muileann naomh	Muileann naomh	Chequy purple and Or, a chevron argent.	Muileann naomh of the south.
117	Muileann naomh	Muileann naomh	Chevronny azure trellised Or and Or, a cross argent.	Muileann naomh of the west.
118	Caol bheag	Caol bheag	Per pale Or and azure, a bar gemel gules, two dolphins gules in chief, and a canton azure trellised Or charged with a mascle argent.	Caol bheag of the northern strait. It bears the crown's arms in a canton.
119	Caol mhin	Caol mhin	Sable, a centaur archer argent.	
120	Seann Vell	Seann Vell	Azure trellised Or, a lymphad argent.	Seann Vell of the west coast.
121	Seann Vell	Seann Vell	Argent, three mascles purple in fess.	Seann Vell of the south-east.
122	Eilean dhìreach	—	Gules, a ship's wheel argent, and a canton azure trellised Or charged with a mascle argent.	An island shire with no town. It bears the crown's arms in a canton, on a heater shield.
123	Eilean Ìseal	—	Per pale argent and purple, on the dexter side a stirrup gules, on the sinister side a bear rampant Or, and a canton azure trellised Or charged with a mascle argent.	An island shire with no town. It bears the crown's arms in a canton.

Of the hundred and twenty-three shires, twelve bear the heater: the eleven Tuathaich shires, the island shire of Eilean dhìreach among them (Appendix H), and Inis mhin on the northern shore, which has one town of each people. Fifteen bear no charge at all, only their field, partitions and ordinaries.

V. The arms of the towns

By kind. The roll holds the arms of five hundred and five towns. Four hundred and forty-one are on the wedge and sixty-four on the heater, one heater for every Tuathaich town. A hundred and five are on the crown's trellis, and seventeen of these carry the mascle as well, so that their arms come close to the kingdom's own. Of the other fields, argent is the commonest, then azure, Or and gules, then sable, purple and vert. Ninety-five towns bear no charge, and eighteen of those bear nothing but their field

and its partition. The commonest charge is the mascle. Crosses of one kind or another are on sixty-three town arms. A hundred and five towns bear a beast, and thirty-one of those are beasts no one on Rodos has seen: lions, griffins, dragons, crocodiles, elephants, a rhinoceros. Twenty bear figures: horsemen, archers, monks, angels and two skeletons. Ships and anchors are on the harbours, and ploughs, scythes, saws and anvils on the farm and mill towns, but only twenty-eight of the hundred and thirty-three harbour towns carry anything from the sea.

The capital and the great cities. The capital and every city of more than twenty thousand people, largest first.

TOWN	SHIRE	PEOPLE	ARMS	NOTES
Cathair dhearg	Cathair dhearg	10,300	Ermine, flaunches gules.	The capital reads its ermine as the black and white of Macha's floors, and the flaunches as the red of the red city.
Seann Skell	Seann Skell	74,100	Or, a cross azure, three dolphins Or in pale.	The seat of Manannan's order and the largest town on Rodos. Its own arms bear dolphins; the scorpion is on its shire's arms.
Ros dhomhain	Ros dhomhain	51,600	Argent, a Maltese cross purple.	
Cathair mhòr	Cathair mhòr	49,300	Gules, a cross paty argent.	
Baile Mòr mhòr	Baile Mòr mhòr	35,900	Azure trellised Or, three mascles argent, two and one.	The crown's field with the hollow stone three times over.
Inis thais	Inis thais	34,900	Per chevron reversed argent masoned sable and gules, a pale azure.	Masoned, like the arms of its shire.
Dùn thais	Dùn thais	34,200	Azure trellised Or, a saw argent.	
Ceann mhin	Ceann mhin	32,300	Azure trellised Or, six mascles argent in orle.	
Cathair dhomhain	Cathair dhomhain	29,400	Per bend azure trellised Or and argent, a bone Or in sinister chief, a spear sable in dexter base.	
Dùn dhearg	Dùn dhearg	25,700	Argent, three lions rampant gules in chief.	
Inis mhòr	Inis mhòr	24,000	Sable, a point in base argent, six plaice argent, three and three.	
Ros bheag	Ros bheag	23,800	Sable, a cross nowy argent between four mascles argent.	

TOWN	SHIRE	PEOPLE	ARMS	NOTES
Dùn iséal	Dùn iséal	22,600	Argent, three mascles gules, two and one.	The hollow stone in red, on the hill of the Keepers' Hall.
Seann Skell	Seann Skell	22,100	Azure trellised Or, a cross Or, three columns gules in pale.	The crown's field; see its shire.
Dùn chrom	Dùn chrom	21,100	Quarterly azure trellised Or and argent, an orle Or.	
Cathair fhada	Cathair fhada	20,900	Azure trellised Or, four mascles argent, two, one and one.	

The seats and holy towns. Towns not among the great cities whose arms the record has cause to mention.

TOWN	SHIRE	PEOPLE	ARMS	NOTES
Cnoc bheag	Cnoc bheag	49,700	Gules, a plaice Or.	The first house of the Hawk. The town bears a plaice, a river fish. The hawk is on the shire's arms.
Seann Skell	Seann Skell	57,900	Or, an orle gules, three inescutcheons purple in pale, each charged with a mullet of four points Or.	The seat of the high custodian.
Caol leathan	Caol leathan	8,600	Argent, two mascles purple in pale.	The masle of the custody, in purple. The wolf-stone is not on the town's arms.
Muileann dhearg	Muileann dhearg	14,100	Azure trellised Or, three mascles argent in chief.	The vein-house town. It bears the custody's field and three mascles.
Muileann chaol	Cnoc bhàn	5,500	Argent, a pale invected gules, a lion rampant azure in dexter chief.	The library town.
Baile chrom	Baile chrom	27,300	Argent, a chief gules, two lymphads azure.	The town of the Grey Night.

VI. The beasts of the orders on the roll

Most of the orders of the Old Faith have a beast: the Hawk order its hawk, the druid schools Flidais's stag, Macha's order the black horse and the grey, the order of the Stone the wolf of its Fianna, and Manannan's order the yellow scorpion of his Cup. The roll does not carry them as a reader of the orders might expect, and the orders have asked for them only twice.

The Hawk. Mòd, the Hawk of Acaill, is on one shield in the roll, the arms of Siorrachd Cnoc bheag, and only since the Hawk houses asked for him (29 an t-Samhain 1964 DE). No town bears a hawk. The northern Seann Skell, where the rite began, bears the crown's field, and Àth mhòr, with the oldest hawk on the island over a door, bears ploughshares. The three falcons of Siorrachd Doire shean are in the country of the Stone, and the record does not explain them.

Macha's horses. No arms on the roll bear Dubh Sainglenn as the wood-watchers told of him, the black horned beast of the wood. The order's houses show the black horse and the grey only in the black and white of their floors (14 am Màrt 1420 DE), and the capital reads its own ermine, black on white, in that way. The capital's shire bears a horseman, and Cnoc dhubh, a town of Macha's order, a horse's head; the roll does not say that either is hers. The horses on the arms of Muileann leathan and its shire are in Tuathaich church country, and nobody reads them as Macha's.

The Wolf of the Fianna. No shire of the Stone bears a wolf. Inis thais bears masonry, which its people read as the Stone itself, since its plain name Clach is the common word for stone. Caol leathan's three beasts are lions in the roll and wolves in the town. Two towns bear a wolf's head: Achadh fhada, a town of the Stone, and Ceann mhòr in the north, where the head is the old magistrate's. Baile ghorm's wolf-head posts stand on its quays and are not on its arms.

The Stag. The druid schools have never worshipped Flidais's stag (7 an Dùbhlachd 2881 BDE), and none of their chief towns bears one. The stags on the roll are at Àth shean, in shire and town, and at Cnoc òg, both towns of Macha's order, and at Doire chaol, the hunters' village of the schools that sends its oak to Caol gharbh. Stags' antlers are on the arms of four more towns.

The Scorpion. The badge of Manannan's Cup is on the arms of the western Seann Skell, at the house's asking (2 an Gearran 1933 DE). The three towns that bear a scorpion, Seann Chwen, Àth chrom and Achadh gharbh, are none of them towns of Manannan's order, and Seann Vell, which cut the first scorpion in yellow stone, bears a fleur-de-lis on the crown's field.

The others. Òrd Bhride has no beast. It has the mascle, the hollow stone of Crom over the vein, on the kingdom's arms and on sixty-seven towns, and it has never asked for more. Bride's flame is on no arms. Of the other gods' signs the roll holds a harp, an Dagda's, at Cnoc dhubh, a town of the schools, and three ravens, the birds of the Mor-rìgan in the tellings, at Baile thais, Àth shean of the northern march and Achadh mhin; none of these towns claims the god. The Old Spirits keep no beast, and the people of the mounds are on no arms. The Church asked for no sign on the roll. The goose of the Grey Night is on no arms, and Baile chrom, the vigil's one town, bears ships.

PART FOUR

A Gazetteer of Rodos

A

Achadh àrsaidh (Doire fhionn). Founded 12 an t-Ògmhios 2178 BDE by Ròdaich herders on an older field. Achadh àrsaidh, the ancient field, was named by Ròdaich herders who found its field-walls already standing and old when they came. No record says who laid them. Tior-machd Achadh shean, the Long Drought, struck it in the Age of Strangers and parched its hay-meadows for three dry seasons running. It has stayed a small village of cattle and hay on the eastern uplands, keeping the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and its walls in repair. Known for field-walls older than any record.

Achadh àrsaidh (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 14 am Màrt 2396 BDE by Ròdaich fishers, resettled by the Tuathaich. An ancient field village on the far western coast, facing the waters of Uilebheist na Mara, the Sea-Watcher. Gorta Baile chrom, the Great Hunger, struck it in the Age of Strangers; it was resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance and keeps the faith of the Church. Pirates have been seen offshore and the villagers keep watch on the headland. Its boats first met the humans' ships at sea, off the north-west cape at the place they call Coinneachadh nan Long. Known for the watch for the Sea-Watcher.

Achadh àrsaidh (Achadh àrsaidh). Founded 17 an t-Iuchar 791 BDE by the fishers of the capital's river. An ancient field village on the Abhainn fhionn east of the capital, grown into one of the largest settlements on the island while keeping its village name. It is the seat of Siorrachd Achadh àrsaidh, and its river quays land the fish and grain that feed Cathair dhearg. It follows the order of Macha. Known for the river quays that feed the capital.

Achadh chaol (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 23 am Faoilleach 527 DE by Ròdaich farmers of Muileann dhomhain. A village of narrow fields that has fed the eastern mining district since the district was opened. Scàineadh Cill ghlas, the Rending, struck it when the fault tore open, and the diggings it fed were closed after. It still sends its grain to the mills around it. The village stands on land the custodians of Muileann dhomhain lent to the people of the closed district at Coinneachadh an Fhearrainn, the standing stone on the moor road. Known for narrow fields feeding the diggings.

Achadh chaol (Achadh chaol). Founded 17 an Lùnastal 2815 BDE by Ròdaich barley farmers. Achadh chaol is a large village of narrow barley fields and the seat of its province. Its grain goes to the mills of Muileann dhìreach, and the two places have kept the same bargain since the Holy Age. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for narrow barley fields.

Achadh dhìreach (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 30 an t-Ògmhios 1962 DE by settlers under the restored kingdom. Achadh dhìreach was laid out in straight fields by the restored kingdom, when extraction returned to full scale and the towns of the plain needed feeding. It is small, fewer than eight hundred people. It feeds Baile Mòr àrsaidh. Known for kingdom-era straight fields.

Achadh dhomhain (Muileann chrom). Founded 10 an t-Ògmhios 2727 BDE by farmers of Muileann chrom. Achadh dhomhain of Muileann chrom is a large farming village in deep fields, founded in the Holy Age. Its granaries fed the mining camps in the Age of Strangers and were requisitioned in the war of the Severance. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for deep-field granaries of the camps.

Achadh dhomhain (Caol shean). Founded 27 an t-Iuchar 128 BDE by hosts of the Allt an Àigh pilgrims. Achadh dhomhain of Caol shean is a large village beside Allt an Àigh, the stream of fortune. Pilgrims have come to drink from it since the Holy Age, and the village lives on them. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for hosts to Allt an Àigh pilgrims.

Achadh fhada (Baile chiar). Founded 30 an Dùbhlachd 877 DE by barley-farmers of the south-west. Achadh fhada, the long field, is a village of barley farms in the capital's southern country. It was founded in the long quiet centuries and has changed little since. It keeps the order of the Stone, unlike most of its neighbours. Known for long field of barley.

Achadh fhada (Cnoc bheag). Founded 31 an Cèitean 625 DE by druids of the Hungry Hawk. A long field village in the wooded middle west, one of the few settlements where Òrd an t-Seabhaig, the Hawk order, whose rite is the older form of Òrd Bhrìde's, still holds. A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death, struck it in the Age of Strangers. Its fields feed the Hawk-order mill at Muileann uaine. Known for the Hawk-order fields.

Achadh fhiadhaich (Ceann bheag). Founded 10 an t-Ògmhios 726 DE by horse-breeders of the north. Achadh fhiadhaich is a village of the north-east, founded in the long quiet centuries on wild pasture that no earlier people had fenced. It breeds horses and grows hay for the coast, and the carters of Ceann bheag have bought its horses for generations. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for wild-field hay and horses.

Achadh fhiadhaich (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 19 an t-Iuchar 1473 DE by Ròdaich fishers of the west coast. A wild field village on the far western shore with a small harbour, kept in Ròdaich hands when the Tuathaich homeland was fixed to the north. It faces the waters where the Sea-Watcher is said to live, and pirates are still seen off the coast. Its people follow the order of Manannan. Known for fishing within sight of the Sea-Watcher's waters.

Achadh fhiadhaich (Ceann àrsaidh). Founded 21 an t-Sultain 1774 DE by Ròdaich farmers who reclaimed the wild field. A village of fields reclaimed from wild ground in the Age of Sundering, when the island had fewer mouths and more hands to spare. It feeds the towns of Ceann àrsaidh and sends its surplus to Muileann chrom to be ground. It is a large village now, of nearly ten thousand. Known for reclaimed wild fields.

Achadh fhionn (Baile ghorm). Founded 23 an Lùnastal 1930 BDE by farmers of the south-east. Achadh fhionn is a village of the south-east, founded in the Holy Age in a fair field under Làrach an Dùin. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and leaves the ruin alone. Its people say the ruin was old when the first Ròdaich came. Known for fair field under Làrach an Dùin.

Achadh fhionn (Cnoc shean). Founded 9 an t-Samhain 491 DE by farmers of Cnoc shean. A fair field village in the south-east, with meadows between the hill-towns of Cnoc shean and Cnoc fhada. It keeps the Old Spirits and is known for its hay. Known for hay from the fair fields.

Achadh fhionn (Ceann mhin). Founded 15 an Dùbhlachd 21 DE by Ròdaich barley farmers. A farming village of fair barley fields between Baile mhin and Àth ghlas. In the Age of Strangers its pastures were taken for the horses of the administration, and they have served as remount grounds for the soldiers of the district ever since. It is a quiet place, larger in fields than in people. Known for barley fields and remount pastures.

Achadh gharbh (Inis bheag). Founded 7 an Dàmhair 166 DE by farmers from Inis bheag. Rough ground behind the river port of Inis bheag, broken to the plough in the long centuries after the Sundering fleet had gone. It feeds the river port and its fishing boats, and it has grown larger than many towns while keeping the name and customs of a village. The druid schools have a strong following among its farmers, who are said to argue the schools' questions over the furrow. Known for stony fields that feed Inis bheag.

Achadh gharbh (Inis bheag). Founded 3 am Faoilleach 1065 DE by farmers of Muileann chaol. A rough field village beside the older Muileann chaol, breaking stony ground for the mill. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and shares its name with two other Achadh gharbhs of the east, which the library's clerks tell apart only by their shires. Known for stony fields for the old mill.

Achadh gharbh (Caol shean). Founded 13 an t-Ògmhios 402 BDE by the keepers of Allt an Àigh. A rough field village beside Allt an Àigh, the stream said to grant fortune to those who drink at the right phase of the moon. Pilgrims have come since the Holy Age, and the keepers' citadel was built to guard the stream from anyone who would bottle and sell it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, whose druids have never agreed whether the stream's luck is real. Known for Allt an Àigh, the stream of fortune.

Achadh gharbh (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 21 an Giblean 526 DE by Ròdaich peat-cutters of the northern uplands. A hamlet-sized village of rough moor fields and peat banks above Tobar fhiadhaich. Its peat warmed the northern towns when the Small-Burning Law still held and the ore was not burned freely. Fewer than a thousand people live there now. Known for rough moor fields and peat.

Achadh gheal (Seann Skell). Founded 23 an t-Samhain 959 BDE by Ròdaich flax-growers of Seann Skell. The white field is the flax country that feeds the linen-weavers of Seann Skell, and in the drying season the whole plain is laid with bleaching cloth. The village is large and prosperous for its kind, and it follows the order of Manannan as the river port does. Its growers' guild has sold to the same Seann Skell houses for longer than either side can prove. Known for flax fields and bleached linen.

Achadh ghlas (Seann Skell). Founded 26 an Lùnastal 1658 BDE by Ròdaich farmers of Seann Skell. A village of grey-green fields on the road north from Seann Skell, whose barley and oats feed the great river port. It lies just south of the Tuathaich line, and since the Severance its farmers have ploughed with one eye on the boundary. In the Long War its barns quartered soldiers of the seventh regiment on the way to Àth leathan. Known for grey fields on the Seann Skell road.

Achadh iséal (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 27 an t-Sultain 1145 DE by farmers from Muileann dhomhain. A low field village in the south-east, farming for the mill town of Muileann dhomhain and the port of Ceann chaol. It keeps the Old Spirits and has no history the chroniclers found worth writing beyond its harvests. Known for harvests for the southern mills.

Achadh mhin (Cnoc naomh). Founded 1 an Lùnastal 2261 BDE by farmers of the southern coast. Achadh mhin is a farming village of the south, founded in the Holy Age. Tonn Mhòr struck it in the first years of the restored kingdom and destroyed it in a single night. It was rebuilt and keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for rebuilt after the Great Wave.

Achadh mhin (Baile gharbh). Founded 19 an Lùnastal 1762 DE by Ròdaich farmers of Baile gharbh. A village of smooth, well-drained fields that feeds the harbour at Ceann dhubh. It is not the Achadh mhin of the southern coast that the Great Wave struck. It has had few recorded troubles and is mentioned in the older rolls chiefly for its tithe. Known for smooth fields of Baile gharbh.

Achadh mhòr (Achadh mhòr). Founded 13 am Màrt 1897 BDE by Ròdaich farming households of the eastern plain. Achadh mhòr is still called a field village, though it is one of the largest settlements on the island and the seat of its province. It is the granary of the east, and the shared-meal custom of the Holy Age is said to have been kept here most faithfully. Travellers on the road stop at An Sligeanach Fad' às nearby. Known for the great granary fields.

Achadh mhòr (Cnoc bheag). Founded 28 an Gearran 143 BDE by Ròdaich farmers of Cnoc bheag. A farming village of six thousand just south of the Tuathaich line. It follows the order of Manannan, like its neighbours across the line. It trades with both sides and has been watched by both. Known for border fields south of the Tuathaich line.

Achadh naomh (Achadh naomh). Founded 5 am Faoilleach 721 BDE by keepers of the holy field. Achadh naomh is a large village and the seat of its province in the north-central country, founded in the Holy Age on a field held sacred. Colbh Cnoc chiar stands to its east, carved 'remember the fire'. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for holy field by Colbh Cnoc chiar.

Achadh naomh (Achadh naomh). Founded 28 an t-Sultain 675 BDE by Ròdaich households of the ancestor feasts. The holy field was a meeting ground for the ancestor feasts of the Old Spirits before any house stood on it, and the houses were built around its edge rather than upon it. It is now a village of twenty-five thousand and the seat of its province, yet the field at its heart is still left unploughed. The feasts are kept there as they were in the Holy Age. Known for the ancestor feasts on the unploughed field.

Achadh shean (Achadh shean). Founded 3 am Màrt 2591 BDE by Ròdaich farming households. Achadh shean, the old field, is a village of twenty-five thousand and the seat of its province. It gave its name to Tiormachd Achadh shean, the Long Drought, which settled over the island's dry season for three years running in the Age of Strangers. Its granaries were emptied in those years and rebuilt larger afterward, and they are the largest on the eastern coast. Known for the old fields and the Long Drought.

Àth àrsaidh (Dùn dhearg). Founded 19 am Màrt 1105 BDE by the ford-keepers of Dùn dhearg. An ancient ford in the east, between the mill town of Muileann leathan and Seann Mhorn on the coast. It keeps the Old Spirits and a ford-stone where travellers leave a pebble, and it has been a small crossing town since the Holy Age. Known for the pebble-cairn at the ford-stone.

Àth àrsaidh (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 12 an t-Samhain 743 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers, resettled by the Tuathaich. An ancient ford in the north-west, the seat of Siorrachd Àth àrsaidh, resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It is a large town of the Church and the market of the Tuathaich southern country. Known for the ancient ford of the Tuathaich.

Àth bheag (Baile fhiadhaich). Founded 14 an t-Samhain 185 DE by the ford-keepers of Baile fhiadhaich. A small ford in the west on the road between Baile fhiadhaich and Cnoc íseal. It follows the order of Manannan and has never been much more than a crossing, though crown regiments marched through it to Àth leathan in the Long War. Known for a small western crossing.

Àth bheag (Baile íseal). Founded 14 an Giblean 1938 DE by Tuathaich families sent north at the Severance. A small ford settlement founded by Tuathaich families who came north at the Severance. It has fewer than a thousand people. It trades with Baile íseal and Baile òg, the other Tuathaich towns of its province. Known for a ford settled after the Severance.

Àth bheag (Àth bheag). Founded 30 am Faoilleach 118 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers of the east coast. Àth bheag is a town of twenty thousand at a ford of the Abhainn dhubh on the east coast, the seat of its province. Pirate ships have been seen offshore, and the town keeps watchers on the dunes. The lighthouse of Baile íseal lies a short way south. Its salt-pans supply the whole eastern seaboard. Known for east-coast ford under pirate watch.

Àth chaol (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 5 an t-Sultain 480 DE by the ford-wardens of Baile Mòr dhomhain. One of the island's many narrow fords, this one a walled post on the north road into Baile Mòr dhomhain. The city built its walls to hold the crossing in the troubles before the Severance, and it is still garrisoned in name. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for walled ford on the city's north road.

Àth chaol (Achadh naomh). Founded 20 an t-Sultain 620 BDE by the ford-keepers of Achadh naomh. A narrow ford in the east where the road to the harbour at Inis mhin crosses a stream. It keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich, and its ford runs low in the dry months. It is a small market town for the holy field of Achadh naomh. Known for narrow ford on the Inis mhin road.

Àth chaol (Seann Tarr). Founded 6 an Gearran 770 DE by harbour-folk of Seann Tarr. A narrow harbour ford in the far east, close to the old Seann-Dhaoine harbour of Seann Tarr. It keeps the Old Spirits and sends its fishing to the market at Cnoc uaine. Known for fishing the eastern narrows.

Àth chaol (Muileann chiar). Founded 30 an Dùbhlachd 1845 DE by miners of the central diggings. A narrow ford-town in the central hills, grown in the Age of Strangers around the camp-roads to the diggings near Cill ghlas. The Rending, Scàineadh Cill ghlas, killed miners of this town in the collapse, and the people here still use scàinte of a man who is shaken. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for miners' town of the Rending.

Àth chaol (Dùn thais). Founded 12 an Lùnastal 1362 DE by carters of Dùn thais. A small town at a narrow ford on the Dùn thais road, living on the carts that pass through it. Since the library was founded at Muileann chaol many of its young people have gone to work there as porters and copyists. It has never been walled or fought over. Known for narrow ford on the Dùn thais road.

Àth chiar (Àth shean). Founded 21 an Dùbhlachd 1323 DE by ford-keepers of the east road. Àth chiar is a ford town east of the capital, founded in the long quiet centuries. The field of Muileann ghlas lies to its south-west, and the town was a supply post in the last battle of An Cogadh Fada. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. The ford carries Rathad na Mèinne, the ore road from the capital to the hills. Known for dusky ford near Muileann ghlas field.

Àth chiar (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 30 an Lùnastal 1308 DE by the ford-guards of Baile Mòr dhomhain. A dusky ford on the west road out of Baile Mòr dhomhain, walled against the roads' thieves in the Age of Strangers. It is a carriers' town, and the road-house An Taigh-seinnse Reòta at Muileann fhada lies a short way down the road. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for carriers' town on the west road.

Àth chiar (Àth chiar). Founded 18 an Giblean 126 DE by the drovers of the south-east. A dusky ford in the south-east with a citadel, the seat of Siorrachd Àth chiar and a large market town. Its keep was held by Ròdaich rebels in the war before the Severance and is still garrisoned. It keeps the Old Spirits and trades with the coast at Seann Mhorn and Muileann chiar to the south. Known for the rebels' keep and southern cattle-market.

Àth chrom (Seann Skell). Founded 21 an Màrt 1232 DE by fishers of the west. Àth chrom, the bent ford, is a river town at a bend of the Abhainn naomh in the west, below Seann Skell, whose boats go down to the sea at Ros àrsaidh. It was founded in the long quiet centuries. Since An Cogadh Fada, troops of the regiment named for Seann Skell have been quartered close by. Known for bent ford on the lower Abhainn naomh.

Àth chrom (Seann Chwen). Founded 19 an t-Samhain 662 DE by ford-keepers of the Seann Chwen country. A small ford on a bent stream south of Cill ghlas, where the Rending opened. It follows the order of Macha. Known for bent ford south of Cill ghlas.

Àth chrom (Muileann naomh). Founded 3 an t-Iuchar 950 DE by Ròdaich drovers; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A drovers' town at the bent ford, Ròdaich until the Severance and Tuathaich since. It lies a short way from the field of Àth leathan, and its people carried the dead from that battle. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for Tuathaich drovers at the bent ford.

Àth chrom (Achadh shean). Founded 9 an Giblean 225 DE by carters of Achadh shean. A small town at a bent ford on the road from Achadh shean to the coast. It lives on the road and has never been more than a crossing. Known for bent ford on the Achadh shean road.

Àth dhearg (Cnoc shean). Founded 26 an Giblean 1801 DE by Ròdaich miners under extraction contract. Àth dhearg of Cnoc shean began as a mining camp at a ford in the Age of Strangers, and its red water is said to come from the spoil. It is neither the Àth dhearg whose name the northern lighthouse bears nor the western ford that the Great Hunger struck. Known for red ford of the mining camps.

Àth dhearg (Cnoc gheal). Founded 19 an Dùbhlachd 2635 BDE by ford-keepers of the north-east coast. A red ford-town near the north-east coast, whose name was given to Taigh-solais Àth dhearg, one of the five lighthouses built in the Age of Strangers at the request of human navigators. The beacon burned the ore for more than a century and was among the first things on the island converted to dubhan. The town keeps the Old Spirits and lives by the coast road and the lighthouse. Known for Taigh-solais Àth dhearg, the north-east beacon.

Àth dhearg (Baile chaol). Founded 25 am Faoilleach 1535 BDE by Ròdaich keepers of the holy wood. Àth dhearg stands at the edge of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar, and its people have acted as keepers of the wood's western paths since the Holy Age. Walls were raised in the Age of Strangers to keep timber-cutters out of the forest as much as to keep raiders out of the town. It is not the Àth dhearg of the light-house in the north. Known for ford at the edge of the holy wood.

Àth dhearg (Ceann mhòr). Founded 15 an Giblean 1090 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A red ford on the western coast below the light-house of Baile chrom, struck by Gorta Baile chrom in the Age of Strangers and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. Its people keep the faith of the Church, as most of this coast does. It is not the Àth dhearg of the north-eastern lighthouse. Known for red ford under the Baile chrom light.

Àth dhìreach (Achadh chaol). Founded 8 am Màrt 1869 DE by Ròdaich carters of the mining road. A straight ford with a citadel in the north-east, built as a waystation on the ore road in the Age of Strangers and fortified in the war before the Severance. Since the Long War it has been the station of An dàrna rèisimeid, the second regiment. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the second regiment's garrison.

Àth dhìreach (Muileann chiar). Founded 20 an Giblean 1829 DE by a mining crew under the human administration. Àth dhìreach was a ford where the ore carts crossed in the Age of Strangers. It is a town of three thousand in the eastern mining district. Its ford is paved with spoil from the diggings. Known for straight ford of the ore carts.

Àth dhomhain (Àth dhomhain). Founded 19 an Lùnastal 1572 DE by Raghnaill Àthach and his kin. The deep ford here could only be crossed on horseback, and a family of ferrymen became a family of lords by owning the one safe path over it. The citadel on the near bank was fought for in the troubles before the Severance and has been the seat of Siorrachd Àth dhomhain since. The town is large and orderly, a house of the druid schools stands by the gate, and Cnoc mhòr and Baile gheal send it their grain. Known for the horseman's ford and shire citadel.

Àth dhomhain (Caol shean). Founded 22 an t-Samhain 1598 DE by ford-keepers of Caol shean. A deep ford on the road from Caol shean inland, where goods from the river port are loaded from boats to carts. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the inland ford of Caol shean.

Àth dhomhain (Dùn thais). Founded 6 an t-Ògmhios 1069 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers of Dùn thais. The deep ford lies below Muileann chaol, and every reader bound for the library crosses it. It is a town of eleven thousand. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for deep ford below Muileann chaol.

Àth dhubh (Dùn chrom). Founded 1 an t-Sultain 738 DE by Ròdaich ferrymen of Dùn chrom. The black ford takes its name from the dark water over the crossing. Walls were raised in the Age of Strangers, when the crossing carried much of the capital's traffic eastward. The Battle of Muileann ghlas, the last of An Cogadh Fada, was fought within sight of its walls. Known for the black ford and its walls.

Àth fhada (Baile gharbh). Founded 12 an t-Sultain 490 BDE by ford-keepers of the north-east road. Àth fhada, the long ford, is a town on the north-east road, founded in the Holy Age. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Its ford is long and shallow, and carts cross it only at low water. Known for long ford of the north-east road.

Àth fhada (Cnoc ghorm). Founded 18 am Màrt 869 DE by Ròdaich ford-wardens, resettled by the Tuathaich. A long ford on the north-western roads, held by a Ròdaich warden-family through the quiet centuries of the Sundering. After the Severance its houses were emptied and given to Tuathaich families shepherded north, who raised the present walls and made it one of the chief towns of their homeland. The Tuathaich here keep the faith of the Church, and their church stands among the shrines the Ròdaich left behind; the ford is still paid for in toll. Its dubhan works, the largest in the north-west, is now its chief trade, and it binds books, a craft the Tuathaich learned at Muileann leathan. Known for the long ford and its toll.

Àth fhiadhaich (Àth fhiadhaich). Founded 21 an t-Samhain 2771 BDE by ford-wardens of the eastern road. Àth fhiadhaich stands in the south-eastern hills at the ford where the eastern road crosses the meeting of the Abhainn gheal and the Abhainn bhàn, and it has been a river landing since the Holy Age. It grew great on the traffic of the vein country in the Age of Strangers, and the famous tavern An Sligeanach Fad' às stands at Ceann bhàn, a short way down the road. The town keeps the Old Spirits, the oldest folk rite, and its river fishers still bless their nets at the ford. Copper is mined in the hills behind it, and the town's new street is named for the Sloc Mòr. Known for wild ford of the eastern road.

Àth fhiadhaich (Baile gheal). Founded 6 an Cèitean 20 BDE by ford-keepers of the road to the Stone. Àth fhiadhaich of the south-west is a ford on the pilgrimage road from Caol leathan to the temple of Lia Fàil at Inis thais. It grew from a single house of the long quiet centuries into a small town that lives on the pilgrims. It keeps the order of the Stone. Known for ford on the pilgrims' road to Lia Fàil.

Àth fhiadhaich (Doire chaol). Founded 14 an t-Sultain 2004 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers of the capital. Àth fhiadhaich is the wild ford on the south road out of Cathair dhearg, a town of ten thousand that grew as the capital grew. Its crossing was paved in the Holy Age, and the road over it carries the capital's trade toward the southern coast. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha, and its shrine keepers take part in the rites at Cathair dhearg. Known for wild ford on the capital's south road.

Àth fhionn (Àth fhionn). Founded 26 an Giblean 2099 BDE by drovers of the southern roads. Àth fhionn, the fair ford, is a large inland town at the crossing of the southern drove road. It has been a resting place for herds and drovers since the Holy Age. Its people keep the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and hold the drove-road fair at the ford. Known for fording place of the southern drove road.

Àth fhionn (Seann Skell). Founded 13 an t-Samhain 1743 DE by farmers of the south-east. Àth fhionn of Seann Skell is a ford town of the south-east. It was founded in the long quiet centuries. Since An Cogadh Fada it has billeted soldiers of the regiments stationed at Seann Skell nearby. It keeps the orthodox rite of Òrd Bhrìde. Known for ford town beside the Seann Skell garrisons.

Àth fhionn (Muileann shean). Founded 30 an Dùbhlachd 658 DE by fishers of the north coast. Àth fhionn of Muileann shean is a ford town of the north coast, founded in the long quiet centuries where the coast road crosses a clear stream. It shares the watch-fire of Cnoc gheal and trades with the harbour of Cill leathan. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. It is the market town of the north coast. Fish, whale-oil and wool come to its strand-market, and its whale-boats go out every summer. Known for fair ford of the north coast.

Àth fhionn (Seann Bhrenn). Founded 8 am Màrt 2761 BDE by the ford-keepers of Seann Bhrenn. A fair ford in the north below the city of Dùn thais, on the road from the Seann-Dhaoine harbour at Seann Bhrenn. It keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich and remains a small crossing town. Known for the fair ford.

Àth fhionn (Caol mhòr). Founded 25 an Cèitean 1793 DE by human traders, as a waystation. Àth fhionn was a waystation of human traders on the road north, built in the Age of Strangers at a fair ford. The Tuathaich kept it after the Severance. It is small, fewer than a thousand people, and its inn is still built in the humans' manner. Known for a human waystation at the fair ford.

Àth fhionn (Ceann mhòr). Founded 14 an Dùbhlachd 1224 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A fair ford on the western coast road below the lighthouse of Baile chrom, struck by Gorta Baile chrom in the Age of Strangers and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It is a town of nearly nine thousand and the market for Doire chaol's charcoal. Its people follow the faith of the Church, as most of this coast does. Known for fair ford of the western coast.

Àth gharbh (Doire shean). Founded 28 an t-Sultain 1144 BDE by drovers of the western road. Àth gharbh, the rough ford, is a walled town of the south-west, a short walk from Doire shean and its great roadside tavern, Am Buabhall Fortanach. That tavern fortified with the others of the old mining circuit before the war of the Severance. Since An Cogadh Fada, A' chiad chabhlach has been stationed here and carries the town's name; its hulls lie in the harbour of Doire shean below. Known for the First Fleet's walled ford town.

Àth gharbh (Cuan ghlas). Founded 13 an Gearran 1477 DE by drovers of the central hills. A rough ford on the hill road near Baile Mòr uaine, where the drovers rest their beasts. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and is a very small place. Coinneachadh nan Cupan, the spring where the keeper's stone cup was first checked against its copies, lies on the moor between the ford and Tobar dhìreach. Known for a drovers' ford in the hills.

Àth gheal (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 29 an t-Sultain 643 DE by Ròdaich ferrymen; resettled by the Tuathaich. Àth gheal was a Ròdaich ford-and-harbour town of the long quiet centuries, walled in the Age of Strangers and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. When the dubhan economy came it was among the northern towns that went on working the last coal seams. It was one of the holdouts broken in An Cogadh Fada, and its people still speak bitterly of that year. Known for a walled town of the coal-holdouts.

Àth gheal (Muileann bheag). Founded 20 an t-Ògmhios 982 DE by farmers of Muileann bheag. Àth gheal of Muileann bheag is a ford town near Seann Tarr, founded in the long quiet centuries. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. At the great feasts it lodges the pilgrims bound for the shrine at Seann Tarr. Known for white ford near Seann Tarr.

Àth ghlas (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 16 an Giblean 110 DE by the grey-stone quarrymen. A ford over grey water on the road between Baile Mòr dhomhain and the south, it grew up around a quarry whose pale-grey stone faces half the city's houses. The quarry is now worked out, and the town has shrunk to a waystation for carriers. Its people keep to the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the worked-out grey quarry.

Àth ghlas (Àth ghlas). Founded 12 an t-Iuchar 2626 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers of the central country. The grey ford is the seat of its province, a large town beside Cathair mhòr and a short way from the ruin of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire. The ruin predates every known pattern of settlement on the island, and the town has kept its people out of it by custom. It lives on trade between Cathair mhòr and the eastern towns. Known for grey ford below the ruined outpost.

Àth ghlas (Ceann mhin). Founded 7 am Màrt 353 DE by Ròdaich ford-keepers. A small town at a grey ford upstream of Drochaid Ros fhionn. It took the traffic when the old bridge fell out of use, and grew as the bridge-villages shrank. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for grey ford that replaced the old bridge.

Àth ghlas (Inis thais). Founded 31 am Faoilleach 1586 BDE by Ròdaich traders of Inis thais. Àth ghlas is a large ford-market of the west, near Seann Warr. It follows the order of Manannan. It is one of three places named Àth ghlas and the largest. Known for grey ford market of the west.

Àth ghorm (Seann Dunn). Founded 28 an Giblean 1364 DE by ford-keepers of Seann Dunn. A blue ford with a small citadel on the road inland from Seann Dunn, built to hold the crossing for the harbour. It follows the order of Macha and is a small town of carters and toll-keepers. Known for the toll-ford of Seann Dunn.

Àth ghorm (Cnoc leathan). Founded 27 an Lùnastal 390 DE by Ròdaich innkeepers of Cnoc leathan. A small town at a blue ford a short way from An Taigh-òsta Grianach, the great roadside inn of the eastern circuit. Its people keep stables and sell to travellers. It fortified its inns before the war, as the tavern road did everywhere. Known for blue ford by An Taigh-òsta Grianach.

Àth iséal (Muileann chrom). Founded 7 an t-Iuchar 285 DE by Ròdaich ferrymen of Muileann chrom. The low ford floods each wet season, and for part of every year the crossing is made by ferry. The town is small and has always been poor. It sends its surplus down to the quays at Inis iséal and Ceann fhada. Known for the low ford and its ferry.

Àth leathan (Seann Skell). Founded 8 am Màrt 1264 DE by Ròdaich drovers; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A Ròdaich drovers' village at the wide ford, emptied at the Severance and resettled by Tuathaich families sent north. In the years before the Long War it became a gathering place for the coal-holdouts of the north-west. The Battle of Àth leathan, the first major engagement of An Cogadh Fada, was fought on the meadows just west of the ford, and the town has not recovered its numbers since. Known for the first battlefield of the Long War.

Àth leathan (Caol mhòr). Founded 24 am Faoilleach 886 DE by Ròdaich drovers; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. The northern Àth leathan is a drovers' ford resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It is not the battlefield of the Long War, which lies far to the south-west, and its people have spent a generation correcting travellers. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for a drovers' ford in the north.

Àth mhin (Dùn chrom). Founded 7 an t-Ògmhios 1025 DE by wardens of the Dùn chrom crossings. A walled town with a citadel at the smooth ford, one of a chain of crossings east of the capital. It was a quartering place for soldiers in the Age of Strangers and again in the Long War, when it held the state's stores for the campaign that ended at Muileann ghlas. Its people are mostly carters and stable-keepers. Known for the smooth ford and its citadel.

Àth mhòr (Baile chaol). Founded 12 an t-Samhain 581 BDE by Ròdaich road-keepers of Baile chaol. The great ford carries the road from Seann Dunn inland, and for most of its history it has been the busiest crossing in the province. A path leaves the town southward to Làrach an Teampaill, and the folk of Àth mhòr have kept that path cleared for as long as there are accounts of it, though they will not say why. It is a large, plain town of carters, smiths and innkeepers. Known for the great ford and the temple-ruin path.

Àth mhòr (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 26 an Cèitean 1401 BDE by Ròdaich ford-keepers of the northern plain. One of several towns of this name, this Àth mhòr carries the tavern road across the river near An Taigh-seinnse Reòta. It was a waypoint on the mining roads in the Holy Age and a militia halt in the years before the war. It trades oak from Doire dhireach down the road to the towns of the plain. Known for ford on the northern tavern road.

Àth mhòr (Àth mhòr). Founded 1 an t-Ògmhios 1452 BDE by a custodian house of the northern ford. Àth mhòr is the walled great ford of the north and the seat of its province, a town of twelve thousand. Its walls were raised in the Age of Strangers, when the northern road carried ore to the coast and the ford was worth holding. Baile bheag lies across the river and handles the traffic after the gates are shut. Known for walled great ford of the north.

Àth naomh (Cuan shean). Founded 26 an Giblean 861 DE by druids of the order of Manannan. A holy ford near Cuan shean, where the druids of Manannan bless the carts that go down to the harbour. It follows the order of Manannan and is a small town of shrine-keepers and carters. Bog-iron is dug in the moss behind the town, and its forges have made arms and field-guns for the regiments since An Cogadh Fada. Known for blessing of the harbour carts.

Àth naomh (Cnoc thais). Founded 26 an t-Sultain 219 BDE by Ròdaich druids of the holy ford; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. The holy ford was a Ròdaich shrine and crossing, and a citadel was raised over it in the Holy Age. At the Severance the Ròdaich left and Tuathaich families took the town, which is now one of the largest they hold. They keep the citadel manned and the old shrine open as their church. Known for citadel over the holy ford.

Àth ruadh (Doire fhionn). Founded 25 an t-Sultain 664 BDE by cattle-drovers of the eastern hills. A red-banked ford where the drovers' road crosses a stream in the east, it has been a cattle-market since the Holy Age. It keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich, and the drovers still pour a cup into the ford before driving a herd across. The town trades beasts to Seann Dunn on the coast and hides to Baile shean. Furs and hides from the eastern hills are sold at its fair. Known for the drovers' ford and cattle fair.

Àth shean (Àth shean). Founded 9 an t-Iuchar 1019 BDE by ford-wardens of the capital road. The northern of the two Àth shean holds the old ford where the road east from the capital crosses its river. It was walled in the Holy Age to guard that crossing and has grown into a large town. An Taigh-seinnse Mòr stands a short way up the road toward Seann Vell. The dark wine pressed on its slopes is sold along the eastern road. Known for old ford of the eastern road.

Àth shean (Àth shean). Founded 15 an Dàmhair 1036 BDE by ford-wardens of the south. The southern Àth shean is the larger of the two, a great ford town near the south coast. It has been a market since the Holy Age and has never needed walls. Its harbour is the old site of Seann Chwen, a short way east. Known for the great southern ford market.

Àth shean (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 8 an t-Ògmhios 513 BDE by boatmen of the Baile Mòr dhomhain river. The old ford and landing that served Baile Mòr dhomhain before the city had quays of its own. Barges from the landing carry the city's goods to the coast, and the boatmen's guild here is older than the city's walls. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith like its great neighbour and is counted, for most purposes, as the city's river-port. Known for the river landing of Baile Mòr dhomhain.

Àth shean (Tobar ghorm). Founded 15 an t-Iuchar 1340 BDE by the ford-lords of Tobar ghorm. An old walled ford with a citadel in the north, holding the road between Tobar ghorm and Cnoc dhubh. Its keep was fought for in the war before the Severance. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the old walled ford.

Àth shean (Seann Skell). Founded 9 an t-Ògmhios 1073 BDE by Ròdaich keepers of the northern ford. An old ford on the road north out of the Ròdaich country, walled in the Age of Strangers and strengthened again after the Severance, when the Tuathaich country began a short way to the west. It is a town of the Hawk order, Òrd an t-Seabhaig, and its temple is one of the oldest of the order, whose rite is the older form of Òrd Bhride's. It trades with Inis bhàn to the south and, warily, with the Tuathaich villages over the line. Known for old ford on the northern march.

Àth uaine (Cnoc ghorm). Founded 18 an t-Samhain 823 BDE by Ròdaich weavers; resettled by the Tuathaich. Àth uaine of Cnoc ghorm is a green ford of the north-west, founded by Ròdaich flax-weavers in the Holy Age. It was resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance and still weaves. It keeps the faith of the Church. Known for green ford and flax-weaving.

Àth uaine (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 6 an Cèitean 1842 DE by Ròdaich miners under extraction contract. Àth uaine of Cnoc dhubh began as a mining camp at a ford in the Age of Strangers. Its camp graves lie in the field by the ford, tended by the keepers of the Old Spirits' ancestor rite. The camp outlived its working and became a small farm town. Known for camp graves by the green ford.

Àth uaine (Seann Skell). Founded 3 an Giblean 2858 BDE by ford-keepers of Seann Skell. Àth uaine of Seann Skell is a ford town inland of the Hawk bay, founded in the Holy Age. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. It is the market for the three quarrelling harbours of the bay. Known for green ford inland of Seann Skell.

Àth uaine (Doire fhionn). Founded 25 an Giblean 1676 DE by the wardens of the Achadh shean road. A small garrison town at the green ford on the road between Doire fhionn and Achadh shean. Its citadel is larger than the town needs, a sign that the ford was once contested, though the record does not preserve by whom. Tiormachd Achadh shean, the Long Drought, struck it in the Age of Strangers, and it lives now on toll and on the soldiers who still keep the tower. Known for garrisoned green ford.

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Baile àrsaidh (Baile chiar). Founded 1 an Gearran 2523 BDE by custodians of the capital's south. Baile àrsaidh, the ancient town, is a citadel town of the capital's southern country, founded in the Holy Age. Its citadel guards the market at Baile chiar. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for old citadel of the southern country.

Baile àrsaidh (Caol mhòr). Founded 15 am Màrt 1348 BDE by Ròdaich shore-lords, resettled by the Tuathaich. An ancient walled town near the harbour of Caol mhòr, one of the Ròdaich towns resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. The walls are older than the Ròdaich say they know, and the Tuathaich have kept them. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for old walls in the Tuathaich north.

Baile àrsaidh (Baile àrsaidh). Founded 6 an t-Ògmhios 2171 BDE by Ròdaich druids of the order of Manannan. Baile àrsaidh is the ancient town of the west, the seat of its province and the place where the druids of the order of Manannan have kept their school since the orders divided. It is a large town of twenty thousand. It trades with Seann Skell to the north and with the fleet at Cuan shean to the south. Known for the school of Manannan's druids.

Baile bhàn (Caol bheag). Founded 21 an Giblean 1595 DE by fullers of the northern coast. A town of fulling-mills and white cloth between the port-city of Ros chiar and the city of Baile Mòr dhìreach. Its fullers bleached wool for the harbours of the north coast and still do, though in smaller measure since the trade moved to Inis mhòr. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for bleached cloth from the fulling-mills.

Baile bhàn (Cill dhìreach). Founded 30 an t-Sultain 1229 DE by a custodian house of Cill dhìreach. Baile bhàn is a white town with a citadel above Cill dhìreach, built to guard the temple-town and its treasures. It is a town of five thousand. Its garrison keeps order at Còmhrag Ceann leathan. Known for citadel above Cill dhìreach.

Baile bhàn (Doire mhin). Founded 19 an Dùbhlachd 1199 DE by Ròdaich traders of Doire mhin. Baile bhàn is a white town of nine thousand near Cathair mhòr, on the road toward Muileann ghlas. Before the last battle of the Long War the state's columns marched through it. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for white town on the Muileann ghlas road.

Baile bheag (Àth mhòr). Founded 20 an Dùbhlachd 141 DE by carters across the ford from Àth mhòr. A small town across the ford from Àth mhòr, grown up to serve the traffic that the walled town would not let in after dark. It is a town of stables, carters and cheap lodging. It has always been a dependent of Àth mhòr and has never been allowed a market of its own. Known for carters across the ford.

Baile bheag (Muileann bheag). Founded 3 an t-Samhain 1007 DE by toll-keepers of Muileann bheag. A small town on the road to Muileann bheag, walled to collect tolls rather than to keep enemies out. It still collects them, and has outlasted every attempt to abolish the right. It is one of several places named Baile bheag. Known for a walled town of tolls.

Baile chaol (Baile chaol). Founded 30 an Dùbhlachd 1660 BDE by the valley-folk of the eastern narrows. A town squeezed into a narrow valley in the east and the seat of Siorrachd Baile chaol. Its houses climb the valley sides in rows, and the one road through it has been tolled since the Holy Age. It keeps the Old Spirits and trades with the city of Baile Mòr dhìreach and the market at Cnoc uaine; the sacred forest of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar lies on its western edge. Known for terraced houses and the valley toll.

Baile chiar (Baile chiar). Founded 1 an Gearran 2130 BDE by farmers of the capital's southern country. Baile chiar, the dusky town, is the market and provincial seat of the capital's southern country. It has been a farm market since the Holy Age and has never been walled; the citadel at Baile àrsaidh stands close by. Grain from Achadh fhada and the southern farms comes to its market. Its chartered weavers make cloth from southern wool. Known for market of the capital's southern country.

Baile chrom (Doire mhin). Founded 24 am Faoilleach 231 DE by the tithe-reeves of Cathair mhòr. A walled town on a bend of the road below Cathair mhòr, raised to store and guard the tithe-grain of the Doire mhin country. Its walls were strengthened when the human administration raised the tithe, and the chroniclers note that the grain was guarded but not shared. It keeps the order of Macha and serves Cill fhada and Muileann ruadh as their market. The dubhan works under its walls supply the forges of the gulf, and the town boils soap. Known for the walled tithe-granaries.

Baile chrom (Dùn chrom). Founded 5 am Màrt 643 DE by herders from Dùn chrom. The lesser of the two Baile chroms in the central midlands, this one lies under the citadel of Dùn chrom and grew as its stockyard. The fighting at Muileann ghlas in the last year of the Long War passed close enough that the town housed wounded for a season. It keeps the order of Macha. Known for Dùn chrom's stockyards.

Baile chrom (Baile chrom). Founded 3 an t-Ògmhios 150 BDE by Ròdaich fishers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A bent town on the far north-west coast, the seat of Siorrachd Baile chrom, beside Taigh-solais Baile chrom, the first of the five lighthouses in the ring. Since the Severance it has been Tuathaich, and it is the one town where Rùn-diomhair na h-Oidhche Glaise, the Christian vigil of the Grey Night, holds the majority; its one night of silence is kept for an Gèadh Fiadhaich, the wild goose of the Holy Spirit. Gorta Baile chrom, the Great Hunger, takes its name from this town, which it struck in the Age of Strangers. The Church's priests at Ceann mhòr hold that the Grey Night grew out of their own harbour prayer to keep the sea shut, and the bishops call it irregular, the Church gone astray. Known for the Grey Night vigil and the lighthouse.

Baile chrom (Ceann àrsaidh). Founded 16 an Lùnastal 697 DE by Ròdaich market families of Ceann àrsaidh. Baile chrom is named for its bending main street, which follows an old stream-bed. It is a market town between the capital and the northern plain, serving Baile fhiadhaich and Cuan chrom. It shares its name with three other places on the island, and the chroniclers take care to give its province. Known for the bent-street market.

Baile dhearg (Achadh chaol). Founded 10 an t-Iuchar 1037 DE by farmers of Achadh chaol. A red town in the east on the road to the harbour at Seann Toll. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for red town on the harbour road.

Baile dhìreach (Inis thais). Founded 14 an t-Iuchar 1353 DE by traders of the order of Manannan from the west. Baile dhìreach, the straight town, is a harbour on the west coast built around one long street to the quay. It was founded in the long quiet centuries by traders of the order of Manannan, among neighbours of the order of the Stone. The two orders have shared its market without any trouble the rolls think worth noting. Known for straight-street harbour of the order of Manannan.

Baile dhireach (Cnoc gheal). Founded 6 an Màrt 1115 DE by road-builders of Cnoc gheal. A straight town on the road from Cnoc gheal to Seann Bhrenn, named for the road that made it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and is a carters' stop on the way to the coast. Known for the straight road to Seann Bhrenn.

Baile dhireach (Caol shean). Founded 16 an Giblean 2124 BDE by Ròdaich pilgrims to Allt an Àigh. Baile dhireach is the nearest town to Allt an Àigh, and the straight road that gives it its name runs from its square down to the stream. It grew up in the Holy Age to serve the pilgrims and still does, alongside Cnoc iséal further up the road. Its people are wary of strangers who come at the wrong phase of the moon. Gold is washed from the stream below the town, and its refiners make blanks for the mint. Known for the nearest town to Allt an Àigh.

Baile dhireach (Muileann naomh). Founded 3 an Gearran 1036 DE by Ròdaich traders of Muileann naomh. A small town of one straight street on the far west, twinned with Cnoc gheal a short walk away. It lies close to the Tuathaich line and trades with the villages beyond it. It follows the order of Manannan. Known for straight-street twin of Cnoc gheal.

Baile dhireach (Doire fhionn). Founded 1 an t-Samhain 212 DE by carters of the Seann Dunn road. A town of one straight road running down to Seann Dunn, whose carters take the dyed cloth of Baile ghorm to the harbour. It is a town of nearly ten thousand. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for straight road to Seann Dunn.

Baile dhomhain (Muileann chrom). Founded 28 an Lùnastal 67 DE by druid-farmers of Cnoc bhàn. A small town in a deep valley, farming for the druids of Macha at Cnoc bhàn. It has no walls and little history beyond the tithe-rolls of the druids' house, which record its harvests without a gap from the Sundering to the present. Known for tithe-fields of the Cnoc bhàn druids.

Baile dhomhain (Baile ghorm). Founded 7 an t-Samhain 1463 DE by rope-walkers of Baile ghorm. The deep town a short walk inland of Baile ghorm, where the harbour's rope-walks and timber-yards were moved to be clear of storms. The panthers' migration road, Imrich nam Pantar, crosses its fields, and the townsfolk shut their stock in when the cats pass. It follows the order of the Stone and works almost entirely for the harbour and its fleet. Known for rope-walks and the panthers' road.

Baile dhomhain (Cnoc bheag). Founded 2 an t-Samhain 1101 DE by Ròdaich followers of the Hawk order. Baile dhomhain is a walled town in a deep valley near Cnoc bheag, one of the towns of the Hawk order. Its walls were raised in the Age of Strangers and strengthened after the Severance, when the Tuathaich line was drawn close by. A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death, struck it in the Age of Strangers. Its trade goes down to the quay at Ceann òg. Known for walled deep-valley town of the Hawk order.

Baile dhubh (Cnoc ghorm). Founded 22 an Dàmhair 1103 DE by Ròdaich herders of the black-soil fields. Named for the dark earth of its fields, Baile dhubh was an ordinary Ròdaich farm town until the Severance drew the northern border around it. It kept its people when the province of Cnoc ghorm passed to the Tuathaich, and has lived since as a place of exchange and quiet mutual suspicion. Its folk keep the Old Faith in the order of Manannan, whose sea-feasts their Christian neighbours to the north have always kept beside their own, which is thought to be why they were left in peace. Known for Ròdaich enclave on the Tuathaich border.

Baile dhubh (Caol mhòr). Founded 4 an t-Samhain 1865 DE by human colliers of the northern seams. Baile dhubh, "the black town", was built by human colliers in the Age of Strangers on one of the northern coal seams, which the humans worked alongside the vein in the south. After the Severance it passed to the Tuathaich with the rest of the north. Before the Long War it was one of the communities that refused the new fuel and kept working the last workable seams. Known for coal pits of the northern holdouts.

Baile dhubh (Baile ghlas). Founded 1 an Giblean 1848 DE by human administrators near Seann Warr. Baile dhubh was built in the Age of Strangers as a clerks' town for the human administration near Seann Warr, where the fifth regiment is now stationed. After the Severance its Ròdaich people took up the order of the Stone, the Old Faith of the country around it. It has fewer than seven hundred people and lives on the garrison. Known for former clerks' town by Seann Warr.

Baile fhada (Seann Dunn). Founded 27 an Dùbhlachd 681 DE by Ròdaich soldiers of the capital's south. A town of one long street with a citadel at its end, south-east of the capital. It was a garrison town in the Age of Strangers and has kept its citadel manned since. Its people are soldiers' families and carters, and its street is the last stage of the road from the southern coast to Cathair dhearg. Known for long street and citadel south of the capital.

Baile fhiadhaich (Cnoc gheal). Founded 6 am Faoilleach 563 DE by farmers of the north-east. Baile fhiadhaich of Cnoc gheal is a walled farm town of the north-east. It was founded in the long quiet centuries and walled in the Age of Strangers against raiders from the sea. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Its fields grow the dye-plants of the north-east, and its colours go to the feast-market at Seann Tarr. Known for walled farm town of the north-east.

Baile fhiadhaich (Baile fhiadhaich). Founded 29 an Dùbhlachd 2977 BDE by Ròdaich traders of the west. Baile fhiadhaich of the west is a large harbour town and the seat of its province, founded in the Holy Age. It lies near the field of Àth leathan, and its people remember the first battle of An Cogadh Fada. It keeps the order of Manannan. Known for west-coast market harbour.

Baile fhiadhaich (Ceann àrsaidh). Founded 7 an Dàmhair 368 DE by Ròdaich hunters of Ceann àrsaidh. The wild town was a hunters' camp in the Age of Sundering, when the forests of Ceann àrsaidh were larger. It still lives on hides and game, and its curing-sheds can be smelled from the road. Its people trade at Baile chrom. Known for hunters and hide-curers.

Baile fhionn (Muileann leathan). Founded 31 an Dàmhair 1733 DE by Ròdaich farmers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A small fair town in the north-west, resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It follows the Tuathaich Church and trades across the line with the Ròdaich town of Baile ruadh. Known for trade across the line with Baile ruadh.

Baile gharbh (Baile gharbh). Founded 21 am Màrt 2138 BDE by wool merchants of the north. Baile gharbh is a large market town of the north-east and the seat of its province. It has been a wool market since the Holy Age, and the moor towns of Cnoc chaol and Àth fhada bring their flocks and cheese to it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and has no walls, trusting to Baile Mòr dhreach close by. Known for rough-town wool market.

Baile gharbh (Tobar dhearg). Founded 1 an t-Ògmhios 661 DE by the carters of Seann Vell. A rough town on the south coast road between Seann Vell and the lighthouse village of Tobar dhearg. It is one of the few towns where Òrd Bhrìde holds the majority, its orthodox druids having come from the pilgrim harbour at Caol naomh. It trades with Muileann naomh and the great port of Seann Skell. Known for an orthodox town of Bride's flame on the coast road.

Baile gheal (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 27 an Giblean 2284 BDE by Ròdaich salt-boilers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A white-washed Ròdaich village of the Holy Age, it was one of the settlements emptied and handed to the Tuathaich after the Severance. The newcomers made it a town and a market, trading with the harbour at Caol naomh a short distance away. Its church stands in the shell of the older Ròdaich shrine of Manannan, and the two sets of carvings can still be told apart. Known for the church in the old shrine.

Baile gheal (Tobar ghorm). Founded 2 an t-Ògmhios 1062 DE by the lime-burners of Tobar ghorm. A white town named for the lime-kilns that whitened it, walled in the Age of Strangers after raids on the road to the harbour at Inis naomh. It is paired with Cnoc mhòr on the hill above, and the two share a market and a quarrel over which is older. Its people follow the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for lime-kilns and whitewashed walls.

Baile gheal (Baile gheal). Founded 3 an t-Ògmhios 1937 BDE by the white-cloth weavers of the west. A large white town of the western plain and the seat of Siorrachd Baile gheal. It is a city of the order of the Stone in all but name, and it trades cloth with Baile Mòr fhionn and the harbour of Inis thais. Known for white cloth of the western plain.

Baile gheal (Ceann leathan). Founded 11 an t-Samhain 243 DE by lime-burners of Ceann leathan. A small town of lime kilns whose white dust gives it its name. It supplies lime to the builders of the eastern coast and the fields around Ceann leathan. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for lime kilns of the east.

Baile ghlas (Baile ghlas). Founded 14 an t-Samhain 2067 BDE by rope-makers of the capital shore. Baile ghlas is a great harbour town on the capital shore and the seat of its province. Its rope-walks and sail-lofts have fitted ships for the capital since the Holy Age, and it claims, with no record to prove it, to have rigged the Sundering fleet. It has never been walled; the capital's walls stand close by. Known for rope-walks and sail-lofts.

Baile ghlas (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 13 an t-Samhain 279 DE by Ròdaich green-dyers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A green-grey town of dyers, emptied at the Severance and resettled by the Tuathaich. It keeps the Tuathaich Church and is a market for Baile Mòr ruadh and Cnoc ghlas. Known for green dyes and Tuathaich church feasts.

Baile ghlas (Cuan ruadh). Founded 4 an Gearran 333 DE by Ròdaich slate-quarriers of Cuan ruadh. A small town of grey slate on the eastern coast, quarrying for the roofs of Achadh shean and Cnoc uaine. Its people keep the Old Spirits. Known for grey slate of the east coast.

Baile ghorm (Baile ghorm). Founded 22 an Gearran 2162 BDE by farming kindreds of the south-eastern downs. Baile ghorm is the market of its shire, a large open town without walls where the south-eastern farms bring their grain and wool. Its people keep the Old Spirits, the oldest folk rite of the island, and household shrines to the ancestors outnumber its spirit-houses. Achadh fhionn is its nearest field-village, and the ruin of Làrach an Dùin stands in its hinterland, left alone by custom. Known for south-eastern grain and wool market.

Baile ghorm (Baile ghorm). Founded 7 an t-Ògmhios 2484 BDE by net-fishing families of the southern shore. A landing of drying-racks and boat-sheds on the southern coast, Baile ghorm grew through the Holy Age into the largest harbour between the capital and the eastern capes. Its people keep the order of the Stone, whose stone is Clach, and its quays are lined with the wolf-head posts, for the wolf of the Fianna, that mark a harbour of that order. Since the Long War it has been the station of An treas cabhlach, the third fleet, and its yards do more repair work for the crown than fishing for themselves. Its smaller twin, Baile dhomhain, lies a short walk inland and sends it timber and rope. Known for the third fleet's anchorage and wolf-post quays.

Baile ghorm (Doire fhionn). Founded 22 an Lùnastal 270 DE by Ròdaich dyers from Achadh shean. Baile ghorm grew up around woad pits and dye-houses, and in the chronicles' day its houses were still washed blue from the vats. It sent cloth to Seann Dunn for shipping and yarn to Achadh shean for weaving. The Old Spirits, the folk tradition of the ancestors, hold here strongly, and the dyers still leave a first skein at the hearth-stone each season. Known for woad dyers and blue-washed houses.

Baile ghorm (Àth dhomhain). Founded 7 am Màrt 1718 DE by slate-quarriers of Àth dhomhain. Baile ghorm is a quarry town whose blue slate roofs half the northern plain. It sends slate to Inis mhòr and takes grain in return. It shares its name with a dyers' town far to the east, and the two are told apart in the record by their provinces. Known for blue slate quarries.

Baile iséal (Seann Chwen). Founded 5 an t-Ògmhios 1273 DE by farmers of the Seann Chwen country. A low town in the middle east, a short way south of Cill ghlas and the ground the Rending tore open. It follows the order of Macha and sends its grain to the harbour at Seann Chwen. Known for grain town south of Cill ghlas.

Baile iséal (Àth bheag). Founded 14 an t-Samhain 158 DE by fishers of the far east coast. A small low town on the far east coast, beside Taigh-solais Baile iséal, one of the five light-houses completed in the Age of Strangers. Pirates are still seen off this coast, and the light-house-keepers double as the town's watch. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for Taigh-solais Baile iséal and the pirate watch.

Baile iséal (Baile iséal). Founded 16 an t-Sultain 1528 DE by Ròdaich farmers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A low walled town in the north-west, the seat of Siorrachd Baile iséal, resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It follows the faith of the Church and is one of the larger Tuathaich towns. Known for the low walled town of the north-west.

Baile iséal (Cill thais). Founded 1 an t-Sultain 788 DE by farmers of Cill thais. A small walled town near Cill thais and Baile chiar, west of the capital. The walls were raised in the war before the Severance. It follows the order of Macha and has little trade of its own. Known for small walls near the capital.

Baile leathan (Muileann leathan). Founded 21 an t-Iuchar 1802 DE by human settlers from an Tìr Thall. Baile leathan was built by human settlers in the Age of Strangers on the northern coast, one of the few places the strangers founded rather than took. After the Severance it became a Tuathaich town. It keeps the faith of the Church and its oldest families still count their descent from the Crossing. Known for an old strangers' settlement of the north.

Baile leathan (Dùn thais). Founded 21 am Faoilleach 906 BDE by Ròdaich scribes of Dùn thais. Baile leathan is one of the towns nearest Leabharlann Muileann chaol, and many of its people are copyists, binders and parchment-makers for the library. It was a market town of the broad valley long before the library was founded, and it grew quickly after. It keeps the druid schools' habit of reading aloud in the evenings. Known for copyists and binders for the library.

Baile mhin (Baile mhin). Founded 17 an t-Ògmhios 1314 BDE by Ròdaich river-folk of the north-east. Baile mhin is a river town on the Abhainn bheag in the north-east and the seat of its province, founded in the Holy Age. Its quays are sheltered and its trade steady, and its barges go down to Caol chrom at the river mouth. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, and the old landing of Seann Vell lies within its province. Known for sheltered river quays of the north-east.

Baile mhin (Achadh chaol). Founded 23 an Dàmhair 1136 DE by carters of the Achadh chaol road. Baile mhin grew where the road from Achadh chaol to the coast levels out, a stopping place for carts. It is a small town of wheelwrights and stables. Its people send their grain to the mills at Muileann dhìreach. Known for wheelwrights on the Achadh chaol road.

Baile mhòr (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 17 an t-Iuchar 2873 BDE by herders of the northern moor. The name promises a great town and the place has never been one; the chroniclers suppose it was large only beside the shielings around it when it was named. It is a quiet market for wool from the moor, dependent on Cnoc dhubh for its road and on Tobar fhiadhaich for its law. Its folk follow the druid schools of the Old Faith and keep a small reading-house where the druid schools' questions are argued on winter nights. Known for moorland wool and an ill-fitting name.

Baile mhòr (Seann Tarr). Founded 15 an t-Samhain 1214 DE by craftsmen outside the walls of Baile Mòr ruadh. Baile mhòr grew outside the walls of Baile Mòr ruadh, a suburb of tanners, dyers and other trades the city would not have within its gates. It has never been walled itself. In the Age of Strangers it was burned once in a quarrel between the city and the administration, and rebuilt in stone. Known for trades outside Baile Mòr ruadh's walls.

Baile Mòr àrsaidh (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 16 an t-Samhain 1662 BDE by Ròdaich traders of the northern plain. Baile Mòr àrsaidh is an ancient market city of the northern plain, ranked a city for its age rather than its size. Its market was old in the Holy Age. It takes oak from Doire dhìreach and grain from Achadh dhìreach. Known for ancient market of the northern plain.

Baile Mòr dhìreach (Caol bheag). Founded 8 an Gearran 1267 BDE by custodians of the north-eastern road. Baile Mòr dhìreach of Caol bheag is a walled town with a citadel, built by Holy Age custodians where the north-eastern road runs straight. It is small for a city, but it holds the road and the market between Inis mhòr and Baile gharbh. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for walled town on the straight road.

Baile Mòr dhìreach (Baile chaol). Founded 7 an Gearran 948 BDE by custodians of the eastern road. Baile Mòr dhìreach of Baile chaol is a citadel city on the eastern straight road, founded in the Holy Age to hold the road between the vein country and the coast. It was a tithe station in the Age of Strangers, and the ledgers kept there were among those burned in the raids before the Severance. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. It is the market town of the east coast. The first glass-house on Rodos was built here and still works, and the town also makes cheese, boots and sail-cloth. Known for citadel city of the eastern road.

Baile Mòr dhomhain (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 24 an t-Samhain 2898 BDE by the lords of the deep river. A walled city with a citadel on a deep river in the north, the seat of Si-orrachd Baile Mòr dhomhain. It was one of the great market cities of the north through the Holy Age and the Sundering and a centre of the human administration in the Age of Strangers. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and holds its four fords and its river landing at Àth shean. It is the market town of the northern hills and the second cattle-market of the island. The white marble of its hills is quarried nearby, and the town is known for its books. Known for the deep-river city and its fords.

Baile Mòr fhionn (Caol leathan). Founded 6 an t-Samhain 2415 BDE by the lords of the western plain. A great fair walled city of the west, seat of lords before the kingdom and a fortress since. Its citadel was held by Ròdaich forces through the war that ended in the Severance, and it is a city of the order of the Stone. It is the chief market of the plain between the capital and the western harbours. Its own vineyards give the plain's wine, and the town salts meat, makes boots and dips candles. Known for the fair citadel of the western plain.

Baile Mòr mhòr (Baile Mòr mhòr). Founded 26 an Lùnastal 2977 BDE by the granary-keepers of the early kings in the north. Baile Mòr mhòr is the great city of the north, walled and crowned by a citadel, and the seat of its province. It held one of the royal granaries in the Holy Age and was a centre of the human administration in the Age of Strangers. Since the Severance it has stood close to the Tuathaich country to the west, the largest Ròdaich city on that frontier. Known for the great walled city of the north.

Baile Mòr ruadh (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 3 an Gearran 747 BDE by Ròdaich lords, resettled by the Tuathaich. A red walled city in the north-west, held by Ròdaich lords from the Holy Age to the Severance, and since then one of the principal Tuathaich cities. It follows the faith of the Church and governs the Àth àrsaidh country with its fords and towns. Known for the red city of the Tuathaich.

Baile Mòr ruadh (Seann Tarr). Founded 25 an t-Sultain 2717 BDE by a custodian house of the eastern shore. Baile Mòr ruadh is a walled city of red stone, crowned by a citadel, and the strongest place of its province, though the seat of the shire is the old harbour of Seann Tarr. It was fought over in the Age of Strangers, when the human administration made it a district seat, and when the shires were drawn the seat went back to Seann Tarr. Its walls show repairs of every age. Travellers on the eastern road break their journey at An Taigh-seinnse Òir just west of the city. Its dyers make the reds and blues of the east, and it is one of the chief towns of the east for books and ink. Known for red-stone walls of the east.

Baile Mòr uaine (Cuan ghlas). Founded 22 an Màrt 2017 BDE by custodians of Cuan ghlas. Baile Mòr uaine is a walled city with a citadel in the north-eastern hills, founded in the Holy Age. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and is among their strongholds. Its walls were repaired in the Age of Strangers. Its forges are the chief armoury of the north-eastern hills. Known for walled city of the druid schools.

Baile naomh (Dùn ìseal). Founded 1 an Gearran 2680 BDE by custodians of the holy wells. Baile naomh, the holy town, grew around wells in the vein country that the Holy Age custodians held sacred. The hot springs of Muileann ruadh lie to the west and the silver workings of Muileann chiar to the north-west. It is a small town of shrines and lodging houses, keeping the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for holy wells of the vein country.

Baile òg (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 7 an Dàmhair 479 DE by stone-gatherers of the temple hills. A young town in the eastern hills close by the ruins of Làrach an Teampaill, whose altar faces the vein. Its early houses were built of stones carried off the ruins, a use the elders of the Old Spirits later forbade. It keeps the Old Spirits and serves travellers who come to look at the ruins. Known for houses of stone from Làrach an Teampaill.

Baile òg (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 25 am Màrt 71 DE by carters of Baile Mòr dhomhain. A small young town on the road between Baile Mòr dhomhain and Baile Mòr àrsaidh, grown from a carters' stable. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and lives by changing horses. Known for a carters' stop between two cities.

Baile òg (Baile ìseal). Founded 5 an t-Samhain 1933 DE by Tuathaich families sent north at the Severance. Baile òg, "the young town", was built by Tuathaich families who arrived after the Severance and found no empty village to take. It stands a short way from the larger Tuathaich town of Baile ìseal and has always depended on it. Its houses are the first the Tuathaich built for themselves on the island rather than inherited. Known for the first Tuathaich-built houses.

Baile òg (Seann Chwen). Founded 6 an Dàmhair 1819 DE by a mining crew under the human administration. Baile òg, "the young town", was a camp of the diggings east of the capital, raised in the Age of Strangers near Cill ghlas. It emptied when Scàineadh Cill ghlas closed the district for a generation. It was reopened after the Severance, and its people now follow the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for camp-town of the Cill ghlas diggings.

Baile ruadh (Seann Tarr). Founded 25 an t-Samhain 33 DE by herders of Seann Tarr. Baile ruadh is a farm town near the eastern coast, founded in the long quiet centuries. Since the lighthouses were built its people have supplied the keepers of Taigh-solais Baile ìseal on the coast beyond. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for supplier to Taigh-solais Baile ìseal.

Baile ruadh (Baile ruadh). Founded 3 an Dàmhair 2028 BDE by red-earth farmers of the east. A red town of the east and the seat of Siorrachd Baile ruadh. It keeps the Old Spirits and trades grain with Achadh naomh. Known for red-earth fields of the east.

Baile ruadh (Cuan shean). Founded 9 am Màrt 1754 DE by red-clay potters of the Cuan shean country. A red town of potters and brick-makers behind the harbour of Cuan shean, whose kilns have fired the roof-tiles of the western coast since the centuries after the Sundering. It follows the order of Manannan, and its potters mark each jar with a small scorpion, the order's badge, under the base. Most of what it makes goes out through Cuan shean. Known for red roof-tiles and scorpion-marked jars.

Baile ruadh (Inis mhin). Founded 9 an t-Iuchar 2042 BDE by Ròdaich farmers of the red ground. A red town in the north-west that stayed Ròdaich when the Tuathaich homeland was fixed around it, and the line of the border wall that was proposed and never built would have run past its gate. It keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich, and its market is used by Tuathaich from Baile fhionn and Ròdaich from Àth uaine alike. Known for a shared market on the border.

Baile shean (Doire fhionn). Founded 5 an Dàmhair 1344 BDE by keepers of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar. An old town beside Coille Naomh Muileann chiar, the forest marked sacred before any faith claimed it. Its people have kept the forest's edge since the Holy Age and keep the Old Spirits, though the forest is now held by the druid schools. Known for the keepers of the sacred forest's edge.

Baile shean (Cnoc thais). Founded 27 an Cèitean 2442 BDE by Ròdaich founders; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. An old Ròdaich town with walls and a citadel, emptied at the Severance and taken over by Tuathaich families. In the years before An Cogadh Fada it was counted among the northern communities that refused the dubhan economy. Its walls still stand, and the Tuathaich guard them as the Ròdaich once did. Known for old walls held by the Tuathaich.

Baile shean (Inis chrom). Founded 18 an t-Iuchar 1814 BDE by Ròdaich followers of the order of the Stone. An old walled town of Òrd na Cloiche, the order of the Stone, beside the fort of Muileann bheag. Its walls are older than the fort, and for most of its history it was the stronger of the two. It is small now, and lives on the fort's custom. Known for old walled town of the order of the Stone.

Baile shean (Caol iséal). Founded 13 an Dùbhlachd 2272 BDE by Ròdaich fishers of the northern shore. Baile shean is an old quay on the northern shore and the port of its province. The inn An Taigh-seinnse Reòta lies inland on the road south, and its pickled spinach goes out through the quay. It is one of several places named Baile shean. Known for old quay of the northern shore.

Baile thais (Muileann dhearg). Founded 5 an t-Ògmhios 913 BDE by river-boatmen of the Abhainn uaine. Baile thais stands on the Abhainn uaine where the river leaves the hills for its run down to the gulf, and the river landing of Cidhe Beag lies just downstream. Boats have been launched here since the Holy Age to carry goods inland and ore down. It is a busy, unwall town of boatmen and warehouses. Slighe-mhara Caol fhiadhaich, the southern sea-lane, ends at the landing of Cidhe Beag below the town. Known for Cidhe Beag landing on the Abhainn uaine.

Baile thais (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 28 an Cèitean 816 BDE by Ròdaich eel-fishers of the water-meadows. Baile thais stands on damp ground where the meadows flood each wet season, and its people have always fished the ditches for eels. It is a large town now, and it supplies Cnoc bhàn with hay and fish. The river works that keep the meadows are older than the town's charter. Known for water-meadows and eel traps.

Baile uaine (Àth shean). Founded 5 an Gearran 1093 DE by market gardeners of Àth shean. Baile uaine is a small town of market gardens, sending green stuff to Dùn gheal and on to the capital each market day. It has never been walled or fought over. Its people follow the capital's order, the order of Macha and pay their dues at Dùn gheal. Known for market gardens for the capital.

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Caol bheag (Caol bheag). Founded 15 am Màrt 2522 BDE by fishers of the north coast. A small harbour on the northern strait, older than its far larger namesake inland and the one that gave that town its name. It keeps the Old Spirits and is a quiet fishing town, though An ceathramh rèisimeid, stationed at the larger Caol bheag, sends its patrols here. It stands on Eilean fhada, the long island off the north coast, and the strait it is named for is the sound between that island and Rodos. Known for the elder Caol bheag on the strait.

Caol bheag (Caol bheag). Founded 14 an Lùnastal 2406 BDE by Ròdaich boatmen of the small narrows. Caol bheag is a river port of more than forty thousand on the narrows of the Abhainn ghorm, crowned by a citadel and the seat of its province; its barges run down to Ros chiar at the river mouth. The fourth regiment, raised in the Long War, is stationed here. The mills of Muileann bheag and the wool of Cnoc chiar pass through its quays. Known for fourth regiment's river port.

Caol chrom (Caol gharbh). Founded 13 an Dùbhlachd 1236 DE by the garrison of the bent strait. Caol chrom is a fortified harbour on a bent strait of the north-east, walled and given a citadel in the long quiet centuries. It is a city by rank but small in people, and its garrison has always outnumbered its fishermen. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Its few townsmen boil soap and blow glass for the hill towns. Its headmen and Caol gharbh's meet at Coinneachadh na h-Amhaich, the stone on the neck of land between the two harbours, to settle the dues of the strait. Known for fortified bent strait.

Caol dhomhain (Ceann mhin). Founded 8 an Gearran 1190 DE by the watch of the deep strait. Caol dhomhain is a harbour village on a deep strait of the south-east, with a citadel raised in the long quiet centuries to watch it. The village is small and the citadel is its reason. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for the deep strait's watch-tower.

Caol fhiadhaich (Inis thais). Founded 13 an t-Iuchar 700 DE by fishers of the wild strait. Caol fhiadhaich is a harbour on a rough strait of the west coast, within the province of Inis thais. It was founded in the long quiet centuries by fishers who braved waters the older harbours avoided. Its people keep the Old Faith in the order of the Stone. Its women distil scent-waters, the town's second trade after the fishing. The southern sea-lane, Slighe-mhara Caol fhiadhaich, is named for its fishers, who first sailed it round the south coast in the long quiet centuries. Known for fishing the wild strait.

Caol fhiadhaich (Caol fhiadhaich). Founded 12 an t-Iuchar 2857 BDE by the strait-pilots of the south-west. A harbour on a wild strait whose pilots earned their living guiding ships through the rocks. It is the seat of Siorrachd Caol fhiadhaich and a large town of the order of the Stone, trading with the great tavern-village of Doire shean on its road. The strait pilots still take no ship through without an offering to Clach, the Stone, at the harbour wolf-stone. Known for strait-pilots and the harbour wolf-stone.

Caol gharbh (Caol gharbh). Founded 5 am Màrt 2276 BDE by Ròdaich seafarers of the rough strait. Caol gharbh is a walled harbour on the rough strait and the seat of its province, a village in name but a town of twenty-seven thousand in fact. Its boatyards take oak from Doire chaol and build the heavy boats the strait demands. Its quarrel with Seann Bhrenn next door is as old as the rolls. Its headmen and Caol chrom's meet at Coinneachadh na h-Amhaich, the stone on the neck of land between the two harbours, to settle the dues of the strait. Known for boatyards on the rough strait.

Caol iseal (Caol iseal). Founded 21 am Màrt 1549 BDE by salt-makers of the northern coast. Caol iseal is a harbour town on a low strait of the north coast and the seat of its province. Its salt pans have supplied the northern fisheries since the Holy Age. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Bog-iron dug behind the pans feeds its forges, which cast field-guns for the regiments. Known for salt pans of the low strait.

Caol iseal (Baile Mòr mhòr). Founded 25 am Faoilleach 1571 BDE by the strait-watchers of the north coast. A small harbour-village on the northern strait, with a citadel built to watch the channel. It served Baile Mòr mhòr as a signal-station and watch-post and has never outgrown that role. It keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich, and the watch-fire on its citadel is still lit on the old feast nights. Known for the strait watch-fire.

Caol leathan (Caol leathan). Founded 12 am Faoilleach 2784 BDE by the strait-pilots of the western shore. Caol leathan grew on the wide strait that gives it its name, where the western pilots of the Holy Age took a toll from every boat bound for the capital's waters. Its walls and citadel were raised in the Age of Sundering to hold the strait, and were manned again when the strangers' ships began to use it after the Crossing. It is the northern anchor of the country of the Stone, and its druids look south to the temple of Lia Fàil at Inis thais for their rite. Known for strait tolls and the western pilots' guild.

Caol mhin (Caol mhin). Founded 17 am Màrt 1654 BDE by Ròdaich seafarers of Baile Mòr mhòr. Caol mhin is the harbour of Baile Mòr mhòr on the calm strait, and its fortunes have always followed the city's. It is walled against raiders from the sea. Its quays load wool and hides from the northern uplands. Its quays stand on Eilean chrom, across the calm strait from the city. Known for calm-strait harbour of Baile Mòr mhòr.

Caol mhòr (Caol mhòr). Founded 23 an Dùbhlachd 2793 BDE by Ròdaich harbour-folk; resettled by the Tuathaich. Caol mhòr, the great strait, was a Ròdaich harbour of the Holy Age. After the Severance it became the chief port of the Tuathaich, and it is now their largest town. Its yards take timber from Doire mhin, and its people keep the faith of the Church. Known for chief harbour of the Tuathaich.

Caol naomh (Caol mhòr). Founded 9 an Dàmhair 956 BDE by Ròdaich ferryman; resettled by the Tuathaich. Caol naomh, the holy strait, is a harbour of the north-west founded by Ròdaich ferrymen in the Holy Age, who held the crossing sacred and blessed each boat before it put out. It was resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance, and the new ferrymen kept the blessing without the old words. It keeps the faith of the Church. Known for the holy strait's ferry.

Caol naomh (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 17 an Giblean 442 DE by druids of Òrd Bhrìde. A holy strait-harbour near the ruins of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, where the orthodox order of Brìde's flame built a landing for pilgrims coming to the mountain of Crom's stone. It is one of the few towns where Òrd Bhrìde holds the majority, and its druids were among those who formalized the order's rite in the first years of the new kingdom. It is a small town and quiet outside the pilgrim season. Pilgrims' boats from the southern Seann Skell come round to its landing by Slighe-mhara chritheanach, the shaking sea-way, named for the swell off the south cape. Known for pilgrim landing of Òrd Bhrìde.

Caol ruadh (Muileann naomh). Founded 22 an t-Iuchar 992 BDE by Ròdaich fishers of the red strait. Caol ruadh takes its name from the red rock of the strait it watches on the southern coast. It was a quiet fishing town for most of its history, and was among the first to take up the orthodox rite of Brìde's flame and Crom's stone when Òrd Bhrìde was formalized. Since An Cogadh Fada its harbour has victualled the garrisons and fleet stationed at Seann Skell close by. It was chartered as the sixteenth market town after An Cogadh Fada, to victual the garrisons and the fleet. Known for red strait and the orthodox rite of Brìde's flame.

Caol shean (Caol shean). Founded 21 an Lùnastal 2960 BDE by the river-fishers of the east. An old river port on the narrows of the Abhainn iseal, above its meeting with the Abhainn chaol, and one of the great river ports of the island, seat of Siorrachd Caol shean. It sent the ore of the central mountains down the river to Seann Mhorn when the extraction was at its height, and now sends dubhan and grain the same way. The spring of Allt an Àigh lies in its hinterland, and pilgrims to it come up the river and land here; the town follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the great eastern river port, pilgrims' landing.

Cathair dhearg (Cathair dhearg). Founded 23 an t-Samhain 2663 BDE by the custodian-kings of the Holy Age. Cathair dhearg, the red city, began as the stone-walled seat of the Holy Age custodians where the mining roads came down to the water on the Abhainn dhomhain, just above Loch chrom; Drochaid Cathair dhearg, heir of the first bridges, still carries the road across the river. It kept its walls, citadel and temple through the Sundering and the Age of Strangers, and after the Severance Rìoghachd Ròdais was declared here and Niall was crowned in it, first of the restored line. The royal precinct is small for a capital, ringed by the great harbours of Ros dhomhain, Cathair dhomhain and Baile ghlais, and its temple is the first house of Macha, where kings are made by her rite and the two horses of her rite, Liath Macha the grey and Dubh Sainglenn the black, are honoured. The royal quays build seagoing hulls for the Crown. Known for royal seat and temple of Macha.

Cathair dhomhain (Cathair dhomhain). Founded 7 an Gearran 2755 BDE by Ròdaich shipwrights of the river mouth. Cathair dhomhain, the deep city, stands beside the capital on the deep-water side of the river mouth, and takes the ships whose draught the royal quays cannot. It was walled and given a citadel in the Holy Age, and its temple of Macha is second only to the capital's. Its harbour carried much of the ore trade in the Age of Strangers and most of the dubhan trade since. It is the market town of the capital shore, and its own workshops bind books and put up salted food for the ships. Its quays stand where the Abhainn fhionn runs into Loch chrom, and the seagoing ships that lie at them come up from the west coast by the Abhainn gheal. Known for deep-water harbour beside the capital.

Cathair fhada (Cathair fhada). Founded 9 am Màrt 1239 BDE by the lords of the long city. A long walled city in the south, strung along a ridge between the capital's country and the coast, and the seat of Siorrachd Cathair fhada. It follows the order of Macha and has always been one of the capital's chief supports. The Fèill Muileann òg is held a short way north, and the city's merchants dominate it. Its market right is among the oldest on the island, and its own trade is in cheese, honey and garments. Known for merchants of the Fèill Muileann òg.

Cathair gheal (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 5 am Màrt 1813 BDE by Ròdaich builders; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. Cathair gheal is a walled city of white stone on the far western coast, built by the Ròdaich and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. Its walls face the sea, where pirate ships have been seen offshore. It is the market for the Tuathaich villages of Muileann àrsaidh province. Its smiths make the tools of the north-west. Known for white walls against the pirate coast.

Cathair mhòr (Cathair mhòr). Founded 30 an Giblean 2450 BDE by Ròdaich custodians of the interior roads. Cathair mhòr, the great city, was raised by the Holy Age custodians beside Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, a Seann-Dhaoine outpost already in ruins when the first Ròdaich walls went up beside it. It commands the roads between the gulf and the vein country, and it was a counting-house of the tithe in the Age of Strangers and a mustering place in the war that ended it. An treas rèisimeid, raised in An Cogadh Fada, is stationed here and bears its name. Its honey and its salted meat are sold in every market of the south, and its soap-boilers and weavers are the busiest in the gulf. Known for the great city beside the old outpost.

Cathair mhòr (Doire mhin). Founded 28 an Cèitean 852 BDE by the lords of Doire mhin. A hill-city with a citadel close to the capital, raised by lords of the Doire mhin country who held the roads north of Cathair dhearg. It has always been a garrison town and was one of the strongholds from which the war before the Severance was fought. It follows the order of Macha and draws on the tithe-granaries of Baile chrom and the great village of Doire mhin. It is not the Cathair mhòr of the third regiment, which lies further east. Its glass-house is the largest on the island. Known for the citadel on the capital's north road.

Cathair naomh (Seann Toll). Founded 22 an Dùbhlachd 4439 BDE by unknown builders, later the Ròdaich keepers of the Old Spirits. The holy city of the north grew around a ring of stones older than the Ròdaich, and the chroniclers do not claim to know who raised them. The Ròdaich made it a place of the Old Spirits in the Holy Age and it has never had walls, since the ancestors' ground was held to need none. It is a city of pilgrims and hostels, and the spirit-house keepers of Cnoc chiar and Inis bheag answer to its elders. Dubhan from the works below the town and books copied in its hostels are its trades; the elders have never blessed the works, since dubhan is not of the vein. Known for the unwalled ring of the ancestors.

Cathair naomh (Seann Chwen). Founded 1 an Gearran 158 BDE by druids of the capital's order. A holy city near the ruins of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, built by the druids of Macha in the Holy Age as a seat of learning. The ruins are said to have been older than any Ròdaich memory when the city was founded, and the druids left them as they were. It is unwallled and trades with the harbour of Seann Chwen and with Ceann leathan. Known for the druids' city by the old outpost.

Ceann àrsaidh (Ceann àrsaidh). Founded 19 an t-Iuchar 477 BDE by Ròdaich river-folk of the east. Ceann àrsaidh is a walled river city on an ancient headland over the Abhainn fhionn, east of the capital. It has been a river port since the Holy Age, and its barges run down to Cathair dhomhain where the river runs into Loch chrom and the barges meet the ships that come up from the sea. An Taigh-seinnse Mòr stands on the road to the west. Known for ancient headland on the capital's river road to the east.

Ceann bhàn (Achadh mhòr). Founded 29 an t-Samhain 1024 DE by the tavern-keepers of the white headland. A walled river port on a pale headland where the Abhainn gheal meets the Abhainn bhàn, with the famous tavern An Sligeanach Fad' às at its gate, where travellers eat dried venison. It grew around the tavern road, and its walls went up in the troubles, when the roadside houses became militia posts. It keeps the Old Spirits, trades with the great village of Achadh mhòr close by, and sends its goods down the Abhainn bhàn to Seann Warr on the coast. Known for An Sligeanach Fad' às and dried venison.

Ceann bheag (Ceann bheag). Founded 15 an t-Iuchar 2688 BDE by Ròdaich harbour-folk of the north-east. Ceann bheag is a citadel harbour of the north-east, a Holy Age landing that grew with the coastal trade. Its citadel was raised in the Age of Strangers to guard the anchorage the human ships used. The villages of Ceann thais and Achadh fhiadhaich lie within its province and send their goods through its quays. Known for citadel harbour of the north-east.

Ceann chaol (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 23 an Giblean 946 DE by Ròdaich seafarers of the narrow point. Ceann chaol is a port city on the narrow point, and the old rival of Ceann mhin along the same shore. Its ships carry the flour of Muileann dhomhain and the grain of the eastern plain. The two harbours have disputed fishing grounds in every age, and the disputes are recorded at length. Known for narrow-point harbour, rival of Ceann mhin.

Ceann chiar (Seann Tarr). Founded 10 an Dùbhlachd 807 DE by Ròdaich fishers of the eastern coast. Ceann chiar is a walled harbour on the eastern coast, walled against the pirate ships that have been seen in these waters in every age. It keeps a watch-fire on its headland. It is the port of Seann Tarr province. Known for walled harbour against pirates.

Ceann dhomhain (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 7 am Màrt 1257 BDE by custodians of the eastern headland. A small city on a headland over a deep reach of the Abhainn naomh, with a citadel that looks down the river toward the sea and back toward the mountain roads. River boats put in here with the cargoes landed at Ceann mhin, at the river mouth, for the library town of Muileann chaol, whose scholars and copyists travel through its gate, and its quaymasters have long kept a copy of every cargo list for the Leabharlann. The druid schools hold the city, and its scholars are counted among the library's oldest correspondents. Known for the library's river landing and cargo registers.

Ceann dhubh (Cnoc ghorm). Founded 25 an Cèitean 1257 BDE by Ròdaich headland-fishers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A black headland harbour on the north-west coast, all but joined to the city of Inis àrsaidh. It was a Ròdaich fishing town until the Severance and has been a Tuathaich harbour since. It follows the faith of the Church, and its boats sail with Inis àrsaidh's. Known for the black headland beside Inis àrsaidh.

Ceann dhubh (Baile gharbh). Founded 26 an Cèitean 1320 DE by Ròdaich fishers of the black headland. Ceann dhubh is a harbour under a dark headland, the port of Baile gharbh province, whose boats work the cold waters of the northern coast. Travellers on the coast road break their journey at An Leòmhann Buidhe a short way west, and the inn buys most of the harbour's catch. The harbour was deepened in the Age of Strangers to take the humans' ore ships, and has been too large for its trade ever since. Known for harbour under the black headland.

Ceann fhada (Muileann chrom). Founded 27 an Cèitean 1320 DE by Ròdaich river pilots. A long spit of land made Ceann fhada a landing for river craft, and its pilots have guided boats on the Abhainn uaine for centuries. It is the old rival of Inis ìseal, a short way downstream, and the two quays have quarrelled over tolls in every age the rolls cover. It prospered in the Age of Strangers carrying ore-cart loads by water and has held its trade since by carrying grain. Known for long quay and river pilots.

Ceann gheal (Cathair dhomhain). Founded 8 an Gearran 1289 DE by fishers of the white headland. Ceann gheal is a harbour town north of the capital, founded in the long quiet centuries. The shaft called Toll-dubh lies in the hills behind it. Quarrymen broke into it in the Age of Sundering and found a stair cut in the rock going down beyond their lamps, and the custodians walled it up; the town's people do not go near it. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for white headland and the Toll-dubh hollow.

Ceann ghorm (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 29 an Giblean 356 DE by river pilots of the east. Ceann ghorm, the blue headland, is a river town on the Abhainn chaol in the east whose pilots have long guided boats up from Seann Mhorn on the coast to the landings of Seann Dunn and Ros fhionn. It was founded in the long quiet centuries and grew in the Age of Strangers. Its people follow the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for river pilots of the Abhainn chaol.

Ceann leathan (Seann Chwen). Founded 19 an t-Samhain 2816 BDE by Ròdaich harbour-folk of the gulf. Ceann leathan, the broad headland, is a walled temple city on the gulf, older than most of the harbours around it. Its temple of Macha is the chief house of her order in the gulf towns. Since the early years of the restored kingdom it has held Còmhrag Ceann leathan, the brutal annual melee, which draws fighters and crowds from every province. It is the market town of the gulf and the old vein country, fifty-two towns in all, and the dearest market on Rodos. Its own trade is in cheese and salted food, and its yards build seagoing hulls. Known for Còmhrag Ceann leathan, the annual melee.

Ceann leathan (Ceann leathan). Founded 27 am Màrt 1189 BDE by Ròdaich harbour-folk of the east. Ceann leathan of the east is a harbour town and the seat of its province, founded in the Holy Age on a broad headland facing the open sea. It is not the gulf city of the melee, and its people resent the confusion. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and a fishing fleet that works as far south as the waters off Seann Bhral. Known for broad headland harbour of the east.

Ceann mhin (Ceann mhin). Founded 18 an Lùnastal 2254 BDE by shipwrights of the smooth headland. Ceann mhin is a citadel harbour on the southern gulf shore, long the chief shipyard of the east. When Tonn Mhòr struck in the first years of the restored kingdom, its yards were spared and it took in the survivors of Achadh mhin. It has since grown into one of the great cities of the south. The hemp for its yards grows in its own fields, and its copyists bind books for the south. Known for shipyards of the smooth headland.

Ceann mhin (Ceann mhin). Founded 12 an t-Iuchar 1336 BDE by harbour-lords of the smooth headland. A smooth headland port, walled, and the seat of Siorrachd Ceann mhin. It was a trading harbour for the northern mines in the Age of Strangers and follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Slighe Ceann mhin, the long road down the east of the island to Seann Dunn, begins at its gate. Known for the northern ore harbour.

Ceann mhin (Ceann mhin). Founded 17 an t-Iuchar 220 BDE by Ròdaich fishers settling in the ruin of Làrach an Dùin. Ceann mhin is built in and around Làrach an Dùin, the ruined fortress of the old builders, and its harbour lies under the fallen walls. The Ròdaich fishers who settled there in the Holy Age reused its stones but never finished clearing it; nobody knows who built the fortress. It is now a walled port town of nearly twenty thousand, the seat of its province, and the rival of Ceann chaol along the same coast. Known for harbour beneath Làrach an Dùin.

Ceann mhòr (Ceann mhòr). Founded 6 an Cèitean 2836 BDE by Ròdaich fishers; resettled by the Tuathaich. Ceann mhòr is a great harbour on a headland of the north-west, under the beacon of Taigh-solais Baile chrom. It was a Ròdaich port of the Holy Age, struck by Gorta Baile chrom in the Age of Strangers and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It keeps the faith of the Church. Its first human fishing families learned their church's harbour prayers here, and its priests say the Grey Night vigil of Baile chrom began from them. It has been the market town of the north-west coast since the shires were drawn, and it sends fish, whale-oil, seal-oil, amber, dyes and tobacco south. Glass is blown from the white sand of its beaches. Known for great headland harbour under the Baile chrom light.

Ceann òg (Cnoc bheag). Founded 19 an t-Sultain 1787 DE by Ròdaich and human traders together. Ceann òg, "the young headland", was built as a river trading quay on the Abhainn ìseal in the first years after the Crossing, when exchange with the humans was still reciprocal. It stands near Carragh Cnoc bheag, the stone carved Bha teine sa chloich. The Green Death, A' Phlàigh Uaine, struck it in the Age of Strangers. It follows the Hawk order, and its quay was rebuilt after the Severance for Ròdaich boats alone. Seòlaid Ceann òg, the western lane round the capes to the capital's water, is named for its quay. Known for young river quay near Carragh Cnoc bheag.

Ceann thais (Ceann bheag). Founded 30 an Giblean 295 DE by fishers of the north-east. Ceann thais is a harbour village of the north-east, best known for An Leòmhann Buidhe, one of the great taverns of the old mining circuit, which stands at its edge. It was founded in the long quiet centuries. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for An Leòmhann Buidhe, the Yellow Lion.

Cill àrsaidh (Doire fhionn). Founded 19 an Giblean 551 BDE by keepers of the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Cill àrsaidh of the north is an old cell of the ancestor rite, founded in the Holy Age and never much more than a village around its shrine. It lies inland of the Hawk bay and has kept to the Old Spirits while its neighbours took up the Hawk order and the rite of Mòd. The shrine keepers are hereditary. Its people gather amber on the strands of the Hawk bay. Known for ancient cell of the ancestor rite.

Cill àrsaidh (Cuan ghlas). Founded 29 an Cèitean 2326 BDE by teachers of the druid schools. Cill àrsaidh of Cuan ghlas is an old cell that the teachers of Scoiltean nan Draoidhean, the druid schools, took as a retreat early in the schools' history. It became a large village of students and farmers. The schools' dormant teachers kept it alive through the Age of Strangers, and it filled again at the revival. Known for retreat of the druid teachers.

Cill àrsaidh (Muileann bheag). Founded 25 an t-Sultain 75 BDE by keepers of the Old Spirits. An ancient cell-site village in the north-east, older than the druid schools that now hold it. The founding shrine is said to have been of the Old Spirits, and its foundations lie under the present meeting-house. It is a large village supplying Muileann bheag. Known for a druids' house on an old shrine.

Cill bhàn (Dùn dhearg). Founded 20 am Màrt 2723 BDE by keepers of the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Cill bhàn, the white cell, is a village of the Old Spirits' ancestor rite in the east, founded in the Holy Age. It lies near the hot springs and the silver workings of the vein country. It has kept its spirit-house through every age and every change of master. Known for white cell of the ancestor rite.

Cill chaol (Muileann leathan). Founded 10 am Màrt 985 BDE by Ròdaich druids; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. Cill chaol was a narrow Ròdaich chapel village near the northern coast, emptied at the Severance and taken by Tuathaich families. They made its chapel a church of the Tuathaich, and the Ròdaich carvings on its doorposts were left in place beside theirs. It is a small place near the lighthouse of Muileann bheag. Known for a Tuathaich church in a Ròdaich chapel.

Cill chiar (Baile chiar). Founded 16 an Dùbhlachd 1244 DE by druids of Macha. A small temple-site village at the edge of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, the forest no one has settled or fully mapped. Its temple-house was built to watch the forest rather than enter it. It follows the order of Macha. Known for the temple-house watching the unclaimed forest.

Cill dhearg (Doire chiar). Founded 7 an t-Samhain 2450 BDE by druids of the schools. A temple village of red stone near Drochaid Ros fhionn, whose house of the druid schools gave shelter to travellers crossing the old bridge when the river trade was busy. As the trade dried up and the bridge fell out of use, the village shrank to its temple-house and a few farms. Its druids still keep a lamp at the bridge-end. Known for red temple-house by the old bridge.

Cill dhìreach (Dùn ìseal). Founded 6 am Màrt 349 BDE by druids of the schools for the silver-miners. A temple village a short way from the silver seam at Muileann chiar, whose house of the druid schools has served the silver-miners since the seam was first worked. In the Age of Strangers its druids kept a record of the miners killed underground, one of the few such records to survive. It is not the Cill dhìreach of the central country. Known for miners' temple by the silver seam.

Cill dhìreach (Cill dhìreach). Founded 12 am Màrt 400 BDE by druids of Macha. Cill dhìreach is a temple village of Macha of twenty-four thousand and the seat of its province. It lies beside Ceann leathan, where Còmhrag Ceann leathan is held each year. Its druids tend the wounded of the melee and bury its dead. Known for temple-town of the Ceann leathan melee.

Cill fhada (Muileann dhearg). Founded 17 an Dùbhlachd 57 DE by druids of Macha. A temple-site village strung along a long ridge near Baile chrom, whose temple of Macha is the longest building in the district. It farms for the market at Baile chrom and sends its grain to the tithe-granaries there. Known for the long temple of Macha.

Cill gharbh (Muileann naomh). Founded 27 an Lùnastal 1073 BDE by Ròdaich druids of the western coast. A village around a rough stone shrine on the far western coast of the Ròdaich country. Its shrine is older than any of its houses, and Manannan was worshipped there before the orders divided. It is a small village of fewer than two thousand. Known for rough stone shrine of the west.

Cill ghlas (Muileann dhearg). Founded 4 am Faoilleach 1185 BDE by a house of the druid schools. Cill ghlas, the grey cell, was a quiet village of the druid schools in the hills east of the capital until the Age of Strangers pushed the workings under it. Late in that age a routine excavation tore open a fault around it, killing dozens and closing the workings; the Rending gave the island the word 'scàinte'. The village was rebuilt on the far side of the crack, and its people still mark the day of the dead. Known for Scàineadh Cill ghlas, the Rending.

Cill ghorm (Cathair dhomhain). Founded 13 an t-Ògmhios 366 BDE by druids of Macha. A temple site on the ridge above the road north from Cathair dhearg, fortified in the Holy Age to guard the approach to the capital. The citadel dwarfs the village, which has never numbered more than a thousand or so, most of them in service to the garrison and the shrine. Pilgrims of Òrd Mhacha, the order of Macha, stop here before entering the capital. Known for fortified temple above the capital road.

Cill ìseal (Ceann mhòr). Founded 14 an t-Iuchar 896 DE by Ròdaich shrine-keepers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A low church-site village of the Ròdaich, emptied at the Severance and resettled by Tuathaich families. It has grown past any village size, with its church at its heart, and it farms for the harbour of Ros ruadh. The Tuathaich here call it by its Ròdaich name and no other. Known for the church of the north-west.

Cill leathan (Muileann shean). Founded 27 am Màrt 1310 BDE by keepers of the north-coast cell. Cill leathan is a large harbour village of the north coast, founded as a cell in the Holy Age. A citadel was raised over its harbour in the Age of Strangers to guard the human ships that used it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for broad cell and its sea citadel.

Cill thais (Cill thais). Founded 15 an t-Samhain 1066 BDE by wardens of the sacred wood. Cill thais, the damp cell, is a large village and the seat of its province, founded in the Holy Age beside Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag. The forest is sacred to Macha and her black horse and has never been settled, logged or fully mapped, and the village's wardens keep others out of it under the division of custody that settled the holy-wood dispute. In the Age of Strangers the wardens refused the timber contracts, and the record does not say how they were allowed to. Known for wardens of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag.

Cill thais (Cuan shean). Founded 22 an Giblean 122 BDE by druids of the order of Manannan. Cill thais is a shrine village on damp ground above the anchorage of Cuan shean, fortified with a citadel in the Holy Age to watch the western sea. The fourth fleet, raised in the Long War, is stationed at Cuan shean below, and the village's druids bless each ship in Manannan's name before it first puts out. It is a small place whose citadel is larger than its village. Known for fortified shrine of Manannan over the fleet anchorage.

Cnoc àrsaidh (Caol mhòr). Founded 19 am Màrt 2579 BDE by Ròdaich shepherds; resettled by the Tuathaich. Cnoc àrsaidh is a small hill town of the Holy Age on the Abhainn mhòr, crowned by a cairn older than its name. Its Ròdaich families went south at the Severance and Tuathaich households took their holdings. It is a small place of hill pasture, looking down on the harbour of Caol mhòr. Known for hill pasture and the old cairn.

Cnoc àrsaidh (Dùn ìseal). Founded 5 an t-Sultain 2222 BDE by shepherds of the eastern hills. Cnoc àrsaidh of Dùn ìseal is a hill town crowned by old cairns, above Baile naomh. It has been a shepherding place since the Holy Age. Its people keep the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and tend the cairns at the turning of the seasons. Known for cairn hill and its shepherds.

Cnoc àrsaidh (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 20 an t-Iuchar 371 DE by hill-farmers from Cnoc dhubh. The 'ancient hill' of the eastern cluster of Cnocs is in fact among the younger of them; the chroniclers think the name was taken from a cairn on its summit rather than from the town. It is a small farming town of the druid schools that sells its barley in Cnoc dhubh and Àth dhomhain. Known for the summit cairn and eastern barley.

Cnoc àrsaidh (Caol mhòr). Founded 9 an t-Samhain 986 BDE by Ròdaich hill-lords, resettled by the Tuathaich. A tiny ancient hill with a citadel, far larger than the handful of people who now live in it. It was a Ròdaich keep until the Severance and has been a Tuathaich watch-post since. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for an empty citadel on the southern march.

Cnoc àrsaidh (Cnoc àrsaidh). Founded 11 am Màrt 1238 BDE by Ròdaich followers of the order of the Stone. Cnoc àrsaidh is a walled town of Òrd na Cloiche and the seat of its province, holding the oldest shrines of the order of the Stone. The panther roads pass close by, and the town keeps a watch on them in the season of crossing. Its walls were raised in the Age of Strangers and have not been needed since. Known for shrines of the Stone and the panther watch.

Cnoc bhàn (Caol ìseal). Founded 21 am Màrt 5 BDE by fishers of Caol ìseal. Cnoc bhàn grew as an overflow of the harbour at Caol ìseal, a white hill with a landing at its foot. Its boats work the kelp beds and the herring of the northern shore. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and has never needed walls. Known for white-hill kelp and herring.

Cnoc bhàn (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 30 an Dùbhlachd 23 DE by Ròdaich fishers; resettled by the Tuathaich. Cnoc bhàn of the north-west is a harbour facing the pirate waters. It was founded by Ròdaich fishers in the long quiet centuries and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. Its boats avoid the waters where old sailors place the Sea-Watcher. Known for harbour facing the pirate waters.

Cnoc bhàn (Ceann àrsaidh). Founded 5 an t-Samhain 1225 DE by druids of Macha. A pale hill in the midlands, crowned by a house of Òrd Mhacha, the order of the capital. The town grew around the druids' farms and remains a quiet place of tithe-barns and schools that train acolytes for the capital's temples of Macha. Baile dhomhain and Àth ghlas send it their tithes and their sons. Known for training acolytes of Macha.

Cnoc bhàn (Caol mhòr). Founded 11 an Lùnastal 1806 BDE by Ròdaich hill-lords, resettled by the Tuathaich. A pale hill with a citadel built by a Ròdaich family in the Holy Age, taken over by the Tuathaich when their homeland was fixed. The Tuathaich garrison it as a guard-post on their southern marches, and it follows the faith of the Church. The town sells cattle and hides to Cnoc àrsaidh. Known for the Tuathaich southern guard-post.

Cnoc bhàn (Baile ghorh). Founded 23 an Dùbhlachd 211 DE by the hill-lords of Baile ghorh. A walled pale hill in the south-east above the long mill-race of Muileann fhada, which grinds its grain. The walls were raised when the road from Làrach an Dùin became unsafe. It keeps the Old Spirits and is the market of the southern-eastern farms. It sends the pearls of the south-eastern shallows and the clay of its fields to other markets. Known for the market above the mill-race.

Cnoc bhàn (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 12 am Màrt 2717 BDE by a custodian house of the Binding. The white hill was fortified early by a custodian house, and its citadel of pale stone is the oldest standing work in the province that bears its name. In the Age of Strangers it served as a district seat of the human administration, and the ledgers kept in its strong-room were among those later lost in the war. It is now a large town of scholars and advocates: the disputations of the druid schools are held in its hall, and its readers walk daily to the library at Muileann chaol. Known for white citadel and the druid schools' disputations.

Cnoc bheag (Cnoc bheag). Founded 10 an Dàmhair 1401 BDE by hill kindreds of the north-central country. Cnoc bheag is the small hill only in name: it is the largest town of the north-central country, a river port on the Abhainn iséal whose barges run down to Ros gheal on the coast, and the heart of the Hawk order of the Old Faith, whose temple here is the chief house of the Hawk of Acaill. The standing stone Carragh Cnoc bheag, carved 'there was fire in the stone', stands a short walk to the south, and the town's older families say their fathers' fathers found it there. A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death, struck the town in the Age of Strangers. Since the Severance it has faced the Tuathaich border, and An siathamh rèisimeid, raised in An Cogadh Fada, is stationed here under the town's name. Known for the carved stone and the Sixth Regiment.

Cnoc bheag (Muileann shean). Founded 8 an Lùnastal 740 DE by farmers of the north coast. Cnoc bheag of Muileann shean is a small town of hill farms on the north coast, founded in the long quiet centuries. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Its people send their sons to the druid teachers at Cill àrsaidh. Known for north-coast hill farms.

Cnoc bheag (Achadh naomh). Founded 9 an t-Ògmhios 1061 DE by the herders of Achadh naomh. A small walled hill in the east, raised as a refuge for the herds of Achadh naomh in the troubled years. Its pastures are thin, and the town has always kept fewer herds than its walls could shelter. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for hilltop refuge for eastern herds.

Cnoc bheag (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 5 an Dàmhair 988 DE by shepherds of Cnoc dhubh. A small hill town below Cnoc dhubh, holding the shepherds' market for the province. It has always been a dependent of the larger town. It is one of several places named Cnoc bheag and is not the fort of the holy wood near the capital. Known for shepherds' market below Cnoc dhubh.

Cnoc bheag (Cill thais). Founded 26 an t-Ògmhios 1865 BDE by custodians named in the holy-wood dispute. Cnoc bheag is a fort with a citadel at the edge of Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag, the forest that has never been settled or logged. It was raised after the holy-wood dispute of the Holy Age, when custody of the wood was divided rather than awarded, to house the custodians of the share that went to the order now called Òrd Mhacha, the order of Macha. It stands outside the trees, never within them, and its twelve thousand people guard the capital's south as well as the wood. Known for fort at the edge of the holy wood.

Cnoc chaol (Baile gharbh). Founded 16 an t-Ògmhios 768 DE by goatherds of the northern hills. Cnoc chaol, the narrow hill, is a small herding town of the north. It is not the southern Cnoc chaol that gave Tonn Mhòr its name. Its people keep the druid schools of the Old Faith and send their cheese and kids to the market at Baile gharbh. Known for goat cheese for Baile gharbh.

Cnoc chaol (Seann Vell). Founded 23 am Faoilleach 128 DE by Ròdaich shore farmers of Seann Vell. Cnoc chaol is the town the Great Wave is named after. Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol struck the southern coast without warning in a single night, devastating it together with Cuan dhearg and Achadh mhin. The town was rebuilt higher up the narrow hill, and its people still leave the lowest street empty. Cnoc chaol and Cuan dhearg share Eilean bhàn, off the south coast. Known for the town the Great Wave named.

Cnoc chaol (Muileann dhearg). Founded 22 an Cèitean 1850 DE by a mining crew under the human administration. Cnoc chaol was a mining camp on the narrow hill, worked by the ton in the Age of Strangers. It emptied after Scàineadh Cill ghlas closed the district and never recovered. Fewer than seven hundred people live there now, among the spoil heaps. Known for a spent camp on the narrow hill.

Cnoc chiar (Seann Toll). Founded 12 an Giblean 2403 BDE by spirit-house keepers of Cathair naomh. A dusky hill beside the harbour of Seann Toll, settled by keepers of the Old Spirits who tended waymarks on the pilgrim road to Cathair naomh. It remains a small town of hostels and way-shrines, busy in the feast seasons and empty between them. Known for way-shrines on the pilgrim road.

Cnoc chiar (Achadh naomh). Founded 24 an Lùnastal 2989 BDE by keepers of the Colbh. A dusky hill near the standing stone Colbh Cnoc chiar, which carries only the words Cuimhnich an teine, 'remember the fire'. The stone was old when the Ròdaich came, and the town grew around the families who tended it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, whose druids still come to argue over the imperative that no one has explained. Known for the stone of 'remember the fire'.

Cnoc chiar (Doire mhin). Founded 10 an t-Samhain 1564 DE by herders of Doire mhin. A small dusky hill between Doire mhin and Muileann ruadh, pastured by herders of the great village. It follows the order of Macha. Known for hill pastures of Doire mhin.

Cnoc chiar (Cuan ghlas). Founded 24 am Faoilleach 2583 BDE by Ròdaich shepherds of Cuan ghlas. A large town on the dusky hill, living on the sheep walks above it and on the wool trade with Caol bheag. It was a mustering place for fleeces in the Age of Strangers, when the humans bought wool as eagerly as ore. Its market is the busiest in the province. Known for sheep walks and wool market.

Cnoc chrom (Cnoc mhòr). Founded 23 an Lùnastal 1923 DE by the ore-carriers of the interior. Cnoc chrom was built in the Age of Strangers as a depot on the ore road from the interior to the gulf. It was walled in the years before the war of the Severance, when the mining roads began to arm themselves. It is a small town now and keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for walled depot of the ore road.

Cnoc chrom (Caol shean). Founded 26 an Cèitean 1814 DE by Ròdaich miners under contract. A crooked hill-town raised when the extraction contracts pushed the diggings out from the central mountains toward the coast. Its walls were thrown up against the raids of the troubles before the war, and the shafts beneath it gave out before the Severance. It is now a small town of the druid schools that sends its young to the river port at Ros fhionn. Known for abandoned shafts beneath a walled hill.

Cnoc dhearg (Muileann naomh). Founded 31 an Lùnastal 605 DE by potters of the west. Cnoc dhearg of Muileann naomh is a small town of the west, founded in the long quiet centuries on a hill of red clay. Its potteries supply jars and tiles to the western harbours, and the Age of Strangers brought it a brief trade in crucibles for the assayers. It keeps the order of Manannan. Known for red-clay potteries of the west.

Cnoc dhìreach (Cnoc leathan). Founded 18 an Dàmhair 1200 DE by tavern-keepers of the eastern road. A straight hill on the mining road in the south-east, home of An Taigh-òsta Gri-anach, a famous roadside inn that serves pan-fried spinach with black wine. The inn was fortified as a militia waypoint in the troubles before the Severance and took dubhan lamps with the rest of the tavern circuit. It keeps the Old Spirits and lies close by the ruins of Làrach an Dùin. Known for An Taigh-òsta Grianach.

Cnoc dhìreach (Caol fhiadhach). Founded 4 am Màrt 1079 DE by carters of Caol fhiadhach. A small town on a straight hill road between Caol fhiadhach and the great mill-town of Muileann bheag. It follows the order of the Stone and is a stop for carters. Known for carters' stop on the south-west road.

Cnoc dhìreach (Ceann mhin). Founded 20 an Lùnastal 2977 BDE by Ròdaich keepers of Tuam Cnoc dhìreach. A small town on the Sìtheas beside Tuam Cnoc dhìreach, the necropolis whose oldest graves are older than its oldest legible names. Its families have kept the necropolis since the Holy Age, when it received its first formally recorded burial. It lives on the burials of the eastern coast and on the masons who cut the stones. Known for keepers of Tuam Cnoc dhìreach.

Cnoc dhìreach (Cnoc dhìreach). Founded 21 an Lùnastal 817 DE by a custodian house of the eastern diggings. Cnoc dhìreach is the walled seat of the eastern mining district, a town of nearly nineteen thousand. It was walled in the Age of Strangers, when the strikes in the district made the administration nervous. It is not the small town of the necropolis on the south-east coast. Known for walled seat of the mining district.

Cnoc dhubh (Achadh àrsaidh). Founded 20 an Giblean 736 BDE by custodians of the capital's south. Cnoc dhubh of Achadh àrsaidh is a black hill with a citadel, south-east of the capital, founded in the Holy Age. Coille Naomh Cnoc bheag lies to its west and the field of Muileann ghlas to its east. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for black-hill citadel south of the capital.

Cnoc dhubh (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 10 an t-Iuchar 601 DE by charcoal-burners of the black hill. A black hill where charcoal burners worked through the long centuries of the Sundering, the Small-Burning Law forbidding them the ore. It is the largest of the cluster of Cnocs in the eastern hills and their common market. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, and its charcoal is still sold to smiths who will not work with dubhan. Known for charcoal for the smithies.

Cnoc dhubh (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 22 an t-Sultain 1478 DE by the peat-cutters of the northern moor. A black hill of peat in the north, cut for fuel since the Small-Burning Law left the ore to the custodians and ordinary hearths to turf. It is the road-town for Baile mhòr and Àth shean and follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. The peat-banks are now nearly as worked out as the vein. Known for peat cut from the black hill.

Cnoc dhubh (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 2 am Faoilleach 2734 BDE by a custodian house that quarried the black hill. The black hill is an outcrop of dark stone that the early custodians hoped was the vein; it was not, and the quarry that tested it became a town. Cnoc dhubh is a walled market for the herders and quarrymen of the hills near Làrach an Teampail; the seat of the shire is the other Cnoc dhubh, the charcoal-burners' town. Prospectors dug here again in the Age of Strangers and found only rock, a result the town's chroniclers record with some satisfaction. Known for black-stone quarries and walled market.

Cnoc dhubh (Caol mhòr). Founded 5 an t-Iuchar 1683 DE by Ròdaich founders; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. Cnoc dhubh is a black hill with coal seams in its flank, first dug by the Ròdaich for building-stone and later by the humans for coal. The Tuathaich who resettled it kept the pits open. It was among the northern communities that refused the dubhan economy, and its pits were the last in the north to close after the Long War. Known for the last coal pits of the north.

Cnoc fhada (Cnoc shean). Founded 18 am Màrt 1322 DE by hill-farmers of Cnoc shean. A long hill in the south-east farmed in terraces since the centuries after the Sundering. It keeps the Old Spirits and trades with Muileann dhomhain. Known for terraced farms on the long hill.

Cnoc fhiadhaich (Ceann mhin). Founded 2 an t-Samhain 1769 DE by hunters of the north-east hills. A wild hill above Ceann mhin, settled by hunters and later by carters on the harbour road. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and sends game and hides down to the port. Known for game and hides for Ceann mhin.

Cnoc fhiadhaich (Muileann chrom). Founded 17 am Màrt 449 DE by hunters of the Muileann chrom country. A wild walled hill in the middle country, near the canoe-landing of Cidhe Beag on Abhainn uaine. Its walls were raised in the troubled years when the river road carried ore. It follows the order of Macha and trades with Muileann chrom and Inis iséal. Known for a walled hill by the river road.

Cnoc fhionn (Baile ruadh). Founded 25 an t-Samhain 2811 BDE by farmers of the north-east. Cnoc fhionn, the fair hill, is a large town of sheltered farms in the north-east. It has been settled since the Holy Age and keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Its barley and ale go down to the harbour at Seann Tàrr. Known for fair-hill barley and ale.

Cnoc gharbh (Ros gharbh). Founded 5 an Giblean 975 DE by quarriers of Ros gharbh. Cnoc gharbh is a rough hill of quarries near Seann Bhral, whose walls were built of its stone. It is a town of nearly five thousand, of quarrymen and carters. The standing column at Cnoc ghorm is not of its stone, a fact its masons have checked more than once. Known for quarries on the rough hill.

Cnoc gheal (Muileann shean). Founded 20 an t-Iuchar 1138 DE by watchmen of the north. Cnoc gheal is a white hill with a small citadel, raised as a watchtower in the long quiet centuries to give warning of ships on the northern coast. Its fire could be seen from Cill leathan and Àth fhionn, and the three kept a common watch. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, and its garrison is now a handful of old soldiers and their families. Known for white-hill watchtower of the north coast.

Cnoc gheal (Cnoc gheal). Founded 5 an t-Iuchar 71 BDE by hill-farmers of the north-east. A white hill in the north-east, seat of Siorrachd Cnoc gheal, looking down on the Seann-Dhaoine harbour of Seann Bhrenn. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and is the market for Baile dhìreach and Àth dhearg. Known for the white hill market of the north-east.

Cnoc gheal (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 16 an Cèitean 516 DE by Ròdaich shepherds; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A white hill of sheepfolds, Ròdaich until the Severance and Tuathaich since. The Ròdaich Cnoc gheal lies a short walk south-west, over the line. The two villages share a name and very little else: the one has its church, the other its shrine of Manannan. Known for white hill sheepfolds on the line.

Cnoc gheal (Muileann naomh). Founded 16 am Màrt 745 DE by Ròdaich druids of the order of Manannan. The Ròdaich Cnoc gheal is a white hill with a shrine of Manannan mac Lir, twinned with Baile dhìreach. A second Cnoc gheal, held by the Tuathaich, lies a short walk north-east over the line. The two villages share a name and very little else, not even a faith. Known for white hill shrine of Manannan.

Cnoc ghlas (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 3 an Cèitean 403 BDE by hill shepherds of the northern coast. Cnoc ghlas is a hill town of the northern coast, a sheepwalk settlement of the Holy Age that later opened quarries in the grey slate of its hill. Its slate roofs much of the province of Tobar fhiadhaich. Its people follow the druid schools of the Old Faith, and the town sent more than its share of students to the schools' revival. Known for grey slate and northern sheepwalks.

Cnoc ghlas (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 13 an Cèitean 1801 DE by human settlers from an Tìr Thall. Cnoc ghlas of Àth àrsaidh was settled by humans in the Age of Strangers and became a Tuathaich town after the Severance. It keeps the faith of the Church, and its singers are among the keepers of the voyage of Naomh Breandan. Known for strangers' settlement on the grey hill.

Cnoc ghlas (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 12 an Dùbhlachd 1236 DE by Ròdaich herders, resettled by the Tuathaich. A small green-grey hill town of the north-west, emptied and resettled at the Severance. It follows the faith of the Church and trades with the Ròdaich mill at Muileann chrom over the line. Known for trade across the line at Muileann chrom.

Cnoc ghlas (Dùn dhearg). Founded 21 an Dùbhlachd 655 DE by quarriers for Dùn dhearg. Cnoc ghlas is the grey hill whose stone built much of Dùn dhearg. It is a quarry town, dependent on the city. Its quarrymen keep the Old Spirits' rites of the ancestors and will not open a new face without them. Known for grey stone for Dùn dhearg.

Cnoc ghorm (Cnoc ghorm). Founded 15 an Dàmhair 717 BDE by Ròdaich farmers; resettled by the Tuathaich. Cnoc ghorm of the north-west is the inland seat of its province and one of the largest Tuathaich towns. It was a Ròdaich farm town of the Holy Age, resettled after the Severance. It is not the place of the stone Calbh Cnoc ghorm, which lies far to the south-east. Its dye-fields and smithies are the busiest in the Tuathaich north. Known for inland seat of the Tuathaich.

Cnoc ghorm (Doire fhionn). Founded 22 an Dàmhair 2265 BDE by bee-keepers of the north. Cnoc ghorm of Doire fhionn is a town of the north-central country, founded in the Holy Age. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and its bees, whose wax lit the shrines at Cill àrsaidh before dubhan lamps came. Known for blue hill and bee-keeping.

Cnoc ghorm (Ceann àrsaidh). Founded 24 an t-Sultain 1152 DE by herders of Cathair mhòr. A blue-grey hill town just north of Cathair mhòr, pasturing the garrison's horses. It follows the order of Macha and has always been the city's stable. Known for horse pastures of Cathair mhòr.

Cnoc ghorm (Ceann mhin). Founded 30 am Faoilleach 707 BDE by Ròdaich keepers of Calbh Cnoc ghorm. The blue hill grew up around Calbh Cnoc ghorm, the standing column carved with the doctrine itself: Cha do thàinig sinn; bha sinn ann. If the doctrine has a birthplace it may be here, and the town has never let the island forget it. It is a large town now, and pilgrims of all three faiths climb to the stone. Known for the doctrine stone.

Cnoc ìseal (Doire chiar). Founded 7 an t-Samhain 1222 DE by flax-growers of the north. Cnoc ìseal, the low hill, is a small town of the north-east given to flax and linen. It was founded in the long quiet centuries and has changed little since. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for flax fields and linen.

Cnoc ìseal (Doire mhin). Founded 31 an Cèitean 4 DE by farmers of Doire mhin. Cnoc ìseal of Doire mhin is a small town of hill farms east of the capital, founded in the long quiet centuries. The field of Muileann ghlas, where An Cogadh Fada ended, lies just to the west, and the town's barns sheltered the wounded after the battle. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for hill farms by Muileann ghlas field.

Cnoc ìseal (Baile chiar). Founded 4 an Dàmhair 831 DE by the garrison of the capital's south road. Cnoc ìseal of Baile chiar is a walled hill on the capital's south road, founded in the long quiet centuries as a watch-post over the southern farms. Its walls were strengthened in the war of the Severance. It is a small town now, keeping the capital's order, the order of Macha and a toll it no longer collects. Known for walled hill on the capital's south road.

Cnoc ìseal (Ros bheag). Founded 18 an Lùnastal 393 BDE by Ròdaich fishers of the west. A low harbour on the western coast, sheltered by Ros bheag, which it has always served as a lesser port. Its people follow the order of Manannan, the order that runs along the west. The fighting of the Long War at Àth leathan was near enough that the harbour carried supplies for the crown's regiments. Known for western fishing and war-supply landing.

Cnoc ìseal (Caol shean). Founded 23 an Giblean 1174 BDE by Ròdaich pilgrims to Allt an Àigh. Cnoc ìseal began as a halt for pilgrims going down to Allt an Àigh, and its inns still fill at the phase of the moon when the stream is said to give fortune. Its nearness to Muileann chaol has drawn scholars as well, and many readers of the library lodge here. The town keeps the druid schools' habit of arguing a question before answering it. Known for pilgrim lodgings on the Allt an Àigh road.

Cnoc leathan (Cnoc leathan). Founded 11 am Màrt 2827 BDE by innkeepers of the south road. Cnoc leathan is a large town and the seat of its province, on the south road of the east. An Taigh-òsta Grianach, one of the great inns of the old circuit, stands to its south. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Slighe Cnoc leathan, the road south past An Taigh-òsta Grianach, has been kept up by the inn's own toll since Anna Ruadh's charter. Known for An Taigh-òsta Grianach on the south road.

Cnoc leathan (Dùn chrom). Founded 12 an Dàmhair 1150 DE by Ròdaich herders of Dùn chrom. A modest town on the broad hill beside Muileann òg, whose people live for most of the year on herding and for one season on the fair. Since Fèill Muileann òg became the island's greatest gathering, Cnoc leathan has lodged the traders the fair town cannot hold and stabled their animals. It stood near the lines at Muileann ghlas and was emptied for the battle. Known for lodgings and horse-lines for Fèill Muileann òg.

Cnoc leathan (Muileann leathan). Founded 9 an t-Samhain 1793 DE by the human administration, as a coast fort. Cnoc leathan was built by the human administration as a fort on the northern coast road, not far from the lighthouse at Muileann bheag. The Tuathaich have held it since the Severance and keep its citadel manned. Its small garrison follows the Tuathaich Church. Known for Tuathaich-held fort on the north coast.

Cnoc mhòr (Cnoc mhòr). Founded 8 am Màrt 1789 BDE by cattle-drovers of the interior. Cnoc mhòr is the market hill on the Abhainn chlar below Cathair mhòr, where the interior drove roads meet. It was walled in the Age of Strangers, when the city's markets spilled out to it. It is a prosperous town that keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha and sells the gulf its beef. Known for cattle market below Cathair mhòr.

Cnoc mhòr (Doire ghlas). Founded 5 an t-Sultain 1194 DE by Ròdaich herders; resettled by the Tuathaich. Cnoc mhòr of Doire ghlas is a Tuathaich town of the north coast, founded by Ròdaich herders in the long quiet centuries and resettled after the Severance. Its people supply the keepers of Taigh-solais Muileann bheag. It keeps the faith of the Church. Known for keepers of the Muileann bheag light.

Cnoc mhòr (Àth dhomhain). Founded 11 an Dùbhlachd 624 BDE by hill-farmers of the Àth dhomhain country. The great hill above Baile gheal, farmed since the Holy Age and never walled, since Baile gheal's walls stand close below. The two towns share a market and a long quarrel over which is the elder. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for hill farms and a quarrel with Baile gheal.

Cnoc mhòr (Muileann bhàn). Founded 31 an Cèitean 1606 DE by hill-lords of Muileann bhàn. A great hill in the south, above the harbour of Seann Warr and the large mill town of Muileann bhàn. It keeps the Old Spirits, and its hill-farms supply both. Known for hill-farms above Seann Warr.

Cnoc naomh (Cnoc naomh). Founded 10 an Gearran 2669 BDE by the druids of Macha. A holy hill with a citadel south of the capital, the seat of Siorrachd Cnoc naomh and a house of the order of Macha since the Holy Age. It lies close by the battlefield of Muileann ghlas, and its druids buried the dead of both sides after the Long War's last battle. It is a large town of druids, soldiers and pilgrims. Known for the druids who buried Muileann ghlas's dead.

Cnoc naomh (Inis mhòr). Founded 29 an Cèitean 1857 BDE by a custodian house of Inis mhòr. The holy hill carried a shrine before it carried a citadel; the citadel was added to guard Inis mhòr from the hills. The shrine still stands inside the walls. The fourth regiment from Caol bheag drills on the plain below it. On the moor above the town is Coinneachadh a' Mhonaigh, the cairn where the crew-leaders of the northern pits fixed the week of their rising. Known for citadel on the holy hill.

Cnoc òg (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 8 an Dùbhlachd 1860 DE by miners' families from Cnoc dhubh. The 'young hill' was settled by families spilling out of Cnoc dhubh when the mass excavation drew workers to the eastern hills. It has little of its own beyond houses and a meeting-hall of the druid schools, and its people work in the fields and shops of its larger neighbour. Known for overflow houses of Cnoc dhubh.

Cnoc òg (Dùn iséal). Founded 7 an t-Iuchar 1859 DE by silver miners of Muileann chlar. A young hill-town with a citadel beside the silver mine of Muileann chlar, raised when the Ròdaich held the silver seam against the human claims. The citadel was built to guard the seam, and the town grew as the silver town expanded. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the citadel over the silver seam.

Cnoc òg (Àth shean). Founded 24 an Cèitean 85 DE by farmers from Àth shean. A young hill town close to Muileann òg, whose fair is the largest gathering on the island. It lodges traders and their beasts during the fair and is quiet the rest of the year. It follows the order of Macha. Known for lodgings for the Fèill Muileann òg.

Cnoc òg (Muileann naomh). Founded 31 am Faoilleach 1931 DE by the restored kingdom, as a border post. Cnoc òg, "the young hill", was walled by the restored kingdom soon after the Severance, on the Ròdaich side of the line facing the Tuathaich towns to the north and west. It has never been more than a small town of soldiers' families and carters. In An Cogadh Fada it lay a short march behind the field at Àth leathan, and its walls held the wounded after that first battle. Known for border walls facing the Tuathaich.

Cnoc òg (Àth shean). Founded 17 an t-Sultain 1822 DE by suppliers to the garrison at Inis mhòr. Cnoc òg grew up in the Age of Strangers to supply the garrison at Inis mhòr, where the first regiment is now stationed. It is a town of bakers and harness-makers. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for supplies for the first regiment.

Cnoc ruadh (Cathair fhada). Founded 9 an Dàmhair 1580 DE by herders of the south road. Cnoc ruadh of Cathair fhada is a town on the south road, a hill only in name, founded in the long quiet centuries by herders who grazed the red ground there. It grew as a stopping place between the southern ford towns and the capital. Its people keep the capital's order, the order of Macha and sell hides at the market of Àth shean. Known for red pasture on the south road.

Cnoc ruadh (Achadh chaol). Founded 14 am Màrt 2962 BDE by shepherds of the eastern uplands. Cnoc ruadh of Achadh chaol is a hill town of the eastern uplands, a sheep town since the Holy Age. Its wool goes down to Cuan ruadh for shipping. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for red-hill sheepwalks and Cuan ruadh wool.

Cnoc shean (Doire fhiadhaich). Founded 6 an t-Sultain 1782 BDE by Ròdaich herders of the south. Cnoc shean, the old hill, is a small town of the south, settled since the Holy Age. Its common holds the market of the farms around it. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for market common on the old hill.

Cnoc shean (Inis chrom). Founded 19 an Dùbhlachd 2797 BDE by the lords of the old hill. A small old hill-town with a citadel in the west, commanding the road between Baile Mòr fhionn and the harbours of the south-west. It follows the order of the Stone and has kept a garrison since the war before the Severance. Known for the old hill citadel.

Cnoc shean (Cnoc shean). Founded 18 am Màrt 2996 BDE by Ròdaich traders of the eastern plain. Cnoc shean is the old hill market for the granary fields of Achadh mhòr, and the seat of its province. It is a town of more than twenty thousand, with grain-halls and a weighing-house older than any coinage on the island. The tavern An Sligeanach Fad' às lies on the road to Achadh mhòr, and its dried deer is sold in Cnoc shean's market. Known for old hill market of the granary fields.

Cnoc thais (Cuan ghlas). Founded 28 an Dùbhlachd 45 DE by shepherds of the Cuan ghlas hills. A damp hill-town above the river port of Cuan ghlas, its name taken from the mists that sit on it most mornings. It was never walled and never fought over, and its people send wool and cheese down to the river quays and to Cnoc chiar. A small house of the druid schools keeps the only books in the place. Known for mist, wool and hill cheese.

Cnoc thais (Cnoc thais). Founded 13 an Giblean 67 BDE by Ròdaich hill-farmers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A damp hill in the north-west, seat of Siorrachd Cnoc thais, and one of the larger Tuathaich towns since the Severance. It follows the faith of the Church and is the market of the two Muileann àrsaidhs. Known for the market of the two ancient mills.

Cnoc thais (Ceann mhin). Founded 3 an t-Iuchar 497 DE by hill-farmers of the south-east. A damp hill above the small harbour of Caol dhomhain in the south-east. It keeps the Old Spirits and sends its cattle to Baile gheal. Known for cattle on a misty hill.

Cnoc thais (Cnoc leathan). Founded 20 an Dùbhlachd 235 DE by reed-cutters of Cnoc leathan. Cnoc thais is a damp hill whose reed-beds thatch the roofs of the eastern plain. It is a town of eleven thousand. Its cutters work the beds in the dry months and its thatchers travel in the wet. Known for reed-cutters and thatch.

Cnoc uaine (Caol ìseal). Founded 17 an t-Ògmhios 1266 DE by the garrison of the north-coast road. Cnoc uaine of Caol ìseal is a hill fort over the north-coast road, raised in the long quiet centuries and walled since. Its garrison watched the road through the Age of Strangers. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for hill fort over the north-coast road.

Cnoc uaine (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 9 an Dàmhair 899 DE by Ròdaich herders; resettled by the Tuathaich. Cnoc uaine of Muileann àrsaidh is a green hill of the north-west, founded by Ròdaich herders in the long quiet centuries. It was resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It is a grazing town and keeps the faith of the Church. Known for green hill grazing.

Cnoc uaine (Cnoc àrsaidh). Founded 31 an t-Iuchar 1116 DE by hill-lords of the south-west. A green walled hill in the south-west, fortified against pirates who raided the coast in the centuries after the Sundering. It follows the order of the Stone and sends its young to the first fleet at Àth gharbh. Known for the walled green hill.

Cnoc uaine (Baile chaol). Founded 21 an Cèitean 147 BDE by Ròdaich keepers of the holy wood. Cnoc uaine is a green hill on the Abhainn mhin at the edge of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar. It is a large town of nearly seventeen thousand, and its people share the keeping of the wood with Àth dhearg. It keeps the Old Spirits, though the wood itself is sacred to Flidais and held by the druid schools. Known for green hill on the holy wood's edge.

Cuan àrsaidh (Achadh naomh). Founded 28 an Dùbhlachd 516 BDE by the river-lords of the Abhainn ìseal. An ancient river port a little below Cuan bheag on the Abhainn ìseal, trading grain from the fields around Baile fhiadhaich since the Holy Age. The Green Death, A' Phlàigh Uaine, struck the town in the Age of Strangers. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha. Its stone jetty is held to be the oldest on the island still in use, and it is patched each generation rather than rebuilt. Known for the island's oldest working jetty.

Cuan bheag (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 1 an Dùbhlachd 1515 DE by river traders of the northern country. Cuan bheag, the small harbour, is a river port on the upper Abhainn ìseal. It was a fishing water until the Age of Strangers, when human traders wanted a sheltered mooring on this side of the island, with the river open to the sea at Ros gheal, and made it busy. The restored kingdom built its citadel to watch the northern approaches, and the town has since become one of the larger river ports of the province. Its people keep the Old Faith in the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for sheltered river mooring and the northern watch.

Cuan bheag (Caol mhòr). Founded 10 am Màrt 1946 DE by Tuathaich fishing families. Cuan bheag of the north-west was built by Tuathaich fishing families in the first years after the Severance, on a shore the Ròdaich had never settled. It is a village of boats and drying racks. It sells its catch through Caol mhòr. Known for Tuathaich fishing boats and drying racks.

Cuan chrom (Seann Vell). Founded 10 am Faoilleach 1192 DE by Ròdaich innkeepers of Seann Vell. Cuan chrom is a river town on a bend of the Abhainn fhionn, and An Taigh-seinnse Mòr, one of the great houses of the old tavern circuit, stands at its river quay. The tavern was a waypoint on the mining roads and doubled as a militia halt in the years before the war. It is known across the island for its steamed carp and green brandy. Known for An Taigh-seinnse Mòr and steamed carp.

Cuan dhearg (Muileann chrom). Founded 12 an Dàmhair 1750 DE by river fishers of the Abhainn uaine. Cuan dhearg is one of the ring of small river towns on the Abhainn uaine above Cathair mhòr, named for the red cliffs over its landing. It lives on the river fish and the short ferry runs between the river towns, and sends what it has for the sea down to Ceann leathan at the river mouth. It has never been walled. It is not the southern Cuan dhearg that Tonn Mhòr destroyed; the chroniclers have confused the two more than once. Its inn, An Cupa Dàna, is where Buidheann an t-Seabhaig Luaidhe, the Leaden Hawk company, gathered in the first spring of the Severance war before walking to the Hawk coast. Known for red-cliffed river landing and ferries.

Cuan dhearg (Seann Vell). Founded 31 am Faoilleach 1615 BDE by fishing clans of the southern shore. A red-cliffed harbour on the southern coast that was a fishing town for three ages. The Great Wave, Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol, struck it in a single night in the first years of the new kingdom and destroyed the lower town with its fleet, and the harbour was rebuilt higher up the cliff. Its people keep the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich, and every house facing the sea keeps a lamp in the upper window. The harbour is on Eilean bhàn, the largest island off the south coast, which it shares with Cnoc chaol. Known for rebuilt after the Great Wave.

Cuan ghlas (Cuan ghlas). Founded 15 an t-Ògmhios 2778 BDE by grey-water fishers of the north-east. A grey river port on the Abhainn ghorm in the north-east with a citadel, the seat of Siorrachd Cuan ghlas, and a large village, whose barges go down to Ros chiar at the river mouth. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and is served by the hill town of Cnoc thais above it. Known for the grey river port and its citadel.

Cuan ruadh (Cuan ruadh). Founded 1 an t-Sultain 477 BDE by Ròdaich fishers of the east. Cuan ruadh is the easternmost harbour of the island and the seat of its province, a port since the Holy Age. Its boats go out further than any on the coast, and it has lost more to pirates than any other eastern town. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for the island's easternmost harbour.

Cuan shean (Cuan shean). Founded 4 an Gearran 2627 BDE by the harbour-lords of the west coast. The old harbour of the west, the seat of Siorrachd Cuan shean and one of the largest towns on the island. It shipped western grain and timber through the Holy Age and served the human traders after the Crossing. Since the Long War it has been home to An ceathramh cabhlach, the fourth fleet. It follows the order of Manannan. Known for the fourth fleet's harbour.

Cuan uaine (Doire fhada). Founded 23 an Dùbhlachd 465 BDE by Ròdaich custodians of the capital's east. Cuan uaine, whose name means the green harbour, is a walled temple city on the Abhainn fhionn east of the capital, fortified in the Holy Age to guard the river road to the eastern shore. Its temple of Macha is much visited by those who cannot reach the capital's. The barracks town of Inis mhòr lies just upriver to the north. Its copyists and tailors work for the capital. Known for the temple of Macha on the Abhainn fhionn.



Doire bhàn (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 14 an t-Iuchar 13 BDE by the oak-cutters of Seann Dunn. A white oak grove between Seann Dunn and Seann Mhorn, cut for charcoal and ship-timber. It keeps the Old Spirits and is a large, quiet village with no walls. Known for timber for the coast harbours.

Doire bhàn (Àth ghlas). Founded 7 an t-Sultain 1248 DE by Ròdaich woodwards of Àth ghlas. A small village in a copse of white-barked trees across the river from Àth ghlas, cutting firewood and poles for the town. It keeps clear of the ruin of Làrach an Dùin-fhaire to the east, as its elder neighbour does. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for white-barked copse by Àth ghlas.

Doire bheag (Muileann mhin). Founded 4 an t-Samhain 1521 DE by Ròdaich woodcutters of the capital. A small village in an oak copse north-east of Cathair dhearg, which has cut firewood and charcoal for the capital for as long as there are accounts. It has never grown past seven hundred people. Its people follow the capital's order, the order of Macha and take their wood into the city on market days. Known for firewood for the capital.

Doire chaol (Doire chaol). Founded 30 an t-Sultain 1947 DE by households of the restored court. Doire chaol was laid out after the Severance on a narrow oak strip by the Abhainn dhomhain south of the capital, to house the families of the royal household. It grew into a large village, and in the kingdom's fourth decade it was cut out of the shire of Baile chiar as a shire of its own, the only shire made since the drawing. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for the capital's household village.

Doire chaol (Ceann mhòr). Founded 28 an Dùbhlachd 1195 DE by Ròdaich charcoal-burners; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A charcoal village in a narrow oakwood, resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. The newcomers made the Ròdaich shrine of Manannan they found there their church rather than raising their own, as several villages of this coast did. It still burns charcoal for the smiths of Àth fhionn and Àth dhearg. Known for narrow oakwood and charcoal.

Doire chaol (Caol gharbh). Founded 22 an Lùnastal 723 DE by woodwards for Caol gharbh's yards. A village in a narrow oakwood that has sent timber to the boatyards of Caol gharbh since the yards were opened. It has always been small and has always been owed money by the yards. Its families also hunt the oakwood, and their venison goes down to Caol gharbh with the timber. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for oak for Caol gharbh's boatyards.

Doire chaol (Baile àrsaidh). Founded 16 an t-Ògmhios 84 DE by Ròdaich woodwards of Baile àrsaidh. A village in a narrow oakwood south of Baile àrsaidh, felling for the yards at Cuan shean as the larger Doire gharbh does. The two oakwood villages have argued over the same buyers in every age. It follows the order of Manannan. Known for narrow oakwood of Baile àrsaidh.

Doire chiar (Doire chiar). Founded 28 am Faoilleach 1575 BDE by oak-keepers of the north-east. A dusky oak grove grown into a large village, the seat of Siorrachd Doire chiar. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, and its druids are said to hold their disputations under the oldest trees. Known for disputations under the oaks.

Doire dhearg (Muileann bhàn). Founded 21 an t-Iuchar 1811 DE by Ròdaich miners under extraction contract. Doire dhearg began as a mining camp in the Age of Strangers, when the interior was first worked by the ton. Its red spoil-heaps are still visible above the village. Many of its people left when the workings moved on, and the village that remains keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for red spoil-heaps of the camp years.

Doire dhìreach (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 1 an Dàmhair 2352 BDE by Ròdaich woodwards of the Baile Mòr dhomhain plain. An oak grove kept by woodward families, whose trees grow unusually tall and true. The record of the Sundering says the shipwrights sent to Doire dhìreach for keels when the ocean ships were built, and the village has told that story of itself ever since. It has grown into a large village of timber-yards and cooperages, serving Àth mhòr and Baile Mòr àrsaidh. Known for straight-grown oak for keels.

Doire dhubh (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 26 an Dùbhlachd 476 BDE by Ròdaich woodwards of Cnoc bhàn. A village in a dark oak grove a short way north of Muileann chaol. When the library was founded its oak was cut for the shelves and reading-tables, and the woodwards still claim a right to repair them. It sends its remaining timber to Cnoc bhàn and Baile thais. Known for dark oak for the library's shelves.

Doire fhada (Baile ghlas). Founded 3 an t-Sultain 321 DE by woodsmen of the capital shore. Doire fhada, the long grove, is a walled village on the shore of Loch chrom near the capital, founded in the long quiet centuries. It was walled in the Age of Strangers to protect its grain stores. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for walled long grove.

Doire fhada (Doire fhada). Founded 27 am Faoilleach 986 BDE by oak-cutters of the capital's forests. A long oak grove east of the capital cut for ship-timber since the Holy Age, and the shipwrights who built the Sundering fleet are said to have taken their keels here. The village grew enormous without changing its name, and it is now the seat of Siorrachd Doire fhada and a river port of the capital's order, Macha's, on the Abhainn fhionn. The grove itself is mostly gone, and the village keeps one old oak fenced by the river quay. Known for ship-timber and the fenced oak.

Doire fhiadhaich (Ros dhomhain). Founded 18 an Dùbhlachd 1467 DE by woodcutters of the wild oak wood. Doire fhiadhaich was a wild oak wood on the capital shore, and tradition holds that timber for the Sundering fleet was felled here. The wood is long gone and the village is now a fishing quarter between Ros dhomhain and the capital's harbours. It has kept its village rank and its own fishing rights. Known for oaks said to have built the Sundering fleet.

Doire fhiadhaich (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 13 an t-Samhain 1651 BDE by custodians of Cnoc dhubh. Doire fhiadhaich of Cnoc dhubh is a village only by the old rank; it is large, and it has a citadel raised by the Holy Age custodians who held these hills. Làrach an Teampaill lies in the hills to its east. Its people keep the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and will not cut the oaks nearest the ruin. Known for citadel village of Cnoc dhubh.

Doire fhiadhaich (Doire fhiadhaich). Founded 19 an Lùnastal 1018 BDE by the oak-keepers of the south. A wild oak grove in the south, grown into a very large village and the seat of Siorrachd Doire fhiadhaich. It follows the order of Macha and supplies timber to the city of Cathair fhada close by. Known for timber for Cathair fhada.

Doire fhiadhaich (Seann Tarr). Founded 11 am Màrt 1078 DE by Ròdaich woodwards of Seann Tarr. A village in a wild oakwood between Baile Mòr ruadh and the east coast. It lives on timber and on the boar hunts that the city's families come out for. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for wild oakwood and boar.

Doire fhionn (Caol shean). Founded 19 an Lùnastal 2330 BDE by woodsmen of the eastern hills. Doire fhionn of Caol shean is an oak-grove village on the way to Allt an Àigh. Pilgrims to the stream have lodged in its houses since the Holy Age, and the Library at Muileann chaol stands on the road to the north. Its people follow the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for oak grove on the pilgrims' way.

Doire fhionn (Doire fhionn). Founded 20 am Màrt 2602 BDE by Ròdaich woodsmen of the east. Doire fhionn of the east is the seat of its province, a great village of the Holy Age in an oak grove, which has never been raised to the rank of town despite its size. Its oaks are managed under rules older than the kingdom. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits, and the old field-village of Achadh àrsaidh lies to its north. Known for great oak grove of the east.

Doire fhionn (Doire fhionn). Founded 4 an t-Samhain 1850 BDE by the oak-keepers of the Old Spirits. A fair oak grove in the north, the seat of Siorrachd Doire fhionn and a large village of the Old Spirits. The grove has never been cut for ship-timber, its keepers holding it for the ancestors, and it lies on the road between Cathair naomh and the Tuathaich line. Known for an uncut grove of the ancestors.

Doire fhionn (Doire ghlas). Founded 5 an Dàmhair 443 DE by Ròdaich woodwards; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A Ròdaich village in a grove of pale oaks, left empty at the Severance and resettled by Tuathaich families sent north. Its people keep the Tuathaich Church, and it is one of the northern households where the voyage of Naomh Breandan is still told at the hearth, a telling the Ròdaich druids call superstition. It lives on timber and on the fort at Cnoc leathan nearby. Known for pale oaks and Tuathaich hearth-tellings.

Doire gharbh (Cnoc dhìreach). Founded 5 an t-Iuchar 1230 DE by Ròdaich woodwards of Cnoc dhìreach. A large village in rough oakwood below the Doire uaine hills, walled against the thing that the old inscriptions say walks in those hills. The record gives a more ordinary reason: the walls went up in the Age of Strangers, when the strikes in the eastern district reached its gates. The warm springs of Muileann ruadh lie a short walk east. Known for palisade under the Doire uaine hills.

Doire gharbh (Cuan shean). Founded 2 an Dàmhair 1304 BDE by Ròdaich shipwrights' woodwards. A large walled village in rough oakwood that has supplied timber to the yards at Cuan shean since the Holy Age. When the fleet of Cuan shean was raised in the Long War its hulls were cut here. It follows the order of Manannan, as does most of the west. Known for rough oak for the western fleet.

Doire gheal (Baile ìseal). Founded 10 an Dàmhair 1844 DE by human settlers of the Age of Strangers. A small white oak grove settled by humans in the early years after the Crossing, one of the few human foundations of the north-west. Its people stayed through the Severance and are among the oldest human families on the island. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for one of the oldest human families.

Doire ghlas (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 14 an Gearran 2496 BDE by woodsmen of Cnoc dhubh. Doire ghlas of Cnoc dhubh is a village of grey oaks near Làrach an Teampaill. It was founded in the Holy Age, and its people have guided visitors to the ruin ever since. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for grey oaks by Làrach an Teampaill.

Doire ghlas (Doire ghlas). Founded 7 an t-Iuchar 1266 DE by Ròdaich oak-cutters, resettled by the Tuathaich. A small Ròdaich village in a grey oak grove until the Severance, when the families shepherded north were gathered here before being sent on, and so many stayed that it became the largest settlement in the Tuathaich homeland almost at once. It never took a town's name, and the Tuathaich keep it a village in speech on purpose. It is the seat of Siorrachd Doire ghlas and the heart of the Tuathaich Church, whose priests are said to hold the oldest copy of the voyage of Naomh Breandan here; the library has asked to copy it and been refused. Its wool mills, built with the Moot's money, make the grey twill of the north. Known for the great Tuathaich gathering-village.

Doire ghorm (Seann Skell). Founded 26 an t-Sultain 1755 DE by charcoal-burners of the south-east. Doire ghorm is a grove village of the south-east, founded by charcoal-burners in the long quiet centuries. Its charcoal once fed the smithies of the south coast. It keeps the orthodox rite of Bride's flame, like its neighbours. Known for charcoal for the south-coast smithies.

Doire mhin (Caol mhòr). Founded 3 an Giblean 256 BDE by Ròdaich woodsmen of the Holy Age. An oak-grove village of the Holy Age, Doire mhin was emptied of its Ròdaich families in the years of the Severance and filled by Tuathaich households moved north. It is a large village for its kind, living on the smooth-barked oaks that name it. Its timber goes down to the yards of Caol mhòr, and its people keep the faith of the Church. Known for oak timber for the Caol mhòr yards.

Doire mhin (Doire mhin). Founded 10 an t-Ògmhios 739 BDE by the oak-keepers of the capital's north. A smooth-barked oak grove north of the capital, grown into one of the largest settlements on the island while keeping its village name and customs. It is the seat of Siorrachd Doire mhin and follows the order of Macha. Its people farm for Cathair mhòr and send much of their grain to the tithe-granaries at Baile chrom. Known for the great grove-village of the north road.

Doire mhòr (Muileann chrom). Founded 24 an Giblean 1838 DE by Ròdaich miners under extraction contract. Doire mhòr was cut out of a great oak wood in the Age of Strangers, when the workings east of the capital needed pit-props faster than any Holy Age forester would have felled them. The wood is gone and the village farms the clearing. Known for pit-props from a vanished oak wood.

Doire mhòr (Àth àrsaidh). Founded 24 an t-Sultain 1683 BDE by Ròdaich woodwards; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A great oakwood village, resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance and now one of the largest places they hold, with fourteen thousand people. It lives on timber and charcoal, and its charcoal fed the northern smithies when the ore was no longer theirs to burn. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for great oakwood and charcoal.

Doire naomh (Seann Skell). Founded 14 an t-Iuchar 1214 BDE by druids of the order of Manannan. A holy oak grove in the west near Àth leathan, where the Long War's first battle was fought. It stayed Ròdaich and kept the order of Manannan, and it buried many of the dead of that battle in its grove. The grove is closed to strangers. Known for graves of the Àth leathan dead.

Doire ruadh (Inis bhàn). Founded 24 an Cèitean 1452 DE by hawk-keepers of the north. Doire ruadh is a village of red oaks inland of the Hawk bay, founded in the long quiet centuries by families who kept hawks for the rite of Mòd, the hungry hawk of Acaill. Its birds are still flown at the Hawk order's gatherings in Cnoc bheag. Since the Severance it has lain close to the Tuathaich border and has seen more soldiers than it wishes. Known for red oak grove and hawk-keepers.

Doire shean (Doire shean). Founded 14 an Lùnastal 1810 BDE by the tavern-keepers of the south-west. An old oak grove in the south-west, grown into one of the largest villages on the island and the seat of Siorrachd Doire shean. At its heart is Am Buabhall Fortanach, the most famous tavern on the old roads, which serves juggled buffalo and has stood since the Holy Age. It is a harbour as well, where the hulls of the first fleet of Àth gharbh lie, and follows the order of the Stone. Rathad na Banrighinn, Queen Catriona's stone road from the capital to Inis thais, runs through the village past the tavern. Known for Am Buabhall Fortanach and juggled buffalo.

Doire uaine (Muileann chiar). Founded 13 an Gearran 120 BDE by herders of the Doire uaine hills. Doire uaine is a small village in the hills where inscriptions describe the Hollow Man, something that walked without breathing and attacked anyone who lit a fire in its sight. The village was founded in the Holy Age. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the Hollow Man of the hills.

Doire uaine (Muileann bheag). Founded 16 an Lùnastal 1261 BDE by the grove-keepers of the Old Spirits. A green oak grove in the north-east, not the Doire uaine of the Hollow Man's hills, a confusion the library records note with some weariness. It keeps the Old Spirits and cuts its oak for Muileann bheag. Known for oak for Muileann bheag.

Dùn chiar (Achadh àrsaidh). Founded 2 an Cèitean 2137 BDE by a custodian house guarding the capital's east. Dùn chiar is a hill fort of dusky stone east of Cathair dhearg, called a city for its rank rather than its people, who are few. Its citadel and walls were rebuilt in every age, and it has served as the eastern guard of the capital since the kings of the Holy Age. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha, and its garrison takes part in the rites of Cathair dhearg. Known for dusky hill fort east of the capital.

Dùn chrom (Dùn chrom). Founded 27 an t-Sultain 707 BDE by the lords of the bent hill. A fortified city on a crooked hill in the midlands, seat of Siorrachd Dùn chrom, with a citadel that commands the roads south of the capital. The last battle of the Long War, at Muileann ghlas, was fought within sight of its citadel, and the crown's commanders used its citadel as their headquarters. It follows the order of Macha and is served by the stockyard town of Baile chrom and the ford at Àth mhin. Known for the citadel above Muileann ghlas.

Dùn dhearg (Dùn dhearg). Founded 27 an Giblean 2914 BDE by a custodian house of the eastern hills. Dùn dhearg is the red hill-fort city of the east and the seat of its province, a city of more than twenty-five thousand. The mills of Muileann dhomhain grind its bread and the quarries of Cnoc ghlas built its houses. It keeps the Old Spirits, and its old fort is the site of the province's ancestor feasts. Known for red hill-fort city of the east.

Dùn dhubh (Muileann bheag). Founded 26 an Cèitean 1817 BDE by a custodian house of Muileann bheag. Dùn dhubh is a walled hill fort of dark stone, ranked a city though it holds under three thousand people. It commands the coast road above Muileann bheag and the harbour of Seann Toll. Its walls were raised in the Holy Age and repaired in every age after. A dubhan works stands under its walls, on the old charcoal-burners' ground. Known for black fort over the coast road.

Dùn fhiadhaich (Cnoc naomh). Founded 20 an Giblean 1615 BDE by the lords of the wild hill. A small wild city on a hill south of the capital, near Achadh mhin, which the Great Wave struck. Its hill kept it clear of the water, and it took in the survivors of the villages below. It follows the order of Macha. The clay of its hill makes it the largest pottery on Rodos, and Cathair fhada sells its ware to the north. Known for refuge from the Great Wave.

Dùn gheal (Àth shean). Founded 26 an Dùbhlachd 1065 BDE by a custodian house of the southern approach. The white fort is ranked a city though it holds only a few thousand people, a hill fort limed white so that it could be seen from the capital. It watched the southern road in the Holy Age and has done so since. It now serves as a market for Baile uaine and the farms of Àth shean. Known for white-limed hill fort.

Dùn iséal (Dùn iséal). Founded 10 an Dàmhair 2997 BDE by the custodian house of Dùn iséal. A low fort-city in the east with walls, a citadel and a temple, the seat of Siorrachd Dùn iséal. Its temple is the Hall where Bride's undying flame was first bound, kept by the Ròdaich custodians through every age; the townsfolk themselves keep the Old Spirits, and their ancestor hall beside it is the chief spirit-house of the eastern hills. It stands between the silver seam of Muileann chiar and the hot springs of Muileann ruadh, and it was held by the Ròdaich in the dispute over the silver. It is the market town of the eastern hills and plain, and the market under the Hall is older than the kingdom. The silver, gold and copper of its hills pass through it as blanks for the mint, and the town salts venison and binds books. Known for the Hall of Bride's flame.

Dùn thais (Ros bheag). Founded 23 an Gearran 857 BDE by custodians of the western hills. Dùn thais, the damp fort, is a hill stronghold above the western coast, held by custodians of the vein's western road since the Holy Age. Its walls were rebuilt in the Age of Strangers, when the western harbours began shipping ore, and its citadel has never stood empty since. In An Cogadh Fada its garrison marched to the field of Àth leathan, a short road to the north-east. Known for hill citadel of the western coast.

Dùn thais (Dùn thais). Founded 20 am Màrt 2469 BDE by custodians of the north-eastern hills. Dùn thais of the north-east is a great hill city with a citadel and a temple, the chief place of its province. It lies close to Leabharlann Muileann chaol, and many of the Library's clerks and copyists live in it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, and its temple is sacred to Flidais, lady of the deer. Its tailors and smiths work for the library's clerks and the hill towns, and its own woods give timber. Known for great hill city near the Library.

Dùn thais (Baile Mòr mhòr). Founded 10 an Dàmhair 1545 BDE by custodians of the northern coast. Dùn thais of the north is the northernmost Ròdaich citadel, raised by the Holy Age custodians on the northern coast. Since the Severance it has watched the Tuathaich country. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for northernmost Ròdaich citadel.

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Inis àrsaidh (Seann Skell). Founded 28 am Faoilleach 2923 BDE by Ròdaich fishers of the west. Inis àrsaidh is an island town on the Abhainn naomh in the west, founded in the Holy Age; its ships put to sea from Ros àrsaidh at the river mouth. It was the nearest river port to the field of Àth leathan, and in An Cogadh Fada it supplied the state's forces for the first battle. Its fairground is one of the two grounds where the travelling circus, An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn, pitches. Known for river port near the field of Àth leathan.

Inis àrsaidh (Cnoc ghorm). Founded 28 an t-Sultain 2757 BDE by Ròdaich island-lords, resettled by the Tuathaich. An ancient island city on the north-west coast, all but joined to Ceann dhubh. It was a Ròdaich harbour-city until the Severance and has been Tuathaich since. It follows the faith of the Church and is one of the few Tuathaich harbours with a fleet of its own. Known for the Tuathaich island harbour.

Inis bhàn (Inis bhàn). Founded 16 an Giblean 2587 BDE by Ròdaich boatmen of the white island. Inis bhàn is the great river port of the north-west Ròdaich country and the seat of its province, a town of nearly forty thousand on the Abhainn íseal whose barges run down to Ros gheal on the coast. It is a town of the Hawk order, and its shrines face down the river toward the sea. The Green Death, A' Phlàigh Uaine, struck it in the Age of Strangers. It is one of several towns that claim the dock from which the ships of the Sundering set out, a claim the others dispute and no roll can settle. Known for white-island river port and Hawk-order shrines.

Inis bheag (Inis bheag). Founded 25 an t-Iuchar 1564 BDE by boat-builders of the north-east. Inis bheag is an island town on the Abhainn bheag in the north-east and the seat of its province. Its boatyards have built fishing craft for the coast since the Holy Age and send them down the river to the sea at Caol chrom. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and shares its river with Ros fhionn of the old bridge. Known for boatyards of the small isle.

Inis bheag (Seann Toll). Founded 4 an Dàmhair 755 BDE by the island-keepers of Seann Toll. A small walled harbour on a tidal islet of the north coast, near the holy city of Cathair naomh. It ferries pilgrims from the sea to the holy city and keeps the Old Spirits. Known for the pilgrims' ferry to Cathair naomh.

Inis chrom (Inis chrom). Founded 25 an Giblean 1398 BDE by sailors of the Stone's order from the south-west. Inis chrom is a large walled harbour on a bent island in the mouth of the Abhainn ghorm in the south-west. It has been a port since the Holy Age and its sailors keep the order of the Stone. It lies close to Am Buabhall Fortanach and Àth gharbh. Known for bent isle harbour and its sailors of the Stone.

Inis ìseal (Cnoc bheag). Founded 11 an Dùbhlachd 820 DE by the garrison of Cnoc bheag. Inis ìseal is a low island in the Abhainn ìseal above Cnoc bheag, fortified in the long quiet centuries to guard that town's river and walled again in the Age of Strangers. Since the Severance it has been a frontier fortress facing the Tuathaich border, supplied by boats that come up the river from Ros gheal. The Green Death, A' Phlàigh Uaine, struck its garrison in the Age of Strangers, and it is a city by rank and a barracks in practice. The fortress keeps its own boatyard and weaving-sheds, and its cheese goes down the river to Ros gheal. Known for island fortress guarding Cnoc bheag.

Inis ìseal (Muileann chrom). Founded 12 an Giblean 1071 DE by Ròdaich river boatmen. Inis ìseal is a river port on a low island in the Abhainn uaine, a short way from the landing at Cidhe Beag. It is the rival of Ceann fhada a short way upstream, and the two have disputed tolls in every age. It prospered in the Age of Strangers carrying ore and has kept its trade by carrying grain. Known for river-island port on the Abhainn uaine.

Inis leathan (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 29 an Giblean 1259 DE by ferryman of the broad isle. Inis leathan is a village on a broad island in the lower Abhainn fhionn near the north coast, founded in the long quiet centuries by ferryman who ran boats to either bank. In the Age of Strangers its ferry carried supplies to the tavern and mill at Muileann fhada. It still keeps the ferry, and little else. Known for ferryman of the broad isle.

Inis mhin (Inis mhin). Founded 17 an Gearran 1152 DE by Ròdaich harbour-folk; resettled by the Tuathaich. Inis mhin was a Ròdaich harbour of the long quiet centuries on a tidal islet of the north coast, and its citadel was raised in the Age of Strangers by human administrators guarding the northern landing. After the Severance it passed wholly to the Tuathaich, and it is now one of their chief ports. It is among the coastal towns where the voyage of Naomh Breandan is still told, and its church keeps the old Tuathaich telling more closely than the churches of its neighbours. In the first spring of the Severance war the Leaden Hawk company, Buidheann an t-Seabhaig Luaidhe, lay twelve hours in the town and heard of the constables riding the western roads. Known for Tuathaich port where Naomh Breandan's voyage is told.

Inis mhin (Achadh naomh). Founded 18 an t-Samhain 1702 BDE by seal-hunters of the eastern coast. A smooth low island joined to the shore by a causeway, walled, with a small harbour. The seal-hunters who settled it in the Holy Age became traders and then wall-builders, since the eastern waters were a haunt of pirates in the Age of Strangers. It keeps the Old Spirits and is the harbour for Àth chaol and Achadh naomh. Known for causeway harbour and seal-oil.

Inis mhòr (Seann Vell). Founded 12 an t-Sultain 691 DE by boatmen of Seann Vell. An island town on the Abhainn fhionn, settled in the long quiet centuries by boatmen from Seann Vell upriver, Inis mhòr was walled once the capital's eastern approaches became worth defending. A' chiad rèisimeid, raised in the campaign of An Cogadh Fada, is stationed here and bears the town's name. Its barracks now outsize the old fishing quarter, and it lies within sight of the temple town of Cuan uaine, a little downriver; what it ships goes down the river to Cathair dhomhain. The white sand of its river banks goes to its glass-house. Known for barracks of the First Regiment.

Inis mhòr (Inis mhòr). Founded 31 an Lùnastal 2037 BDE by net-fishers of the Abhainn ghorm. Inis mhòr of the north-east is the great river port of its province, on the Abhainn ghorm, a fishing town of the Holy Age that became a city under the Age of Strangers' trade; its barges run down the river to Ros chiar at the mouth. Its people follow the druid schools of the Old Faith, and the town's debating halls were among the first to reopen at the schools' revival. It shares the river and coastal trade with Ceann bheag and the walled town of Baile Mòr dhìreach inland. Known for north-eastern river fleet and debating halls.

Inis naomh (Tobar ghorm). Founded 9 am Faoilleach 478 BDE by keepers of the holy isle. Inis naomh is a walled harbour on a holy tidal isle of the north coast, reached on foot at low water, founded in the Holy Age. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Its walls were built to keep the isle's shrine safe from raiders. Known for holy isle and its walled landing.

Inis thais (Inis thais). Founded 21 an Lùnastal 2636 BDE by druids of the order of the Stone. Inis thais is a walled temple city of the south-west and the seat of its province. Its temple of Lia Fàil, the stone called Clach that cries out under the rightful king, is the chief house of the order of the Stone, and pilgrims come to it from Caol leathan and the whole western coast. It has been a holy city since the Holy Age. Besides its pilgrims it lives on its shipyard, which builds seagoing hulls for the western coast, and on its cheese and books. Buidheann an t-Seabhaig Luaidhe, the Leaden Hawk company sent by the council in the Severance war, ended its road at the temple here; the druids of Lia Fàil kept the city out of the war but shut its harbour to the Company's ships. Known for the temple of Lia Fàil and its pilgrims.

Inis uaine (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 3 an t-Ògmhios 941 DE by boatmen of the Abhainn chaol. Inis uaine is a river town on a green island in the Abhainn chaol in the east, founded in the long quiet centuries; its boats go down to the sea at Seann Mhòrn. In An Cogadh Fada, An t-ochdamh rèisimeid was raised here to guard the eastern dubhan tanks and took the town's name, and the barracks have changed the town's trade from fish to soldiers' wants. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for barracks of the Eighth Regiment.



Muileann àrsaidh (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 10 an t-Iuchar 555 BDE by Ròdaich millers; resettled by the Tuathaich. Muileann àrsaidh, the ancient mill, is the younger of the two Muileann àrsaidh in the Tuathaich north-west, founded as a Ròdaich mill town in the Holy Age; the seat of the shire is the elder town close by. It was walled in the Age of Strangers and resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. The mill still grinds for the surrounding villages. Known for the old mill of the north-west.

Muileann àrsaidh (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 2 an Gearran 621 BDE by Ròdaich millers, resettled by the Tuathaich. An ancient mill town of the north-west, and seat of Siorrachd Muileann àrsaidh, resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A second Muileann àrsaidh lies close by, and the two are called the elder and the younger. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for the elder of the two ancient mills.

Muileann àrsaidh (Cnoc thais). Founded 20 an Giblean 1740 DE by Ròdaich millers, resettled by the Tuathaich. The younger of the two Muileann àrsaidhs, walled, a short distance from the elder. Gorta Baile chrom, the Great Hunger, struck it in the Age of Strangers, and it was resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for the younger ancient mill.

Muileann àrsaidh (Dùn thais). Founded 19 am Faoilleach 1329 BDE by a custodian house of Dùn thais. Muileann àrsaidh is an ancient mill fortified with a citadel, a short way from Muileann chaol. The citadel guarded the road to the ore in the Holy Age and now guards the road to the library. It is a small place of fewer than two thousand. Known for fortified ancient mill.

Muileann bhàn (Muileann bhàn). Founded 8 am Màrt 272 DE by a custodian house of the ore road. Muileann bhàn is a town of thirty-four thousand with a citadel, the seat of its province, standing where the ore road from the eastern diggings met the mills. In the Age of Strangers its citadel held the human administration's weighing-house and its guards. The mills have turned to grain since the Severance, and the Old Spirits, the folk tradition of the ancestors, never lost here, have returned to the square. Known for white mills and citadel of the ore road.

Muileann bheag (Muileann bheag). Founded 23 an Giblean 1210 BDE by grain-millers of the north-east. A small mill that grew into a sizable town and the seat of Siorrachd Muileann bheag. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and grinds for the harbour at Ros chiar. It shares its name with three others on the island, including the Tuathaich lighthouse town. Known for flour for the north-east harbours.

Muileann bheag (Muileann leathan). Founded 14 an Giblean 1491 DE by Ròdaich millers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A small mill town on the north coast beside Taigh-solais Muileann bheag, one of the five lighthouses built in the Age of Strangers. It became Tuathaich at the Severance, and the Tuathaich lighthouse-keepers tended the beacon for the kingdom until it was converted to dubhan. It follows the Tuathaich Church. Known for Taigh-solais Muileann bheag.

Muileann bheag (Caol fhiadhaich). Founded 31 an Cèitean 1256 DE by wardens of the panther roads. Muileann bheag is a fort with a citadel north of Baile dhomhain, whose fields the panthers of Imrich nam Pantar cross. It is not the Muileann bheag of the northern lighthouse. Travellers stop at Am Buabhall Fort-anach nearby, and the first fleet lies at Àth gharbh a short way west. Known for citadel north of the panther roads.

Muileann bheag (Cuan ghlas). Founded 23 an t-Sultain 689 DE by millers of Cuan ghlas. Muileann bheag is a mill town of fourteen thousand grinding for Inis mhòr and Caol bheag. Its mills are among the busiest in the north. It is one of several places named Muileann bheag, and not the fort above the panther roads nor the town of the northern lighthouse. Known for mills for Inis mhòr and Caol bheag.

Muileann chaol (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 12 am Màrt 429 BDE by grain-millers of the Holy Age. The smaller and older of the two Muileann chaols, a narrow mill beside a small keep in the eastern hills. The great library stands in its namesake to the south-east, and the library's carriers are said still to bring misaddressed parcels here. It is a town of the druid schools, and its mill feeds the villages of Achadh gharbh and Tobar dhubh. Known for the library's misaddressed parcels.

Muileann chaol (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 24 an Dùbhlachd 469 DE by millers of the narrow race. A narrow mill town in the eastern hills, and the home of Leabharlann Muileann chaol, the library that keeps the most complete record of the island. The library was founded in the new kingdom and has since taken in the provincial archives, and its war archive is sealed. The town lives on the library and on the river landing at Ceann dhomhain, and to put a thing in the Library is to settle it. Paper has been made here since the Age of Sundering, and its copyists and binders work for the library. Known for Leabharlann Muileann chaol, the great library.

Muileann chiar (Achadh shean). Founded 10 an Gearran 2901 BDE by keepers of the sacred forest. Muileann chiar of Achadh shean stands at the edge of Coille Naomh Muileann chiar, the forest marked sacred before any faith claimed it. Its people were party to the holy-wood dispute of the Holy Age and have kept the forest's edge since. Tiormachd Achadh shean, the Long Drought, struck it in the Age of Strangers. It is not the silver town of the same name. Its smiths make arms for the east coast. Known for keepers of the sacred forest's edge.

Muileann chiar (Seann Bhral). Founded 10 an t-Iuchar 200 DE by millers of the Seann Bhral country. A dusky mill town with a citadel in the south-east, not the silver town of the same name further north; the confusion of the two is an old grievance here. It grinds for Àth chiar and the harbour of Seann Bhral. It keeps the Old Spirits. Known for the other Muileann chiar.

Muileann chiar (Muileann chiar). Founded 23 an t-Iuchar 326 DE by ore-crushers of the eastern diggings. Muileann chiar, seat of the province of the same name, began as an ore-crushing mill for the diggings in the hills east of the capital. It grew large in the Age of Strangers, when the district was worked by the ton, and lost its trade when Scàineadh Cill ghlas, a short way west, closed the district for a generation. It is not the silver town of the same name further east, and the two are often confused in the older records. Known for ore mills of the eastern district.

Muileann chiar (Dùn ìseal). Founded 10 an Lùnastal 2992 BDE by Ròdaich custodians who found the silver seam. Muileann chiar was founded when a silver seam was found near, but distinct from, the great vein, the island's first confirmed resource that was not obsidian. In the Age of Strangers human interests tried to claim the silver as well, and the Ròdaich kept it; the town grew alongside the obsidian workings as demand for both rose. It is smaller now than in its great years. Known for the island's silver seam.

Muileann chrom (Seann Skell). Founded 22 an Cèitean 1187 DE by Ròdaich millers of the Seann Skell country. A crooked mill on the edge of the north-west, left in Ròdaich hands when the Tuathaich homeland was fixed around it. It keeps the order of Manannan, whose sea-feasts its Tuathaich neighbours keep beside their church's, and its millers have ground for both peoples since the Severance, which the chroniclers note without comment. Cnoc ghlas and Àth àrsaidh over the line buy its flour. Known for a Ròdaich mill on the Tuathaich line.

Muileann chrom (Muileann chrom). Founded 11 an Gearran 1443 BDE by Ròdaich millers on the river bend. The mill on the bend of the river gave its name to the town and then to the province, of which it is the seat and the largest place. It ground grain for the whole central country and, in the Age of Strangers, for the camps east of it as well. It is a busy, unwallled town that has never needed walls, standing between Cathair mhòr and Ceann leathan on the road that joins them. From the last years of the humans' rule the Company's railway ran from its pits down to the quay at Ros dhomhain, and the kingdom's Rail Board keeps its yards here. The ore line, the railway the Company laid to Cathair dhearg, was built from its yards. Known for the great mill on the river bend.

Muileann chrom (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 27 an Gearran 432 DE by millers of Tobar fhiadhaich. A mill town on the north coast, grinding for Tobar fhiadhaich and the upland farms behind it. It is one of several places named Muileann chrom and is not the great mill town of the central country. It is a quiet town of millers and inshore fishers. Known for north-coast mill of Tobar fhiadhaich.

Muileann dhearg (Inis bheag). Founded 15 an Giblean 1527 DE by red-stone millers. A red mill town beside Muileann fhada in the north-east, the two together grinding for Doire chiar. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for red mill beside Muileann fhada.

Muileann dhearg (Muileann dhearg). Founded 2 an t-Ògmhios 1820 BDE by Ròdaich millers of the central country. The red mill is the seat of its province and one of the largest towns of the centre, standing between Seann Chwen and Cnoc ghorm. Its mills stamped ore in the Age of Strangers and turned back to grain after the Severance. It is a town of the capital's order, the order of Macha, busy and unwallled. Known for stamping mills turned to grain.

Muileann dhearg (Muileann chrom). Founded 26 an Gearran 758 DE by millers of Muileann chrom. A walled mill town on the road north of Muileann chrom, one of three places named Muileann dhearg. It was walled in the Age of Strangers to protect its stores. It follows the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for walled red mill.

Muileann dhearg (Muileann dhearg). Founded 30 an t-Sultain 38 BDE by ore-millers of the central diggings. Muileann dhearg, seat of its province, is a mill town a short way from Cill ghlas. Sàineadh Cill ghlas tore open the hills nearby and killed dozens, and the town's mills stood idle for a generation after. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for red mill beside Cill ghlas.

Muileann dhìreach (Achadh chaol). Founded 17 an Lùnastal 1567 BDE by the custodian house of Achadh chaol. Muileann dhìreach was raised to grind the barley of Achadh chaol, and its mill-race still runs straight as a ruled line from the stream above the town. In the Age of Strangers it ground for the camps as well as for its own people, and the tithe clerks kept a counting-room beside the wheel. A reading-house of the druid schools stands on the square, and the miller's guild and the school have shared its bell since before anyone wrote the arrangement down. Known for grain mills on the straight race.

Muileann dhomhain (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 8 an t-Iuchar 1252 BDE by the millers of the deep race. A mill on a deep, fast race in the central country and the seat of Siorrachd Muileann dhomhain. It was a milling town for centuries and grew rich carrying grain to the mining settlements in the Age of Strangers, when the camps could no longer feed themselves. It keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich, and its grain-exchange still sets the price of flour for the south-east. Known for the grain-exchange of the south-east.

Muileann dhomhain (Dùn iséal). Founded 23 am Màrt 362 BDE by Ròdaich millers of Dùn iséal. The deep mill takes its name from a mill-race cut far down into the rock to reach a steady flow. It grinds for Dùn dhearg and the villages around it and has done so since the Holy Age. The Old Spirits, the folk tradition of the ancestors, hold here, and each new mill-stone is blessed at the hearth before it is set. Known for its deep-cut mill-race.

Muileann dhomhain (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 9 an t-Samhain 1582 BDE by Ròdaich millers of the south-east. Muileann dhomhain, seat of its province, is a town of twenty thousand built around deep mill-pools fed from the hills. Its flour goes down to the quays of Ceann chaol and out by sea, and the two towns have depended on each other since the Holy Age. It is not the smaller Muileann dhomhain of Dùn iséal to the north. Known for deep mill-pools feeding Ceann chaol's ships.

Muileann dhubh (Achadh naomh). Founded 27 an Dùbhlachd 980 DE by millers of Achadh naomh. The black mill stands on the northern road near Tobar ghorm, grinding for the villages of Achadh naomh province. Its wheel was darkened, the old telling says, by ore dust carried downstream from the mining roads. It is a small town and has always been one. Known for black mill of the northern road.

Muileann fhada (Baile Mòr dhomhain). Founded 8 an Dàmhair 2449 BDE by millers of the northern mining road. Muileann fhada, the long mill, is a small walled town on the old mining road of the north. An Taigh-seinnse Reòta stands at its edge, one of the great taverns of the old circuit. Colbh Cnoc chiar stands to the west, and the town's people say the stone's two words are older than any mill. Known for An Taigh-seinnse Reòta on the mining road.

Muileann fhada (Baile ghorm). Founded 16 an t-Samhain 578 DE by millers of the house of Tormod mac Ruairidh. A long mill-race cut beside a south-eastern stream gave the town its name and its living, grinding the grain of the farms about the other Baile ghorm. Its walls were raised in the Age of Strangers, when the roads past Làrach an Dùin carried ore-wagons and the thieves who followed them. It keeps the Old Spirits, and the millers still leave the first sack of each season at the race-head for the ancestors. Cnoc bhàn on the hill above buys most of its flour. Known for the long mill-race and first-sack offering.

Muileann fhada (Doire chiar). Founded 10 am Màrt 746 DE by millers of Doire chiar. A long mill in the north-east beside Muileann dhearg, grinding for the large village of Doire chiar. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for flour for Doire chiar.

Muileann fhada (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 21 an Giblean 1759 BDE by millers of the Ros fhionn river. A long mill-house on the Ros fhionn gave the place its name, and a river quay below it made it a port, sending flour downstream by barge. Its walls date from the Age of Strangers, when a tithe store was kept here and needed guarding. Trade on the river dried up when the carts took the traffic, and the crossing of Drochaid Ros fhionn just upstream is now rarely used; the town has shrunk to its walls. Known for a river port gone quiet.

Muileann fhionn (Caol mhòr). Founded 12 an t-Iuchar 1802 DE by human administrators of the northern landing. Muileann fhionn was built as a fort and mill by human administrators in the Age of Strangers, to guard the northern landing. After the Severance it became a Tuathaich town. It keeps the faith of the Church. Since the Severance it has been the market town of the north-western interior and the greatest cattle-market on Rodos. Its own trade is in paper and books. Known for strangers' fort of the north.

Muileann fhionn (Seann Chwen). Founded 1 an Cèitean 1365 DE by millers of the Ceann leathan country. A fair-stoned walled mill town between Ceann leathan and Cuan dhearg, grinding grain landed at Ceann leathan's harbour and Cuan dhearg's river landing. Its walls went up in the Age of Strangers. It follows the order of Macha. Known for grain milled for two landings.

Muileann gharbh (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 12 am Màrt 1812 DE by a human ore concern. Muileann gharbh, the rough mill, was built in the Age of Strangers to crush ore on the road down to the eastern harbours. When the mountain was worked day and night the mill never stopped, and the town grew no larger than the mill needed. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith, whose teachers found many hearers among the mill hands. Known for rough mill of the ore road.

Muileann gheal (Dùn dhearg). Founded 7 an Dàmhair 1043 DE by white-stone millers. A white stone mill in the south-east that grinds for the city of Dùn dhearg. It keeps the Old Spirits and is a large mill-town with a guild of millers older than the city's walls. Known for flour for Dùn dhearg.

Muileann gheal (Muileann chiar). Founded 20 an Lùnastal 1841 DE by a mining crew under the human administration. Muileann gheal was a walled mill-camp under the Doire uaine hills, built in the Age of Strangers to crush ore from the eastern diggings. It is small, fewer than seven hundred people. The warm springs of Muileann ruadh lie a short walk away, and the camp's miners bathed there. Known for walled mill-camp under Doire uaine.

Muileann ghlas (Dùn chrom). Founded 16 an t-Samhain 2251 BDE by Ròdaich millers of Dùn chrom. The grey mill is an old grain town near the fair at Muileann òg and within a day of the capital. It is remembered above all for the Battle of Muileann ghlas, the second and final major battle of An Cogadh Fada, fought on its fields, in which the Tuathaich holdouts were broken. The battlefield, Àraich Muileann ghlas, lies just north-west of the town. Known for the last battle of the Long War.

Muileann leathan (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 23 an Lùnastal 1942 DE by Tuathaich millers. Muileann leathan of the north-west was built by Tuathaich settlers soon after the Severance to grind grain for the northern villages, which had lost the Ròdaich mills to the south. It is a small town, and its mill-race was dug by hand by the first households. It keeps the faith of the Church. Amber washed up on the nearby shore is its other trade. Known for Tuathaich grain mill.

Muileann leathan (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 15 an Dùbhlachd 1253 BDE by the millers of the wide stream. A broad mill on a slow river, old enough that its founding is recorded only in the king-lists of the Holy Age. It grinds for the coast-town of Seann Mhòrn and for the villages round Àth àrsaidh, and its people keep the Old Spirits. The temple ruins of Làrach an Team-paill lie in the hills behind it, and the millers will not quarry them. Known for wide mill-wheels, grain for Seann Mhòrn.

Muileann leathan (Muileann leathan). Founded 24 an Giblean 2880 BDE by Ròdaich millers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A wide mill on a northern stream, walled with a citadel, and the seat of Siorrachd Muileann leathan. It was a Ròdaich town until the Severance, when the Tuathaich took it over as one of the principal towns of their homeland. It is a centre of the Tuathaich Church, and its keep is where the Tuathaich northern coast is governed. Known for the Tuathaich mill-citadel.

Muileann leathan (Ceann mhin). Founded 16 an Dàmhair 1384 DE by millers of Ceann mhin. A walled mill town a short way inland from Ceann mhin, whose broad mill-pool is the largest on that coast. It was walled when Ceann mhin was, in the Age of Strangers, to protect its stores. Its flour goes to the ships at Ceann mhin and never to the rival quays of Ceann chaol. Known for broad mill serving Ceann mhin.

Muileann mhin (Baile fhiadhaich). Founded 18 an Gearran 1560 DE by millers of the west. Muileann mhin of Baile fhiadhaich is a mill town of the west, founded in the long quiet centuries on a stream that turns smooth stones. It grinds for the harbour at Baile fhiadhaich. It keeps the order of Manannan, and its millers are known for honest measures. Known for smooth-stone mill of the west.

Muileann mhin (Muileann mhin). Founded 20 an t-Iuchar 1541 BDE by millers of the capital country. Muileann mhin is a large river town on the Abhainn fhionn east of the capital and the seat of its province. Its flour mills have fed the capital since the Holy Age. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha and ships its flour down the river to Cathair dhomhain and along the shore to Cathair dhearg and Ros dhomhain. Known for the capital's flour mills.

Muileann mhin (Tobar ghorm). Founded 8 an t-Iuchar 617 DE by millers of Tobar ghorm. Muileann mhin grinds the fine flour of Tobar ghorm, a short way east, and has risen and fallen with the larger village's harvests in every age. Its wheels are the oldest still turning in the province, and the miller families keep a roll of their masters going back to the Age of Sundering. In fair season the carts from the wool fairs come back loaded with its flour. Known for fine flour for Tobar ghorm.

Muileann naomh (Muileann naomh). Founded 4 an t-Ògmhios 2400 BDE by druids of the order of Manannan. A holy mill in the west, the seat of Siorrachd Muileann naomh, whose wheel is said to have been consecrated to Manannan mac Lir. It lies near the Àth leathan battlefield and was taken over by crown regiments in the Long War. It follows the order of Manannan. Known for the consecrated mill-wheel.

Muileann naomh (Muileann naomh). Founded 16 an t-Iuchar 88 DE by druids of Òrd Bhrìde. A holy mill in the south, the seat of Siorrachd Muileann naomh, whose druids of the orthodox order of Bride's flame bless the grain before it is ground. It is one of the few towns of Òrd Bhrìde and trades with Caol ruadh and Seann Skell. Its hawk-house was the southernmost of Òrd an t-Seabhaig, the first on Rodos to hang a bronze bell, until it took Òrd Bhrìde's written order in the first years of the restored kingdom; the bell now rings for Bride's flame. Known for grain blessed by the druids of Bride's flame.

Muileann òg (Dùn chrom). Founded 10 am Faoilleach 1950 DE by millers of the restored kingdom. Muileann òg, the young mill, was built in the first years of the restored kingdom. Its annual fair, Fèill Muileann òg, became the island's largest gathering. The field of Muileann ghlas, where An Cogadh Fada ended, lies close by. Rathad na Fèille, the fair road, was metalled from Cathair dhearg in the fair's first years. Known for Fèill Muileann òg, the great fair.

Muileann ruadh (Doire fhionn). Founded 29 an Giblean 1416 BDE by Ròdaich millers of the north. Muileann ruadh of Doire fhionn is a mill town of the north-central country, founded in the Holy Age. Its citadel was raised after the Severance to watch the Tuathaich border. It keeps the Hawk order of the Old Faith. Known for red mill and border citadel.

Muileann ruadh (Cnoc naomh). Founded 14 an Lùnastal 1346 DE by red-sandstone millers. A small mill-town built of red sandstone, grinding for Baile chrom and the village of Cill fhada. It was never walled, relying on Baile chrom's walls in hard times. Its people keep the order of Macha, and the mill-house has a small shrine to Macha's black horse above the wheel. Known for red sandstone mill-house.

Muileann ruadh (Dùn ìseal). Founded 11 an t-Ògmhios 2594 BDE by keepers of the hot springs. A red walled mill town beside Fuarain Theth Muileann ruadh, the hot springs whose warm water drives its wheel through winter. The springs were held sacred by the Old Spirits, and the healers of the Old Faith call them Dian Cècht's, and the town walled them against claims from the human administration. It is a place for the sick and the old to bathe. Known for the hot springs of Muileann ruadh.

Muileann ruadh (Cnoc leathan). Founded 15 am Faoilleach 151 DE by Ròdaich millers of Cnoc leathan. Muileann ruadh is a walled mill town near An Taigh-òsta Grianach, the great inn of the eastern road. Its walls were raised when the inns fortified before the war, and the town and the inn have shared a watch ever since. The eastern Toll-dubh, the shaft of the Old Ones that charcoal-burners found again in the Age of Sundering and the custodians walled up, lies close by, and the townsfolk keep away from it. It is not the Muileann ruadh of the warm springs to the west. Known for red mill on the inn road.

Muileann shean (Muileann shean). Founded 1 an t-Samhain 1906 BDE by the first millers of the northern river. The old mill of the north, whose wheel the Holy Age king-lists already call ancient, and the seat of Siorrachd Muileann shean. Its walls went up in the Age of Strangers, when it ground grain for the mining camps on contract and was raided for it. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and owns the well-village of Tobar ìseal below it. Known for the oldest mill-wheel in the north.

Muileann uaine (Muileann dhomhain). Founded 8 am Màrt 1827 DE by a human milling concern with Ròdaich labour. Muileann uaine was built in the Age of Strangers as a crushing mill for ore from the interior workings. It is not the Muileann uaine of the Cnoc bheag country that the Green Death struck, though the two are often confused. It is a small town now and keeps the orthodox rite of Òrd Bhride. Known for ore-crushing mill of the interior workings.

Muileann uaine (Cnoc bheag). Founded 3 an t-Sultain 406 BDE by druids of the Hungry Hawk. A green mill in the wooded middle west, one of the few towns where Òrd an t-Seabhaig, the Hawk order, whose rite is the older form of Òrd Bhride's, still holds. The carved hawk over the mill-door is said to be as old as the Binding of the First Flame. A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death, struck it in the Age of Strangers, and since then the second sense of 'uaine' has clung to its name. Known for the Hawk-order mill.

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Ros àrsaidh (Ros bheag). Founded 16 an t-Ògmhios 1778 BDE by custodians of the western headland. Ros àrsaidh is a small walled harbour on an ancient headland of the west, fortified by the Holy Age custodians. It lies within the province of Ros bheag and has always stood in the shadow of that citadel. It keeps the order of Manannan. The coast road north from Ros bheag, Ceum Ros àrsaidh, starts below its walls; Strake's constables held it in the last months of the Severance war. Known for walled harbour on the ancient headland.

Ros bhàn (Seann Chwen). Founded 24 an Lùnastal 65 DE by the garrison of the gulf mouth. Ros bhàn is a fortified headland at the mouth of the gulf, walled and given a citadel in the long quiet centuries to guard the harbours within. It is a city by rank, though most of its people are soldiers, customs clerks and their families. The white stone of its headland gives it its name. The customs town also boils soap and blows glass for the gulf. Known for fortified headland at the gulf mouth.

Ros bheag (Ros bheag). Founded 4 am Faoilleach 1362 BDE by custodians of the western coast. Ros bheag is the citadel harbour and provincial seat of the western coast, holding Dùn thais and Ros àrsaidh within its province. It was fortified in the Holy Age and has been the western sea's naval station through every age since. Its people keep the order of Manannan. It is the market town of the west coast, and its own trade is in books, boots and salted food. Known for citadel harbour of the western coast.

Ros chiar (Ceann bheag). Founded 1 an t-Iuchar 2992 BDE by the headland-lords of Ceann bheag. A dusky headland city on the north coast, walled, with a citadel on the rock and a harbour below. It was one of the harbours the human traders first used after the Crossing, and its citadel was taken and retaken in the war before the Severance. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and competes with Caol bheag for the northern trade. Slighe-uisce fhuar, the cold way along the north coast to Caol mhin, begins at its harbour; the grain barges of Inis mhòr sailed it until the roads took their trade. Known for the fortified headland harbour.

Ros chiar (Muileann bheag). Founded 19 an Lùnastal 1449 DE by fishers of Muileann bheag. A dusky headland harbour village on the north-east coast that ships the flour of Muileann bheag. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and competes with Seann Toll for the coast trade. Known for the flour harbour of Muileann bheag.

Ros dhìreach (Cnoc bheag). Founded 30 an Lùnastal 586 DE by fishers of the Hawk coast. Ros dhìreach of Cnoc bheag is a walled fishing village on the north-central coast, founded in the long quiet centuries. A' Phlàigh Uaine, the Green Death, struck it in the Age of Strangers. It was walled after the Severance, when the Tuathaich coast became a frontier. It keeps the rite of the Hawk order. Known for walled fishing village of the Hawk coast.

Ros dhìreach (Cnoc mhòr). Founded 22 an t-Ògmhios 37 DE by Ròdaich harbour-folk of the gulf. Ros dhìreach of Cnoc mhòr is a harbour on a straight headland of the gulf, founded in the long quiet centuries. It is a city by rank and the harbour of Cnoc mhòr's cattle trade. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Its clay-pits feed its potteries, and its soap-boilers serve the gulf. Known for straight headland harbour.

Ros dhomhain (Ros dhomhain). Founded 27 am Faoilleach 1232 DE by merchant families of the capital shore. Ros dhomhain is the most populous place of the capital country, a merchant port that outgrew every wall it was ever given until no one built another. The first human traders lodged here after the Crossing, and its counting-houses have served every master of the island's trade since. It sits between the capital and the old harbour of Seann Vell, and the three have run together into one shore. The Company's railway, the ore line, came down to its deep-water quay from the pits at Muileann chrom in the last years of Edward Vane's commission, and the first steamer seen on Rodos had come into its harbour half a century before. In the present year its quay became the one place on the island where dubhan may be loaded for beyond the island, under the charter Dubhan won from the council: a clerk of the Treasury takes the tithe on every barrel, and the custodians of Bride's order seal every hold. Known for the capital country's great merchant port.

Ros fhionn (Caol shean). Founded 10 am Màrt 1737 BDE by Ròdaich river-folk of the east. Ros fhionn of Caol shean is a small citadel city on the Abhainn chaol in the east, near the stream of Allt an Àigh. It is where most pilgrims to the stream come ashore from the river boats that bring them up from Seann Mhorn, and its citadel was raised in the Age of Sundering to guard them. It is not the Ros fhionn of the old bridge, which lies to the north. Known for river landing of the Allt an Àigh pilgrims.

Ros fhionn (Inis bheag). Founded 29 an Lùnastal 2958 BDE by custodians of the river crossing. Ros fhionn of Inis bheag is a walled city on a headland over the Abhainn bheag, founded in the Holy Age where the first bridges crossed the river. Drochaid Ros fhionn, the old crossing, is still standing. It has seen little traffic since the salt went by sea, except for the century when the Company's ore carts crossed it on the eastern ore road, and it fell silent again when the eastern pits flooded in the Severance war. The salt-boats' lane round the east cape, Seòlaid Ros fhionn, is named for the town. Its temple is a hall of the druid schools, sacred to Flidais. The salt trade that built the bridge has gone, but the market-court the salt-masters set up stayed on the headland, and the town is still the market of fifty-three towns of the north-eastern hills, the widest reach of any market. Its yards on the river build barges and hulls, and it makes cheese for the hill towns. Known for Drochaid Ros fhionn, the old bridge.

Ros gharbh (Ros gharbh). Founded 3 am Faoilleach 216 DE by fishers of the rough headland. Ros gharbh is a harbour town on a rough headland of the gulf and the seat of its province. It was founded in the long quiet centuries and grew with the gulf's fishing fleet. Tonn Mhòr Cnoc chaol, the Great Wave, ran up the gulf in 1933, broke its quays and threw the fleet onto the headland, though the town on its height lost few people. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for the gulf's fishing fleet.

Ros gheal (Ros gheal). Founded 29 an Dùbhlachd 1990 BDE by Ròdaich fishers of the white headland. Ros gheal, Ros leathan and Seann Skell share one bay on the north-central coast, and have quarrelled over its moorings for as long as the rolls run. Ros gheal is the largest of the three and the seat of its province. Its people keep the Hawk order's rite of Mòd, and its white headland is the first land the northern fishing boats see coming home. Known for white headland and the disputed bay.

Ros leathan (Ros gheal). Founded 30 am Faoilleach 1735 DE by Ròdaich fishers of the Hawk bay. Ros leathan is a harbour town on the Hawk bay, sharing it with Ros gheal and Seann Skell. It was founded in the long quiet centuries by fishers who would not pay Ros gheal's mooring dues. It keeps the Hawk order of the Old Faith. Known for rival wharves of the Hawk bay.

Ros mhòr (Caol mhòr). Founded 15 an t-Ògmhios 393 DE by Ròdaich fishers; resettled by the Tuathaich. Ros mhòr of the north-west is a harbour on a great headland, founded by Ròdaich fishers in the long quiet centuries. After the Severance it was resettled by the Tuathaich and grew with the northern trade. It lies between the harbours of Caol mhòr and Caol naomh. Known for big headland harbour of the Tuathaich.

Ros ruadh (Seann Chwen). Founded 27 am Faoilleach 61 DE by quarrymen of the red headland. Ros ruadh is a small harbour on the gulf, founded by quarrymen who shipped its red stone to the gulf cities. Much of Ceann leathan and Ros bhàn is built of it. It keeps a ferry to the harbours across the water. Known for red stone for the gulf cities.

Ros ruadh (Ceann mhòr). Founded 29 an t-Iuchar 1636 DE by Ròdaich fishers, resettled by the Tuathaich. A red headland harbour on the north-west coast, one of the Ròdaich harbours given to the Tuathaich after the Severance. The fishing families of Ros ruadh are among those who keep the voyage of Naomh Breandan alive in speech, and some say the saint's boat put out from this headland. It follows the faith of the Church. Known for the Naomh Breandan telling of the north-west.

S

Seann Bhral (Baile àrsaigh). Founded 5 an Dàmhair 12,845 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Bhral of the west coast is a Seann-Dhaoine site the Ròdaich resettled in the Holy Age. It grew into a large port on the western sea roads and took up the order of Manannan, the Old Faith's order of the sea, which is strong along this coast. Its harbour is unwallled, trusting to the citadel at Ros bheag to the north. Known for west-coast harbour of the order of Manannan.

Seann Bhral (Seann Bhral). Founded 30 an Lùnastal 12,578 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Bhral of the south-east is a Seann-Dhaoine site that the Ròdaich resettled in the Holy Age, and it has grown into the greatest harbour of that coast and the seat of its province. It was walled in the Age of Strangers, when its quays shipped ore from the interior. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. Known for the south-east's great walled harbour.

Seann Bhral (Ros gharbh). Founded 9 an t-Samhain 5524 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Bhral is a walled harbour on a Seann-Dhaoine site, settled by the Ròdaich and named by them for the Old Ones. It lies near Làrach an Dùin-fhaire, the ruined outpost no one can date. It is a port town of four thousand. Known for walled old harbour of Ros gharbh.

Seann Bhrenn (Seann Bhrenn). Founded 12 an Giblean 12,930 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. A Seann-Dhaoine harbour on the north coast, called Seann Bhrenn by the Ròdaich, and the seat of the shire of the same name. It is a large village of the Old Spirits, and its fishers tell that the harbour-stones were laid by people who had no need of the Ròdaich's tides. Known for the northern Seann-Dhaoine harbour.

Seann Bhrenn (Ceann mhin). Founded 15 an Lùnastal 12,144 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Bhrenn is an old harbour of the Seann-Dhaoine, settled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age. It lies hard beside Caol gharbh, and the two harbours have quarrelled over the same water for as long as there are records, each claiming the other was built on its fishing ground. It is a port town of nearly nine thousand and the older of the two by its name. Known for old harbour quarrelling with Caol gharbh.

Seann Chwen (Seann Dunn). Founded 1 am Faoilleach 12,033 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. The landing stones at Seann Chwen are of the Seann-Dhaoine, and the name was given by the Ròdaich who resettled the site in the Holy Age. It is a small harbour on the south shore, but its citadel guards the capital's southern sea road, and it has been garrisoned more often than its size would suggest. Its people keep the order of Macha, the capital's order of the Old Faith, and its green is one of the two grounds where the travelling circus, An Siorcas Siubhail Do-thuigsinn, pitches. Known for citadel on the capital's southern sea road.

Seann Chwen (Seann Chwen). Founded 19 an Giblean 12,736 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. The larger Seann Chwen is the chief harbour of the gulf and the seat of the province that bears its name, built on a Seann-Dhaoine site the Ròdaich resettled in the Holy Age. It takes the fish of the gulf and the goods of Cathair mhòr. It has no walls; the fortified headlands of Ros bhàn and Ceann leathan stand to either side of it. Known for the gulf's chief harbour and fish-market.

Seann Chwen (Àth shean). Founded 29 an Lùnastal 9436 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Chwen of Àth shean is a harbour on the south coast, on a Seann-Dhaoine site. It was resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age and is the port for the southern Àth shean. It keeps the capital's order, the order of Macha. Known for south-coast old harbour.

Seann Dunn (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 5 an Cèitean 10,435 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Dunn keeps a Seann-Dhaoine name, and its citadel stands on footings no Ròdaich mason laid. It stands on the Abhainn chaol a little above the river mouth, and is the river landing and lodging-place for those who visit Làrach an Teampaill in the hills to the north, whose ships put in at Seann Mhorn down the coast; its own ancestor hall serves the Old Spirits. An Taigh-seinnse Òir, one of the great taverns of the old mining circuit, stands in the town itself. Its yards are the largest shipyard on Rodos, and the town cuts the sails and makes the cheese of the east coast. Slighe-mhara àrsaidh, the ancient sea-way of the Old Ones, begins at the river mouth below the town and runs round the south-east cape to Ceann chaol. Known for An Taigh-seinnse Òir and the temple road.

Seann Dunn (Seann Dunn). Founded 28 am Faoilleach 12,773 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. The Seann-Dhaoine left the harbour-mole and the name Dunn; the Ròdaich called it Seann Dunn and built a citadel over the mole. It is the seat of the shire of the same name and follows the order of Macha. It is a village in form but large in number, with the ford-town of Àth ghorm under its protection. Known for the Seann-Dhaoine harbour-mole.

Seann Dunn (Baile chaol). Founded 22 an Dùbhlachd 12,794 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. The harbour stones of Seann Dunn are older than any Ròdaich work, and the name the Ròdaich gave the place keeps a root that is not their own. It became a Ròdaich port in the Holy Age, and its citadel was raised above the harbour to guard the eastern approaches. It is now a city of shipping and salt-fish, and its oldest families still claim that the harbour wall was only repaired, never built, by their ancestors. Its yards build seagoing hulls and cut their sails. Known for Seann-Dhaoine harbour stones and citadel.

Seann Mhorn (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 5 an t-Iuchar 12,516 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. The Seann-Dhaoine left the harbour-stones and the name Morn; the Ròdaich, finding both, called the place Seann Mhorn and built on top. It is a walled port with a citadel over the harbour mouth, fought over more than once in the troubles before the Severance, and it keeps the Old Spirits of the Ròdaich. Stones of the older builders are set into the harbour wall, and the fishermen touch one before they sail. Known for Seann-Dhaoine stones in the harbour wall.

Seann Mhorn (Àth chiar). Founded 31 an Cèitean 11,110 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Mhorn is a small old harbour, one of several Seann names on this stretch of the southern coast, and was settled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age. It lies between Seann Skell and Seann Vell. It is a fishing village of three thousand. Known for small old harbour.

Seann Skell (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 10 an Gearran 11,535 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Skell is a Seann-Dhaoine harbour on the far north-west coast, named by the Ròdaich who resettled it; it passed to the Tuathaich after the Severance. Its citadel looks out over the waters where pirate ships are still reported and where old sailors place the Sea-Watcher. It is not the Seann Skell whose name the regiments carry, which lies far to the south-east. Known for watch over the pirate waters.

Seann Skell (Seann Skell). Founded 19 an t-Samhain 11,340 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Skell of the Hawk bay is a walled harbour city on a Seann-Dhaoine site, sharing its bay with Ros gheal and Ros leathan. It was resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age and walled in the Age of Sundering. It keeps the Hawk order of the Old Faith. It is the market town of the Hawk bay and the north-central coast. Amber from the bay's strands is the one good it sells to other markets, and its yards build seagoing hulls. Known for walled old harbour of the Hawk bay.

Seann Skell (Seann Skell). Founded 29 am Faoilleach 4937 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Skell is the great southern port, a town of nearly sixty thousand whose harbour lies on a site the Seann-Dhaoine used before the Ròdaich; the name keeps their root. It is the seat of its province and a centre of Òrd Bhride, the order of Bride's flame. The ninth regiment and the second fleet, raised in the Long War, are stationed here. It shares its name with the great western river port. Glass is blown there from the white sand of its own shore. Known for the southern fleet harbour.

Seann Skell (Seann Skell). Founded 6 an Gearran 12,522 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Skell is the great river port of the west, a city of seventy-four thousand and the largest place on the island, whose barges run down the Abhainn naomh to Ros àrsaidh; its river harbour is a Seann-Dhaoine site and the name keeps their root. It is walled by its citadel rather than by curtain walls, and the seventh regiment, raised in the Long War, is stationed here. The first battle of that war was fought at Àth leathan, a short march north. Known for the great western river port.

Seann Tarr (Muileann bheag). Founded 30 an Cèitean 12,927 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Tarr is a Seann-Dhaoine site on the north-eastern coast, resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age, and its ancestor hall is one of the oldest spirit-houses of the Old Spirits still in use. A citadel was raised over the harbour in the Age of Sundering. It is small for a city, but the shrine draws the whole north-east at the great feasts. It is the market town of the north-eastern coast, whose market began at the shrine's feasts. Honey from its heather and wax for the shrine lights are its own goods, with cheese and books, and its rope-makers are a chartered guild. Known for north-eastern ancestor shrine.

Seann Tarr (Seann Tarr). Founded 25 an Giblean 12,039 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. A harbour of the Seann-Dhaoine on the eastern coast, named Seann Tarr by the Ròdaich, and the seat of the shire of the same name. It is a large village that follows the Old Spirits. The eastern pirates made it unsafe in the Age of Strangers, and it has a small fleet of its own. Known for the old eastern harbour and fleet.

Seann Tarr (Cnoc gheal). Founded 17 an Lùnastal 8218 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Tarr is a small harbour whose landing stones are older than any Ròdaich work, and the root in its name is not Gaelic. Ròdaich fishers settled it in the Holy Age and gave it the name it bears, marking it as a place of the Old Ones. On clear nights the lighthouse of Àth dhearg can be seen from its quay, and its boats steer by it. Known for the Old Ones' landing stones.

Seann Toll (Seann Toll). Founded 8 an t-Samhain 12,898 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Toll, old hollow, is named for the sea-caves under its headland, where Seann-Dhaoine marks are said to be cut into the rock. The Ròdaich resettled it in the Holy Age and it has been a fishing port ever since. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and the northern herring fleet. Known for sea-caves and the north-coast herring.

Seann Toll (Muileann chrom). Founded 8 an Gearran 12,832 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. A Seann-Dhaoine river port on the Abhainn uaine in the midlands, called Seann Toll by the Ròdaich for the hollow in the rock where its boats lie. It is walled and follows the order of Macha, and it stands a short way west of Cill ghlas, where the Rending opened. It lies close to Ceann leathan at the river mouth, where the Còmhrag is fought each year, and fighters from the tournament fill its taverns. Known for the rock-hollow landing and Còmhrag crowds.

Seann Toll (Muileann bheag). Founded 19 an Giblean 10,605 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Toll is a harbour in a cleft of the rock, and its lowest quay is cut in a manner the Ròdaich did not use; it is held to be the work of the Seann-Dhaoine, and nothing more is known of it. The Ròdaich settled it in the Holy Age as the nearest harbour for Dùn dhubh and Muileann bheag. It is a small port town of fishers and lightermen. Known for cleft-rock harbour of the Old Ones.

Seann Vell (Ros dhomhain). Founded 29 an Lùnastal 4041 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Vell on the capital shore stands on Seann-Dhaoine quay stones, still visible at low water beneath the later harbour. The Ròdaich resettled it in the Holy Age and walled it in the long quiet centuries. It has since been drawn into the sprawl of Ros dhomhain, but keeps its own walls and its own harbour-master. Its scent-makers distil the best-known scent on the island. Known for old quay stones of the capital shore.

Seann Vell (Seann Vell). Founded 4 an t-Ògmhios 12,916 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Vell of the south-east is a citadel harbour on a Seann-Dhaoine site, resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age. Its citadel guards the south-eastern coast and the approach to Seann Bhral, its larger neighbour and old rival. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits. The town stands on Eilean dhearg, the island where the Seann-Dhaoine of the older Seann Vell laid their dead. Known for south-eastern citadel harbour.

Seann Vell (Baile mhin). Founded 1 an Gearran 11,723 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Vell of Baile mhin is a small river landing on a Seann-Dhaoine site on the Abhainn bheag in the north-east, a short way above the river mouth at Caol chrom, resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age. It lives on the seal-hunt at the river mouth and the fishing. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for old landing stones and seal-hunters.

Seann Vell (Seann Vell). Founded 16 an Dàmhair 10,889 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Vell of the west coast is a small harbour on a Seann-Dhaoine site, the seat of its province. It was resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age and took up the order of Manannan with the rest of the coast. An ceathramh cabhlach is stationed at Cuan shean, a short way up the coast. Its shire is the humans' old district of the outer coasts, kept whole: the islands of the west and south, Eilean bhàn with Cuan dhearg and Cnoc chaol, and the southern edge of the windy coast in the far north-west. Known for old harbour of the west coast.

Seann Vell (Seann Vell). Founded 1 an t-Ogmhios 9251 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Vell of the capital's east is a walled river town on a Seann-Dhaoine site on the Abhainn fhionn and the seat of its province. It was resettled by the Ròdaich in the Holy Age. An Taigh-seinnse Mòr stands just east of it, at the river quay of Cuan chrom. Known for walled river town on the Cuan chrom road.

Seann Warr (Seann Warr). Founded 27 an Màrt 11,799 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Warr is a Seann-Dhaoine harbour on the capital's western shore, resettled by the Ròdaich and walled in the Holy Age. Its citadel guards the western approaches to the capital. An còigeamh rèisimeid, raised in An Cogadh Fada, is stationed here and carries its name. Its salt-pans have sold salt since the first years of the humans' trade, and the flax of its lake-shore fields, pressed for linseed oil, is grown nowhere else on the island. Loch chrom is fresh, and the town's salt is boiled from brine springs that rise in the reed marsh behind it. Known for the Fifth Regiment's walled harbour.

Seann Warr (Àth chiar). Founded 15 an Gearran 10,679 BDE by the Seann-Dhaoine. Seann Warr of Àth chiar is a small harbour on a Seann-Dhaoine landing on the south shore of the gulf. The Ròdaich resettled it in the Holy Age. It keeps the ancestor rite of the Old Spirits and a few boats, and pays its dues to the larger harbours across the water. Known for old landing on the gulf's south shore.

T

Tobar bhàn (Cnoc gheal). Founded 13 an Cèitean 2031 BDE by well-keepers of the north-eastern shore road. Tobar bhàn is a well village on the north-eastern shore road, named for a spring whose water runs white with chalk. The beacon of Taigh-solais Àth dhearg stands on the coast beyond it, and through the later Age of Strangers the village kept the lamp-keepers in bread and peat. Its people hold to the Old Spirits, the ancestors and the weather, and still leave a cup at the well before a sea-journey. Known for white well and the lighthouse keepers.

Tobar dhearg (Tobar dhearg). Founded 31 an Cèitean 110 BDE by Ròdaich well-keepers of the southern coast. Tobar dhearg is a large village around a well of red water, the seat of its province. Taigh-solais Tobar dhearg, one of the five lighthouses of the Age of Strangers, stands on the shore below it; it burned obsidian-lit flame for over a century before it was converted to dubhan. The village holds to Òrd Bhride, and its druids, keepers of Bride's flame, keep the light's log. Known for the southern lighthouse and red well.

Tobar dhearg (Muileann àrsaidh). Founded 16 an Dùbhlachd 1849 BDE by Ròdaich well-keepers; resettled by the Tuathaich after the Severance. A Ròdaich village around a well of red water, resettled by Tuathaich families after the Severance. Like several villages of this coast it made the shrine of Manannan that it inherited its church rather than raising its own. It lives on sheep and on the market at Cathair gheal. Known for red well of the western Tuathaich.

Tobar dhìreach (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 25 an t-Iuchar 362 DE by well-diggers of Baile thais. A large well village in the central-east, laid out along a straight channel that carries its water. It follows the druid schools of the Old Faith and supplies water and vegetables to Baile Mòr uaine and Baile thais. Its paper-mill makes the paper of the royal chronicle. Known for the straight water-channel.

Tobar dhomhain (Cnoc bheag). Founded 17 an Màrt 1811 DE by miners of the western hills. A deep well-village in the western hills, dug to supply a mining camp that has since been abandoned. It is one of the smallest villages on the island and follows the order of Manannan. The grassland above the village is where the Leaden Hawk company kept its watch on the road from Ros bheag in the first spring of the Severance war. Known for the well of a lost camp.

Tobar dhubh (Cnoc bhàn). Founded 7 an t-Samhain 1409 BDE by Ròdaich well-keepers of Cnoc bhàn. A village around a deep well whose water runs dark, said in the old telling to rise from near the vein. It has never been proved so, and the druid scholars of Cnoc bhàn have argued it both ways. The well still draws visitors who drink from it for luck. Known for the dark well of old telling.

Tobar fhiadhaich (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 10 an t-Samhain 2045 BDE by Ròdaich herders of the northern moor. Tobar fhiadhaich is a large village around a wild spring on the moor, and the seat of its province. It lives on grazing and on the peat of Achadh gharbh. Its herders have walked the same moor paths since the Holy Age, and its spring is said never to have failed, even in the driest years. Known for wild spring and moorland grazing.

Tobar ghorm (Doire fhionn). Founded 27 an Faoilleach 78 BDE by Ròdaich well-keepers of the northern road. A village around a blue spring on the road running north toward the Tuathaich country, and the last Ròdaich water on that road. Since the Severance it has traded with both sides of the line and has been trusted by neither. It is not the larger Tobar ghorm of the wool fairs, and it resents the confusion. Known for blue spring on the northern road.

Tobar ghorm (Tobar ghorm). Founded 31 an Faoilleach 2049 BDE by Ròdaich herders of the northern plain. Tobar ghorm is a large village around a blue spring, the seat of its province, and home to the greatest wool fairs of the north. The fairs were old before the humans came, and the humans' wool-buyers made them larger. The mills of Muileann mhin grind its grain. Known for blue spring and wool fairs.

Tobar ìseal (Tobar fhiadhaich). Founded 26 an Dùbhlachd 505 BDE by the well-keepers of Muileann shean. A low well in a hollow below Muileann shean, ringed with stone in the Holy Age and watched ever since. The small keep that gives it a citadel was built to guard the water for the mill town in dry years, and the dry summers since have proved the builders right. It remains a village, owned in all but name by the millers upstream. Known for the guarded low well.

Tobar iseal (Dùn dhearg). Founded 26 am Faoilleach 469 DE by well-keepers of Dùn dhearg. A low well-village in the east that waters the city of Dùn dhearg in dry seasons. It keeps the Old Spirits, and its well-keepers still bless the water before it is carted up the hill. Known for the well that waters Dùn dhearg.

Tobar òg (Inis bheag). Founded 21 an t-Iuchar 1356 DE by well-diggers of Inis bheag. A young well village in the north-east, dug to water the fields behind Inis bheag when those fields were first broken. It has grown into a sizeable village and follows the druid schools of the Old Faith. Known for the young well behind Inis bheag.

Tobar shean (Cnoc dhubh). Founded 29 an Lùnastal 783 DE by well-keepers of Baile òg. An old well-village in the eastern hills, walled in the troubled years because its well was the only sure water on the road past Làrach an Team-paill. It keeps the Old Spirits, and the well-keepers still close the gate in dry seasons and ration the water by the bucket. Known for the walled well on the temple road.